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Part 1: Introduction to RapidResponse

- ["What is RapidResponse?" on page 15](#)
- ["About Kinaxis" on page 31](#)
- ["New and changed features" on page 33](#)

CHAPTER 1: What is RapidResponse?

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Different capabilities for different users	24

This documentation set (Help and User Guide) supports RapidResponse® from Kinaxis®.

RapidResponse integrates key functional processes in supply chain management (SCM), sales and operations planning (S&OP), and other associated areas. It is a cloud solution that allows companies to dramatically reduce the time it takes to identify plan deviations and make critical course corrections.

Expanding beyond SCM and S&OP, RapidResponse measures the impact of changes (current and future) and allows teams to collaborate on response scenarios across interrelated functions, inside and outside the company.

With RapidResponse, companies benefit from an end-to-end solution in a single product. Users throughout the entire supply chain, from demand managers and customer service representatives to master schedulers and planners have access to these key capabilities:

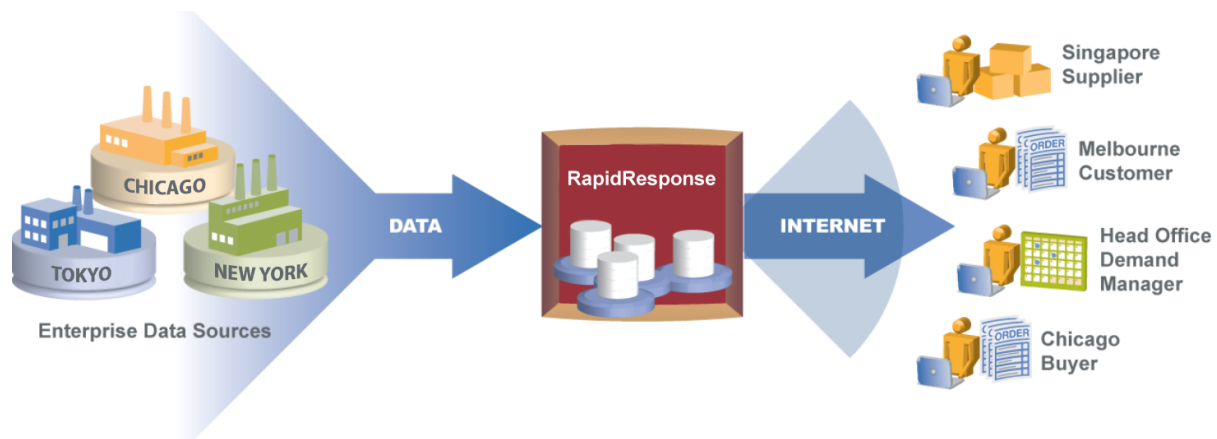
- **Data visibility and reporting**—provides companies with an accurate and dynamic view of their entire supply chain. Data collected from multiple sites and disparate enterprise systems, including key suppliers and contract manufacturers, is transformed into valuable information that provides operational insight, driving improved decision-making and action.
- **Interactive visualizations**—dashboards, treemaps, and chart visualizations fulfill a critical requirement for monitoring key performance indicators (KPIs) and pinpointing the cause of a problem before taking action. Plan deviations are easily identified and the root causes of any issues are quickly discovered, allowing companies to make crucial course corrections in a timely manner.
- **Collaborative what-if analysis**—enables companies to instantly understand the impact of a change on operations by simulating supply chain events and proposed solutions. Numerous scenarios can be created and evaluated by various departments before any corrective actions are taken.
- **Scorecarding**—calculates and compares the scores of multiple what-if scenarios in terms of how well they meet specific individual, departmental, and company-wide metrics and objectives.
- **Alerting and event management**—allows for continuous monitoring of supply and demand activities and automatically generates notifications when exceptions that pose risk to the business occur.

Key concepts in RapidReponse

The following concepts are important for understanding how RapidResponse works and how it is different from your other enterprise data systems.

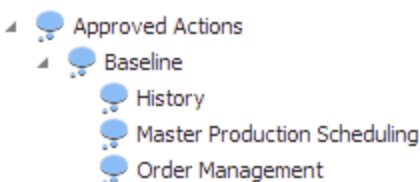
Where does the data in RapidResponse come from?

An important capability of RapidResponse is that it enables users to view and analyze enterprise data from multiple systems and sites. Data is extracted from different sources, such as your ERP system, forecast system, and your contract manufacturer's system, and imported into RapidResponse. This data is instantly transformed into valuable information that users can access through the RapidResponse client interface, using a secure Internet (or intranet) connection.



Data in scenarios

RapidResponse enables what-if analysis and collaboration through scenarios, which are essentially versions of a company's enterprise data. Scenarios are organized in a tree structure, in which each scenario is based on another scenario. The following example shows the organization of RapidResponse scenarios.



Within a scenario, data can be modified, and the changes that can be evaluated range from an order policy change to an introduction of an entire product line.

For more information, see ["Scenarios in RapidResponse" on page 17](#).

Resources for viewing and editing data

Resources are used to view and edit data in scenarios. They include:

- **Reports**—display data in dashboards, workbooks, and scorecards.
- **Tasks**—help you to follow steps to complete procedures and edit data in RapidResponse.
- **Automation resources**—are used to free up your time by performing repetitive tasks for you, or by simplifying tasks.
- **Filtering resources**—are used to control which subset of the data you are working with.

For more information, see ["Introduction to RapidResponse resources" on page 18](#).

Some resources needed for common business processes are included with RapidResponse, and other resources might be created to meet your company's unique needs. RapidResponse users are given access to different resources, depending on their roles in the company. For more information, see ["Different capabilities for different users" on page 24](#).

User account permissions

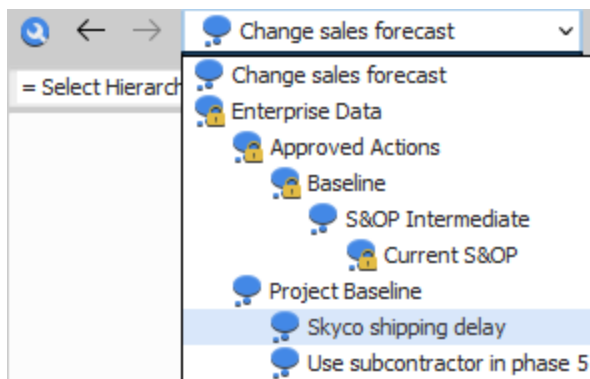
Permissions define which RapidResponse capabilities user or group of users can access, and the data they can view. For example, creating new scenarios requires a permission. RapidResponse administrators are responsible for ensuring that users have the permissions needed to do their jobs. For more information, see ["Different capabilities for different users" on page 24](#).

Some capabilities, such as accessing help or printing reports, do not depend on permissions, and are available to all users.

Scenarios in RapidResponse

The RapidResponse database stores data as scenarios. Each scenario represents a different, complete version of your company's enterprise data. Depending on the permissions assigned by their administrators, RapidResponse users can create new scenarios to simulate business changes, such as supply shortages or changes to large orders. Scenarios allow you to experiment with different ways to respond to challenges, and discard plans that do not work, rather than having to undo changes. Historical data can also be stored in scenarios, allowing you to see what has changed over time.

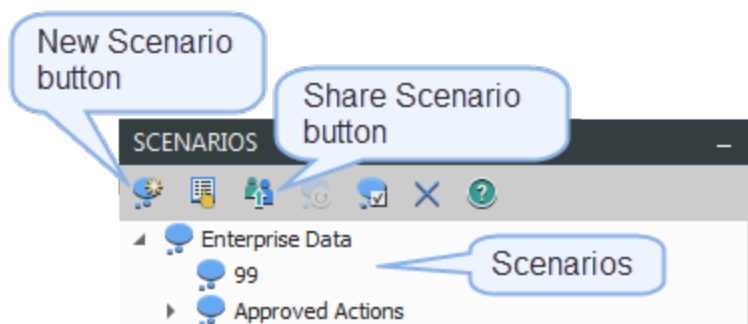
If you have access to more than one scenario, you can see the list of scenarios you have access to in the Scenarios pane or in the toolbar or data settings of an open report. If a scenario icon is shown with a padlock 🔒, you can view data in the scenario, but you cannot edit it. An example of scenarios that can be selected from a workbook toolbar control is shown in the following illustration.



Scenarios exist in a parent-child relationship, where each scenario, except for the root scenario, is the child of another scenario. If you have access to a scenario and its parent, the parent-child relationship of those scenarios is shown. For example, in the preceding illustration, the Approved actions scenario is a child of the Enterprise Data scenario. The parent of the Change sales forecast scenario is not visible because it has not been shared with this user. The Enterprise Data scenario is the root scenario, so it does not have a parent. For more information about the structure of the scenario tree, see ["Understanding the scenario structure" on page 462.](#)

Creating scenarios

If you have the required permissions, you can perform actions including creating scenarios and sharing scenarios from the Scenarios pane. Creating scenarios and sharing scenarios require two separate permissions, so you might be able to create them for your own private analyses, but not share them with other users.



New scenarios can be created quickly because only the differences between the data in the new scenario and the data in its parent are recorded. When a new scenario is created, there are not any differences yet, so the process is more like creating a blank file than like copying a very large database.

After a scenario is created, changes made to the parent or the child that result in the data in the two scenarios being different are tracked. When you access data in a scenario, any records that are identical in both that scenario and its parent are retrieved from the parent scenario.

For more information about creating and managing scenarios, see ["Managing scenarios" on page 481.](#)

Viewing data in scenarios

You can view, and in some cases edit, a scenario's data in reports. These scenarios might be ones you create, ones created by other users and shared with you, or the standard scenarios included with RapidResponse, which can be shared with you by your RapidResponse administrator. For more information about how a scenario affects the data visible in a worksheet, see ["Viewing data in workbooks" on page 139](#) and ["Data settings in dashboards" on page 265.](#)

Introduction to RapidResponse resources

Resources are tools that you can use to view, monitor, and work with data. They are broken down into several types, each with a different function. For example, you might use workbooks to view and modify data, filters to limit the data displayed in workbooks, alerts to monitor changes in the data, and so on. Individual users are granted permission to use different subsets of the available resources, depending on their job functions.

Resources are shown in the Explorer, which provides access to common functions performed with those resources. For more information, see ["Finding resources using the Explorer" on page 82](#).

The following types of resources might be available to you:

Reports

-  ["Dashboards" on page 19](#)
-  ["Workbooks" on page 20](#)
-  ["Scorecards" on page 21](#)

Tasks

-  ["Task flows" on page 21](#)
-  ["Processes" on page 22](#)
-  ["Responsibility Definitions" on page 22](#)
-  ["Forms" on page 22](#)

Automation

-  ["Automation chains" on page 22](#)
-  ["Alerts" on page 22](#)
-  ["Scheduled tasks" on page 23](#)
-  ["Scripts" on page 23](#)

Filtering

-  ["Filters" on page 23](#)
-  ["Hierarchies" on page 23](#)

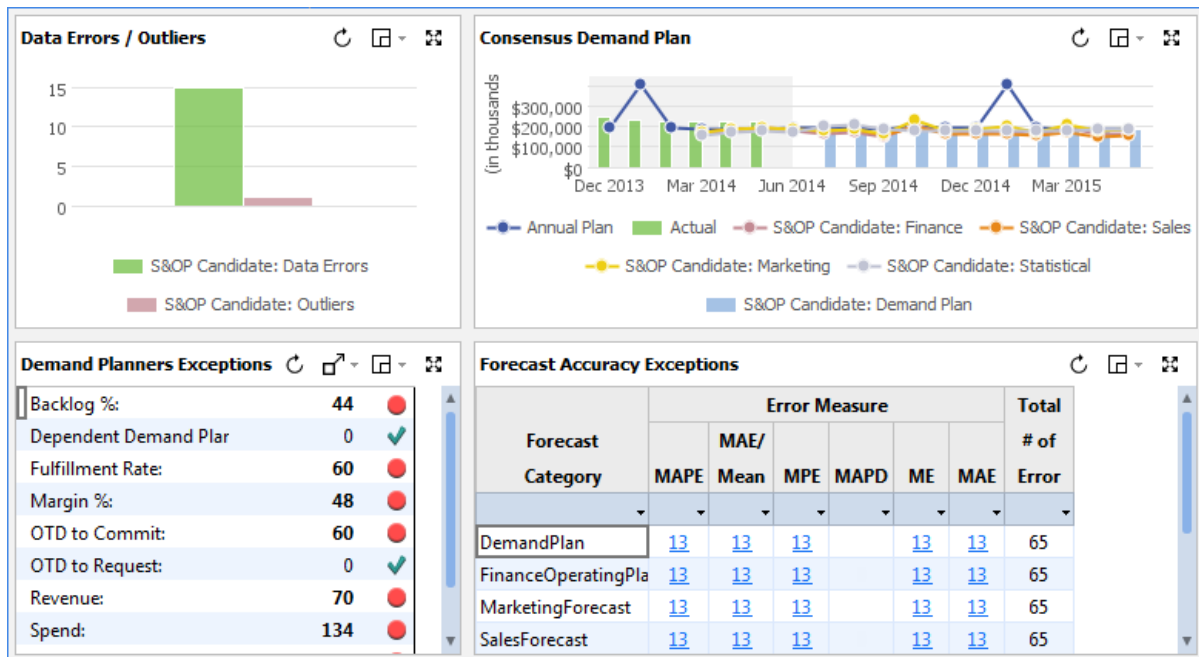
Other

-  ["Widgets" on page 23](#)

Reports

Dashboards

Dashboards hold a series of widgets that provide you with status updates on areas important to you and allow you to drill to detailed resources as needed. Dashboards are designed based on your role, and are provided to you by your RapidResponse administrator. For more information, see ["Viewing data in dashboards" on page 249](#).



Workbooks

Workbooks are used to view, analyze, and modify data. Each workbook contains worksheets, which display data in a spreadsheet-like environment. For more information, see ["Using worksheets and workbooks" on page 125](#).

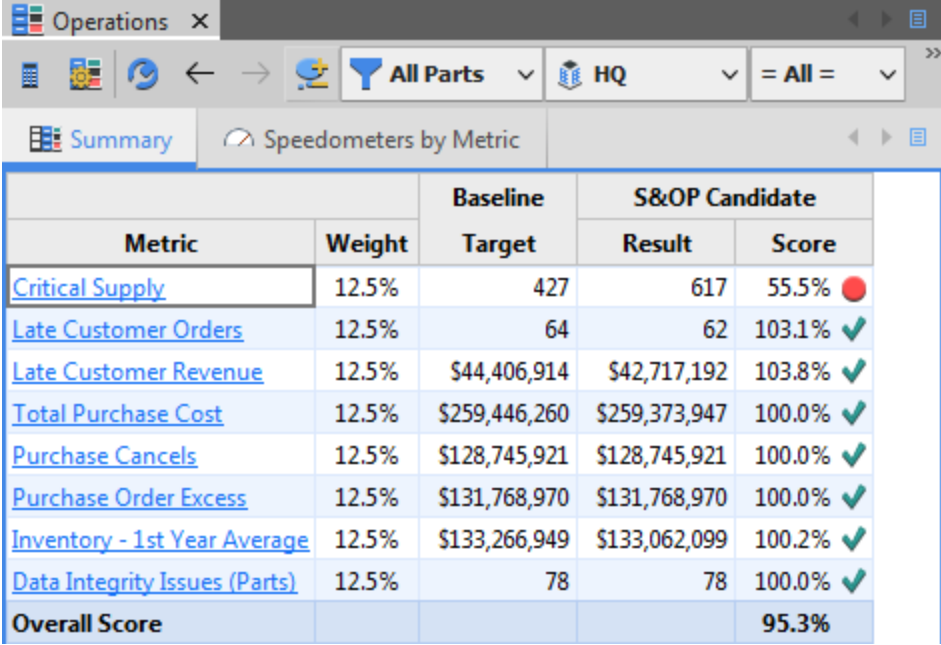
		Date				
		Month				
		06-02-14	07-01-14	08-01-14	09-01-14	10-01-14
1	Previous Year Supply					
2	Actual					
3	Demand Plan		397,795	415,865	361,629	361,629
4	Supply Plan	347,654				311,629
5	Previous Supply Plan	365,978	352,158	357,671	358,276	361,629

There are three types of workbooks that you might see in the Explorer, each identified with a different icon:

- standard workbooks
- metric workbooks.
- workbooks for publishing data to your customers who are RapidResponse subscribers. For more information, see ["Publishing data to subscribers" on page 655](#).

Scorecards

Scorecards are used to view data summarized by various metrics, which show how data varies between scenarios or how closely data meets a set of targets. Comparing results between scenarios allows you to choose the most beneficial course of action. For more information, see ["Viewing scorecard data " on page 279](#).



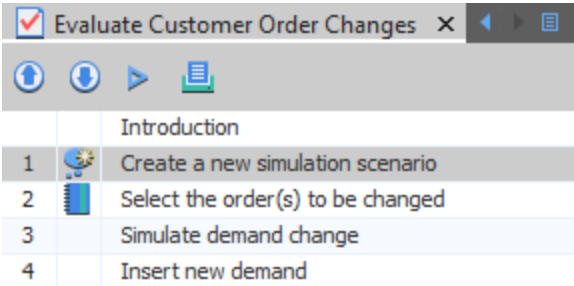
The screenshot shows a software window titled "Operations" with a sub-tab "Summary". Below the tab is a section titled "Speedometers by Metric". The main content is a table with the following data:

Metric	Weight	Baseline	S&OP Candidate	
		Target	Result	Score
Critical Supply	12.5%	427	617	55.5% 🔴
Late Customer Orders	12.5%	64	62	103.1% 🟢
Late Customer Revenue	12.5%	\$44,406,914	\$42,717,192	103.8% 🟢
Total Purchase Cost	12.5%	\$259,446,260	\$259,373,947	100.0% 🟢
Purchase Cancels	12.5%	\$128,745,921	\$128,745,921	100.0% 🟢
Purchase Order Excess	12.5%	\$131,768,970	\$131,768,970	100.0% 🟢
Inventory - 1st Year Average	12.5%	\$133,266,949	\$133,062,099	100.2% 🟢
Data Integrity Issues (Parts)	12.5%	78	78	100.0% 🟢
Overall Score				95.3%

Tasks

Task flows

Task flows are step by step procedures you can follow to perform a complex task. Individual steps of a task flow might link to the resources required to complete the steps, or launch scenario actions. For more information, see ["Following standard procedures using task flows" on page 91](#). For information about the task flows included with RapidResponse, see the [RapidResponse Applications Guide](#).



The screenshot shows a software window titled "Evaluate Customer Order Changes". Below the title bar is a toolbar with icons for back, forward, and search. The main content is a list of steps in a task flow:

	Step
	Introduction
1	Create a new simulation scenario
2	Select the order(s) to be changed
3	Simulate demand change
4	Insert new demand

Processes

Processes are a little bit like tasks, but they are used to coordinate the efforts of multiple people across an organization to complete more complex series of activities. For more information, see ["Participating in business processes" on page 95](#) and ["Running business processes" on page 543](#).

Responsibility Definitions

Responsibility definitions are used to assign responsibility for data to RapidResponse users, so that they can be contacted about issues affecting the data they are responsible for. You might be able to assign responsibility for data to other users, or you might only be able to assign responsibility to yourself. For more information, see ["Assign responsibility" on page 504](#).

Forms

Forms are used to complete a business task or series of focused tasks such as running a data modification. For more information, see ["Run a form" on page 603](#).

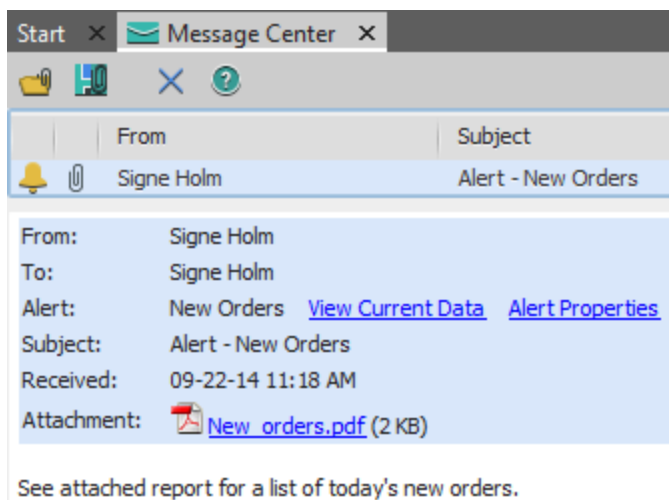
Automation

Automation chains

Automation chains are a type of automation task used to run a sequence of alerts and scheduled tasks. Automation chains can be used to define a business process, which runs automatically. You can specify the schedule that an automation chain runs on. For more information, see ["About automation chains" on page 561](#).

Alerts

Alerts are a type of automation task used to monitor data and send notification messages when the data meets a specified condition. For more information, see ["About alerts and data monitoring" on page 560](#). The following illustration shows an alert message in Message Center.



Scheduled tasks

Scheduled tasks are a type of automation task used to automatically run specific operations, such as modifying data with workbook commands or running scripts. You can specify the schedule that a scheduled task runs on. For more information, see ["About scheduled tasks" on page 560](#).

Scripts

Scripts are used to automate RapidResponse tasks and processes, such as creating and sharing scenarios or modifying data with workbook commands. If you have been provided scripts, you can run a script manually, or automatically using a scheduled task. For more information, see ["About scripting" on page 560](#).

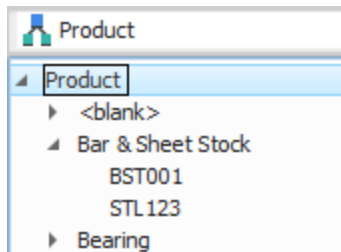
Filtering

Filters

Filters are used to limit the data shown in a dashboard, workbook, or scorecard. Filters allow you to see a manageable amount of data in a worksheet, or to view data specific to your job. For more information, see ["Viewing data in workbooks" on page 139](#).

Hierarchies

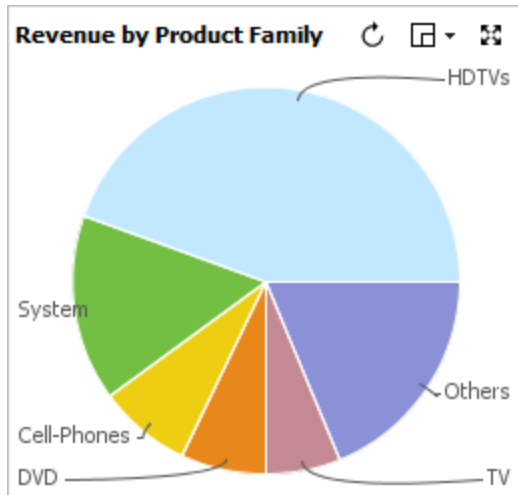
Hierarchies are used to view data at different levels of detail, and allow you to view both high-level data—such as forecasts for an entire product line—and low-level data—such as forecast for a single part—in the same worksheet. For more information, see ["Viewing data in workbooks" on page 139](#).



Other

Widgets

Widgets provide a visual or text-based summary of data and trends and allow you to drill to detailed resources as needed. Widgets are located on your dashboard for easy access. For more information, see ["About widgets" on page 251](#).



Different capabilities for different users

RapidResponse is a versatile and dynamic application that offers unique features and resources for different types of users. How you use RapidResponse depends largely on your job function. Your RapidResponse administrator customizes your RapidResponse experience based on the information you require and the tasks you need to perform as part of your job. For example, some users only need to view information, while others need to run what-if simulations to resolve various supply chain problems.

This topic describes four common categories of RapidResponse users to help you to understand the range of configurations that can exist:

- **Consumer**—users can view some data from their company's enterprise data systems and might be able to monitor data by creating personal alerts.
- **Contributor**—users can view and modify data in one or more scenarios that have been shared with them.
- **Simulation/Collaboration**—users can create what-if scenarios to simulate business problems. They might also be able to collaborate on solutions with other RapidResponse users.
- **Resource Author**—users can create a variety of RapidResponse resources.

There are considerably more than the four general settings that determine what you can do in RapidResponse, so two users who fall into the same category might have very different capabilities.

As you use this guide, keep in mind that your toolbars, menus, and resources might not be exactly like the ones shown in an illustration, because so many variations are possible. Your list of options might be longer or shorter, and in some cases, you might not be able to complete a procedure described in this guide because the option is not available to you. If you do not have access to the options you need, contact your RapidResponse administrator to modify your permissions.

Consumers

Consumers could include managers and financial analysts. They typically view data in reports created for them. As a consumer, when you first sign in to RapidResponse, you might be presented with a report (a

dashboard, workbook or scorecard) that displays data related to your job function, and includes links to detailed information, as in the following illustration.

Part Properties

Part: = All = = All = = All =

General Planning Policies Range of Coverage Overrides Reference Parts

	Part	Site	Description	Type	Control
1	A	HQ	A Part	MRP	Default
2	A1	HQ	A1 Part	MRP	Default
3	A3	HQ	A3 Part	MRP	Default
4	AC-0101	HQ	Water Bottle and Holder	MRP	Default
5	AC-0201	HQ	Tire Pump and Holder	MRP	Default
6	AC-0301	HQ	Luggage Racks	MRP	Default
7	AC-0401	HQ	Lock	MRP	Default
8	AC-0501	HQ	Tricycle Computer	MRP	Default
9	AC-0601	HQ	ProCruiser Tool Kit	MRP	Default
10	AC-0801	HQ	Underseat Pouch	MRP	Default
11	AC-0901	HQ	Tire Repair Kit	MRP	Default
12	AC-1001	HQ	Racer Tool Kit	MRP	Default
13	AC-1101	HQ	Adjustable Helmet	MRP	Default
14	ACCES-01	HQ	ProCruiser ACCESSORY ASSEMBLY Phantom	Phantom	Default
15	ACCES-02	HQ	RACER ACCESSORY ASSEMBLY Phantom	Phantom	Default
16	ACCES-030	HO	DE LUXE CITY ACCESSORY ASSEMBLY Phantom	Phantom	Default

General

Use this worksheet to view general part information such as Part Type, ABC Code, planner code, unit of measure, cumulative lead time, and on hand inventory. You can also use this worksheet to edit data and insert new part records.

Controlling what you see

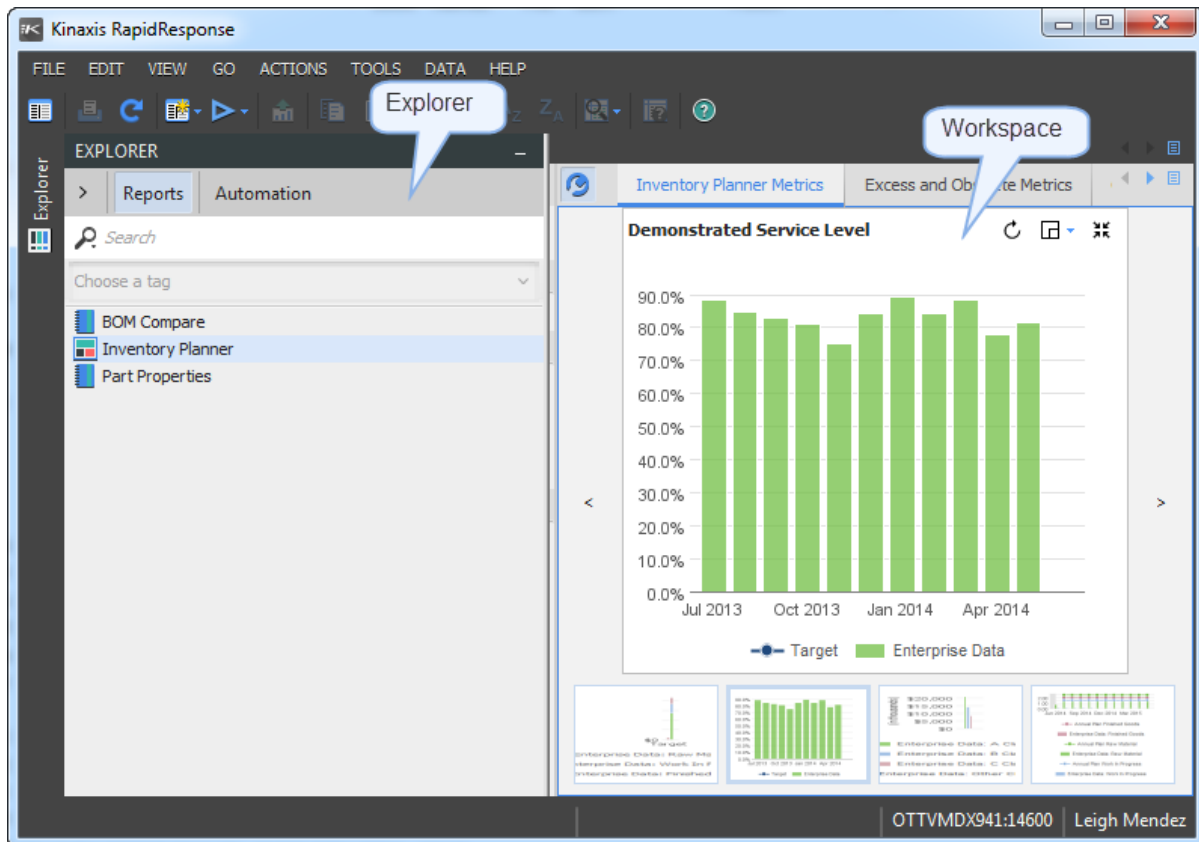
The following table describes how each control affects the information you see in the worksheet.

Data Control	Description
Part	Displays data for the selected part.

Column descriptions

OTTVMDX941:14600 Leigh Mendez 100% +

You might also have access to multiple reports, which you can open from the Explorer. You might also be able to create personal alerts that monitor data and notify you if specific data changes.



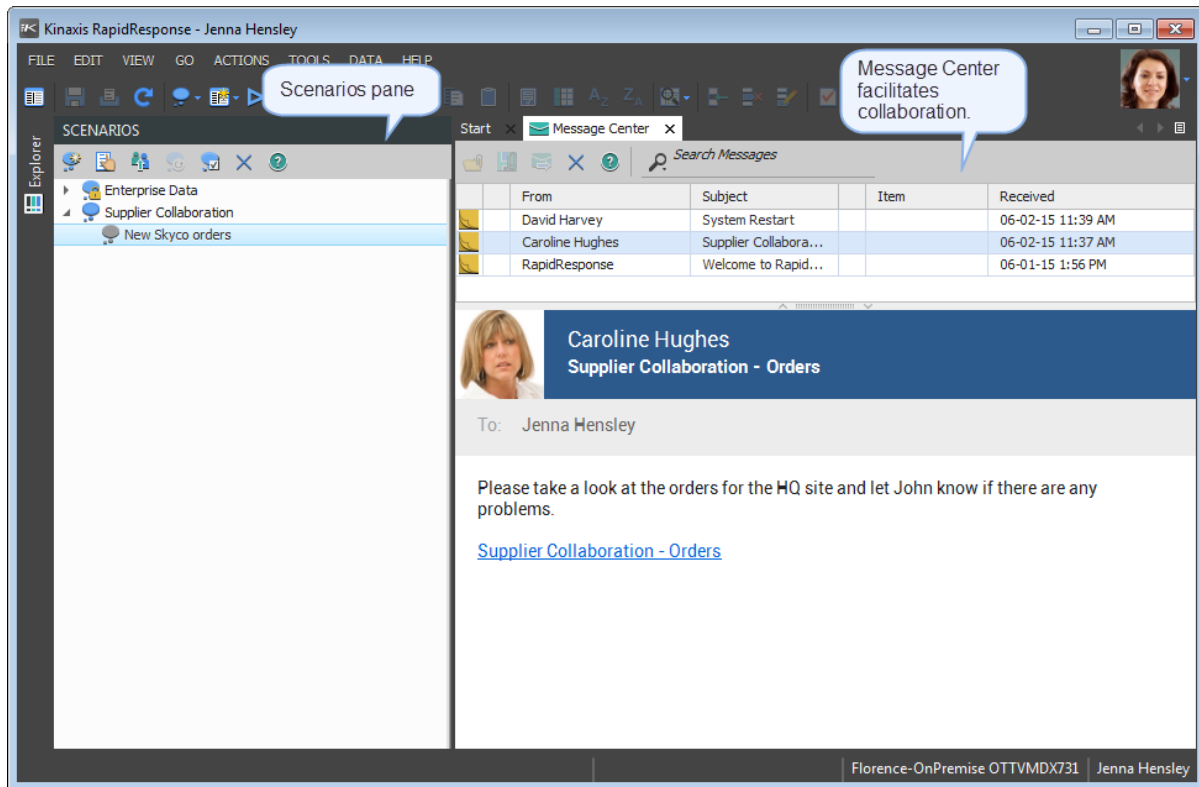
Contributors

Contributors not only view data in RapidResponse, but contribute by editing or adding information. For example, a warehouse manager might use a form to update inventory data. Contributors might also be external users, such as suppliers and customers, who need to modify order information. A supplier, for example, might open a workbook to view new part orders, and then commit to delivering the parts, decline the orders, or propose changes.

	Site	Date		Quantity			Notes
		Request	Commit	Request	UOM	Commit	
1	AmeriComp	06-16-14		1,500	EA		
2	AmeriComp	07-18-14		300	EA		
3	AmeriComp	07-21-14		1,500	EA		
4	AmeriComp	07-28-14		1,500	EA		
5	AmeriComp	06-20-14		450	EA		
6	AmeriComp	06-23-14		1,500	EA		3/11/2015 10:25:26 lmendez See email from Ji
7	AmeriComp	06-27-14		650	EA		
8	AmeriComp	06-30-14		1,500	EA		
9	AmeriComp	07-04-14		650	EA		
10	AmeriComp	07-07-14		1,500	EA		
11	AmeriComp	07-11-14		650	EA		
12	AmeriComp	07-14-14		1,500	EA		
13	AmeriComp	06-13-14		3,400	EA		
14	AmeriComp	07-18-14		3,400	EA		
15	AmeriComp	07-25-14		3,400	EA		

Simulation/collaboration users

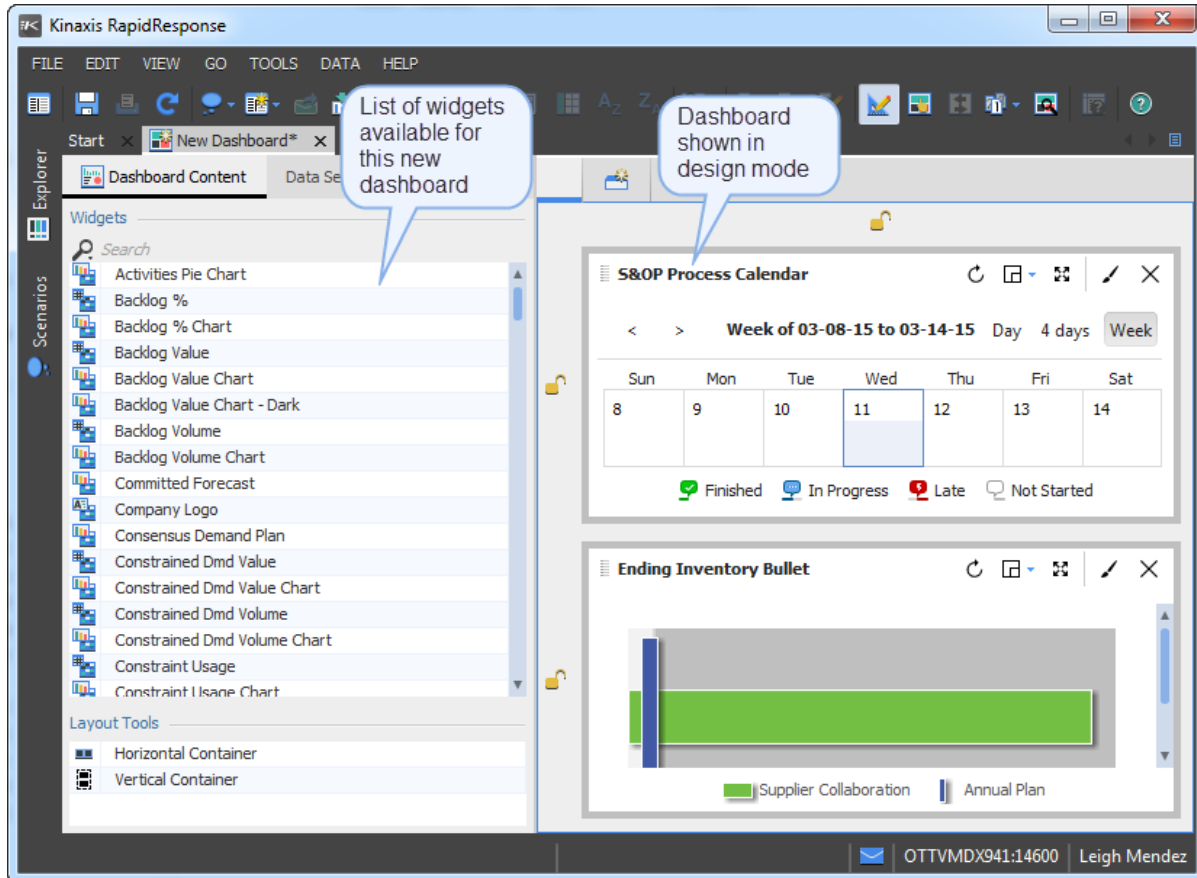
Simulation/collaboration users might be master schedulers, production planners, and material planners who view data, and also modify it to perform what-if simulations to resolve various issues. These users might also be able to collaborate with others on a solution to a particular problem and have access to the Scenarios pane where these tasks can be performed.



Resource authors

Users who are resource authors have more advanced reporting and analysis knowledge, and can create some or all of the types of resources available in RapidResponse. Resources include reports, tasks, automation tools, and filters. Sometimes they create these resources for their own purposes, and they might also have permission to share resources with other users.

To learn more about resource authoring, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).



CHAPTER 2: About Kinaxis

Kinaxis® delivers cloud-based S&OP and supply chain applications for discrete manufacturers and brand owners with complex supply chain networks and volatile business environments.

Leaders across multiple industry verticals, including A&D, Automotive, High Tech, Industrial and Life Sciences rely on RapidResponse® applications to create a foundation for concurrent planning, continuous performance monitoring, and coordinated responses to plan variances across multiple areas of the business. All founded on a single product, RapidResponse's configurable applications encompass a full spectrum of supply chain processes, including such functions as S&OP, supply planning, capacity planning, demand planning, inventory management, MPS, and order fulfillment.

As a result, Kinaxis customers have replaced disparate planning and performance management tools and are realizing significant operations performance breakthroughs in planning cycles, supply chain response times and decision accuracy. From a single product, customers are able to easily model varying supply chain conditions to make both long-term and real-time demand and supply balancing decisions quickly, collaboratively, and in line with the shared business objectives of multiple stakeholders.

For more information, visit www.kinaxis.com or the Kinaxis Knowledge Network at <http://knowledge.kinaxis.com/>.

Customer Support

The Kinaxis Customer Support team understands demand and supply chain planning, monitoring and response, and is experienced in applying RapidResponse to real-world business scenarios. Areas of expertise include:

- RapidResponse functionality
- Data extraction and mapping issues
- Technical software compatibility
- Coordination of integration
- Product implementation

If you are a key support contact, you can submit support cases. To submit a support case, you need to log into the Kinaxis Knowledge Network. You can also contact Kinaxis Customer Support by phoning 1-866-463-7877 or by sending a message to support@kinaxis.com.

Kinaxis Knowledge Network

The Kinaxis Knowledge Network is the place to find knowledge about RapidResponse. In one site, you can:

- Search all knowledge about RapidResponse, including product documentation, knowledge base articles, and threaded discussions about common questions.
- Review your company's Customer Support requests (and, if you are a key support contact, create new Support requests).
- Engage with a community of RapidResponse experts in the Discussion Groups.

Go to <https://knowledge.kinaxis.com> and log in today. You can also access the Kinaxis Knowledge Network from RapidResponse by clicking **Kinaxis Knowledge Network** on the **Help** menu.

CHAPTER 3: New and changed features

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2017 changes affecting general users	38
2016 changes affecting general users	39

This section describes all the new user features introduced in recent versions of RapidResponse.

There are similar chapters in other guides. For more information, see ["Determining which help system or guide to use" on page 64](#).

You can also learn more about the new features and changes included in RapidResponse from the *RapidResponse Release Summary Guide*. A new version of the *RapidResponse Release Summary Guide* is released with each new version of RapidResponse.

This document is available for download from the Kinaxis Knowledge Network and summarizes the changes to RapidResponse. It contains a compilation of changes gathered from every RapidResponse guide and help system. It also contains lists of defects resolved in each version.

► To access the *RapidResponse Release Summary Guide*

1. On the **Help** menu, click **Kinaxis Knowledge Network**.
2. Sign into the Kinaxis Knowledge Network.
You can create a new Kinaxis Knowledge Network account if you do not have one. An account is required.
3. On the **Knowledge** menu, click **Documentation**.
4. Under **Release Summary Documents**, select a release to download the PDF document.



Tip: You can also find release summary content in the [Global Help](#) system.

2019 changes affecting general users

The following 2019 releases include features affecting general users:

Service Update 1906

Updated collaboration pane

The collaboration side pane has a new look.

Service Update 1903

Updated sign-in page

The RapidResponse sign-in web page has a new look.

Service Update 1902

Automation resources locked when given

If someone gives you an alert, scheduled task, or automation chain, it is locked and cannot run until you unlock it. This gives you an opportunity to ensure that it is configured correctly before it runs.

For more information, see ["Unlock an automation resource" on page 570](#).

Running automation tasks

If you have access to an alert, script, scheduled task, or automation chain that is shared with multiple other users, you can now all run the automation task at the same time. Each run request is now queued individually, which replaces the previous behavior of marking the task for execution, which could only add a single request to the automation queue in a specific period. This ensures each user who needs to run an automation task can run the task, regardless of how many other users are attempting to run it at the same time.

This also adds the automation task to the queue immediately, instead of adding it at the end of interval. This allows your automation tasks to run sooner, and to receive the output of your automation tasks more quickly.

For more information, see ["Run an automation task" on page 617](#).

Calculated values in subtotal buckets

In crosstab worksheets that display subtotals for date buckets using the data from multiple grouped rows, the subtotals now display a calculated value. This might affect some of your predefined resources where calculated subtotal values display instead of blank cells.

For more information, see ["View data in a crosstab worksheet" on page 162](#).

Sign Out menu item not available when using gateway

For security reasons, when you sign in to RapidResponse using the gateway, the Sign Out option is not included on the File menu. You can use the Exit option to end your RapidResponse session.

Service Update 1901

Release numbering

As of this version of RapidResponse, the service update numbering now reflects which release number of the year the service update is. This supports the continuous delivery of RapidResponse, and allows you to correlate your RapidResponse installation with the order of releases for that year.

For example, RapidResponse 1901 is the first release of 2019 using this numbering system.

In some places, a letter might be included in front of the number—for example, G1901. The letter designation (G) is used to identify the major platform version. If it is not necessary to distinguish between major platform versions, the letter might not be included.

Version 2016.2, Service Update 27

Improved hierarchy filtering

When you use more than one hierarchy to filter data in a report, the options that are available in each hierarchy now depend on your selections in any previous hierarchies. This way, your options do not include combinations for which no data exists. For more information, see ["Applying multiple hierarchies" on page 302](#).

2018 changes affecting general users

The following 2018 releases include features affecting general users:

- ["Version 2016.2, Service Update 26" on page 35](#)
- ["Version 2016.2, Service Update 25" on page 36](#)
- ["Version 2016.2, Service Update 24" on page 37](#)
- ["Version 2016.2, Service Update 23" on page 37](#)
- ["Version 2016.2, Service Update 21" on page 37](#)
- ["Version 2016.2, Service Update 18" on page 38](#)

Version 2016.2, Service Update 26

Administrators can limit visibility of names and contact information

RapidResponse administrators can now limit the visibility of certain users' contact information to other users. This way, users can have access to a RapidResponse system without necessarily having access to

other users' personal information. This might be used if, for example, an external supplier is given access to a company's RapidResponse system.

Two types of restricted visibility are allowed:

- The user cannot see any other users' names and contact information.
- The user cannot see the names and contact information of other users who also have restricted visibility.

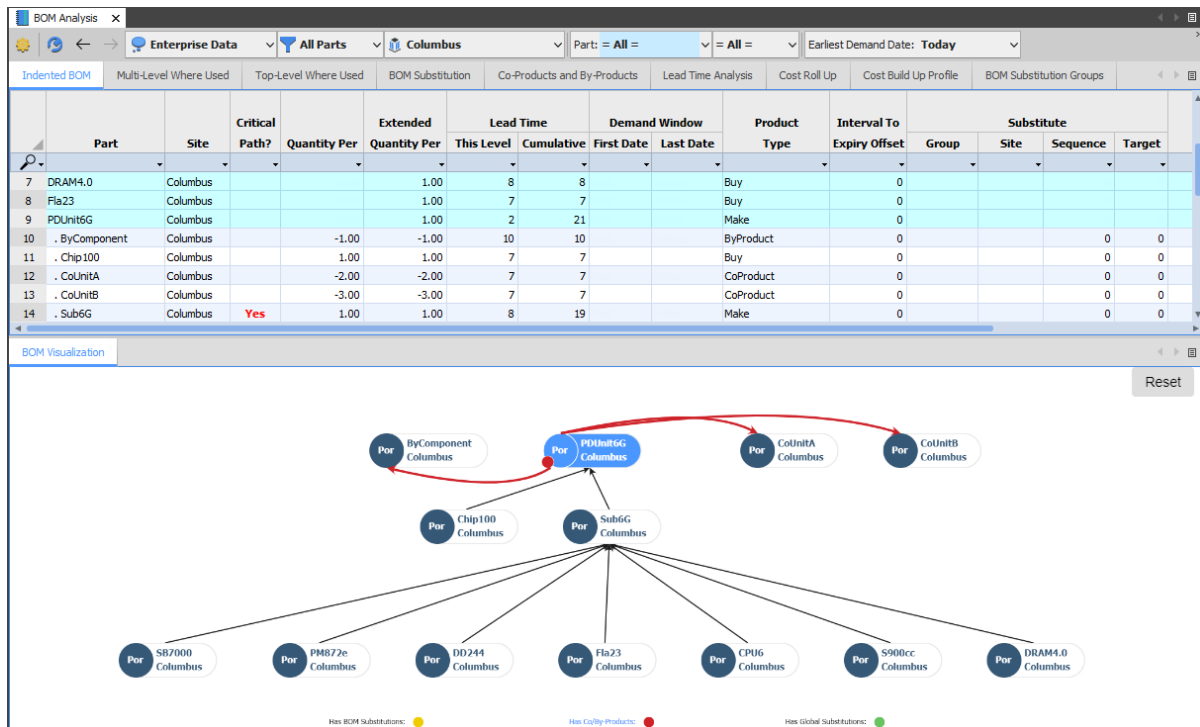
If information about another user is blocked, a user might see the user ID in place of a name, a generic label, or nothing at all.

In collaborations, users who cannot see each other's information can still see each other's comments, but might not know who made the comments. You are warned if you add users with restricted visibility to a collaboration.

Version 2016.2, Service Update 25

Gain a better understanding of the bill of material with BOM visualization

RapidResponse now offers BOM charts. A BOM chart provides you with an up-to-date view of the bill of material, which you can easily filter to focus only on the components or sites (or other criteria) that are relevant to you. The new BOM Visualization worksheet in the BOM Analysis workbook includes a BOM chart.



To better focus on the information you need, you can zoom in and out or reposition any components within the chart.

Additionally, the chart allows you to view links between components that show:

- BOM level part substitutes
- Global part substitutes
- Co-products and by-products

For more information, see ["Visualizing the bill of material" on page 225](#).

Version 2016.2, Service Update 24

New chart types

RapidResponse now provides three new chart types that you might see in dashboards or workbooks:

- Tornado charts
- Treemap charts
- Waterfall charts

For more information, see ["Viewing data in charts" on page 199](#).

Version 2016.2, Service Update 23

Importing data from and exporting data to Microsoft Excel

If you export data to or import data from Microsoft Excel, update 1803 (March 2018) changed how Microsoft Excel handles internal code execution. This update is now supported by the import and export process in RapidResponse. For more information, see ["Export data to a Microsoft Excel file" on page 319](#) and ["Import data from a Microsoft Excel file into a workbook" on page 380](#).

Version 2016.2, Service Update 21

Java 10 support

RapidResponse now works with Oracle Java Runtime Environment (JRE) version 10. Version 8 is still supported.

For full system requirements, see ["RapidResponse system requirements" on page 49](#).



Note: You might see the following warning when you run the Desktop Client using Java 10: Java Web Start and Java Plug-in are deprecated and will be considered for removal in a future Java release. Please contact the developer of this content "Kinaxis Inc." and request an update for this program. No action is required in response to this warning. RapidResponse is updated frequently and will be compatible with future versions of Java.

Variables in alerts and scheduled tasks

You now have the increased flexibility when creating or editing alerts and scheduled tasks on worksheets that use workbook variables. Depending on how you expect the monitored workbook to change, you can specify if the default variable value is used or if a value you have specified is used. This can reduce the number of unexpected results the alert or scheduled task returns.

For more information, see ["Create an alert to monitor worksheet data" on page 574](#) and ["Schedule an automatic data modification" on page 595](#).

Version 2016.2, Service Update 18

Add links to automation task notifications

You can now add resource links to notification messages for automation tasks (including alerts, automation chains, and scheduled tasks). Message recipients can open the resource with the data settings that you set. To view the data, users require permission to all of the resources you are using to display the data.

For more information, see ["Add links to automation task notifications" on page 627](#).

2017 changes affecting general users

The following 2017 releases include features affecting general users:

- ["Version 2016.2, Service Update 12" on page 38](#)
- ["Version 2016.2, Service Update 9" on page 39](#)
- ["Version 2016.2, Service Update 7" on page 39](#)

Version 2016.2, Service Update 12

Changing your view of quantity and money data

You can now change your view of numeric data in some workbooks. The unit of measure control enables you to switch the unit of measure applied to quantity or money columns.

For example, you might change your view of order quantities from pallets to kilograms to assess whether or not a new shipping route is feasible.

Part Name	Id	Site	Type	Line	Quantity	Expiry Offset	Due Date
AC001	Direct	Direct	BrandDemand	5	400	-1	07-27-17
AC001	Direct	Direct	BrandDemand	6	400	-1	08-10-17
AC001	Direct	Direct	BrandDemand	7	400	-1	08-24-17
AC001	PCW-005	CM3	CHDemand	1	130	-1	06-08-17
AC001	PCW-005	CM3	CHDemand	10	130	-1	08-10-17

Part Name	Id	Site	Type	Line	Quantity	Expiry Offset	Due Date
AC001	Direct	Direct	BrandDemand	5	4	-1	07-27-17
AC001	Direct	Direct	BrandDemand	6	4	-1	08-10-17
AC001	Direct	Direct	BrandDemand	7	4	-1	08-24-17
AC001	PCW-005	CM3	CHDemand	1	2	-1	06-08-17
AC001	PCW-005	CM3	CHDemand	10	2	-1	08-10-17

For more information, see ["Change the units for numeric data in a worksheet" on page 154.](#)

Version 2016.2, Service Update 9

Monitoring the health of your supply chain using maps

You can now view and review details for manufacturing and distribution sites on a map. The map displays in a RapidResponse dashboard and enables you to track and view information for specific sites, identify relationships and geographical context between sites, and communicate with other RapidResponse users involved with those sites.

For more information, see ["Viewing data in a map" on page 273.](#)

Version 2016.2, Service Update 7

More flexibility when editing percentages in crosstab worksheets

Some worksheets that allow percentage values to be edited in hierarchies require totals in each bucket to add up to 100% before you can save data changes. Previously, the value had to be exactly 100%. Now a range of totals is allowed. The worksheet author specifies how close the total must be to 100%. If the total in a bucket is outside of this range when you try to save your data changes, an error message is displayed. The message tells you what the range is, as well as the current total.

2016 changes affecting general users

The following 2016 releases include features affecting general users:

- ["Version 2016.2, Service Update 4" on page 40](#)
- ["Version 2016.2 initial release" on page 40](#)



Note: Features that were added in versions of RapidResponse prior to 2016.2 are not included in this list of changes.

Version 2016.2, Service Update 4

New option to copy percentage values

In previous versions of RapidResponse, when you copied a value formatted as a percentage from a RapidResponse worksheet, the raw value was copied to the Clipboard. Now, the value displayed in the cell is the value copied to the Clipboard by default. For example, if you see 2% in the cell and you copy that value by selecting Copy from the Edit menu, 2 is copied to the Clipboard, regardless of any scaling applied to the column.

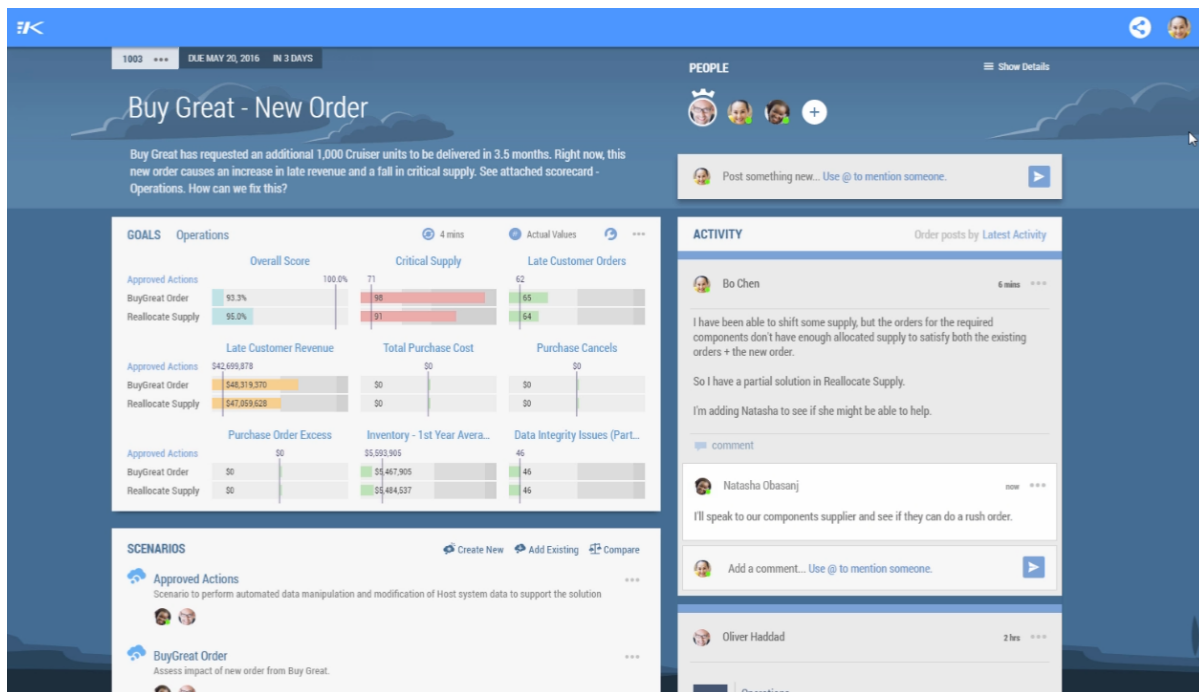
If you want to copy the raw value of a percentage instead, you can use the new Copy Raw % Values option on the Edit menu. For example, if you copy the raw value from a cell that displays 2%, the value copied to the Clipboard is 0.02, assuming that 2% is not a scaled value.

For more information, see ["Copying percent values" on page 359](#).

Version 2016.2 initial release

Adaptive Collaboration: A new way to address business challenges

You are now able to communicate securely, share simulated data in scenarios, and compare solutions in a single interface for collaborations. You can also include links to resources and annotated screenshots directly in the collaboration to provide more comprehensive details about the data and your proposals. Optionally you can provide more context for the situation by naming the collaboration, adding a description, and setting a due date for the collaboration's resolution.



You can add a scorecard directly in the collaboration to track and assess proposed solutions. With an interface that supports real-time communication and modern communication tools like social markup, collaborations provide you with flexibility over who leads the collaboration, who participates, and what collaborations you are involved in.

Once the collaboration team is finished with the collaboration, you can archive the collaboration to keep a record of the communications and the actions taken. The collaboration title, description, posts, and comments are saved. For more information, see ["Archive a collaboration" on page 541](#).

Adaptive Collaboration is available in both the Mobile Client and the Desktop Client. The Mobile Client has the same interface and many of the same collaboration features. For more information, see the [RapidResponse User Guide \(Mobile Client\)](#).

For more information, see ["Collaborating to solve business challenges" on page 513](#).



Note: You can still collaborate with other RapidResponse users as you did in RapidResponse 2014.4 and earlier using Message Center, tracking scenarios changes, and generating a report of the scenario actions taken. For more information, see ["Track activity in a scenario" on page 467](#), ["Track data changes in a scenario" on page 468](#), and ["Generate and distribute a report of your actions" on page 540](#).

Copy resource links

To support faster decision-making, you can now copy and paste resource links in collaborations and optionally, in external communications such as instant messaging.

Activity

Sort by Latest Activity



Post something new... Use @ to mention someone.



Bo Chen

now

<http://link?rrClientAction=openResource&type=Link&name=0327a2e2-b2f2-4276-bb7d-9ad3ee270c17>

 Planning Sheet

Comment

For more information, see ["Add resource links to a collaboration" on page 537](#) and ["Copy and paste a resource link" on page 448](#).

A more user-friendly sign-in page

The RapidResponse sign-in page has been improved: it now provides browser-specific instructions to guide users through opening the JNLP file and launching RapidResponse. It also provides links that you

might find useful: a link to download the latest version of Java, a link to more detailed sign-in help, and a link to RapidResponse system requirements.

NEXT STEPS



Download

Download and open the launcher file, `RapidResponse.jnlp`



Open

RapidResponse will now open in a new window



Install Java if needed

If RapidResponse does not open, you may need to [install Java](#)

[Sign in help](#)

[System requirements](#)

For more information about signing in to RapidResponse, see "[Sign in and sign out](#)" on page 45.

System requirement changes for Desktop Client users

The Desktop Client runs as a standalone Java Web Start application but is started from a Web browser and requires a supported Oracle Java Runtime Environment (JRE).

The Desktop Client is now supported on Microsoft's newest operating system, Windows 10 (32-bit and 64-bit). In addition, RapidResponse can now be started using the Microsoft Edge browser.

Mac OS users can use the Desktop Client with Mac OS X 10.11 (El Capitan) however Mac OS X 10.9 (Mavericks) is no longer supported.

It is strongly recommended that user systems have the latest service updates and patches applied to operating systems, browsers, and JREs to maintain system performance and security.

For more information, see "[RapidResponse system requirements](#)" on page 49.

Part 2: Getting started

- ["Sign in and sign out" on page 45](#)
- ["Accessing help and documentation" on page 63](#)
- ["Determining where to begin" on page 75](#)
- ["Following standard procedures using task flows" on page 91](#)
- ["Participating in business processes" on page 95](#)
- ["Managing resources" on page 99](#)
- ["Arranging your workspace" on page 111](#)
- ["Troubleshooting" on page 119](#)

CHAPTER 4: Sign in and sign out

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Specify formats for dates, times, numbers, and currencies	60
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RapidResponse runs as a Java Web Start application on supported Microsoft Windows and Mac OS operating systems. To run RapidResponse, you must have a supported Java Runtime Environment (JRE) installed and running. RapidResponse is started from a Web browser which downloads the latest RapidResponse application files to your computer. For information about system requirements, see ["RapidResponse system requirements" on page 49](#).

Depending on how RapidResponse has been set up for your company, you might use the On-Premises version of RapidResponse or the RapidResponse On-Demand service. Your RapidResponse administrator provides you with the credentials that you need to sign in to either version of RapidResponse.

After you sign in to RapidResponse for the first time, you might need to change your password. For more information, see ["Sign in to RapidResponse \(On-Demand systems\)" on page 46](#), ["Sign in to RapidResponse \(On-Premises systems\)" on page 48](#), and ["Changing your password" on page 59](#).

You can also access RapidResponse using the Mobile Client. Workbooks, dashboards, scorecards, and forms that you have access to display on the Mobile Client. For more information, see the [RapidResponse User Guide \(Mobile Client\)](#).

Once you have signed in, you see the RapidResponse application window, including the Start page, which provides links that can help you to find information and access resources that you need. For information about getting started in RapidResponse, see ["Determining where to begin" on page 75](#).

You can further customize your RapidResponse experience by selecting data format preferences (such as your preferred currency), selecting a report or task flow that will open each time you start RapidResponse, or creating shortcuts to resources that you use often. For more information, see ["Specify formats for dates, times, numbers, and currencies" on page 60](#), ["Open a resource automatically upon signing in" on page 103](#), and ["Access favorite resources quickly" on page 103](#).

Announcements from your RapidResponse administrator, such as scheduled maintenance windows that might affect your work, might be available on the Bulletin Board. For more information, see ["Bulletin Board information" on page 61](#).

When you have finished using RapidResponse, you can either close the application window or, if you did not sign in through the gateway, you can sign out and leave the application window open so that you can sign in again without having to restart RapidResponse. For more information, see "[Sign out and exit RapidResponse](#)" on page 61.

What to do if you cannot sign in

If you cannot sign in to RapidResponse, ask your RapidResponse administrator for help. If you do not know how to contact your RapidResponse administrator, RapidResponse Support can provide the contact information. You can contact support by sending a message to support@kinaxis.com.

Sign in to RapidResponse (On-Demand systems)

To run RapidResponse, you need the following:

- A supported Microsoft Windows or Mac OS operating system
- A Java Runtime Environment (JRE) installed and running
- A supported web browser

For detailed information, see "[RapidResponse system requirements](#)" on page 49.

If you are using a newer version of a supported browser such as Google Chrome, you might need to complete an additional step to sign in to RapidResponse.

- After entering your credentials, you might need to manually open the JNLP file that is sent to your computer each time you sign in. In Chrome, you can do this by clicking the file on the download bar to start RapidResponse.
- Depending on your browser and your security settings, you might need to confirm that you really want to proceed. For example, in Firefox, you might need to click OK in the Opening dialog box.

The RapidResponse sign-in page provides instructions to guide you through opening the JNLP file. It also provides links that you might find useful: a link to download the latest version of Java, a link to more detailed sign-in help, and a link to RapidResponse system requirements.

NEXT STEPS



Download

Download and open the launcher file, `RapidResponse.jnlp`



Open

RapidResponse will now open in a new window



Install Java if needed

If RapidResponse does not open, you may need to [install Java](#)

[Sign in help](#)

[System requirements](#)

Users on some RapidResponse systems might see a notice, such as a data use policy or legal notice, immediately after signing in. If you see this notice, you must acknowledge the notice by clicking the button below the notice before you can do anything else in RapidResponse. The label on the button is set by your RapidResponse administrator.

Your RapidResponse administrator provides you with a company ID, a user ID, and a password to access your RapidResponse system.

► Sign in to the Desktop Client

1. In your web browser address bar, type the URL <https://rapidresponse.kinaxis.com> and press **ENTER**.
2. Type your **Company ID**, **User ID**, and **Password**, and then click **Sign In**.
3. If a sign-in notice is displayed, review it and then click the button below the notice to continue.

► Sign in to the RapidResponse Mobile Client

1. In your web browser address bar, type the URL <https://rapidresponse.kinaxis.com/mobile> and press **ENTER**.
2. Type your **Company ID**, **User ID**, and **Password**, and then click **Sign In**.
3. If a sign-in notice is displayed, review it and then tap the button below the notice to continue.



Note: You cannot have two instances of RapidResponse running on the same computer and connected to the same server. This means that you cannot be concurrently signed into one RapidResponse system using two accounts from the same computer. However, you can sign into two different RapidResponse systems concurrently (for example, a production system and a test system) from the same computer.

Sign in to RapidResponse (On-Premises systems)

To run RapidResponse, you need the following:

- A supported Microsoft Windows or Mac OS operating system
- A Java Runtime Environment (JRE) installed and running
- A supported web browser

For detailed information, see "[RapidResponse system requirements](#)" on page 49.

If you are using a newer version of a supported browser such as Google Chrome, you might need to complete an additional step to sign in to RapidResponse.

- After entering your credentials, you might need to manually open the JNLP file that is sent to your computer each time you sign in. In Chrome, you can do this by clicking the file on the download bar to start RapidResponse.
- Depending on your browser and your security settings, you might need to confirm that you really want to proceed. For example, in Firefox, you might need to click OK in the Opening dialog box.

The RapidResponse sign-in page provides instructions to guide you through opening the JNLP file. It also provides links that you might find useful: a link to download the latest version of Java, a link to more detailed sign-in help, and a link to RapidResponse system requirements.

NEXT STEPS



Download

Download and open the launcher file, [RapidResponse.jnlp](#)



Open

RapidResponse will now open in a new window



Install Java if needed

If RapidResponse does not open, you may need to [install Java](#)

[Sign in help](#)

[System requirements](#)

Users on some RapidResponse systems might see a notice, such as a data use policy or legal notice, immediately after signing in. If you see this notice, you must acknowledge the notice by clicking the button below the notice before you can do anything else in RapidResponse. The label on the button is set by your RapidResponse administrator.

Accessing RapidResponse

Your RapidResponse administrator provides you with a user ID, a password, and the URL you need to type into your browser address bar to access your RapidResponse system. The password is case sensitive.

For the Desktop Client, the URL address typically looks like *http://computername/rapidresponse/*.

For the Mobile Client, it typically it looks like *http://computername/rapidresponse/mobile*.

► Sign in to the Desktop Client or Mobile Client

1. In your web browser address bar, type the URL given to you by your RapidResponse administrator and press **ENTER**.
2. Type your **User ID** and **Password** in the **Sign In** box.
3. If a sign-in notice is displayed, review it and then click the button below the notice to continue.



Note: You cannot have two instances of RapidResponse running on the same computer and connected to the same server. This means that you cannot be concurrently signed into one RapidResponse system using two accounts from the same computer. However, you can sign into two different RapidResponse systems concurrently (for example, a production system and a test system) from the same computer.

RapidResponse system requirements

This section outlines the system requirements for Desktop Client users. These system requirements do not apply to Mobile Client users.

Requirements	Details
System memory	4 GB of RAM
Operating system	Microsoft Windows • Microsoft Windows Vista Business SP2 (32-bit and 64-bit) • Microsoft Windows Vista Enterprise SP2 (32-bit and 64-bit) • Microsoft Windows 7 SP1 (32-bit and 64-bit) • Microsoft Windows 8 (32-bit and 64-bit) • Microsoft Windows 8.1 (32-bit and 64-bit) • Microsoft Windows 10 (32-bit and 64-bit) Mac OS • Mac OS X 10.10 (Yosemite) • Mac OS X 10.11 (El Capitan) Notes: • It is advisable that the operating system also include the latest updates, service packs, and patches. • For more information about using the Mac OS operating system with RapidResponse, see "RapidResponse Desktop Client on the Mac OS operating system" on page 51.

Requirements	Details
Java Runtime Environment (JRE)	Oracle Java Runtime Environment (JRE), version 8 or 10. Notes: - To protect your system from potential security threats, it is recommended that you use an up-to-date version of JRE 8. - You can test the version of the JRE you are using by visiting http://www.java.com/en/download/help/testvm.xml. You can also download a supported version of the JRE by visiting http://www.java.com/en/. - By default, the JRE controls how much system memory RapidResponse can consume. For information about memory settings, see "JRE memory settings and versions" on page 51.
Web browser	Browsers are used to initially start RapidResponse as a Java Web Start application. Kinaxis has verified that the following browsers can be used to start the Desktop Client. However, you might also be able to use other browsers. Microsoft Windows - Microsoft Internet Explorer 11 - Microsoft Edge 25 (and later) - Mozilla Firefox 31 (and later) - Google Chrome 40 (and later) Mac OS - Apple Safari 8 and 9 - Mozilla Firefox 31 (and later) - Google Chrome 40 (and later) Notes: - RapidResponse can be used with 32-bit and 64-bit versions of the supported browsers. However, the JRE configuration determines whether Java Web Start runs as 32-bit or 64-bit application. - Depending on how your browser is configured, you might need to change some browser security settings to ensure that RapidResponse can start and properly communicate with the Microsoft Windows operating system.
Monitor	Microsoft Windows: 1024 x 768 (minimum resolution) Mac OS: 1440 x 900 (minimum resolution)
System Peripherals	Keyboard and mouse
PDF viewer application	A PDF viewer such as Adobe Reader or Preview for MacOS is required to open RapidResponse guides and documents.
Adobe Flash Player	Adobe Flash Player 11.8 or later (browser plug-in) is required to view videos included in the RapidResponse help systems and documentation. A sound card, and speakers and headphones to listen to the audio portion of the video recording is also required. You can verify that Adobe Flash Player is properly set up by visiting http://www.adobe.com/software/flash/about/ .



Notes:

- Kinaxis has verified that RapidResponse runs effectively with the operating systems and



browsers noted in the previous table. In certain cases, you might experience unexpected results or performance issues using newer browsers and JREs or other operating systems. Kinaxis endeavors to verify new platforms as they are released.

- It is strongly recommended that user systems have the latest service updates and patches applied to operating systems, browsers, and JREs to maintain system performance and security.

RapidResponse Desktop Client on the Mac OS operating system

The Desktop Client client can be used on Microsoft Windows and Mac OS operating systems. However, not all RapidResponse features supported on Microsoft Windows are supported on Mac OS. This includes:

- The Start page. For more information, see ["Accessing resources and information from the Start page" on page 58](#).
- Forms. For more information, see ["About forms" on page 601](#).
- Collaboration Center. For more information, see ["Collaborating to solve business challenges" on page 513](#).

In addition, some RapidResponse applications such as Order Fulfillment make use of forms in process and workflows. These applications should only be used with the Desktop Client on the Microsoft Windows operating system.

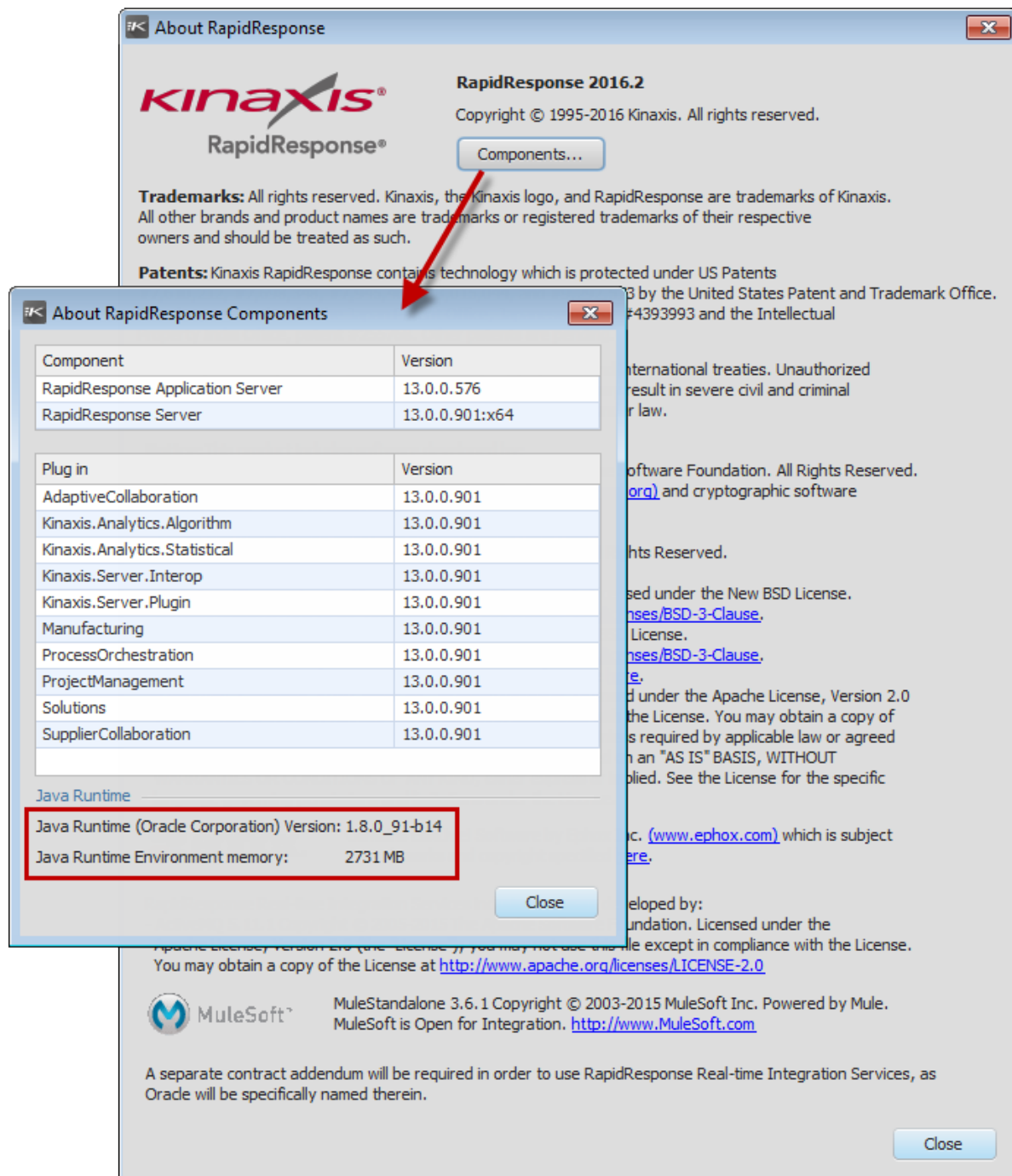
If you are using the Mac OS, consider using the Mobile Client if you want to take advantage of forms or Collaboration Center. For more information about starting the Mobile Client, see ["Sign in to RapidResponse \(On-Demand systems\)" on page 46](#) or ["Sign in to RapidResponse \(On-Premises systems\)" on page 48](#). Alternatively, you might be able to run Microsoft Windows in a Mac OS virtual environment to run the Desktop Client.

JRE memory settings and versions

To run RapidResponse, you require an installed and enabled Java Runtime Environment (JRE) on your computer. For more information about system requirements, see ["RapidResponse system requirements" on page 49](#).

By default, the JRE controls how much system memory RapidResponse (a Java Web Start application) can consume. For example the 32-bit version of JRE 8 sets the Java Web Start memory to 256 MB. The 64-bit version provides additional memory.

You can determine which version of the JRE you are using and how much system memory the JRE can consume by selecting **About RapidResponse** from the **Help** menu, then clicking the **Components** button.



Determining which version of JRE you are using

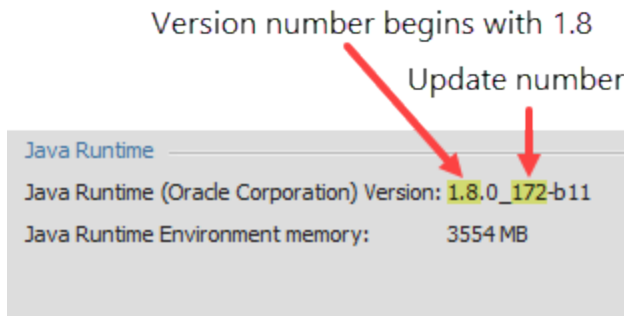
You can determine which version of the JRE is installed on your computer from the Java Runtime area of the **About RapidResponse Components** dialog box.



Note: Java version numbering conventions changed between version 8 and version 10.

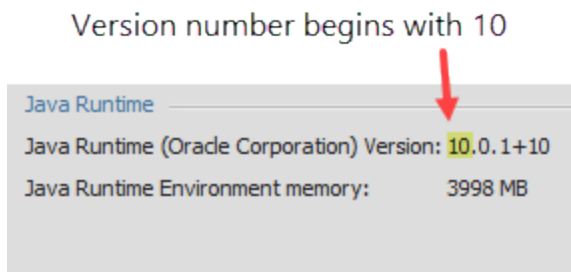
Java 8

If you have Java 8 installed, the version number begins with 1.8, and the number after the underscore is the update number. For example, if your Java Runtime (Oracle Corporation) Version is 1.8.0_172-b11, as shown in the following image, the Java version number is 8, and the update number is 172.



Java 10

If you have Java 10 installed, the version number begins with 10. For example, if your Java Runtime (Oracle Corporation) Version is 10.0.1+10, as shown in the following image, you have Java 10.0.1.



You can also determine the version of the JRE you are using from the Java control panel in the Windows Control Panel.

JRE memory

Your RapidResponse administrator can override your JRE memory setting for RapidResponse. If this is the case, the **About RapidResponse** dialog box continues to show your computer's JRE memory setting but RapidResponse uses the override setting.

To optimize RapidResponse performance, you can download the latest version of the JRE by visiting <http://www.java.com/en/>. You might want to consider installing the 64-bit version of the JRE (if you are using a 64-bit browser).

32-bit and 64-bit browsers and JREs

If you are using a 32-bit browser with a 64-bit version of a JRE, you will not be able to sign into RapidResponse if a 32-bit JRE is not also installed on your system. Upon trying to sign into RapidResponse, you will be warned that a JRE is not enabled. To work around this, install a 32-bit JRE.

As a Java Web Start application, RapidResponse is launched by a JNLP file from a browser. The JNLP file is associated with the enabled JRE. If more than one JRE is enabled, for example, a 32-bit and a 64-bit version, the JNLP file and the RapidResponse client uses the most recent JRE that was installed on the user's system. The most recent JRE installed takes into account updates.

JRE tips

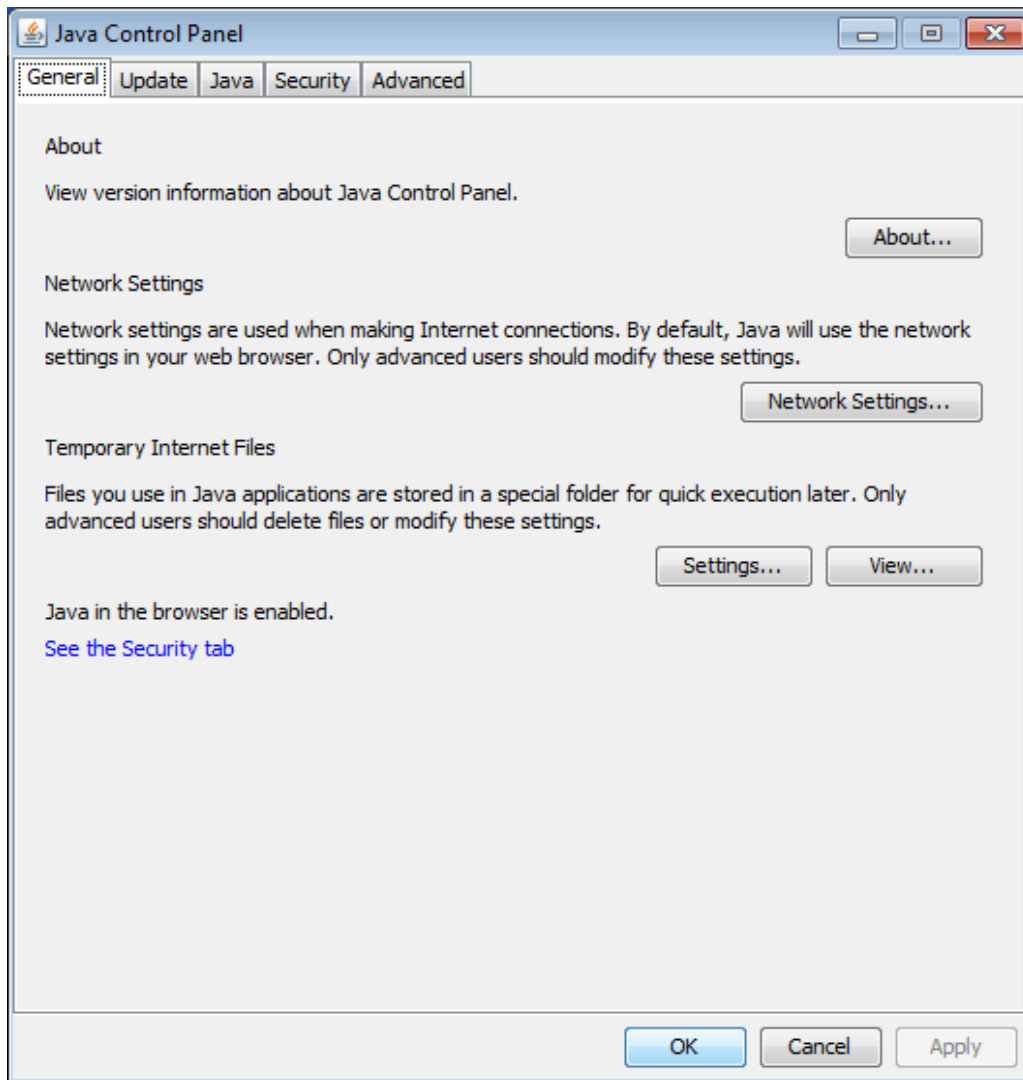
If you are experiencing any difficulty with signing into RapidResponse or using RapidResponse while signed in, you might have to first perform the following tasks to ensure that your issue is not related to the JRE.

Clear the JRE cache

If your RapidResponse is loading slowly or not at all, clearing the Java cache files can remedy this problem. Doing so clears out historical files that might be causing problems and force your web browser to load the fresh version of RapidResponse.

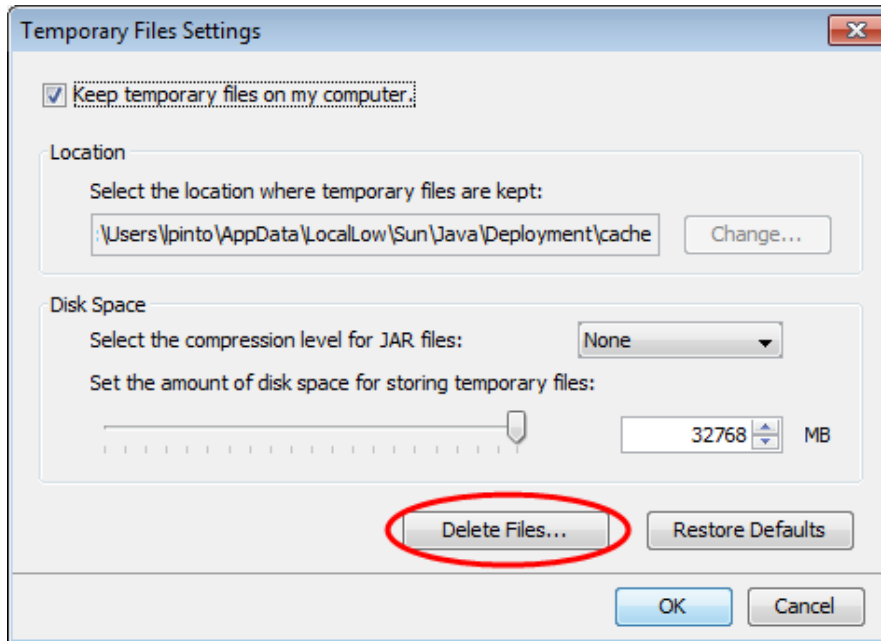
► To access the Java Control Panel

1. Click the Windows **Start** menu and select the **Control Panel** option.
2. In the Control Panel, click **Programs**.
3. Select **Java 32-bit/64-bit**.
The **Java Control Panel** opens.

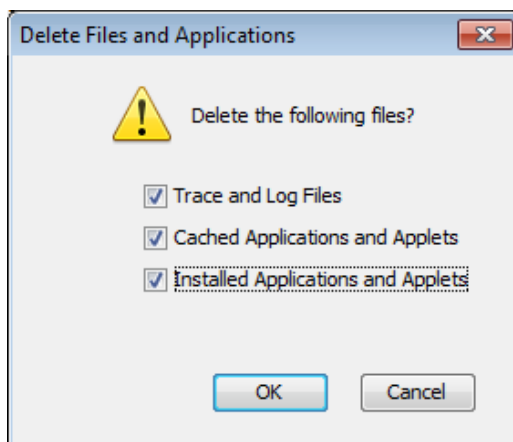


► **Clear the Java cache (Java 8)**

1. In the Java Control Panel, on the **General** tab, under the Temporary Internet Files section, click **Settings**.
The **Temporary Files Settings** dialog box appears.



2. In the Temporary Files Settings dialog box, click **Delete Files**. The **Delete Files and Applications** dialog box appears.



3. In the **Delete Files and Applications** dialog box, select all three check boxes.
4. Click **OK**.

To find the Java Control Panel on your computer or for more information, see https://www.java.com/en/download/help/plugin_cache.xml.

► Clear the Java cache (Java 10)

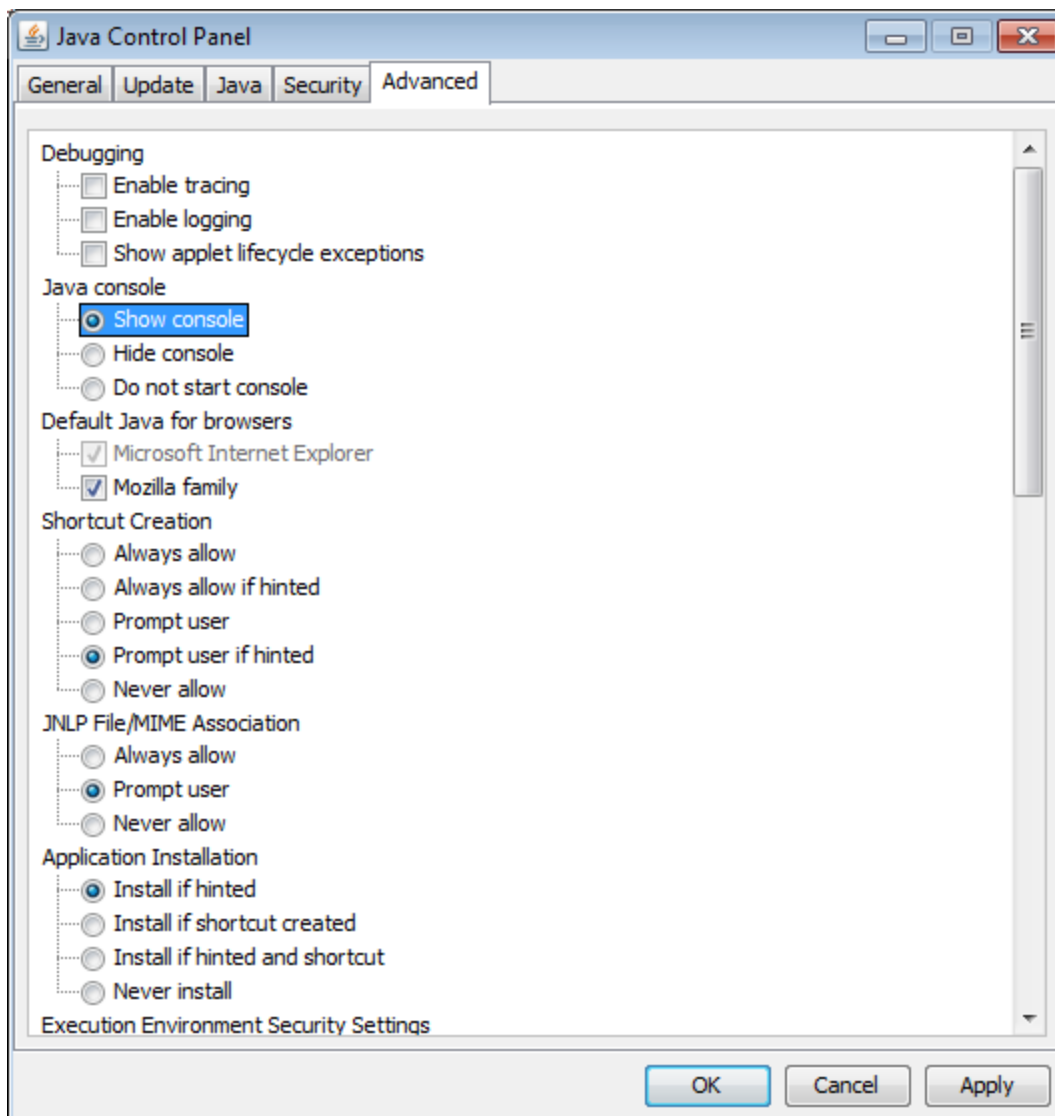
1. In the **Java Control Panel**, on the **Web Settings** tab, select the **Temporary Files Settings** tab.
2. Click **Delete Files**.
3. In the **Delete Files and Applications** dialog box, select all three check boxes.
4. Click **OK**.

Enable the Java console

If you are still experiencing any difficulty with using RapidResponse, you might need to enable Java console (or Java Log) on your computer. Once Java Console is enabled, it appears in a separate window providing information about the Java version, user home directory, and any error messages that occur while running RapidResponse or any other JRE-based application.

► To enable the Java console

1. In the Java Control Panel, click the **Advanced** tab.
2. Under the Java console option, select **Show Console**.
3. Click **OK**.



Information provided in the Java Console can be communicated to your RapidResponse administrator or Kinaxis Customer Support in order for them to investigate any problem you are experiencing. For more information about enabling the Java Console, see

<http://www.java.com/en/download/help/javaconsole.xml>.

Accessing resources and information from the Start page

By default, most users see a Start page after signing in to RapidResponse. The Start page has four sections:

- **Getting Started or Recent Activity**—The first time you sign in, this section is called Getting Started, and it provides you with links to your account settings and information about RapidResponse. On subsequent sign-ins, it is called Recent Activity, and it displays links that you can use to open your most recently used resources with the same data settings you used last time.
- **Act Faster**—This section provides links to help you get started on common tasks.
- **Recent Messages**—This section is shown if you have access to the Message Center. Any recent messages in your inbox are displayed here. You can click a message title to read it, or click See All to go to the message center.
- **Learn**—This section provides links to resources that you can use to learn more about RapidResponse, such as videos, documentation, discussions, and news. These links only work if you have Internet access.

RECENT ACTIVITY	ACT FASTER	RECENT MESSAGES	LEARN
Jun 10, 2016	Open Explorer	See All	
Process Owner 1 MIN	Reports	RapidResponse Welcome to RapidRespo... 7 HRS	Introduction to RapidResponse Get started quickly with this video series
Corporate Metrics 2 MINS	Tasks		RapidResponse Training Paths Discover the role-based training available to you
Finish Activity 7 MINS	Scenarios		Training schedule Review the schedule and register in one place
Create New Constraints 7 MINS	Search Resources		Kinaxis Certification Gain competitive advantage with certification
Constraint Manager 8 MINS			Tour the new interface (2014.4 and I... Learn about the Explorer, tagging, and more
			What's New? Videos and documents covering the new features
			Training Videos Free, on-demand training videos to help you succeed
			Help and Documentation All help systems and documentation in one place
			Kinaxis Customer Mailing List Stay informed with product info, webcasts & more
			Supply Chain Expert Community Learn, laugh, share and connect with other users
			Contact Kinaxis Knowledge Services Not seeing what you're looking for? Contact us!



Notes:

- Depending on account settings, some users might not have a start page available to them.
- The Desktop Client can be used on Microsoft Windows and Mac OS operating systems. However, the Start Page is not supported on Mac OS.

Showing and hiding the Start page

The Start page appears on a tab, which you can leave open and refer to as you work, or close after RapidResponse starts. If you have closed the Start page, you can open it again at any time. By default, the Start page opens each time you start RapidResponse, but you can toggle this behavior on and off.

► Specify whether the start page is shown each time you sign in

1. On the **Tools** menu, click **Options**.
2. On the **Settings** tab, check the **Show Start Page** box if you want the **Start** page to open when you sign in to RapidResponse, or clear the box if you do not want it to open.



Tip: If profile pictures are enabled on your RapidResponse system, you can access **Options** by clicking on your profile picture in the RapidResponse toolbar.

► Open the Start page

- On the **Go** menu, click **Start Page**.



Note: If a report and the Start page both open automatically when you start RapidResponse, the tab for the report is shown in front of the tab for the Start page.

Changing your password

To maximize the effectiveness of your password, follow these guidelines:

- Make your password at least 8 characters long.
- Use letters, numerals, and symbols in your password. You cannot use the straight quotation mark (") character or the semicolon (;) character in the password.
- Avoid actual words and common names.
- Do not use personal information, for example: your name, your pet's name, birth dates, or phone numbers.

Your RapidResponse administrator might set requirements for passwords, such as a minimum password length or specific types of characters (such as numbers and symbols).

► Change your password

1. On the **Tools** menu, click **Change Password**.
2. In the **Change Password** dialog box, type your current password, your new password, and then the new password again.
3. Click **OK**.



Caution: If you automatically sign in to RapidResponse either through a portal or without entering a password, changing your password could cause you to become locked out of RapidResponse.



Notes:

- You can change your password only if you have been granted the required permission.
- If your RapidResponse administrator has specified password complexity requirements, those requirements are displayed in the **Change Password** dialog box..

Specify formats for dates, times, numbers, and currencies

Date, time, number, and currency information displayed in RapidResponse resources has formatting applied. For example, number information can be displayed using commas or spaces as thousands separators, or date information can be displayed with a two-digit or four-digit year.

The formats applied to data can be defined by the resource's author. In resources where the author has not defined a format, your specified format is used. The format you specified is also used in the RapidResponse interface. If your RapidResponse system supports multiple currencies, you can also specify the currency that is used in all resources that contain money values.

The number format includes thousand separators, decimal symbol, and positive and negative formats. It does not include the number of decimal places which is specified by the resource authors.

The date and time displayed in RapidResponse (including worksheets) is taken from your computer, unless your computer's time zone is not defined in RapidResponse. If the time zone is not defined, you are notified when signing in to RapidResponse, and a different time zone is used for the session. Contact your RapidResponse administrator to define your time zone.

Any notes you add to a scenario include the date and time information of when the note was added, using RapidResponse's date and time. For any automatically generated notes, such as when you create a scenario, RapidResponse's date and time is also used. For information about scenarios, see ["Scenarios in RapidResponse" on page 17](#).

► Specify formats for number, date, time, and currency data

1. On the **Tools** menu, click **Options**.
2. In the **Options** dialog box, click the **Settings** tab.
3. In the **Formats** area, click a format in any of the following lists:
 - **Currency**
 - **Number**
 - **Date**
 - **Time**

► Specify your preferred currency

1. On the **Tools** menu, click **Options**.
2. In the **Options** dialog box, click the **Settings** tab.
3. In the **Currency** list at the top of the **Settings** tab, select the currency you want to view in resources.



Note: RapidResponse administrators control which data formats are available to users. If you want to use a data format that is not currently available, contact your RapidResponse administrator.



Tips:

- To view information about the currency, currency format, or number format you have selected, click the  button beside the currency or format.
- If profile pictures are enabled on your RapidResponse system, you can access **Options** by clicking on your profile picture in the RapidResponse toolbar.

Bulletin Board information

You have access to the Bulletin Board dialog box which provides information about the RapidResponse system. This dialog box provides:

- Information about the next scheduled maintenance activity.
- Announcements from RapidResponse administrators.

The Announcements section typically includes information about system activities such as when data updates and system restarts will occur. This could help you pick optimal times to schedule your own automatic activities such as alerts or scheduled reports.

- On the **Help** menu, click **Bulletin Board**.

Sign out and exit RapidResponse

You can sign out of RapidResponse by closing the RapidResponse client window. It is recommended you close the window by using the RapidResponse menu command. If you want to sign back in, you must open another browser window and provide the RapidResponse URL. For more information about signing in, see ["Sign in to RapidResponse \(On-Premises systems\)" on page 48](#) or ["Sign in to RapidResponse \(On-Demand systems\)" on page 46](#).

► To sign out and exit RapidResponse

- On the **File** menu, click **Exit**.

If you are using the On-Premises version of RapidResponse and did not sign in through the gateway, you can sign out of RapidResponse, but leave the RapidResponse client window open. This way, you can quickly sign back in by clicking Sign In on the File menu, without having to restart RapidResponse.

► **To sign out of the On-Premises version of RapidResponse**

- On the **File** menu, click **Sign Out**.



Note: By default, your RapidResponse session automatically expires if it is inactive for four hours, and all unsaved data changes are lost. This setting can be changed by your RapidResponse administrator.



Tip: If profile pictures are turned on, you can sign out by clicking on your profile picture in the RapidResponse toolbar and selecting **Sign Out**.

CHAPTER 5: Accessing help and documentation

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The RapidResponse documentation set includes several different help systems and guides, each dealing with a different area of knowledge. Help for individual resources, such as workbooks is also available.

In addition to the RapidResponse documentation, you can access a variety of other resources to help you learn about the capabilities and features in RapidResponse. These include an online community where you can view how-to videos and find advice, a mailing list that you can use to keep up to date on supply chain news and upcoming events, and instructor-led training courses.

Accessing RapidResponse help systems and guides

You can access RapidResponse help systems and guides two ways:

- Access documentation directly from the Help menu in RapidResponse.
- For links to all of the available help systems and guides, see ["Determining which help system or guide to use" on page 64](#).

Account permissions and the contents of your Help menu

The list of options you see when you click the Help menu in RapidResponse depends on the permissions associated with your RapidResponse account. The more permissions you have in RapidResponse, the more options you see on the menu. For example, resource authors have more permission than general users.

Links to documentation that you are less likely to need, based on your permissions, are not shown on the Help menu. For example, users without administrator permissions do not see Administration Help.

Documentation formats

Most RapidResponse documentation resources are available as both HTML help systems and PDF documents. Some documentation is only available in PDF format.

HTML help systems are optimized for viewing in a web browser. While it is possible to print individual topics from HTML help, you will get better results if you print the topic or topics from the equivalent PDF guide.

PDF guides are optimized for printing. They can be viewed and printed using Adobe Reader®. You can download Adobe Reader from the Adobe site at www.adobe.com.

Accessing help for RapidResponse resources

Help is often available in the RapidResponse application window for individual resources of the following types:

- Dashboards and widgets
- Worksheets and workbooks
- Scorecards
- Forms
- Scripts
- Responsibility definitions

For more information, see ["Help embedded in resources" on page 68](#).

Determining which help system or guide to use

The RapidResponse documentation set includes several help systems and guides, each dealing with a different area of knowledge. The following table summarizes the available documentation, some of which you can access from the Help menu in RapidResponse.

Title	Description
<i>RapidResponse User Guide</i>	This guide provides RapidResponse users with basic reference and procedural information. It covers topics such as viewing data, modifying data as part of simulation, solving business problems, and customizing the user interface.
RapidResponse User Guide (Mobile Client)	This guide provides information on how to view and edit data in the Mobile Client.
RapidResponse Applications Guide	Practical ways to use RapidResponse and the applications that can be deployed to support business processes and make decisions. It also includes instructions aimed at RapidResponse administrators that outline how to install and configure applications.
RapidResponse Fundamental Concepts Guide	RapidResponse product overview, which includes key capabilities and the deployment methodology.

Title	Description
RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide	This guide provides information on creating and managing resources, such as dashboards, workbooks, and filters. Detailed information about RapidResponse Query language is also included.
RapidResponse Analytic and Data Model Guide	Description of the RapidResponse data model and associated analytics. All tables and fields in the data model are listed and described. This guide also notes changes to the data model corresponding to the RapidResponse release.
Data model posters	A series of posters illustrating the structure of tables and fields in RapidResponse, and the relationships between fields. For more information, see "Data Model Posters" on page 65 .
RapidResponse Administration Guide	Information for administrators, covering installation, upgrades, maintenance, system settings, and user administration.
RapidResponse Scripting Guide	Information about building custom applications using scripting language objects, functions, and methods to automate some RapidResponse processes.
RapidResponse Web Services Guide	Information on using RapidResponse Web services to create users, resources, and Web service client programs.
RapidResponse Data Integration Guide	Information about integrating enterprise data sources with RapidResponse, including mapping data from source tables and fields, customizing the RapidResponse database, extracting data from enterprise sources, performing data updates to bring new and updated data into RapidResponse, moving data between RapidResponse instances, and moving data changes between RapidResponse and business partners in real-time.
Global Help	If you are not sure which help system contains the information you need, you can search for it in this help system, which includes information from all of the other help systems.
RapidResponse Release Summary	Outlines all of the changes that have been made in RapidResponse 1906, including new features and defect resolutions in service updates. Release summaries can be found in the Kinaxis Knowledge Network in the Documentation Center.
Custom Help	Your company might have also created custom help specific to your RapidResponse implementation.

The permissions associated with your RapidResponse account affect the list of guides that you can access from the Help menu. For more information, see ["Account permissions and the contents of your Help menu" on page 63](#).

Data Model Posters

Users who have permission to create resources such as workbooks and dashboards have access to the following posters on their RapidResponse Help menus:

- *RapidResponse Data Model for Import poster*—displays the relationship between the tables and fields used in the RapidResponse data import process.
- *RapidResponse Calculated Data Model poster*—displays the relationship between the main RapidResponse database calculated tables and fields. Calculated fields in the RapidResponse data model input tables are also displayed.

- *RapidResponse Sales & Operations Planning poster* —displays the relationship between the tables used to support the Sales & Operations Planning application.
- *RapidResponse Inventory Planning and Optimization poster* —displays the relationship between the tables used to support Inventory Planning and Optimization application.
- *RapidResponse Integrated Project Management poster* —displays the relationship between the tables used to support Integrated Project Management application.
- *RapidResponse Historical Supply poster* and *RapidResponse Historical Demand poster*—displays the relationship between all tables (input, control, and calculated) that are used to store historical supply data and historical demand data, respectively.

Documentation conventions

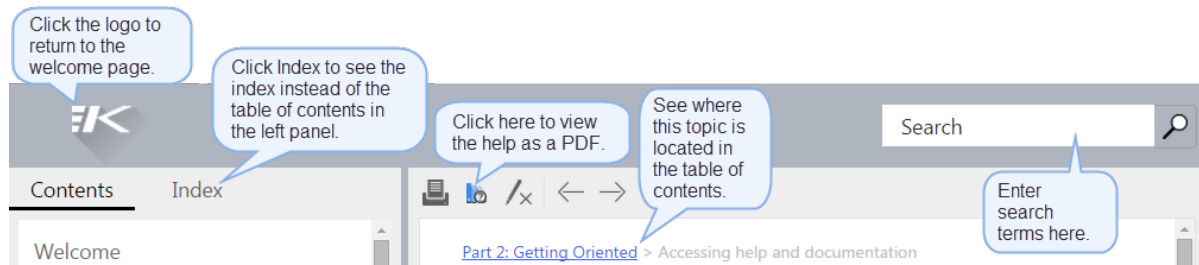
To help you quickly locate and interpret information, Kinaxis guides use conventions noted in the following table.

Convention	Description
bold	Bold is used for user-interface elements in procedures. For example: On the File menu, click New .
<i>italic</i>	Italic is used when citing other documents. For example: For more information, see the RapidResponse Administration Guide .
Courier New	Courier New is used for programming examples and text that is entered in Microsoft Windows Command Prompt window or command lines.
 Caution:	Identifies a caution message (critical information).
 Note:	Identifies a note.
 Tip:	Identifies a tip.

If you are using a Mac OS, procedures that use the Windows CTRL key should be replaced with the Mac OS Command key.

Finding the content you need in HTML help

You can find information in any RapidResponse HTML help system by searching or by browsing in the contents or the index.



Searching the help

You can find the information you require by entering a term in the Search box. You can also refine your search by using AND or OR to search for a combination of words, and you can put quotation marks around your search word or phrase to search for that exact phrasing only. For example, "sort" would return any topics with the word "sort", but not the words "sorted" or "sorting".

► Search for content

- Type a search term in the search bar and then click .



Note: If you do not want the words you searched for highlighted in the help topic, click **Remove Highlights** .



Tip: If the browser window is small, the search bar might not be displayed. To see a search bar click  or enlarge the window.

Browsing the contents and the index

You can also find information by browsing in either of these panes:

- **Contents**—Browse through the topics in the table of contents.
- **Index**—Find a topic through the index. Scroll through the index or type a word or phrase in the Search Index box to find an index entry.



Tip: If the browser window is small, the Contents and Index panes might not be displayed. To see them, click  or enlarge the window.

Your feedback

Kinaxis Inc. takes great pride in developing user-friendly applications and we hope that our documentation resources ensure a high level of usability. We welcome your feedback about the help topics you access.

If you have comments or suggestions about Kinaxis documentation or training materials, you can email them to learning-techsupport@kinaxis.com.

Help embedded in resources

Many openable RapidResponse resources have help embedded within the resource. The form the help takes depends on the type of resource.

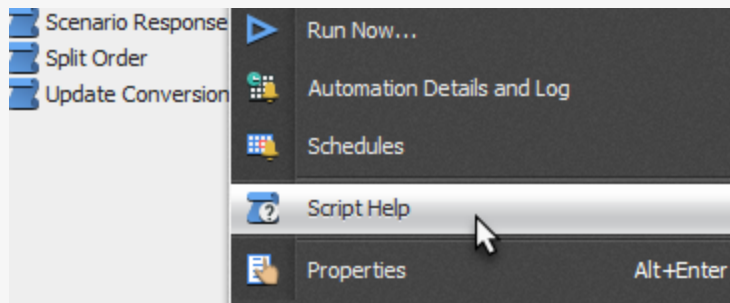
When help is available for a resource, you can view it from the open resource. You can also view the help for some types of resources from the Explorer, without having to open the resource first. These resources include workbooks, scorecards, widgets, forms, and scripts. Viewing resource help from the Explorer can help you to determine whether a resource is the right one to use, without having to wait for it to load.

► View resource help without opening the resource

- In the **Explorer**, select a resource and then click  beside the name of the resource.



Tip: You can also view resource help from the Explorer by right-clicking the name of the resource and then selecting the Help option for the resource from the menu. For example, to view help for a script, click Script Help.



View and print worksheet and workbook help

RapidResponse worksheets can include a help page that is displayed in a pane on the right-hand side of the worksheet. Workbooks might also include a help page, in which case, the help pane includes two tabs: Workbook Help and Worksheet Help.

BOM Analysis

The BOM Analysis workbook contains a number of worksheets that display part structures and relationships within a bill of material. You can look down a bill tree at all components used by a given part, or you can look up a bill tree to see all assemblies that use a given part. Other bill of material related information such as costs, lead time, and critical path can also be analyzed in this workbook.

► Show or hide the help pane

- On the **Help** menu, click **Show Workbook/Worksheet Help**.



Note: This command is not available for workbooks that do not have workbook help or help for at least one worksheet defined.



Tip: You can also show or hide the help pane by clicking **Show Workbook/Worksheet Help**  on the toolbar.

► Print the worksheet or workbook help

You can print the worksheet or workbook help when the help pane is displayed.

- On the **File** menu, click **Print**.
- Click **Worksheet help** or **Workbook Help**, and then click **OK**.



Note: The worksheet and workbook help are printed as they appear in the help pane. Widen the help pane before printing to maximize the amount of information printed on a page.



Tip: You can also print the worksheet help by right-clicking in the help pane, and then clicking **Print**.

View and print scorecard help

Each scorecard in RapidResponse includes a help page that is displayed in a pane on the right-hand side of the scorecard. You can show and hide the scorecard help pane.

- On the **Help** menu, click **Show Scorecard Help**.



Note: This command is available only for scorecards that have help defined.



Tip: You can also show or hide the scorecard help pane by clicking **Show Scorecard Help**  on the toolbar.

► Print the scorecard help

You can print the scorecard help when it is displayed.

1. On the **File** menu, click **Print**.
2. Click **Scorecard help**, and then click **OK**.



Note: The scorecard help is printed as it appears in the help pane. Widen the worksheet help pane before printing to maximize the amount of information printed on a page.



Tip: You can also print the scorecard help by right-clicking in the help pane, and then clicking **Print**.

View dashboard and widget help

Dashboard help is often available for a dashboard as a whole, and you might also be able to view help for individual widgets.

Dashboard help

Some dashboards might have an Information tab with a text widget that shows dashboard help. Dashboard help contains information about how the dashboard is intended to be used, and can include links to related resources, websites, or help videos.

Widget help

Most widgets on dashboards that are supplied with RapidResponse have widget help, and some custom widgets might also include help. Widget help typically describes the metrics displayed in a widget, and might include links to other resources such as workbooks and websites. You can access help for widgets directly from the widget controls on a widget on your dashboard.

► View widget help

- On a widget title bar, click **Actions** , and then click **Help**.

The widget help displays in a dialog box.



View form help

Forms can display two types of embedded help:

- Text on the form itself can provide information such as what action is run by the underlying script, the purpose of the form, or how best to use the form.
- Individual controls on the form might also display help specific to the control, such as the purpose of the control or what types of values it accepts.

The screenshot shows a 'Resolve Case' form with several sections and help callouts:

- Resolve Case** (Section Header)
- Case** (Section Header)
- Display case** (Text)
- Current Status** (Section Header)
- Resolution Details *** (Text)
- More information** (Section Header)
- Upload *** (Text)
- Upload more details about the case** (Text)

Help callouts include:

- A callout pointing to the top right corner: "Use this form to submit information for case resolutions."
- A callout pointing to the 'Current Status' section: "Type the summary of the resolution and include the case number."
- A callout pointing to the 'Resolution Details' section: "Resolution Details * i"
- A callout pointing to the 'More information' section: "Hover over the information ions to see help for the form or for a specific control."

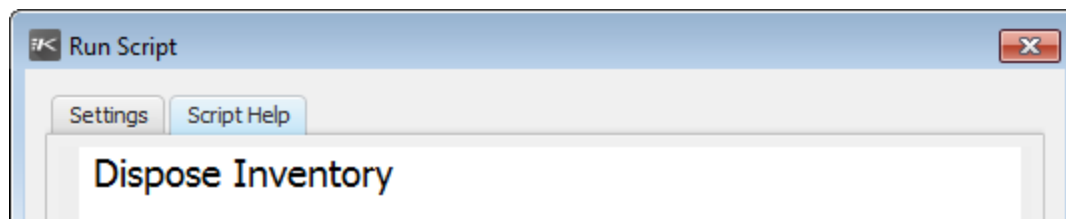
At the bottom, there is a 'Monitor' icon (a magnifying glass over a bar chart) and two buttons: **OK** and **CANCEL**.

On an open form:

- To view form help, click the information icon at the top right corner.
- To view help for a control, next to the control title click the information icon.

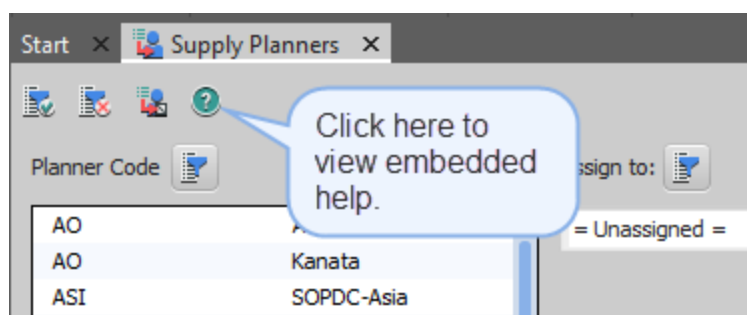
View script help

Some scripts might have embedded help. If a script has embedded help, a Script Help tab is shown when you run the script.



View help for a responsibility definition

You might be able to access embedded help for an open responsibility definition. If help is available, a Responsibility Help (?) button is available near the top left of the tab.



Resources without embedded help

Some types of resources, such as filters, cannot have embedded help, and not every resource that could have embedded help does have embedded help. Resource authors decide whether or not to include help when they create new resources that can have embedded help.

Sometimes, the information needed to use that resource might be available elsewhere. For example, if you access a dashboard by opening it from a task flow, the information you need to understand the purpose of the dashboard might be included in the task flow. Another example is a custom resource created for your company, which might be documented in company procedures that are maintained outside of RapidResponse.

Other ways to learn about RapidResponse

In addition to the RapidResponse documentation set, there are several other ways to learn about RapidResponse.

Kinaxis Knowledge Network

Visit the Kinaxis Knowledge Network at knowledge.kinaxis.com to access features including:

- [Upgrade Center](#)—Learn what's new in each version of RapidResponse.
- [Training videos](#)—Familiarize yourself with the basic capabilities of RapidResponse by taking an introductory course, delivered as a series of short videos. You can also view videos on some more advanced topics.
- [Discussion Forums](#)—Discuss RapidResponse with other users.
- [Blogs](#)—Learn how others are using RapidResponse and solving supply chain problems.

Some content is only available after you create a Kinaxis Knowledge Network user account and sign in.

News mailing list

Subscribe to the mailing list to stay up-to-date on news and upcoming supply chain events, such as Kinexions, the annual Kinaxis training and user conference. You can find the subscription form at <http://info.kinaxis.com/customer-subscription-page>.

Training courses

Kinaxis offers instructor-led courses and self-paced online training courses to help you develop in-depth RapidResponse knowledge. Instructor-led courses are usually delivered online in a virtual classroom, but on-site instruction can also be arranged. To see a list of available courses, visit <https://www2.kinaxis.com/rapidresponse-training/courses.cfm>.

CHAPTER 6: Determining where to begin

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There are several ways to determine what you need to do and begin getting work done in RapidResponse. Which one you use depends on the work you need to do, the resources that have been made available to you, and in some cases, your experience level. Often, there is more than one way to accomplish a task.

This section discusses some ways that you might begin your work in RapidResponse, and covers some basic information that all RapidResponse users need to know, including application window layout and how to locate and open resources.

Starting with a task flow

Task flows are resources intended to help you to perform routine, but complex, tasks in a standard way. Often, task flows also provide links to the other resources, such as workbooks, that you need to complete certain steps. Task flows can be particularly useful for new employees who might not be familiar with their employer's procedures yet, but task flows can also help experienced employees to complete routine tasks without errors or omissions, and locate necessary resources quickly. For more information about task flows, see ["Following standard procedures using task flows" on page 91](#).

Example

Robert signs in to RapidResponse to respond to late orders. He opens a task flow specifically designed for this task. Robert already knows how to complete each step, but he still refers to the task flow so that he doesn't forget a step. He uses the links beside the step titles to quickly open the resources he needs, using predefined data settings.

Starting with a dashboard

Some RapidResponse users begin by looking at a dashboard. The summary data displayed in dashboard widgets can help you to detect areas that require your attention. For more information, see ["Viewing data in dashboards" on page 249](#). Often, you can drill to detailed resources from widgets on a dashboard, or click links from the dashboard to open related resources.

Example

Helena is a district sales manager. The first thing she does when she signs in to RapidResponse is open a dashboard and check sales figures for the area that she is responsible for. She notices a sudden, unexpected drop in sales revenue for a particular product family, so she contacts the person responsible for the product family to find out whether the numbers are accurate.

Starting with Message Center

Most RapidResponse users can receive messages through the RapidResponse Message Center. These messages can let you know when you need to take action, and help direct you to the resources you need to complete the necessary task. You might receive messages from colleagues who would like you to investigate an issue, reminders about routine tasks that you need to complete, reports containing data that you need to review, or alerts that let you know when certain conditions (such as inventory dipping below safety stock) arise.

You can also set RapidResponse to forward these messages to your email, so even if you are not signed in to RapidResponse, you can see that something requires your attention.

For more information about Message Center, see ["Communicating using Message Center" on page 437](#).

Example

Jada checks message center as soon as she signs in to RapidResponse. She sees that her district manager has sent her a link to a dashboard, and wants to know whether last week's unusually low sales figures are accurate. Jada clicks the link to view the dashboard, and when she sees the chart, it is obvious that something isn't right. She clicks on the data point representing last week's sales, and opens the workbook containing sales data. She determines that some figures were entered using the wrong currency, so she corrects the errors.

Starting with a form

For some business tasks or series of tasks in RapidResponse, you might use a form. Only the information and controls you need to complete the tasks are included in the form. This way you can avoid making common mistakes, such as accidentally editing data in the wrong scenario. If another resource, for an example a script, is also available to complete the same task or tasks, it is recommended that you use the form each time you perform the tasks. For more information, see ["About forms" on page 601](#).

Example

Samer uses RapidResponse once a month to enter the marketing values required in the S&OP forecast calculations. He opens the Enter Forecast form from his S&OP Forecast task flow to type the marketing values. Clicking okay runs the form and submits his values to the RapidResponse database for the forecast calculations.

Starting with the process activities calendar

Some companies use RapidResponse to orchestrate business processes that involve multiple people, who are each expected to perform one or more activities within a given time frame, contributing to the overall process. If any activities in such a process are assigned to you, then you have access to a calendar showing any activities that you are responsible for, on the days that these activities are scheduled to start. You can also see which other activities in the process are in progress or completed, so you can determine whether the prerequisites for your activity have been met. For more information about processes, see ["Participating in business processes" on page 95](#).

You might view your process calendar in a dashboard, or in the Process Activities workbook.

Example

Lucy signs in to RapidResponse and checks her Process Activities calendar. She sees that she is supposed to begin an activity tomorrow. Lucy checks to see whether the prerequisite activity has been completed yet, and discovers that it has been completed. She decides to get started early. She changes the task status of her task to In Progress and then clicks the link in the activity instructions to open a task flow that details the steps for her activity.

Starting with a workbook

Sometimes, it makes sense to go straight to a workbook when you sign in to RapidResponse. This is particularly true when the task you need to accomplish is not routine. For example, you might need to search for specific data and export it to Microsoft Excel, or you might need to create a new scenario and perform a simulation. For more information, see ["Using worksheets and workbooks" on page 125](#).

Example

Konstantinos signs into his company's client's RapidResponse system and opens a workbook to review new purchase order requests. He reviews the worksheet help to refresh his memory about precisely what the information in each of the columns means, and then he responds to the requests.

Starting from the Start page

Most RapidResponse users have access to a Start page, which opens when they sign in to RapidResponse. It provides quick access to recently used resources and serves as a launching point for common activities. Your list of recently used resources can also help you to remember what you did in previous RapidResponse sessions, and either repeat tasks that you have completed previously or move

on to the next task that needs to be done. For more information, see ["Accessing resources and information from the Start page" on page 58](#).

Example

Roger signs in to RapidResponse to review a dashboard to see how well his department is meeting goals set out in the annual plan. He has recently viewed the dashboard, using the same dashboard settings he wants to use today. He clicks on the name of the dashboard in his Start page to access the dashboard directly, using the same settings. He glances at the data settings to make sure they are what he expected, and then he reviews the charts on the dashboard.

Starting with a collaboration

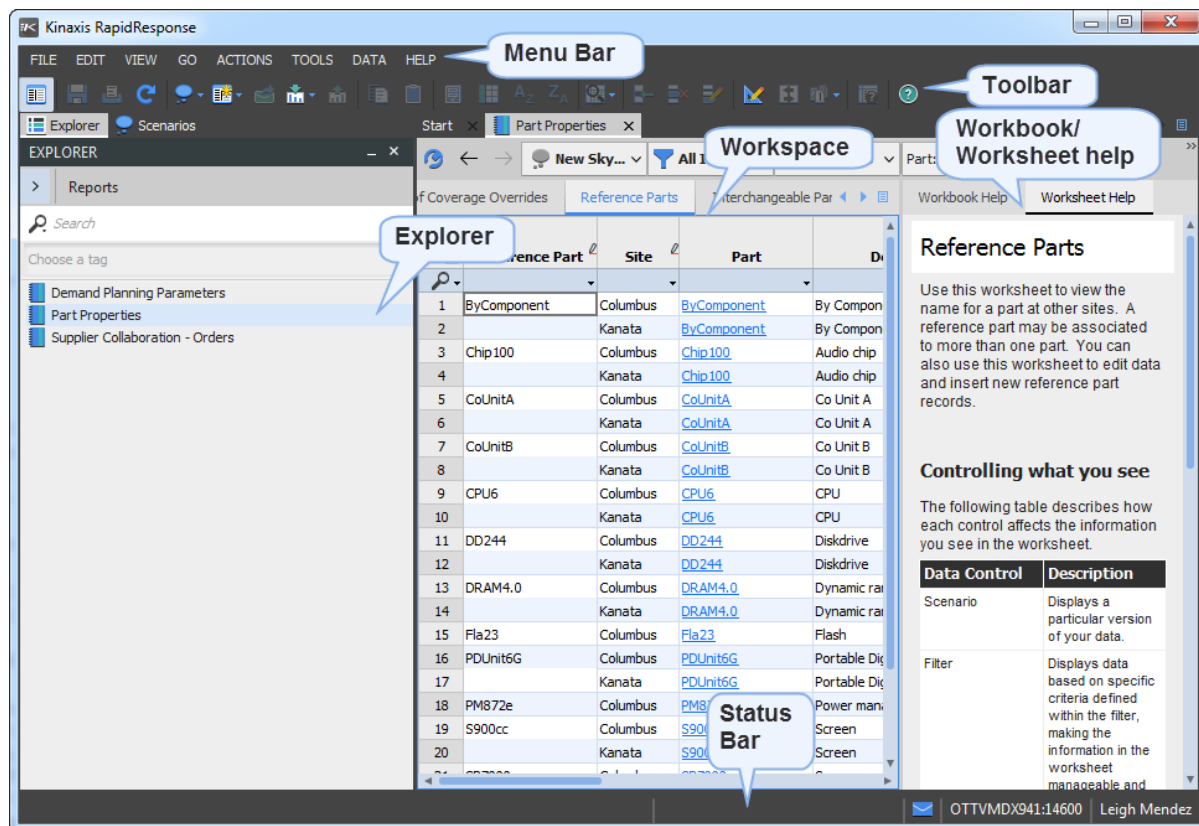
Collaborations allow RapidResponse users to assemble a team to solve complex problems that involve too many different data sources or have too much of an impact for one person to handle. Teams use collaborations to communicate, share simulated data, and compare solutions. You can start a new collaboration or you can be added to a collaboration by another participant. All the collaborations you have access to are displayed in Collaboration Center. For more information about collaborations, see ["Collaborating to solve business challenges" on page 513](#).

Example

Aman signs in to RapidResponse to check on the status of an unexpected customer order. He opens the Collaboration Center and clicks on the collaboration that was created to address the impact of this order. He sees that a number of the collaboration participants have added scenarios and posts. He reviews the information and responds to the issues that relate to his location.

RapidResponse application window basics

The following image shows an example of a RapidResponse window, and the table provides a quick overview of the items labeled in this image.



The following table describes the areas labeled in the above illustration.

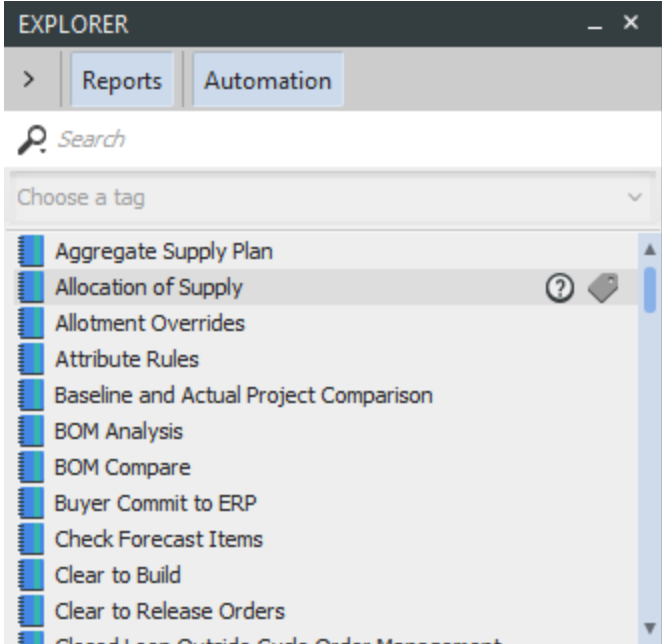
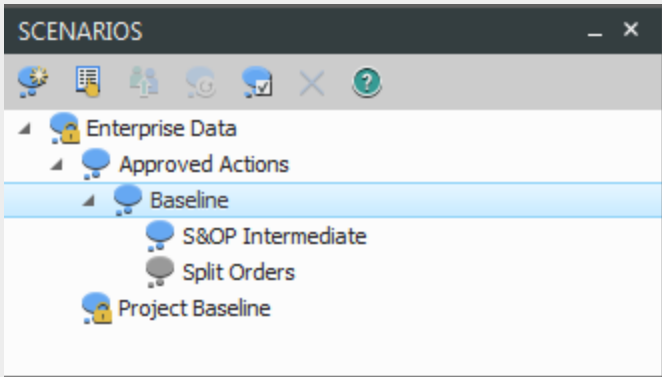
Area	Description
Toolbar	This area contains tools that provide shortcut access to the menu commands.
Workspace	The workspace area displays the resources you are using. When you open a dashboard, workbook, or scorecard, they are displayed in the workspace area, allowing you to view, modify, and analyze data. When you view a scenario's properties, the scenario properties open in the workspace area, and allows you to respond to or modify the properties of the scenario. For more information about scenarios, see "Scenarios in RapidResponse" on page 17. The workspace area can also show the Start page or the RapidResponse Message Center. The Start page provides you with quick access to resources and information. For more information, see "Accessing resources and information from the Start page" on page 58. The Message Center contains notification messages that can tell you when alert conditions have been met, when resources have been given to you, and so on. For more information, see "Communicating using Message Center" on page 437.
Explorer	The Explorer provides access to resources, and you can use it to perform many actions with resources, such as opening resources or making changes to resources. For more information, see "Finding resources using the Explorer" on page 82 .
Workbook/Worksheet Help	This pane contains help for the currently displayed worksheet. If workbook help is also defined, then a workbook help tab is also available in this pane. For more information, see "View and print worksheet and workbook help" on page 68 .

Area	Description
Menu Bar	This area contains the menu bar, which provides access to various commands from pull-down menus.
Status Bar	The status bar displays information about RapidResponse, including your name, the server you are signed in to, and whether you have unread messages. The status bar also displays automatically-calculated statistics about data you have selected. For more information, see "View auto statistics for selected data" on page 169 .

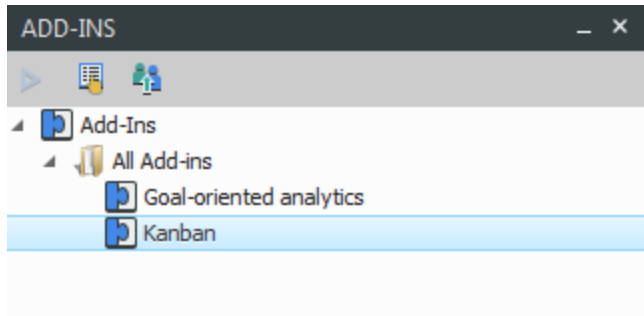
There are several ways you can customize the arrangement of your workspace. For more information, see ["Arranging your workspace" on page 111](#).

Summary of RapidResponse panes

The following is a summary of the panes you might be able to access, and some of the tasks that can be performed within each pane.

Pane	Description
Explorer	The Explorer pane allows you to view and open resources that you have access to. Resources include reports (dashboards, workbooks, and scorecards), tasks (task flows, forms, business processes, and responsibility definitions), automation resources (alerts, scheduled tasks, scripts, and automation chains) and filtering resources (filters and hierarchies). You can also perform a search to narrow down the list of resources. For more information, see "Finding resources using the Explorer" on page 82. Depending on the permissions you have been granted by your RapidResponse administrator, you might also be able to perform resource management activities, such as editing or sharing resources, in the Explorer. For more information, see "Managing resources" on page 99. 
Scenarios	If you have access to the Scenarios pane, you can view a list of scenarios available to you in reports, create scenarios, and perform simulations. You might also be able to share scenarios. For more information, see "Scenarios in RapidResponse" on page 17. 

Pane	Description
Add-ins	Provides access to custom applications, generally developed by your company, that extend base RapidResponse functionality. For more information, see "Extensions and add-in applications" on page 555 .
Extensions	Your RapidResponse administrator defines the content of the Extensions pane. It can be used to provide access to optional Web-based application, your company intranet and documents, and important Web sites. For more information, see "Extensions and add-in applications" on page 555 .



Searching for items in a navigation pane

If one of the panes in RapidResponse contains a large number of items, for example, scenarios, you can search for a specific item.

1. Click inside the pane.
2. Begin typing the name of the item. A text box is displayed at the top of the pane.
You can also use the * and ? wildcards to search for text fragments and use the arrow keys to scroll through the items in the pane that match the search criteria. For example, searching for To* in the scenarios pane finds scenarios whose names begin with "To" and end with any number of characters. For more information about the wildcards, see ["Operators and wildcards" on page 195](#).
3. Once you find the resource, press **ESC** to close the text box.

The Explorer pane also has its own special search functions. For more information, see ["Finding resources using the Explorer" on page 82](#).

Finding resources using the Explorer

Every RapidResponse user has access to at least one openable resource, which can be a report (dashboard, workbook or scorecard), a task, or an automation resource. If you have more than one resource you can open or you have resource authoring permission, you can locate all types of resources using the Explorer.

► Open the Explorer to view resources

- On the **Go** menu, click **Explorer**.

If the **Explorer** button  is shown at the left side of the RapidResponse window, you can also click this button to open the **Explorer**.

► Open a report, task, or automation resource

- In the **Explorer**, select the resource you want to open.
- On the **Actions** menu, click **Open**.



Notes:

- You might be able to access certain resources by clicking on links from other resources. For example, you might be able to open a workbook from a dashboard widget. Some of these resources that you access through links might not appear in the Explorer. For more information, see ["Resources that can only be opened from links" on page 88](#).
- Some resources, such as filters, are listed in the Explorer, but cannot be opened.
- If a  displays next to a resource that you have selected or hovered over with your mouse pointer, you can click it to view the help for that resource. This can help you to determine whether it is the resource you are looking for before opening the resource and waiting for data to load.



Tips:

- You can also open a resource by double-clicking it in the Explorer or by selecting it in the Explorer and pressing Enter on your keyboard.
- You can use the Search Resources tool to search for text in more locations than just the title of the resource. For example, you could find a workbook that uses a specific word in a column heading. For more information, see ["Search for a report that contains a specific text string" on page 86](#).

► Open another copy of a report

You can open another copy of a report (dashboard, workbook, or scorecard) that you already have open. For example, you might want to compare the data in the report with different data settings applied.

1. In the **Explorer**, select a report that is already opened.
2. On the **File** menu, click **Open in New Tab** .



Tip: You can also open a report on a new tab by right-clicking the name of the report in the **Explorer**, and then clicking **Open in New Tab** .

Searching and filtering resources

Narrowing down the list of resources can make it easier to find the what you need when you have a long list of resources in the Explorer. You can use the following strategies:

- Apply basic or advanced filtering options
- Search for a resource by name
- Only show resources with a specific tag

These strategies can be used in combination to narrow down the selection further.

Your filtering, tag selections, and searches in the Explorer persist when you sign out of RapidResponse and sign back in. For example, if you select the option to view only filters in the Explorer, the next time you sign in to RapidResponse, you will only see filters in the Explorer, until you make a different selection.

Apply basic or advanced filtering options

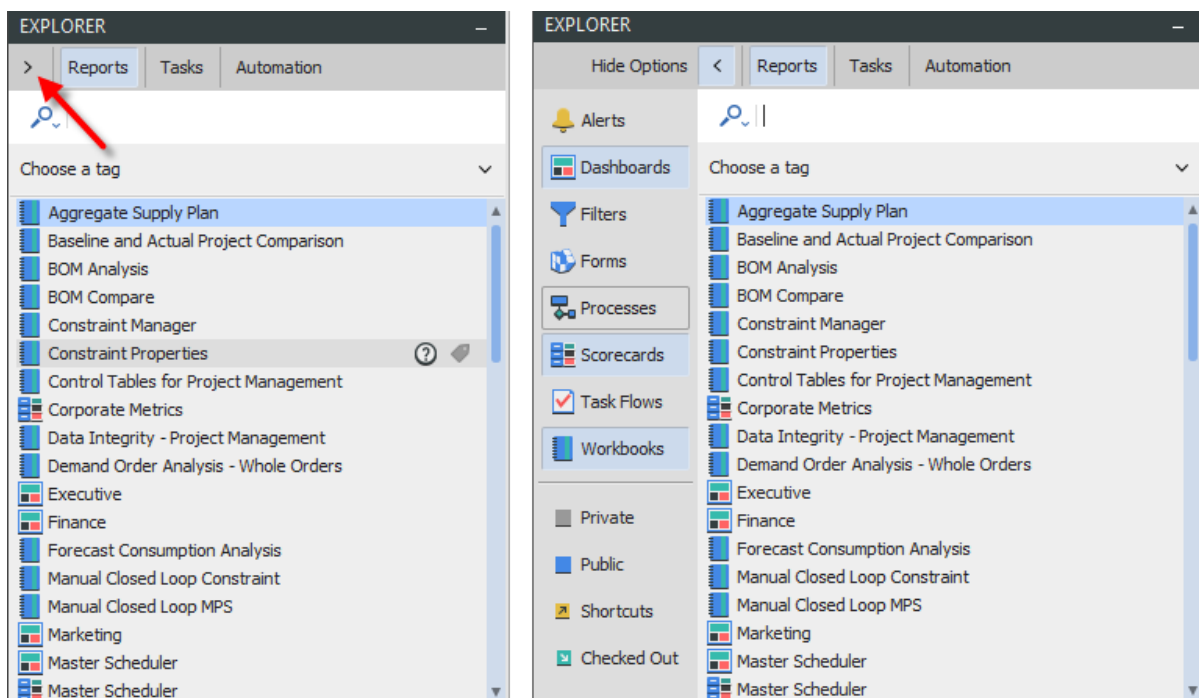
You can use the basic filtering options to select categories of resources to see. These basic filtering options are available:

- **Reports**—shows dashboards, workbooks, and scorecards.
- **Tasks**—shows task flows, forms, processes, and responsibility definitions.
- **Automation**—shows alerts, scripts, scheduled tasks, and automation chains.

To view a list of all resources, which includes the sites, hierarchies, and filters that you have access to, de-select all three basic filtering options—Reports, Tasks, and Automation—or use advanced filtering options.

Advanced filtering options allow you to select any combination of resource types to view. You can also view only public resources, only private resources, or only shortcuts. Users with authoring permission also have the option to view only resources that are checked out of the resource repository.

The following illustration shows the Explorer, without the advanced filtering options shown, and with them shown. The red arrow points to the Show Options button.



► Use basic filtering options to limit the resources listed

- In the **Explorer**, click any of the following buttons to select or deselect it:

- **Reports**—Shows dashboards, workbooks, and scorecards.
- **Tasks**—Shows forms, processes, responsibilities, and task flows.
- **Automation**—Shows alerts, automation chains, scheduled tasks, and scripts.

When a button is selected, it is highlighted and resources in that category are listed in the **Explorer**.

► Use advanced filtering options to limit the resources listed

1. In the **Explorer**, click .

Advanced filtering options appear at the left side of the **Explorer**.

2. Select the type of resource you want to see.



Note: If no basic or advanced filtering options are selected, all of the resources that you have access to are listed. This can occur if you select one or more basic filtering options, and then deselect all of the basic filtering options without selecting any advanced filtering options.



Tip: You can select multiple advanced filtering options by holding down the **CTRL** key and clicking each of the options that you want to select.

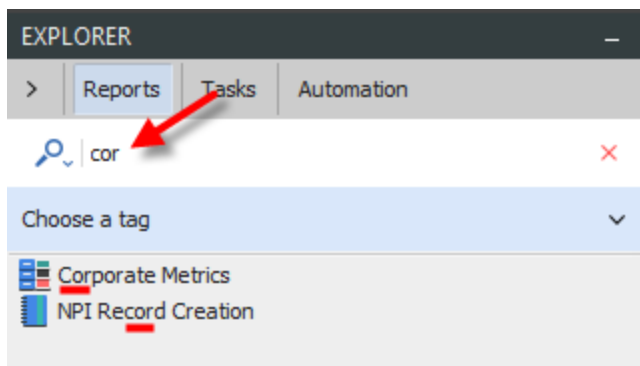
Search for a resource by name

You can search for a resource by typing all or part of its name. The more characters you type, the narrower your selection becomes.

You can also search for a report using text, such as the name of a worksheet or a widget, that might not be included in the name of the resource. For more information, see ["Search for a report that contains a specific text string" on page 86](#).

► Search for a resource by name

- In the search bar of the **Explorer**, type all or part of the name of the resource.



Tip: You can click the  button on the search bar and select Match from start or Match anywhere to change the way RapidResponse determines what is a match. In the example shown here, the default option, Match anywhere, is selected. If Match from start were selected, NPI Record Creation would not be included in the search results.

Only show resources with a specific tag

Some resources might be marked with tags to identify them as belonging to a group of related resources. A resource can have multiple tags applied.

There are two types of tags: global and personal.

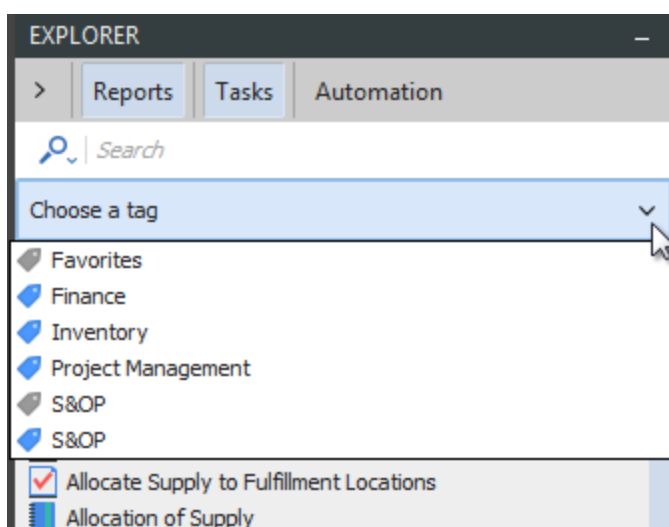
Global tags can be applied to shared resources by administrators, and are visible to everyone who has access to the tagged resources. For example, all project management resources or financial planning resources might be grouped together using a global tag. Global tags are identified with blue icons .

Personal tags can be applied by any user to any resource listed in the Explorer. A personal tag is visible only to the user who created it. For example, you might apply a personal tag to the resources that you use to produce forecasts for your company's annual plan, or you might create a favorites tag that you apply to resources that you use often. Personal tags are identified with gray icons . For information about creating personal tags, see ["Creating personal resource tags" on page 107](#).

You can only view results for one tag at a time in the Explorer.

► Only show resources with a specific tag

- From the **Choose a tag** menu, select a tag.



Note: You can also manage your resources in the Explorer. For more information about managing resources, see ["Managing resources" on page 99](#).

Search for a report that contains a specific text string

You can search the dashboards and workbooks directly available to you in order to find the ones that contain a specific text string. The following elements are searched:

- Workbooks—workbook names, column headers, chart titles, worksheet names, column help, worksheet help, or workbook help.
- Dashboards—dashboard titles, widget titles

For example, suppose you know you have a worksheet that reports supply and demand balances, but you do not remember which workbook it is in. You can search the workbooks for the term "balance" to find worksheets that contain a Balance column. The search results would also include any workbooks that contain the term "balance" somewhere other than the column header, and dashboards that have "balance" in their names or their widget names.



Tip: You can also use the Explorer to search for text strings in workbook, dashboard, and widget names. For more information, see ["Finding resources using the Explorer" on page 82](#).

This type of search is different from searching in a worksheet to find a specific data value. For information about searching for data within a worksheet, see ["Search for specific data" on page 190](#). This type of search is also different from searching for a workbook or other resource based on its title. For information about searching for workbooks by title, see ["Finding resources using the Explorer" on page 82](#).

Search results are displayed in the Search Resources window, which is shown in the following illustration.

The screenshot shows the 'Search Resources' window with the search term 'Finance'. The results show 12 resources with 25 occurrences. A detailed view of the 'S&OP Consensus Demand Planning Widgets' workbook shows two matches: 'Finance' in the column header and 'Finance' in the column help.

Resource	Occurrences
Inventory Planning	1
S&OP Consensus Demand Planning	1
S&OP Consensus Demand Planning Widgets	2

Worksheet	Found In	Item
Consensus Demand Plan - Revenue Chart	Column header	Finance
Consensus Demand Plan - Revenue Chart	Column help	Finance

In this example, the term "Finance" was found in 25 places in 12 reports. You can expand each report's results to determine where in the report your search term is used. In this example, there are two matches in the S&OP Consensus Demand Planning Widgets workbook, including in a column header and column help for the Consensus Demand Plan - Revenue Chart worksheet.

If you search for a text string that includes multiple words, results are returned for the complete phrase, and not for the individual words in the text string. For example, if you search for 'Ship Set Available', you get results only for columns or help entries that contain the full text string 'Ship Set Available', such as "Ship Set Available Date". This search does not match columns or help that contain 'Ship', 'Set', or 'Available' individually.

You can open workbooks and dashboards from the result list. Alternatively, you can copy the list of results into another program, such as Microsoft Excel, if you want to make a permanent record of the workbooks and dashboards that contain the text string.

RapidResponse users with authoring permissions can perform more advanced searches. For more information, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

► Search for a text string

1. On the **Tools** menu, click **Search Resources**.
2. In the **Search Resources Settings** dialog box, type the text string you want to search for, and then click **OK**.

The search is not case sensitive. For example, searching for 'demand' or 'Demand' produce the same search results.

► Open a resource

1. In the **Search Resources** window, click the workbook you want to open.
2. Optionally, click the ► symbol beside the resource, and then click the worksheet or tab you want to view.
3. On the **Search Resources** toolbar, click **Open** .



Tip: You can also open a resource by double-clicking the worksheet or tab you want to open.

► Copy search results

1. On the **Search Results** toolbar, click **Copy search results to the Clipboard** .
2. Paste the results into another application, such as Microsoft Excel or Microsoft Word.

► Perform another search

1. On the **Search Resources** toolbar, click **Search Settings** .
2. Type the text string you want to search for, and then click **OK**.

Resources that can only be opened from links

RapidResponse resource authors can create resources that link to other resources. Examples include a workbook linking to other workbooks or a dashboard widget linking to scorecards and task flows.

By creating links, resource authors can create a simplified user experience. For example, a single workbook might be used as a launching point for several other workbooks.

If someone has shared a resource with you, and it links to other resources that have not been shared with you directly, the only resource that will display in the Explorer will be the shared, or main, resource. This means you can open the shared resource from the Explorer and all of the linked resources can only be opened from the shared resource. For example, if someone shares a workbook with you, and that workbook links to five other workbooks, only the main (originally shared) workbook will be available from the Explorer.



Note: If you have permission to create alerts, you can create alerts based on linked workbooks.

The following table summarizes the RapidResponse resources that can be linked.

Main resource	Can link to
Dashboard widget	• Workbooks • Dashboards • Scorecards • Task flows
Script	• Workbooks • Scripts
Scorecard	• Workbooks
Task flow	• Workbooks • Scorecards • Forms
Workbook	• Scripts • Workbooks • Forms

 **Note:** If a task flow is shared with you, any linked resources (workbooks and scorecards) are available from the Explorer.

CHAPTER 7: Following standard procedures using task flows

A task flow is a series of steps you follow to complete an overall process or task. For example, a task flow to simulate the effect of reducing the safety stock level for a group of parts might include steps to create a new scenario, change the safety stock value in a worksheet, compare the new scenario to existing scenarios, and so on.

You might have access to task flows that have been shared with you. These are likely specific to your job function. RapidResponse includes predefined task flows for common business procedures. Custom task flows might also be created to address the specific needs of your company. If you have task flow authoring permissions, you can create your own task flows. For information about creating your own task flows, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

Often, task flows contain action buttons that you can click to quickly open resources that are necessary to complete the task. These can include dashboards, workbooks, scorecards, forms, or additional task flows. Task flows can also include buttons that launch scenario actions, including creating, deleting, sharing, updating, and committing scenarios.

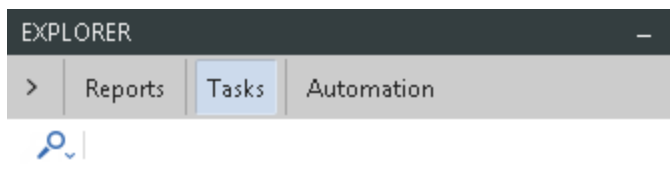
Open and follow a task flow

If you have access to task flows, you can access them in the Explorer.

When you open a task flow, it appears in a pane at the right side of the screen. When you open multiple task flows at the same time, each appears on its own tab at the right side of the screen.

► Open a task flow

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that task flows are shown. You can do this by selecting **Tasks**.



2. Double-click the task flow to open it.



Tips:

- You can also open a task flow by selecting it and then clicking **Open** on the **File** menu.
- For quicker access to your most frequently used tasks flows, you can create shortcuts. For more information, see ["Access favorite resources quickly" on page 103](#).



- If you always open a task flow when starting RapidResponse, consider automatically opening it upon sign in. For more information, see ["Open a resource automatically upon signing in" on page 103](#).

In the task flow, a list of steps appears in the top section. Instructions for the selected step appear in the bottom section.

► View instructions for a step

- Click a step in the list to select it.



Tip: You can also move to the next step or the previous step by clicking the arrow buttons at the top of the task flow.

Task flows with steps that use a specific resource are identified with an icon for the resource required to complete the step. For example, some task flows might require that you open a workbook, or that you create a new scenario. Some task flow steps might also open resources needed for the first step or steps automatically when the task flow opens.

► Launch the action associated with a step

- Click  on the task flow toolbar.



Tip: You can also launch the action by double-clicking the step title.

Click these arrows to move up and down through the task flow steps.

Click the arrow to open the resource or dialog box required to complete the step.

Steps that automatically open resources or dialog boxes are identified with this icon next to the step number.

Task flow steps

Steps that allow you to open a resource or dialog box are identified with an icon.

Procedure to complete the step

Step Number	Icon	Task Name
1		Open dashboard
2		Introduction
3	Checkmark	Define and update constraint targets
4		Analyze the constraints
5	Lightbulb	Create a scenario
6	Checkmark	Create new constraints
7	Book	Modify the existing constraints
8	Book	Assign additional parts to existing constraints
9	Book	Review and adjust the constraint factor
10	Book	Analyze the adjusted constraints
11	Book	Adjust constraints to increase availability
12	Checkmark	Review the simulated changes to constraints
13	Book	View and update assumptions
14	Checkmark	Commit the scenario
15	Book	Close the loop with enterprise data
16		Close the task flow

The **Define and Update Constraint Targets** task flow walks you through the process of defining and updating targets that your company might have for constraints. The targets are generally set as part of an Annual Planning process within Sales & Operations

To help you follow a task flow, you have the option of printing by clicking **Print**  in the task flow reading pane. You can also hide the task flow or re-size the task flow window if it is taking up too much room on your screen. For more information, see ["Adjust task flow reading pane" on page 117](#).

CHAPTER 8: Participating in business processes

View process activities	95
Change the status of your activities	96

Every company owns complex processes that are performed on a regular basis. Often, these processes can be cumbersome, inefficient, not properly tracked, and not performed consistently from instance to instance. RapidResponse offers the capability to define processes, compiling the activities and performers of a given process in a logical manner, allowing for a consistent execution of processes that occur frequently within a company.

Like task flows, processes outline steps and provide instructions, but they coordinate the activities of multiple individuals on a larger scale. Execution of a process requires a person, typically referred to as a process owner, designated for starting the process instance and monitoring its progress. While the process owner coordinates the overall execution, performers are responsible for individual activities in the process.

When you are designated as a performer in one or more process activities, you are granted access to a process calendar that lets you view information about the activities you are responsible for. You can also adjust the status of your activities to let the process owner know when they are in progress or finished. Depending on how a process is configured, performers might receive automated messages in Message Center about process activities. For example, you could receive a message to inform you that a process activity you are responsible for is scheduled to start soon.

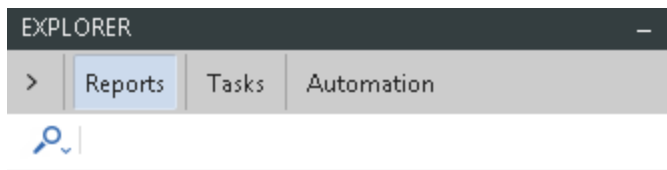
Performers can be individual RapidResponse users, but performers can also be groups of users defined within RapidResponse. For example, if you belong to the Marketing group, you can view the process activities that the Marketing group is responsible for, and change the status of these activities. When a group that is designated as a performer for an activity, any automated messages about the activity are delivered to all members of the group. Groups are defined by RapidResponse administrators.

For information about running a process instance, see ["Running business processes" on page 543](#).

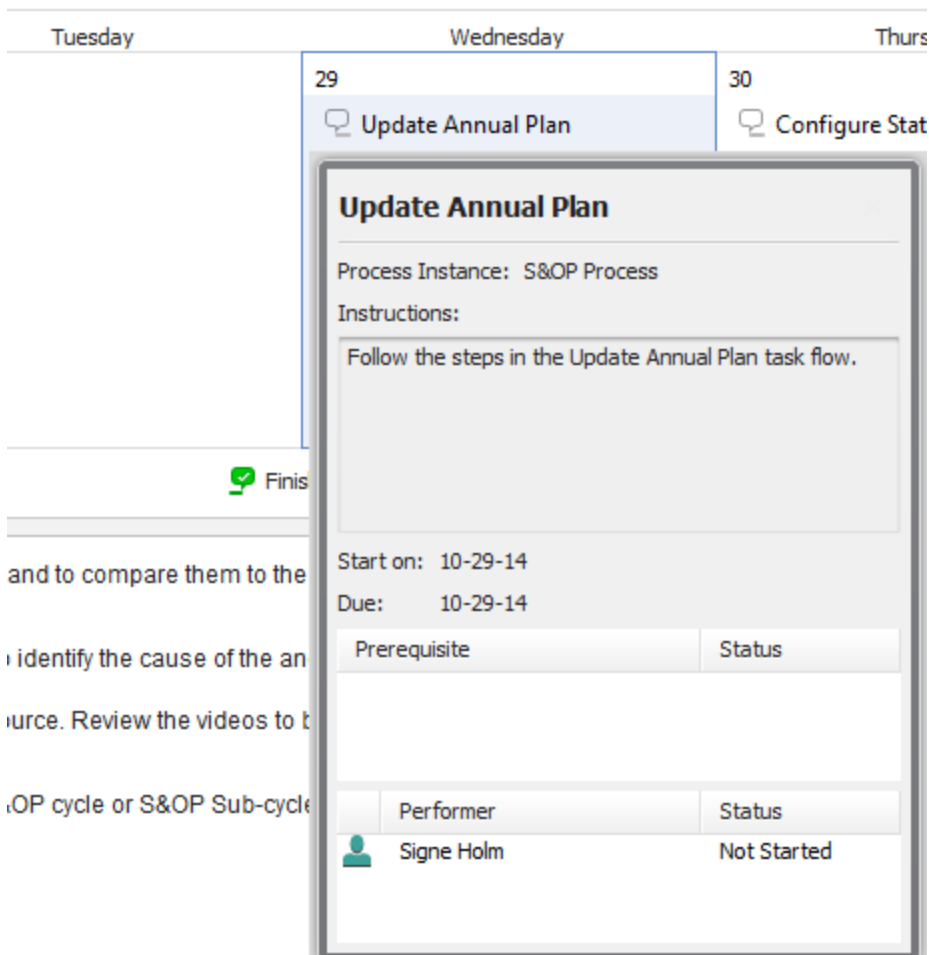
View process activities

If you are defined as a performer of any activities within a process in RapidResponse, then you have access to a dashboard that includes a calendar widget for the process. The calendar displays all of the activities you are tasked with performing, on the day that they are scheduled to start.

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that dashboards are shown. You can do this by selecting **Reports**.



2. Double-click the dashboard that contains the calendar widget for a process you are involved in.
3. Click the activity that you want to perform. In the pop-up dialog box you can see instructions for the activity, and sometimes, a link to the RapidResponse resource required to complete the activity.

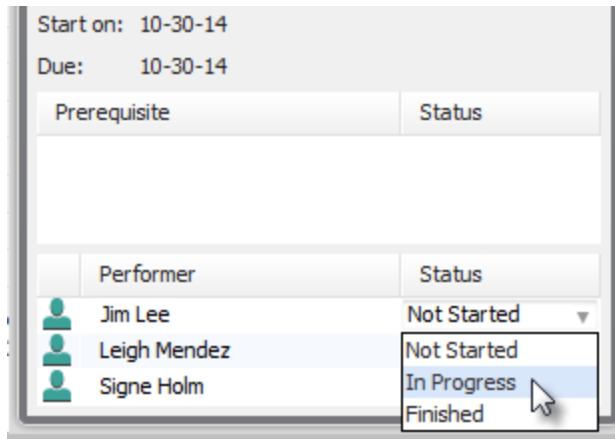


Change the status of your activities

You can change the status of the activities you are assigned to as you begin work on them and when they are complete.

Typically, you will change the status of your activities in a dashboard designated for your role in the process. For example, if you are participating in an S&OP process, you will use an S&OP dashboard, specific to your role in the process.

1. On the dashboard calendar widget, click the activity that you want to change.
2. In the list at the bottom of the dialog box, click a status, as shown in the following illustration.



3. Click outside the pop-up dialog box or click the close button on the dialog box toolbar.

CHAPTER 9: Managing resources

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Managing resources includes:

- Creating resources. For more information, see ["Creating new resources" on page 101](#).
- Viewing the properties of resources. For more information, see ["Viewing resource properties" on page 101](#).
- Editing, copying, renaming, deleting resources. For more information, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).
- Giving and sharing resources. For more information, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).
- Importing and exporting resources. For more information, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).
- Creating shortcuts. For more information, see ["Access favorite resources quickly" on page 103](#).
- Assigning tags to resources. For more information, see ["Creating personal resource tags" on page 107](#).

Which of these actions you can perform might depend on several factors, such as:

- What type of resource it is
- What permissions have been granted to you by your RapidResponse administrator
- Who owns the resource
- Whether the resource is shared or private. For information about identifying private and shared resources, see ["Private and shared resources" on page 100](#).
- Whether the resource is checked out of the versioned repository. For information about resource versioning, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

How permissions affect what you can do with resources

You might have permissions that allow you to perform certain resource management actions with some types of resources, but not others. For each resource type, there are two permissions you can have: permission to create resources and permission to share them.

- **Permission to create**—Many resource management actions are only possible if you have permission to create resources of that type. When you have permission to create resources of a particular type, you can also own, copy, import, export, and view the properties of resources of that type. You own all resources that you create, unless you give them to someone else. You can only rename, give, or delete resources that you own.
- **Permission to share**—There might be types of resources that you can create, but not share with other users. Since you must own a resource to share it, it is not possible to share a type of resource that you do not have permission to create.

Private and shared resources

Every resource that you have access to is either private or shared.

- Private resources are resources that you own. Other RapidResponse users do not have access to them.
- Shared resources are resources that more than one RapidResponse user has access to.

Private resources can become shared, but shared resources cannot be made private again. For more information about sharing resources, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

Icons for private and shared resources

You can tell from the appearance of a resource's icon in the Explorer whether it is private or shared. When an icon is not colored, it is private. For example, this is an icon for a private workbook: . When a resource is shared, the icon is shown in color. For example, this is an icon for a shared workbook: .

Private resources

You can own private resources of any type that you have permission to create. These might be resources that you created yourself, or resources that someone else created and then gave to you.

Shared resources

A shared resource that you have access to might be owned by you, or by another user. Even if you cannot create a type of resource, you can still have access to resources of that type that other users have shared with you.

Cautions:

- If a shared resource that you have access to is owned by someone else, the resource owner can make changes to it. These changes might affect the way the resource functions in ways that are not obvious, such as changing the way calculations are performed. You are not automatically informed about these changes.



- Resources that use private data settings such as a private filter or hierarchy should not be shared with other users unless the data settings are changed. For more information, see ["Send a resource link" on page 442](#).

Creating new resources

Your RapidResponse administrator might have granted you permission to create one or more types of resources. The process for creating new resources varies depending on the resource that you are creating, and it is recommended that you view documentation specific to the type of resource that you are creating.

- For information about creating static filters, see ["Create or modify a filter" on page 179](#).
- For information about creating alerts, see ["Create an alert to monitor worksheet data" on page 574](#) and ["Create an alert to monitor scorecard data" on page 581](#).
- For information about creating automation chains, see ["Automating sequences of tasks" on page 607](#).
- For information about creating scripts, see the [RapidResponse Scripting Guide](#).
- For information about creating any other type of resource, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

► Begin creating a new resource

- From the **File** menu, select **New**.
- Select a type of resource to create.

The steps required to configure the new resource depend on the type of resource.



Note: When you create a new resource, it is always a private resource. Depending on the permissions that have been granted to you by your RapidResponse administrator, you might be able to share the resource with other users after creating it. For more information, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).



Tips:

- You can also begin creating a new resource by clicking the New Resource  button on the toolbar and selecting the type of resource you want to create.
- You can also begin creating a new resource by opening the Explorer and right-clicking any resource, selecting New, and then selecting the type of resource you want to create.

Viewing resource properties

You can view the properties of resources of any type that you have permission to create. You can also view the properties of any process that has been shared with you, and you might be able to view the properties of workbooks that have been shared with you even if you cannot create workbooks.

If you can view the properties of a resource, when you select the resource in the Explorer, the Properties option is available on the Actions menu.

Information contained in resource properties

Resource properties provide information about the resource, such as the name of its owner and when it was created, and they often define the way the resource functions.

Sometimes, the resource properties contain the complete definition of the resource. For example, you can discover everything there is to know about a filter by viewing its properties.

Other times, the resource properties contain only part of the definition of a resource. For example, dashboard properties contain information about some of the dashboard's global settings, but they do not tell you which widgets are on the dashboard, how the widgets are arranged, or what the settings for each individual widget are.

► View the properties of a resource

1. Select the resource in the **Explorer**.
2. From the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.

For information about viewing workbook and worksheet properties, see "[View workbook and worksheet properties](#)" on page 102.

View workbook and worksheet properties

If you have the appropriate permissions, you can view workbook properties to find out more information about a workbook, such as the author of the workbook, the tables the worksheets in the workbook are based on, and any special expressions used in the worksheet columns to display data.

For more information about workbook or worksheet properties, click the **Help** button in the **Workbook Properties** or **Worksheet Properties** dialog box.

► View workbook properties

1. In the **Explorer**, select a workbook.
2. On the **File** menu, click **Properties**.

► View worksheet properties

1. In an open workbook, select the worksheet for which you want to view properties.
2. On the **File** menu, point to **Properties**, and then click **Worksheet Properties**.

► View column properties

1. In an open workbook, select the column for which you want to view properties.
2. On the **File** menu, point to **Properties**, and then click **Column Properties**.



Tip: You can also access properties by clicking **Workbook Properties**  on the toolbar, and then clicking **Workbook Properties**, **Worksheet Properties**, or **Column Properties**.

Open a resource automatically upon signing in

If you use a dashboard, workbook, scorecard, or task flow frequently, or begin with it when you start your work in RapidResponse, you can have it open automatically each time you sign in.

1. On the **Tools** menu, click **Options**.
2. Click the **Settings** tab.
3. In the **On sign in** area, select the **Open** check box, and then click the resource or shortcut you want.



Notes:

- If you only have access to one resource, it will open automatically when you log in to RapidResponse.
- This setting only applies to the Desktop Client. It does not apply to the Mobile Client.



Tips:

- If you want to open a resource with specific data settings applied, create a shortcut before performing this procedure and select it from the list.
- If profile pictures are enabled on your RapidResponse system, you can access **Options** by clicking on your profile picture in the RapidResponse toolbar.

Access favorite resources quickly

You can use shortcuts to open workbooks or scorecards with specific data settings, or to open a workbook to a specific worksheet. This can save you time if you frequently open a resource with the same data settings, because it eliminates the need to choose multiple data settings every time you open the resource.

Even if you do not need to open resources with specific data settings, you can create shortcuts to help you find them quickly. There is a button in the Explorer that allows you to view only shortcuts, which can help you to narrow down the list. You can also create shortcuts with easy-to-remember names to help you find resources with difficult-to-remember names that other users might have shared with you.

Shortcuts are available for the following types of resources:

- Scorecards
- Scripts
- Workbooks

For more information, see ["Create a shortcut to display workbook data" on page 104](#) and ["Create a shortcut to display scorecard data" on page 106](#).

Creating shortcuts to scripts

When creating a shortcut to a script, you can specify values for script arguments, which are then used as the default values each time you use the shortcut to run the script. For more information about running

scripts, see ["Run a script" on page 623](#).



Tip: Another way to make it easier to find resources is to apply tags to them. For more information, see ["Creating personal resource tags" on page 107](#).

► Create a new shortcut

1. In the **Explorer**, select a frequently used resource. For more information, see ["Finding resources using the Explorer" on page 82](#).
2. On the **File** menu, point to **New**, then click **Shortcut**.
3. If you do not want the shortcut to have the same name as the resource, type a new name in the **Name** box.

► Display only shortcuts in the Explorer

1. Ensure that the advanced filtering options are shown in the **Explorer**. If you do not see the advanced filtering options, click  to display them.
2. Select the types of resources you want to see shortcuts for. To select more than one type of resource, hold down the **CTRL** key while you make your selections.
3. Select  **Shortcuts**.

► Open a resource using a shortcut

- In the **Explorer**, double-click the shortcut.

Create a shortcut to display workbook data

If you use a workbook frequently with specific data settings (scenario, filter, site, and so on), you can create a shortcut to the workbook. The selections made from these controls are then used each time you open the workbook using the shortcut.

Shortcuts are also useful for opening workbooks to a specific worksheet.

► Create a shortcut from an open workbook

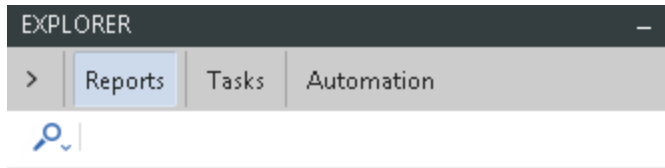
1. In an open workbook, specify the data settings you want the shortcut to include.
2. On the **File** menu, point to **New**, then click **Shortcut** .
3. In the **New Shortcut** dialog box, verify the settings are set the way you want.



Note: You cannot create a shortcut to a workbook that can only be opened by clicking a link in another workbook. For more information, see ["Resources that can only be opened from links" on page 88](#).

► **Create a shortcut to open a workbook with specific settings**

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that workbooks are shown. You can do this by selecting **Reports**.



2. Select a workbook.
3. On the **File** menu, point to **New**, then click **Shortcut** . You can also right-click a workbook in the **Explorer**, and then click **New** .
4. In the **Name** box, change the default name. This step is optional.
5. In the **Worksheet** list, click the worksheet that the shortcut will open.
Select **Default Worksheet**, to open the last worksheet you viewed.
6. To define the data that is displayed, select the check boxes you want, and click an item in the corresponding lists.
7. If the workbook contains multi-scenario columns and you want it to open with specific scenarios, do the following:
 - Select the **Scenarios** check box.
 - Click **Select**.
 - In the **Scenarios** dialog box, in the **Select from this list** box, click the scenarios you want to add, and then click **Add**.
 - Click **OK**.
 - To remove a scenario, select it in the list and then click **Remove**.
8. If the workbook includes hierarchies and you want to specify a hierarchy for the workbook to open with, do the following:
 - Select the **Hierarchy** check box.
 - Click **Hierarchy Settings**.
 - In the **Hierarchy Settings** dialog box, select the hierarchy you want to apply to the worksheet.
 - To add additional hierarchies, click **Add Hierarchy**, and then click a hierarchy in the list.
 - Select the hierarchy value or values you want to apply to the worksheet.
For information about selecting multiple values in hierarchies, see "[Filter and summarize data with hierarchies](#)" on page 304.
 - To remove a hierarchy, click the **X** button  beside the hierarchy list.
 - Click **OK**.



Notes:

- If the workbook author has defined settings that cannot be set by modifying the workbook toolbar controls, you should specify a value for each setting in the **New Shortcut** dialog box.
- You can add as many hierarchies as you have access to, to a maximum of five.
- If the workbook you created the shortcut to becomes unavailable to you, the shortcut is automatically deleted.



Tip: You can also create a shortcut by selecting a workbook in the **Explorer** and clicking **New Shortcut**  on the **Actions** menu or **New Resource**  on the RapidResponse toolbar, followed by **New Shortcut** .

Create a shortcut to display scorecard data

If you use a scorecard often, you can create a shortcut to open that scorecard with the scenarios, filter, site, and hierarchy settings (if the scorecard includes the hierarchy panel) you analyze most often.

You can choose to only show shortcuts in the Explorer, making it easier to find your shortcuts quickly. For more information, see ["Display only shortcuts in the Explorer" on page 104](#).

► Create a shortcut from an open scorecard

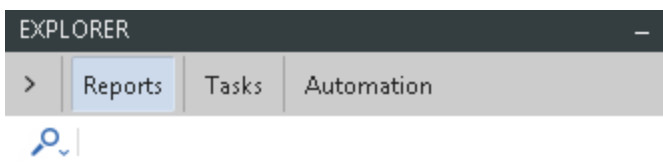
1. In an open scorecard, specify the data settings you want the shortcut to include.
2. On the **File** menu, point to **New**, then click **Shortcut**.
3. In the **New Shortcut** dialog box, verify the settings are set the way you want.



Tip: If you have a scorecard open, you can also create a shortcut by clicking  **New Resource** on the RapidResponse toolbar, and then clicking **New Shortcut**.

► Create a shortcut to open a scorecard with specific settings

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that scorecards are shown. You can do this by selecting **Reports**.



2. Select a scorecard.
3. On the **File** menu, point to **New**, then click **Shortcut**.
4. In the **New Shortcut** dialog box, in the **Name** box, type a name for the shortcut.
5. If you want the scorecard to open with some specific scenarios, do the following:
 - Select the **Scenarios** check box.
 - Click **Select**.
 - In the **Scenarios** dialog box, in the **Select from this list** box, click the scenarios you want to add, and then click **Add**.
 - Click **OK**.
6. If you want the scorecard to open with a specific filter, select the **Filter** check box, and then in the list, click the filter you want.
7. If you want the scorecard to open with a specific site, select the **Site** check box, and then in the list, click the site you want.

8. If the scorecard includes the hierarchy panel and you want the scorecard to open with specific hierarchy settings, do the following:
 - Select the **Hierarchy** check box, and then click **Settings**.
 - In the **Hierarchy Settings** dialog box, add the hierarchies you want to use to filter the scorecard.
 - For each hierarchy, click the value you want to apply to the scorecard.
 - Click **OK**.

For more information about hierarchies, see "[Filter and summarize data with hierarchies](#)" on page 304.

9. Click **OK**.



Tip: You can also create a shortcut by selecting a scorecard in the **Explorer**, and then clicking  **New Resource** on the RapidResponse toolbar and selecting  **Shortcut**.

Managing shortcuts

You can edit the properties of shortcuts. You can also rename and delete them. This works similarly to managing resources.

► Change shortcut properties

1. In the **Explorer**, select a shortcut.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. In the **Shortcut Properties** dialog box, make desired changes.

► Rename a shortcut

1. In the **Explorer**, select a shortcut.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Rename**.
3. Type a new name for the shortcut.

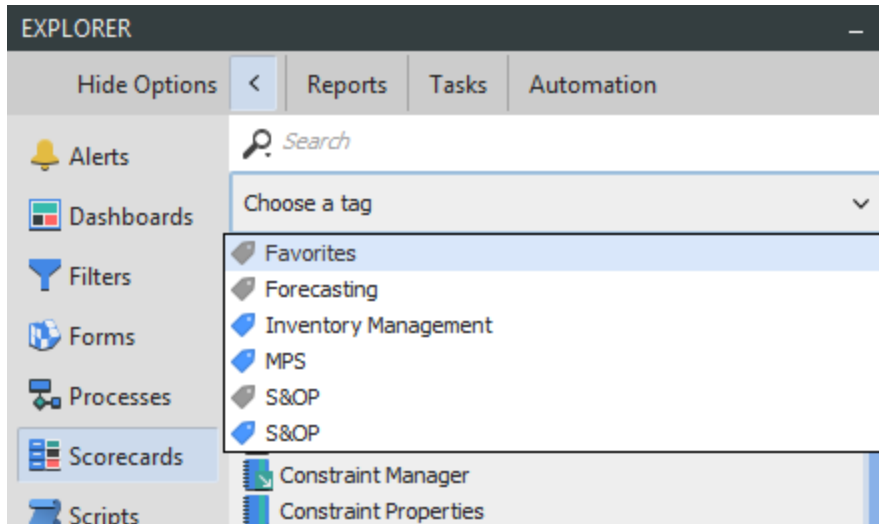
► Delete a shortcut

1. In the **Explorer**, select a shortcut.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Delete**.

Creating personal resource tags

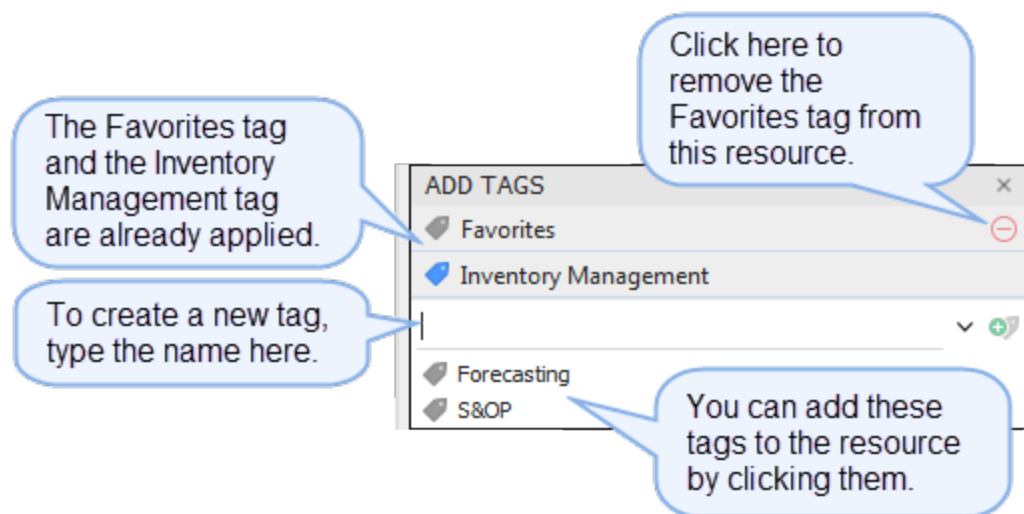
You can use personal resource tags to customize the way that resources (reports, tasks, automation activities, filters, and so on) are organized. A tag is a word or brief description that can be assigned to resources in the Explorer. By creating and assigning personal tags, you create custom categories that allow you to quickly locate required resources. For example, you could use a tag to group workbooks, dashboards, and task flows related to a business process.

The personal tags you have assigned to resources are displayed along with global tags in the Choose a tag menu at the top of the Explorer, as shown in the following illustration. Personal tags are identified with gray icons .



When you select a tag from this menu, only the resources that have that tag assigned to them are displayed in the Explorer. You can perform a search in resources that have been filtered using a tag, and apply additional filtering options, such as selecting a resource type. For more information about searching for tagged resources, see ["Only show resources with a specific tag" on page 86](#).

The personal tags you create and assign cannot be shared. When you share a resource that you have assigned a tag to, the tag is not available to the user you shared the resource with. A personal tag is automatically deleted when it is no longer assigned to any resources.



► Assign a personal tag to a resource

1. In the **Explorer**, select the resource you want to assign the tag to and click **Add and remove tags** .

2. In the **Add Tags** dialog box do one of the following:
 - Type the tag name and press **Enter**.
 - Select an existing tag name by clicking the name of the tag in the list.
3. Repeat the previous step if you want to add additional tags.
4. When you are done adding tags to the resource, click **Close** ✕ .



Tip: If you do not see the list of available tags, click ▼ to see the list.

► Assign a personal tag to multiple resources

1. In the **Explorer**, select all the resources you want to assign the tag to and, beside any of the selected resources, click **Add and remove tags** .
2. In the **Add Tags** dialog box do one of the following:
 - Type the tag name and press **Enter**.
 - Select an existing tag name by clicking the name of the tag in the list.
3. Repeat the previous step if you want to add additional tags.
4. When you are done adding tags to the resources, click **Close** ✕ .



Tip: If you do not see the list of available tags, click ▼ to see the list.

► Remove a personal tag from a resource

1. In the **Explorer**, hover your mouse cursor over the resource you want to remove the tag from and then click **Add and remove tags** .
2. In the **Add Tags** dialog box, locate the tag you want to remove from the resource, and beside it, click **Remove tag** .
3. When you are done removing tags from the resource, click **Close** ✕ .



Note: Only administrators can add global tags to resources or remove global tags. For more information, see the [RapidResponse Administration Guide](#).

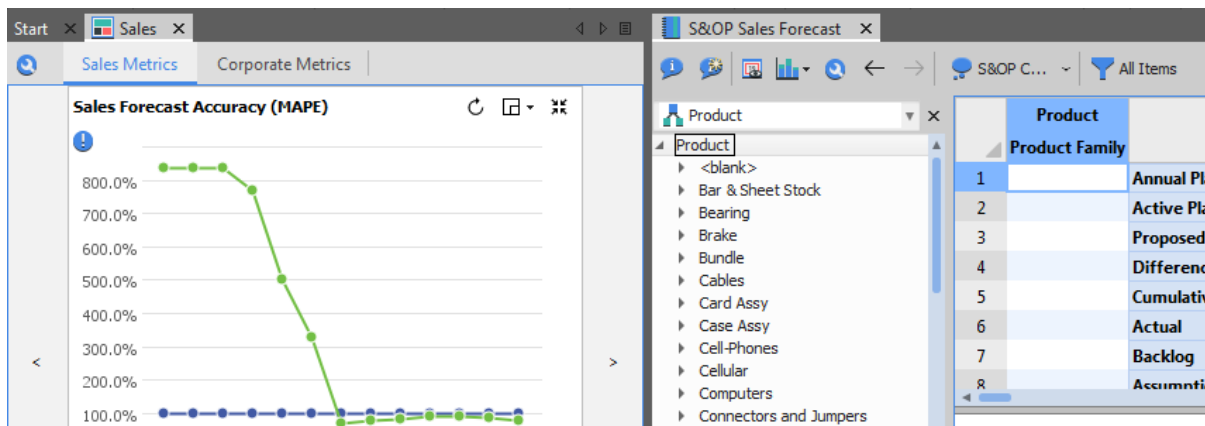
CHAPTER 10: Arranging your workspace

View multiple reports simultaneously	112
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Customize navigation pane layout	115
Refresh the contents of the Navigation Pane	117
Restore the original navigation pane layout	117
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You can change which panes are shown in your RapidResponse workspace and how they are arranged. This way, you can maximize your workspace by hiding panes that you do not need to see, or keep panes in view if you need to refer to them often.

Viewing multiple reports at the same time

If you want to refer to two or more reports without flipping back and forth between tabs, you can add additional tab groups to your workspace, so you can see the reports side by side.



You can also open two copies of the same report and select different data settings for each. This way, you can do things like comparing data from two different sites, or data at different levels of a hierarchy. For more information, see ["View multiple reports simultaneously" on page 112](#) and ["Open a second instance of a workbook" on page 127](#).

You can also create additional tab groups within workbooks so that you can view more than one worksheet in the same workbook at the same time, and you can re-size or hide worksheet columns. For more information, see ["Set worksheet viewing options" on page 129](#).

Showing, hiding, and rearranging navigation panes

You can keep panes such as the Explorer and Scenarios pane in view all the time. You can also show a navigation pane that can contain these panes on separate tabs. If you have access to the Add-ins pane or the Extensions pane, the navigation pane can contain those too. You can change the way that individual panes are arranged in the navigation pane. For more information, see ["Show or hide the Navigation Pane" on page 114](#), ["Keep a pane in view" on page 113](#), and ["Customize navigation pane layout" on page 115](#).

Showing, hiding, and resizing the task flow pane

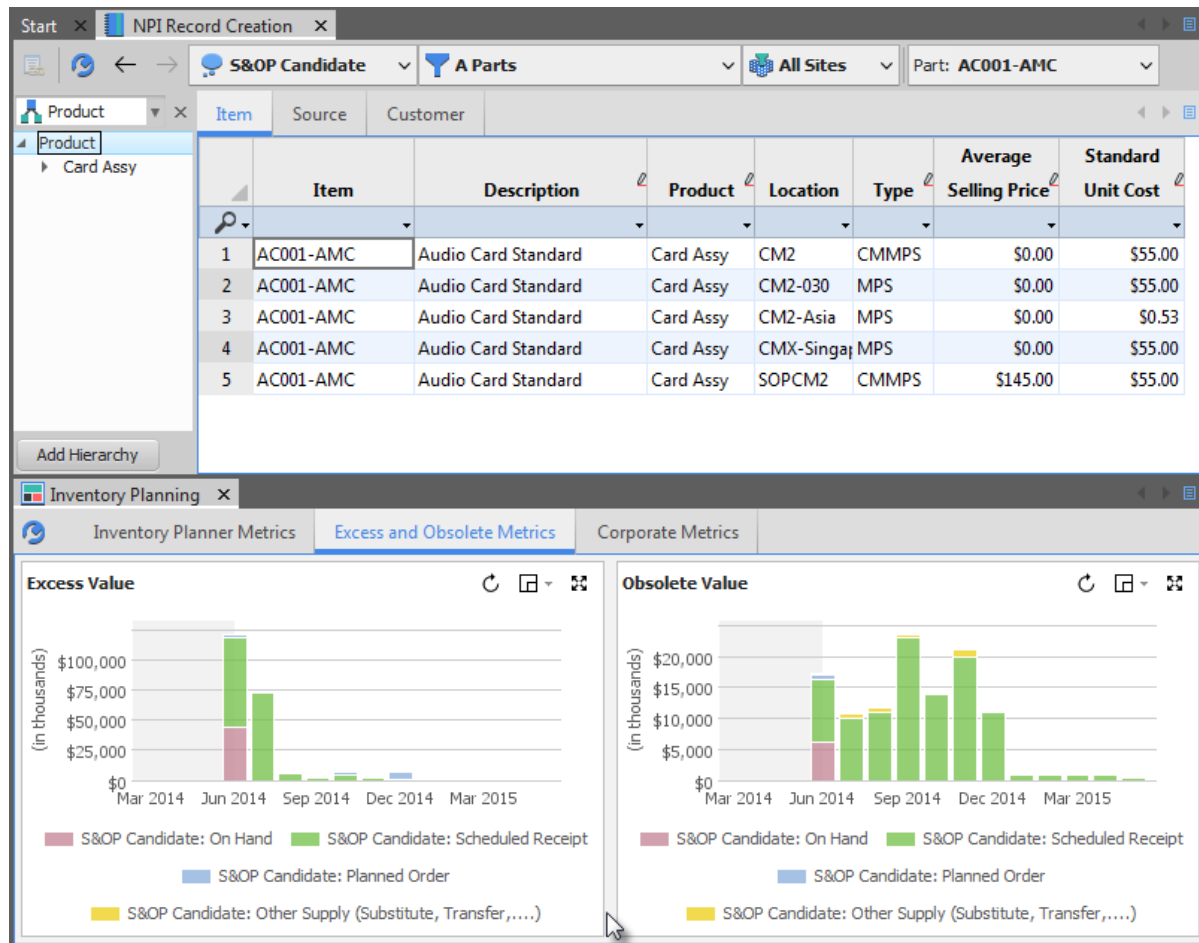
If you are working on a task flow step and the task flow reading pane is taking up too much space in the RapidResponse window, you can adjust its size or temporarily hide the task flow without closing it. For more information, see ["Adjust task flow reading pane" on page 117](#).

View multiple reports simultaneously

You can view multiple items, including reports, Message Center, the Start page, and scenario properties together in the same window by organizing them into different panes.

1. Open the items you want to view.
2. Right-click a tab, and then click one of the following:
 - **New Horizontal Group**
 - **New Vertical Group**

The following example displays a workbook and a dashboard in separate horizontal panes.



Note: You can organize items into either horizontal or vertical panes, not both.



Tips:

- You can also move items into different panes by clicking and dragging the tab.
- Once you have created at least two panes, you can move items between them by right-clicking a tab and then clicking one of the options.

Keep a pane in view

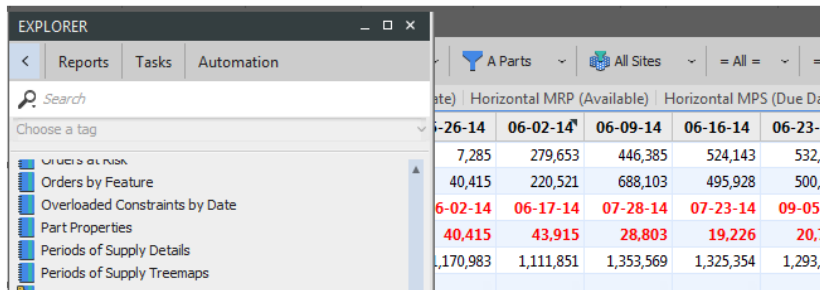
By default, the Explorer pane (and some other panes such as the Scenarios pane) are automatically hidden when you perform actions such as opening a resource or clicking somewhere else in the RapidResponse window. This is called auto-hide.

If you want to keep panes in view, you can turn off the auto-hide function. When you turn off auto-hide, the pane stays in view until you close it, open a different pane, or turn auto-hide back on. In addition,

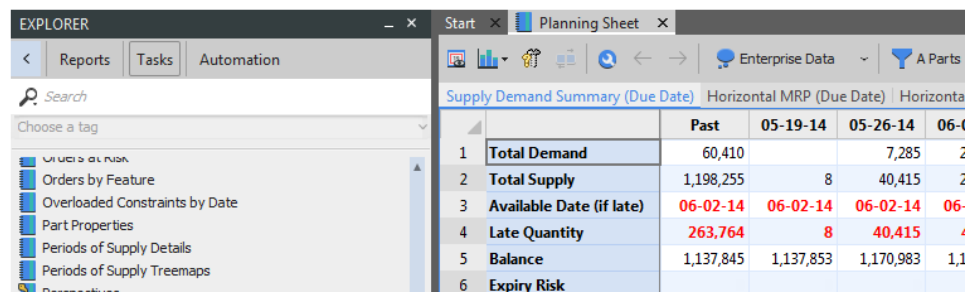
when auto-hide is turned on, the pane does not overlap with the open tabs in the RapidResponse window.

You can also move a pane by dragging it and dropping it when auto-hide is turned off. For example, if you wanted to move your Explorer pane from its default location at the left side of the RapidResponse window to the right side, you could turn off auto-hide, and then drag the Explorer to its new location.

Auto-Hide on

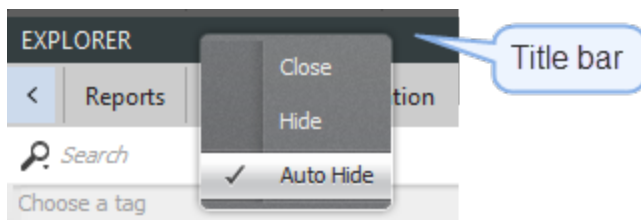


Auto-Hide off



► Toggle Auto-Hide

1. Right-click the title bar of the pane.
2. Click **Auto-Hide**.



Show or hide the Navigation Pane

When you sign into RapidResponse, the Navigation Pane is hidden, and tabs for each pane are displayed to the left of your workspace. As needed, you can show or hide the Navigation Pane.

- On the RapidResponse toolbar, click **Show Navigation Pane** .



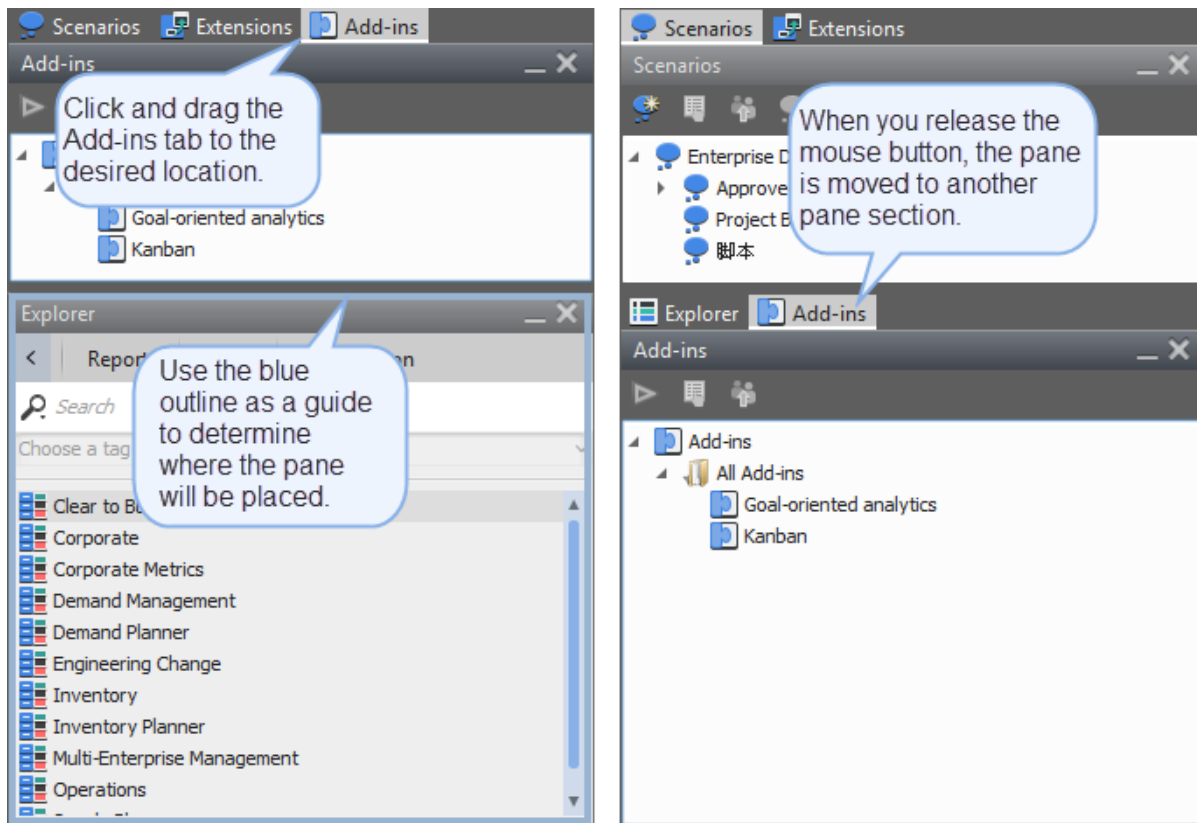
Tip: You can also show or hide the Navigation Pane by clicking **Show Navigation Pane** under the **View** menu.

Customize navigation pane layout

When you first view the Navigation pane, all of the panes to which you have access are arranged in a preset layout. You can modify the pane layout to suit your needs by doing the following:

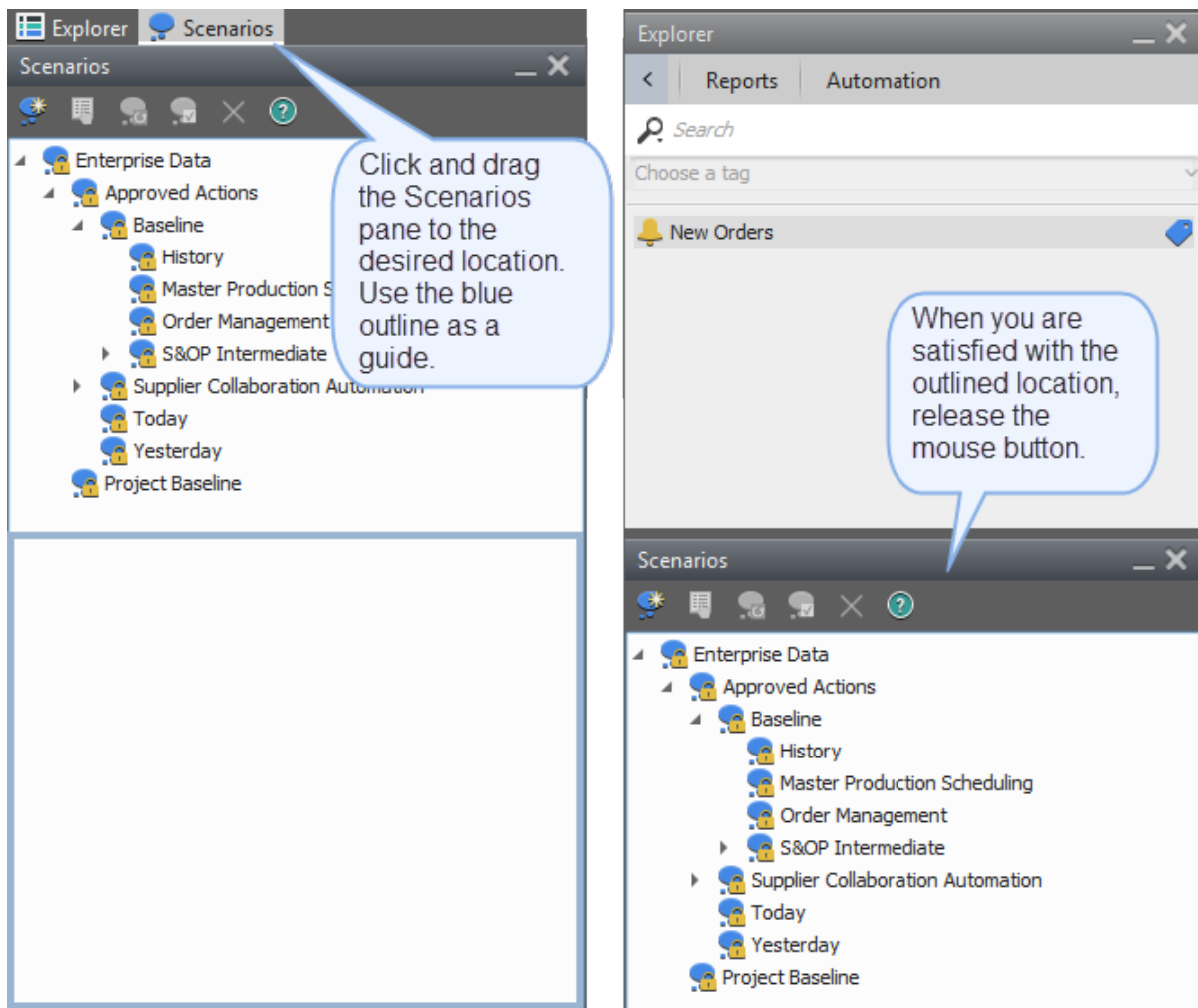
Move a pane

Drag a tab from one pane section to another pane section. Use the blue outline to determine where the pane will go. The following illustrates how to move the **Add-ins** pane.



Create a pane section

If all of your panes are in one pane section, you can create other pane sections if you need to view multiple panes at the same time. You can create another pane section by moving a pane, as shown in the following illustration.



► Resize a pane

1. Pause your pointer over the border of the pane sections or the Navigation Pane and the working area.
2. When the pointer becomes a double arrow, click and drag to the desired size.

► Close a pane

1. Click the tab of the pane you want to close.
2. On the title bar of the pane, click **Close** .

► Open a pane

- On the **Go** menu, click the pane that you want to open.

Refresh the contents of the Navigation Pane

If an administrator, resource author, or another user shares resources or scenarios with you while you are signed in to RapidResponse, you can refresh the Navigation Pane to access them. For example, if an author shares a filter with you and you refresh the Explorer pane, you can access the filter right away from the list of filters.

- On the **View** menu, click **Refresh**.



Note: This also refreshes the data in scenarios and updates your user permissions if they have been modified since the last time you signed in. For more information about refreshing data, see ["Display most recent data" on page 158](#). For information about scenarios, see ["Scenarios in RapidResponse" on page 17](#).

Restore the original navigation pane layout

You can change the layout of the docked panes in your Navigation pane back to the default layout.

- On the **View** menu, click **Reset Navigation Pane**.

Adjust task flow reading pane

You can adjust the amount of space occupied by the task flow reading pane by resizing it. You can also toggle between showing and hiding the task flow reading pane, without having to close and re-open the task flow.

► Resize the task flow reading pane

1. Place your mouse cursor over the line between the task flow reading pane and the tab group immediately to its left.
When the cursor is in the correct position, it turns into a pair of lines with arrows pointing left and right.
2. Hold down the left mouse button and drag the mouse left or right to adjust the amount of space occupied by the task flow reading pane.

► Show or hide the task flow reading pane

- On the RapidResponse toolbar, click **Show Task Flow**

CHAPTER 11: Troubleshooting

If you encounter a RapidResponse application error, your administrator or Kinaxis Customer Support might request information about the error from you. If your company has deployed the On-Premises version of RapidResponse and you have been granted access from your administrator, you can open the RapidResponse Application Server Event Log.

A detailed error report is written to the event log if a user receives an error message while using RapidResponse. The event log can help you or Kinaxis Customer Support diagnose RapidResponse application issues and problems.

Each error report includes:

- The date and time the error occurred.
- The User ID of the user that triggered the error.
- An error title.
- A detailed description of the error. Descriptions can include query error information that might be useful in better understanding issues related to dashboards, workbooks, and scorecards.

► **To access the RapidResponse Application Server Event Log**

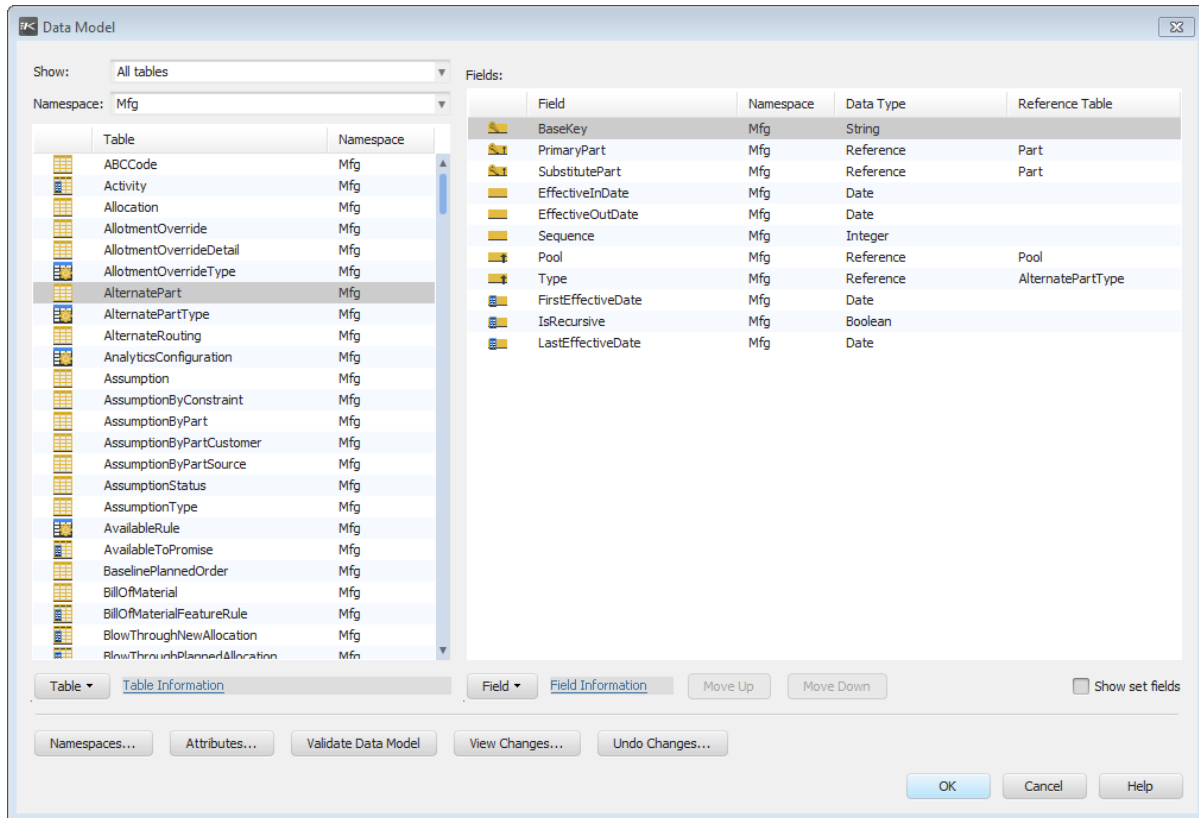
- On the **View** menu, click **Application Server Event Log**.

Data Model Dialog Box

System and data administrators can customize the RapidResponse data model using the Data Model dialog box. These administrators need to be granted permission to modify data integration settings.

This dialog box, as shown in the following illustration, provides information about all the tables and fields in the RapidResponse data model. It also provides data model reference information.

General users and authors can be given permission to open the Data Model dialog box. Access to the dialog box might help general users troubleshoot issues. It can also provide authors a better understanding of the data model to improve the resource authoring process.



► **To open the Data Model dialog box:**

- Do one of the following:
 - System and data administrators**—In the **Administration** pane, under **Data**, click **Data Model**.
 - All other users**—On the **View** menu, click **Data Model**.
- From the **Show** list, select one of the following:
 - All tables**—displays all standard and custom RapidResponse input and control tables, as well as all standard RapidResponse calculated tables.
 - Calculated tables**—displays all standard RapidResponse calculated tables.
 - Control tables**—displays all standard and custom RapidResponse control tables.
 - Frequently used tables**—displays all tables that have been designated as frequently used. These allow you to define a group of tables you expect to frequently work with or modify.
 - Input tables**—displays all standard and custom RapidResponse input tables.
 - Tables with fields in namespace**—displays only tables with fields that belong to the namespace selected from the **Namespace** list. For example, for a namespace created by your company, this might include custom input tables you've created as well as standard RapidResponse input tables in the Mfg namespace that you've added fields to.
- Optionally, from the **Namespace** list, select the namespace whose tables you want to view. The list of tables shown is then narrowed to those matching the selection in the **Show** list that also belong to the selected namespace.
- If you want to display the set fields on each table, select the **Show set fields** check box.

► **To view table and field reference information**

- Do one of the following:
 - To view help for a given table, select it from the **Table** box, and then click **Table Information**.
 - To view help for a given field, select it from the **Fields** box, and then click **Field Information**.

For standard RapidResponse tables and fields, the *RapidResponse Data Model and Analytic Guide* opens and displays information about the selected table or field. For custom tables and fields, a dialog box opens displaying properties and information provided by the user who added the table or field.



Tips:

- For more information about the Data Model dialog box, click **Help**.
- You can also access reference information for a given table by right-clicking it in the **Table** box and then clicking **Table Information**. Similarly, you can access reference information for a given table by right-clicking it in the **Field** box and then clicking **Field Information**.

Part 3: Viewing data in reports

- ["Using worksheets and workbooks" on page 125](#)
- ["Viewing data in workbooks" on page 139](#)
- ["Working with data in workbooks" on page 175](#)
- ["Searching data in workbooks" on page 187](#)
- ["Viewing data in dashboards" on page 249](#)
- ["Data settings in dashboards" on page 265](#)
- ["Viewing data in a map" on page 273](#)
- ["Viewing data in charts" on page 199](#)
- ["Viewing data in treemaps" on page 233](#)
- ["Viewing scorecard data " on page 279](#)
- ["About automatically generating reports" on page 307](#)
- ["Exporting data" on page 317](#)
- ["Printing reports" on page 329](#)

CHAPTER 12: Using worksheets and workbooks

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You can view and work with RapidResponse data in worksheets that provide a spreadsheet-like environment. Worksheets are stored and organized in workbooks. A workbook typically contains several worksheets that display related data. For example, you might have a workbook that provides master data for all parts and includes details such as part type, planner codes, unit cost, and demand fences.

Constraint Properties							
Active Constraints							
All Sites							
Constraint: = All =							
Reset							
Constraint Summary							
Apply Constraints to Parts							
	Constraint	Site	Description	Responsible	Type	Key Constraint	UOM
1	4Cyl	India	4Cyl constraint	Master Administra	Production	✓	EA
2	CruiserLine	HQ	Cruiser production line (HQ)	Master Administra	Production		EA
3	FrameAssembly	HQ	mbly line (HQ)	Master Administra	Production		EA
4	FrameWelder		der Constraint	Master Administra	Production		EA
5	KitLine	HQ	Kit assembly line (HQ)	Master Administra	Production		EA
6	LCD 3D Display	SOP030		Master Administra	Constrain		EA
7	LCD Display	SOP030		Master Administra	Constrain		EA
8	LCD Testing	SOP030		Master Administra	Constrain		EA
9	Plasma Glass	SOP030		Master Administra	Constrain	✓	EA
10	Plasma Testing	SOP030		Master Administra	Constrain	✓	EA
11	Racer	HQ	Racer assembly line (HQ)	Master Administra	Production		EA
12	Thaw SAProd 50	SAProd	01 Room 503	Master Administra	Constrain		HRS

A worksheet's formatting is defined by the person who creates the workbook, called the workbook author. Some options a workbook author has include hiding row numbers, hiding grid lines, allowing columns to be hidden, and so on. An example of a worksheet with hidden row numbers is shown in the following illustration.

Constraint Summary		Constraint Groups	Apply Co
Constraint	Site	Description	
4Cyl	India	4Cyl constraint	
CruiserLine	HQ	Cruiser production line (HQ)	
FrameAssembly	HQ	Frame assembly line (HQ)	

RapidResponse includes predefined workbooks that address common business problems; however, your company might have modified these workbooks or created new workbooks for company specific processes, or you might have created your own. The workbooks to which you have been granted permissions are accessed from the Explorer. For more information about accessing resources using the Explorer, see ["Finding resources using the Explorer" on page 82](#).



Note: Workbooks and worksheets are also available on the Mobile Client. For more information, see the [RapidResponse User Guide \(Mobile Client\)](#).

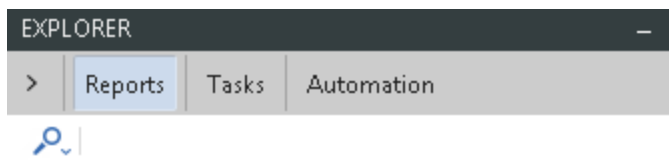
Worksheet types

Data is displayed in worksheets, which can be one of the following types:

- **Vertical**—Displays data in a vertical format, with one record per row. Vertical worksheets can be displayed in either Table view, which displays every record in the worksheet, or Form view, which displays one record at a time. You can switch between the views at any time. For more information, see ["Set worksheet viewing options" on page 129](#).
- **Crosstab**—Displays summarized data in a horizontal format, usually bucketed by date. Crosstab worksheets have two sections, the dimensions (columns that show how the data is summarized) and the data (the crosstab rows). For more information, see ["View data in a crosstab worksheet" on page 162](#).
- **Chart**—Displays data in a chart format. There are several possible chart types, including bar, line, and area charts, pie charts, gauge charts, and scatter charts. Worksheets might only display a chart, or they might display a chart in addition to a vertical or crosstab format, by displaying the chart above, below, or beside the worksheet grid. For more information, see ["Viewing data in charts" on page 199](#).
- **Treemap**—Displays data in a treemap visualization, which presents large sets of data as container and nested rectangles. Treemap worksheets are indicated with a unique icon . For more information, see ["Open a treemap to view data" on page 238](#).
- **Tree view**—Displays data in a tree structure with collapsible nodes. Mainly used in worksheets for project management.

Open a workbook to access a worksheet

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that workbooks are shown. You can do this by selecting **Reports**.



2. Double-click on a workbook in the **Explorer**.
If the workbook is already open, focus is placed on the opened workbook tab.



Notes:

- You might have to specify data settings when opening certain workbooks. For more information about the settings you can modify to view data, see ["Viewing data in workbooks" on page 139](#).
- The next time you open the workbook, it will display the last worksheet you accessed, unless the workbook author specified that the workbook always open to the first worksheet. If you want to always open to a specific worksheet, create a shortcut to the worksheet. For more information, see ["Create a shortcut to display workbook data" on page 104](#).
- Some workbooks might automatically modify data when you open them. For more information, see ["Run workbook commands" on page 360](#).



Tip: You can also open a workbook by selecting it in the **Explorer**, and then clicking **Open** on the **File** menu.

► Open a second instance of a workbook

You can open another instance of an already opened workbook on a new tab. For example, you might want to compare the data in the workbook with different data settings applied.

1. In the **Explorer**, select a workbook that is already opened.
2. On the **File** menu, click **Open in New Tab**.



Tip: You can also open a workbook on a new tab by right-clicking the workbook in the **Explorer**, and then clicking **Open in New Tab**.

Navigate workbooks and worksheets

Workbooks typically contain multiple worksheets. You can navigate through worksheets in a workbook and through rows in a specific worksheet. You can use the scroll bars to navigate through the data in a worksheet or you can use the corresponding shortcut keys.

► Navigate through worksheets

- Do one of the following:
 - Click the worksheet tab for the worksheet you want to view.
 - Click the arrow buttons to scroll the worksheet tabs in the workbook.
 - Click **Show List** , and then click the worksheet you want to view.

► Navigate within a worksheet

To move	Press
In Table view	
To the next cell in the current row.	TAB
To the previous cell in the current row	SHIFT+TAB
Up one page in the worksheet.	PAGE UP
Down one page in the worksheet.	PAGE DOWN
Over one cell in a given direction.	Any arrow key
To the edge of the active worksheet.	CTRL+Arrow key
To the beginning of the record.	HOME
To the first record on the worksheet.	CTRL+HOME
To the end of the record.	END
To the last record on the worksheet.	CTRL+END
In Form view	
To the next field in the current record	TAB
To the previous field in the current record in Form view.	SHIFT+TAB

To move	Press
Up one record.	PAGE UP
To the next record.	PAGE DOWN
To the beginning of the current field.	HOME
To the end of the current field.	END



Note: For information about Form view, see ["Switch between Table and Form view" on page 131](#).

Set worksheet viewing options

You can customize how you view worksheets within a workbook. For example, you can change the size of worksheet columns, or you might be able to view multiple worksheets at the same time in several different panes. These settings are saved after you close the workbook, until the next time you make changes.

Some viewing options might not be allowed by the workbook's author. For example, the author can choose to not allow you to move worksheets within the workbook, or not allow you to switch between table view and form view.

You always have the option of restoring the workbook's default display settings. For more information, see ["Restore original worksheet appearance in a workbook" on page 138](#).

► View multiple worksheets from one workbook simultaneously in different panes

You can view multiple worksheets from one workbook at the same time by moving them into a different horizontal or vertical pane, if the workbook's author has allowed the worksheets to be moved.

- In a workbook, right-click a worksheet tab, and then click one of the following:
 - **New Horizontal Group**
 - **New Vertical Group**

The following illustration shows worksheets displayed in different panes.

Indented BOM

Part	Site	Description	Quantity Per	Lead Time		Effective Date
				This Level	Cumulative	
1 AC001	030	Audio Card Standard		1	1	Past
2 Server	030	Server System	1.00	0	1	Past
3 Workstation	030	Workstation Computer System	1.00	0	1	Past
4 AC001	AmeriComp	Audio Card Standard		0	53	Past

Top-Level Where Used

Component				Top-Level Assembly			
Reference Part	Site	Part		Part	Site	Reference Part	Description
1 AC001	030	AC001		Server	030	Server	Server System
2 AC001	030	AC001		Workstation	030	Workstation	Workstation Co
3 AC001	AmeriComp	AC001		Server	AmeriComp	Server	Server System
4 AC001	AmeriComp	AC001		Workstation	AmeriComp	Workstation	Workstation Co
5 AC001	CM3	AC001		AC001	CM3	AC001	Audio Card Star
6 AC001	CM3-030	AC001		AC001	CM3-030	AC001	Audio Card Star

Multi-Level Where Used

Part	Site	Description	Quantity Per	Lead Time		Effective Date
				This Level	Cumulative	
1 AC001	030	Audio Card Standard		1	1	Past
2 Server	030	Server System	1.00	0	1	Past
3 Workstation	030	Workstation Computer System	1.00	0	1	Past
4 AC001	AmeriComp	Audio Card Standard		0	53	Past
5 Server	AmeriComp	Server System	1.00	1	111	Past
6 Workstation	AmeriComp	Workstation Computer System	1.00	1	111	Past

BOM Analysis workbook displaying worksheets in a single pane

BOM Analysis workbook displaying worksheets in two horizontal panes



Notes:

- Your pane settings stay the same the next time you view the workbook.
- The **New Horizontal Group** and **New Vertical Group** options are not available if the workbook author has not allowed the worksheets to be moved.

► Change the order of worksheets

- In a workbook, click and drag a worksheet tab along the other tabs in the worksheet. Release the mouse button when you have the tab in the appropriate position.



Note: Your worksheet order settings stay the same the next time you view the workbook.

► Move worksheets between panes

- In a workbook, right-click a worksheet tab, and then click one of the following:

- **Move to Next Tab Group**
- **Move to Previous Tab Group**

► Switch between Table and Form view

Table view is the default worksheet viewing format. It displays each record as a row in a table, similar to a spreadsheet. Form view displays one record at a time, as shown in the following illustrations.

You can switch between Table view and Form view on the worksheet, if the workbook author has allowed it.

- On the **View** menu, click **Form**.
If the worksheet is in Table view, it switches to Form view.
If the worksheet is in Form view, it switches to Table view.



Notes:

- The **Table** and **Form** viewing options are unavailable for crosstab worksheets. For more information about crosstab worksheets, see ["View data in a crosstab worksheet" on page 162.](#)
- Your view settings stay the same the next time you view the worksheet.



Tip: You can also click the **Form View** toggle button  to switch between Table view and Form view.

► Resize worksheet columns

1. Move the pointer over the right border of the column's title you want to resize.
2. When the pointer becomes a double arrow, click and drag to the desired size.

When you resize a column, the column's size displays in a tooltip. You can use this value to resize columns to a precise width, or to resize a number of columns to a consistent size. Column widths are represented by the number of standard-sized characters the column can display at once. This size should be used as a guideline, because the actual number of characters displayed in a column might vary slightly depending on the column's contents (for example, upper or lower case characters, numerals, symbols, and so on). An example of a column width is shown in the following illustration.

General		Range of Coverage Overrides		Refer
		Width: 17.0 (102 pixels)		
	Reference Part	Site	Part	
1	IC010	BAU-Taiwar	IC010	
2		CM2	IC010-AMC	



Notes:

- In a crosstab worksheet, all pivoted bucket columns resize together. You can resize the columns to the left of the pivoted columns individually.
- Your column size settings stay the same the next time you view the worksheet.

► Resize the worksheet help

1. Move the pointer over the left edge of the workbook help pane.
2. When the pointer becomes a double arrow, click and drag to the desired size.



Note: Your help size settings stay the same the next time you open the worksheet.

Hide worksheet columns

You can hide columns that you do not need to view in any open worksheet. For example, you can hide columns not relevant to the business process you are working on, or you can hide columns that contain private or sensitive data before you print the worksheet or export the worksheet to Microsoft Excel. You can also subsequently display any columns you have hidden, or reset the workbook back to its default display configurations. For more information about resetting the workbook, see ["Restore original worksheet appearance in a workbook" on page 138](#).

Some worksheets might contain columns that are initially hidden; you can also display these columns when required. These columns should typically be mentioned in the worksheet help.

► Hide a column

1. In a worksheet, do one of the following:
 - Click a cell in the column you want to hide
 - Select one or more cells in the columns you want to hide
2. On the **Data** menu, click **Hide Column** .



Notes:

- You must always have one visible column in the worksheet.
- You can hide only vertical columns in a crosstab worksheet. You cannot hide data rows.
- If the workbook author has not allowed columns to be hidden, the **Hide Column** option is not available.



Tip: You can also hide a column by right-clicking on a cell in the column and then clicking **Hide Column**, or by pressing **CTRL+0** (zero).

► Show hidden columns

1. On the **Data** menu, point to **Unhide Column**.
The columns you have hidden are displayed in a list
2. To show a column, click it in the list.



Tips:

- If you have hidden multiple columns in the worksheet, you can show every hidden column by clicking **Unhide All**.
- You can also show columns by right-clicking in the worksheet, pointing to **Unhide Columns**, and then clicking the column you want to show.

Freeze columns in a worksheet

Specific columns of data in a worksheet can be frozen so that the columns remain visible as you scroll through the worksheet. A workbook author may specify frozen columns for a worksheet so that the worksheet opens with those settings. You can modify or delete author-specified frozen columns or add frozen columns to a worksheet that doesn't have preset frozen columns.

General		Range of Coverage Overrides		geable	
	Reference Part	Site			Inven Avail
1	IC010	BAU-Taiwa	IC010	IC 3.3 V Field Programmable	
2		CM2	IC010-AMC	IC 3.3 V Field Programmable	
3		CMX-Singa	IC010-AMC	IC 3.3 V Field Programmable	
4		JBC-USA	IC010	IC 3.3 V Field Programmable	
5		PCM-Hong	AMC-IC010	IC 3.3 V Field Programmable	
6		SOPCM2	IC010-AMC	IC 3.3 V Field Programmable	

The darker line indicates that all columns to the left of the line are frozen.

You can freeze a single column of data or multiple columns, and this setting will be maintained when you close and re-open the worksheet.

However, frozen columns will not be maintained if you:

- select a pivoted column or the last Group By column in a crosstab worksheet
- select a multi-scenario column that is not the first scenario on the multi-scenario list for that column. RapidResponse will save the settings of the first scenario and the worksheet will open with those settings.

You can modify preset frozen columns by unfreezing the columns, and then selecting and freezing a new set of columns. To return to the author-specified settings for the worksheet, on the **View** menu click **Reset Workbook**.

► Freeze a column

1. On the worksheet, click in the column to the right of the column that you want to freeze.
2. On the **View** menu, click **Freeze Columns**.



Note: You can only freeze one set of columns in a worksheet.



Tips:

- You can also freeze columns by right-clicking on the column to the right of the column you want to freeze and clicking **Freeze Columns**  or pressing **CTRL + R**.
- You can also freeze columns by selecting **Columns** from the data menu, right-clicking the column below the column you want to freeze, then clicking **Freeze Columns** .

► Unfreeze a column

1. Right-click anywhere on the worksheet.
2. On the **View** menu, click **Freeze Columns**.

**Tips:**

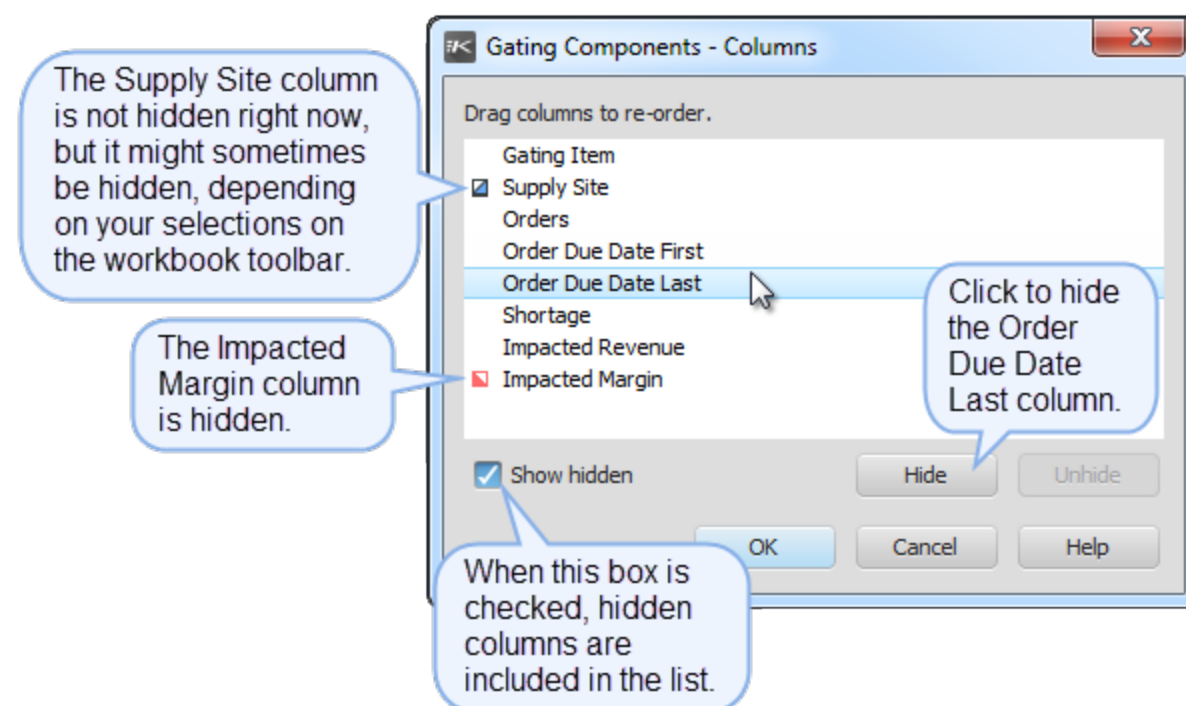
- You can also unfreeze columns by right-clicking on any column and clicking **Freeze Columns**  or pressing **CTRL + R**.
- You can also unfreeze columns by selecting **Columns** from the data menu, right-clicking any column, and then clicking **Freeze Columns** .

Changing the order of worksheet columns

You can change the order of columns in worksheets, and place any two columns next to each other so you can compare them more easily. The column order you choose persists until you reset the worksheet layout or the workbook author makes changes to the worksheet. For more information, see ["Restore original worksheet appearance in a workbook" on page 138](#).

Before you change the order of worksheet columns, it is recommended that you make as many columns as possible visible using the worksheet controls. For example, if you can toggle between a regular view and a detail view that has more columns, choose the detail view. This way, you can arrange the detail columns the way you want them, rather than having them appear in unexpected places when you switch to the detail view.

Before you reorder columns, it might also be useful to hide or unhide columns. In the columns dialog box, which is shown in the following illustration, you can toggle the view to list all columns, or only list visible columns.



In some cases, there might be restrictions on the changes that you can make to the column layout. In crosstab worksheets and worksheets that contain subtotals, it is not possible to reorder columns, and

the Columns dialog box is not available. Some worksheets do not allow you to hide columns. For these worksheets, Hide and Unhide options are not available in the Columns dialog box.

► Change the order of worksheet columns

1. On the **Data** menu, click **Columns** .

The **Columns** dialog box opens.



Tip: You can also right-click anywhere in the worksheet, and then click **Columns** .

2. Click the name of a column and drag it up or down in the list.



Note: Spacer columns that do not have headers appear as blank lines in the column list. Columns that have images in their headers are listed as **Image** in the column list.



Tip: You can select multiple adjacent columns in the list and move them all at the same time.

Importing and exporting data after changing the column order

When you export data from a worksheet, the order in which the columns appear in the exported file depends on the current order of columns in the worksheet. This means you can customize the order of columns in the exported file by reordering the worksheet columns in RapidResponse before exporting the data. However, some business process might require columns in the exported data to appear in the default order, and these processes fail or produce unexpected results if you change the order of the columns.

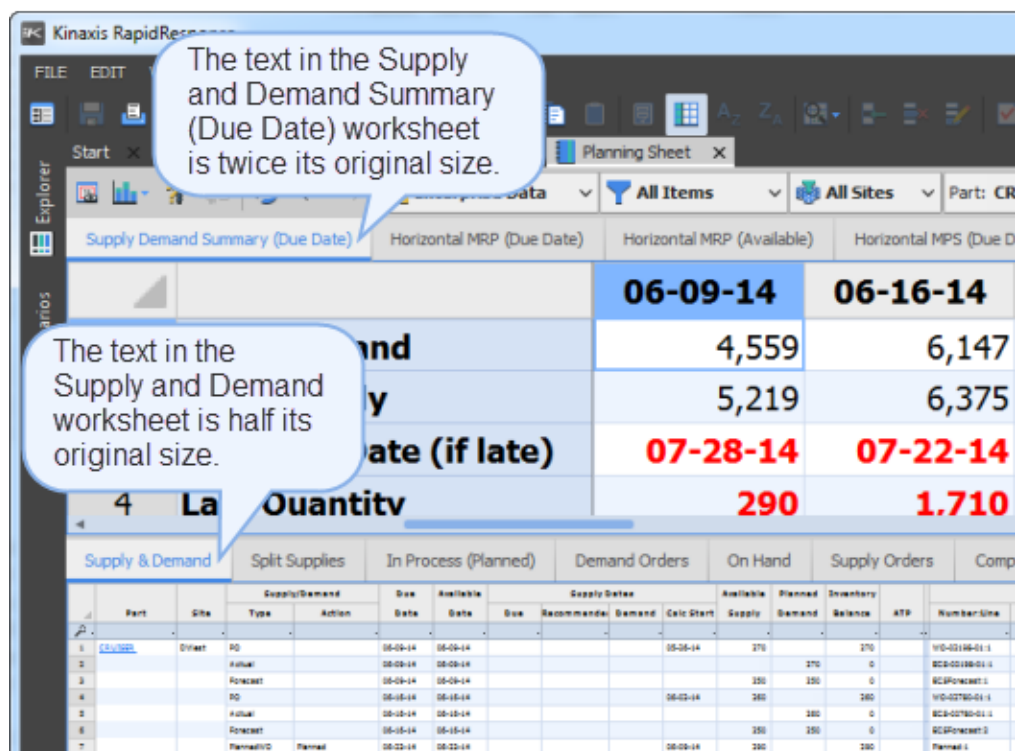
When you import data using a worksheet, the columns in the worksheet you are importing data from must be in the same order as the columns in the RapidResponse worksheet. Reordering the columns in RapidResponse so that they no longer match causes the import process to fail.

Adjust a worksheet's zoom level

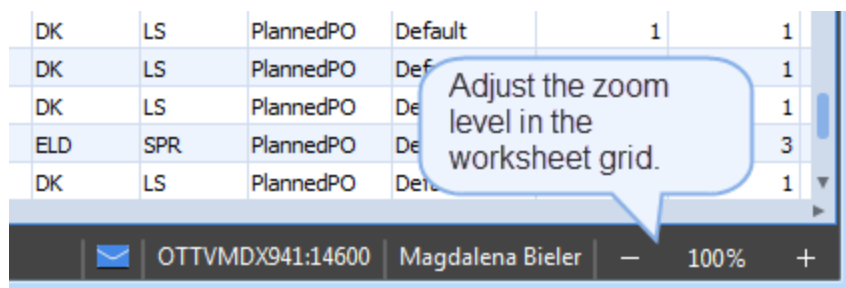
You can adjust zoom levels on

- **Worksheet grids**, including those found in dashboard widgets, workbooks, scorecards, and scenario properties.
- **Some types of charts**. For more information, see ["Change how a chart displays data " on page 219](#).

When you open a worksheet, the default zoom level setting is based on your computer settings (DPI of monitor resolution). Before you can adjust the zoom level on a worksheet, it must be in focus. You can put it in focus by clicking on it. Only the worksheet or worksheet widget that is currently in focus is affected when you adjust the zoom level, so you can set different zoom levels on different worksheets.



If the item that is in focus does not contain a worksheet that you can zoom in on—for example, the Start page or a chart widget—zoom controls are not shown. When zoom controls are available, they are on the status bar, at the bottom right corner of the RapidResponse window.



► Make the text in a worksheet smaller or larger

1. Click anywhere on the worksheet you want to adjust.
2. On the status bar, click **+** or **−** until the text is the size you want it to be.



Notes:

- The zoom level on worksheet grids does not affect the appearance of printed reports. For information about adjusting the size of the text in printed reports, see ["Adjust the amount of information printed on a page" on page 333](#).
- Worksheet authors cannot set the default zoom level.



Tip: You can also press **CTRL + PLUS SIGN** or **CTRL + MINUS SIGN** to zoom in and out, or hold down **CTRL** and use the mouse scroll wheel.

Resetting the zoom level

The zoom level you select remains in effect if you switch focus to other tabs, but it is not saved when you close the report. Each time you open a report that contains worksheet grids, the zoom level for each is reset to the default.

You can also return the text size to its default setting without closing the report.

► Reset the text in a worksheet to its original size

1. Click anywhere on the worksheet you want to adjust.
2. On the status bar, hover your mouse pointer over the zoom level indicator.
The zoom level indicator becomes a **Reset** button.



3. Click **Reset**.

Restore original worksheet appearance in a workbook

After modifying the appearance of a workbook, you can reset the workbook's appearance to use the original settings that were specified by the workbook author.

This function resets many different settings, including the following:

- Arrangement of worksheet tabs
- Zoom level
- Worksheet view (Form view or Table view)
- Chart appearance
- Bucket settings in crosstab workbooks
- Column width
- Column order
- Hidden/unhidden status of columns
- Frozen columns
- Column searches
- Column sorting

► Reset worksheet layout

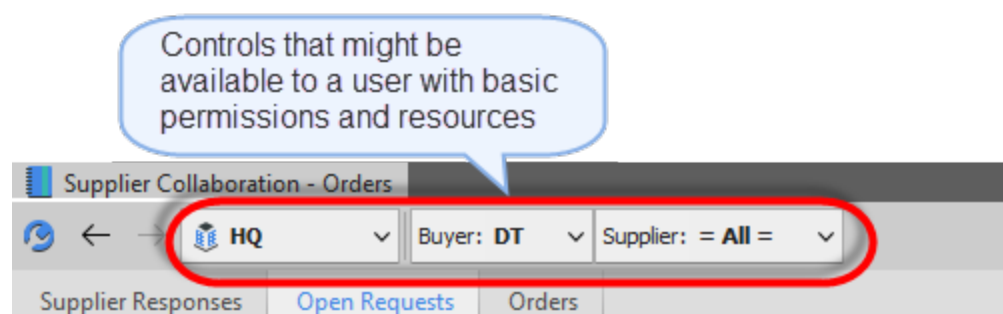
1. Select a workbook tab in the workspace area.
2. On the **View** menu, click **Reset Workbook**.

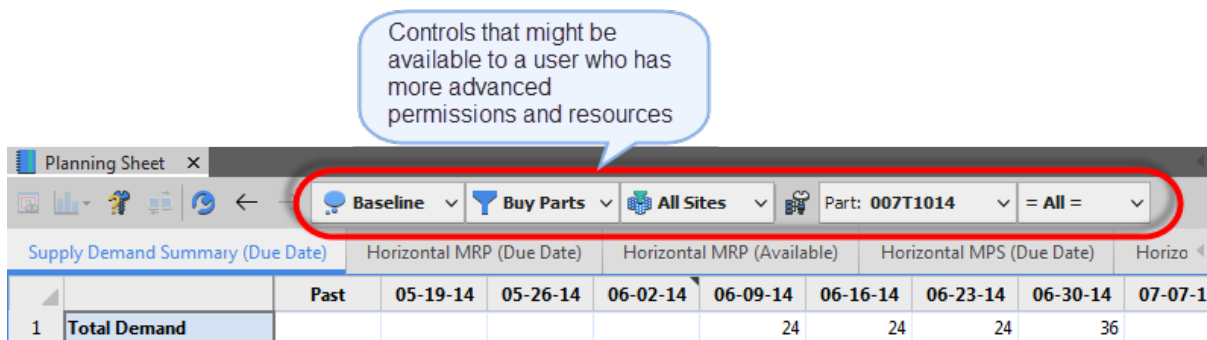
CHAPTER 13: Viewing data in workbooks

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You can view RapidResponse data in workbooks, which contain worksheets. The type of information presented in a RapidResponse worksheet is partly determined by the design of the worksheet. Each worksheet acts as a container that displays specific types of records (for example, late customer orders).

The data that displays in a worksheet is also determined by the selections you make in the controls at the top of the worksheet. The controls you see depend on your user permissions and resources, and the worksheet itself. Only records that match every selection you make from the controls are displayed in the worksheet. If there are no records matching your selections, the worksheet remains empty.





You might also have a hierarchy panel on the left side of the worksheet to control the data that is displayed in the worksheet.

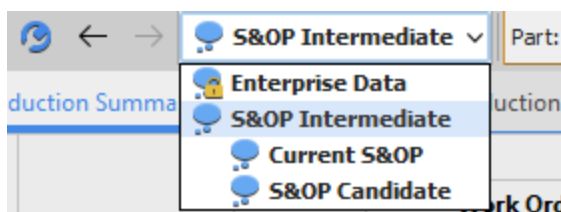
The following is a list of the most common controls that you might have available to you.

Scenario

A scenario represents a complete version of your company's enterprise data. Scenarios enable what-if analysis and collaboration in RapidResponse. When a supply chain event occurs that requires a response or resolution, users who have permission to manage scenarios can create numerous scenarios and evaluate them before any action is taken.

The scenarios you have access to depend on your job function and how you typically use RapidResponse. You might have access to only one scenario that represents the current state of your supply chain, in which case, you will not see the scenario control. If you are often involved in resolving common supply chain problems, other users might share with you scenarios in which data has been modified to simulate a specific business problem. You might also see scenarios that evaluate potential solutions to the problem. Each of these scenarios represents a different version of your enterprise data. You might also have access to workbooks that contain multi-scenario worksheets, which display data from more than one scenario and allow you to compare the data values in the scenarios side by side. For more information about multi-scenario worksheets, see ["View data from multiple scenarios" on page 159](#).

Scenarios exist in a parent-child relationship, where each scenario is the child of another scenario. For example, in the following illustration, the Current S&OP scenario is a child of the S&OP Intermediate scenario. The parent of the S&OP Intermediate scenario is not visible because it has not been shared with this user.



For information about scenarios, see ["Scenarios in RapidResponse" on page 17](#).

Filter

A filter focuses on a subset of data in the selected scenario. It defines the selection criteria that data must meet to display in a worksheet. For example, a planner might have a filter that displays data only for the parts he oversees.

Some workbooks also contain a Part control, or Work center, Constraint and Project control if your company has enabled the appropriate modules. In these worksheets, you must select a part, work center, or constraint after you select the filter in order to populate the worksheet with data.

Some worksheets might exceed the worksheet record limit after a filter is selected. The worksheet record limit is the maximum number of records that can be displayed. If you need to reduce the number of records, you can create search conditions on your worksheet. For more information, see ["Searching data in workbooks" on page 187](#).



Notes:

- You cannot access some workbooks if the appropriate filters are not available to you. If this situation occurs, contact your RapidResponse administrator.
- Only filters that are compatible with the workbook you are viewing are available for selection. For example, if a worksheet contains material (part-based) data, you cannot apply a capacity-based (work center-based) filter.
- To always open a worksheet with a specific filter, you can create a shortcut to the worksheet. For more information, see ["Create a shortcut to display workbook data" on page 104](#).

Site

You frequently filter the data in a worksheet by site.

All parts in the RapidResponse database are associated with a site. The combination of the part's name and its site, make the part unique. While multiple sites could carry the same part and use the identical name to identify it, the part is considered unique in each different site.

For example, three different sites can each carry the same part and use an identical name to identify it. For planning purposes the part is considered unique in each different site. You can distinguish between the parts using the site and part name.

Sites are used to identify data sources. Data sources can include your company's enterprise system (for example, ERP), data feeds from your customers and suppliers, and other databases. RapidResponse can use sites to model a source of supply, demand, or both. Supply and demand from each site is segregated from other sites.

The site you select is used with the selections you make in other controls to determine the data that displays in a worksheet. For example, if you select a site in a part-based worksheet, the worksheet shows only parts carried at that site.

RapidResponse supports two types of sites: manufacturing/physical and inventory/logical. These types of sites are identified with the following icons:

-  manufacturing/physical site
-  inventory/logical site

Manufacturing/Physical

A manufacturing/physical site is an individual location within a company (or a company's subsidiary or a company's third-party manufacturing facilities) that segregates its supply and demand from other locations, for example, a plant, a specific geographic location, and so on. Typically, manufacturing, assembly of products, or both occur at this type of site.

Data from manufacturing/physical sites is used to model supply and demand, and model the building of supply to support demand. The part data associated with manufacturing/physical sites includes a BOM structure.

Enterprise data sources are often used as a site identifiers.

Inventory/Logical

Inventory/logical sites are used to identify units, such as business units and inventory hubs. An inventory/logical site is often an inventory location, and it segregates its supply and demand from other locations. Examples include retail site, hub, VMI, and order consolidation.

These types of sites are primarily used to model a source of supply, demand, or both.

The part data associated with the inventory/logical site type does not involve transformation of one part into another (for example, processing, assembly, and so on) and should not include any BOM structures. RapidResponse analytics (including netting) must not be used in modeling exercises that explode BOM structures.

You can filter data in a worksheet by individual sites or possibly by site filters, which include multiple sites. Permission to see data for a particular site is granted to you by an administrator. Site filters are shared by users who create them.

Site filters

Site filters are used to group data from multiple sites. Site filters provide RapidResponse users with the ability to view aggregated data based on logical groupings (for example, geography or manufacturing plants). For example, assume your company has five sites:

- United States
- Canada
- Mexico
- Japan
- China

In this case you might have two site filters:

- North America (for United States, Canada, Mexico)
- Asia (for China and Japan)

You should be aware that although you might have been given permission to a site filter, it does not provide you access to the all the underlying sites. For example, you might be given permission to the North American site filter and only have permission to the data from the United States and Canada sites.

In this case, using the North America site filter only returns data from the United States and Canada sites and excludes data from the Mexico site.



Notes:

- Every RapidResponse user with access to two or more sites can filter data based on every site available to them using the **All Sites** site filter.
- Sites filters using the  icon.

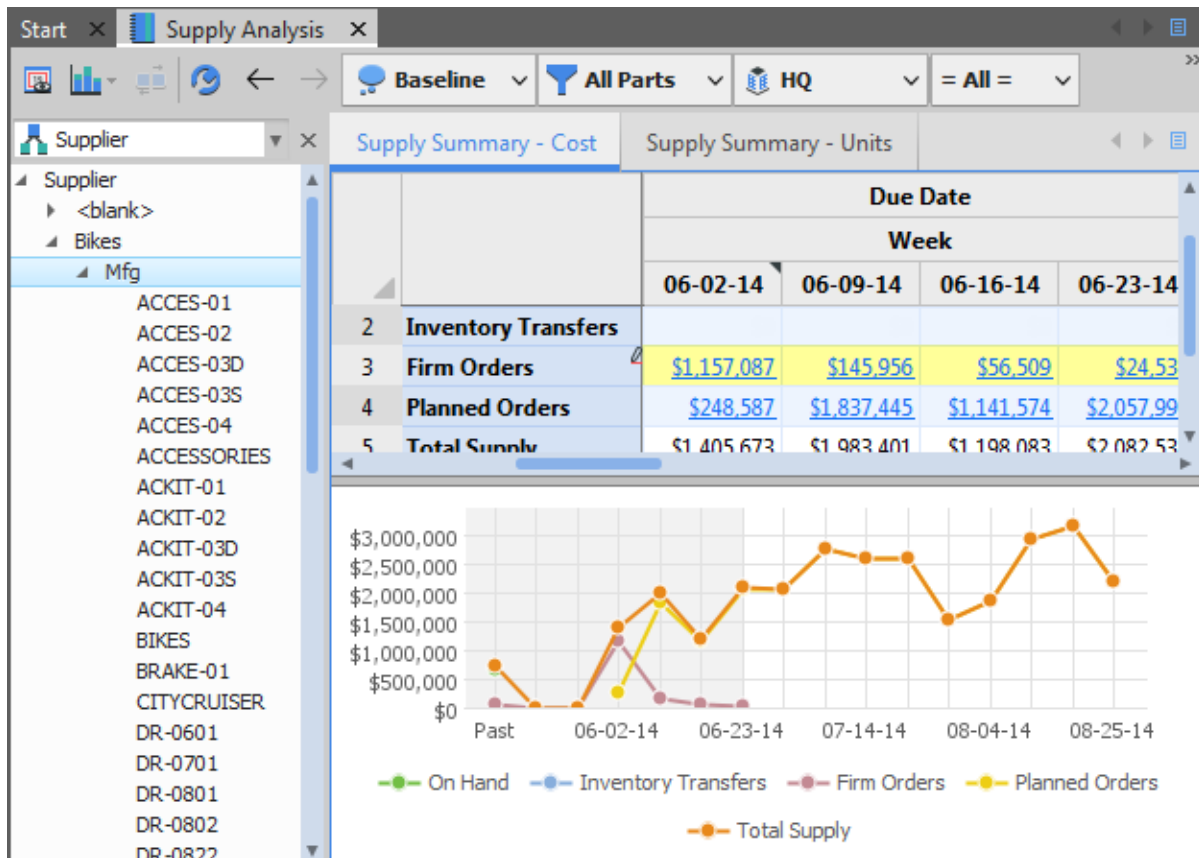
You might also see the following controls where you can make selections.

Hierarchy

A hierarchy is used to display data at different levels of detail within a workbook. A hierarchy typically represents one aspect of your company's data, such as a product structure or geographical regions. For example, you could have a product structure represented as a hierarchy with levels for divisions of your company, product families, product lines, and individual parts.

Each level in the hierarchy, when selected, summarizes the data in the levels below it to show you data at that level of detail. By selecting different values in the hierarchy, a worksheet can show summarized values for each level of the hierarchy, such as forecast values for individual product lines, or for an entire division of your company.

Hierarchies are selected from a panel on the left side of the worksheet, as shown in the following illustration.



For more information about hierarchies, see ["Using hierarchies in reports"](#) on page 301.

Part

In some workbooks available to you, you might be able to filter the data down to a particular part. After you select a filter and a site, the parts available with that filter and site combination are listed in a Part control. Select a part from this control to populate each worksheet with data pertaining to that part.



Notes:

- It is important to select an appropriate filter in workbooks that include the Part control. Some filters can load a large part list into the Part control, making it more difficult to locate the part you want.
- If your company has enabled the reference part functionality, a **List Reference Parts** button might be displayed beside the Part list. For more information, see ["Show reference parts"](#) on page 156.
- Workbooks that use part data in worksheets, but have no Part control, typically include a Part column so that you can search for records pertaining to a specific part. For more information about searching, see ["Search for specific data"](#) on page 190.

Constraint

If your company has enabled constraints, a Constraint control might be available in workbooks that are compatible with constraints.

A constraint is a factor that represents the capacity of a process or supply source. Each constraint is based on a rate, that is the amount of the constraint available per time period. For example, a constraint on a manufacturing process can be the number of units that a production line can produce per day, or the number of production hours per day. A supplier, or a particular piece of equipment can also be defined as a constraint.

Work Center

If your company has enabled the Capacity Manager application, a Work Center control might be available in workbooks that are compatible with work centers.

Model

This control is displayed only if your company has enabled the Model-Unit Effectivity module. Model-Unit effectivity is typically used to simplify bill of material maintenance. A model is a variant of a specific part. Models are used where several variants of a common part are made, and where the differences in structure between the variants are relatively small. A model uses the same part number, but is different from other models of the same part. As such, supply of one model is never used to satisfy the demand for a different model.

For example, in the aviation industry, an aircraft engine has a specific part number. However, there might be different models of the engine for left and right side mounting. The right-side model uses a right-side fuel pump and engine mounts while the left-side model uses a left-side fuel pump and engine mounts. The bill of material for the engine uses model effectivity to generate dependent demand for either right-side mounts and fuel pumps, or left-side mounts and fuel pumps.

Some worksheets contain hidden Model and Unit columns, which can be made visible if your company has enabled the Model-Unit Effectivity module. For more information, or if you see a worksheet that should have the Model and Unit columns, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

Pool

This control is displayed only if your company has enabled the optional Pool module. A pool is a set of supplies and demands that are segregated from other supplies and demands for the same part. Pools can be constructed on a project or customer basis. For example, a customer may pay early to have inventory set aside for them and not allow it to be used in another customer's production. Pool netting then plans each pool for a part independently, respecting the segregation.

Some worksheets contain a hidden Pool column, which can be made visible if your company has enabled the Pool module. For more information, or if you see a worksheet that should have the Pool column, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

Project

This control is displayed only if your company is using integrated project management and only in project related workbooks.

Currency

This control is displayed only if your company uses multiple currencies, the workbook contains Money columns, and the workbook's author has allowed you to select the currency used in the worksheet. By changing the currency, you can view Money data in the worksheet in any available currency.

Unit of measure

This control is displayed if the workbook is configured to display quantity or money columns in different unit of measures. Changing the unit of measure enables you to view data in measures most useful to your context, such as viewing orders in equivalent units.

Other settings

Some worksheets allow you to specify values for other settings, which are defined by the workbook's author and can be used to filter the data in the workbook, or to provide values to be used if you click a link to another workbook. These settings might be displayed on the workbook toolbar, or might be visible only on the **Data Settings** dialog box, which you can use to specify display settings for the worksheet. In the data settings, settings that are displayed on the workbook toolbar are listed above settings that are not displayed on the toolbar. For information about specifying values for these settings, see ["Display data in a worksheet" on page 146](#).

Some workbooks also contain buttons that can apply multiple settings at one time. In these workbooks, you can use the button to reset the workbook to its initial appearance or change other control settings to display specific data defined by the workbook's author. Using a button sets the values the button specifies, and cannot be undone.

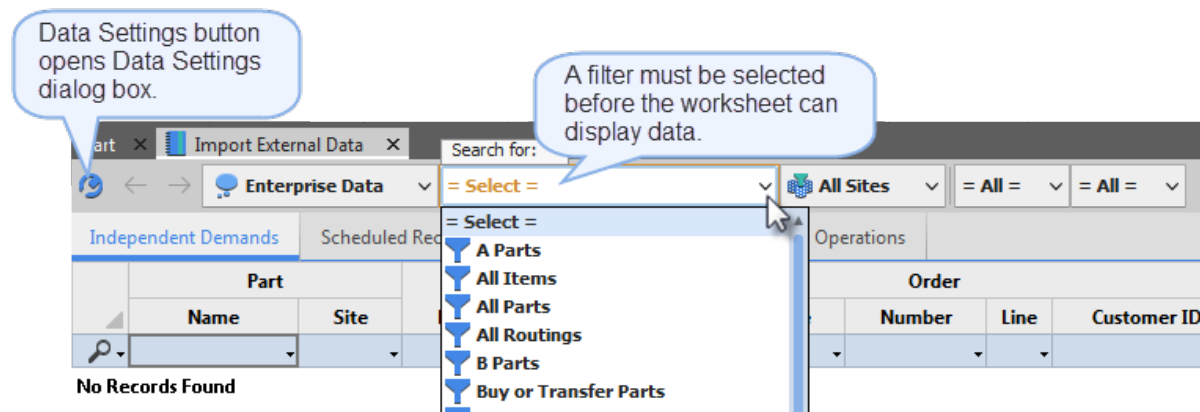
Display data in a worksheet

You can specify the data that the worksheet displays in two ways: by modifying the controls on the workbook toolbar one at a time, or by modifying the controls all at once in the Data Settings dialog box. If you modify the controls individually, the data displayed in the workbook is refreshed after each selection you make. If you modify multiple settings in the Data Settings dialog box, the data displayed in the worksheet is refreshed only after you close the dialog box, which means that you do not have to wait for the worksheet data to load for every setting you change.

Data settings on the workbook toolbar

Workbook authors can create custom workbook controls on the workbook toolbar, which you can use to control the data displayed in the worksheet. These controls are visible only if they affect the active worksheet. For example, if the control determines which customer data is displayed for, it is not visible in worksheets that do not display customer data. These settings are always visible in the Data Settings dialog box.

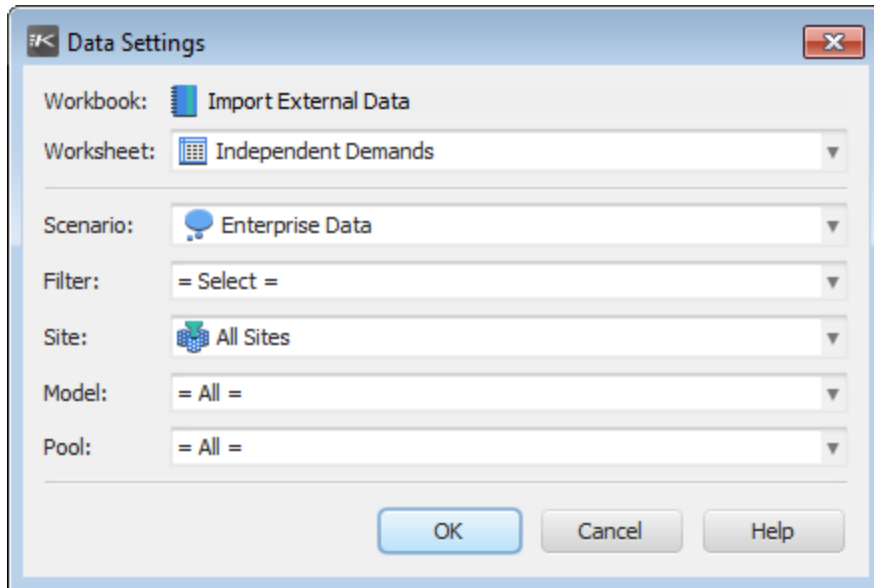
When a value is shown in orange on a control on the worksheet toolbar, it means that the value that is currently selected is placeholder text. When you see placeholder text, select a different value from the drop-down list.



The Data Settings dialog box

Some worksheets might also contain settings that can only be modified in the Data Settings dialog box. These settings are defined by the workbook's author, and can be used either to filter the worksheet, or to provide data for another workbook through a worksheet link.

In workbooks that have additional settings, you should specify a value for every setting in the Data Settings dialog box. Otherwise, you might have to specify settings when you open a worksheet, or the worksheets might not contain meaningful data, depending on how the worksheet was created.



► Select data settings

- Open a workbook, and do one of the following in the selected worksheet:
 - In the controls at the top of the worksheet, select the appropriate items. After you make a selection in a control, the worksheet data is refreshed to match the selected item.
 - If you want to change the selection in several controls at the same time, you can click **Data Settings**  to make all of your selections before refreshing the data.

For information about how the selections you make populate a worksheet, see ["Viewing data in workbooks" on page 139](#).



Notes:

- When you open a workbook, the last control selections you made are retained. If you want to specify that a workbook always open with certain selections, you can create a shortcut to the workbook. For more information, see ["Create a shortcut to display workbook data" on page 104](#).
- If the data takes longer than twenty seconds to display, a dialog box opens where you can cancel the data retrieval. For more information, see ["Cancel data retrieval in a worksheet" on page 185](#).
- A workbook might be set to manual refresh. Worksheets that might be displaying outdated data must be manually refreshed to view the most current data. For more information, see ["Display most recent data" on page 158](#).
- If the workbook contains a button that specifies values, the button is not displayed in the **Data Settings** dialog box.



Tips:

- You can search for specific items in the worksheet controls by clicking the control and typing the name of the item.
- You can revert to the data that was previously displayed by clicking **Back** . For more information, see ["Revert to previously displayed data" on page 150](#).

Worksheet Record Limit

There is a limit to the number of records that can be displayed in a RapidResponse workbook, which is set by your RapidResponse administrator. Some users can override the worksheet record limit, but others cannot. If, after you select the data settings, the number of records that match the criteria exceed the worksheet record limit, a dialog box warns you that the worksheet record limit has been exceeded. For more information about searching, see ["What if the worksheet record limit is exceeded?" on page 189](#).

Display part data

You might have access to the Part Properties workbook, which you can use to view key part and part source parameters. You can also edit some part data, including modifying specific parameters, or inserting and deleting records. The following illustration shows the Part Properties workbook.

The screenshot shows the 'Part Properties' workbook interface. The top navigation bar includes 'Start', 'Part Properties', and 'Order Management'. Below the navigation bar, there are tabs for 'General', 'Planning Policies', 'Range of Coverage Overrides', 'Reference Parts', and 'Interchangeable'. The 'General' tab is active, displaying a form with various fields. Callouts highlight specific features: 'Each worksheet contains part planning data.' points to the 'Part:' field; 'Editable values' points to the 'Site:' field; and 'Non-editable values' points to the 'Planner:' field.

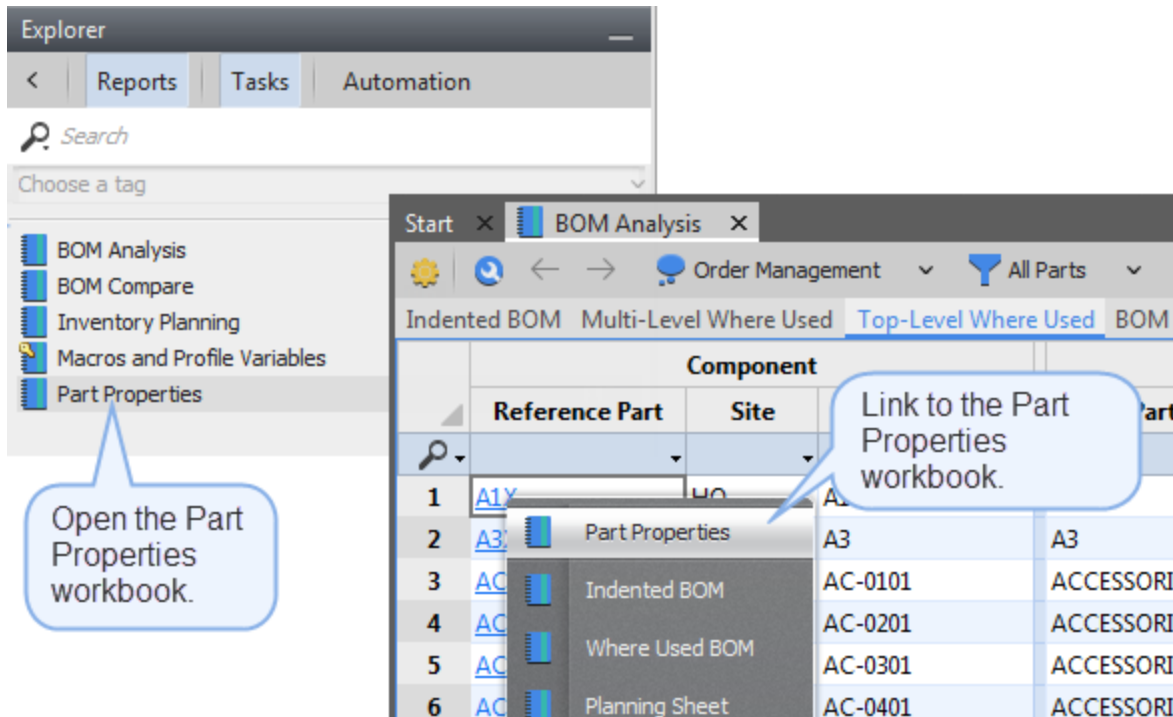
Part:	AC-0501
Site:	HQ
Description:	Bicycle Computer
Type:	MRP
Control Set:	Default
Reference Part:	AC-0501X
ABC Code:	C
Planner:	RO
Buyer:	EH
Primary Supply Type:	PlannedPO
Primary Control Set:	Default



Note: You can read detailed information about all worksheets in the Part Properties workbook by opening the workbook and then clicking **Show Workbook/Worksheet Help** on the **Help** menu.

Open the Part Properties workbook

You can open the Part Properties workbook from the Explorer or you can link to it from a part column in any worksheet, if the part names are shown in blue. The following illustration shows ways to open the Part Properties workbook.



Note: For more information about opening workbooks or linking to a workbook, see ["Open a workbook to access a worksheet" on page 127](#), or ["Link to different resources from a worksheet" on page 181](#).

Revert to previously displayed data

After changing the selections in the controls within a workbook, you can revert to the previously displayed data. There are five views preserved in history per workbook or scorecard. The views preserved in a workbook or scorecard are not applicable to any other workbooks or scorecards. For more information about scorecards, see ["Viewing scorecard data " on page 279](#).

- On the workbook toolbar, click **Back** ←.



Note: Clicking the **Back** button does not take you back to a different worksheet if you were viewing one previously, rather, it applies the previously selected controls to the active worksheet.



Tip: You can display the data you had displayed before clicking the **Back** button by clicking **Forward** →.

View money data in a worksheet

In worksheets that display financial information, such as revenues, costs, prices, or margins, the money values are displayed using a specific currency. If your company uses multiple currencies, depending on how the worksheet was created, the money values might be displayed in your preferred currency, or in a currency specified by the worksheet's author. For information about specifying your default currency, see ["Specify formats for dates, times, numbers, and currencies" on page 60](#).

Money values for each record can be displayed in any available currency, and converted to any other currency when displayed in worksheets. For example, the Revenue column in the following illustration shows money values converted into four currencies.

Order Revenues							
	Order	Due Date	Quantity	Revenue			
				US Dollars	Canadian Dollars	Euros	Japanese Yen
1	C00002	07-14-14	200	\$12,327	\$13,400	€9,387	¥1,284,027
2	C00003	06-02-14	125	\$7,704	\$8,375	€5,867	¥802,517
3	C00004	07-07-14	125	\$7,704	\$8,375	€5,867	¥802,517
4	C00005	06-02-14	80	\$4,048	\$4,400	€3,082	¥421,621
5	C00006	07-07-14	80	\$4,048	\$4,400	€3,082	¥421,621
6	C00007	06-09-14	100	\$5,059	\$5,500	€3,853	¥527,026
7	C00008	07-21-14	100	\$5,059	\$5,500	€3,853	¥527,026
8	C00009	06-09-14	410	\$37,339	\$40,590	€28,436	¥3,889,452

Each record inserted or imported into RapidResponse is saved using a currency. If your RapidResponse system supports multiple currencies, the currency used to insert the record is determined by RapidResponse. These values are then converted in workbooks. This allows you to have records inserted in multiple currencies, but display those records in one currency. For example, if you have records inserted using euros, US dollars, and Canadian dollars, those values are converted to a single currency when displayed in a worksheet, as shown in the following illustration.

Value	Currency
45	EUR (€)
45	USD (\$)
45	CAD (\$)

Order prices inserted in multiple currencies

	Order	Line	Due Date	Quantity	Unit Selling Price
1	C00001	1	06-02-14	200	€45
2	C00001	2	06-02-14	200	€34
3	C00001	3	06-02-14	200	€32

Order prices displayed in one currency in the worksheet

In workbooks that contain the Currency data control, you can choose the currency to view data in. This currency is applied to all Money columns, except those which always display a specific currency. For example, the workbook shown in the following illustration displays the unit price and order total in Canadian dollars.

			New Scenario	All Parts	HQ	= All =	= All =	CAD (Canadian Dollar)
Order Revenues								
	Order	Line	Due Date	Part	Quantity	Unit Price	Order Total	
1	C00002	1	07-14-14	ACKIT-01	200	\$67	\$13,400	
2	C00003	1	06-02-14	ACKIT-02	125	\$67	\$8,375	
3	C00004	1	07-07-14	ACKIT-02	125	\$67	\$8,375	
4	C00005	1	06-02-14	ACKIT-03D	80	\$55	\$4,400	

By selecting a different currency, such as yen, the unit price and order total values are converted.

			New Scenario	All Parts	HQ	= All =	= All =	JPY (Yen)
Order Revenues								
	Order	Line	Due Date	Part	Quantity	Unit Price	Order Total	
1	C00002	1	07-14-14	ACKIT-01	200	¥6,420	¥1,284,027	
2	C00003	1	06-02-14	ACKIT-02	125	¥6,420	¥802,517	
3	C00004	1	07-07-14	ACKIT-02	125	¥6,420	¥802,517	
4	C00005	1	06-02-14	ACKIT-03D	80	¥5,270	¥421,621	

Understanding how numeric values are displayed

Scaled numbers

In some cases, the numbers displayed might not be actual values, but are formatted to scale to a value that the worksheet author specifies (for example, thousands or millions). The column heading or worksheet help should indicate the scaling factor used in the column. Scaling numbers simplifies the data, making it easier to understand and edit.

Scientific notation

In some cases, when a numeric value in a cell is very large, it might display as a scientific notation (also known as exponential notation) so that it is easier to read. For example, the number 123000000000 might display as 1.23e+011, which is 1.23 times 10 to the power of 11, where e stands for exponent.

Scientific notation is applied to quantity fields, not integer fields.

Values used in calculations

RapidResponse calculations use stored values rather than values displayed in a worksheet. For example, cost information for three parts might be displayed as \$11, \$12, and \$13 when the actual values are \$10.60, \$11.95, and \$13.45. In a calculation that sums this cost information, the actual values are used.

Numbers that cannot be displayed

In some cases, the result of a calculation might not be able to be displayed in RapidResponse. This could happen if, for example, a value is divided by zero, or an infinite value is used in a calculation.

If the result of the calculation is not a number that can be represented in RapidResponse, it is displayed as 0 or an alternative such as is **NaN** for "Not a Number" or is **INF** for "Infinity".

Alternatives to 0 are specified by the workbook author.

Units of measure

Columns that display quantity or money data typically display in a set unit of measure which is determined by the data itself and how it will be used.

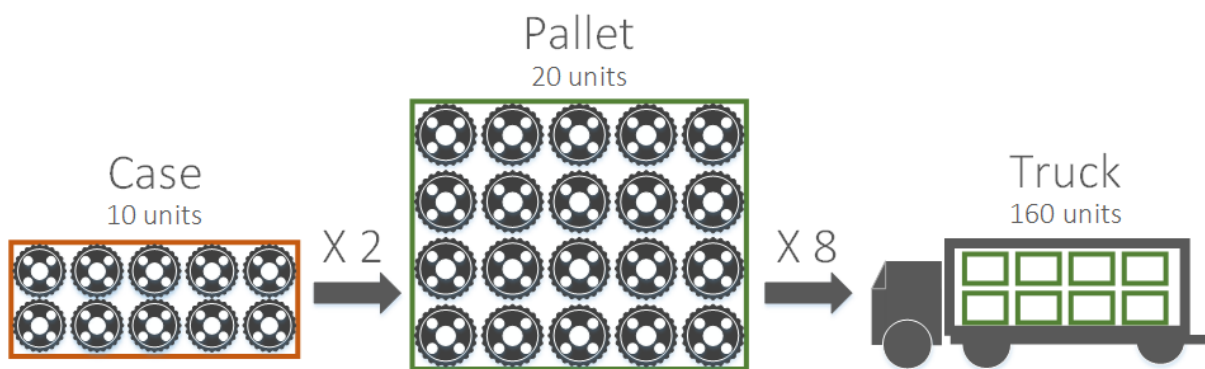
In some workbooks, you might have a control that allows you to change the unit of measure that those columns display in. For example, you might change how the quantities for a set of orders displays, from pallets to kilograms.

Change the units for numeric data in a worksheet

In worksheets that display quantity or money columns, the data values display in a specific unit of measure. Typically, this measure is individual units.

Orders - Chart									
Part Name	Order			Line	Quantity	Sell Price	Expiry Offset	Due Date	
	Id	Site	Type						
863 ACKIT-02	C00052	HQ	Actual	1	21	\$740	-1	07-13-17	
864 ACKIT-02	C00074	HQ	Actual	1	26	\$740	-1	08-24-17	
865 ACKIT-02	C00099	HQ	Actual	1	33	\$740	-1	06-08-17	

For example, a quantity value could be expressed in units, cases, pallets, or trucks, which allows you to view orders in terms of different scales. In this example, there might be 10 units to a case, 2 cases to a pallet, and 8 pallets to a truck, so an order for 160 units will occupy one truck.



If your company has multiple units of measures defined, workbooks with a unit of measure control allow you to view numeric data in different units. The selected unit of measure is applied to all quantity and money columns in the worksheet. For example, if you had to coordinate an alternate shipping route for a group of orders and the new shipping requirements needed items clustered into groups of twelve, you could switch your view of the data to see those order quantities in dozens instead of individual units.

Approved Actions

All Parts

HQ

ACKIT-02

= No conversion =

Orders

Orders - Chart

	Part Name	Order			Line	Quantity	Sell Price	Expiry Offset	Due Date
		Id	Site	Type					
863	ACKIT-02	C00052	HQ	Actual	1	250	\$62	-1	07-13-17
864	ACKIT-02	C00074	HQ	Actual	1	313	\$62	-1	08-24-17
865	ACKIT-02	C00099	HQ	Actual	1	400	\$62	-1	06-08-17

Approved Actions

All Parts

HQ

ACKIT-02

DZ (Dozen)

Orders

Orders - Chart

	Part Name	Order			Line	Quantity	Sell Price	Expiry Offset	Due Date
		Id	Site	Type					
863	ACKIT-02	C00052	HQ	Actual	1	21	\$740	-1	07-13-17
864	ACKIT-02	C00074	HQ	Actual	1	26	\$740	-1	08-24-17
865	ACKIT-02	C00099	HQ	Actual	1	33	\$740	-1	06-08-17

A workbook can only have one type of measure applied at a time. The list of values in a unit of measure control display for the first scenario or the current scenario applied in the workbook.

DZ (Dozen)
= No conversion =
DZ (Dozen)
EA (Each)
FT (Feet)
G (Gram)
KG (Kilogram)
LB (Pound)
M (Meter)
ML (Milliliter)
PL (Pallet)
T (Tonne)

You might see unit of measure controls in short cuts, drill links, collaboration links, in an open action in a task flow, or in the Data Settings pane of a dashboard. For some records, the data value cannot be converted to the selected unit of measure. Instead, the records display as Not a Number (NaN) or infinity (INF).

Enterprise Data

KG (Kilogram)

Orders

	Part Name	Order			Line	Quantity	Sell Price	Expiry Offset	Due Date
		Id	Site	Type					
4932	CDMA-C333	102-CDMAc-req	SOPDC-SouthAmerica	DCRequest	8	240	\$45	-1	11-09-17
4933	CDMA-C333	102-CDMAc-req	SOPDC-SouthAmerica	DCRequest	9	240	\$45	-1	11-16-17
4934	CDMA-C333	102-Cell-ACT001	SOPDC-SouthAmerica	DCActual	1	100	\$36	1	06-06-17
4935	CDMA-C333	102-Cell-ACT004	SOPDC-SouthAmerica	DCActual	1	100	\$36	-1	06-16-17
4936	CDMA-C333	BBy-CDMAc	DC-Asia	DCForecast	1	NaN	NaN	-1	05-25-17
4937	CDMA-C333	BBy-CDMAc	DC-Asia	DCForecast	10	NaN	NaN	-1	07-27-17



Notes:

- Unit of measure controls are only available in the Desktop Client.
- Units of measure not available for the selected scenario or that are not available in your system display with a red X in the list of units in the unit of measure control.
- If an alert is created for a worksheet that has a unit of measure control, the alert might use the measure selected in the workbook or it might the default measure (specified as = No conversion = in the control list).

Show reference parts

Your company might have enabled the reference part functionality if:

- Your company is a brand owner that imports data into RapidResponse from a contract manufacturer's instance of RapidResponse.
- Your company wants to more easily aggregate and analyze demand and supply across sites.
- Your company has transferred to a new part naming system and is also keeping the old part name information in RapidResponse for reference purposes.
- Your company has divisions that use different part naming conventions.
- Your company uses RapidResponse to group a product line. For example, you might group various pager models into one reference category.

Several predefined RapidResponse workbooks contain worksheets which include a Reference Part column, as illustrated below.

This column lists the parts using the contract manufacturer's part naming conventions.

This column lists the part using your company's part naming conventions.

	Part	Site	Description	Type	Control Set	Reference Part	ABC Code	Planner	Buyer	Supp
1	AMC-MB002	PCM-Hong	Motherboard Socket Y (Dual	Normal	Default	MB002		ChrisG	DK	Plann
2	GC002-AMC	CM2	Mother Board	CMMP	Default	MB002				CMPI
3	GC002-AMC	CM2-030	Mother Board	MPS	Default	MB002				HubP
4	GC002-AMC	CM2-Asia	Mother Board	MPS	Default	MB002				HubP
5	GC002-AMC	SOPCM2	Mother Board	CMMP	SOPDefault	MB002				CMPI
6	MB002	030	Motherboard Socket Y (Dual	Outsourc	Default	MB002	A	ChrisG	DK	SCPla
7	MB002	AmeriComp	Motherboard Socket Y (Dual	Normal	Default	MB002	A	ChrisG	DK	Plann
8	MB002	BAU-Taiwar	Motherboard Socket Y (Dual	MPS	Default	MB002	A	ChrisG	DK	Plann
9	MB002	CM1	Motherboard Socket Y (Dual	CMMP	Default	MB002	A	ChrisG	DK	CMPI

Understanding the part to reference part relationship

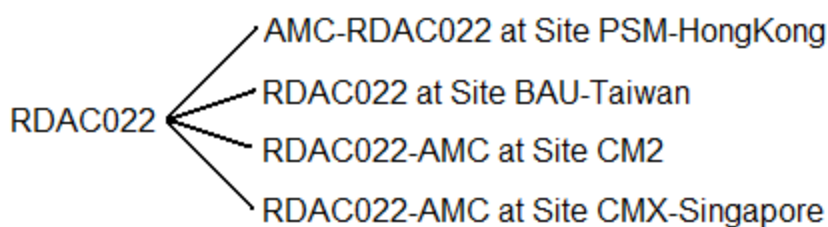
If your company is using the reference part functionality to show the relationship between old and new part names, then a one to one relationship between part and reference part is common.

If your company is using the reference part functionality to group product lines, then a one to many relationship exists.

Consider the following scenario:

You are interested in part RDAC022, which is manufactured at four different sites. Some of the sites use a part name different from your company, and have a naming convention unique to the others.

Some naming conventions for part RDAC022 are shown in the following illustration.



The relationship between these parts is displayed as shown in the following illustration.

Part RDAC022 is manufactured at four different sites, therefore four records are displayed in this worksheet when RDAC022 is selected from the Reference part control.

Part RDAC022 is displayed in the Reference Part column.

Start										
General										
Reference part: RDAC0022										
Changeable Parts Unit of Measure Conversion										
	Part	Site	Description	Type	Control Set	Reference Part	ABC Code	Planner	Buyer	Supp
1	AMC-RDAC0022	PCM-Hongl	RAMDAC Chip High End	MRP	Default	RDAC0022	A	ChrisG	DK	Plann
2	RDAC0022	BAU-Taiwar	RAMDAC Chip High End	MRP	Default	RDAC0022	A	ChrisG	DK	Plann
3	RDAC0022-AMC	CM2	RAMDAC Chip High End	CMNorm	Default	RDAC0022	A	ChrisG	DK	CMPI
4	RDAC0022-AMC	CMX-Singap	RAMDAC Chip High End	MRP	Default	RDAC0022	A	ChrisG	DK	Plann

► Toggle between parts and reference parts

1. Open a workbook that includes a **Part** control, for example, the **Part Properties** workbook.
2. Select the scenario, filter, and site for which you want to view data.
3. Click **List Reference Parts** , and then select a part from the **Reference Part** control.
The worksheet is populated with information related to the part you selected.
4. Click **List Reference Parts**  to toggle back to the **Part** control.



Note: The **List Reference Parts** button is only available to you if your RapidResponse administrator has enabled it.



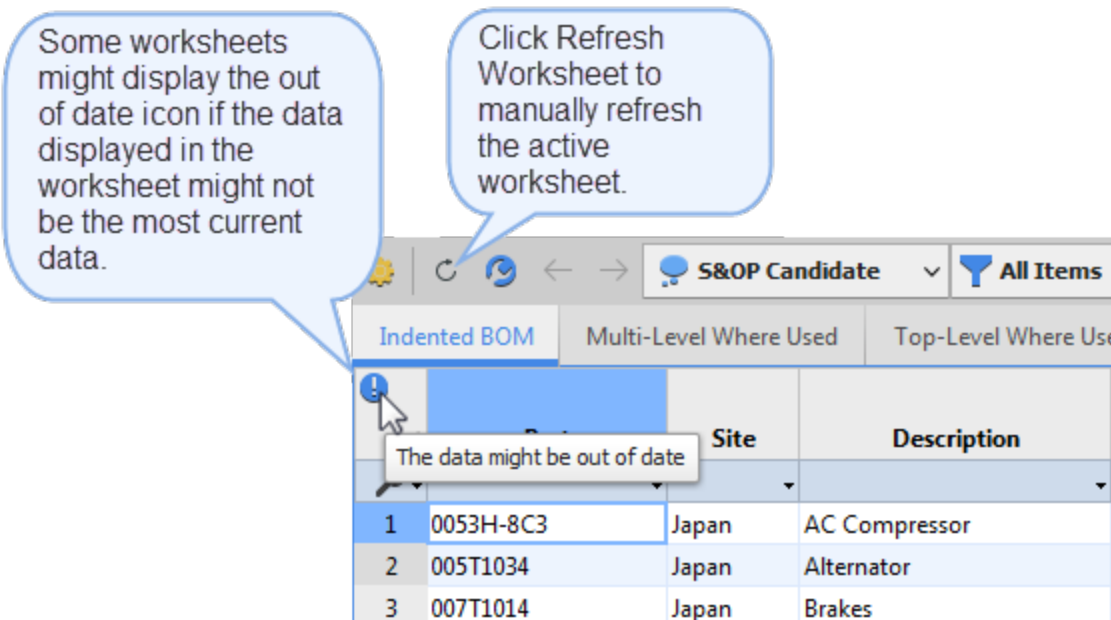
Tip: You can also display the part you want by clicking the part link and then clicking **Current Worksheet**. This filters the worksheet by the selected part.

Display most recent data

Other users might be able to edit data in the shared scenarios to which you have access. If the workbook has been authored to refresh automatically, the data in scenarios is instantly updated on a regular basis as long as you are performing tasks in RapidResponse. During a period of inactivity, the data is updated every five minutes. Some workbooks that process large amounts of data might be authored to refresh data manually to reduce worksheet load times. This allows you to make edits to an active worksheet and then choose when to refresh the data in the worksheet.

Manual refresh

Workbooks with the manual refresh option enabled display the **Refresh Worksheet**  button on the workbook toolbar. When a data change impacts an open worksheet, click **Refresh Worksheet**  to refresh the worksheet and see the most current data. Some workbooks will also display the out of date  icon that displays on worksheets that might have outdated data and need to be manually refreshed.



► Manually refresh a worksheet

1. Click on the worksheet to make it active.
2. Click **Refresh Worksheet**  on the worksheet toolbar.



Tip: You can also manually refresh an active worksheet by clicking **Refresh Worksheet** on the **Data** menu or by pressing CTRL-SHIFT-R.

► Manually refresh a workbook

- To refresh all of the worksheets in the workbook at the same time, click  **Refresh All** on the RapidResponse toolbar.



Note: Manually refreshing also updates the contents of the Navigation pane and your user permissions. For more information, see ["Refresh the contents of the Navigation Pane" on page 117](#).

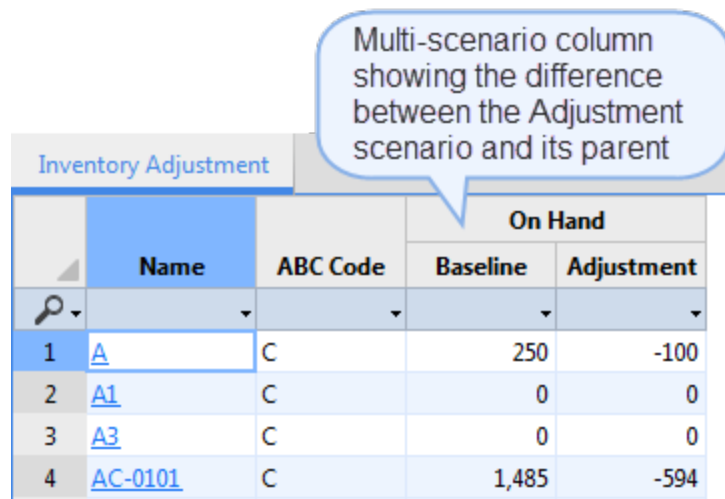


Tip: You can also refresh the workbook by clicking  **Refresh All** on the **View** menu.

View data from multiple scenarios

Some worksheets include multi-scenario columns, which display data from different scenarios. These columns allow you to compare data values between scenarios. Depending on how the workbook you are using was authored, you might be able to compare the scenario you have selected to one other scenario, or you might be able to specify multiple scenarios for comparisons.

For workbooks that compare your selected scenario to one other scenario, your scenario might be the baseline scenario or the comparison scenario. The baseline scenario is displayed first in the workbook, and the values in the comparison scenario are compared to the baseline. The scenario your selected scenario is compared to can be your selected scenario's parent or a scenario chosen by the worksheet's author, depending on the workbook. The data displayed in the comparison scenario can be shown as actual values, differences from the baseline scenario, or differences expressed as percentages. An example of a worksheet with a multi-scenario column displaying differences is shown in the following illustration.



Inventory Adjustment				
	Name	ABC Code	On Hand	
			Baseline	Adjustment
1	A	C	250	-100
2	A1	C	0	0
3	A3	C	0	0
4	AC-0101	C	1,485	-594

In this example, the on hand quantity of each part is shown in the On Hand column. The value in the Baseline column shows the On Hand quantity in the Baseline scenario, while the value in the Adjustment column shows the difference between the Baseline scenario and the Adjustment scenario. There are 250 units of Part A on hand in the Baseline scenario, and 150 units on hand in the Adjustment scenario. The difference, -100, is shown in the Adjustment column.

Some multi-scenario worksheets include more than one comparison scenario. For these worksheets, you can specify each of the scenarios, including the baseline scenario. The first scenario you specify is the baseline, and the values in each additional scenario you add are compared to it. An example of a worksheet with multiple comparison scenarios is shown in the following illustration.

Approved Actions is the baseline scenario.

Each row shows data for a different scenario.

Multi-Scenario Demand Orders		Demand Orders					
Part	Part Site				06-09-14	06-16-14	06-23-14
61	CRUISER	HQ	Available Date	Approved Actions	06-02-14	06-06-14	07-29-14
62				Cancel Orders	06-02-14	09-08-14	06-06-14
63				Increase Orders	06-02-14		06-02-14
64			Days Late	Approved Actions	0	0	31
65				Cancel Orders	0	+65	-31
66				Increase Orders	0	0	0
67			Quantity	Approved Actions	4,811	2,870	2,900
68				Cancel Orders	0	-870	0
69				Increase Orders	+100	-870	+870

This worksheet is a multi-scenario crosstab worksheet. Each row represents data from a different scenario, which in this case are the Approved Actions, Cancel Orders, and Increase Orders scenarios. The Approved Actions scenario is the baseline scenario. For more information about crosstab worksheets, see ["View data in a crosstab worksheet" on page 162](#).

In this example, the values in the Demand Increase and Demand Decrease columns show the difference between the Approved Actions scenario and the Demand Increase and Demand Decrease scenarios, respectively.

Depending on how the workbook was created, the number of scenarios might be fixed, which require you to add a specific number of scenarios. For these workbooks, you cannot add more or fewer scenarios; you must add the number specified by the workbook's author.

If you create a scenario in these workbooks, the scenario you create replaces the baseline scenario. If a worksheet in the workbook contains editable columns, you can use the scenario you created to modify data and then compare the changes to the comparison scenarios already in the workbook. For more information, see ["Modifying data in workbooks" on page 339](#).

You cannot modify data in a worksheet that contains multi-scenario columns.

► Add or remove scenarios

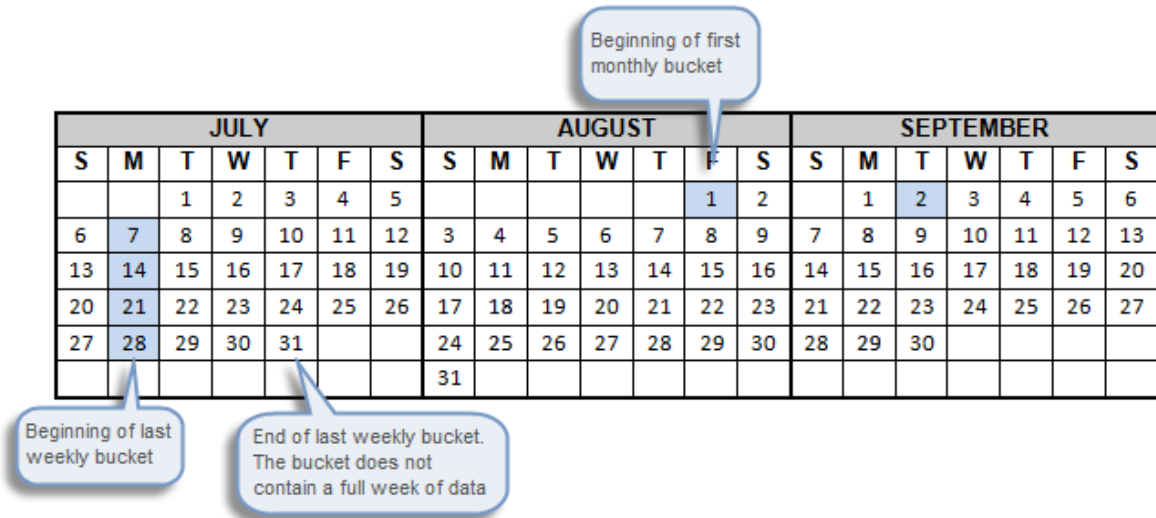
1. In a multi-scenario workbook, on the workbook toolbar, click **Add or Remove Scenarios** .
2. In the **Scenarios** dialog box, do the following:
 - To add a scenario to the worksheet, select it in the **Select from this list** box, and then click **Add**.
 - To remove a scenario from the worksheet, select it in the **Scenarios** box, and then click **Remove**.
 - To change the order in which scenarios are displayed, drag a scenario up or down in the **Scenarios** box.

Start		Planning Sheet		S&OP Can...		All Items	Japan	Part: =
Supply Demand Summary (Due Date)		Horizontal MRP (Due Date)		Horizontal MRP (Available)				
		05-26-14	06-02-14	06-09-14	06-16-14	06-23-14	06-30-14	
1	T			2,480	1,641	1,651		
2	T			360				
3	Available Date (if late)						07-07-14	
4	Late Quantity							
Supply & Demand		Split Supplies		In Process (Planned)		Demand Orders		On Hand
	Part	Site	Quantity	Type	Non Nettable	Warehouse	Loca	
1	0053H-8C3	Japan	2	Net		JapanWarehouse	Store1	
2	005T1034	Japan	22	Net		JapanWarehouse	Store1	
3	007T1014	Japan	9	Net		JapanWarehouse	Store1	

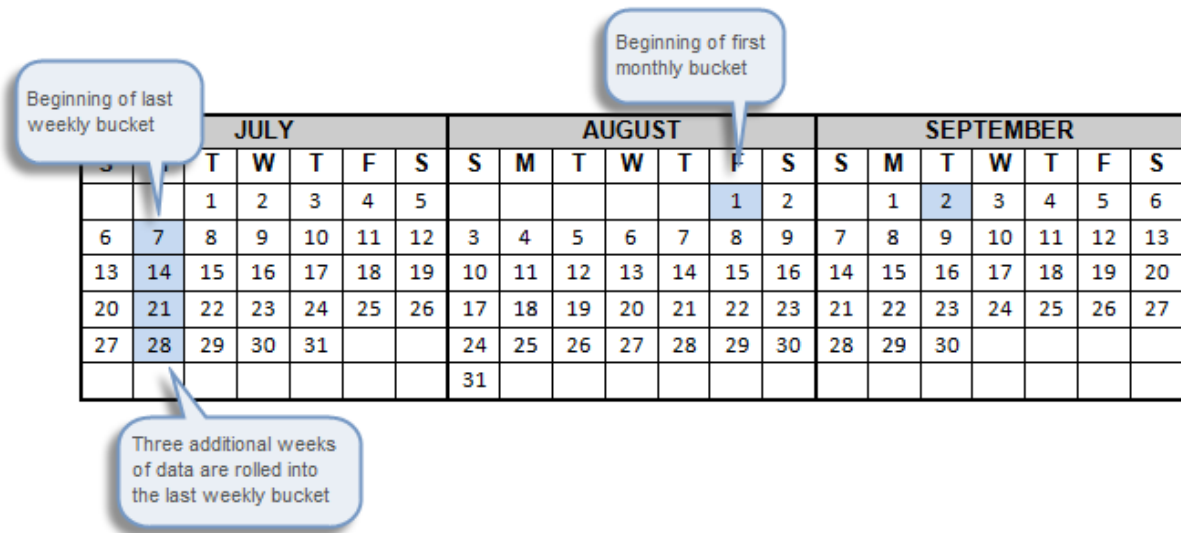
The buckets in a crosstab worksheet are specified from a date of the worksheet author's choice. In some cases, this date might be several weeks or even months from the current date or planning date. For these worksheets, the worksheet author can highlight the current date or planning date to indicate where it is in relation to the worksheet buckets. An example of a highlighted date is shown in the following illustration.

Start		Planning Sheet		S&OP Can...		All Items	Japan	P
Supply Demand Summary (Due Date)		Horizontal MRP (Du		Bucket that contains the planning date highlighted with the triangle icon.				aila
		05-26-14	06-02-14	06-09-14	06-16-14	06-23-14	06-30-14	
1	Total Demand						4	
2	Total Supply						51	
3	Available Date (if late)						07-21-14	
4	Late Quantity						2	

Some buckets might contain data for only a portion of the bucket, such as a weekly bucket that contains only two days of data. This typically happens when the date the buckets are defined from falls near the end of a bucket, or when the bucket is the last bucket before the bucket size changes, as shown in the following illustration.



Some buckets might contain data for more than the bucket period. This typically happens when the buckets change size and the last bucket of one size comes more than one period in advance of the first bucket of the next size. For example, in a worksheet bucketed by week and month, if the last weekly bucket comes near the beginning of the month, it will contain data for each week until the end of that month, as shown in the following illustration.



Partial buckets and buckets that contain more data than expected are identified by the black triangle symbol in the top right corner of the column header, as shown in the following illustration.

Enterprise Data All Parts All Sites Part: CS003 = All = All									
Supply Demand Summary (Due Date)		Horizontal MRP (Due Date)		Horizontal MRP (Available)		Horizontal MPS (Due Date)		Horizontal	
		05-26-14	06-02-14	06-09-14	06-16-14	06-23-14	06-30-14	07-07-14	08-01-14
1	Total Demand		935	2,715	2,400	2,400	2,400	7,935	11,275
2	Independent Demand		300	1,025	725	725			400
3	Intersite Demand		125	675	675	675			375
4	Firm								
5	Planned		125	675	675	675			375
									2,200

Weekly bucket that contains data for more than one week

Crosstab worksheets can contain bucketed subtotals, which are displayed after the buckets they summarize. For example, you might have a crosstab worksheet bucketed by week with a monthly subtotal at the end of each month. Depending on how the buckets are defined, the subtotals could split buckets into two partial buckets, as shown in the following illustration.

Demand Forecast							
			Partial bucket for the end of July		Monthly subtotal for July		
			Week		Week	Total	Quantity by
			07-14-14	07-21-14	07-28-14	Month	08-01-14 08-04-14
1	ACKIT-01	HQ	600	600	600	2,400	
2	ACKIT-02	HQ	750	750	750	3,000	
3	ACKIT-03D	HQ	450	450	450	1,800	
4	ACKIT-03S	HQ	400	400	400	1,600	0 400
5	ACKIT-04	HQ	600	600	600	2,400	0 600
6	CRUISER	HQ	2,000	1,800	1,800	7,600	0 1,800

Partial bucket for the beginning of August

Crosstab worksheets can also contain a to-date subtotal, which shows the total of a crosstab row from the beginning of a period to a current date. For example, a worksheet might contain a year to date subtotal that displays the total of demands from the beginning of the year to the beginning of the current week. An example of a year to date subtotal is shown in the following illustration.

Year to Date							
	Part	Site	Week			Total	
			07-07-14	07-14-14	07-21-14	Year to Date	07-28-14
1	ACKIT-01	HQ	600	600	600	3,800	600
2	ACKIT-02	HQ	750	750	750	4,800	750
3	ACKIT-03D	HQ	450	450	450	3,000	450
4	ACKIT-03S	HQ	400	400	400	2,800	400
5	ACKIT-04	HQ	600	600	600	3,900	600
6	CRUISER	HQ	2,000	2,000	1,800	13,800	1,800

Depending on how the crosstab worksheet was created, the values displayed in the subtotal columns might be calculated using values not displayed in the worksheet. For example, if the worksheet contains a quarterly subtotal but only displays two monthly buckets, the subtotal might be calculated using the month that is not displayed. The subtotal might also be calculated using only the values visible in the worksheet. The worksheet's author specifies how subtotals are calculated in these cases.

When a subtotal column is displayed without all the buckets for the period that it summarizes (such as a quarterly subtotal with only two monthly buckets), the column header is marked with a triangle, which tells you whether the subtotal is calculated using only the visible values or using values not shown in the worksheet. An example of a subtotal calculated using values not displayed in the worksheet is shown in the following illustration.

Demand Order Totals							
	Part	Site	Quantity by Due I				
			Month		Total	Month	
			08-01-14	09-01-14	Quarter	10-01-14	11-03-14
1	ACKIT-01	HQ	2,400	2,150	6,950	1,300	1,000
2	ACKIT-02	HQ	3,000	2,700	8,700	1,650	1,200
3	ACKIT-03D	HQ	1,800	1,650	5,250	1,100	800
4	ACKIT-03S	HQ	1,600	1,500	4,700	1,100	800
5	ACKIT-04	HQ	2,400	2,150	6,950	1,300	1,000

Crosstab worksheets present aggregated data. You can only modify data in these worksheets if the worksheet author has allowed a row of the crosstab to be editable. For more information, see ["Edit records in a crosstab worksheet" on page 349](#).

In a crosstab worksheet, blank cells can be used to represent zero values. Typically, a cell with a zero value represents a date bucket that does not contain any detailed records. However, you might have buckets that contain a record or records with zero quantities. To determine whether the bucket contains records, you can view the records summarized in a bucket in the detail worksheets.

The detail worksheets display records that are summarized in the crosstab worksheet. In some crosstab worksheets, you can drill to details in another resource by clicking a drill link in a crosstab cell. When you drill to details, searches are applied to the columns in the detail worksheet, so it displays only the records that are summarized in the crosstab cell.

An example of a crosstab worksheet that drills to a details worksheet is shown in the following illustration.

Demand Summary						
	Part	Site	Week			
			06-16-14	06-23-14	06-30-14	07-01-14
87	PROCRUISER	DWest	1		100	0
88		HQ	650	0	1,000	0
89		Taipei	1,324	1,590	318	1,272
90	PRORACER	HQ	750	0	750	0
91	RACER	Germany	200	200	200	0
92		HQ	750		750	0
Demand Details						
	Part	Site	Order	Line	Due Date	Quantity
	PROCRUISER	Taipei			06-16-14..	
1	PROCRUISER	Taipei	AsiaForecast	1091	06-16-14	208
2				1092	06-17-14	208
3				1093	06-18-14	272

Clicking a value in a crosstab row in the Demand Summary worksheet displays the records summarized in the Demand Details worksheet. The Part, Site, and Due Date columns in the detail worksheet are searched for the corresponding values in the Part, Site, and Due Date columns in the crosstab.

Some drill links open a form when clicked. For more information, see ["Link to different resources from a worksheet" on page 181](#).



Note: A crosstab worksheet cannot display more than 100,000 records.

► Determine how much data is in a marked bucket

- In a crosstab worksheet, move the pointer over a bucket or subtotal bucket that is marked with a black triangle.

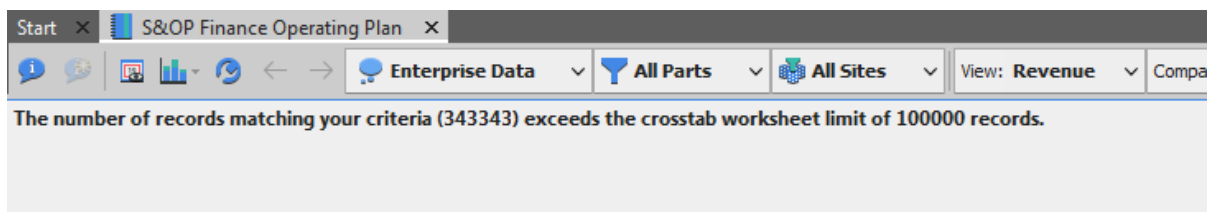
A tooltip indicates whether the bucket does not contain data for a full period ("Transition bucket - time period is shorter than indicated") or contains data for more than one period ("Transition bucket - time period is longer than indicated").

If the bucket is a subtotal bucket, the tooltip indicates whether the subtotal is calculated for only the visible values ('Subtotal bucket - time period is shorter than indicated') or calculated for values not visible in the worksheet ('Subtotal bucket - time period contains dates not displayed in buckets').

When the crosstab worksheet record limit is exceeded

Your RapidResponse administrator sets a worksheet record limit for crosstab worksheets, determining the maximum number of records that worksheets can display. By default, the limit is 500,000 records. When the worksheet record limit is exceeded in a crosstab worksheet, no records are displayed. A crosstab worksheet's record limit applies to the number of its source records; that is, the number of records that would be returned if the crosstab worksheet was formatted as a vertical worksheet.

A message appears to indicate that the number of records exceeds the limit, as shown in the following illustration.



There is no option to override the record limit of a crosstab worksheet, even if an administrator has granted you permission to override record limits (the permission applies only to vertical worksheets). However, you may be able to adjust the worksheet's data and bucket settings to display records. If necessary, contact a system administrator who can change the record limit for you.

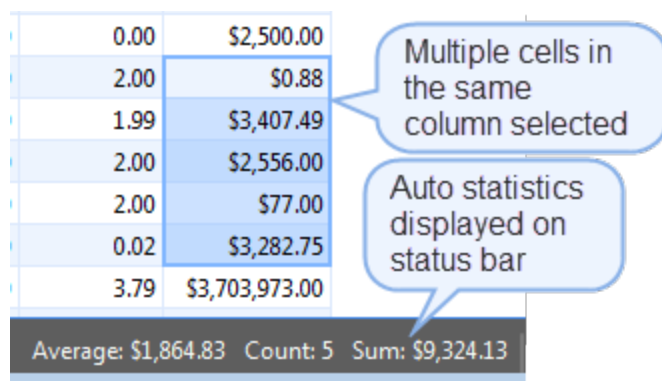
Select data

The following table describes how you select data in worksheets.

To select	Do the following
A single cell	Click the cell you want to select.
Multiple cells	Click and drag to select cells.
A row	Click the row number of the row you want to select. You can also select the row number using arrow keys.
A column	Click the column header. You can also select a column header using arrow keys.
Adjacent rows	Click a row number and drag to select multiple rows.
The entire worksheet	Click the empty cell in the top left corner of the worksheet.

View auto statistics for selected data

When you select a range of cells—either in a worksheet column or crosstab worksheet row—you can view automatically calculated statistics about the selected data, such as the number of selected cells. By default, no statistics are displayed; you can activate those that you want to view. An example of displaying auto statistics is shown in the following illustration.



Auto statistics are also available scorecards and in worksheet data widgets on dashboards.



Caution: Using auto statistics with scorecard summary data or detail worksheets with multiple scenarios displayed in rows might not return meaningful results.

The available auto statistics vary depending on the data type of the selected cells.

Statistic	Description	Data types
Average	The average of the selected cells. The average is calculated using the actual values in RapidResponse, not the values displayed in the worksheet.	Quantity, Integer
Count	The number of selected cells.	Quantity, Integer, Date, Time, DateTime, String
Maximum	The highest value or latest date selected.	Quantity, Integer, Date, Time, DateTime
Minimum	The lowest value or earliest date selected.	Quantity, Integer, Date, Time, DateTime
Sum	The total of the selected cells. The sum is calculated using the actual values in RapidResponse, not the values displayed in the worksheet.	Quantity, Integer

► Turn on auto statistics

1. On the **Data** menu, click **Auto Statistics**.
2. In the **Auto Statistics** dialog box, select the check boxes for the auto statistics you want to turn on.
3. Click **OK**.

**Tips:**

- You can turn on all statistics by clicking **Select All**.
- You can also open the **Auto Statistics** dialog box by right-clicking the status bar.

► **Turn off auto statistics**

1. On the **Data** menu, click **Auto Statistics**.
2. In the **Auto Statistics** dialog box, clear the check boxes for the auto statistics you want to turn off.
3. Click **OK**.

**Tips:**

- You can turn off all statistics by clicking **Clear All**.
- You can also open the **Auto Statistics** dialog box by right-clicking the status bar.

► **Calculate and display auto statistics**

- In any worksheet, select two or more cells in the same column. For more information, see "[Select data](#)" on page 168.

**Note:** Cells in subtotal rows are not included in auto statistic calculations.**Tip:** Click a column header to see statistics for the entire column.► **Calculate and display auto statistics in crosstab worksheets**

- In any crosstab worksheet, select two or more cells in the same row.
An example of displaying auto statistics in a crosstab worksheet is shown in the following illustration.

107,306	154,055	231,453	254,101	278,220
-17,834	-277	72,544	95,192	119,311
3.18	4.56	6.85	7.52	

Average: 71,692 Count: 4 Sum: 286,769

For more information about crosstab worksheets, see "[View data in a crosstab worksheet](#)" on page 162.

Add and view notes

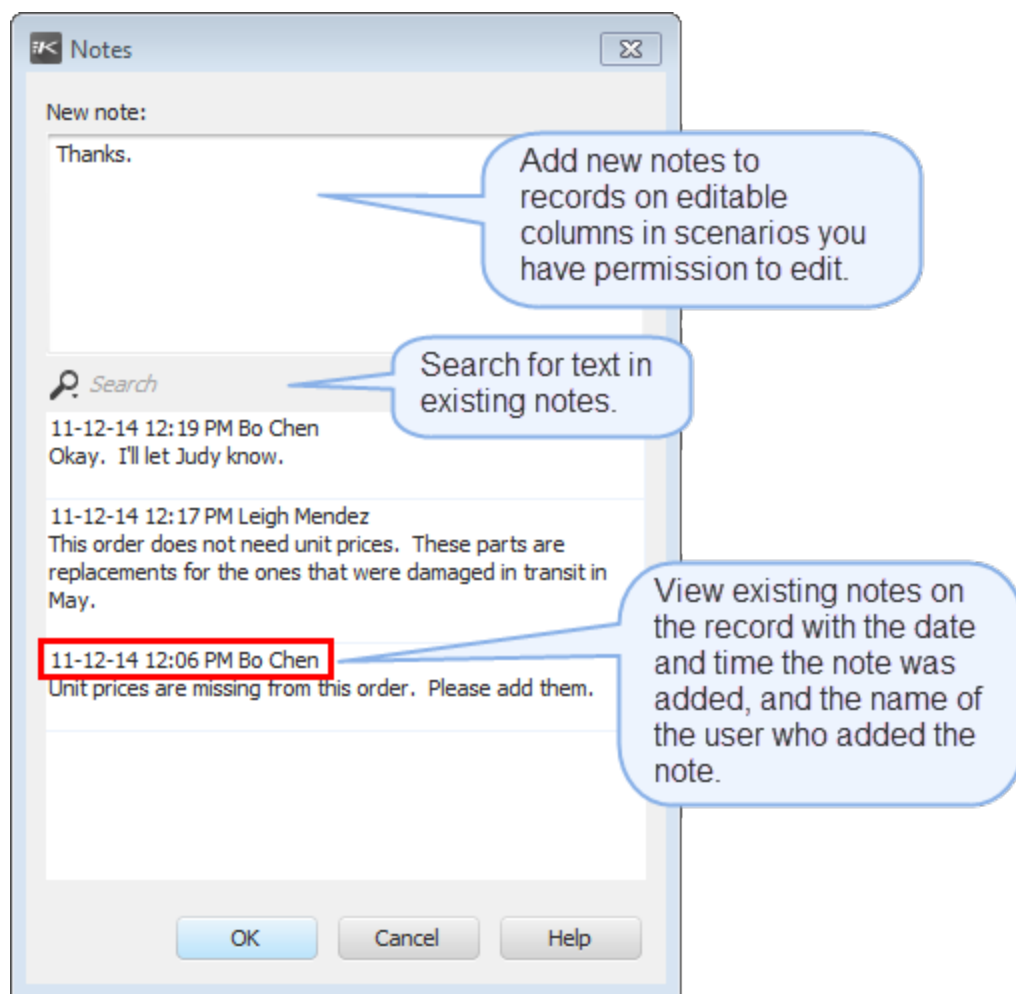
Some worksheets might have a notes option enabled that attaches a note to a data record. Notes allow for greater collaboration between the users of a worksheet. For example, suppliers that have access to workbooks might add a note providing status on an order or notes can be added to a sales order to keep a record of customer communication and preferences.

There are two ways that notes for a record are indicated on a worksheet:

- In a **Notes** column in a table-based worksheet.
- As a notes indicator on a cell in a cross-tab or composite worksheet.

Double-clicking on the **Notes** column or selecting a cell with the notes indicator and clicking **Add or view notes**  opens the **Notes** dialog box.

You can add new notes, and view and search existing notes in the **Notes** dialog box. Above existing note text, the date and time the last note was added and the ID of the user who added the note are displayed. If you do not have editing permission for a worksheet with notes enabled, you can only view and search existing notes.

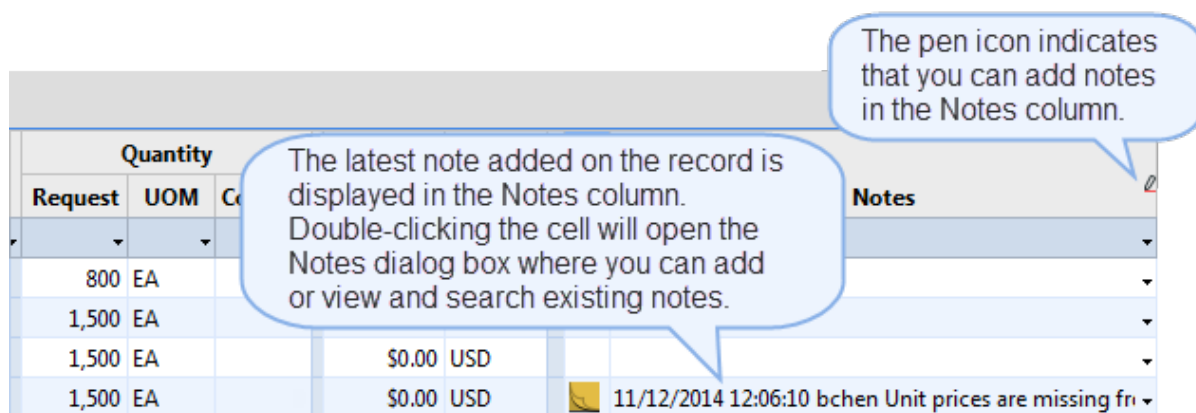


**Notes:**

- Date and time in notes are displayed in the format as specified in user options. For more information, see ["Specify formats for dates, times, numbers, and currencies" on page 60.](#)
- If you have data editing permissions and are working in an editable scenario, a pen icon  displays in the Notes column header, indicating that you can add notes to this worksheet. For more information, see ["Add a note" on page 365.](#)

Adding and viewing notes in a table-based worksheet

For table-based worksheets with notes enabled, the most recent note with date, time, and user ID displays in the **Notes** column.



Request	UOM	Co	Quantity	Unit Price	Unit	Notes
800	EA					
1,500	EA					
1,500	EA			\$0.00	USD	
1,500	EA			\$0.00	USD	11/12/2014 12:06:10 bchen Unit prices are missing fr

► Add and view a note in a table-based worksheet

1. Double-click the cell in the **Notes** column for the record you want to add or view a note on. The **Notes** dialog box will open.
2. To add a note, type text in the **New note** box.
3. View any existing notes below the **Find** box.
4. Click **OK**.



Tip: To search existing notes, type text in the **Find** box.

Adding and viewing notes in a cross-tab or composite worksheet

For cross-tab worksheets with notes enabled, records with an attached note display the notes indicator, a red triangle in the upper corner of a cell. Notes are added and viewed by clicking **Add and view notes**  on the workbook toolbar. You can only add notes to cells in an editable column.

Baseline B Parts All Sites Forecast Period: All periods Sigmas: 2 Forecast Category

Customer Data Errors Causals Outliers

Add and view notes when you have selected a cell in an editable column.

Item	Date	Average Demand	Total Demand	Suggested Demand	Suggested Adjustment	Demand Adjustment	Adjusted Demand
Galaxy-850A	07-01-13	1,167	10,000	8,492	-1,508	-1,508	
Galaxy-A-Plug	06-03-13		5,300	3,434	-1,866	-1,866	
TabletGalaxy-D-Plug	06-03-13		2,200	1,803	-397	-397	
TabletGalaxy-P11	06-03-13		77,000	49,883	-27,117	-15,000	
USBMini-A	06-03-13		13,100	8,205	-4,895	-32	13,068

The notes indicator signals that there are existing notes for a record.

► Add and view a note on a cross-tab or composite worksheet

1. Select the cell to add a note to or a cell displaying the notes indicator .
2. Click **Add or view notes**  on the worksheet toolbar.
3. The **Notes** dialog box opens, and if you have editing permission, you can add notes on the column.
4. To add a note, type text in the **New note** box.
5. Click **OK**.



Tip: To search existing notes, type text in the **Find** box.

CHAPTER 14: Working with data in workbooks

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When you view data in a worksheet, you can modify how the data is presented to you, such as changing how the worksheet data is sorted, the size and number of date buckets a crosstab worksheet displays, or the appearance of a chart.

You can also create a shortcut to always open a workbook with the same filter, site, and so on, open another workbook based on the data in the worksheet, or stop worksheet data from loading.

Sort data

You can sort a worksheet to change the order in which records are displayed. You can sort the worksheet by the data in any column so the records are displayed in the order of the data values in that column. For example, you can sort by a quantity column to show the records with the greatest quantity first in the worksheet, or by a due date column to show the records with the earliest due date first.

When you sort a column, you must decide whether to sort in ascending or descending order. The following table explains how the order applies to different types of data.

Order	Sorts
Ascending	Quantity values smallest to largest. Date values earliest to latest. String values A to Z.
Descending	Quantity values largest to smallest. Date values latest to earliest. String values Z to A.

1. Select the column you want to sort by clicking the column heading.
2. On the **Data** menu, click one of the following:
 - **Sort Ascending**
 - **Sort Descending**



Tip: You can also sort a column by clicking the **Sort Ascending**  or **Sort Descending**  buttons.

► Reset to the default sort order

- On the **Data** menu, click **Reset Sort**.



Note: Sorting is not available if you are working with data displayed in Form view.

Set date buckets

Some worksheets you have access to, particularly crosstab worksheets, might have data grouped into date buckets. These buckets are predefined by the worksheet author. If necessary, however, you can change the buckets used in a worksheet or workbook. For example, if you are doing longer term planning you might want to add more buckets.

Depending on how the bucketing settings were specified by the workbook author, you will either have basic bucketing permissions, where you simply set the size and number of buckets to display in the worksheet, or you will have more advanced bucketing permissions. Both the basic and advanced bucketing permission are accessed by clicking the **Bucket Settings** button  on the worksheet toolbar. The following information pertains to workbooks in which the author has specified advanced bucketing permissions. For more information on specifying basic bucketing settings, see "[Set the size and number of buckets](#)" on page 178, below.

Some worksheets automatically scroll past historical date buckets to the anchor date, which is especially helpful in worksheets that include many historical date buckets, as it prevents you from scrolling to locate the anchor date each time you open the worksheet.

Defining date buckets

You can also use different bucket units within the same worksheet. For example, if you require more detailed data in the short term, you can initially use weekly buckets, and then switch to monthly or quarterly buckets after a specified period of time. All bucket settings are done relative to a date, called the anchor date, chosen by the workbook's author.

If the workbook author has specified subtotals for any of the buckets, you can only change the number of buckets that are displayed. You cannot change the bucket sizes, add additional sizes of buckets, or modify the subtotal settings.

The bucket that contains the anchor date is identified by the dividing line between buckets. You can determine which bucket contains the anchor date by looking for bucket sizes that are either the same on both sides of the line, or different with the size on the right of the line smaller than the size on the left. For example, if the left side shows weekly buckets and the right side shows daily buckets, the first daily bucket represents the anchor date. The first bucket to the right of the line is always the bucket that contains the anchor date, as shown in the following illustration.

Dividing line between buckets of same size identifies the anchor date.

		Due Date					
		Week			Week		
		Past	05-19-14	05-26-14	06-02-14	06-09-14	06-16-14
2	Inventory Transfers						
3	Firm Orders	\$32,504,401	\$45,718	\$700,978	\$70,072,008	\$69,935,294	\$62,564,069
4	Planned Orders					28,056,419	\$44,424,374
5	Total Supply	\$195,054,889	\$45,718	\$700,978	\$70,072,008	\$97,991,712	\$106,988,444

Bucket that contains the anchor date

The buckets at the end of a calendar period might display data for multiple periods. For example, if you have buckets for weeks and months, you might have multiple weeks of data displayed in the last weekly bucket, as shown in the following illustration.

Beginning of last weekly bucket

Beginning of first monthly bucket

JULY							AUGUST							SEPTEMBER						
S	T	W	T	F	S		S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S
		1	2	3	4	5						1	2		1	2	3	4	5	6
6	7	8	9	10	11	12	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
13	14	15	16	17	18	19	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
20	21	22	23	24	25	26	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	21	22	23	24	25	26	27
27	28	29	30	31			24	25	26	27	28	29	30	28	29	30				
							31													

Three additional weeks of data are rolled into the last weekly bucket

A bucket that contains more data than expected is identified by the black triangle symbol in the top right corner of the column header. An example of a bucket that contains more data than intended is shown in the following illustration.

Supply Demand Summary (Due Date)									
Horizontal MRP (Due Date)									
	05-26-14	06-02-14	06-09-14	06-16-14	06-23-14	06-30-14	07-07-14	08-01-14	09-01-14
1 Total Demand		935	2,715	2,400	2,400	2,400	7,935	11,275	7,475
2 Independent Demand		300	1,025	725	725			400	2,275
3 Intersite Demand		125	675	675	675			375	2,200
4 Firm									
5 Planned		125	675	675	675			375	2,200

Weekly bucket that contains data for more than one week

If you do not want buckets to contain more data than intended, you can automatically insert buckets when the bucket sizes change. These buckets are inserted only when required, so you always see, at minimum, the number of buckets you have specified. However, inserting buckets in this manner can insert partial buckets at the end of a calendar period. For example, if you have buckets for weeks and months, the last weekly bucket might end on the last day of the month but before the end of the week, causing the bucket to not contain the entire week, as shown in the following illustration.

JULY							AUGUST							SEPTEMBER						
S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S
		1	2	3	4	5						1	2		1	2	3	4	5	6
6	7	8	9	10	11	12	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
13	14	15	16	17	18	19	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
20	21	22	23	24	25	26	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	21	22	23	24	25	26	27
27	28	29	30	31			24	25	26	27	28	29	30	28	29	30				
							31													

► Set the size and number of buckets

If the workbook author has specified basic bucketing settings, you can specify the size and number of date buckets to display. If the worksheet's author has allowed it, you can also specify whether buckets earlier than the planning period are displayed.

1. On the toolbar, click **Bucket Settings** .
2. From the **Bucket by** list, select one of the following bucket sizes:
 - Month
 - Quarter
 - Year
3. In the **Future Buckets** box, specify the number of buckets to display.
4. If buckets earlier than the worksheet's planning period are available, do one of the following:
 - To display earlier buckets, select the **Include buckets for earlier periods** check box.
 - To hide earlier buckets, clear the **Include buckets for earlier periods** check box.

► Define advanced worksheet bucket settings

If the workbook author has specified advanced bucket settings, you can select how many buckets to display before the anchor date, and specify the bucket size and number of buckets to display. You can also apply bucket settings to the open worksheet only, or to the entire workbook.

1. On the toolbar, click **Bucket Settings** .
2. Click one of the following:
 - **Workbook bucket settings**—Lets you specify buckets that will be used for all worksheets in this workbook that do not have worksheet specific settings (that is, all worksheets that have the **Workbook bucket settings** option selected).
 - **Bucket settings specific to worksheet**—Lets you specify buckets that will be used for this worksheet.
3. In the **Before anchor date** area, select the number and size of buckets you want to display before the anchor date.

A Past bucket that contains all dates earlier than any specified bucket is also included. If you do not want to display the Past bucket, clear the **Include Past bucket** check box.
4. In the **After anchor date** area, select the number and size of buckets you want to display after the anchor date. You must have at least one bucket after the anchor date.

The first bucket specified after the anchor date contains the anchor date. For example, if it is a Weekly bucket, then the bucket will include data from the week containing the anchor date.

A Future bucket that contains all dates later than any specified bucket is also included. If you do not want to display the Future bucket, clear the **Include Future bucket** check box.
5. To insert buckets when bucket sizes change, select the **Automatically add buckets when transitioning between bucket sizes** check box.
6. Click **OK**.

**Notes:**

- If the worksheet author has defined subtotal buckets for the worksheet, you can modify only the number of buckets. The bucket sizes cannot be modified, and you cannot add additional bucket sizes.
- This procedure can be used to modify the buckets in many of the crosstab worksheets included in RapidResponse predefined workbooks, except for the Inventory Analysis workbook. For information about changing the bucket settings for the Inventory Analysis workbook, see the [RapidResponse Administration Guide](#) or contact your administrator.
- The calendars (bucket sizes) available in your RapidResponse system are specified by data administrators. Calendars can be defined to be excluded from the Bucket Settings dialog box. For more information, see the Calendar.PlanningOnly field in the [RapidResponse Analytic and Data Model Guide](#). This is available to resource authors and administrators.

Create or modify a filter

If your RapidResponse administrator has granted you permission, you can create filters that limit the records displayed in a report to a specific subset of the available records. You can copy values from a worksheet column into a filter. You can also create filters by typing one or more values that define the filter, or copying and pasting values from other applications (for example, Microsoft Excel) into a filter.

When you create a filter this way, you must pick a RapidResponse database table to base the filter on. A RapidResponse database table is a section of the RapidResponse database where a particular type of record is stored. For example, the Part table contains information about parts, and the Project table contains information about projects.

When you apply the filter, only records where the key field matches a value listed in the filter display in the report. The key field must be a string value. So, for example, if the filter is based on the Part table, the

values in the filter are compared to part names. If the filter is based on the Project table, the values are compared to project names.

For tables that have only one key field, that key field is the default value for the table and it cannot be edited. If the table has multiple key fields, you can select from an alphabetical list of all valid string key fields in the table. Filters cannot be created for tables that have no string key fields.

There are many other tables in RapidResponse. For more information about tables, see the [RapidResponse Analytic and Data Model Guide](#).

► Create a filter

1. On the **File** menu, point to **New**, and then click **Filter**.
2. In the **Name** box, type a name for the filter.
3. In the **Table** list, click the table you want to base the filter on.
4. Optionally, add a description of the filter in the **Author Notes** box.
5. Click the **Static Values** tab.
6. In the **Enter a value** box, type a static value to define the filter, and then click **Add**. Repeat for each value you want to add.
7. If the table has more than one key value, you can select another value in the list for the **Values for field** box.
8. After you have added all required values, click **OK**.



Notes:

- If you have values in your Windows Clipboard, you can paste them into the filter by clicking **Paste**. Each line or tab character in the pasted text represents the beginning of a new value.
- You can remove static values by selecting them in the **Values** list, and then clicking **Remove**, or you can click **Remove All** to remove all static values.



Tip: You can also create a new filter by clicking **New Resource**  on the RapidResponse toolbar and selecting **Filter**..

► Copy values from a worksheet into a filter

You can copy values from selected worksheet columns to create a filter based on those column values. If any of the worksheet columns you have selected directly reference a field in a table that has a key field, the Values for fields box is set to that key field by default. If the table has multiple or no key fields, you must select a key field from the list or select another table for the filter.

1. In an open worksheet, select the cell values you want to add to a filter. The values must be in adjacent rows of the same column.
2. On the **Edit** menu, click **Copy to Filter**.
3. If you have at least one private filter, the **Copy to Filter** dialog box opens. Do one of the following:
 - To add the worksheet values to a new filter, click **Create a new filter**.
 - To add the worksheet values to an existing filter, click **Modify filter**, select the filter from the list, and then click **Append to list of values**.
 - To overwrite the static values in an existing filter with the worksheet values, click **Modify filter**, select the filter from the list, and then click **Replace existing values**.

- Click **OK**.
- Optionally, select **Add a comment** to the version history for the filter.
- If you selected **Create a new filter** in Step 3, type a name for the filter in the **Name** box.



Note: If you do not have at least one private filter, clicking **Copy to Filter** takes you directly to the **New Filter** dialog box where you can create a new filter using the selected worksheet values.



Tip: You can also click **Copy to Filter**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.

Link to different resources from a worksheet

In some worksheets, you can open related resources by clicking on links in the worksheet cells. In some bucketed crosstab worksheets, you might see links on column headers.

You can drill to a details worksheet or to a form from a worksheet cell.

	Part	Site		Jun 2015	Jul 2015	Aug 2015	Sep 2015
87	GSM-850A	CM2	Quantity	1,491	2,298	2,598	2,562
88	GSM-850A	CM2	Status	Firm	Firm	Firm	Firm
89	GSM-850E	CM2	Quantity	1,024	2,908	2,882	2,504
90	GSM-850E	CM2	Status	Firm	Firm	Firm	Firm
91	GSM-850NA	CM2	Quantity	807	1,541	1,665	1,885
92	GSM-850NA	CM2	Status	Firm	Firm	Firm	Firm
93	GSM-990N	CM2	Quantity	1,513	2,302	2,576	2,444

Or you can drill to a details worksheet or to a form from a column header.

	Part	Site		Jun 2015	Jul 2015	Aug 2015	Sep 2015
88	GSM-850A	CM2	Status	Firm	Firm	Firm	Firm
89	GSM-850E	CM2	Quantity	1,024	2,908	2,882	2,504
90	GSM-850E	CM2	Status	Firm	Firm	Firm	Firm
91	GSM-850NA	CM2	Quantity	807	1,541	1,665	1,885
92	GSM-850NA	CM2	Status	Firm	Firm	Firm	Firm
93	GSM-990N	CM2	Quantity	1,513	2,302	2,576	2,444
94	GSM-990N	CM2	Status	Firm	Firm	Firm	Firm

There are two types of links: drill links and part, constraint, and work center links.

Drill links

Drill links can open a details worksheet in the same workbook or another workbook, or they can open a form. The information displayed in the linked resource is related to the record you click to drill from. When you drill to a form, some of the data values from the record might populate some of the form controls. For example, when looking at order information, you might open a form to dispose of unneeded inventory without having to leave the order worksheet.

The screenshot shows a 'Dispose Inventory' dialog box. The 'Scenario' is 'Enterprise Data'. The 'Disposing of Inventory' section shows 'Quantity to Dispose: *' as 325,887 and 'Disposition Code: *' as DCActual. The 'Current Values' section shows 'Existing Quantity: 325,887' and 'Part: LCD-4641'. The dialog has 'DISPOSE' and 'CANCEL' buttons.

	Part	Site	Due Date	Quantity	Type	Site
	Name					
1	CRUISER	Bern	06-01-17	12,365	Actual	Bern
2	LCD-3735	Bern	06-06-17	329,912	DCActual	Bern
3	LCD-3755	Bern	06-06-17	329,912	DCActual	Bern
4	LCD-3775	Bern	06-06-17	329,912	DCActual	Bern
5	LCD-4226	Bern	06-06-17	355,066	DCActual	Bern
6	LCD-4641	Bern	06-06-17	325,887	DCActual	Bern
7	MOUNTAIN	Bern	06-01-17	10,509	Actual	Bern
8	PLA-2626F	Bern	06-06-17	25,219	DCActual	Bern
9	PLA-3255	Bern	06-06-17	48,556	DCActual	Bern
10	PLA-4248	Bern	06-06-17	52,902	DCActual	Bern
11	RACER	Bern	06-01-17	13,675	Actual	Bern

- Click a cell or column value. For cells with one drill link, the linked resource opens. For cells with two or more drill links, select a menu option.

The screenshot shows a table with multiple drill links in the 'Quantity' column. A context menu is open over the cell containing '95', showing options: 'Dispose Inventory', 'Operations', 'Scheduled Receipts', and 'Forecast Plan'. A callout box says: 'From a cell in this worksheet column, you can select from multiple drill links.'

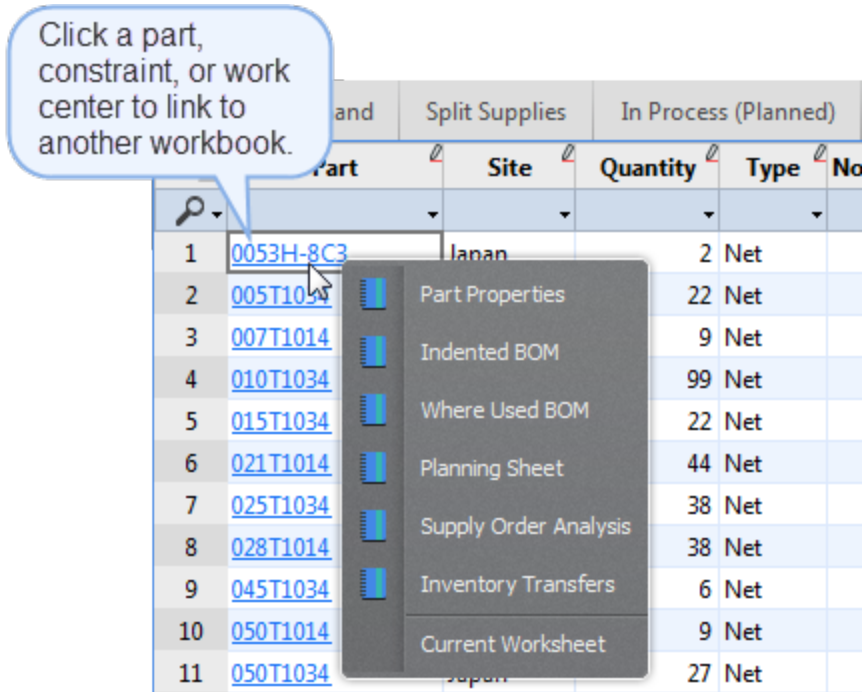
	Part	Site	Due Date	Quantity	Type	Site	Order Number
	Name						
1	AC001	CM3	06-08-15	95	CMDemand	CM3	TCS-003
2	AC001	CM3	06-08-15	150	CMDemand	CM3	PCW-005
3	AC001	CM3	06-08-15	150	CMDemand	CM3	PCW-ACT001
4	AC001	CM3	06-15-15	95	CMDemand	CM3	TCS-003
5	AC001	CM3	06-15-15	150	CMDemand	CM3	PCW-005
6	AC001	CM3	06-22-15	95	CMDemand	CM3	TCS-003
7	AC001	CM3	06-22-15	150	CMDemand	CM3	PCW-005
8	AC001	CM3	06-29-15	95	CMDemand	CM3	TCS-003
9	AC001	CM3	06-29-15	150	CMDemand	CM3	PCW-005
10	AC001	CM3	07-06-15	95	CMDemand	CM3	TCS-003
11	AC001	CM3	07-06-15	150	CMDemand	CM3	PCW-005
12	AC001	CM3	07-13-15	95	CMDemand	CM3	TCS-003

Part, Constraint, and Work Center Links

This type of link opens other workbooks to view additional part, constraint, or work center information.

For example, when you click a part name in a worksheet, you can access the Planning Sheet workbook, where you can view date-bucketed supply and demand information for a part. You can also link to the current worksheet, which filters the worksheet to only display the selected part, constraint, or work center.

- Click a part, constraint, or work center link in a worksheet column, and select a menu option. Part, constraint, and work center links are underlined.
- This can be done when viewing a worksheet in table view and in form view. For more information, see ["Set worksheet viewing options" on page 129](#).



Either the worksheet is filtered or a workbook opens that corresponds to your selection. The selection in the item list is set to the selected part, constraint, or work center. This ensures your worksheet displays data for only the item you are linking from.

If the workbook you are linking from contains multi-scenario columns, you can choose which scenario to view in the workbook you link to, as shown in the following illustration.

Click a part, constraint, or work center to link to another workbook.

Click the scenario to view in the workbook.

3	A3	A3X	MRP	RO	
4	AC-0101	AC-0101X	MRP	RO	,105
5	AC-	Part Properties ▶			Baseline 9,590
6	AC-	Indented BOM ▶			Shipping delay 2,400
7	AC-	Where Used BOM ▶			RO 39,140
8	AC-	Planning Sheet ▶			RO 11,500
9	AC-	Supply Order Analysis ▶			ChrisG 39,140
10	AC-	Inventory Transfers ▶			RM 33,100
11	AC-	Current Worksheet			DK 34,450
12	AC-				JP 34,450
13	AC-				JP 34,450
14	ACCES-02	ACCES-02X	Phantom	RT	0
15	ACCES-02	ACCES-02X	Phantom	RT	0



Notes:

- The workbooks you can link to from the shortcut menus vary depending on the workbooks to which you have access. If you require, but do not have access to a workbook, contact your RapidResponse administrator.
- Your RapidResponse administrator can add links to other workbooks to the link menu.
- Links are available to you only if you have access to more than one filter. If you require additional filters, contact your RapidResponse administrator.



- For drill links on cells with part, constraint, or work center links, drill links display in a secondary list, as shown in the following illustration.

ACCESSORIE	ACCESSORIE	MPSmodel	DD	0	
ACKIT-01	ACKIT-01X	MPS	RT	15,610	15,610
ACI			RT	19,660	19,660
ACI			RT	12,460	12,460
ACI			RT	11,730	11,730
ACI			RT	15,705	15,705
B			RO	0	
B1			RO	0	
BIK		el	JP	0	
BR-			DK	199,592	199,592
BR-				94,611	194,611
BR-				99,608	199,608
BR-				203,262	203,262
BX-01	BX-01X	MRP	JG	15,400	15,400

Cancel data retrieval in a worksheet

Occasionally, it can take longer than expected to display data in a report. This is mainly due to the selections in the workbook controls. If data is not displayed within 20 seconds, the **Retrieving Data** dialog box includes a **Cancel** button that lets you cancel long running queries. After a query (data retrieval) is canceled you can modify the data selection controls.

RapidResponse system administrators can modify the 20 second threshold.

- In the **Retrieving Data** dialog box, click **Cancel**.



Notes:

- In multi-pane workbooks, data retrieval is canceled for all worksheets in which data has not yet been displayed.
- In some cases, the data retrieval process might take several minutes if the data is complex.
- To refresh the data when data retrieval has been canceled, click **Refresh This Worksheet**  on the worksheet toolbar or **Refresh**  on the RapidResponse toolbar. For more information, ["Display most recent data" on page 158](#).
- RapidResponse administrators can also cancel data retrievals.
- For more information about displaying data in a worksheet, see ["Display data in a worksheet" on page 146](#).

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The controls you set for a worksheet (scenario, filter, and so on) might return a set of records that is too large for your needs. For example, a worksheet might display all customer orders and you want to filter the worksheet to show only late orders for a specific part, or only orders from a specific customer.

To reduce the data that displays, you can specify conditions that the data in one or more columns must meet in order to display in the worksheet. After applying a search, the worksheet displays only those records that match the criteria you specified. All other records are hidden from view until you clear the search. The following illustration applies search criteria to display only work orders for the part "Mountain".

Search row shows existing search conditions.

Only records that meet search conditions display.

	Part	Site	Description
1	MOUNTAIN		
2	MOUNTAIN	G	
3	MOUNTAIN	HQ	THE MOUNTAIN BIKE
4	MOUNTAIN	New York	THE MOUNTAIN BIKE
5	MOUNTAIN	Ottawa	THE MOUNTAIN BIKE
6	MOUNTAIN	Taipei	THE MOUNTAIN BIKE



Note: The search capability is sometimes called QBE or Query By Example.

Searching in multi-scenario columns

In workbooks that contain multi-scenario columns, searches applied to comparison scenario columns apply to every comparison scenario. For example, in the following illustration, the Cancel Orders and Increase Orders columns are comparison scenarios, and the search condition was specified for only the Cancel Orders column.

	Due Date	Part	Site	Quantity		
				Approved Actions	Cancel Orders	Increase Orders
					<500	<500
1	05-26-14	ACKIT-01	HQ	350	350	350
2	05-26-14	ACKIT-02	HQ	450	450	450
3	05-26-14	ACKIT-03D	HQ	300	0	0
4	05-26-14	ACKIT-03S	HQ	300	300	300

Searching in worksheets with grouped records

Some worksheets can group similar records together, and provide summarized totals for records with the same grouping criteria, such as orders for the same part or from the same supplier. These worksheets are similar to crosstab worksheets, except the data is presented in a vertical format instead of horizontal. For more information, see ["View data in a crosstab worksheet" on page 162](#). In these worksheets, you cannot search the grouped columns. For example, the following illustration shows a worksheet grouped by the Part, Site, and Due Date columns.

	Part	Site	Due Date	Quantity	Days Late
					
1	ACKIT-01	HQ	06-02-14	2,815	0
2			07-01-14	3,565	0
3			08-01-14	2,857	0
4			09-01-14	3,025	0
5			10-01-14	1,300	0
6			11-03-14	1,000	0

In this example, the Quantity and Days Late columns contain grouped data, and cannot be searched. In addition, the Due Date column summarizes all order dates into weekly increments, so it also contains grouped data and cannot be searched.

Worksheets with column searching disabled

Workbook authors have the option to disable column searching in any worksheet they create. If column searching is disabled, the search row is not displayed in the worksheet.

In the following image, the worksheet on the left has a search row, but the worksheet on the right does not have a search row because column searching is disabled.

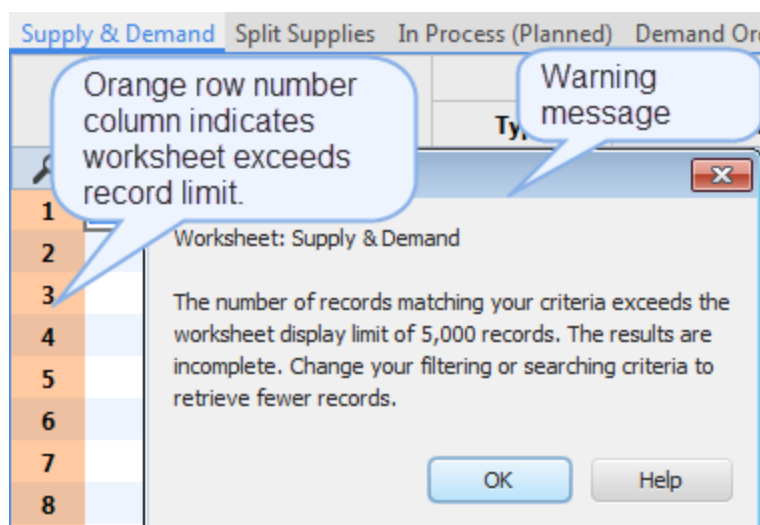
	Part		Due		
	Name	Site	Date	Quantity	Type
1	AC001	CM3	06-09-14	95	CMDemand
2	AC001	CM3	06-09-14	150	CMDemand
3	AC001	CM3	06-09-14	150	CMDemand

	Part		Due		
	Name	Site	Date	Quantity	Type
1	AC001	CM3	06-09-14	95	CMDemand
2	AC001	CM3	06-09-14	150	CMDemand
3	AC001	CM3	06-09-14	150	CMDemand
4	AC001	CM3	06-16-14	95	CMDemand

What if the worksheet record limit is exceeded?

Your RapidResponse administrator sets separate worksheet record limits for vertical (also known as tabular) and crosstab worksheets. These limits determine the maximum number of records that worksheets can display. For information about exceeding the record limit of a crosstab worksheet, see ["When the crosstab worksheet record limit is exceeded" on page 168](#). The following discussion applies to vertical worksheets.

You can use searching to reduce the number of worksheet records when the row number column of the worksheet becomes orange and you receive a warning message that indicates the worksheet record limit is exceeded, as shown in the following illustration.



When a worksheet exceeds the record limit, it displays only an incomplete, random subset of all possible records. As well, any worksheet processing such as grouping or difference calculations in multi-scenario columns will not complete. For multi-scenario columns, when the first scenario exceeds the record limit, no records are retrieved from the other scenarios, leading to incorrect results in those columns. All data displayed in the worksheet should not be considered correct if the worksheet record limit is exceeded.

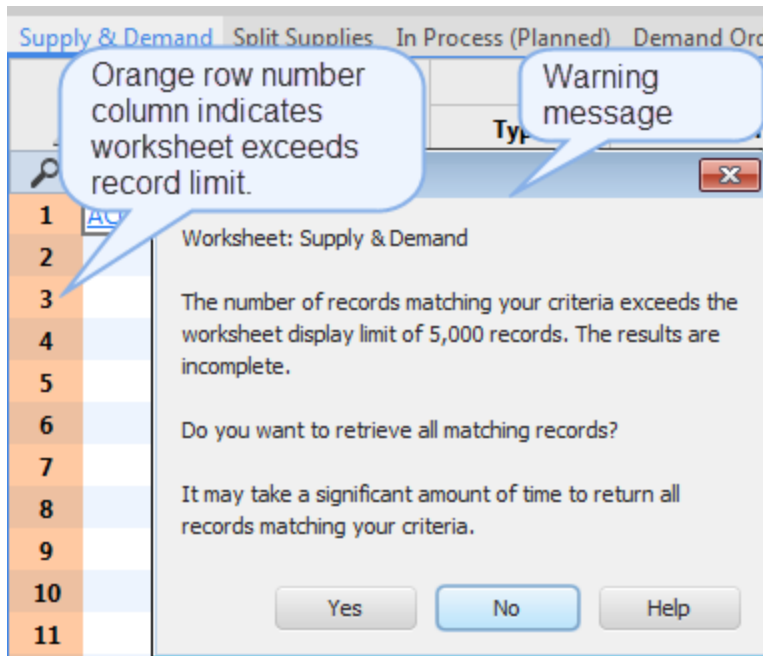
The data displayed in a worksheet with the worksheet record limit exceeded should not be used as part of your decision making process. The results are returned to give a hint of how you can enhance the search to produce fewer records.

Your RapidResponse administrator might have granted you permission to override the worksheet record limit and retrieve all records in the worksheet. However, doing so might cause performance issues and should only be done when necessary (for example, if you need to export a worksheet or edit a large number of records). Overriding the worksheet record limit might also be necessary if you are editing data in a crosstab worksheet, as overriding the record limit ensures that each bucket includes all of its

summarized records. The warning message that allows you to override the worksheet record limit is shown in the following illustration.



Note: Worksheet data cannot be printed or exported when the worksheet record limit has been exceeded.



Applying a search helps to reduce the record count to a number within the worksheet record limit. For more information, see ["Search for specific data" on page 190](#).



Note: The worksheet record limit applies only to the final output of the worksheet. Any records that are required to generate the final output, such as records in multi-scenario columns or grouped records, are not limited by the worksheet record limit.

Search for specific data

For each column you want to search, you typically must specify a value to search for and an operator. The value you specify should be of the same data type as the column you are searching (for example, a date, quantity, text string, and so on). The operators you can use vary depending on a column's data type and they determine how the value you enter is interpreted by the search. For example, a quantity column (such as, Revenue) can be searched for values equal or not equal to, greater than, less than, or between quantities that you specify.

When searching a column containing text strings (for example, Part Name), you can search for an exact string or you can include wildcards to look for patterns of text. There are two wildcards available to you; a ? which represents a single character, and a * which represents any number of characters including none. For example, searching for wheel? finds all occurrences of the word "wheel" followed by any single

character (such as, wheels). Similarly, searching for wheel* finds all occurrences of the word “wheel” followed by any number of characters (such as, wheel, wheels, wheel covers, and so on).

Regardless of the data type in the column you search, all the operators compatible with that data type are available in a list in the Search dialog box. You can use this dialog box to create most of your search conditions. However, in certain situations, and as you become familiar with the search syntax, you can type your search conditions directly into the search row.

Caution: When searching columns containing quantity values, avoid using a comma (,) as a thousands separator. This will produce undesirable results because the comma is interpreted as an OR operator. For example, 1,500 would be interpreted as 1 or 500. If you want to represent fifteen hundred, type 1500.

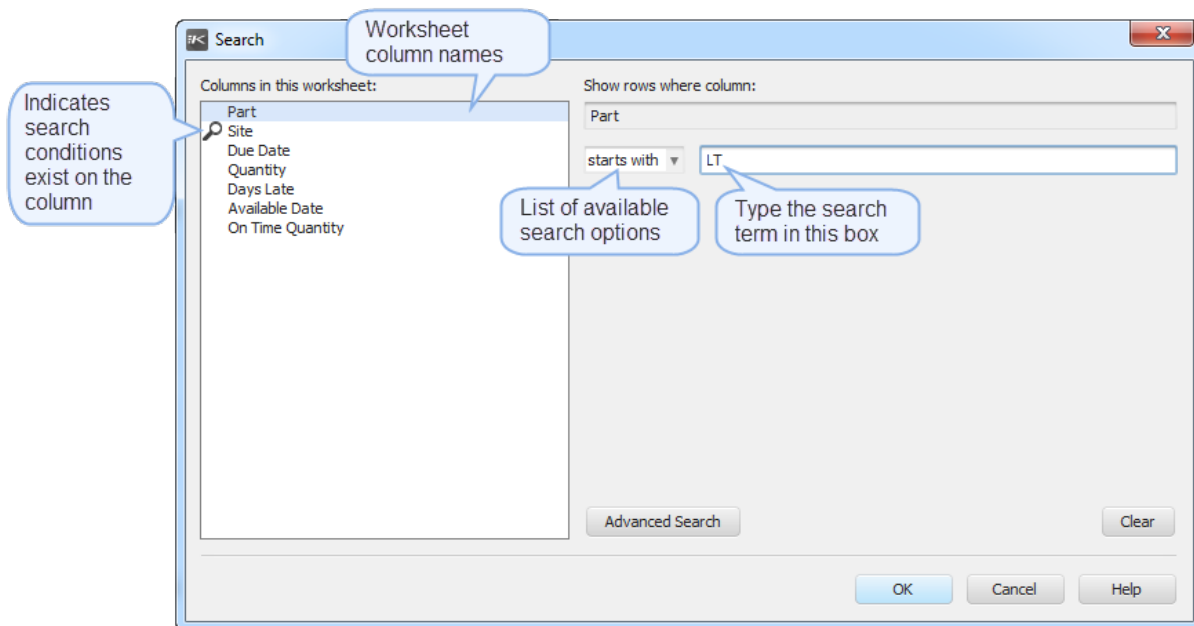


Notes:

- When searching for a date, use the date format that is displayed in the column.
- When searching columns that use scaled numbers, search based on the scaled values, not the actual values. For more information, see ["Understanding how numeric values are displayed" on page 153](#).

Illustration of Search dialog box

The Search dialog box is shown in the following illustration.





Note: Unless you edit or clear them, the search conditions you create remain until you close the worksheet. If you want to save your search conditions with the worksheet, you can create a shortcut to the worksheet. For more information, see ["Create a shortcut to display workbook data" on page 104](#).

► Create a search condition

1. Do one of the following:
 - On the **Data** menu, point to **Search**, and then click **New Search**.
 - Click **Search Worksheet Data**  on the toolbar, and then click **New Search** .
 2. In the **Columns in this worksheet** list, click the name of the column you want to search.
 3. Select an operator from the list available with the column's data type.

The list of operators varies depending on the data type. For complete descriptions of the operators available for a given data type, see ["Data types" on page 194](#).
 4. Type the term or condition you want to search for in the text box.

If you selected the **Is between** operator in step 3, you must specify the minimum and maximum values for the search

If the column you selected contains a list of values, select the values you want to search for in the **Select from this list** list, and then click **Add**.
 5. Repeat steps 2 to 4 for each additional column you want to search.
 6. Click **OK**.
- The results displayed are those that meet the conditions specified in all columns. The columns to which a search has been applied contain the search condition in the search row.



Notes:

- The **Basic Search** functionality of the **Search** dialog box allows you to search for one term or condition per column. To search for multiple terms or conditions in a column (for example, two or more part names), click **Advanced Search** and then type the search conditions. Separate each condition with a comma. For more information, see ["Data types" on page 194](#).
- For columns that display check boxes, you can search for all rows that are selected or all rows that are cleared instead of specifying search operators.



Tips:

- You can copy and paste a value from any worksheet cell into the search. To copy a value, select a worksheet cell and press **CTRL+C**. To paste the value into the **Search** dialog box, place the insertion point in the text box and press **CTRL+V**.
- If you are searching a date column, click the down arrow at the right of the text box to access a pop-up calendar for easy date selection.

► Create a search condition directly in the Search row

1. Click in the Search row cell above a column you want to search.
2. Type the full syntax for the search condition you want to create.
3. To search for multiple conditions in the column, separate each with a comma (for example, **ac-04, ac-05**).

4. Repeat steps 1 and 2 for any other column you want to add search conditions for.
5. Click **OK**.

**Notes:**

- For information on the proper syntax required to create search conditions, see ["Data types" on page 194](#).
- You can click **Cancel** to remove search conditions and restore the worksheet to its previous state.
- For columns that display check boxes, search for the text string '**Y**' to find selected check boxes and '**N**' to find cleared check boxes.

► Edit a search condition

1. On the **Data** menu, click **Edit Search**.
2. Make any changes you want to your search conditions.

**Tips:**

- You can also access the **Search** dialog box by clicking the down arrow at the right of any search row cell, or by clicking **Search Worksheet Data**  on the RapidResponse toolbar and then clicking **Modify Search**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.
- You can modify search conditions by typing directly in the Search cell.

Clear a data search

If you have limited the records shown in a worksheet by searching for specific data in one or more columns, you can clear all of the search conditions that you have specified. After you clear the data search, all records that match the selected data settings are shown, as long as the worksheet record limit is not exceeded.

► Clear a data search

- On the **Data** menu, click **Search**  and then click **Clear Search** .

**Tips:**

- You can also clear a search by clicking **Search Worksheet Data**  on the RapidResponse toolbar, and then clicking **Clear Search** , or by clicking **Search**  at the top left corner of the worksheet, and then clicking **Clear Search** .
- If you have specified search conditions for more than one column, and you do not want to clear all of them, you can modify your search to remove one or more of the search conditions. For more information, see ["Search for specific data" on page 190](#).

Data types

The following table describes the basic data types you can search in the columns of your worksheets, and lists the operators and wildcards you can use with each. For information on what the specific operators do, and examples detailing their use, see ["Operators and wildcards" on page 195](#). For information about searching, see ["Search for specific data" on page 190](#)

Data type	Description	Operators & Wildcards
String	You can search columns containing text by entering a string (containing any combination of text, numbers, or symbols) and, optionally, any of the operators and wildcards shown to the right. If you do not enter an operator with your search, the search uses the LIKE operator. Note: To search for the * or ? characters, which are typically used as wildcards, precede your search with the = operator. Note: To search for the comma character, which is otherwise interpreted as the or operator, within a string, the entire string should be enclosed in single quotes (for example, 'AX,5R'. This can only be done within the Advanced Search dialog.	* (any number of characters) ? (any single character) ! (not) , (or) Like = (equal to) < (less than) > (greater than)
Boolean	You can search columns containing 'yes' or 'no' values by entering the value, represented as 'Y' or 'N'. If the column displays check boxes, you can find all selected or all cleared check boxes.	
Quantity, Integer, and Money	You can search columns containing numbers (quantity, integer, or money), such as units or dollar values, by entering a numeric value and, optionally, any of the operators shown to the right. If you search a column that contains scaled numbers or Money values, the search is performed using the numbers displayed in the column. If you do not enter an operator with your search, the search uses the = operator. If you are using the range operator, ensure you specify two numeric values to set the range (for example, 100..250) Do not use a comma as a thousands separator. The comma is used as an OR operator to separate multiple terms in a single search. For example, 1, 500 would be interpreted as 1 or 500; if you wanted to indicate fifteen hundred, you would enter 1500. Do not include the currency symbol in Money columns.	= (equal to) <> (not equal to) > (greater than) >= (greater than or equal to) < (less than) <= (less than or equal to) .. (range) , (or)

Data type	Description	Operators & Wildcards
Date	You can search columns containing dates by entering a date and, optionally, any of the operators shown to the right. Ensure that you enter dates in a valid date format (for example, 11-17-04, or 05-20-2005). It is recommended that you use the date format displayed in the column. If you use the RANGE operator, ensure that you specify two values to set the range (for example, 07-01-05..07-31-05) If you do not enter an operator with your search, the search uses the = operator. You can also search for any of the following date constants: • Past—A date earlier than any calendar definition. • Future—A date later than any calendar definition. • Today—The current date. This value is determined by converting the current date and time from RapidResponse Server to your local time zone. • Undefined—Any date value that has not been defined. If you do not get any results, try a DateTime search.	= (equal to) <> (not equal to) > (greater than) >= (greater than or equal to) < (less than) <= (less than or equal to) .. (range) , (or)
Time	You can search columns containing time by entering a time value and, optionally, any of the operators shown to the right. Ensure that you enter times in a valid time format (for example, 2:35, or 14:35). If you are searching for a time using the = operator, you must specify the time up to the second (for example, 14:35:12). If you do not specify the seconds, the search uses :00. If the seconds do not match, no records are returned. If you do not know the exact second, use the > or < operators (for example, >14:35 or <14:36 to search for 2:35 PM).	Same as Date.
DateTime	You can search columns containing a combination of date and time by entering a date value followed by a time value, and, optionally, any of the operators shown to the right. Ensure that you enter DateTimes in valid date and time formats (for example, 05-20-2005 14:35:12). If you do not specify the seconds, the search uses :00. If you do not enter an operator with your search, the search uses the = operator. If the seconds do not match, no records are returned. If you do not know the exact second, use the > or < operators. If your region participates in Daylight Saving Time (DST), DateTime values returned by the search might be affected the time change on the dates DST begins and ends. When DST begins, no records exist for the 2:00 AM to 3:00 AM range, because no times exist in this range. When DST ends, you might have multiple records in the 1:00 AM to 2:00 AM range, and you might not be able to determine the order of records returned by the search.	See Date and Time.

Operators and wildcards

The following tables describe the operators and wildcards you can include in your searches, and provide examples of each.

Operator	Description	Examples
=	Use the EQUAL TO operator to find exact date or quantity values. You can also use the EQUAL TO operator if you want to search for the characters * and ? instead of having them interpreted as wildcards.	Searching =05-20-05 on an order received date column finds all orders with a promise date of May 20, 2005. Searching =AC-*1 on a part number column find all occurrences of the part number AC-*1.
<>	Use the NOT EQUAL TO operator to search for dates or quantities other than one that you specify.	Searching <>06-30-05 on an order promise date column finds all orders other than those with a promise date of June 30, 2005.
<	Use the LESS THAN operator to search for quantities less than one you specify, dates occurring before one you specify, or times without specifying the time up to the second.	Searching <07-15-05 on an order shipment date column finds all orders with a shipment date before July 15, 2005.
<=	Use the LESS THAN OR EQUAL TO operator to search for quantities less than or equal to one you specify, or to search for dates or times occurring on or before one you specify.	Searching <=10000 on an order unit price column finds all orders with a value of less than or equal to \$10,000.
>	Use the GREATER THAN operator to search for quantities greater than one you specify, to search for dates occurring after one you specify, or to search for times without specifying the time up to the second.	Searching >10000 on an order unit price column finds all orders with a value greater than \$10,000. Searching >14:35 on a time column finds all times later than 2:35:00 PM.
>=	Use the GREATER THAN OR EQUAL TO operator to search for quantities greater than or equal to one you specify, or to search for dates or times occurring on or after one you specify.	Searching >=08-01-05 on an order shipment date column finds all orders with a shipment date on or after August 1, 2005.
LIKE	Use the LIKE operator to search text strings in a column against a pattern of characters and wildcards. If you do not specify an operator when searching text, the LIKE operator is automatically applied.	Searching Like AC-1? on a part number column finds all part numbers that begin with AC-1 and end with any single character (for example, AC-13, AC-1B, and so on). Searching Like AC-11 on a part number column finds only the part number AC-11.
!	Use the NOT operator to find text or patterns of text that do not match that which you enter.	Searching !Rochester on a part site column finds records for all sites other than Rochester.
..	Use the RANGE operator to search for quantities on or between two values that you specify, or you can search for date values on or between two values that you specify.	Searching 1000..15000 on an order amount column finds only those orders with a value of at least \$1,000 but no more than \$15,000.
,	Use the OR operator to search for multiple conditions in a column. When using the OR operator, the search will find records that match any of the conditions you specify.	Searching Rochester, Buffalo, Albany on a part site column finds all records pertaining to either the Rochester, Buffalo, or Albany sites. Searching !Rochester, Buffalo on a part site column finds all records other than those pertaining to the Rochester or Buffalo sites. Searching 01-01-04..03-31-04, 01-01-05..03-31-05 on an order received date column finds all orders received in either the first quarter of 2004 or the first quarter of 2005.

Wildcard	Description	Examples
?	Use the ? wildcard to represent any single character when searching for a text string pattern.	Searching AC-1? on a part number column finds all part numbers that begin with AC-1 and end with any single character (for example, AC-1E). Searching ??-yy on a part number column finds all part numbers that begin with any two characters and end with -yy (for example, A1-yy).
*	Use the * wildcard to represent any number of characters, including none, when searching for a text pattern.	Searching wheel* on a part name column finds records pertaining to parts whose names begin with the word wheel and end with any number of characters (for example, wheel, wheels, wheel cover). Searching *wheel* on a part name column finds records pertaining to parts whose name contains the word wheel (for example, steering wheel, wheel, wheel cover).

Non-standard data types

The following table describes how to search non-standard data types that might display in some worksheet columns.

Column contains	Description
Check box	Boolean columns can be formatted as check boxes and might have a check box in the column header to check or uncheck all of the Boolean values. For information about searching in these columns, see "Search for specific data" on page 190 . If you have access to legacy workbooks created by Kinaxis, Integer columns might be formatted as check boxes. If you have access to these workbooks, you can search columns containing check boxes to find either those records which are selected or those records which are cleared. To search a check box column, enter one of the following: 0 —finds all records that are cleared. 1 —finds all records that are selected.
Urgency marker(!)	You can search Urgency columns to find either those records which are marked as urgent(!) or those records which are not marked as urgent (blank). To search an urgency column, enter one of the following: =! —finds all records that are marked as urgent. !! —finds all records that are not marked as urgent.

Examples of search syntax

The following table provides examples of search syntax to use when searching for specific conditions in a given column. Also note that if you apply search conditions to more than one column, your search only returns records that meet the conditions specified in all columns.

To find	Type
The part name wheel	wheel
Part names that begin with the word wheel	wheel*

To find	Type
Part names that contain the word wheel	*wheel*
Part numbers that begin with AC- and end with any single character	AC-?
Part numbers that begin with any two characters and end with -A	??-A
All part sites other than the Chicago site	!Chicago
Any of the sites Chicago, Taipei, or Melbourne	Chicago, Taipei, Melbourne
All part sites other than Buffalo or Rochester	!Rochester, Buffalo
Orders received on April 2, 2018	04-02-18
Supply orders confirmed on April 2, 2018 at 3:30 PM	04-02-18 15:30
Supply orders confirmed on April 2, 2018 between 3:35 and 4:35 PM.	04-02-18 15:35..04-02-18 16:35
Orders due between July 1, 2018 and July 31, 2018	07-01-18..07-31-18
Orders due between July 1, 2018 and July 31, 2018 or between Sept 1, 2018 and Sept 30, 2018	07-01-18..07-31-18, 09-01-18..09-30-18
Orders with a due date of today or later	>= today
Orders due within 5 calendar days of the today or earlier	<= today + 5
Orders due within 5 working days of today or earlier	<= today + 5 Workday
Orders for more than 15000 units	>15000
Orders with a dollar value between \$10,000 and \$50,000	10000..50000
Orders with a dollar value between \$10,000 and \$50,000 or between \$100,000 and \$200,000	10000..50000, 100000..200000

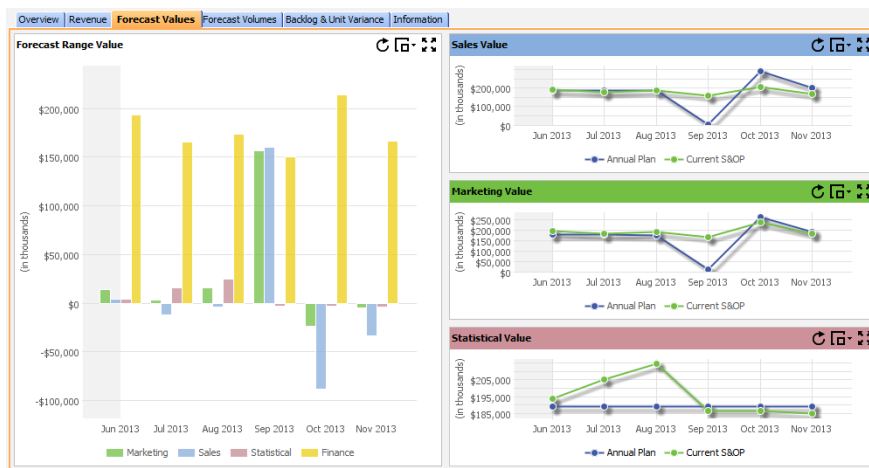
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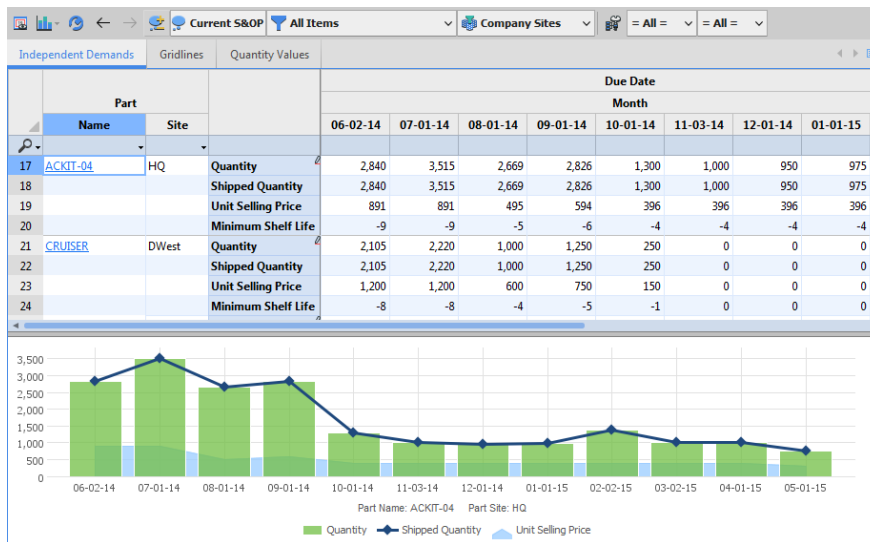
RapidResponse can display data in a variety of charts in dashboards, workbooks, and scorecards. Charts provide you with a quick and compact view of data to help you identify trends, patterns, and exceptions in data.

Information about what specific data displays in the chart can be found in chart titles, legends, axes, or in worksheet or widget help. For more information, see ["Help embedded in resources" on page 68](#).

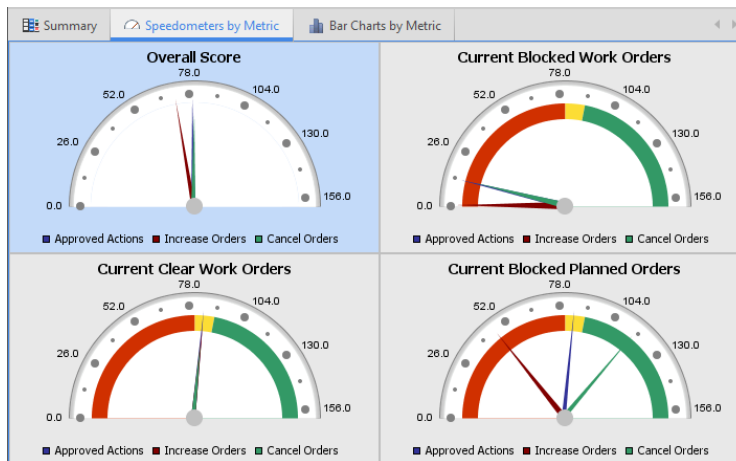
- **Dashboards**—For information, see ["Viewing charts in dashboards" on page 209](#).



- **Workbooks**—For more information, see ["Viewing charts in workbooks" on page 210](#).



- **Scorecards**—Scorecards summarize data in a special type of chart called a speedometer. Speedometer charts are not discussed in this section. For more information, see ["Viewing scorecard data " on page 279](#).



Depending on how a chart has been authored, you might be able to change some of its appearance. For example, you might have control over what data series display in the chart or what colors represent each data series. For more information, see ["Change what data displays in a chart" on page 216](#) and ["Change the colors in a chart" on page 222](#).

To learn more about the types of charts you might see in RapidResponse, see [Types of charts](#).

Types of charts

You might see any of the following types of charts in a dashboard or workbook:

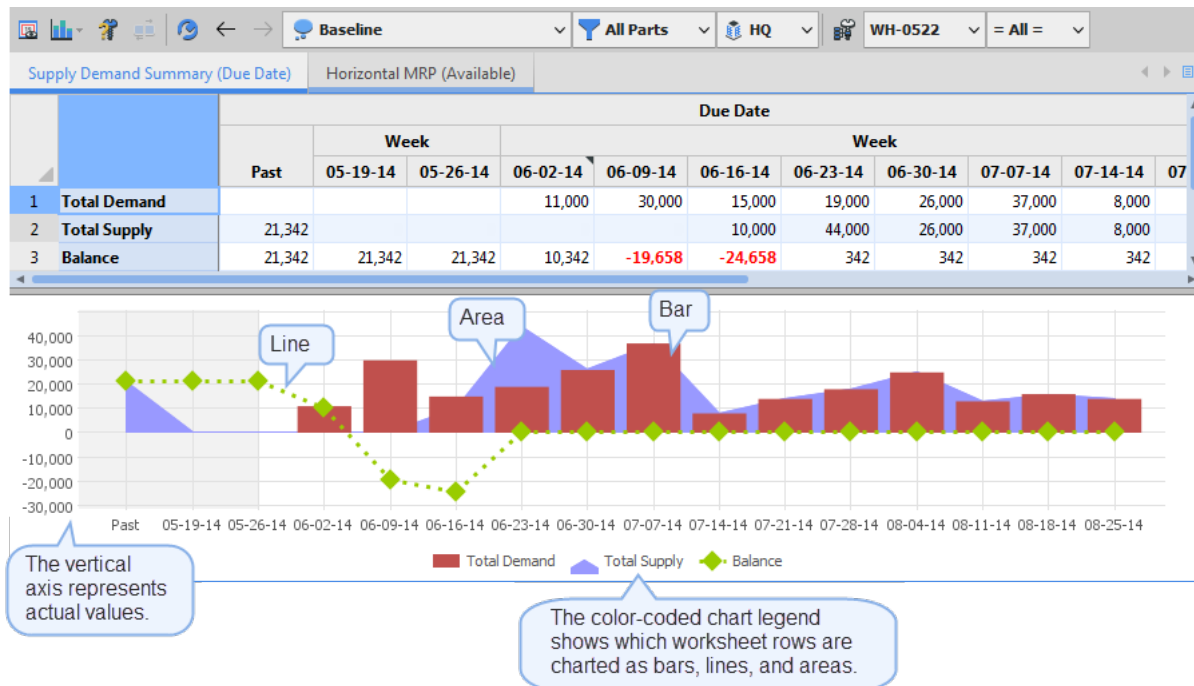
- ["Bar, line, and area charts" on page 201](#)
- ["Pie charts" on page 206](#)
- ["Gauge charts" on page 205](#)

- "Scatter charts" on page 206
- "Gantt charts" on page 204
- "Bullet charts" on page 202
- "Calendar charts" on page 203
- "Tornado charts" on page 207
- "Treemap charts" on page 207
- "Waterfall charts" on page 208
- BOM charts (see "Visualizing the bill of material" on page 225)

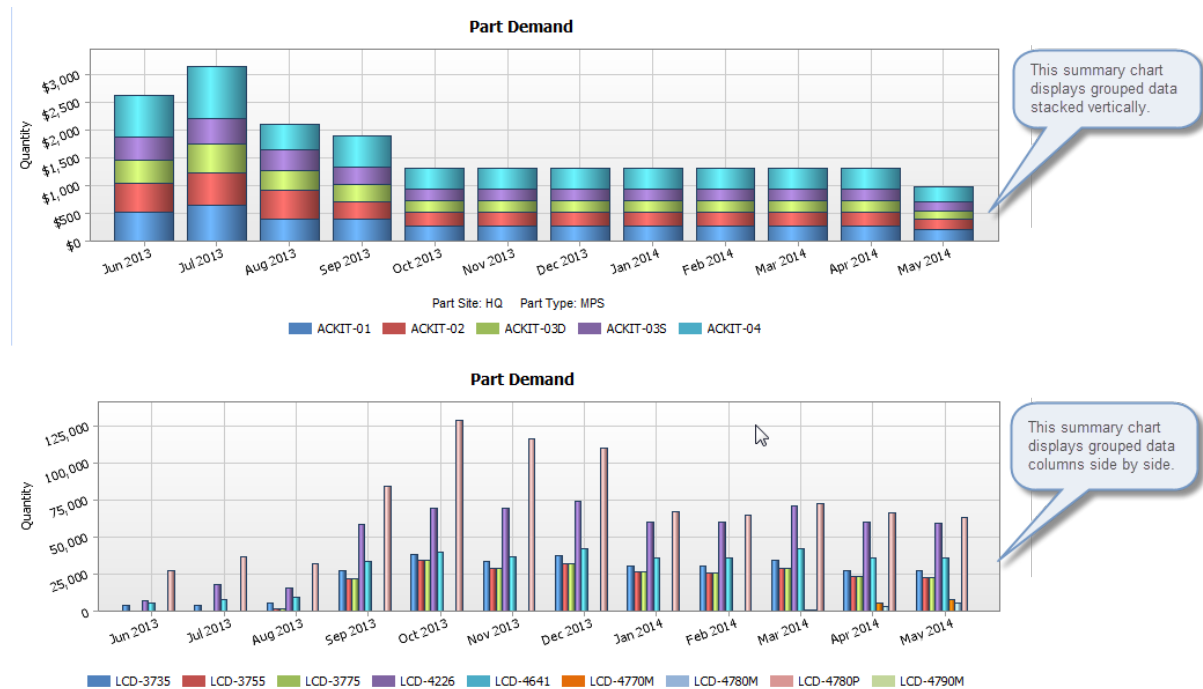
Bar, line, and area charts

Bar, line, and area charts provide a visual representation of data changes, typically over time. Bar, line, and area charts can include any combination of bars, lines, and areas.

In the following example of a combination chart, the changes in Total Demand, Total Supply, and Balance for one part and site are shown across a range of due dates. The bucketed due dates make up the chart's horizontal axis.

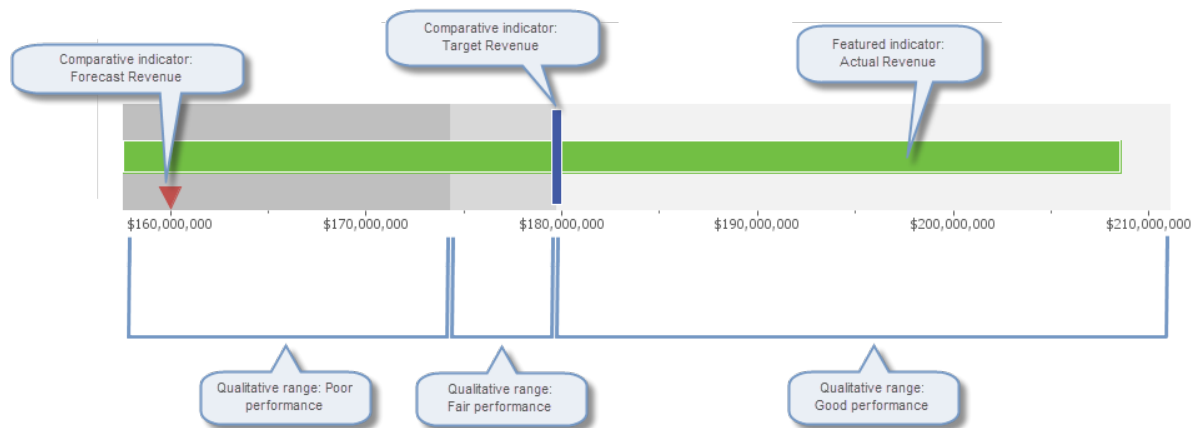


You can summarize bar, line, or area charts and then display them as grouped data columns or points. For bar and area charts, you can display summarized data as stacked data series.



Bullet charts

Bullet charts are linear data displays that compare measures against a featured measure on a background of target ranges. For example, a bullet graph can display actual revenue (featured indicator) against forecast revenue and target revenue (comparative indicators) along a scale of performance: poor, fair, and good (qualitative ranges).

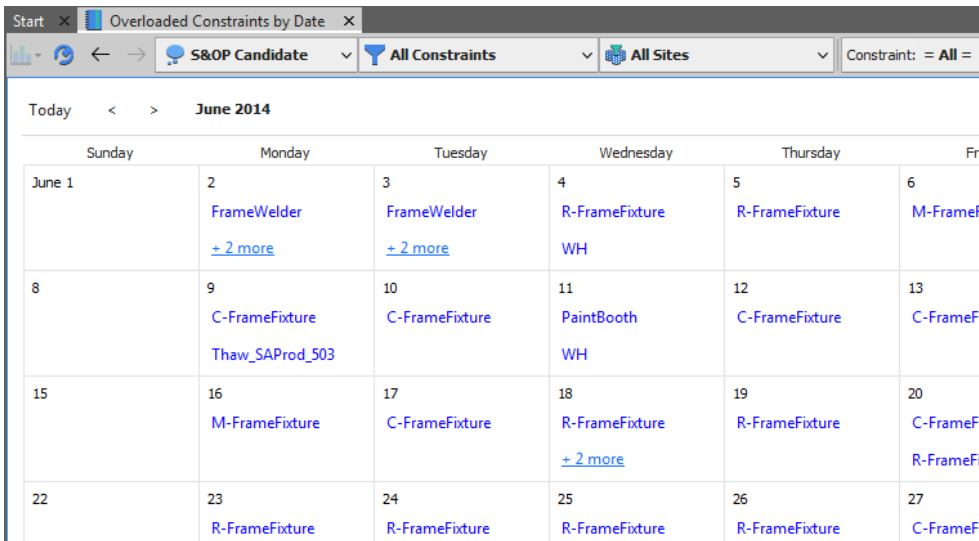


You might see bullet charts displayed horizontally or vertically in a workbook or on a dashboard. The following images show bullet charts that display ending inventory comparisons.



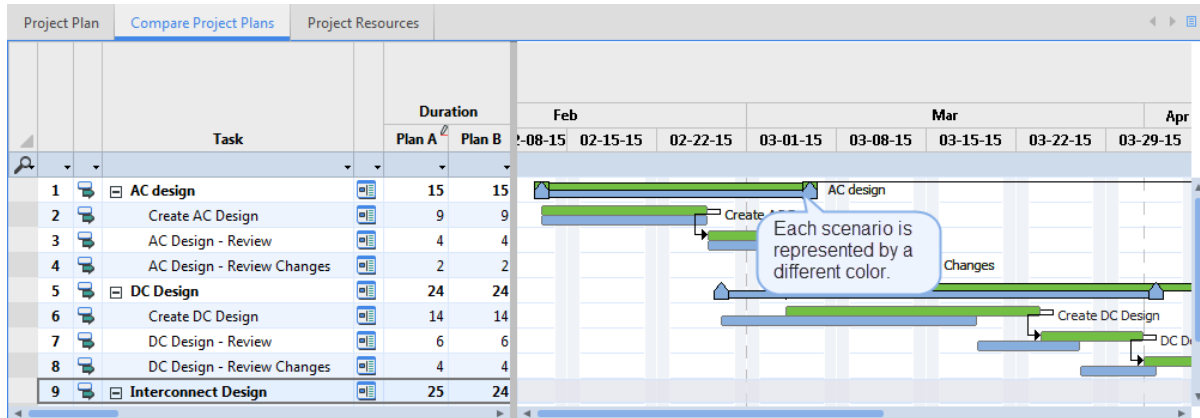
Calendar charts

Calendar charts present information in a calendar view, in a monthly, weekly, or daily format. They are particularly useful for process orchestration, allowing process participants to see the activities within a process that they are responsible for. They can also be used to display other information, such as constraints on the date that they become overloaded, as shown in the following image.



Gantt charts

Gantt charts show date ranges. For example, they can be used to track the progress of a project and its associated tasks over time. In RapidResponse, Gantt charts can display up to two scenarios for a project, allowing you to compare the impact of each scenario on tasks, resources, and timelines. The resource author determines if the corresponding worksheet is displayed with the Gantt chart, the scenarios, and whether dependency relationships are displayed. The following example shows a multi-scenario Gantt chart with the worksheet it is based on.

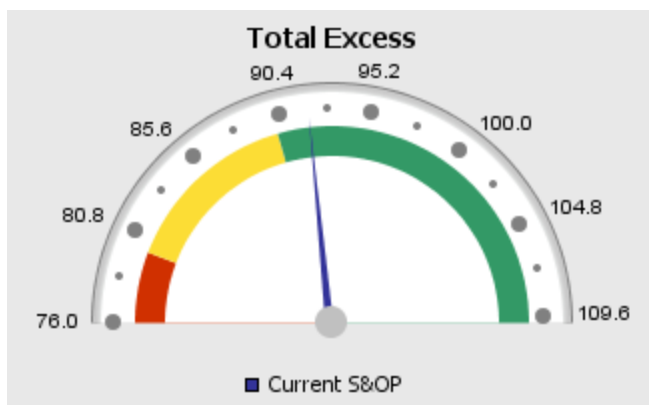


If you can edit data in the worksheet, you might be able to change a date range by dragging the ends of the corresponding bar in the Gantt chart. If you have this option, the mouse cursor changes to  when placed near the end of a bar.

Gauge charts

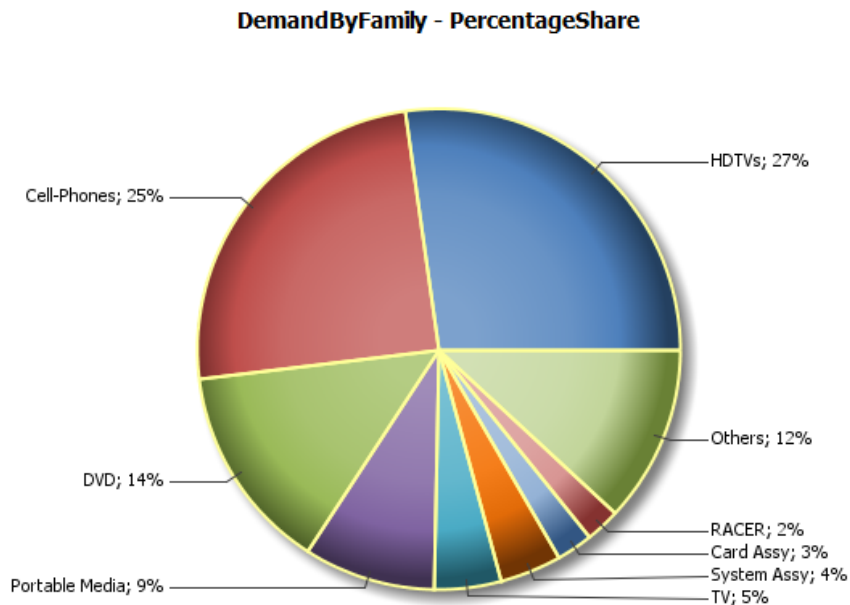
Gauge charts display the performance of selected data series measured against a specific target. Gauge charts are most often included in dashboards, but can also be included in workbooks. Displayed as a circle, semi-circle, or arch, a gauge chart includes the following elements:

- **Needles**—Each needle on a gauge chart represents one data series or a unique scenario of a data series. A gauge chart can include one or more needles.
- **Target color ranges**—The target color ranges, displayed as color blocks surrounding the gauge chart, typically represent acceptable, warning, and critical ranges for the specific target.
- **Scale values**—The actual data or percentage of the target is displayed as a numerical value in a scale around the chart.



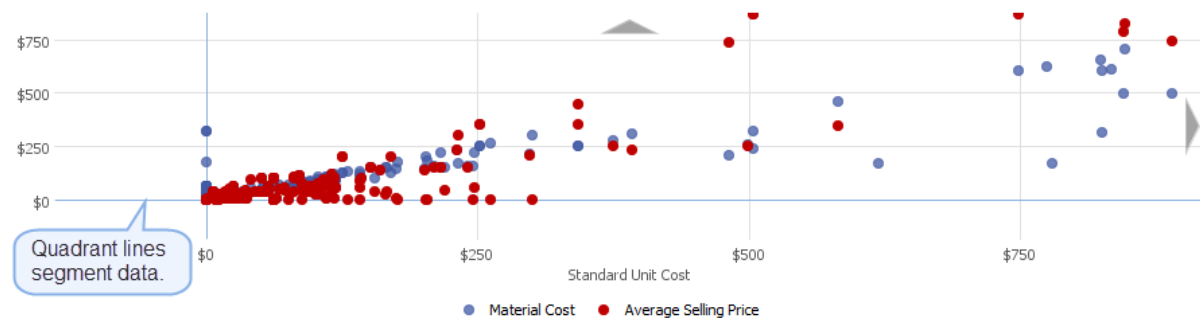
Pie charts

Pie charts provide a visual comparison of data. Data values might be displayed as percentages or total quantities. The resource author determines how many pie segments are displayed, and whether data value labels are displayed on the chart, as shown in the example below, or as tooltips when you hover the pointer over a pie segment. For more information about tooltips on charts, see ["Change how a chart displays data "](#) on page 219.



Scatter charts

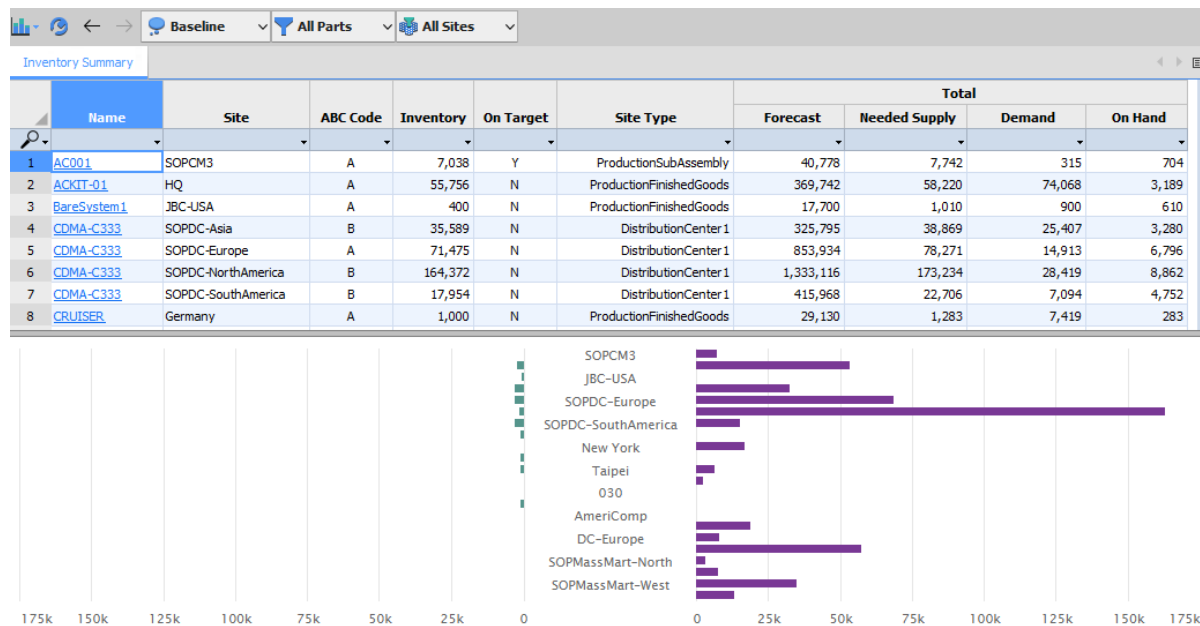
Scatter charts plot data as dots on a grid whose concentration provides a quick view of data trends that can be used for planning and forecasting. Quadrant lines might be included to further segment data for easier chart reading. The resource author determines whether tooltips are used in the chart, and whether quadrant lines are included. Scatter charts can be located in workbooks and in dashboards.



Tornado charts

Tornado charts display data in vertical bars to the right and left of the X-axis. Use them to compare data sets on the same scale or to identify specific trends. You can look at similar data sets or two different ones to identify the differences between them.

For example, in the image below, inventory levels are grouped by site and depending on how much the total inventory value falls below or above target, the bars display on the left(below target) or right(above target) axes of the chart.



Treemap charts

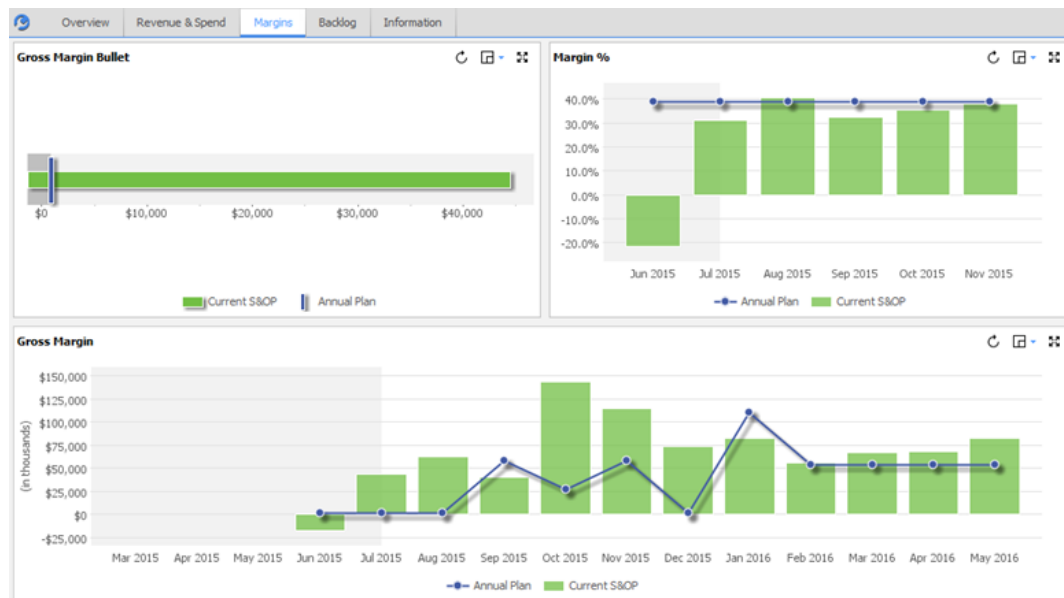
Treemap charts display large data sets grouped into category and subcategory boxes. Use a treemap chart to find patterns and outliers in your data.

Each category of data is represented by container rectangles which are further divided into nested rectangles to represent subcategories of data. For example, in the treemap chart below, customers are represented by container rectangles and each site for a customer is represented by the nested rectangles.



Viewing charts in dashboards

Charts in dashboards display in components called widgets. Typically, multiple widgets display on each dashboard tab and most widgets display data as a chart.

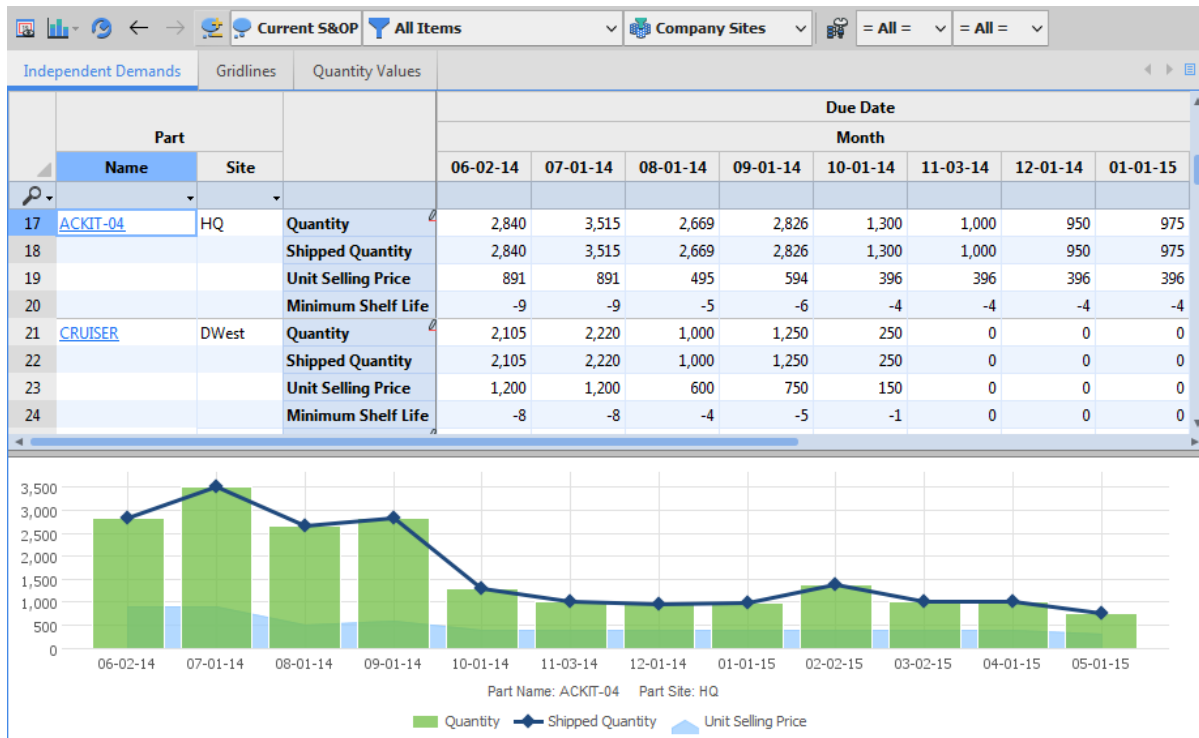


You can view more details in a chart widget by zooming in to widget, hovering over chart elements, or clicking a data series to see more detailed data. For more information, see ["Magnify a widget" on page 254](#), ["Viewing details in a chart" on page 210](#), and ["Drill from a chart" on page 211](#).

For more information about dashboards and widgets, see ["Viewing data in dashboards" on page 249](#) and ["About widgets" on page 251](#).

Viewing charts in workbooks

In workbooks, charts display in worksheet tabs either on the same tab with a related worksheet or on its own worksheet tab.

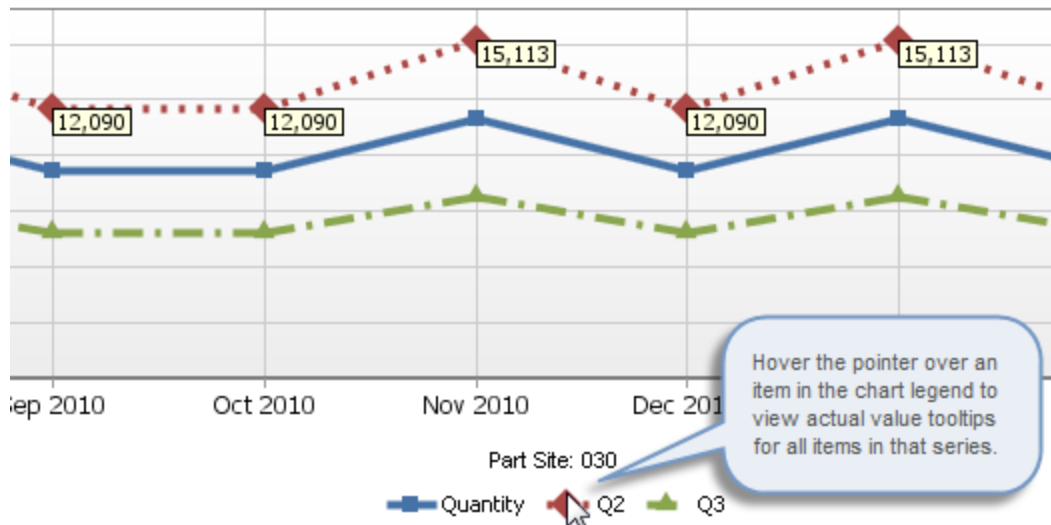
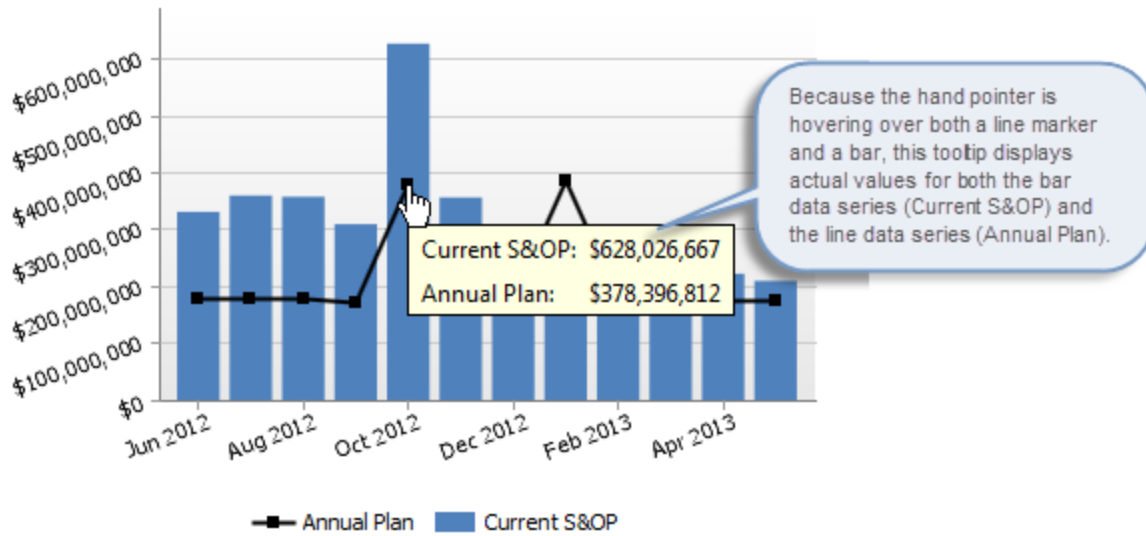


When you view data in a worksheet, you can see more details by hovering over chart elements or click a data series to see more detailed data. For more information, see ["Viewing details in a chart" on page 210](#) and ["Drill from a chart" on page 211](#).

Depending on how the chart was designed, you might be able to change what data you see in the chart and how it displays. For more information, see ["Change what data displays in a chart" on page 216](#), ["Change the colors in a chart" on page 222](#), and ["Change how a chart displays data" on page 219](#).

Viewing details in a chart

To see details for specific data points in a chart, hover over the data point or an item in the chart legend. A tooltip displays information specific to that data point. When data series overlap in a chart, the tooltip displays multiple values.



► View the exact value of a bar, data point, area, gauge needle, or pie segment

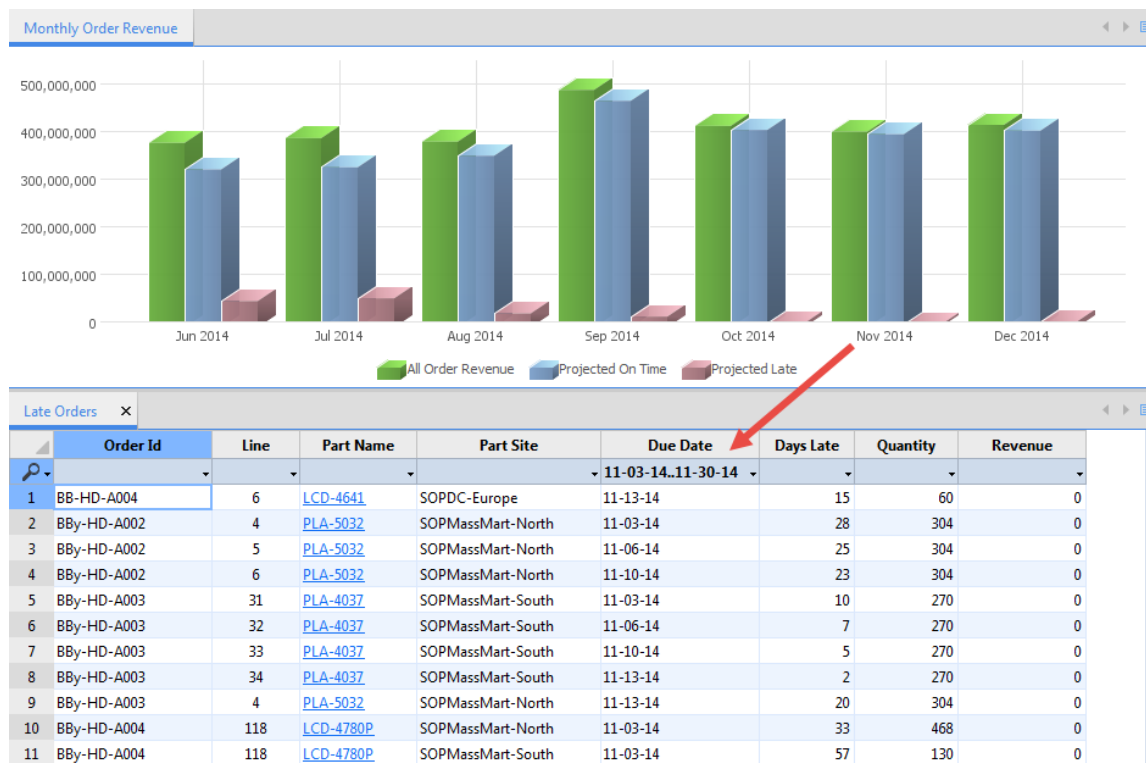
- Hover the pointer over the bar, line marker, area, gauge needle, or pie segment, or over an item in the chart legend.

Drill from a chart

Some charts are linked to more detailed resources. In those charts, clicking a data series in the chart drills you to one of the following:

- A worksheet that displays detailed information specific to the data you drilled from. The details worksheet might open in the same worksheet tab as the chart, a new worksheet tab, or in a

separate workbook.



- A form with controls populated with values from the data you drilled from.

All Orders

Customer	Order ID	Site	Type
1 AMC	AMC-BrightStar	Sunnyvale	Actual
2 bci	BCI-ACT100	030	Actual
3 Berlin	C234563	Germany	Actual
4 BetterBuy	BB-HD-A001	DC-Europe	DCActual
5 BIKEM	C00201	HQ	Actual
6 BoT	CC2001	Taipei	Actual
7 BW	C17627	Germany	Actual
8 C101	S1010	R1001	Actual
9 C102	S1020	R1001	Actual
10 C103	S1030	R1001	Actual
11 C111	DRP C111	R1001	Actual

New Order

Scenario *
Order Management

Order
Site *
Germany

New Order ID *

Type *
Actual

Customer Site
Germany

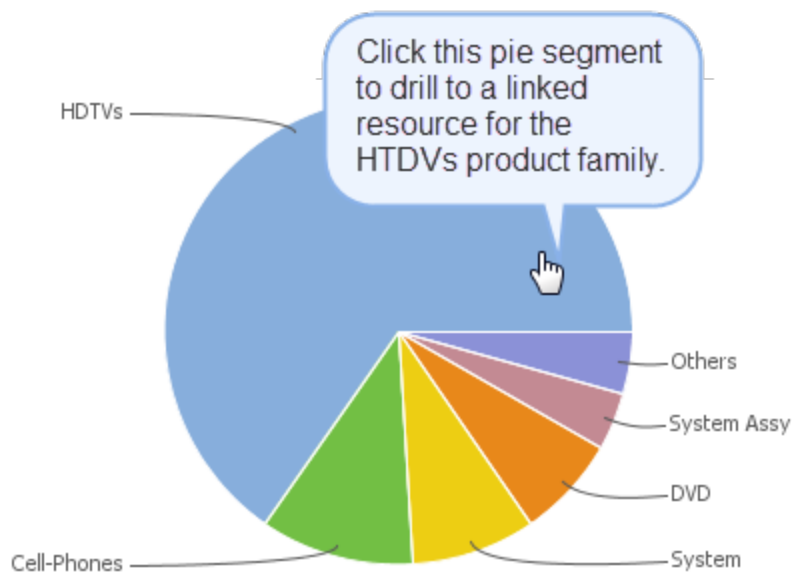
Customer *
BW

Order Line

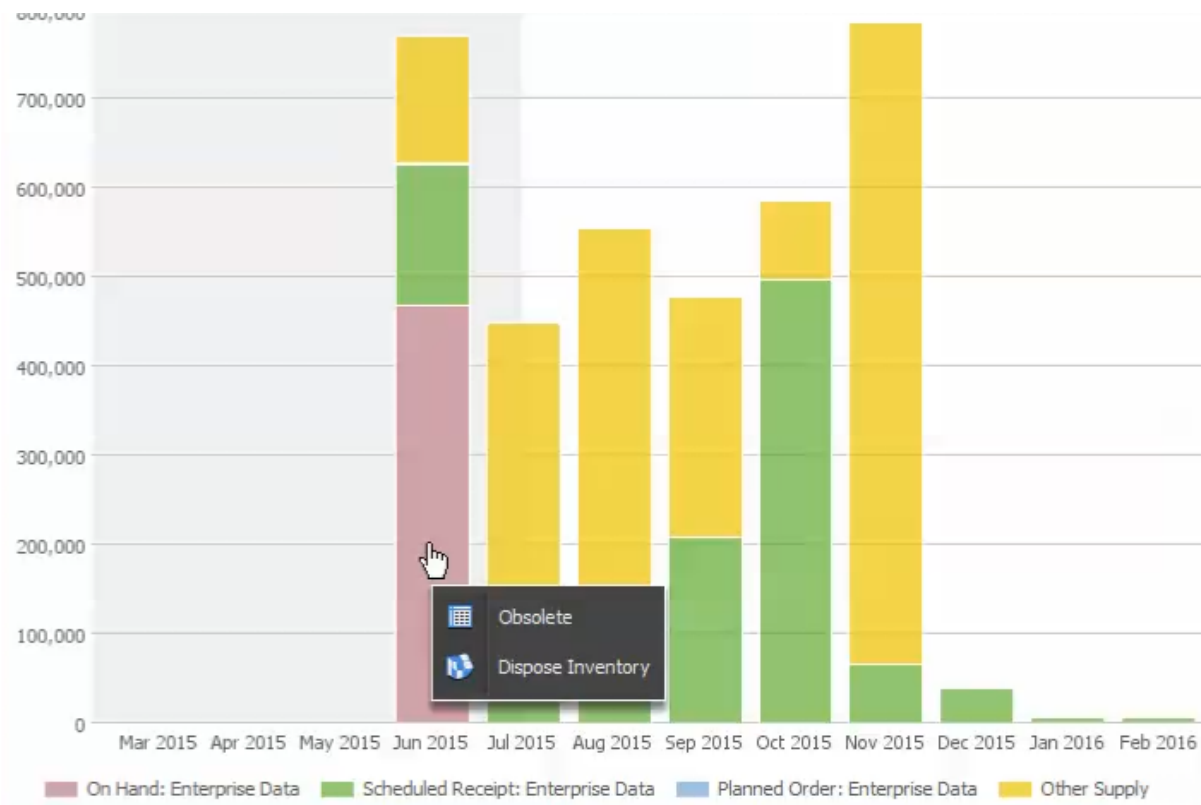
OK CANCEL

If you can drill from a data series on a chart, the pointer changes to a hand (link select mode) when you hover over that data series. For example, you can drill from the following types of data series representations:

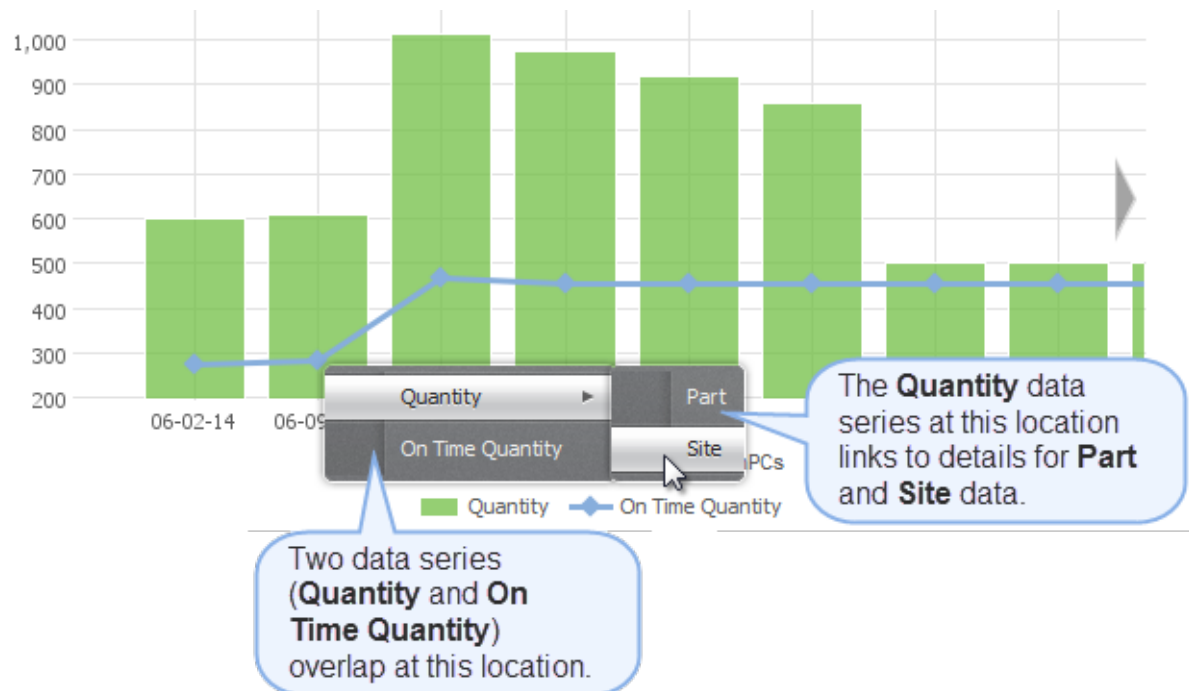
- Bar, line marker, or area (in a bar, line, or area chart)
- Gauge needle (in a gauge chart)
- Pie segment (in a pie chart)
- Bar, line, or triangle indicator (in a bullet chart).



A data series might have multiple drill links defined. When you click the data series, a list of linked resources displays for you to select from.



When you click overlapping data points that both drill to linked resources, you can select with data point you want to drill from.



► Drill to a linked resource from a chart

- When the pointer displays in link select mode, click a bar, line data point, area, gauge needle, pie segment, or indicator.
 - If you are drilling from a chart in a workbook, a details worksheet opens in separate worksheet tab or workbook or a form opens as an overlay on the workbook.
 - If you are drilling from a chart on a dashboard, a workbook opens displaying the details worksheet, or a form opens as an overlay on the dashboard.

► Drill to a linked resource when data points overlap

1. When the pointer displays in link select mode, click the data marker.
2. In the list, click the data series you want to view details for.



Note: Data points in scatter charts cannot display drill links.

Copy, print, and save a chart

You can copy, print, or save charts in workbooks or dashboards.

► Copy a chart

When you copy a chart it is copied to your computer clipboard. From there you can paste the chart into documents, presentations, or web pages outside of RapidResponse.

1. Select the chart.
2. On the **Edit** menu, click **Copy**.



Tip: You can also copy a chart by right-clicking the chart, and then clicking **Copy Chart**.

► Print a workbook chart

1. Select the workbook tab that includes the chart.
2. On the **File** menu, click **Print**.
3. In the **Print** dialog box, select **Chart**.
4. Click **OK**.



Notes:

- The chart will print as it is currently displayed on the screen, including zoom levels and scrolled areas.
- If you want to customize the printed output, in the **Print** dialog box, click **Properties**. By default, charts print in landscape orientation.
- You cannot directly print a Gantt chart but you can copy your current view of the chart (see [Copy a chart](#)).



Tip: You can also print a workbook chart by right-clicking the chart, and then clicking **Print Chart**.

► **Print a dashboard chart**

1. Select the chart widget title bar.
2. On the **File** menu, click **Print**.



Notes:

- The chart will print as it is currently displayed on the screen, including zoom levels and scrolled areas.
- If you want to customize the printed output, in the **Print** dialog box, click **Properties**. By default, charts print in landscape orientation.



Tip: You can also print a dashboard chart by right-clicking the chart and then clicking **Print Chart**.

► **Save a chart as an image**

You can save a chart as PNG or JPEG image file.

1. Do one of the following:
 - For workbook charts, select the worksheet tab that includes the chart.
 - For dashboard charts, select the widget title bar.
2. On the **File** menu, click **Save Chart**.
3. In the **Save As** dialog box, navigate to the location where you want to save the chart.
4. In the **File name** box, type a name for the file.
5. In the **Files of type** list, click the image type you want to save the chart as.
You can save charts as PNG or JPEG formats.
6. Click **Save**.

After saving the file, you can open the file or the folder where the file is saved. If you do not want to do open the file, click **Close**.



Note: Charts will save with their current view settings intact. This includes zoom levels and scrolled areas.



Tip: You can also save a chart by right-clicking the chart, and then clicking **Save Chart**.

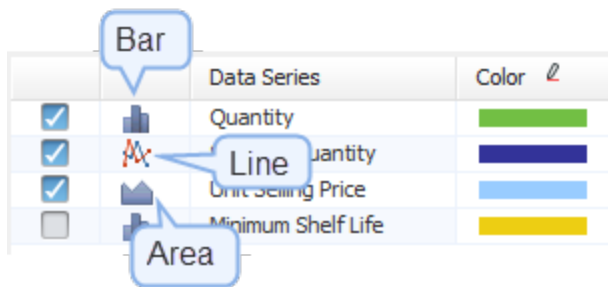
Change what data displays in a chart

There are two ways you can change what data is displayed in a chart:

- Depending on how the chart was authored, you might have the option of including or excluding data series or selecting from multiple data series options.
- If the chart includes a multi-scenario column, you can add data for multiple scenarios to the chart. For more information, see ["View data from multiple scenarios" on page 159](#).
- Changing data settings in the dashboard or workbook will change what data displays in the chart. For more information, see ["Data settings in dashboards" on page 265](#) and ["Display data in a worksheet" on page 146](#).
- For charts in workbooks, if the chart displays on the same tab as the worksheet that provides its data, you can change the data in the chart by selecting a different record in the worksheet.

Changing which data series display in a chart

Some types of charts can be defined to allow you to include and exclude data series. When this is enabled, only data series that have been selected by the resource author can be added. Data series are included or excluded using the Chart Settings dialog box, which displays an icon beside each available data series to indicate whether it is charted as a bar, line or area:



Note: Some charts might have hidden data columns specified for a data series. If the chart does not display data, you will be prompted to select a data series that is not based on a hidden data column.

► Change the record displayed in a chart

- Click a record in a worksheet column to view information for that record in a chart.

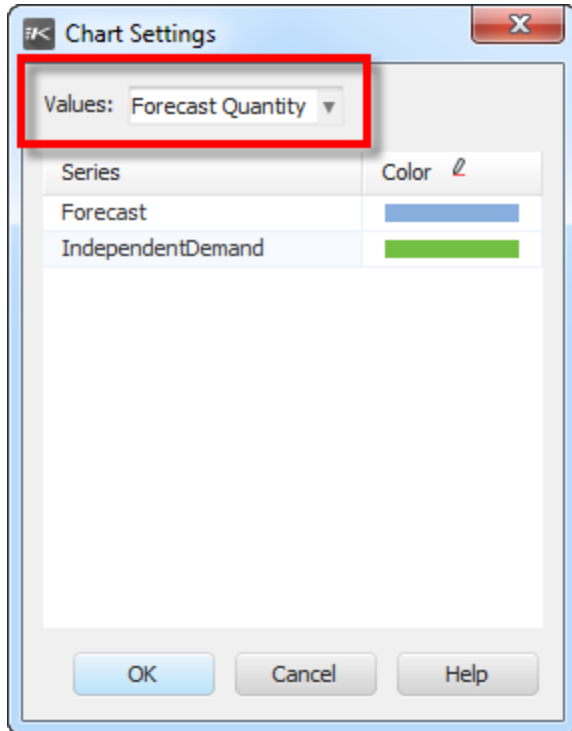
► Exclude or include a data series in a chart

1. Do one of the following:
 - For workbook charts, on the workbook toolbar, click **Chart** , and then click **Chart Settings**.
 - For dashboard widget charts, on the widget title bar, click **Actions** , and then click **Chart Settings**.
2. In the **Chart Settings** dialog box, clear the check box for the data series you do not want to appear on the chart, or select the checkbox for the data series you want to appear on the chart.

► Select from multiple data series options

This setting only applies summarized bar, line, or area charts.

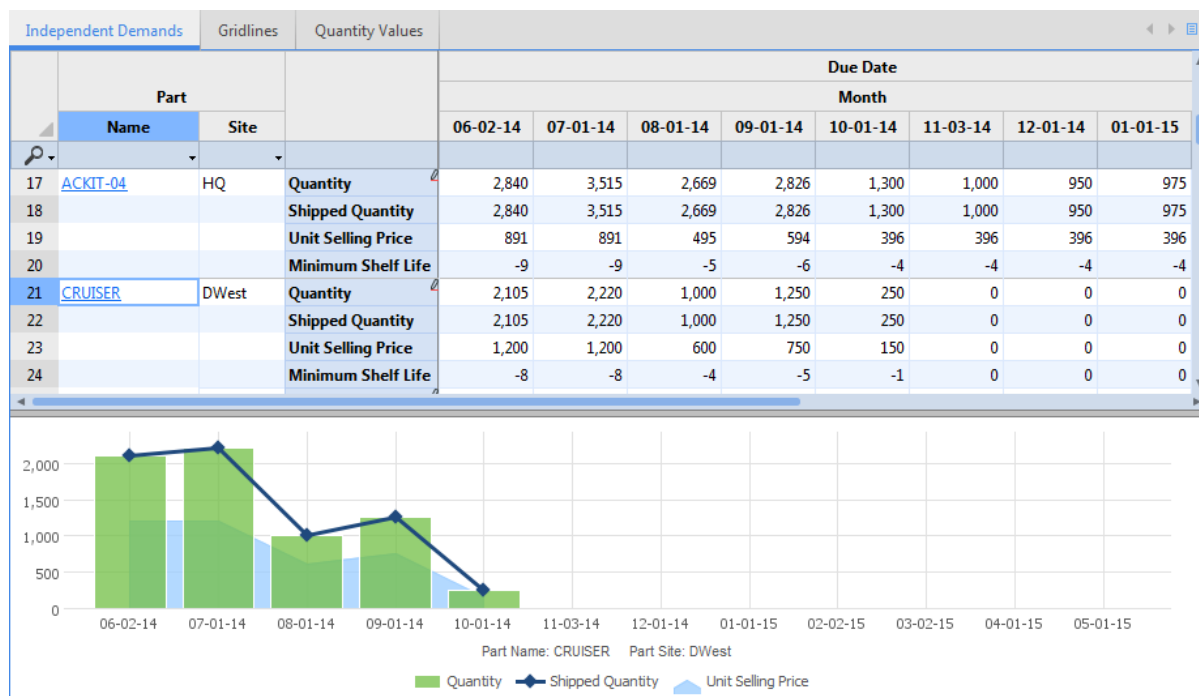
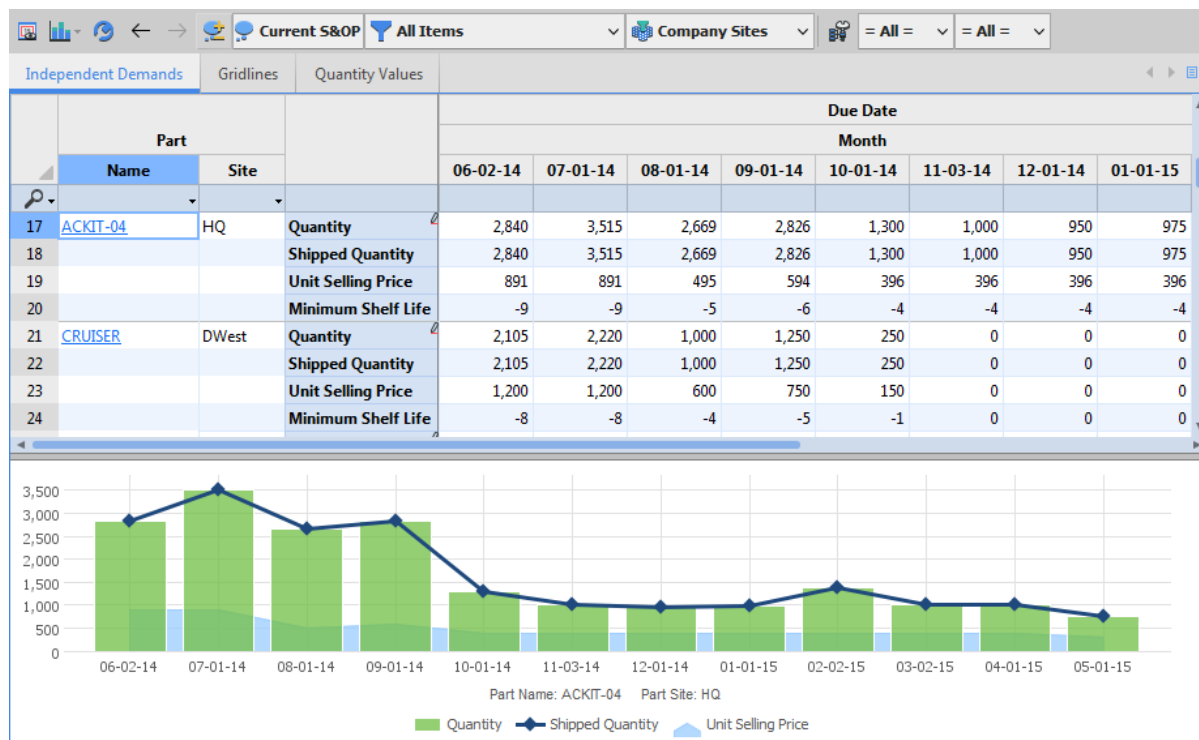
1. Do one of the following:
 - For workbook charts, on the workbook toolbar, click **Chart** , and then click **Chart Settings**.
 - For dashboard widget charts, on the widget title bar, click **Actions** , and then click **Chart Settings**.
2. In the **Chart Settings** dialog box, select the data column you want to display in the summary chart from the **Values** list.



Changing the data in a chart by selecting a different record

When you click a new record in the worksheet that provides the data for a chart, the chart instantly updates to display data for that record. Chart data can only be changed for bar, line, and area charts, gauge charts, and bullet charts, displayed on the same tab as their related worksheets.

For example, the following illustration shows bar, line, and area charts created by clicking different part sites in the same worksheet.



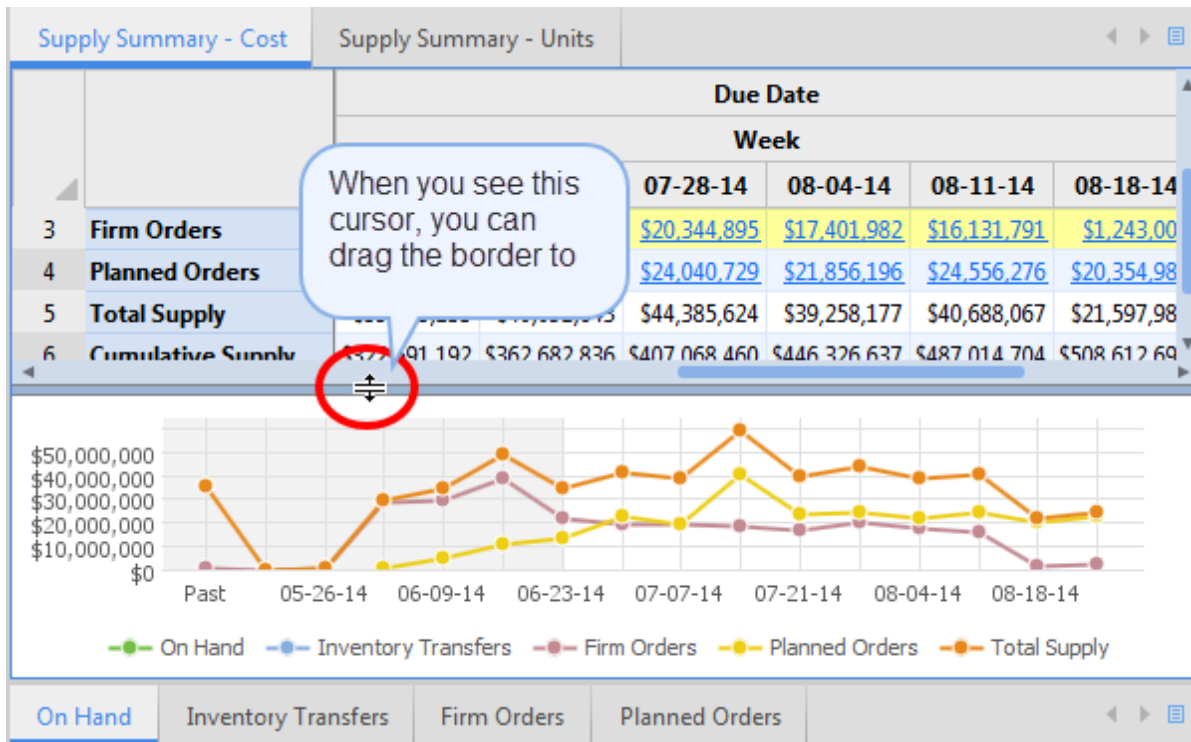
Change how a chart displays data

You can change how a chart displays in a worksheet by resizing the chart, zooming in and scrolling through the data, and for charts that display next to a worksheet grid you can hide the chart from view

to focus on data in the grid.

Resize a chart

A chart located on the same tab as its related worksheet might initially display larger or smaller than you want. In this case, you can resize the chart as needed by clicking and dragging a border. When you hover the cursor over a chart border that can be moved, the cursor changes to a pair of lines with arrows pointing in either direction.

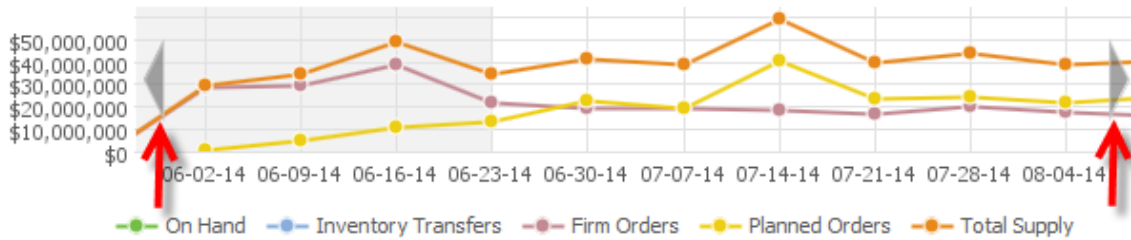


► Resize a workbook chart

1. Move the pointer over the border between the worksheet and chart.
The cursor changes to or .
2. Click and drag the border until the chart is the desired size.

Zoom into a chart

You can change the zoom level of bar, line, and area charts, and scatter charts. You can zoom in for focus on specific data points, or zoom out to see more data. When a bar, line, and area chart is zoomed in and extends beyond the viewing area, gray arrows appear on the left and right of the chart:



When a scatter chart is zoomed in and extends beyond the viewing area, gray arrows appear on the left, right, top, and bottom of the chart:



When a chart is zoomed in and gray arrows appear, you can click on the arrows or pan back and forth in the chart to view data that is outside of the viewing area.

► Change the chart zoom level

- Click in the chart area, and then scroll the mouse wheel up to zoom in, or scroll the mouse wheel down to zoom out.



Note: If your mouse does not have a scroll wheel, right-click the chart and then click **Zoom In** or **Zoom Out**.

► Pan back and forth in a chart

- Click and then drag the mouse left or right.



Note: In a scatter chart, you can also drag the mouse up or down.

Show or hide a workbook chart

If a worksheet includes a chart, the **Chart**  button is present on the workbook toolbar. Use the chart button as a toggle to show or hide the chart in that worksheet.

To show or to hide a chart in a worksheet:

- On the workbook toolbar, click **Chart** , and then click **Show Chart**.

Change the colors in a chart

In some charts you can control which colors are used in the chart. All of your changes are saved and display the next time you view the chart. At any time, you can reset chart settings to their original state.

The table below outlines the changes you can make to different types of charts:

Chart	Changes Allowed
Bar, line, and area	• Color of bars, lines, and areas • Include or exclude data series • Change the date buckets for the data series
Pie	• Color of pie segments
Gauge	• Color of gauge needles
Scatter	• Color of markers • Include or exclude data series
Gantt	• Color of percentage complete indicator • Color of bars • Show or hide bar text and dependency relationships • Highlight today's date • Change color of highlight line
Bullet	• Color of indicators • Include or exclude indicator measures

For more information, see ["Viewing data in charts" on page 199](#).

► Change the colors used in the chart

1. Do one of the following:
 - For workbook charts, on the workbook toolbar, click **Chart** , then click **Chart Settings**. In some cases you might need to only click **Chart** .
 - For dashboard widget charts, on the widget title bar, click **Actions** , and then click **Chart Settings**.
2. In the **Chart Settings** dialog box, click the color you want to change, and then click the drop-down arrow that appears beside the color.
3. Select a color from the color palette.



Tips:

- Click **More Colors** at the bottom of the color palette to select swatches, HSB, or RGB colors.
- You can also access the **Chart Settings** dialog box from the **View** menu.

► Reset the original chart settings

At any time, you can return to the original chart settings set by the resource author.

- For workbook charts, on the **View** menu, click **Reset Workbook**.
- For dashboard charts, on the **View** menu, click **Reset Dashboard**.

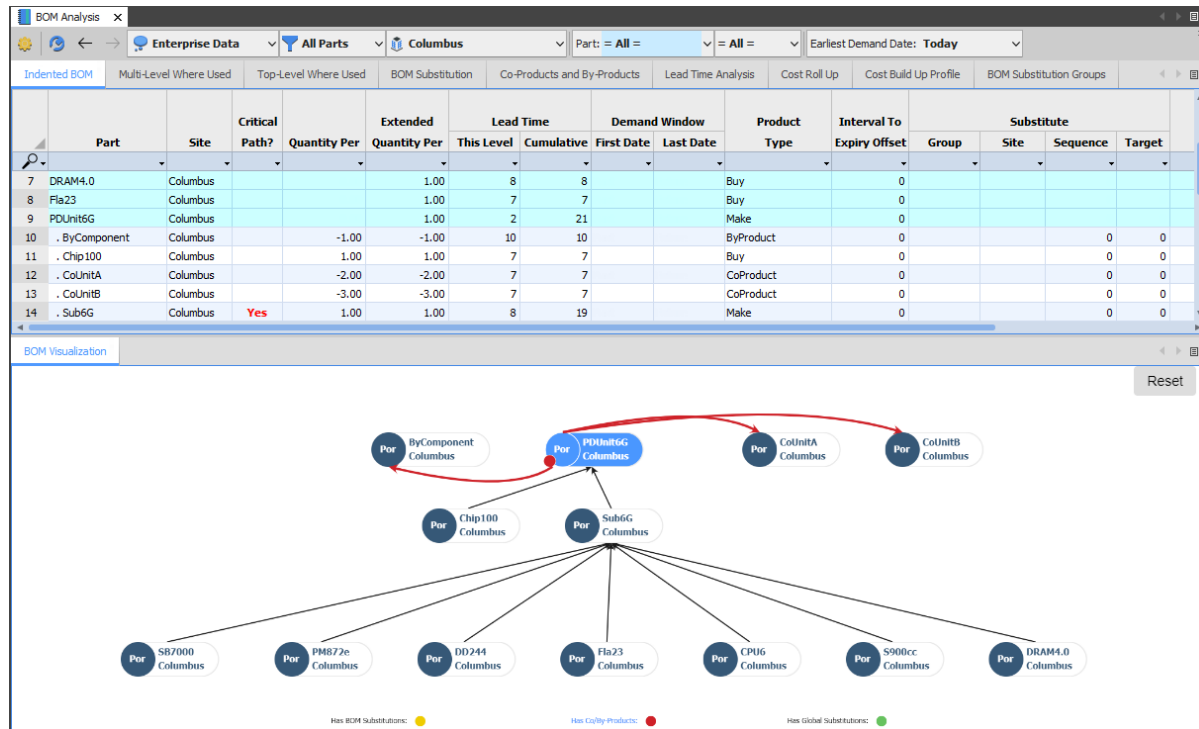


Caution: **Reset Dashboard** resets the data settings for all widgets on the dashboard.

Visualizing the bill of material

Some workbooks can include a chart that shows the bill of material (BOM). A BOM chart provides you with an up-to-date view of the product structure, and you can filter the chart to focus only on the components or sites (or other criteria) that are relevant to you.

For example, the BOM Visualization worksheet in the BOM Analysis workbook includes a BOM chart.



The nodes that you see in the chart depend on the filter settings that you have applied. For more information about nodes, see ["Understanding nodes in a BOM chart" on page 226](#).

Additionally, in a BOM chart you can:

- Control your view by moving the whole chart, moving individual nodes, or zooming in and out of the chart (see ["Controlling your view in a BOM chart" on page 228](#)).
- Focus on a single component and its relationships (see ["Focusing on a component in a BOM chart" on page 229](#)).
- View substitutes, co-products, and by-products for all components or a specific component (see ["Viewing part substitutes, co-products, and by-products in a BOM chart" on page 229](#)).
- Reset the chart to return to its default view (see ["Resetting a BOM chart" on page 231](#)).



Notes:

- It is recommended that you use a 64-bit version of Java when viewing a BOM chart. Using a

32-bit version of Java can result in you not being able to use this chart.
BOM charts can depict a maximum of 10,000 records.

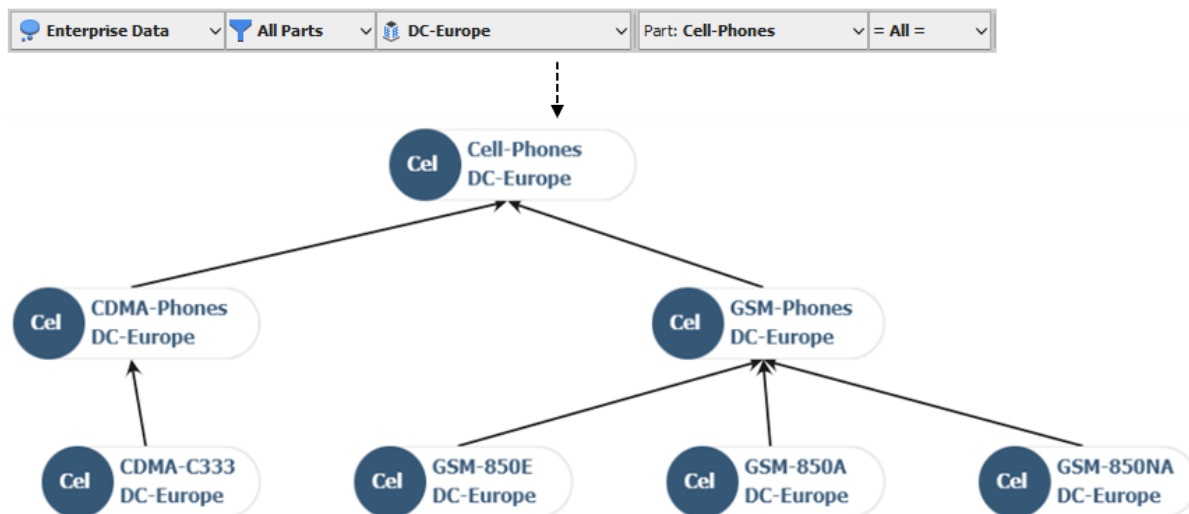
Understanding nodes in a BOM chart

Each component in the chart is represented by a node. Typically, each node lists the component's name, site, and the first three characters of its product group (this displayed information might change depending on how the chart was authored). Lines connect the nodes, with arrows pointing from a child node to its parent.

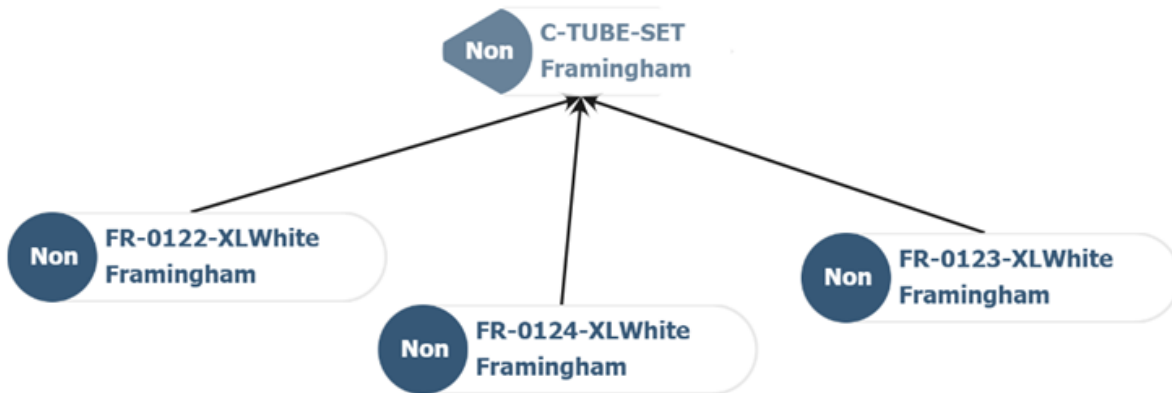
The nodes that you see in the chart depend on the filter settings that you have applied. For more information about changing your workbook settings, see ["Viewing data in workbooks" on page 139](#).

Your selected settings represent the highest level of the structure that will appear in the chart. In other words, when you select a part from the filter settings, only nodes representing this part and its children will appear in the chart (not the part's parent).

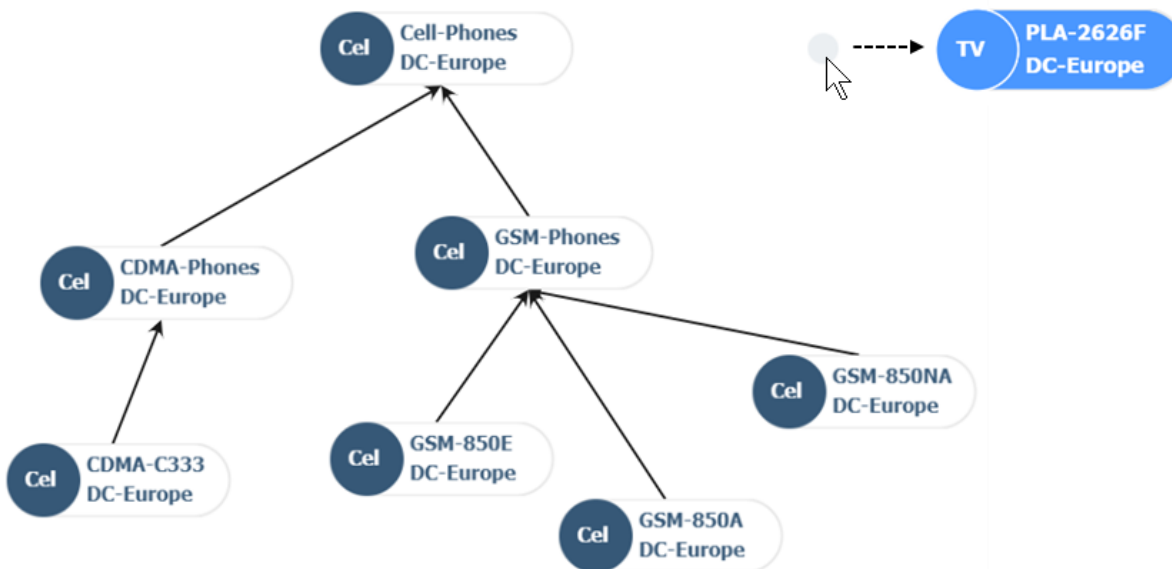
For example, the following image shows a chart that is filtered to show information about part Cell-Phones at site DC-Europe.



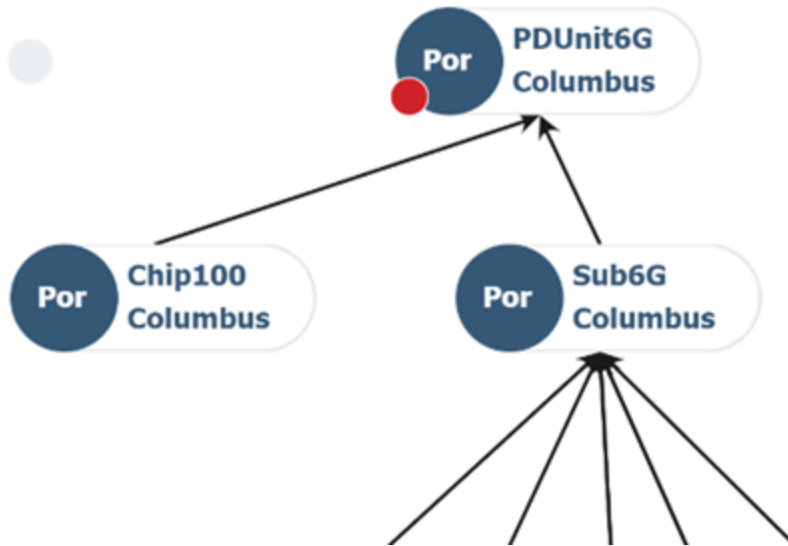
Nodes that represent phantom assemblies have a different color and shape.



If a component is not a child or parent of any other component in the chart but matches the filter settings of the worksheet, it appears in the chart as a gray circle. Clicking on a gray circle selects it, allowing you to see the full node. Because you selected it, the focus is on this node, so you must click outside of this node to deselect it and to return the focus to main chart structure.



If a component in the product structure includes a substitution, co-product, or by-product, this is indicated by one or more small circles along the edge of the node. You can click the node to view the links between the component and its substitutions, co-products, or by-products. When the links are hidden, the substitutions, co-products, or by-products appear as gray circles. For more information, see ["Viewing part substitutes, co-products, and by-products in a BOM chart" on page 229.](#)



You can focus on any node in the chart to more clearly see its relationships. For more information, see ["Focusing on a component in a BOM chart" on page 229](#).

Controlling your view in a BOM chart

You can control your view of a BOM chart by moving the whole chart structure, moving individual nodes, or zooming in and out of the chart.

To return to the default view of the chart, you can reset it. For more information, see ["Resetting a BOM chart" on page 231](#).

► Move the chart

- Click on the chart outside of a node and drag the chart to a new position.

► Move a node

You can move any node in the chart. Lines connecting nodes automatically move with them.

- Click on the node you want to move and drag it to a new position.

► Zoom in and out of the chart

When the chart loads, it might display a large BOM structure made up of many nodes. It can be useful to zoom in to specific areas of the chart to view details.

- With your cursor on the chart, use your mouse wheel to scroll up and down.

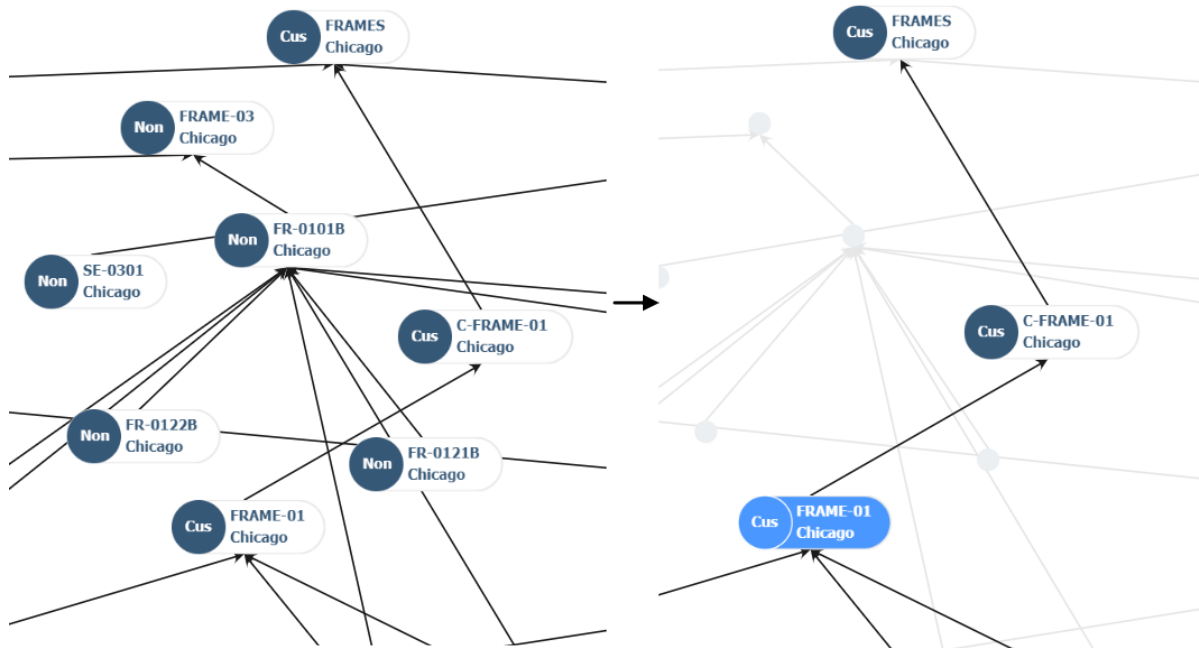


Tip: If you have zoomed in and want zoom out to view the full chart, it might be easier to click Reset instead of scrolling. Note, however, that this will reset all other changes that you have made.

Focusing on a component in a BOM chart

You can click on any node in a BOM chart to bring focus to this node and its relationships. Child and parent relationships are shown, as well as grandchild and grandparent relationships (and so on) through the entire structure.

The selected node is highlighted, and any other nodes in the chart that are not related to the selected part are hidden. This can be useful when you are looking at a BOM chart that includes a large number of nodes.



Focusing on a node also displays all links to the part's substitutes, co-products, and by-products. For more information, see ["Viewing part substitutes, co-products, and by-products in a BOM chart" on page 229](#).

Deselecting a node

To deselect a node, click somewhere in the chart, outside of the node. Or, you can click on a different node to change the focus.

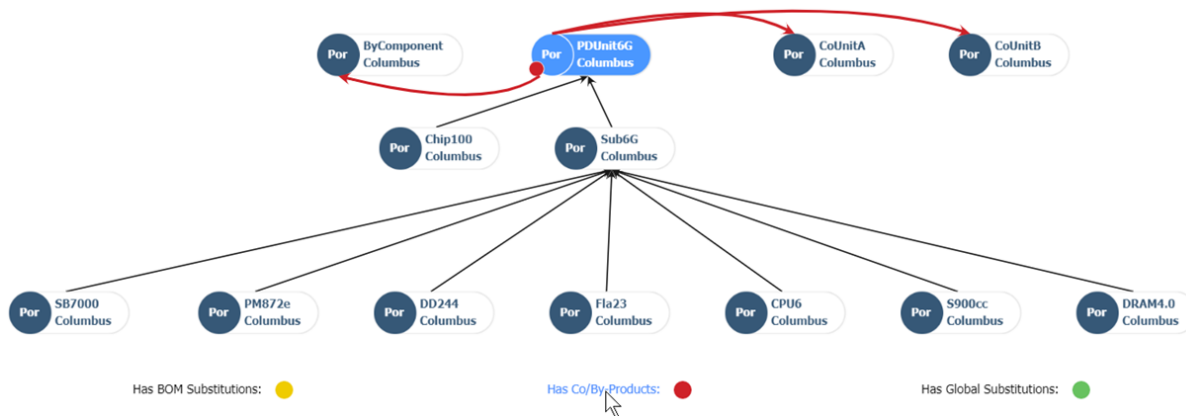
You can also deselect a node by resetting the entire chart (but this will also reset any other changes you have made). For more information, see ["Resetting a BOM chart" on page 231](#).

Viewing part substitutes, co-products, and by-products in a BOM chart

In a BOM chart, if a component in the product structure includes a BOM level part substitution, global substitution, co-product, or by-product, this is indicated by one or more small circles along the edge of

the node. You can click the node to view links between the component and its substitutions, co-products, or by-products.

You can also toggle between showing and hiding these links by clicking the buttons at the bottom of the chart. You can view all link types at once or just one at time.



When the links are hidden, the substitutions, co-products, or by-products appear as gray circles.

► View part substitutes, co-products, and by-products for a specific node

- Click a node to view links to this component's substitutes, co-products, or by-products.
To hide these links, deselect the node by clicking somewhere in the chart, outside of the node.

For more information about viewing links to part substitutes, co-products, and by-products, see:

- ["View BOM level part substitutions" on page 230](#)
- ["View co-products and by-products" on page 231](#)
- ["View global part substitutions" on page 231](#)

For more information about part substitutions, co-products, or by-products and how to configure them in RapidResponse, see the [RapidResponse Analytic and Data Model Guide](#).

View BOM level part substitutions

A component used in the production of an assembly might not always have sufficient supply available to satisfy dependent demand exploded down from the assembly. However, there could be available supply on other similar components which could be used instead. In RapidResponse, an assembly can be configured to have substitutable component parts that can be used in place of one another.

► View or hide all BOM level part substitutions in a BOM chart

- At the bottom of the chart, click **Has BOM Substitutions**.

View co-products and by-products

RapidResponse can be configured to support generating co-products and by-products. These are products that are generated during, and because of, the production of another part.

Co-products are parts manufactured alongside the supply of a primary product to which they are functionally similar and with which they might typically share common components or manufacturing processes. For example, a co-product might be a lower quality grade version of a primary product.

By-products are parts generated from and considered residual to the production of a primary product. For example, a by-product might be a chemical generated during the production of one or more assemblies (primary products) in a given product structure. In other cases, a by-product might be scrap material with value that is salvaged or recovered during the production process of the primary product.

► View all co-products and by-products in a BOM chart

- At the bottom of the chart, click **Has Co/By-Products**.

View global part substitutions

In some cases, when there is not enough supply of a part to satisfy its demand(s), there might be other similar parts whose supply could be used to satisfy demand for the original part. RapidResponse allows for parts to be configured as substitutes for one another on a global basis (that is, outside of a bill of material context).

► View all global substitutions in a BOM chart

- At the bottom of the chart, click **Has Global Substitutions**.

Resetting a BOM chart

BOM charts include a Reset button. After making changes in the chart, you can click this button to reset the chart to its default view.



Resetting the chart will hide any substitution, co-product, or by-product links. If you have clicked on a node, it will also remove the focus from the selected node.

Clicking the Reset button does not change worksheet settings.

► **Reset a BOM chart**

- In the top-right corner of the chart, click **Reset**.

CHAPTER 18: Viewing data in treemaps

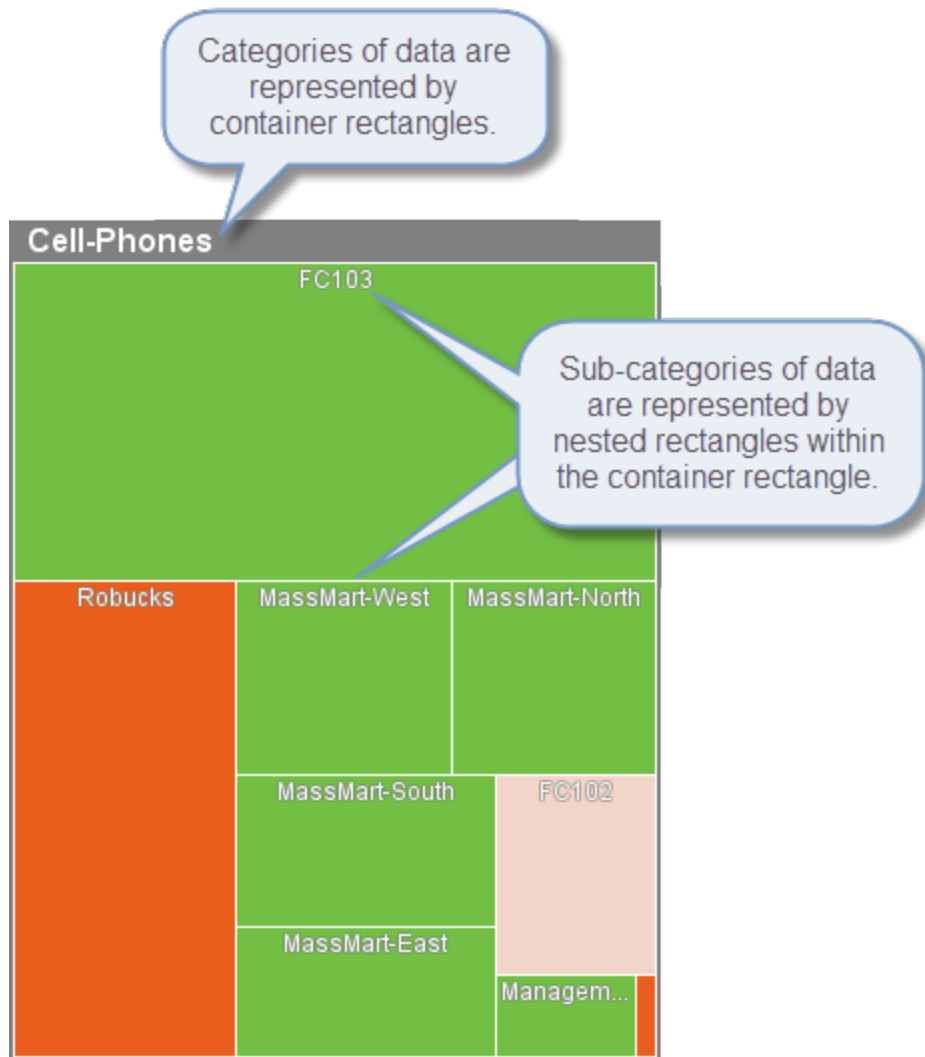
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- Open a treemap to view data** 238
- Change the data views in a treemap** 238
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You might see treemaps in RapidResponse workbooks or dashboards. Like charts, they provide visual representations of large data sets. This section discusses interpreting and navigating through treemaps.

What is a treemap?

Treemaps are interactive visualizations of large data sets that help users recognize patterns and identify outliers and problem areas. Data is grouped into categories and subcategories that can be viewed at both hierarchical and linear, grouped levels. You can view treemaps in worksheets or in widgets on a dashboard.

Each category of data in a treemap is represented by container rectangles, which are further divided into nested rectangles to represent subcategories of data. For example, in the treemap section below, the container rectangle represents a product family (Cell-Phones) which is then further divided into nested rectangles that represent customers for items in that product family.



The structure of the treemap is provided by a hierarchy or from data in the underlying worksheet the treemap is based on. Category and subcategory groups can be dynamically updated based on the options you select. For more information, see ["Interpret data in a treemap" on page 235](#) and ["Change the data views in a treemap" on page 238](#).

Treemaps can help you recognize patterns and outliers in your data that might otherwise be difficult to detect. For example, from a forecast chart you might see that sales revenue is expected to dip. Drilling to a treemap worksheet allows you to quickly and easily determine which parts or regions are causing issues so you can take corrective action.



Treemap worksheets can be viewed in a workbook or in dashboard widget, or they can be accessed by drilling from another worksheet or widget. Treemap worksheets provide the same filtering controls as other worksheet types, with a few additional controls that are unique to treemaps. For more information see ["Interpret data in a treemap" on page 235](#) and ["View data in a treemap widget" on page 257](#).

Interpret data in a treemap

Treemaps consist of container and nested rectangles, which represent the tree structure's categories and subcategories of data. Treemap categories are based on worksheet data or hierarchy levels, such as customer, product family, and location. For example, in the treemap below, the container rectangles (category) represent product parts, and the nested rectangles (subcategory) represent customers for those product parts.

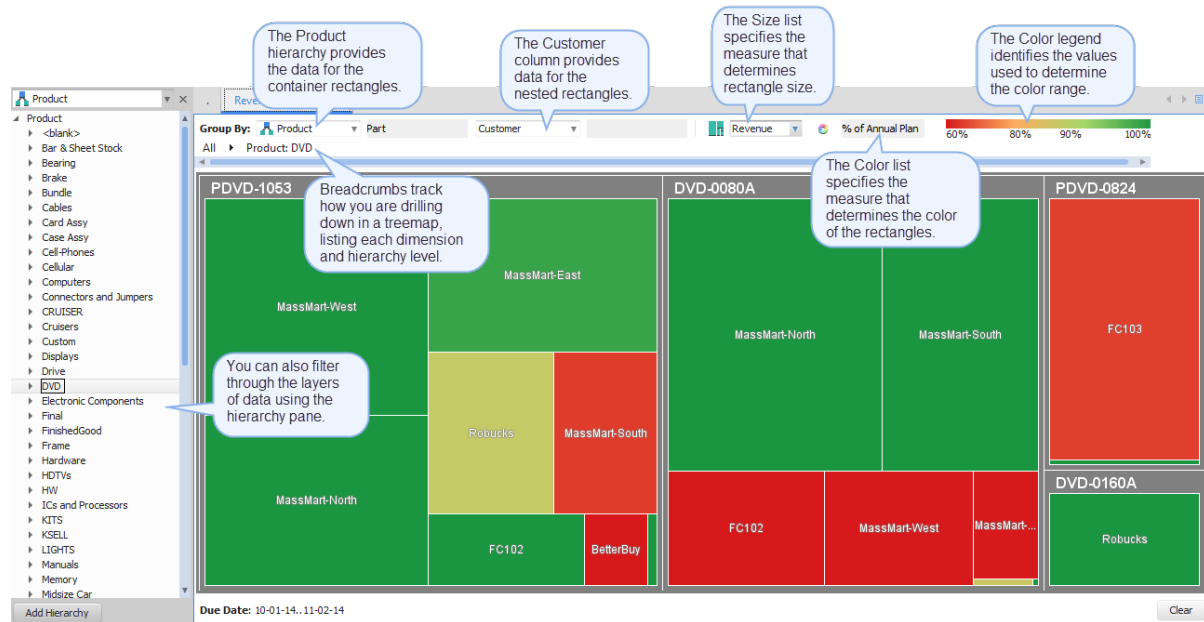
The size of the rectangles are determined by a quantitative measure, which provides a visualization of the rectangle value. In the treemap below, the size of each rectangle is determined by the total revenue generated by the rectangle's categories; that is, by the part and customer represented by the rectangle. The greater the revenue quantity for that customer and part, the larger the rectangle.

The color of the rectangles is also determined by a quantitative measure; in the treemap below, a color range of orange, white, and blue has been applied to illustrate the difference between revenue quantity and the targeted % of Annual Plan. Treemap worksheets include a color legend to help you interpret the colors used in a treemap. The value set on the treemap may appear as a percentage, or as a range, depending on how the treemap was created.

Breadcrumb navigation helps you track the filtering you have placed on the data as you drill down into the treemap. Making a selection in the hierarchy pane or clicking on a rectangle filters the data you are viewing. In the treemap below, breadcrumbs display that the data displayed has been filtered to only display data for the Product: Cell Phones. For more information about breadcrumbs, see ["Track data filtering in a treemap" on page 245](#).

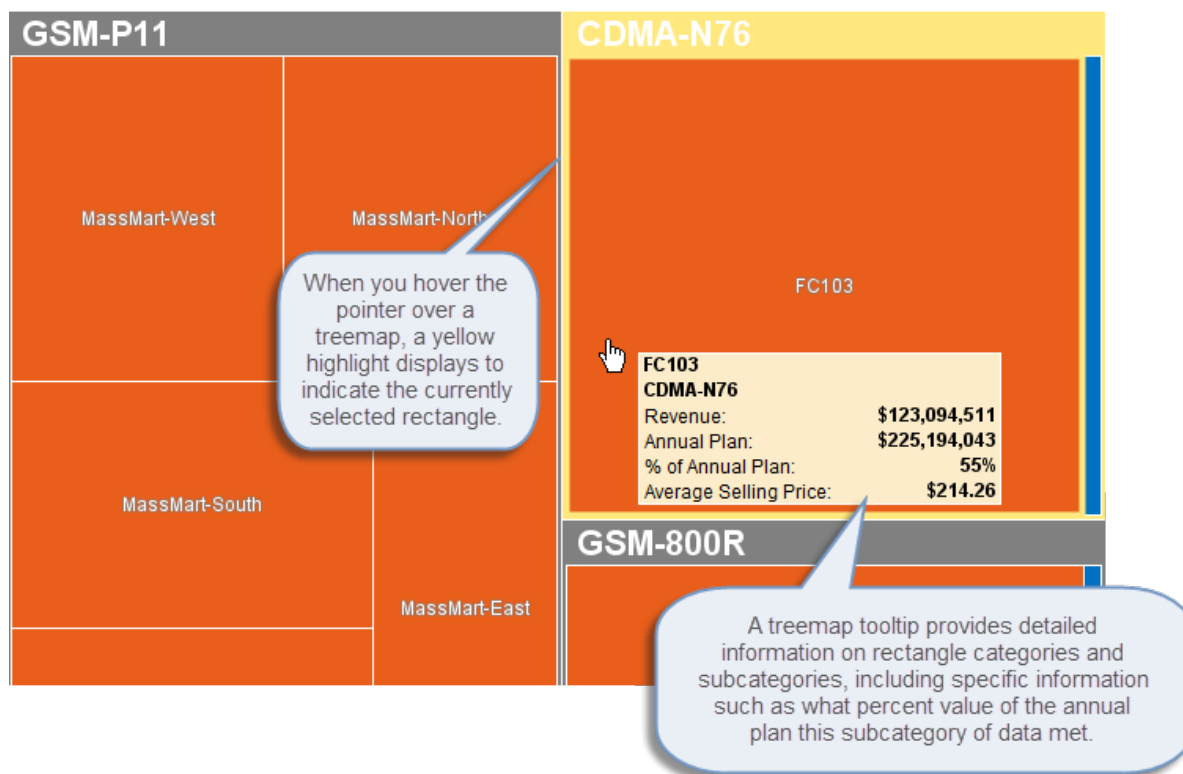
Treemaps are designed to draw your eye to problem areas; you can easily see by the size and color of the rectangles in the treemap where the problem areas occur. In the treemap below, problem areas are indicated by large, orange rectangles, which represent items and parts with high numbers of total units

produced but which are falling well below the required backlog levels. Thus, the categories represented by large, orange rectangles have the greatest negative impact on overall revenue.



View details in a treemap

A treemap usually includes labels on each container and nested rectangle. To view further details for a rectangle, such as the actual data values represented by the rectangle size and color, hover the pointer over the rectangle to view a tooltip.



The first two rows in the tooltip list the category and subcategory for the rectangle. The values for the color and size metrics for that rectangle are listed below the categories. If there are multiple size or color metrics available for the treemap, or if the treemap author has decided to display additional metrics in the tooltip, those additional metrics are also listed in the tooltip.

Enlarge a treemap to view details

You can enlarge areas that are too small to view in the treemap. You can maximize a treemap container in which the nested rectangles are too small to view their labels. You can also zoom in to any area of a treemap. When you zoom in, subcategory labels that were too small to appear in the initial treemap view will appear.

► Zoom in to an area of the treemap

- Position the pointer over an area of the treemap and roll the mouse wheel up to zoom in to that area. To zoom back out, roll the mouse wheel down.

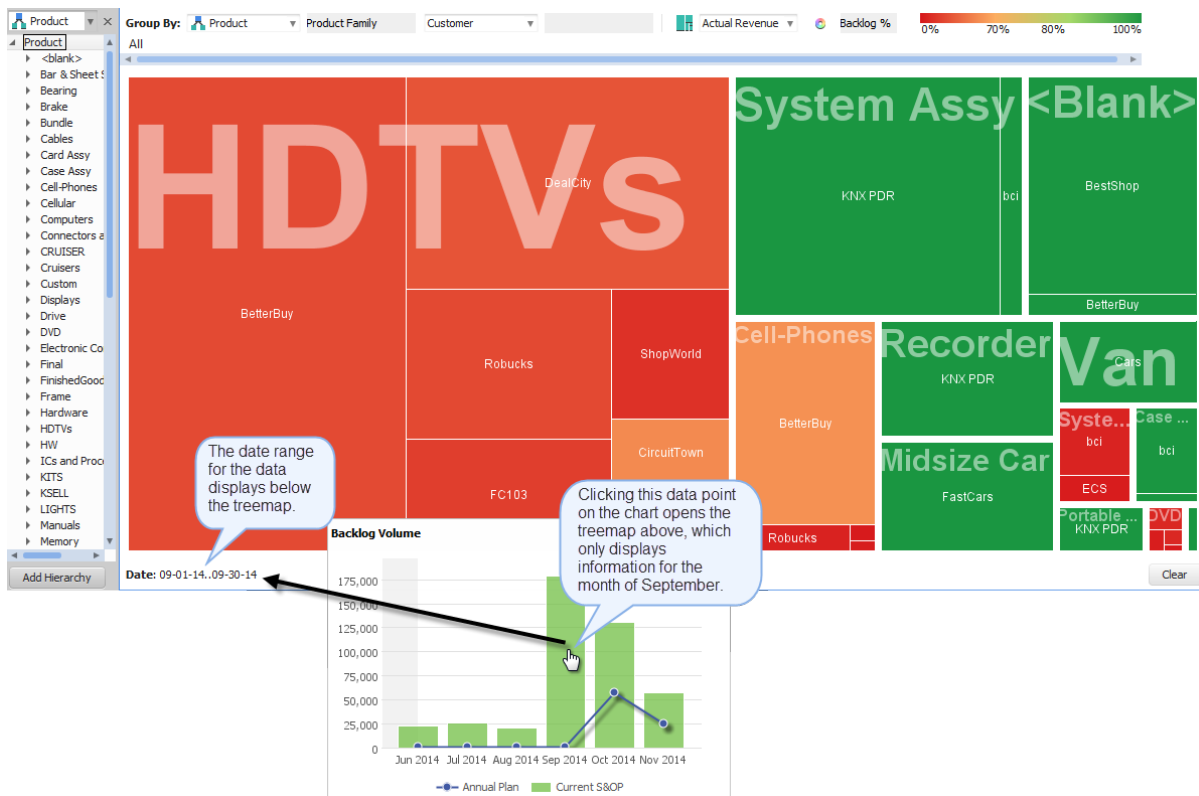


Note: If your mouse does not have a mouse wheel, you can zoom in and out by pressing the **Page Out** and **Page In** keys.

Open a treemap to view data

Some treemaps are accessed by drilling from another resource, such as a worksheet or dashboard. Treemaps might also be available from the Workbooks pane or as a widget on a dashboard.

When you drill to a treemap from another resource, the data settings such as the scenario and filter selections are typically passed on to the treemap; the exact interaction between the resource and the treemap depends on how the drilling behavior was defined by the resource author. For example, when you click a data point in a chart to drill to a treemap, the treemap typically displays information for that data point only. For charts that use a date as the base axis, the date is displayed below the treemap.



► Clear treemap drilling context filters

When you have drilled to a treemap from another resource, you can clear the drill context.

- In an open treemap, click **Clear**.

Change the data views in a treemap

You can change how data displays in a treemap by:

- Changing the data settings for the worksheet or widget.
- Selecting different data categories and subcategories.
- Drilling down the levels of a hierarchy in the hierarchy pane.

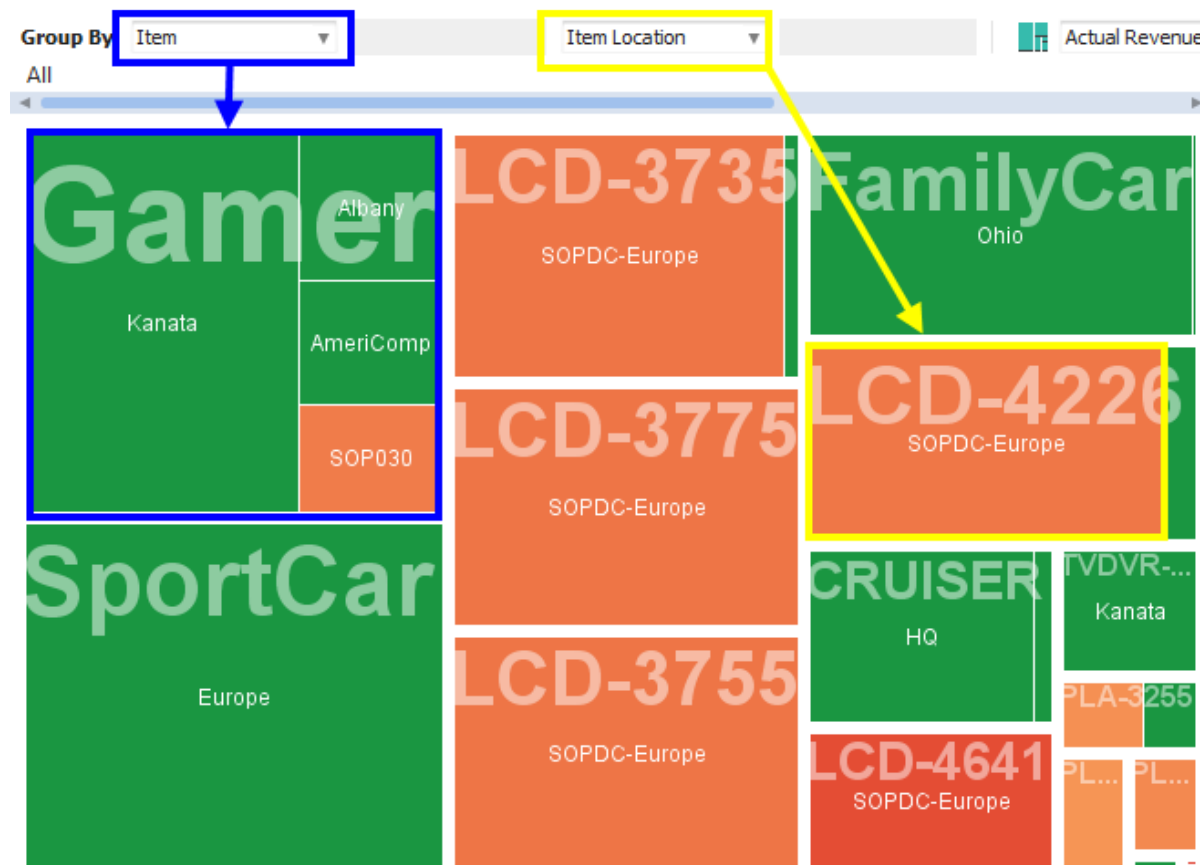
- Drilling down in the treemap by clicking on container or nested rectangles.
- For some treemaps, you can select different color or size measures from a drop down menu.

Changing data settings and hierarchies

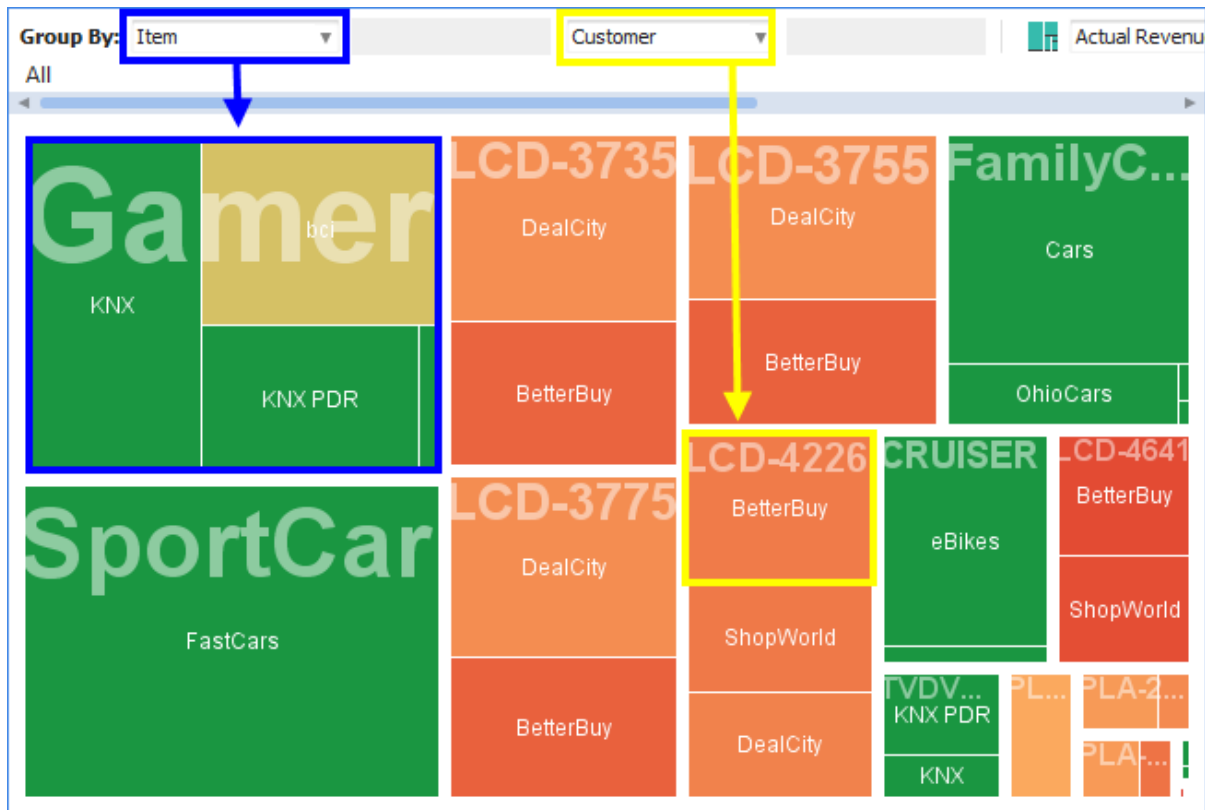
By selecting different data settings, including hierarchies, for a worksheet or widget you can modify what data displays in a treemap. For more information, see ["Viewing data in workbooks" on page 139](#) and ["Data settings in dashboards" on page 265](#).

Selecting different data categories and subcategories

You can modify what data displays in a treemap by selecting the categories and subcategories of data to display from the **Group By** lists above the treemap. The left **Group By** list determines the category for container rectangles, and the right **Group By** list determines the category for nested rectangles. Every time you make a new selection from one of these lists, the treemap updates to display the new view of the data set. For example, in the treemap below, the treemap is categorized by Item and Item Location.



Selecting Customer from the right **Group By** list instantly updates the treemap:

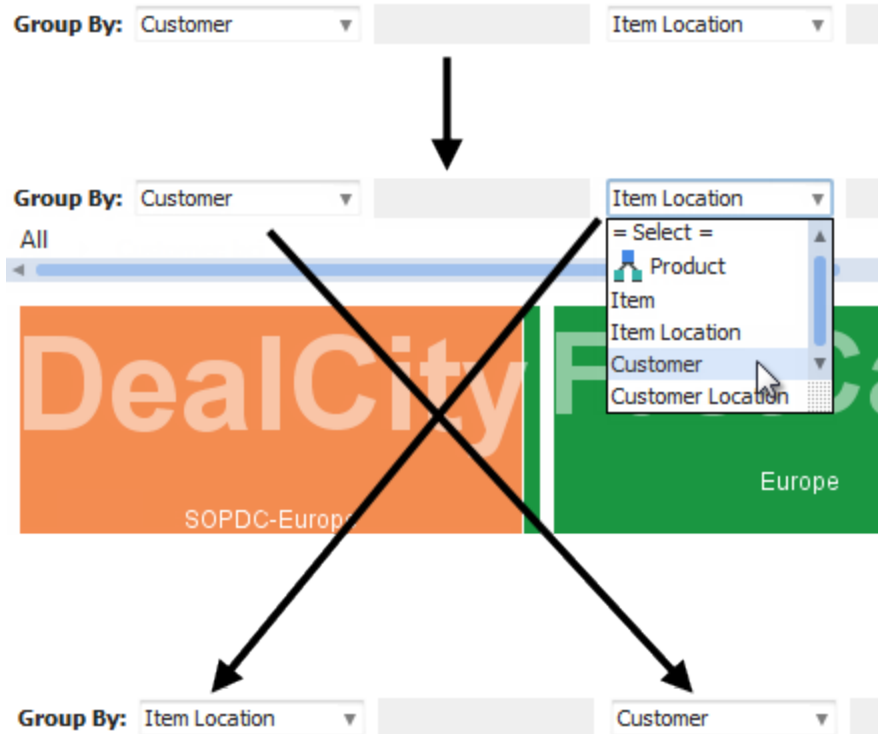


► Change data categories and subcategories

- To change the way data is categorized in the treemap, do the following:
 - To change how the data is categorized in the container rectangles, select a different category from the left **Group By** list.
 - To change the data subcategories displayed in the nested rectangles, select a different subcategory from the right **Group By** list.



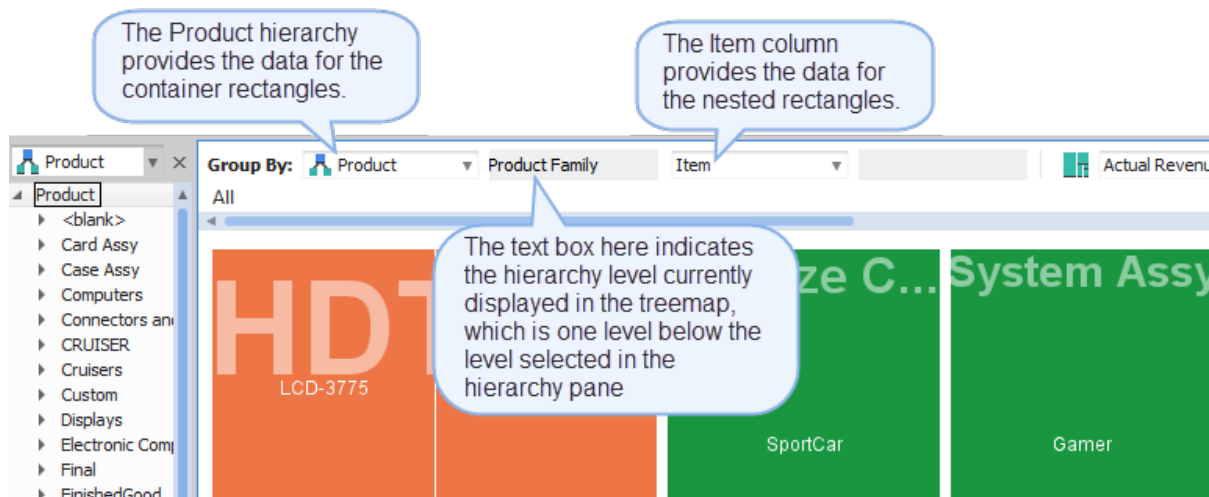
Note: If you select a Group By value and then select the same value for the other Group By, RapidResponse automatically switches the two values. For example, if you selected Customer for the first Group By and then changed the second Group By from Item Location to Customer, RapidResponse changes the first Group by to Item Location and keeps the second Group By as Customer.



Drilling down in a hierarchy

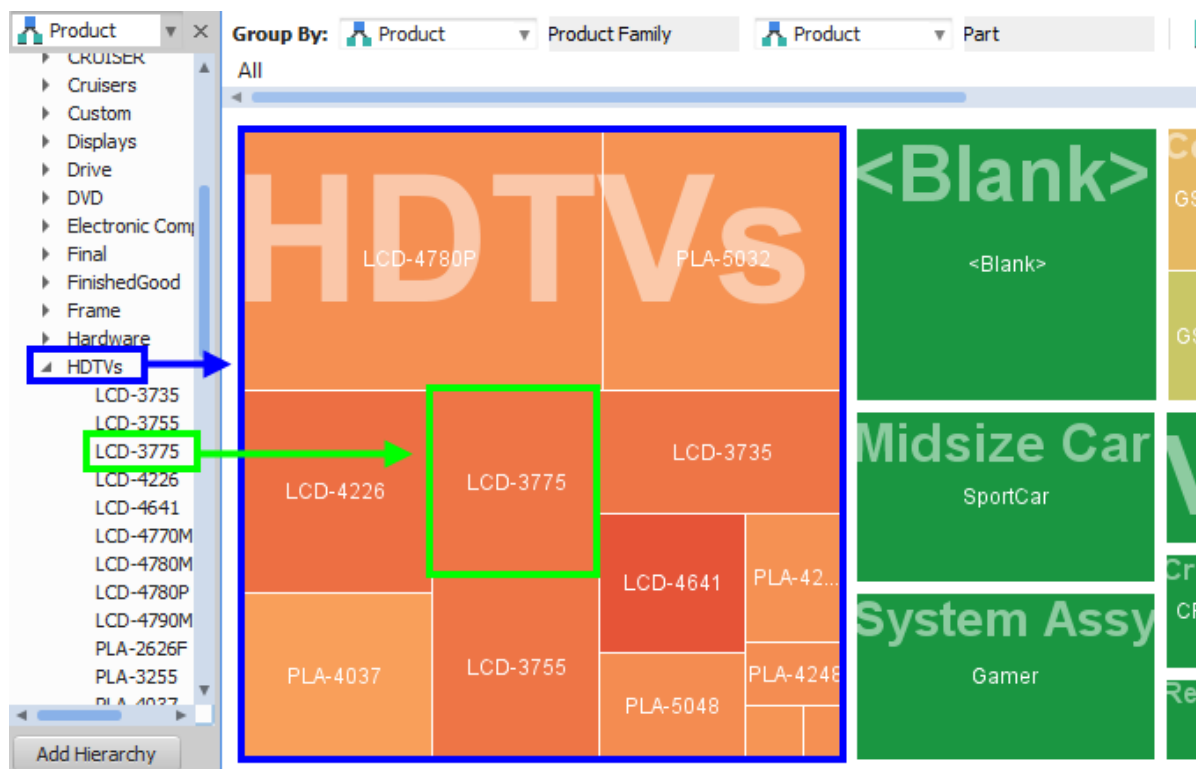
You might be able to drill down to more focused data in a treemap by using a hierarchy. When a hierarchy is available for a treemap worksheet, you might be able to select the hierarchy from the Group By lists. You can use a hierarchy to filter data in a treemap either in place of or in conjunction with the defined Group By categories. For more information, see ["Using hierarchies in reports" on page 301](#).

When you select a hierarchy from one of the Group By lists, the treemap displays data for all hierarchy levels below the node selected in the hierarchy pane; as you drill down to lower levels in the hierarchy pane, the treemap updates to display a more focused set of data. As you select nodes in the hierarchy, the text box below the Group By list with the hierarchy selected updates to display the hierarchy level currently shown in the treemap. When the lowest hierarchy level is selected, the text box is blank.

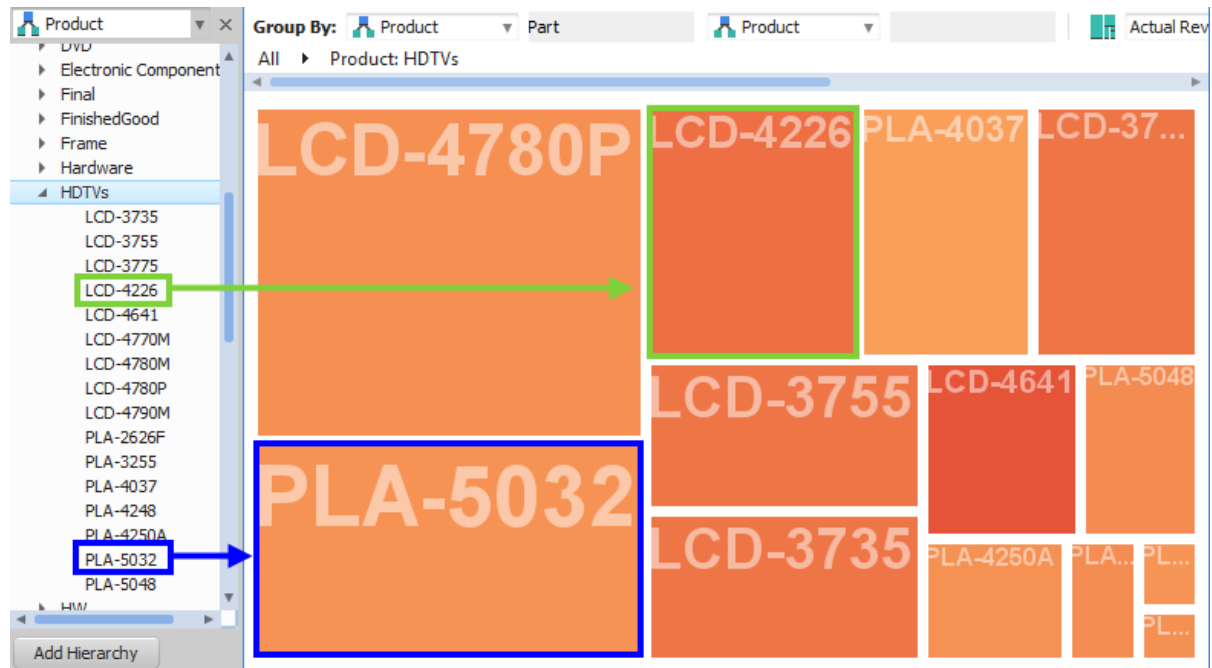


You can also choose to categorize data in a treemap by using the hierarchy only. When you select the same hierarchy from both Group By lists, the container rectangles display the hierarchy level one level below the currently selected node, and the nested rectangles display two hierarchy levels below. As you walk through the hierarchy, the treemap data updates each time you select a node.

The following treemap categorizes data using the Product hierarchy, which is selected at the highest level:



Selecting HDTVs in the hierarchy updates the treemap to display only the parts in the HDTV product family:



If there are multiple hierarchies available for the treemap worksheet, you can select different hierarchies from each Group By list to categorize the data by one hierarchy for container rectangles, and another hierarchy for nested rectangles.



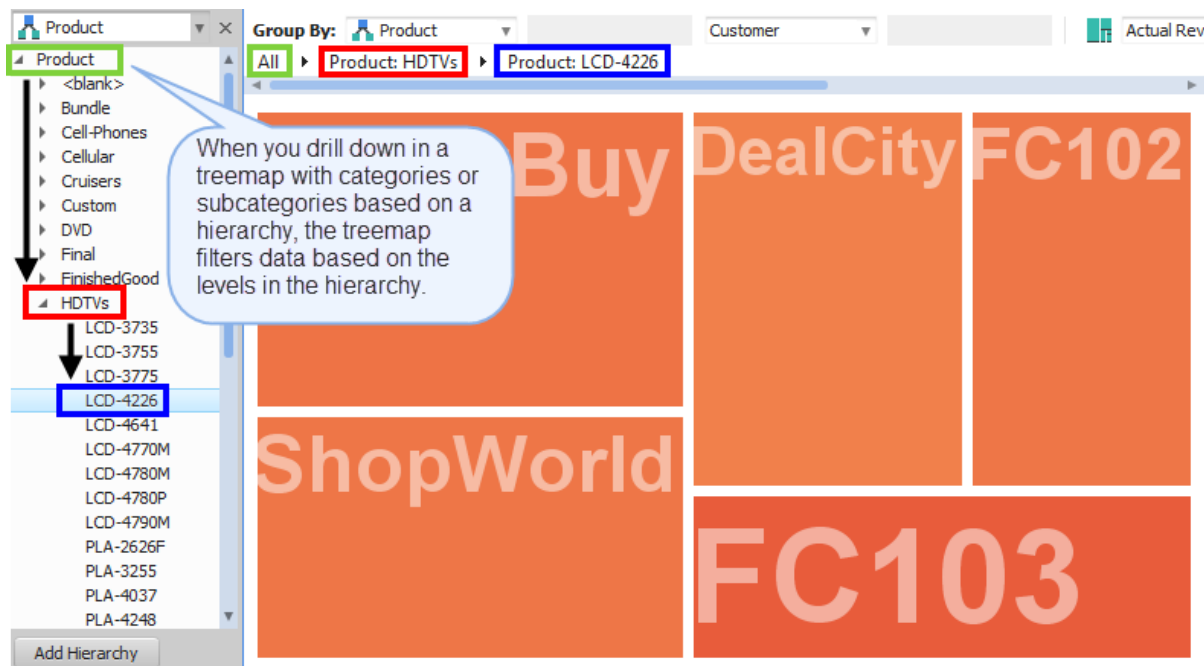
Note: If a hierarchy is available for a treemap worksheet, but not available from the Group By lists, you can still use the hierarchy to filter data in the treemap by selecting data categories from the Group By lists, and then selecting nodes in the hierarchy pane.

► Drill down in a hierarchy

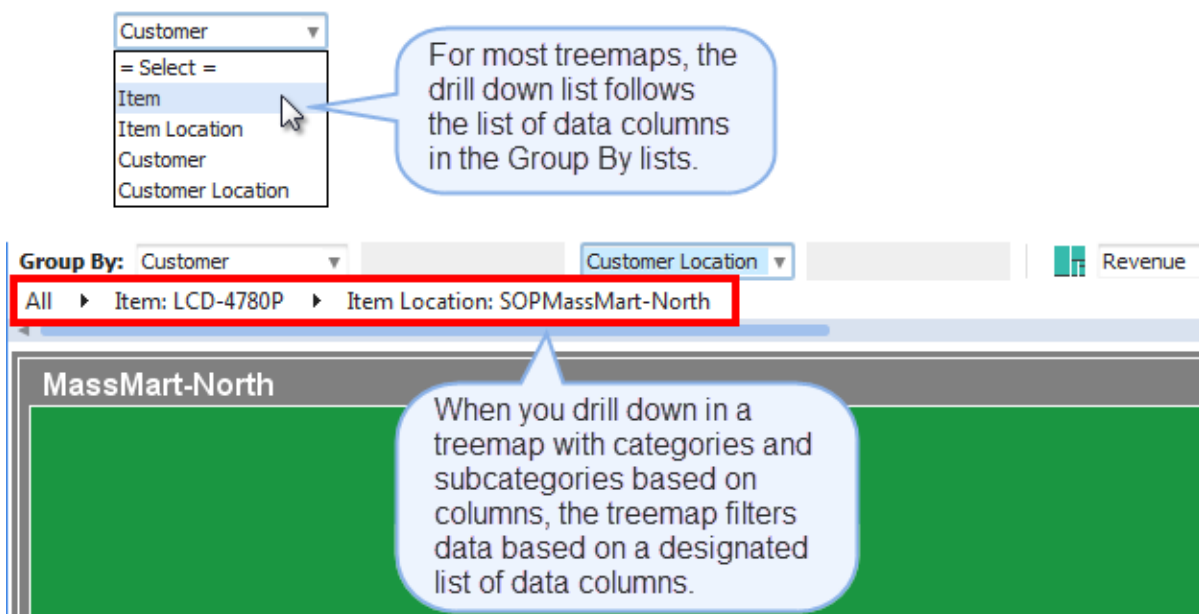
- To drill down through the hierarchy levels, do one of the following:
 - If the hierarchy is available in the Group By lists, select it from one of the Group By lists to categorize the data into hierarchy levels. The treemap displays all hierarchy levels below the node selected in the hierarchy pane.
 - If the hierarchy is not available in the Group By lists, select a node in the hierarchy pane to further refine the data displayed in the treemap.

Drilling down in a treemap

You can filter down to specific views in a treemap by clicking on category or subcategory rectangles. For rectangles grouped by a hierarchy, as you click on rectangles, you drill down to each level of the hierarchy.



For rectangles grouped by worksheet columns, as you click on rectangles, you drill down through a designated list of data columns. For most treemaps, the list order follows the order of data columns in the Group By lists.



Changing rectangle size and color measures

Some treemaps include additional size and color measures to allow you to change the way the data categories are measured. When additional measures are available, the Size and Color measures are displayed as lists. When you select a new size or color measure, the treemap updates to display the new view of the data.

► Change treemap size or color measures

1. To change the measure on which the rectangle size is based, select a different measure from the **Size** list.
2. To change the measure on which rectangle color is based, select a different measure from the **Color** list.



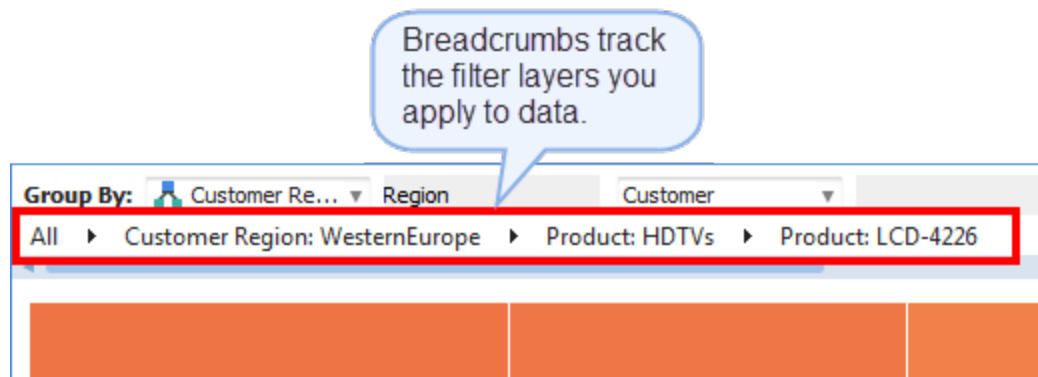
Tip: To view data at one level, without subcategories, select "None" from the right Group By list.



Note: If the treemap does not include additional size or color measures, you cannot select a different size or color measure.

Track data filtering in a treemap

RapidResponse uses breadcrumbs to track the filtering layers you are applying to a treemap. Breadcrumbs display as a sequence of filters, in the order the filter is applied. Each time you change the data view by changing a hierarchy level, data category or subcategory, or drill down in a treemap, a new filter layer is added to the breadcrumb row.



You can return to earlier data views by removing a filter layer. For example, if you have filtered the data in a treemap by drilling down from a customer region (WesternEurope) to a product family (HDTVs) and then product (LCD-4226), you can return to a view of the data filtered by only the customer region by clicking the product family filter layer (WesternEurope) in the breadcrumbs row.

Clicking on a filter layer in a breadcrumb row removes all of the subsequent filter layers.

All ▶ **Customer Region: WesternEurope** ▶ Product: HDTVs ▶ Product: LCD-4226 ➡ All ▶ Customer Region: WesternEurope

► **Return to an earlier data view in a treemap**

- In the breadcrumbs row, click an earlier filter layer.

► **Return to the original data view in a treemap**

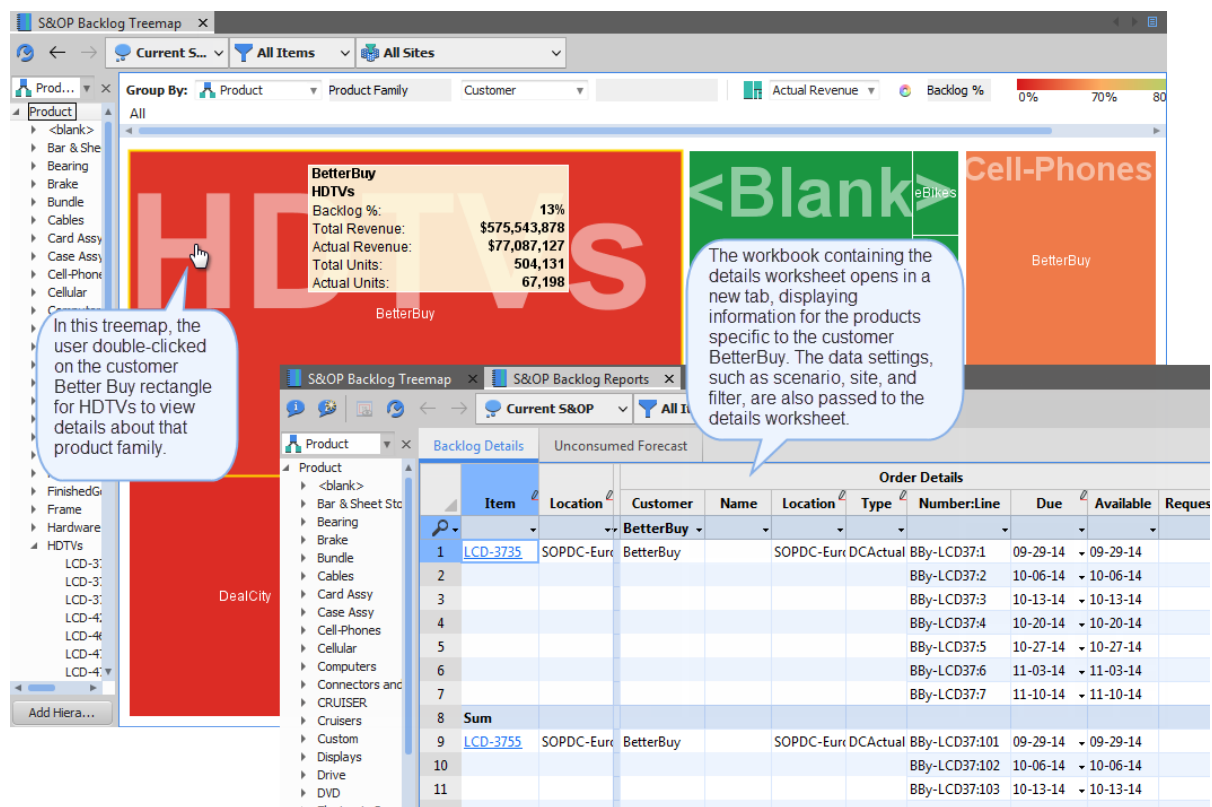
- In the breadcrumbs row, click **All**.

Use a treemap to drill to details

You might be able to click problem areas in a treemap worksheet to drill to more details. When drilling to details is enabled, the pointer changes to a hand icon when you position it over treemap rectangles. When you double-click on a rectangle, a detail worksheet opens for you to view data summarized by that rectangle. The way data is summarized in the detail worksheet depends on how the resource author defined the drilling to details process for the treemap; data can either be summarized by container or nested rectangles. Additionally, the data settings for the treemap worksheet, such as filter, site, and scenario, might also be passed to the detail worksheet.

Drilling to details is a subsequent step in a typical task flow in which you use the treemap to identify problem areas, and then drill to a worksheet to view details and possibly resolve the problem.

When you drill to details, a details worksheet opens in either the lower pane, a new tab, or in a separate workbook. In the example below, the details worksheet opens in a new tab:



► Drill to details in a treemap

- Move the pointer over a rectangle in the treemap and double-click to open a details worksheet.

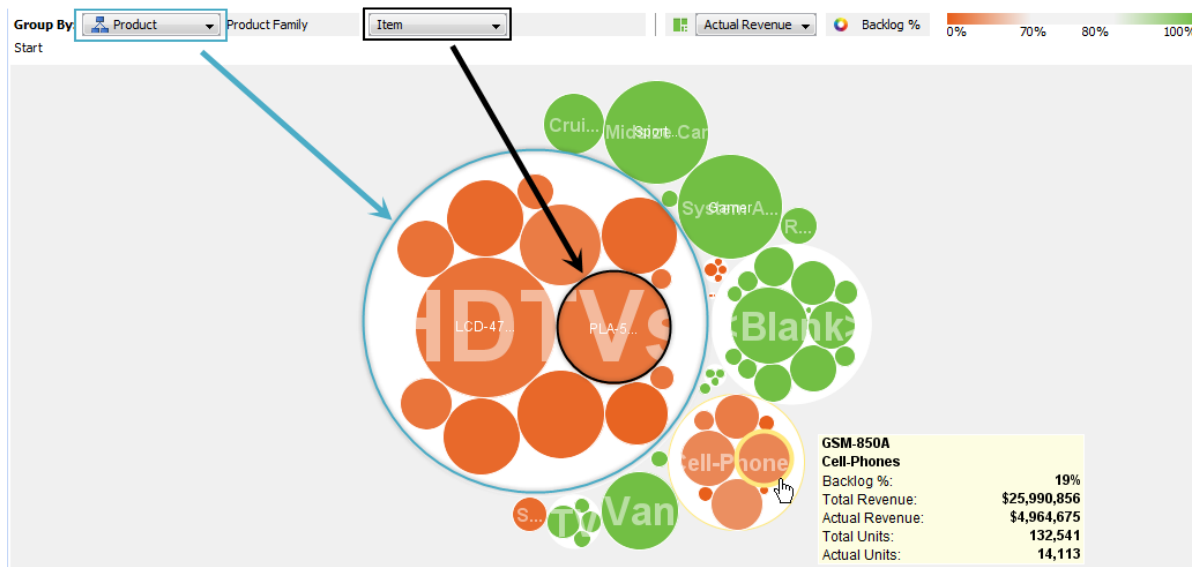


Notes:

- Some treemaps might open a form when you click on a treemap category or subcategory rectangle. For more information, see ["Link to different resources from a worksheet" on page 181](#).
- When you drills to details from a treemap category or sub-category, the hierarchy settings applied to the category or sub-category are passed to the details worksheet. For categories or sub-categories with no hierarchy applied, the hierarchy from the treemap worksheet is passed to the details worksheet.

View data in a circular treemap

Treemaps can also be displayed as circles. In a circular treemap, data categories are represented by container and nested circles. Color and size metrics are applied in the same way to a circular treemap. However, because circles do not nest perfectly within other circles, a circular treemap does not use space as efficiently as rectangular treemaps. In the treemap below, container circles are indicated as a white circle, and nested circles have the green, gray, and orange color range applied.



Copy, print, and save a treemap

You can copy, print, and save a treemap to use in other documents, presentations, or web pages.

► Copy a treemap

- Right-click on a treemap and select **Copy Treemap**.

► Print a treemap

1. On the **File** menu, click **Print**.
2. In the **Print** dialog box, click **OK**.



Tip: You can also print a treemap by right-clicking on it and selecting **Print Treemap**.

► Save a treemap as an image

1. On the **File** menu, click **Save Treemap**.
2. In the **Save Treemap** dialog box, navigate to the location where you want to save the treemap.
3. In the **File name** box, type a name for the file.
4. In the **Files of type** list, click the image type that you want to save the treemap as.
5. Click **Save**.



Tip: You can also save a treemap by right-clicking on it and selecting **Save Treemap**.

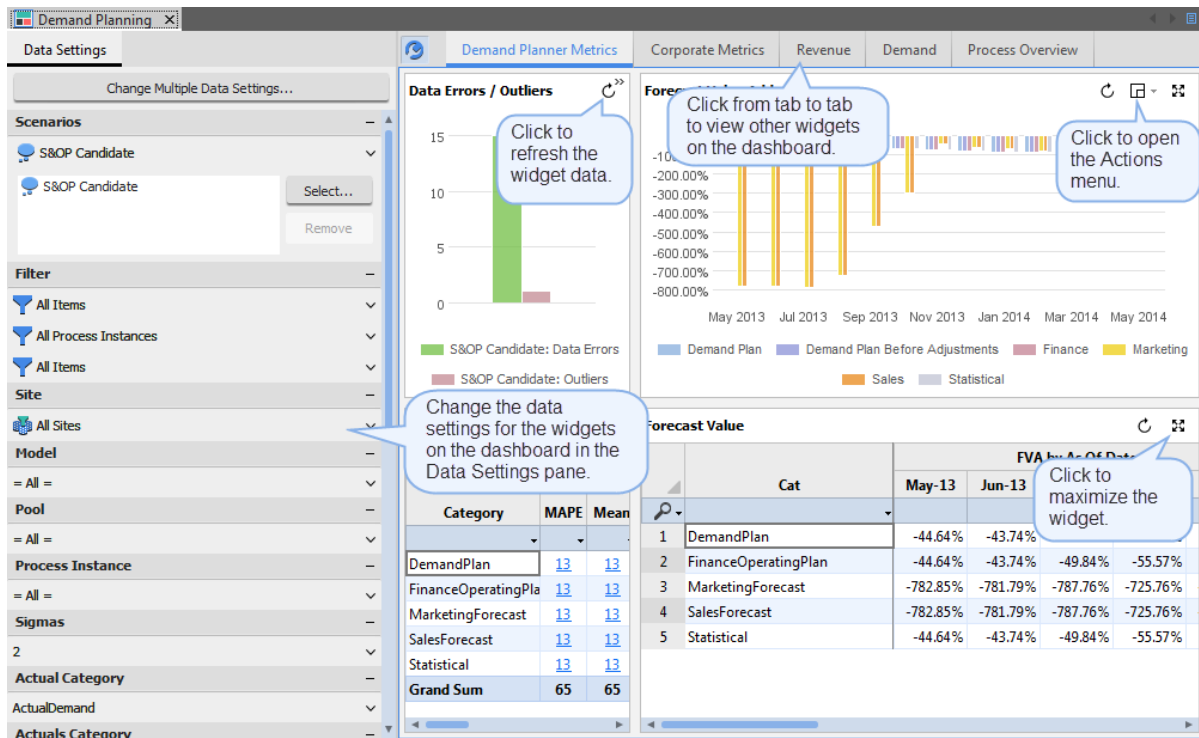
CHAPTER 19: Viewing data in dashboards

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Dashboards are summarized views that help you monitor business performance categories important to you. Data and charts are displayed in components called widgets, which are assembled in an easy-to-understand control panel view. Dashboards can display widgets on multiple tabs, with widgets grouped by type, theme, or use on each tab. You can drill to more detailed data on a dashboard by clicking a widget to open another resource, such as a treemap or source worksheet, where you can view and correct the root cause of a problem area. For more information, see ["Drill from a widget" on page 260](#).

Dashboards are for monitoring purposes only, however the data settings for widgets can be modified. You can control the data displayed in a widget by selecting different data settings like scenario or hierarchy. All of the widgets on the dashboard can display a specific set of data settings or you can define different data settings for individual widgets. To see what data settings have been applied to the dashboard you can hover over a widget or over a data setting to highlight the matching data settings or widgets. For more information, see ["Data settings in dashboards" on page 265](#).

The following is an example of a dashboard with key tools noted.



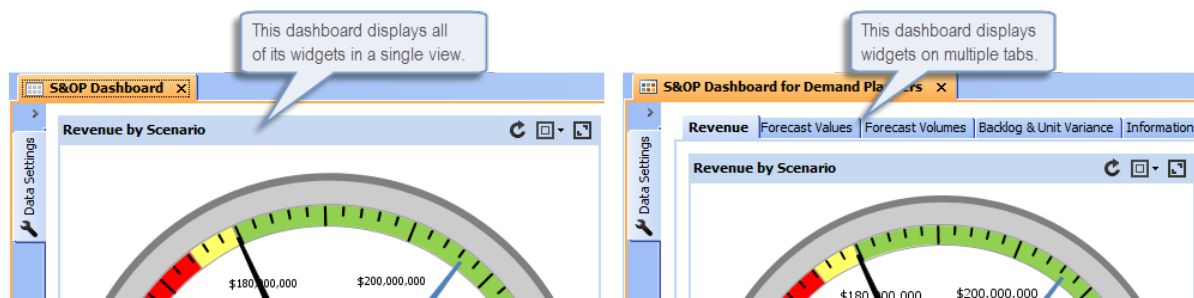
You might have access to multiple dashboards, each of which are designed to help you oversee different areas of performance. You can only access dashboards that you have created if you have dashboard authoring permission, or that have been shared with you. When a dashboard is shared with you, all of the underlying resources are also shared. This includes the widgets in the dashboard, the workbooks containing the source worksheets for widgets, and any linked resources such as other dashboards, workbooks, scorecards, and task flows. These underlying resources cannot be opened directly from the Explorer; they are only available from within the dashboard. For more information, see ["Open a linked resource from a dashboard widget" on page 259](#).

If you have dashboard authoring permission, you can create a personalized dashboard by changing the widgets in the dashboard and the dashboard layout. For more information, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

Open a dashboard

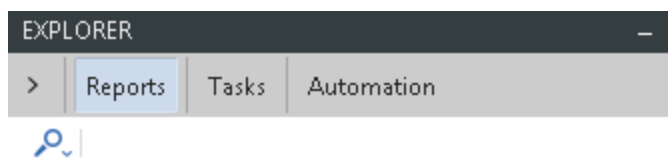
You might have access to multiple dashboards that might be specific to your role in your company and to your company's business processes. RapidResponse also includes several predefined dashboards that your RapidResponse administrator might make available to you. For more information, see ["Introduction to RapidResponse resources" on page 18](#).

Dashboards might open automatically when you log in to RapidResponse, or they might be accessible from the Explorer



► Open a dashboard from the Explorer

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that dashboards are shown. You can do this by selecting **Reports**.



2. Double-click a dashboard.



Tip: You can also open a dashboard by selecting the dashboard and clicking **Open** on the **Actions** menu.



Note: You might be prompted to specify data settings for the dashboard before it opens.

► Open a dashboard in another tab

You can open another instance of an already opened dashboard on a new tab. For example, you might want to compare the data in the workbook with different data settings applied.

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that dashboards are shown. You can do this by selecting **Reports**.
2. Select a dashboard that is already open.
3. On the **File** menu, click **Open in New Tab**.

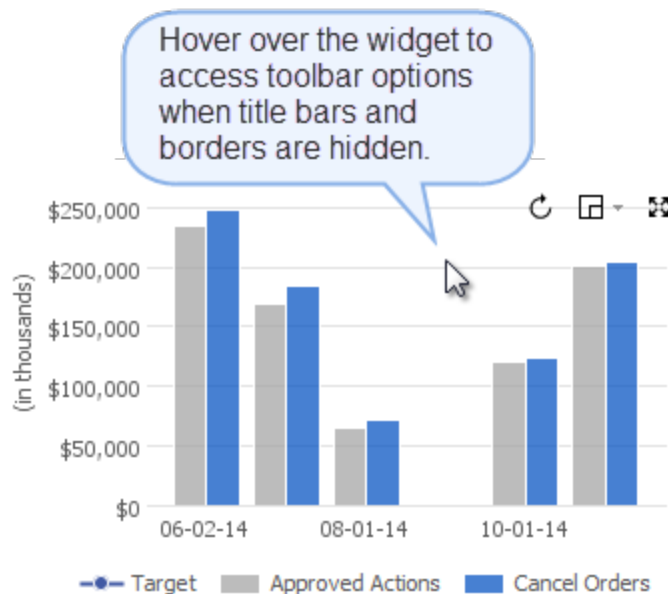


Tip: You can also open the dashboard in another tab by right-clicking on the open dashboard in the **Explorer** and then clicking **Open in New Tab**.

About widgets

Widgets display summarized data in the form of charts, worksheets, or reports. You can modify the data settings of widgets to view and compare different scenarios, sites, filters, and hierarchies. If you have widget authoring permission, you can create and modify widgets. For more information, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

If the widget has a hidden title bar and borders, hover over the widget to display the widget options.



Widget types

Dashboard widgets fall into three categories:

Worksheet widgets

Worksheet widgets are based on worksheets in RapidResponse workbooks. This widget type can be a worksheet data grid, worksheet chart, or treemap widget. You can perform the same actions in a worksheet widgets as you would in a regular worksheet, depending on how the worksheet was defined. You can sort data, change scenarios and other data settings. For worksheet charts, you might be able to change bucket settings, the colors used, and the data series that are charted. In a treemap widget, you can change the Group By options and size and color measures.

Example of a worksheet widget:

Revenue Value	Date						
	Month						
	Jun 2014	Jul 2014	Aug 2014	Sep 2014	Oct 2014	Nov 2014	Dec 2014
Annual Plan	\$195,673,442	\$195,673,442	\$195,673,442	\$185,374,840	\$205,972,056	\$195,673,442	\$194,983,38
Baseline	\$14,013,014	\$16,195,245	\$6,563,529	\$57,467,822	\$370,163,835	\$345,416,133	\$255,450,10

Revenue Value

The same information is presented in a widget based on a worksheet chart.

(in thousands)

\$400,000
\$300,000
\$200,000
\$100,000
\$0

Mar 2014 May 2014 Jul 2014 Sep 2014 Nov 2014 Jan 2015 Mar 2015 May 2015

Annual Plan Baseline

Month	Annual Plan (in thousands)	Baseline (in thousands)
Mar 2014	190,000	230,000
Apr 2014	190,000	230,000
May 2014	190,000	230,000
Jun 2014	200,000	10,000
Jul 2014	200,000	15,000
Aug 2014	200,000	5,000
Sep 2014	190,000	60,000
Oct 2014	210,000	370,000
Nov 2014	200,000	350,000
Dec 2014	200,000	260,000
Jan 2015	410,000	200,000
Feb 2015	200,000	220,000
Mar 2015	190,000	200,000
Apr 2015	190,000	210,000
May 2015	190,000	200,000

S&OP Backlog

Group By: Item Customer Actual Revenue Backlog % 0% 70% 80% 100%

All

The treemap displays the following items and their associated customers:

- LCD-4780P**: BetterBuy, bci
- LCD-4226**: BetterBuy, ShopWo...
- LCD-3775**: DealCity, BetterBuy
- PLA-5032**: BetterBuy, Robucks, FC103
- SportCar**: FastCars
- LCD-3735**: DealCity, ECS, Gamer
- PLA-5048**: Robucks, CircuitTo...
- LCD-4641**: Better..., ShopWorld
- CRUISER**: eBikes
- GSM-850...**: BetterBuy, BestShop
- PLA-425...**: FC103
- GSMce...**: BestShop
- PLA-1037**: Family...
- Cars**: BetterBuy
- GSM-850A**: BetterBuy
- GSM-990N**: BetterBuy
- GSMcell...**: BestShop
- GSM...**: BestS...
- TVD...**: KNX
- PLA...**: bci
- GSM-850A**: ECS
- GSMcell...**: BestShop
- PD...**: ...
- G...**: ...

Text widgets can provide help for a dashboard and might contain meaningful information about the tasks and processes the dashboard supports. Text widgets might include links to workbooks and other resources to help you complete a workflow related to your dashboard.

SCM for Planners and Schedulers

Use this dashboard to review key metrics in selected scenarios and to compare them to targets. The targets are defined according to key corporate metrics.

If business performance areas need further investigation, drill to detailed information to identify the cause of the anomaly.

From this widget, open related resources by clicking , and then clicking a resource. Review the videos to better understand how to use dashboards.

Many widgets available in this dashboard require targets to produce meaningful results. To enter targets for metric categories, click , and then click SCM Targets or SCM Constraint Targets.

Videos

-  [Working with dashboards](#)
-  [Dashboard data settings](#)

The text widget provides dashboard users with a link to a webpage.

Message widgets

Message widgets are a simplified version of Message Center. From a message widget, you can read messages, send messages to your email, and open the full Message Center page. Message widgets can only be viewed if you have the permission to Message Center. For more information on Message Center, see ["Communicating using Message Center" on page 437](#).

Messages

	From	Subject	Received
	RapidResponse	Welcome to RapidResp...	01-05-15 11:10...

A message widget displays a simplified version of Message Center. You can read your messages from the widget and open the full version of Message Center.

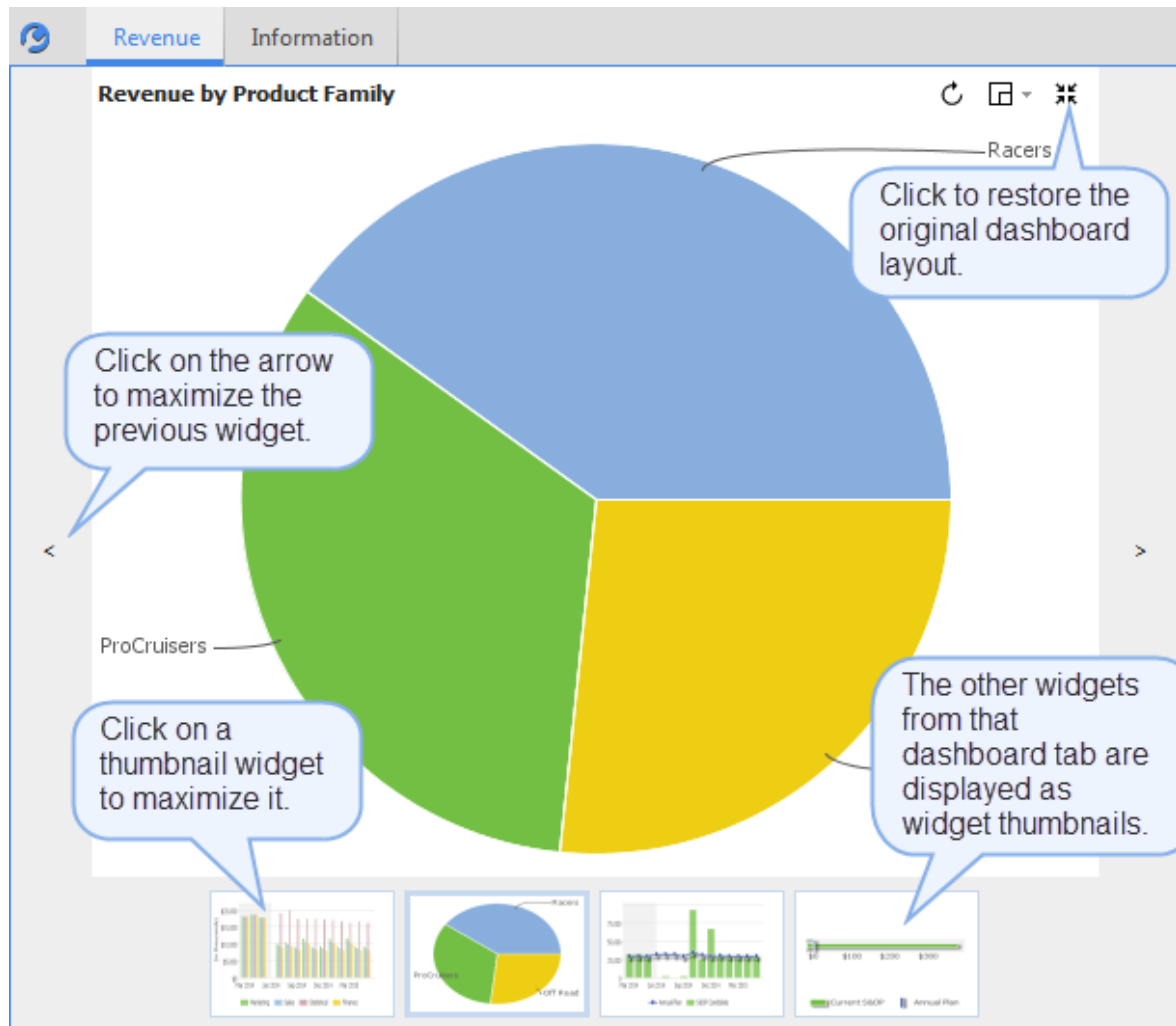
Magnify a widget

There are two ways to make the contents of widgets easier to see. You can maximize a widget so that it takes up most of the space on the dashboard, and in some types of widgets, you can zoom in on the contents of the widget without changing its overall size.

Maximizing widgets

You might find that a widget is too small to view the data. You can maximize any widget in a dashboard so that it fills most of the page, and the other widgets are shown as thumbnails below the maximized

widget.



► Maximize a widget

1. In a widget title bar, click **Maximize Widget** .
2. To restore the widget size, in the widget title bar, click **Minimize Widget** .

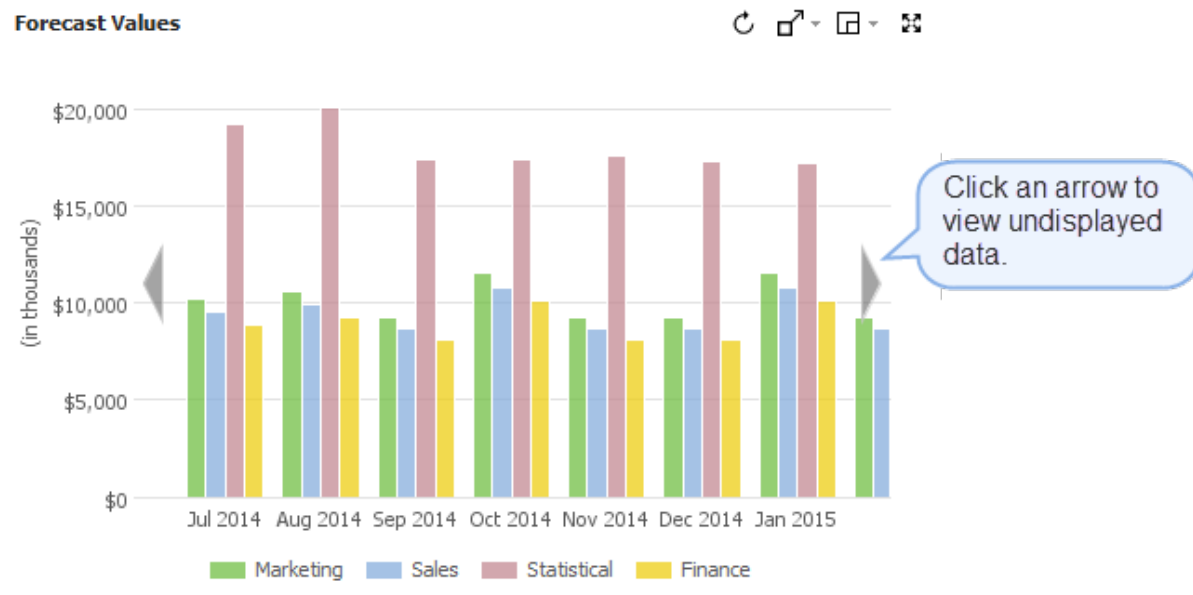


Tip: You can also maximize a widget by double-clicking the widget title bar. Double-click the title bar again to restore the widget to its position in the dashboard.

Widget zooming

For some chart widgets, you can zoom in to more easily view individual data points. When you zoom in to a chart widget, arrows appear at the edges of the chart to indicate that there is additional data that is

not being displayed. You can also pan back and forth to view the areas of the chart that are not displayed. You can pan or zoom to a widget when the widget is on the dashboard or is maximized.



You can use zoom controls to adjust the text size in a worksheet data widget, just like you can in a worksheet in a workbook. For more information, see ["Adjust a worksheet's zoom level" on page 136](#).



Note: You cannot zoom in to pie charts, gauge charts, or bullet charts.

► Zoom in to a chart widget

1. Click to select the chart widget on the dashboard.
2. Move the pointer over the chart widget you want to zoom in to, and then move the mouse wheel up to zoom.
3. To zoom back out, move the mouse wheel down.



Note: You can also zoom into a chart widget that has been maximized.



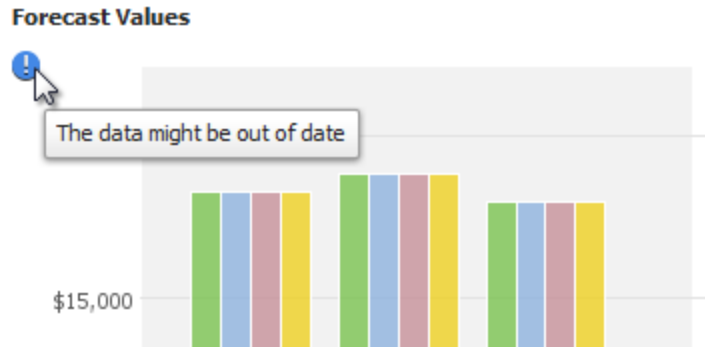
Tip: You can also zoom in and out by right-clicking in a line, bar, or area chart and selecting **Zoom in** and **Zoom out**. If the widget has drill links, clicking on a data point opens the resource or a menu where you select which resource to drill to.

► Pan back and forth in a chart widget

1. Click on a chart widget to select it.
2. Click and hold anywhere in the chart area, then drag the pointer to pan to the left or right.

Refresh widget data

When a data change impacts an open widget's source worksheet, you will need to refresh the widget to see the most current data displayed. A message might display on any widgets that might have data that is out of date.



You can also manually refresh all of the widgets on the dashboard by refreshing the dashboard. It is a good practice to manually refresh the dashboard if you have the dashboard open for a period of time.

► Manually refresh a widget

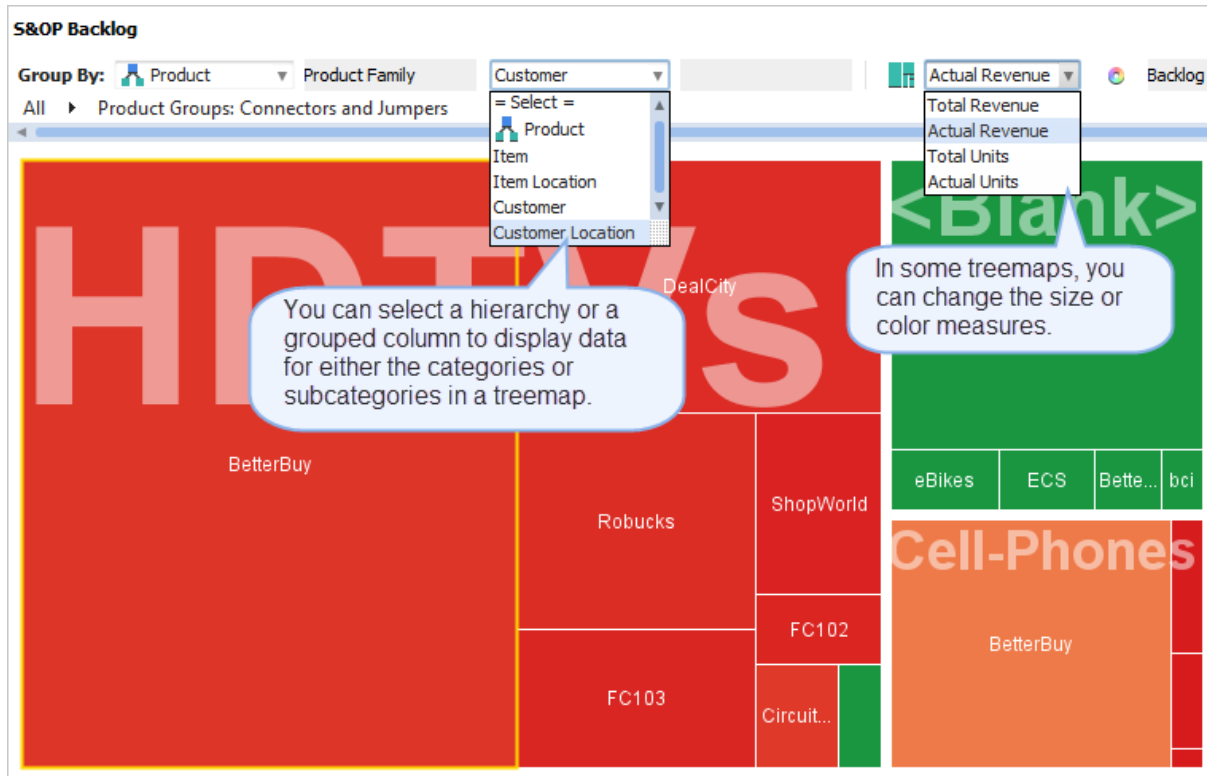
- Click  on the widget toolbar.

► Manually refresh a dashboard

- Click  on the dashboard toolbar.

View data in a treemap widget

In addition to changing data settings to filter the data view in a treemap widget, you can also change the Group By dimensions and size or color measures. The left Group By list determines the category for container rectangles, and the right Group By list determines the category for nested rectangles. Every time you make a new selection from one of these lists, the treemap updates to display the new view of the data set. For more information, see "[Change the data views in a treemap](#)" on page 238.



► Change the categories and subcategories in a treemap

1. Click the first **Group By** list and select a data category to display.
2. Click the second **Group By** list and select a subcategory to display.

► Select a hierarchy as a category or subcategory

1. Select the hierarchy in the data settings for the treemap.
2. Depending on whether you want to display hierarchy data in the category or subcategory rectangles, do one of the following:
 - To display hierarchy data in the category rectangles, click the first **Group By** list and select the hierarchy.
 - To display hierarchy data in the subcategory rectangles, click the second **Group By** list and select the hierarchy.

► Change the size or color measures in a treemap

In some treemaps, you can change the size or color measures.

1. To change the color measure, click the **Color** list and select the color measure to display.
2. To change the size measure, click the **Size** list and select the color measure to display.

Drill down in a treemap widget

You can filter to specific data views in a treemap by drilling down from category or subcategory rectangles. For most treemaps, the drill down path follows either a hierarchy or the order of data columns in the Group By lists.

Breadcrumbs track the filtering layers you are applying to a treemap with the filters displaying in the order each filter is applied. Each time you change the data view, such as drilling down or changing a category, a new filter layer is added to the breadcrumb row. For more information, see "[Change the data views in a treemap](#)" on page 238 and "[Track data filtering in a treemap](#)" on page 245.

► Drill down in a treemap

1. Depending on how you want to drill down in the treemap data, do one of the following:
 - To drill down in the category list, click on the bar for a category rectangle.
 - To drill down in the subcategory list, click on a subcategory rectangle.
 - To drill down in the hierarchy, select the hierarchy levels in the hierarchy pane. For more information, see "[Filter and summarize data with hierarchies](#)" on page 304.
2. Continue to drill down successively in a treemap until you have reached the end of the drill



Tip: You can also drill down in a hierarchy if you specify the hierarchy as a category or subcategory and then drill down in the treemap.

► Return to an earlier view of the data

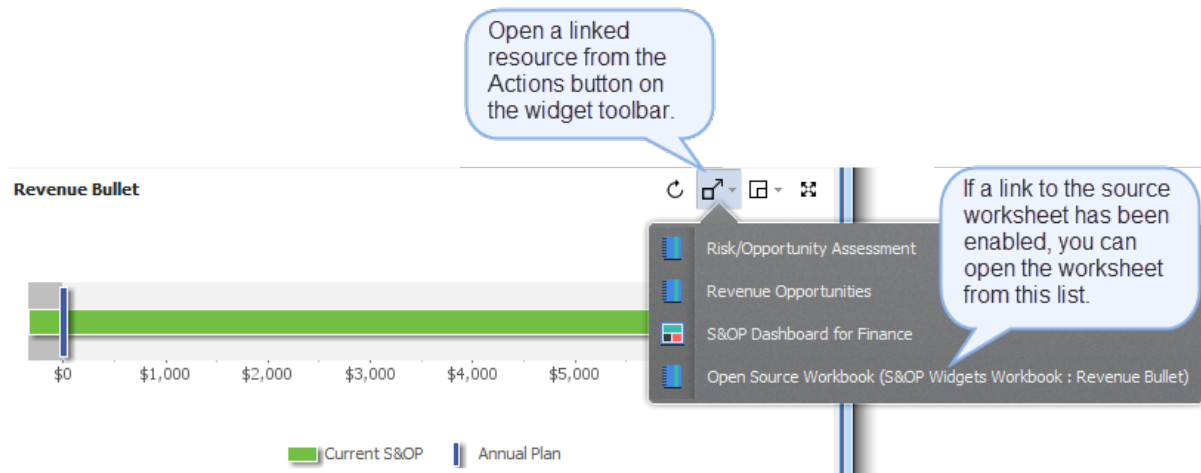
- Click an earlier filter layer in the breadcrumbs row.

► Return to the original view of the data

- Click **All** in the breadcrumbs row.

Open a linked resource from a dashboard widget

Worksheet and text widgets might allow you to open a linked resource, such as workbooks, dashboards, scorecards, and task flows. If a linked resource is available for a widget, the Open button is available on the widget title bar. Linked resources are only available from the dashboard; you cannot access them from the Explorer. The source worksheet that the widget is based on may also be displayed with linked resources.



For more information about linked resources, see ["Resources that can only be opened from links"](#) on page 88.

► Open a linked resource

- In the worksheet widget title bar, click **Open** and select the resource to open.

Drill from a widget

Some worksheet data and chart widgets might allow you to drill to more detailed information in a worksheet, or to open a form. When you click on a drill link from a widget, data settings or data values from the widget are passed to the linked resource, which opens in another tab or as an overlay on the dashboard. Depending on the widget type, the method used to drill to linked resources differs.

Drill from a worksheet data widget

You can drill from a worksheet data widget by clicking a link in a data cell. For example, if you click in a cell that displays forecast data for the month of October, the linked worksheet that opens only displays detailed data for that forecast in the October time period. The details worksheet also preserves the scenario, hierarchy level, and other filters from the worksheet widget data settings.

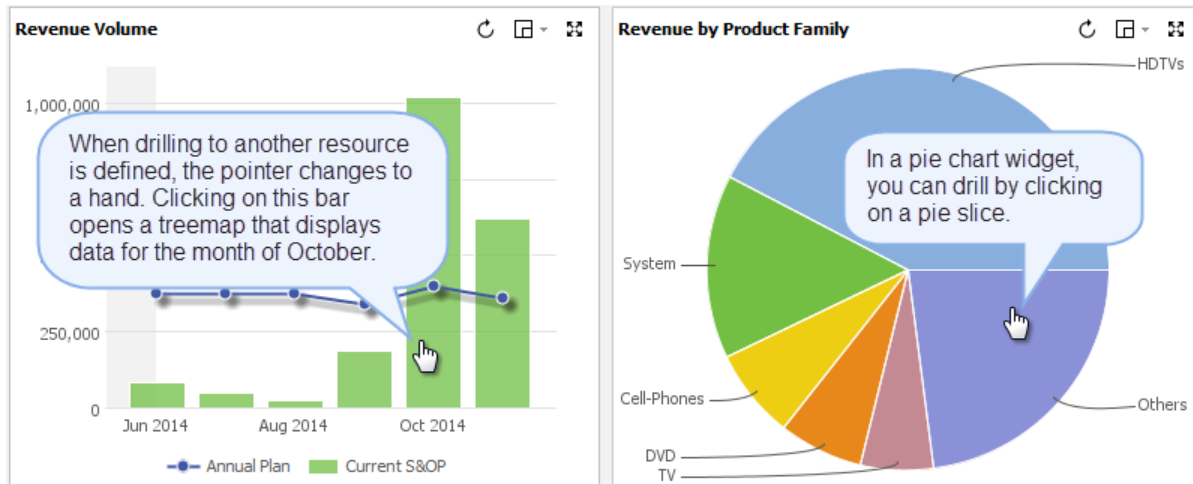
Gross Margin

	Date							
	Month							
	Oct 2014	Nov 2014	Dec 2014	Jan 2015	Feb 2015	Mar 2015	Apr 2015	May 2015
Annual Plan	\$1,591,203	\$3,471,707	\$86,769	\$6,652,277	\$3,181,524	\$3,181,524	\$3,181,524	\$3,181,524
Baseline	\$3,057,678	\$14,495,064	\$22,810,895	\$8,084,660	\$8,084,660	\$8,084,660	\$8,077,569	\$8,077,268



Drill from a worksheet chart widget

You can drill from a chart widgets by clicking on a chart element such as a line marker in a line chart or a needle in a gauge chart. If drilling is defined for that chart widget, the pointer changes to a hand when you hover over a charting element.



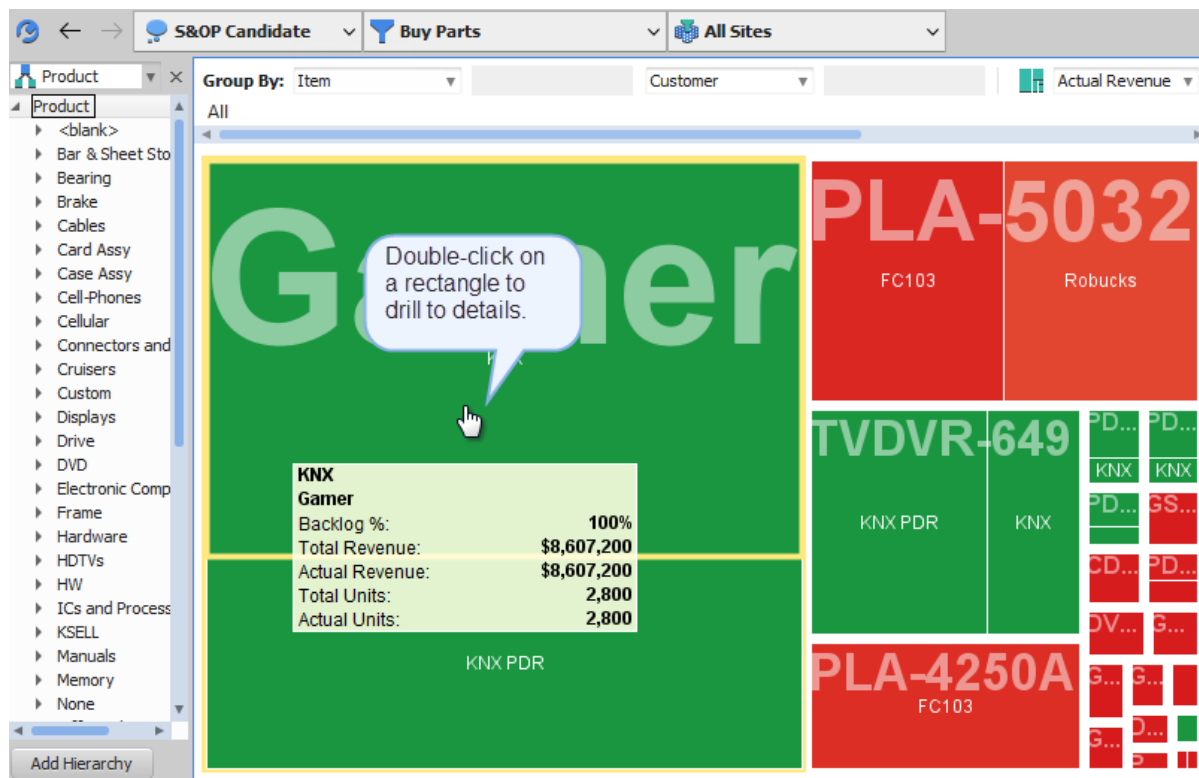
1. In a chart widget, hover the pointer a charting element, such as:
 - a data point in a line, bar, or area chart;
 - a slice in a pie chart;
 - a needle in a gauge chart
2. Click to open the linked resource in another tab or as an overlay on the dashboard.



Note: You cannot drill from data points in scatter charts.

Drill from a treemap widget

You can drill from a treemap widget by double-clicking on a category or subcategory rectangle. The drill to details worksheet opens in a new tab in the workbook.



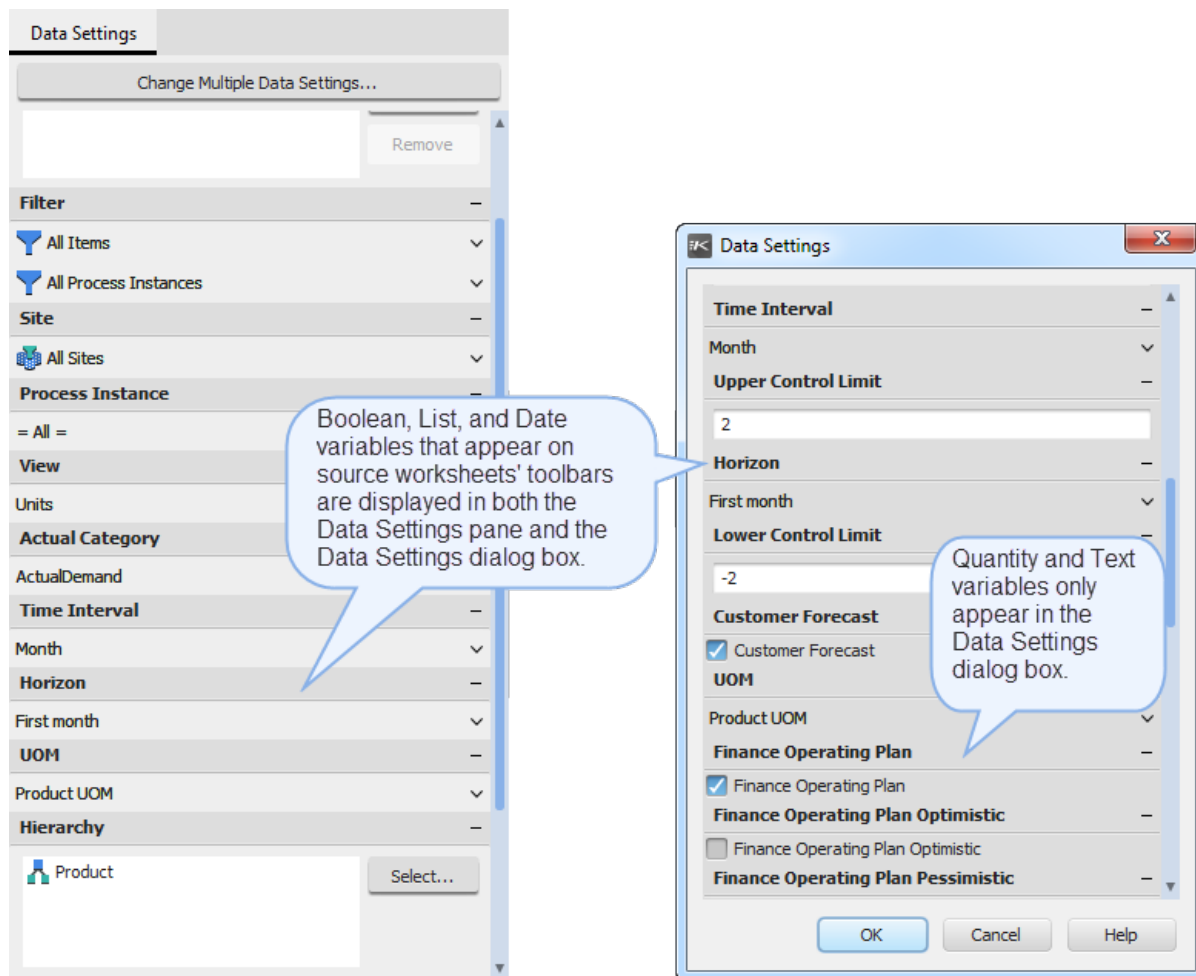
Note: Single-clicking on a category or subcategory rectangle drills down in the treemap. For more information, see "[Change the data views in a treemap](#)" on page 238.

CHAPTER 20: Data settings in dashboards

View data dashboard settings	267
Change data settings for a dashboard	269
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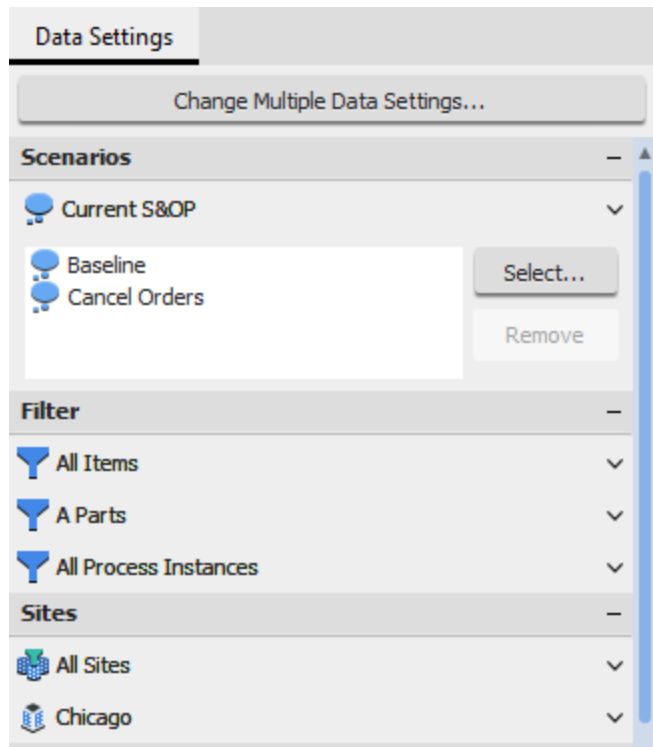
Dashboard are created with predefined settings that you can change to customize your view of data on the dashboard. Data settings are applied to individual widgets, however you can modify data settings that are shared by multiple widgets on a dashboard. For example, some of the widgets on a dashboard might display data for the Approved Actions scenario. When you change that scenario to Current S&OP, those widgets will change to display data from the Current S&OP scenario.

Data settings are accessed and display in the Data Settings pane or dialog box.



When you open a dashboard for the first time, the data settings pane might be hidden if the author has created the dashboard to display that way. Expand the Data Settings pane to view and modify the settings for the dashboard and for individual widgets.

For dashboards, all of the data settings applied to widgets on the dashboard are displayed and you might see multiple controls for some data settings. When different widgets on a dashboard carry a different data setting, each setting is displayed in the dashboard's data settings.



Notes:

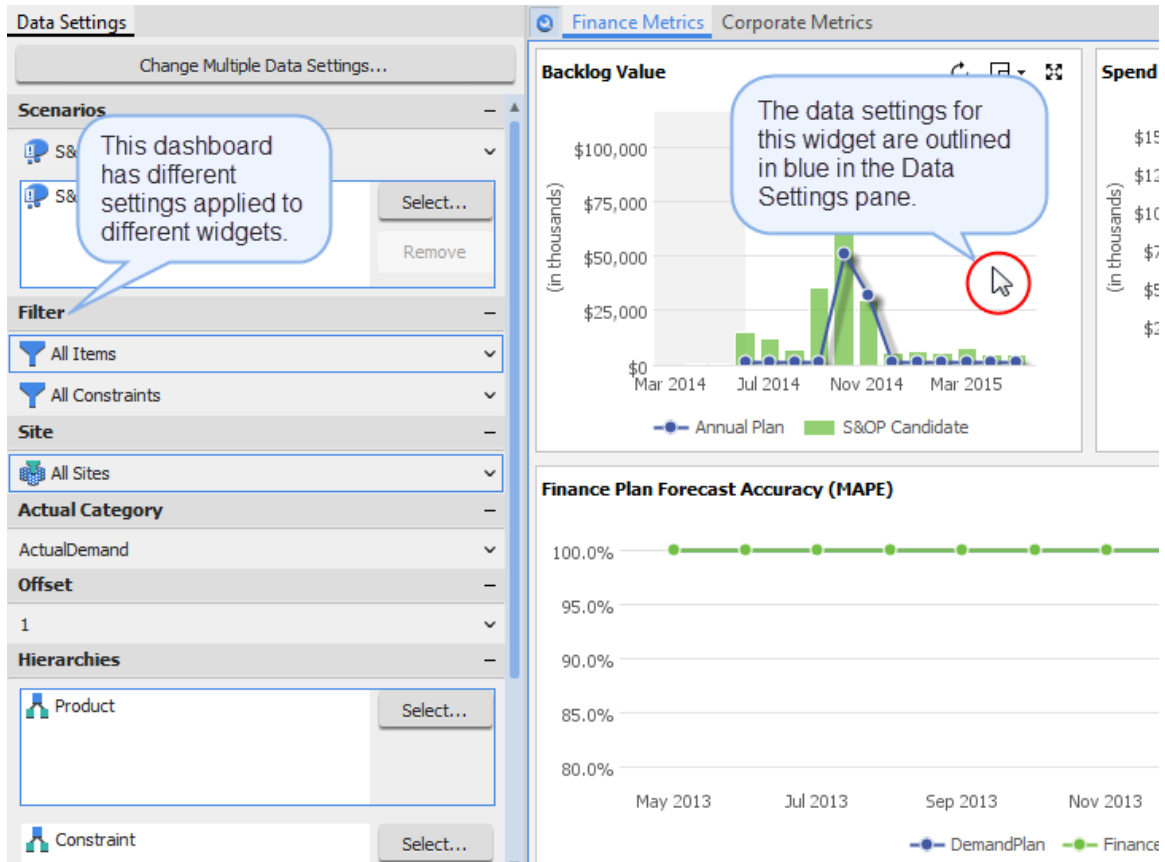
- The Data Settings pane might be empty if you cannot modify data settings. This might occur if you do not have access to multiple data settings such as scenarios, filters, and sites.
- After opening a dashboard for the first time, RapidResponse will remember your display preference for the Data Settings pane and accordingly the dashboard will open the next with the pane minimized or maximized.

View data dashboard settings

You can determine which data settings have been applied to the widgets on a dashboard by hovering over a data setting or hovering over a widget. The corresponding widget or data setting(s) are outlined in blue.

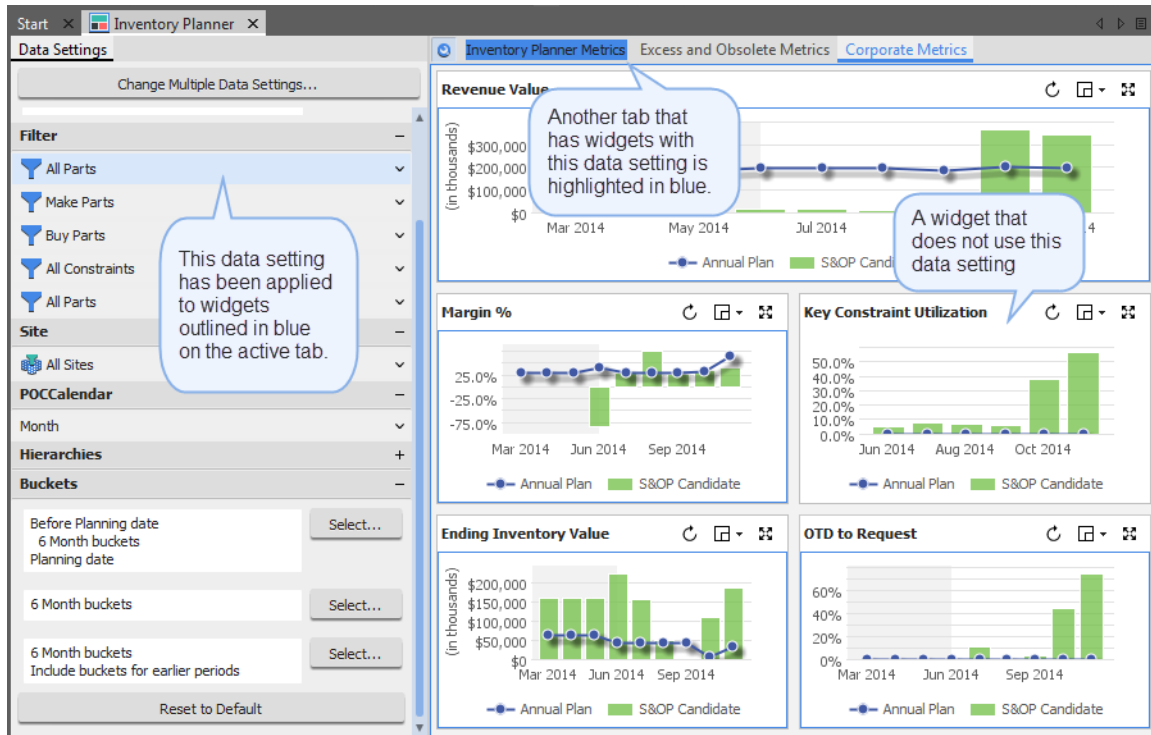
► **View the data settings applied to a widget**

- Hover the cursor over the center of the widget.



► View which widgets carry a specific data setting

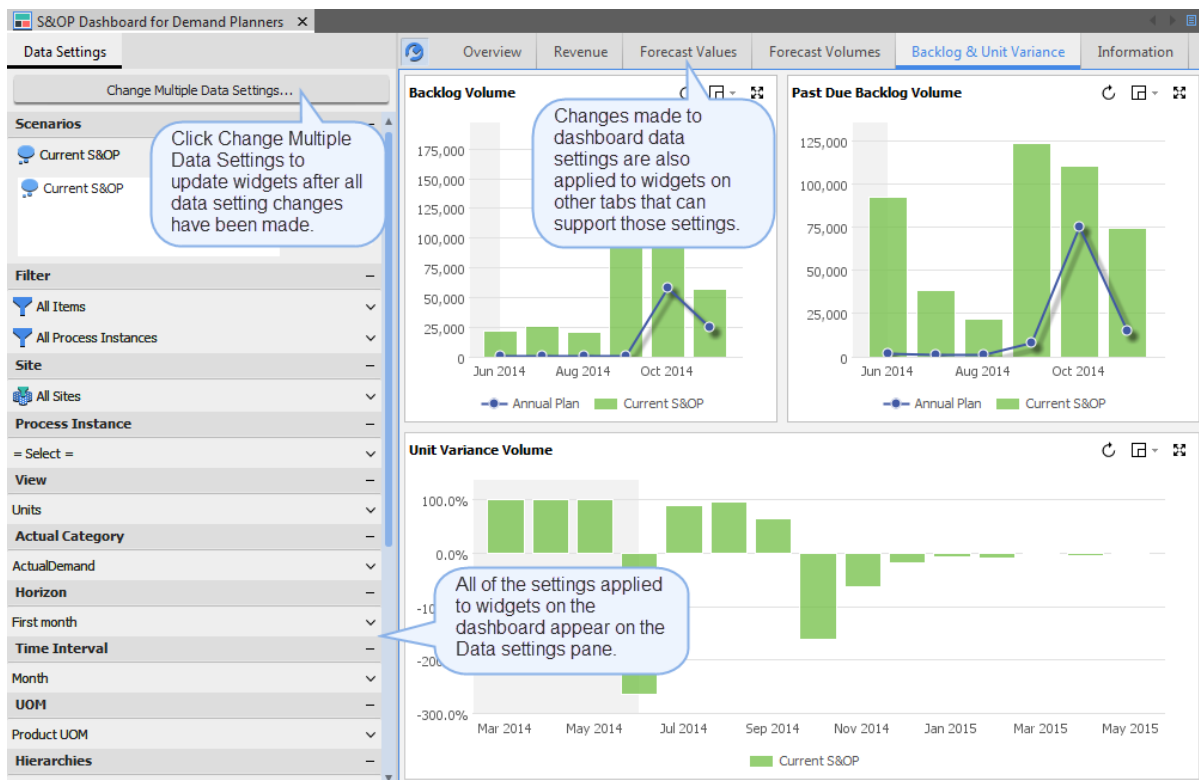
- Hover the cursor over the data setting.



Change data settings for a dashboard

Data settings for all widgets on the dashboard are visible and can be changed in the Data Settings pane. After each change, each widget on the dashboard updates to reflect the new setting. When you are making multiple changes to the data settings for a dashboard, click **Change Multiple Data Settings**. Instead of updating after each individual change, all of the widgets on the dashboard updates after all changes have been made, thereby reducing load times.

For more information on viewing data settings already defined for a dashboard, see ["Data settings in dashboards" on page 265](#).



Notes:

- The dashboard might open with the **Data Settings** pane minimized. Click  or the **Data Settings** tab to expand the pane.
- Changes made to dashboard data settings are maintained when you move between RapidResponse clients. For example, if you change the scenario on a dashboard while working on the Mobile Client and then check that dashboard later on the Desktop Client, the scenario change will be applied to the dashboard.

► Change data settings for widgets on a dashboard

1. Open the dashboard you want to change data settings for.
2. On the **Data Settings** pane, make your data setting changes.
Widgets will automatically update one by one to display the new data setting.



Notes:

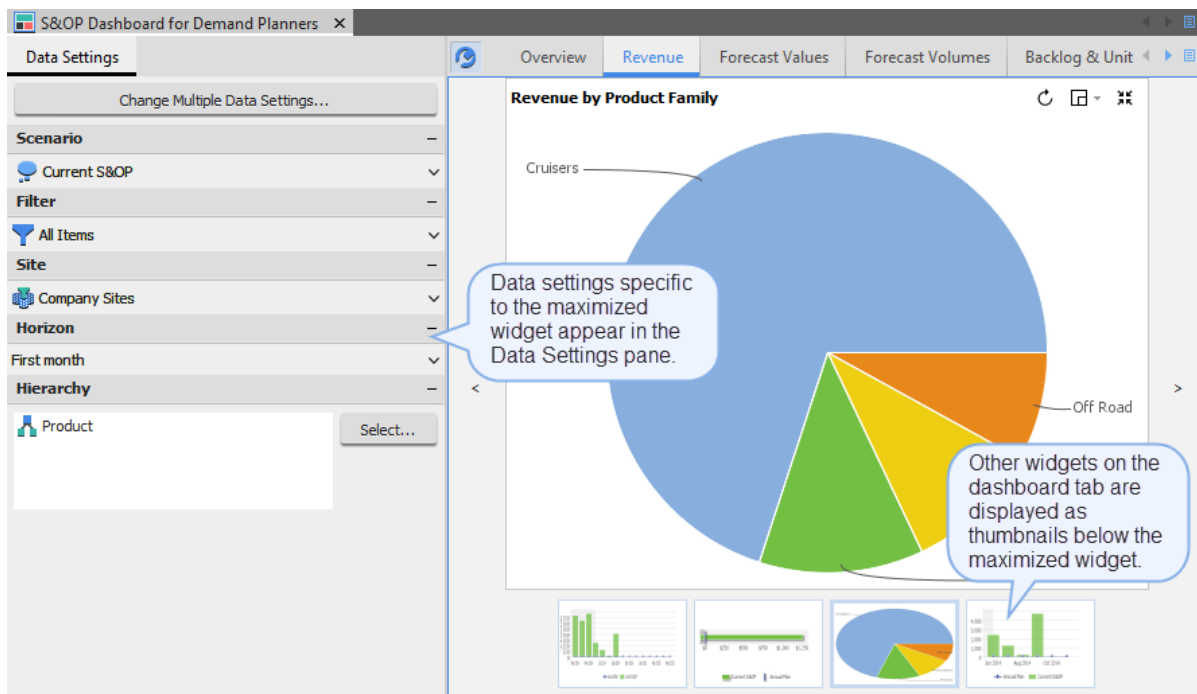
- These new data settings are applied to all the widgets on the dashboard tab that can accept the data settings. To modify data settings for an individual, see ["Change data settings for a widget" on page 271](#).
- To change multiple settings at a time for a dashboard, click **Change Multiple Data Settings** to open the **Data Settings** dialog box. You can make your changes and the dashboard will only update after you click **OK**.

Change data settings for a widget

You can change the data settings applied to a widget by maximizing the widget and then making the changes on the **Data Settings** pane. The widget will update after each change to reflect the new setting. Like dashboards, only Boolean, List, and Date variables might display in the **Data Settings** pane. Quantity and Text variables available for a widget only display in the **Data Settings** dialog box.

When you are making multiple changes to the data settings for a widget, click **Change Multiple Data Settings**. Instead of updating after each individual change, the widget updates after all changes have been made, thereby reducing load times.

For more information about viewing data settings already defined for a widget, see ["Data settings in dashboards" on page 265](#).



Note: The **Data Settings** pane might be minimized. Click **>** or the **Data Settings** tab to expand the pane.

► Change data settings for an individual widget

1. Select the widget on the dashboard to change data settings for.
2. Maximize the widget by clicking **Maximize Widget** on the widget title bar.
3. On the **Data Settings** pane, make your data setting changes.
The widget will automatically update and display the new data setting after each change.
4. To return to the dashboard after you have made your changes, click **Minimize Widget** or if the dashboard has multiple tabs, click on the tab title.



Note: To change multiple settings at a time for a widget, click **Change Multiple Data Settings** to open the **Data Settings** dialog box. You can make your changes and the widget will only update after you click **OK**.



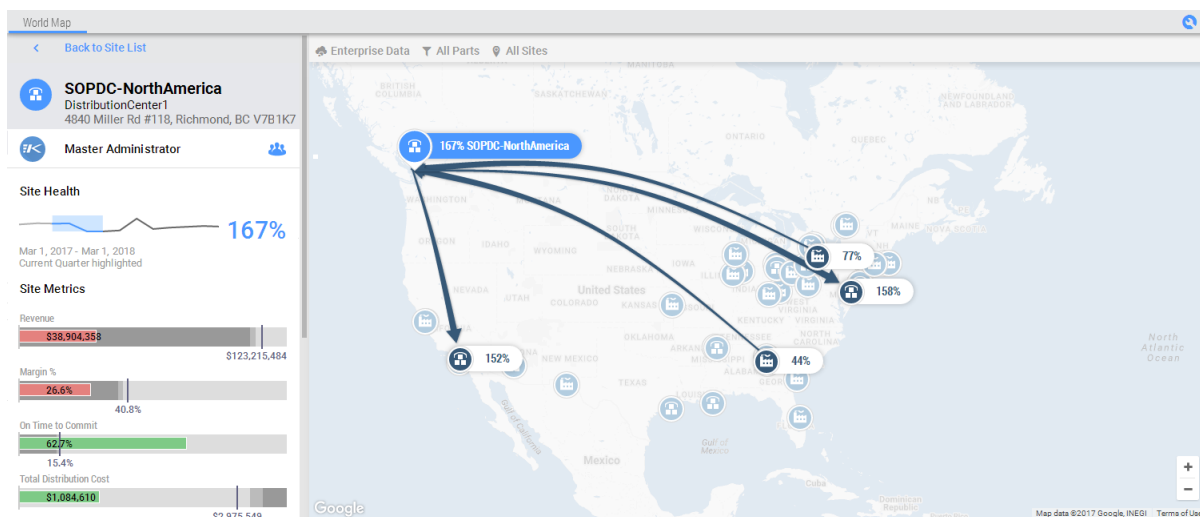
Tip: You can also double-click on the widget title bar to maximize the widget.

CHAPTER 21: Viewing data in a map

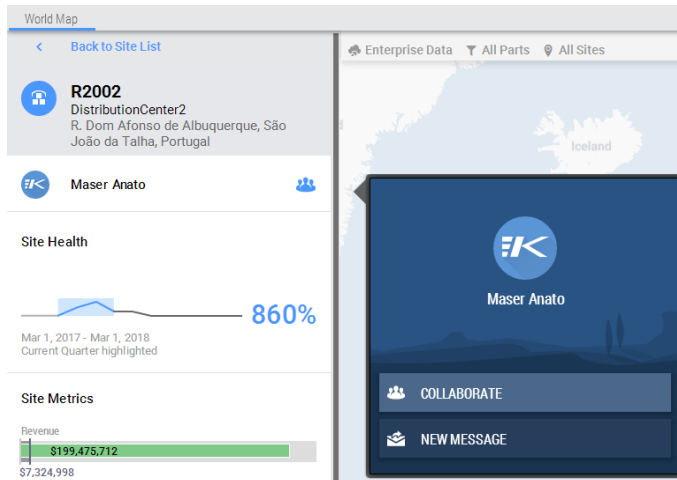
View site data	274
Navigate on a map	275
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Refresh map data	277
Communicate from a map	277

You can monitor the health of your supply chain by tracking and viewing information for sites on a RapidResponse map. Data for your distribution and manufacturing sites display, enabling you to view the geographical context and connections between sites.

The arrows identify which direction goods flow between linked sites and you can navigate in the maps to focus on specific areas or view sites in a broader geographical setting. For more information, see ["Navigate on a map" on page 275](#).



You can focus on individual sites and communicate and collaborate with other colleagues to resolve issues. For more information, see ["Communicate from a map" on page 277](#).



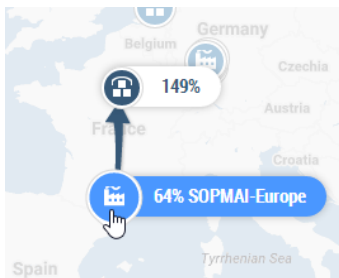
As with other dashboards, you can change the data settings to customize your view of data on the map. For more information, see ["Change data settings on a map" on page 275](#).

View site data

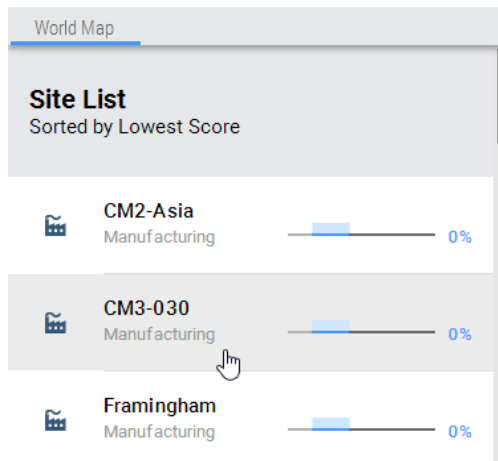
Maps display data for manufacturing and distribution sites. You can focus on the health of individual sites and move from site to site using either the map or the side pane.

► To view data for a site

- Do one of the following:
 - Click a site icon on the map.



- Click a site in the **Site List** widget.



► To return to the main site list

- Click **◀ Back to Site List**.

Navigate on a map

You can navigate in different ways on a map. You can zoom in to focus on sites in a specific area, zoom out to view sites in a broader geographical context, or move around on the map at whichever level of zoom you have specified.

► Zoom in to a map

- Do one of the following:
 - Click in the map area and scroll the mouse wheel up.
 - Click the **Zoom in** button.

► Zoom out of a map

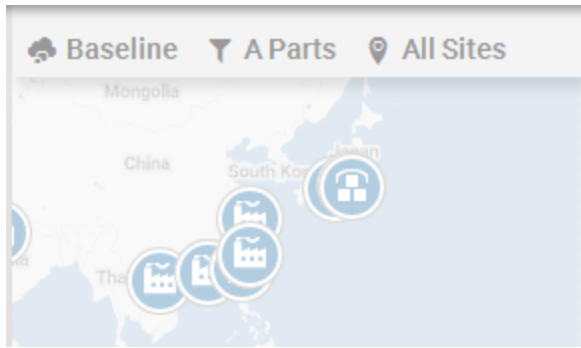
- Do one of the following:
 - Click in the map area and scroll the mouse wheel down.
 - Click the **Zoom out** button.

► Pan through a map

1. Click in the map area.
2. Click and drag the mouse in any direction on the map.

Change data settings on a map

The data settings applied to a map display in the Data Settings widget at the top of the dashboard.



► Change data settings on a map

1. Do one of the following:
 - Click the **Data Settings** widget at the top left of the map.
 - Click **Data Settings**  at the top right of the map.
2. In the **Settings** pane, click the data setting you want to change.
3. Select a new setting option.
4. Click .
5. Repeat steps 2 - 4 for each data setting you want to change.
For each change, the Data Settings widget automatically updates to display the new settings.
6. Click  to close the **Settings** pane.

► Add a hierarchy on a map

1. Do one of the following:
 - Click the **Data Settings** widget at the top left of the map.
 - Click **Data Settings**  at the top right of the map.
2. In the **Settings** pane, click +.
3. Click .
4. Click  to close the **Settings** pane.

► Add a hierarchy level on a map

1. Do one of the following:
 - Click the **Data Settings** widget at the top left of the map.
 - Click **Data Settings**  at the top right of the map.
2. Click All > next to the hierarchy you want to select a level in.
3. Do one of the following:
4. Select a level setting.
5. Click > to view sub-level settings.
6. Click  to return to the previous hierarchy level or click  to return to the top hierarchy level.
7. Click  to close the **Settings** pane.

► Remove a hierarchy setting from a map

1. Do one of the following:
 - Click the **Data Settings** widget at the top left of the map.
 - Click **Data Settings**  at the top right of the map.
2. In the **Settings** pane, click  next to the hierarchy setting.
3. Click  to close the **Settings** pane.

► Reset data settings on a map

At any time, you can return to the original data settings for the map.

1. Do one of the following:
 - Click the **Data Settings** widget at the top left of the map.
 - Click **Data Settings**  at the top right of the map.
2. In the **Settings** pane, click **Reset to Default**.

Refresh map data

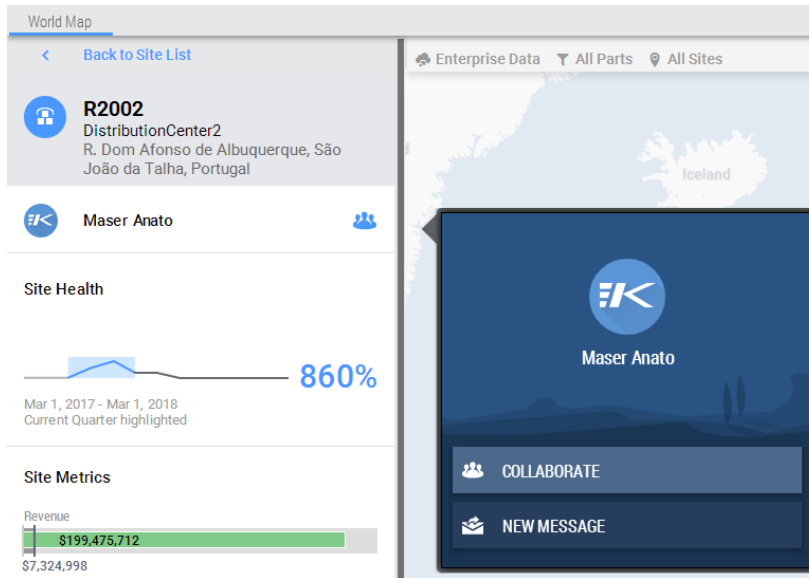
Map data might become out of date when data is updated on your company's enterprise system or another user updates data in a shared scenario you are viewing. When this happens, you can refresh the map data to ensure you are viewing the most up-to-date information.

► To refresh map data

1. Do one of the following:
 - Click the **Data Settings** widget at the top left of the map.
 - Click **Data Settings**  at the top right of the map.
2. Click **Refresh**.

Communicate from a map

You have the ability to communicate with other RapidResponse users from a map. Users responsible for specific sites have an accessible contact card that allows you to send them messages that display in Message Center or to initiate a collaboration with them.



► To send a message from a map

1. Do one of the following:
 - Click a site icon on the map.
 - Click a site in the **Site List** widget.
2. Click the user you want to send a message to.
3. In the contact card, click **New Message**.
4. Optionally, select additional recipients of the message.
5. Add text in the **Message** box to explain why you are sending the message.
6. Optionally, add one or more links to the message or attach a report.
7. Click **Send**.

► To start a collaboration from a map

1. Do one of the following:
 - Click a site icon on the map.
 - Click a site in the **Site List** widget.
2. Click the user you want to start a collaboration with.
3. Click **Collaborate**.

CHAPTER 22: Viewing scorecard data

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Depending on your role within your organization, you might have access to scorecards. Scorecards incorporate various metrics that measure key performance aspects of select scenarios, including customer impact, costs, and quality. Scorecards show the scores for different metric results for various scenarios. You specify the filter, site, hierarchy settings and so on that define the data a scorecard analyzes, as well as the scenarios to be compared.

You access and organize scorecards in the Explorer. For more information about Scorecards are defined by users who have scorecard authoring permissions; if you require changes in a scorecard, contact the person who created the scorecard, or your RapidResponse administrator.

Each metric in a scorecard usually links to detailed information about how the metric's result is calculated. For more information, see "[Drill to worksheets and forms from scorecards](#)" on page 288. You can view information about the scorecard and the metrics it calculates by clicking **Scorecard Help** on the **Help** menu.

Scorecard comparing scenario metric results against targets

Scorecards can include metric targets, against which the metric results of a scenario can be compared, and assigned a score. The overall score of each scenario in the scorecard is also calculated. Scorecards with targets can help you meet objectives. By comparing the metric results of select scenarios against department and corporate targets, you can determine the best plan of action to meet and exceed these targets, and adjust your operations accordingly.

In a scorecard that contains targets specified by the scorecard author or uses values from the annual plan as targets, every scenario has a score.

Metrics that measure different performance aspects

Target for each metric

Scenarios to compare

Visual performance indicator

Metric	Weight	Target	Approved Actions		Increase Orders			
			Result	Score	Result	Score	Result	Score
Current Blocked Work Orders	12.5%	15	28	13.3%	36	0.0%	28	13.3%
Current Clear Work Orders	12.5%	50	43	86.0%	43	86.0%	43	86.0%
Current Blocked Planned Orders	12.5%	50	57	86.0%	77	46.0%	42	116.0%
Projected Late Work Orders	12.5%	70	53	124.3%	50	128.6%	54	122.9%
Projected Late Planned Orders	12.5%	500	448	110.4%	418	116.4%	264	147.2%
Projected On-Time Planned Order	12.5%	2,000	2,987	149.4%	2,919	146.0%	2,098	104.9%
Overall Score				79.2%		71.1%		81.6%

Each metric is assigned a weight to reflect its importance in calculating the overall score.

Overall score based on the individual scores for each metric and its target

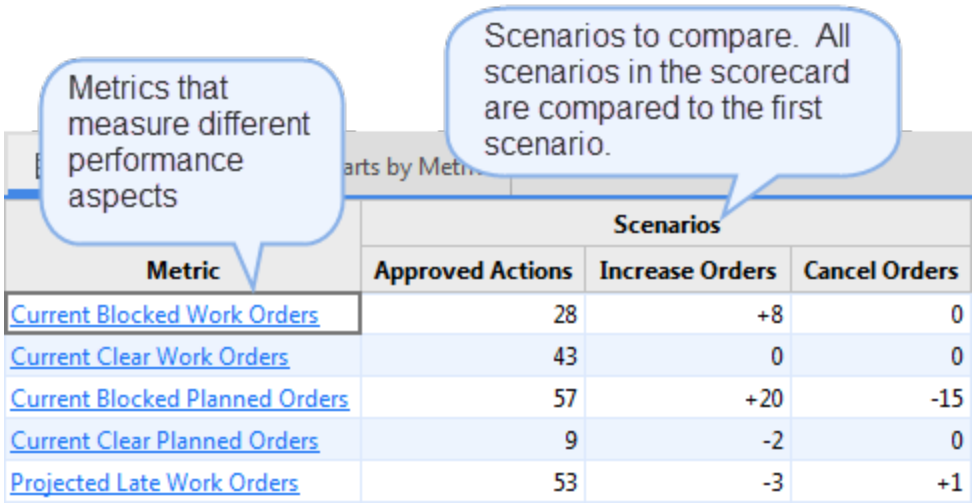
In a scorecard where the first scenario contains the targets, the first scenario does not have a score. Every other scenario is compared to the first scenario and has a score.

The first scenario in the scorecard provides targets for the other scenarios.

From: 06-02-14 To: 05-31-15		Baseline	Cancel Orders		Larger Order	
Metric	Weight	Target	Result	Score	Result	Score
Revenue	25.0%	\$226,368,088	\$145,434,841	64.2%	\$240,598,399	106.3%
Cost Of Goods Sold - Standard	25.0%	\$125,564,635	\$80,547,996	135.9%	\$133,392,079	93.8%
Gross Margin - Standard (%)	25.0%	44.6%	44.5%	99.8%	44.6%	100.0%
On-Time Delivery (%)	25.0%	90.8%	92.1%	101.5%	88.3%	97.3%
Overall Score				100.4%		99.4%

Scorecard comparing metric results between scenarios

Scorecards can also be used to show the differences between the metric results for various scenarios without using targets and scores.

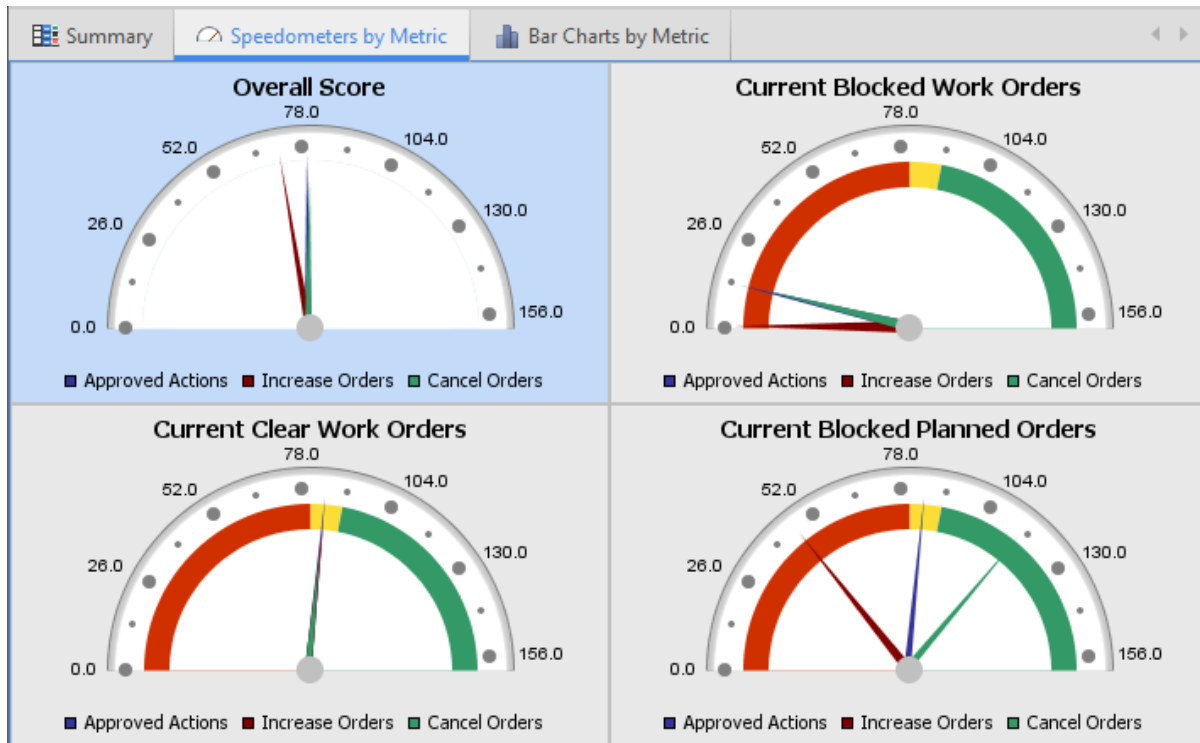


The image shows a scorecard table with two callout boxes. The first callout, pointing to the 'Metric' column, says 'Metrics that measure different performance aspects'. The second callout, pointing to the 'Scenarios' header, says 'Scenarios to compare. All scenarios in the scorecard are compared to the first scenario.'

Metric	Scenarios		
	Approved Actions	Increase Orders	Cancel Orders
Current Blocked Work Orders	28	+8	0
Current Clear Work Orders	43	0	0
Current Blocked Planned Orders	57	+20	-15
Current Clear Planned Orders	9	-2	0
Projected Late Work Orders	53	-3	+1

Scorecard with charts

Scorecards can show summary information in charts. Charts are available in the top pane of the scorecard, with each type of chart on a separate tab.



For more information about scorecard charts, see "[Display scorecard data in a chart](#)" on page 291.

Scorecard comparing metric results for a period of time

Scorecards can show metric results for a specific time period.

Results are calculated for the indicated time period.

From: Jun 2014 To: May 2015			Baseline		Cancel Orders		Increase Orders	
Metric	Weight	Target	Result	Score	Result	Score	Result	Score
Revenue	25.0%	\$2,500,000	\$6,849,413	274.0% ✓	\$3,049,770	122.0% ✓	\$6,849,413	274.0% ✓
Margin %	12.5%	25.0%	4.8%	19.2% ●	11.5%	45.8% ●	3.8%	15.1% ●
Projected Inventory (Finished Goods)	12.5%	\$13,000,000	\$16,403,366	73.8% ●	\$47,674,598	0.0% ●	\$24,141,550	14.3% ●
Inventory Turns	25.0%	1.2	1.2	103.0% ✓	0.7	60.8% ●	1.2	98.8% ⚠
Excess	12.5%	\$9,018,000	\$130,099,998	0.0% ●	\$144,190,540	0.0% ●	\$130,099,173	0.0% ●
Obsolete	12.5%	\$60,000	\$19,685	167.2% ✓	\$19,685	167.2% ✓	\$19,685	167.2% ✓
Overall Score				126.8%		72.3%		117.8%

You can view a time-based scorecard as either an overall summary for the entire period, or as a time-bucketed summary that displays the metric result and score (if the scorecard uses targets) for each bucket. A scorecard that shows results in buckets is shown in the following illustration.

From: Jun 2014 To: May 2015			Jun 2014		Jul 2014	
Metric	Weight	Scenario	Result	Score	Result	Score
Revenue	33.3%	Target	\$500,000		\$500,000	
		Baseline	\$0	0.0% ●	\$0	0.0% ●
		Cancel Orders	\$572,520	114.5% ✓	\$924,840	185.0% ✓
Projected Inventory (Finished Goods)	16.7%	Target	\$3,000,000		\$3,000,000	
		Baseline	\$3,227,371	92.4% ●	\$4,997,182	33.4% ●
		Cancel Orders	\$6,492,444	0.0% ●	\$13,736,347	0.0% ●
Inventory Turns	33.3%	Target	2.0		2.0	
		Baseline	2.4	120.7% ✓	1.2	59.9% ●
		Cancel Orders	1.4	71.2% ●	0.7	35.1% ●
Obsolete	16.7%	Target	\$5,000		\$5,000	
		Baseline	\$19,685	0.0% ●	\$0	200.0% ✓
		Cancel Orders	\$19,685	0.0% ●	\$0	200.0% ✓
Overall Score		Baseline		55.6%		58.9%
		Cancel Orders		61.9%		106.7%

Specify the data displayed in a scorecard

You can change the scenarios that are included in the scorecard, the order in which the scenarios are presented, or the data that the scorecard analyzes.

If you open the scorecard using a shortcut, the scenarios specified in the shortcut are always used. For more information about scorecard shortcuts, see ["Create a shortcut to display scorecard data" on page 106](#).

You can also specify whether to view the metric results as one of the following:

- Actual values for all scenarios and targets.
- Differences between the first scenario and other scenarios or targets and results.
- Percentage differences between the first scenario and other scenarios or targets and results.

► Define the data that is displayed in the scorecard

1. Make selections from the controls at the top of the scorecard. For information about each control, see ["Viewing data in workbooks" on page 139](#).
2. If the scorecard includes the hierarchy panel, add the hierarchies and select the values that determine the scorecard data. For more information, see ["Filter and summarize data with hierarchies" on page 304](#).



Tip: If you want to change the selection in several controls, you can click **Data Settings**  to make all of your selections before refreshing the data.

► Change the scenarios analyzed by a scorecard

1. On the scorecard toolbar, click **Add or Remove Scenarios** .
2. In the **Scenarios** dialog box, to add a scenario, select a scenario in the **Select from this list** list, and then click **Add**.
3. To remove a scenario, select a scenario in the **Scenarios in this scorecard** list, and then click **Remove**.
4. To change the order of scenarios, in the **Scenarios in this scorecard** list, drag a scenario up or down in the list. Moving the scenario up in the list moves the scenario to the left in the scorecard. Moving the scenario down in the list moves the scenario to the right in the scorecard.



Tip: If you want to change the selection in several controls, you can click **Data Settings**  to make all of your selections before refreshing the data.

Specifying the time period for a scorecard

If the scorecard author has allowed the time period for a time-based scorecard to be changed, you can select the number and type of buckets to display after the scorecard's anchor date, which is specified by the scorecard's author. Today's date, the planning date, or the beginning of the current calendar period are commonly used as anchor dates.

Some scorecards also have the option to include buckets for earlier periods, in addition to the number of buckets you select to display after the anchor date. The scorecard author defines when these earlier periods begin.

► Specify the time period for a time-based scorecard

1. On the scorecard toolbar, click **Scorecard Settings** .
2. On the **View** tab, in the **Duration** box, type the number of calendar periods you want the scorecard to analyze.
3. In the list, click the calendar unit.
For example, if you specify **4** in the **Duration** box and **Month** in the calendar list, the scorecard displays results for four months, starting from the date specified by the scorecard author.
4. If applicable, check or uncheck the **Include buckets for earlier periods** box.



Note: Depending on how the scorecard's author has defined when the earlier periods begin, you might sometimes select **Include buckets for earlier periods**, but not see any additional buckets in the scorecard. For example, a scorecard uses Today as the anchor date, and the scorecard author has specified that including buckets for earlier periods shows additional buckets going back to the beginning of the current year. On January first, you do not see additional buckets when you select **Include buckets for earlier periods** in this scorecard, because the anchor date and the beginning of the current year are the same day.

Example: specifying the time period

Today is June 15th. You have opened a time-based scorecard, and it displays data in three buckets: June, July, and August. You open the Scorecard Settings and see that the scorecard is set to display three buckets, using the Month calendar period. The Include buckets for earlier periods box is not currently selected.

You increase the number of buckets to four, and select the Include buckets for earlier periods box. The scorecard's author has specified that the buckets for earlier periods go back to the beginning of the current year, so you now see a total of nine buckets for January through September—the four buckets you specified, plus five additional buckets for January through May.

Specify scorecard viewing options

You can specify whether the scorecard calculates results automatically. If you choose to automatically calculate, the metric results are recalculated when you change the scorecard's data settings, such as adding a scenario or changing the filter. Automatically calculating data is recommended if the scorecard includes the hierarchy panel, so you can see the data for your selected hierarchy values as you make selections.

If the scorecard shows time-based metric results, you might be able to modify the period of time displayed in the scorecard. In addition, you can choose to view either a summary of results for the entire time period, or a summary for each date bucket in the period.

If you modify the scorecard's settings, you can reset them to the scorecard defaults at any time.

► Specify how to display metric results

1. On the scorecard toolbar, click Scorecard Settings .
2. On the **View** tab, in the **Show metric results as** area, click one of the following:
 - **Actual values**—displays the actual calculated value for each metric for all scenarios.
 - **Differences**—displays the difference between the results calculated for the first scenario or the scorecard's targets and the results calculated for each other scenario in the scorecard.
 - **% Differences**—displays the differences in percentage values.
3. Click **OK**.



Notes:

- These settings apply to the scorecard and to multi-scenario columns in metric detail worksheets. For more information about detail worksheets, see "[Drill to worksheets and forms from scorecards](#)" on page 288.
- If a result in a scorecard that includes targets is blank, a target might be missing. Contact the scorecard author or your RapidResponse administrator to define the required target.

► Change the order of scenarios in a scorecard

1. On the scorecard toolbar, click **Add or Remove Scenarios** .
2. In the **Scenarios in this scorecard** list, drag a scenario up or down in the list. Moving the scenario up in the list moves the scenario to the left in the scorecard. Moving the scenario down in the list moves the scenario to the right in the scorecard.



Note: If you are viewing a scorecard that does not include targets, the first scenario in the scorecard is used as the scenario against which all other scenarios in the scorecard are compared (if you are viewing differences). If you are viewing a scorecard that uses the first scenario's results as targets (that is, if the first scenario is the only one that does not have a score), dragging a scenario to the top of the **Scenarios in this scorecard** list makes that scenario's results the targets for the other scenarios in the scorecard.

► Specify whether a scorecard is automatically calculated

1. On the scorecard toolbar, click **Scorecard Settings** .
2. On the **View** tab, select or clear the **Automatically calculate** check box.
3. Click **OK**.



Note: Some metrics are complex and can take a long time to calculate. You should not automatically calculate scorecards with complex metrics.

► Show data in time buckets

You can change to a date-bucketed view if the scorecard author has specified buckets for the scorecard.

- On the scorecard toolbar, click **Bucket Data by Date** .

If the scorecard was displaying the summary, the scorecard changes to a horizontal date-bucketed view with results and scores (if applicable) calculated for each bucket.

If the scorecard was displaying a date-bucketed view, the scorecard changes to the summary view.



Note: You might also be able to change the bucket settings for the scorecard. For more information, see ["Specifying the time period for a scorecard" on page 284](#).

► Reset scorecard settings

Resetting the scorecard settings resets the scorecard's data settings and viewing options, such as the chart settings, whether the scorecard automatically calculates results, and how metric results are displayed in the scorecard summary. Scorecard layout changes, such as column widths, are not reset.

- On the **View** menu, click **Reset scorecard settings**.



Note: You can use zoom controls to adjust the text size in a scorecard, just like you can in a worksheet in a workbook. For more information, see ["Adjust a worksheet's zoom level" on page 136](#).

Calculate metric results in a scorecard

A scorecard can automatically calculate metric results if you or the scorecard author has enabled it to. If not, you can manually calculate the results when you open the scorecard, or after you have changed any of the data in the scorecard, such as adding a scenario or changing the site. Certain metric calculations are quite complex and can take some time to complete.

► Calculate metric results

- On the **Data** menu, click **Calculate** .



Notes:

- For more information about automatically calculating a scorecard, see ["Specify scorecard viewing options" on page 285](#).
- If the scorecard compares results to targets and a target is not specified for a metric, results for that metric are not displayed. A metric without a result is not the same as a result of zero.



Tip: You can also calculate metric results by clicking **Calculate**  on the scorecard toolbar.

Drill to worksheets and forms from scorecards

Scorecards usually contain links that you can click to drill to details or open forms or workbooks where you can make data changes. You might be able to click the name of a scenario or a metric result to open a form or a worksheet in another workbook. You might also be able to click the name of a metric to view one or more details worksheets in the scorecard, below the summary of metric results.

The following illustration shows a scorecard in which you can drill to an editable worksheet in a workbook, a form that you can use to commit a scenario, or detail worksheets that can be displayed in the scorecard. In this example, two drill links are available for the item that was clicked, and the user can choose either one from the pop-up menu.

The screenshot shows a scorecard with a table of metrics. Callouts explain the functionality of different links:

- Click a scenario name to commit the scenario using a form or view and edit demand orders for the entire period.** (Points to 'Current Scenario')
- Click metric results to view and edit demand orders for this date bucket.** (Points to a metric result)
- Click the metric name to view a metric details worksheet in the scorecard.** (Points to 'Revenue')

Metric	From	Result
Gross Margin - Planned		\$7,774,371
		\$7,570,751
	Current Scenario	\$7,774,371
	Target: Baseline	\$7,570,751
	Changes to	\$29,222,530
Revenue	25.0%	\$29,222,530
	Current Scenario	\$29,222,530
	Target: Baseline	\$29,222,530
	Changes to frame orders	\$29,222,530

Drilling to forms and worksheets in workbooks

If scenario names or metric results in a scorecard are blue and underlined, you can click them to open related worksheets or forms. You might find links to worksheets that you can use to edit data and perform simulations, or worksheets that give you information related to the metrics in the scorecard. You might be able to use linked forms to make changes to data, or perform scenario actions, such as accepting or rejecting a scenario based on scorecard results.

In time-based scorecards, you can click a metric result for a date bucket to open a worksheet or form with the date range from that bucket selected. You can click the name of a scenario to open worksheet or form with the range for all the date buckets in the scorecard selected, or to open a worksheet or form in which no date range is selected.

Viewing detail worksheets for metrics in a scorecard

You can view worksheets containing the detailed data behind each metric in a scorecard. These worksheets display data from multiple scenarios, so that you can compare values that change from scenario to scenario. For example, the detail worksheet for the Revenue metric, shown in the following illustration, contains the revenue, cost of goods sold, and gross margin values for three scenarios.

Summary									
From: Jun 2014 To: May 2015			Baseline		Plan One		Plan Two		
Metric	Weight	Annual Plan	Result	Score	Result	Score	Result	Score	
Revenue	12.5%	\$2,731,709,705	-\$750,858,730	72.5% ●	-\$704,985,962	74.2% ●	-\$704,985,962	74.2% ●	
Margin %	12.5%	36.5%	+39.7%	208.7% ✓	+37.6%	203.1% ✓	+37.6%	203.1% ✓	
Key Constraint Utilization	12.5%	0.0%	+29.5%	101.0% ✓	+63.0%	101.0% ✓	+63.0%	101.0% ✓	
On Time to Request	12.5%	0.0%	+12.1%	101.0% ✓	+49.0%	101.0% ✓	+49.0%	101.0% ✓	
Projected Inventory (Finished Goods)	12.5%	\$362,152,770	+\$2,609,901,015	0.0% ●	+\$1,087,647,834	0.0% ●	+\$1,002,805,593	0.0% ●	
Inventory Turns	12.5%	0.0	+2.8	101.0% ✓	+10.1	101.0% ✓	+16.7	101.0% ✓	
Excess	12.5%	\$38,174,038	+\$186,676,648	0.0% ●	+\$207,151,740	0.0% ●	+\$199,019,832	0.0% ●	
Obsolete	12.5%	\$80,216	+\$372,233,686	0.0% ●	+\$119,792,530	0.0% ●	+\$119,801,810	0.0% ●	
Overall Score				73.0%		72.5%		72.5%	

Details for metric: Revenue				
Revenue: by Period by Demand		Revenue: by Period, Actual vs. Forecast		
Period	Scenario	Actual	Forecast	Total
1 06-02-14	Baseline	\$14,706,505	\$0	\$14,706,505
2	Plan One	\$15,402,037	\$0	\$15,402,037
3	Plan Two	\$14,622,037	\$0	\$14,622,037
4 07-01-14	Baseline		\$22,269,070	\$27,595,594
5	Plan One		\$6,376,074	\$12,716,171
6	Plan Two		\$6,376,074	\$11,456,171

The detailed information includes records that are different between the first scenario in the scorecard and all other scenarios included in the scorecard. For example, the Revenue metric calculates the revenue associated with customer orders. The results displayed in the scorecard reflect the total revenue from orders for each scenario in a particular time period. When you view the detailed information, revenue values that differ between scenarios are displayed.

For example, in the illustration above, for the 06-02-08 period, the revenue for the Approved Actions scenario is \$7,511,915. In the Demand Increases scenario, the revenue for the period is \$2,736,900 and in the Demand Decreases scenario, the revenue is \$6,441,915.

You can choose to display data from multiple scenarios as either rows or columns. For more information, see ["Specify how multi-scenario data is displayed" on page 290](#).



Notes:

- Data in detail worksheets displayed in a scorecard cannot be modified.
- You can see all detail records in a scenario for a metric result by including only that one scenario in the scorecard.

► View metric details

- In the scorecard **Summary** or chart tabs, click the metric for which you want to view details. The detail worksheets display in the bottom pane of the scorecard, and the metric name is displayed in the **Details for metric** list.

► View details for a different metric

- Do one of the following:
 - In the scorecard **Summary** or chart tab, click a different metric.
 - In the area above the detail worksheets, in the **Details for metric** list, click the metric you want to view details for.

► Specify how multi-scenario data is displayed

- On the scorecard toolbar, click **Scorecard Settings** .
- On the **View** tab, in the **Show multi-scenario data in** area, click one of the following:
 - Rows**—for every unique data record in the worksheet, each scenario has one row added to the worksheet. This row displays data for that record under each multi-scenario column, as shown in the following illustration.

	Period	Scenario	Actual	Forecast	Total
1	06-02-14	Baseline	\$14,706,505	\$0	\$14,706,505
2		Plan One	\$15,402,037	\$0	\$15,402,037
3		Plan Two	\$14,622,037	\$0	\$14,622,037
4	07-01-14	Baseline	\$5,326,524	\$22,269,070	\$27,595,594
5		Plan One	\$6,340,097	\$6,376,074	\$12,716,171
6		Plan Two	\$5,080,097	\$6,376,074	\$11,456,171

- Columns**—each scenario has a column added under each multi-scenario column header. This column displays scenario data for every unique data record in the worksheet, as shown in the following illustration.

	Period	Actual			Forecast	
		Baseline	Plan One	Plan Two	Baseline	Plan One
1	06-02-14	\$14,706,505	\$15,402,037	\$14,622,037	\$0	\$0
2	07-01-14	\$5,326,524	\$6,340,097	\$5,080,097	\$22,269,070	\$6,376,074
3	08-01-14	\$5,589,791	\$7,024,996	\$6,064,996	\$2,358,956	\$267,119
4	09-01-14	\$29,670,811	\$29,236,530	\$32,236,530	\$20,881,770	\$21,977,979
5	10-01-14	\$54,682,572	\$72,976,065	\$72,976,065	\$238,872,591	\$296,305,866
6	11-03-14	\$16,922,786	\$28,056,671	\$28,056,671	\$293,903,823	\$223,491,673

► Access workbooks from detail worksheets in scorecards

You might be able to drill to worksheets in other workbooks from a detail worksheet in a scorecard, to see more information about a part, constraint, or work center listed in a detail worksheet. You might be able to use the linked worksheet to edit data. If you are viewing data from more than one scenario in the

scorecard, you can specify the scorecard scenario that you want to review or modify so that the workbook opens with the scenario selected in the scenario list.

1. Click a part, constraint, or work center link in a detail worksheet column, and select a workbook from the menu.
2. Click the scenario that contains the information you want to view in the workbook.

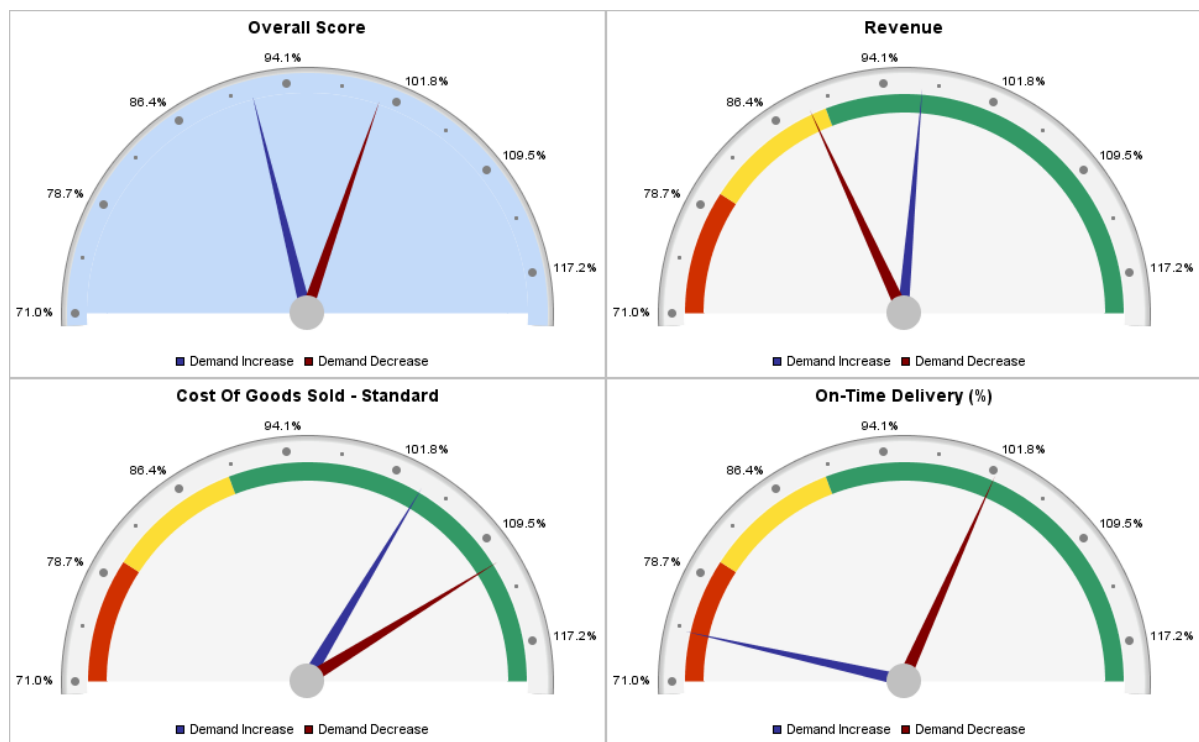
The workbook opens with the data you requested. Note that your scenario is in the **Scenario** list and that the part, constraint, or work center is also selected. This ensures your worksheet displays data for only the item you requested.

► Close the detail view

- In the area above the detail worksheets, click **Close Details** ✕.

Display scorecard data in a chart

One or more charts might be included in the top pane of the scorecard on separate tabs. On a chart tab, each metric in the scorecard is charted separately. Charts can display the metric results for each scenario, or the score for each scenario. For example, a scorecard showing results for three metrics with targets would display four score-based charts; one for each metric, and the fourth for the overall score of each scenario, as shown in the following illustration.



This is an example of a speedometer chart. The scores for the Demand Increase and Demand Decrease scenarios are calculated relative to the target values provided by the Approved Actions scenario, which is not shown in the charts. Each scenario's score is represented by a needle. The Warning and Critical

ranges for each metric are displayed as colored bands on the speedometer so you can see the range for each scenario's score.

You can customize a chart's style, which modifies the background or, depending on the chart type, whether the chart is two-dimensional or three-dimensional. You can also customize the colors displayed in charts. When you modify colors, the same colors are used for every chart. You cannot change the chart's type or its position in the scorecard.

For charts that show scores, you can choose to show or hide the Warning and Critical limits. These limits are shown as lines in most charts or colored bars in the speedometer chart, and can be used as references to see which scores are outside of your acceptable ranges. Depending on the scores, each chart might use a different scale. When compared, the different scales might present misleading results, such as differences that look greater than they actually are. You can specify each chart use the same scale, which ensures the scores can always be compared using the same frame of reference.

The scorecard must be calculated to see information in the charts.

Chart types

The charts you might see are described in the following table.

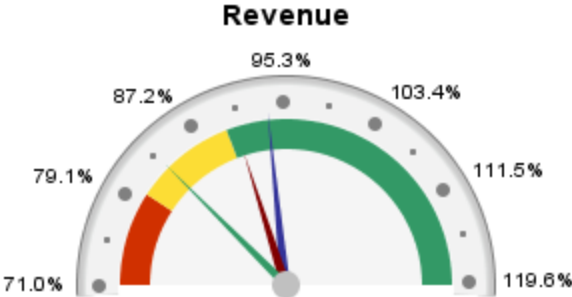
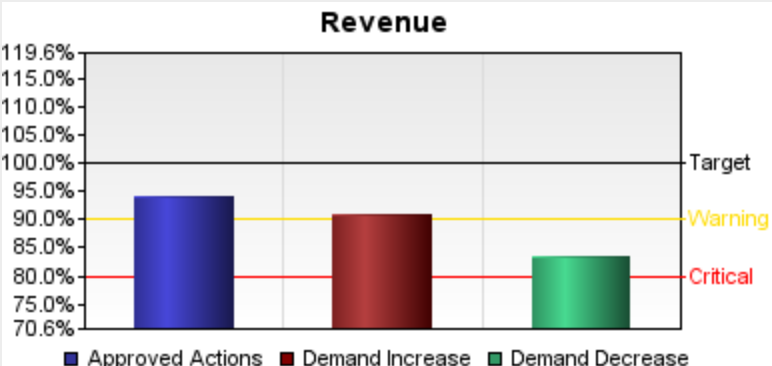
Chart type	Description and Example
Speedometers by Metric	Displays the actual value or score for each metric as a speedometer, with lower values on the left and higher values on the right. If the scorecard uses targets and calculates scores, the Warning and Critical ranges for each metric are displayed as colored bands on the speedometer. Revenue  Legend: ■ Approved Actions ■ Demand Increase ■ Demand Decrease
Bar Charts by Metric	Displays each metric's results or scores in a bar chart, with one bar for each scenario in the scorecard. If the scorecard includes targets, the Warning and Critical ranges for each metric can be included as lines in the chart. Revenue  Legend: ■ Approved Actions ■ Demand Increase ■ Demand Decrease

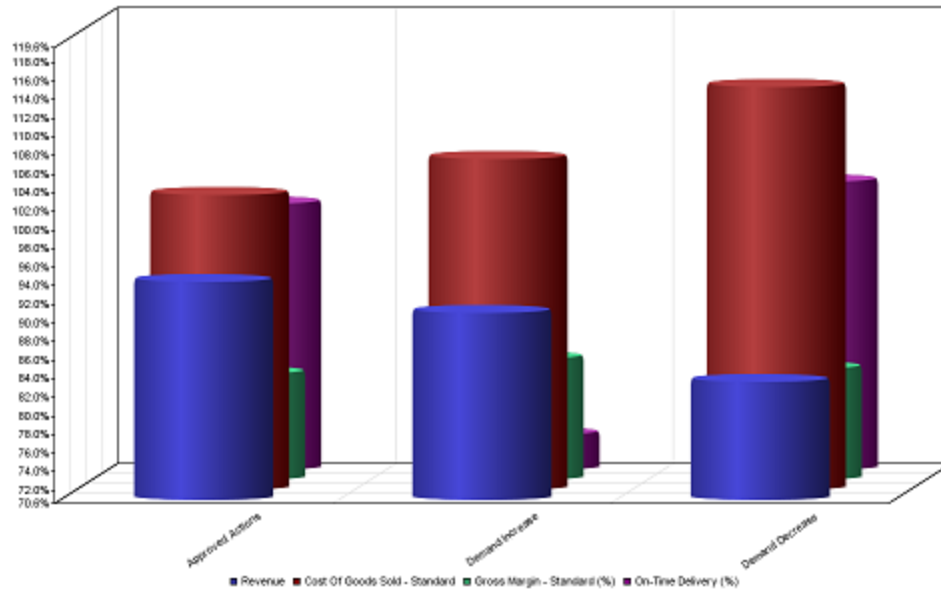
Chart type	Description and Example																				
Bar Charts by Metric Over Time	Displays each metric's results or scores in a bar chart, by time period and scenario. Each bar represents the result or score for a scenario in a time period. If the scorecard includes targets, the Warning and Critical ranges for each metric can be displayed as lines in the chart. Revenue <table><thead><tr><th>Time Period</th><th>Approved Actions</th><th>Demand Increase</th><th>Demand Decrease</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>06-02-08</td><td>95.0%</td><td>88.0%</td><td>90.0%</td></tr><tr><td>07-01-08</td><td>88.0%</td><td>98.0%</td><td>88.0%</td></tr><tr><td>08-01-08</td><td>98.0%</td><td>75.0%</td><td>85.0%</td></tr><tr><td>09-01-08</td><td>98.0%</td><td>105.0%</td><td>75.0%</td></tr></tbody></table>	Time Period	Approved Actions	Demand Increase	Demand Decrease	06-02-08	95.0%	88.0%	90.0%	07-01-08	88.0%	98.0%	88.0%	08-01-08	98.0%	75.0%	85.0%	09-01-08	98.0%	105.0%	75.0%
Time Period	Approved Actions	Demand Increase	Demand Decrease																		
06-02-08	95.0%	88.0%	90.0%																		
07-01-08	88.0%	98.0%	88.0%																		
08-01-08	98.0%	75.0%	85.0%																		
09-01-08	98.0%	105.0%	75.0%																		
Line Charts by Metric Over Time	Displays each metric's results or scores in a line chart, by time period and scenario. If the scorecard includes targets, the Warning and Critical ranges for each metric can be included as additional lines in the chart. Revenue <table><thead><tr><th>Time Period</th><th>Approved Actions</th><th>Demand Increase</th><th>Demand Decrease</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>06-02-08</td><td>95.0%</td><td>88.0%</td><td>90.0%</td></tr><tr><td>07-01-08</td><td>88.0%</td><td>98.0%</td><td>88.0%</td></tr><tr><td>08-01-08</td><td>98.0%</td><td>75.0%</td><td>85.0%</td></tr><tr><td>09-01-08</td><td>98.0%</td><td>105.0%</td><td>75.0%</td></tr></tbody></table>	Time Period	Approved Actions	Demand Increase	Demand Decrease	06-02-08	95.0%	88.0%	90.0%	07-01-08	88.0%	98.0%	88.0%	08-01-08	98.0%	75.0%	85.0%	09-01-08	98.0%	105.0%	75.0%
Time Period	Approved Actions	Demand Increase	Demand Decrease																		
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08-01-08	98.0%	75.0%	85.0%																		
09-01-08	98.0%	105.0%	75.0%																		

Chart type	Description and Example
Summary Bar Chart by Scenario	Displays scores for every metric by scenario in one chart. This type of chart can only display scores.
Summary Bar Chart by Metric	Displays the scores for all metrics in all scenarios in one chart. Each score is displayed as a bar in the color that reflects its performance. A score in the Critical range is displayed as a red bar, a score in the Warning range is displayed as a yellow bar, and a result that is on track is displayed as a green bar. This chart type can only display scores, and also includes the overall scores for each scenario.

Summary Bar Chart by Scenario

Displays scores for every metric by scenario in one chart.

This type of chart can only display scores.

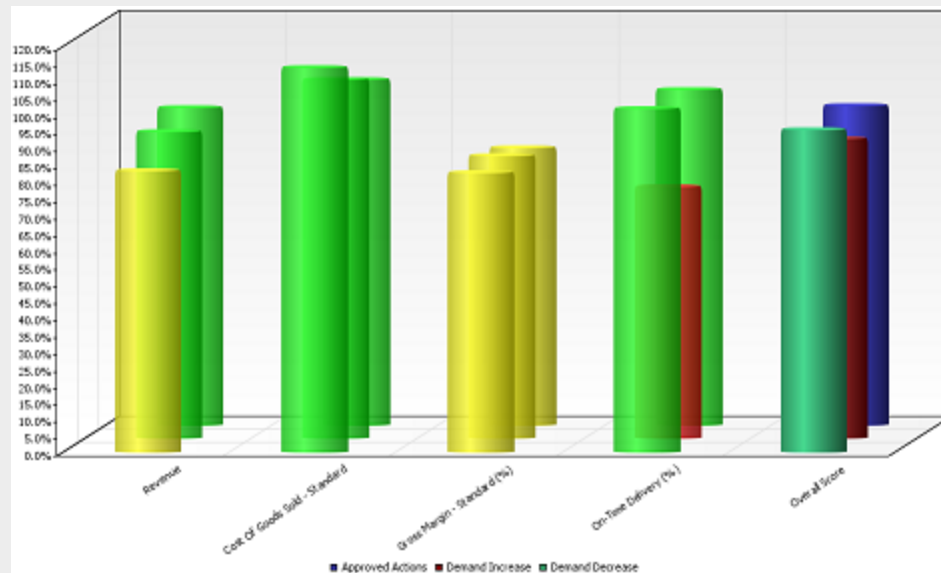


Summary Bar Chart by Metric

Displays the scores for all metrics in all scenarios in one chart.

Each score is displayed as a bar in the color that reflects its performance. A score in the Critical range is displayed as a red bar, a score in the Warning range is displayed as a yellow bar, and a result that is on track is displayed as a green bar.

This chart type can only display scores, and also includes the overall scores for each scenario.



► View a scorecard chart

1. Ensure that the scorecard you are viewing is fully calculated.
2. Click the tab for the chart you want to view.

► Modify a chart's style

1. On the scorecard toolbar, click **Scorecard Settings** .
2. Click the **Charts** tab.
3. In the chart list, click the chart you want to modify.
4. Click **Chart Settings**.
5. In the **Chart Settings** dialog box, in the **Style** list, click the style you want to apply to the chart.
6. If the chart shows scores, do either of the following:
 - To hide or show the Warning and Critical limits on the chart, clear or select the **Include warning and critical limits** check box.
 - To use the same scale for every metric, select the **Use same scale for all metric scores** check box.



Tip: You can move your pointer over a style in the list to see a description of the style in a tooltip.

► Customize the colors used in a chart

The colors in the chart are applied to the metrics or scenarios in the chart. The order of the colors in the Chart Settings dialog box shows the order in which colors are applied to the metrics or scenarios.

Chart colors	
	Color 
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	
6	
7	
8	

For example, color 1 in the above illustration is applied to the first metric or scenario in the chart. Each successive color is applied to successive metrics or scenarios.

1. On the scorecard toolbar, click **Scorecard Settings** .
2. Click the **Charts** tab.
3. In the **Chart colors** area, for the color you want to modify, click the color in the **Color** column.
4. In the color picker, click the color you want to apply to the metric or scenario in the chart.

This color is applied to the metric or scenario, depending on the chart type, displayed in the chart.

5. Repeat steps 3 and 4 for the other colors you want to modify.
6. Click **OK**.



Note: The colors that identify the target values or the Warning and Critical ranges in charts that show scores cannot be modified.



Tip: You can change colors by dragging them up or down in the list.

► **Save a chart**

1. In the scorecard, click the tab for the chart you want to save.
2. On the **File** menu, click **Save Chart**.
3. In the **Save Chart** dialog box, specify a location and name for the file you save the chart as.
4. Click **Save**.



Tip: You can also save a chart by right-clicking the chart and then clicking **Save Chart**.

► **Print a chart**

1. In the scorecard, click the tab for the chart you want to print.
2. On the **File** menu, click **Print**.
3. In the **Print** dialog box, click **Chart**, and then click **OK**.



Tips:

- You can also print a chart by right-clicking the chart and then clicking **Print Chart**.
- For more information about printing, see ["Printing reports" on page 329](#).

Using a target scorecard to make decisions

Target scorecards include the following elements to help you make business decisions:

Metrics Weights Targets Score									
Metric	Weight	Target	Approved Action		Increase Orders		Cancel Orders		Score
			Result	Score	Result	Score	Result	Score	
Current Blocked Work Orders	12.5%	15	28	13.3% ●	36	0.0% ●	28	13.3% ●	
Current Clear Work Orders	12.5%	50	43	86.0% ▲	43	86.0% ▲	43	86.0% ▲	
Current Blocked Planned Orders	12.5%	50	57	86.0% ▲	77	46.0% ●	42	116.0% ✓	
Current Clear Planned Orders	12.5%	30	9	30.0% ●	7	23.3% ●	9	30.0% ●	
Projected Late Work Orders	12.5%	70	53	124.3% ✓	50	128.6% ✓	54	122.9% ✓	
Projected On-Time Work Orders	12.5%	70		13.3% ●	16	22.9% ●	23	32.9% ●	
Projected Late Planned Orders	12.5%	500		149.4% ✓	418	116.4% ✓	264	147.2% ✓	
Projected On-Time Planned Orders	12.5%	2,000	2,987	149.4% ✓	2,919	146.0% ✓	2,098	104.9% ✓	
Overall Score				79.2%		71.1%		81.6%	

Scorecard element	Description
Metrics	Metrics that measure different performance aspects. Each metric links to detailed information.
Weights	The weight of each metric impacts how the overall score of each scenario in the scorecard is calculated.
Targets	The target for the metric. All of the metrics results in the scorecard are compared to the target, and a score for the metric is calculated based on the target. The target can be the data from the first scenario in the scorecard, data from the annual plan, or a specific metric target defined by the scorecard author. When the scorecard author defines specific metric targets, they are defined for a specific set of data, defined by a filter, site, and hierarchy (if applicable). If a metric target has not been defined for your current data settings, (as determined by the site, filter, and hierarchy selections from the controls in the scorecard), the target value is blank.
Score	The score calculated for each metric in each scenario and an icon that identifies the range the metric score falls into. There are three icons that you might see in a scorecard: ✓—signifies that the metric results are on track ▲—signifies that the metric results are in the warning range ●—signifies that the metric results are in the critical range
Overall score	The overall score of all metrics for each scenario in the scorecard.



Notes:

- If the scorecard you are viewing includes a metric for which there is no target, the individual



- score for that metric and the overall score cannot be calculated.
- If the scorecard is time-based and does not contain a target for one time period, the score for that metric is not calculated.

Understanding scores in target scorecards

RapidResponse metrics can be configured so that metric results higher than the target are desirable or that metric results lower than the target are desirable. For example, a metric that measures revenue is configured so that results higher than the target are favorable, where a metric that measures inventory is configured so that lower results are favorable.

RapidResponse calculates the score for metric results differently depending on how the metric is configured. This ensures that scores accurately depict the type of results that is desirable. It is important to understand how these calculations affect the scores displayed in the scorecards you review.

Consider the scorecard in the following illustration.

Metric		Weight		Approved Actions		Cancel Orders	
Metric	Weight	Target	Result	Score	Result	Score	
Projected Late Work Orders	25.0%	50	53	94.0% ✓	49	102.0% ✓	
Projected On-Time Work Orders	25.0%	50	24	48.0% ⬛	28	56.0% ⬛	
Projected Late Planned Orders	25.0%	500	448	110.4% ✓	126	174.8% ✓	
Projected On-Time Planned Orders	25.0%	2,000	2,987	149.4% ✓	2,135	106.8% ✓	
Overall Score				100.4%		109.9%	

Desirable results for the Projected Late Work Orders metric are low.

Desirable results for the Projected On-Time Work orders metric are high.

The target for the Projected On-Time Work Orders metric is 50, and the metric is configured so that higher results reflect desirable performance. The result for this metric in the Cancel Orders scenario is 28; RapidResponse generates a score of 56.0%.

The target for the Projected Late Work Orders metric is 50, and the metric is configured so that lower results reflect desirable performance. The result for this metric in the Cancel Orders scenario is 49; RapidResponse generates a score of 102.0%.

The fact that one metric has a score in the fifties and the other above 100% indicates that the Cancel Orders scenario is underperforming in one area but excelling in another.

Understanding scores for zero value targets

Targets set to zero are handled differently than other target values. For a target of zero, a metric result of zero scores 100%. Any result that surpasses the zero mark is assigned a score of 101%, while any score not meeting the zero target is assigned a score of 0%.

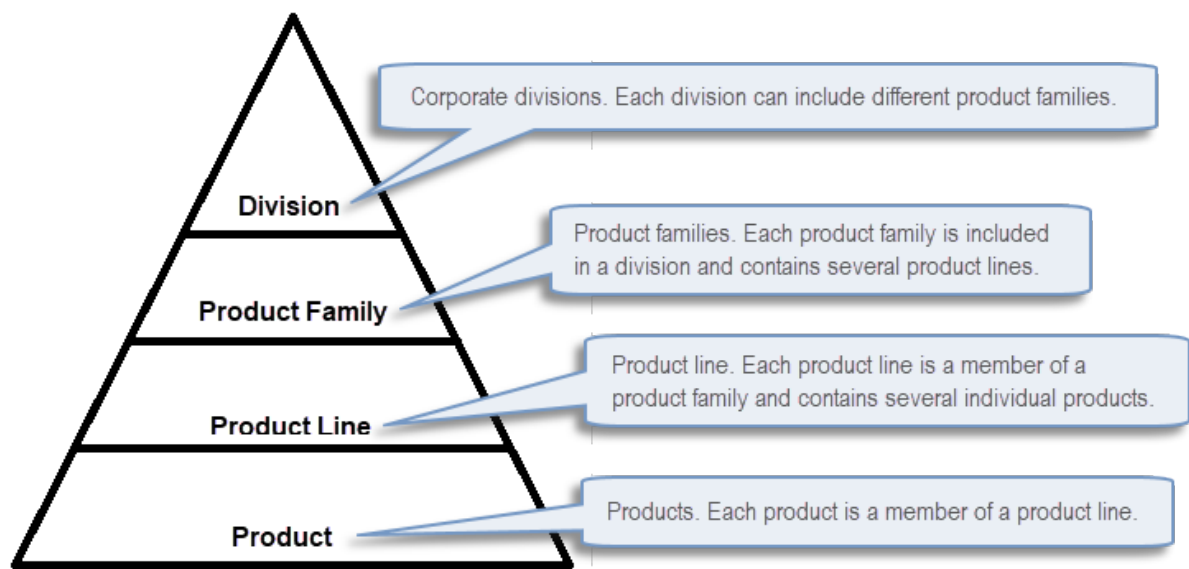
Depending on whether the metric considers high or low values to be better, a result greater than zero could have a score of either 0% or 101%. For example, you might have a target of zero for a late customer order metric. This metric considers low values to be better, so a result greater than zero would give a score of 0%.

CHAPTER 23: Using hierarchies in reports

Filter and summarize data with hierarchies 304

You might have access to reports that use hierarchies to filter and summarize the data in workbooks, dashboards, and scorecards. Each level of the hierarchy summarizes data from every level below it, allowing you to view data at the level of detail you require.

For example, depending on the hierarchies you have available to you, you can use a hierarchy in a worksheet to view for a part, product line, product family, region, division, or country. As outlined in following illustration, a hierarchy might be divided into the following divisions.



Each level of the hierarchy summarizes data from the levels below it. Using the above example, each division summarizes data for the product families in that division. Similarly, each product family summarizes data for the product lines in that family, and so on. You can move from one level to another to either see details about the values summarized at a high level, or see how values at a low level are summarized at higher levels.

Applying a hierarchy

You can only apply a hierarchy to a workbook or scorecard that has been defined to include a hierarchy panel as shown in the following illustration.

The screenshot shows a software interface with a hierarchy panel on the left and a data table on the right. The hierarchy panel is titled 'Hierarchy panel' and shows a tree structure under 'Customer'. The tree has the following levels: Customer, Bike, E, T, The Bike Shop, Toronto Bikes, W, Wheel Appeal, and Wheels To Go. Callouts point to 'Selected hierarchy' (Customer), 'Selected hierarchy values' (The Bike Shop), and 'Data corresponding to the selections made in the hierarchy' (the data table). The data table is titled 'Forecast Summary - Revenue' and shows revenue data for various weeks. The table has columns for 'Due Date' and 'Week'. The data is summarized by all of the active hierarchies.

		Due Date				
		Week				
		06-01-14	06-09-14	06-16-14	06-23-14	06-30-14
Forecast		\$2,583,542	\$1,554,997	\$2,295,539	\$15,643	
Forecast						
4	Variance	\$2,583,542	\$1,554,997	\$2,295,539	\$15,643	
5	Cumulative Variance	\$2,583,542	\$4,138,540	\$6,434,079	\$6,449,722	\$6,449,722

You can change the selected hierarchy level by clicking a new value in the hierarchy tree. In addition, you can add and remove hierarchies from the panel. You can only add hierarchies that are compatible with the filter you have selected.

Applying multiple hierarchies

If you have access to more than one hierarchy, you can apply multiple hierarchies to the data up to a maximum of five hierarchies. The data displayed in the report represents the data that is summarized by all of the active hierarchies. For example, if you have one hierarchy representing product lines and another representing geography, you can view data summarized for a product line at a specific location. Only data matching both the selected product line and selected geographic location is displayed in the report.

When you add a second hierarchy, the options available in the second hierarchy are limited based on your selection in the first hierarchy. If you add a third hierarchy, it is filtered based on your selections in the first two, and so on. For example, if the first hierarchy represents geography and you use it to select a region, a second hierarchy representing product lines would then only list product lines associated with the selected region.

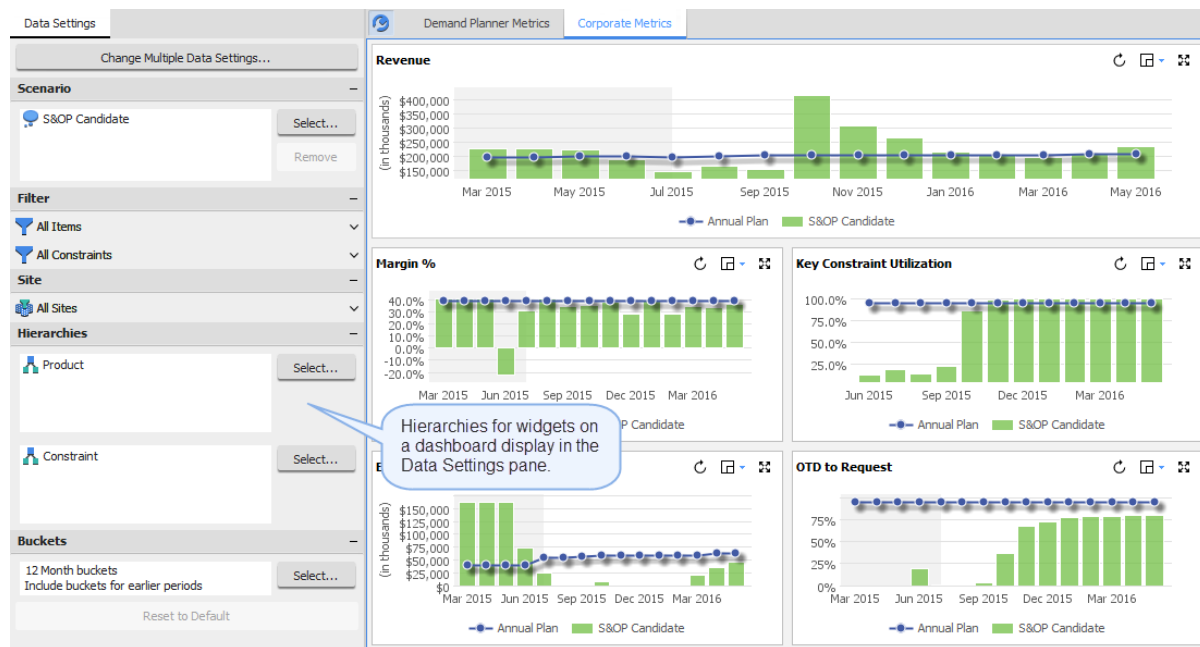
Selecting multiple values in a hierarchy

You can select multiple values in a hierarchy, including values in different levels of the hierarchy, if none of the worksheets contains a hierarchy column. See ["Hierarchy columns in workbooks" on page 303](#). The values you select can be adjacent (SHIFT + click) or non-contiguous (CTRL + click). However, if you have selected a high-level value, you cannot select a value underneath that value, because that value is

included in the high-level value. For example, if you have a product hierarchy with a level named Portables and a value PDVD-1053 under it, you cannot select both Portables and PDVD-1053.

Hierarchies in dashboards

Hierarchies in dashboards are applied to one or more widgets from the Data Settings pane.



Hierarchy columns in workbooks

Some worksheets can display columns based on the values you select in a hierarchy. Depending on how the workbook was created, you might see only one column for a hierarchy, multiple columns for one hierarchy, one column for every hierarchy you add, or multiple columns for every hierarchy you add. An example of a worksheet with a hierarchy column is shown in the following illustration.

This column is added to the worksheet based on the value selected in the hierarchy.

Selected value in hierarchy

Supplier				
	Supplier Group	Supplier	Part	Site
1	Bikes	Mfg	ACKIT-01	HQ
4			ACKIT-02	HQ

The header shown for a hierarchy column is based on the hierarchy name and the level name specified by the hierarchy author. In this example, the selected value is in the Supplier Group level of the Supplier hierarchy. If multiple columns are added for the hierarchy selection, the hierarchy name acts as a spanning header, as shown in the following illustration.

Supplier			
	Supplier Group	Supplier	Part
1	Bikes	Mfg	ACKIT-01
2			ACKIT-02

Filter and summarize data with hierarchies

► Select a hierarchy in a workbook or scorecard

- In the hierarchy panel, in the hierarchy list, click a hierarchy.



Tips:

- You can also select hierarchies by clicking **Data Settings**, **Hierarchy Settings**, and then selecting the desired hierarchies.
- You can also create a shortcut to open a workbook with hierarchies already applied to it. for more information, see ["Create a shortcut to display workbook data" on page 104.](#)

► Select a hierarchy in a widget

1. In the **Data Settings** pane, click **Select** in the **Hierarchies** section.
2. In the **Hierarchy Settings** dialog box, select a hierarchy from the drop down list.

► View data for a hierarchy level

1. In the hierarchy panel or **Hierarchy Settings** dialog box, click the ► or ◄ symbol beside a hierarchy level to expand or collapse the values in that level.
2. Click a value in the hierarchy.
3. If you want to select more values in the hierarchy, do one of the following:
 - To select non-contiguous values, hold **CTRL**, and then click the values you want to select.
 - To select a group of adjacent values, click the first value, hold **SHIFT**, and then click the last value you want to select.
 - To add the next value in the hierarchy to the selected values, hold **SHIFT**, and then press the down arrow.



Note: When you select a value or values in the hierarchy, the workbook, dashboard, or scorecard automatically updates with data for the selected value or values.

► Add a hierarchy to the panel in a workbook or scorecard

1. In the hierarchy panel, click **Add Hierarchy**.
2. In the hierarchy list, click a hierarchy.

► Remove a hierarchy from the panel in a workbook or scorecard

- In the hierarchy panel, click ✕ beside the hierarchy you want to remove.



Note: You cannot remove the hierarchy panel.

► Resize the hierarchy panel in a workbook or scorecard

- Drag the right border of the hierarchy panel left or right.



Note: You cannot remove the hierarchy panel.

CHAPTER 24: Scheduling reports

About automatically generating reports	307
Create a scheduled report	308
Prerequisites for sending customized reports	310
Specify report settings	311
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Specify information included with a report	313
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You can receive regularly scheduled reports, containing selected information from RapidResponse worksheets or scorecards. For example, you could receive a financial update for your division every Monday. Scheduled reports can be delivered by email, in RapidResponse message center, or both, depending on how your account is configured. Reports can also be posted to a website, or stored in a file.

The contents of the reports, when they are sent, and where they are sent are defined using alerts.

You can create customized reports to deliver different data to different recipients. For example, you might create a report that provides updated information to your suppliers every week, but only sends information to each supplier that pertains to that supplier. For more information, see ["Prerequisites for sending customized reports" on page 310](#).

Before creating a report

Depending on the information you want to include in a report and on how the report is delivered, you might have to complete the following preparatory steps:

- Ensure that you have access to the workbook, worksheet, scenario, filter and site filter used to generate the report content. Contact your RapidResponse administrator or the person responsible for creating RapidResponse resources.
- If the worksheet contains columns that you do not want to include in the report, you can hide them. For more information, see ["Hide worksheet columns" on page 132](#).

About automatically generating reports

You can automatically export data from RapidResponse into comprehensive reports in various formats and deliver the reports to key contacts at regularly scheduled intervals.

To automatically create and deliver a report, you must create an alert, which defines the content and format of the report, the report's recipients, and the schedule upon which the report is generated and delivered. For more information, see ["About alerts and data monitoring" on page 560](#).

A report generated by an alert can include the same information as any worksheet or scorecard you can view in RapidResponse, because when you create the report you choose the following elements to define the content:

- Workbook and worksheet, or scorecard
- Scenario
- Filter
- Site or site filter
- Other workbook data controls

When the alert's condition is met, data is extracted from the RapidResponse database, compiled into a file, and delivered to users. The report file can be sent through RapidResponse Message Center, and can be exported to a network file location or posted to a Web site. The report can be delivered by email if your RapidResponse administrator has enabled file attachments.

You can also configure RapidResponse so that a custom report is generated for each recipient. For example, you can provide suppliers with reports that include information about their parts only. For information about resources required for generating custom reports, see ["Prerequisites for sending customized reports" on page 310](#).

After the initial setup, you can rely on RapidResponse to automatically generate and deliver the reports without any maintenance. At any time, you can change when the report is created, the delivery method, the information that is exported, and the report recipients.

When a report is generated, the worksheet record limit is ignored. This means that a report generated from a worksheet includes every record in the report, even if the worksheet returns more records than RapidResponse can display. However, if the report is generated from a crosstab worksheet, the record limit of 100,000 records is not ignored. Reports generated from crosstab worksheets that return more than 100,000 records cause the alert generating them to fail.



Note: If the report content is defined by a worksheet, hidden columns are not included, and if you have reordered the columns in the worksheet, the column order that you specified is used.

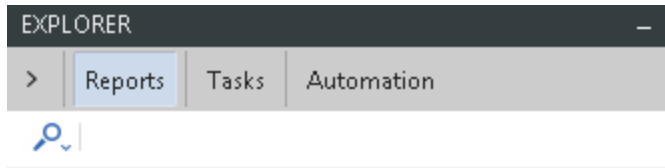
Create a scheduled report

Before creating a report, ensure that you performed the appropriate preparation tasks (see ["Scheduling reports" on page 307](#) for more information). In order to generate a report on a schedule, you must have an alert that checks for a condition at scheduled intervals. For more information, see ["Prerequisites for sending customized reports" on page 310](#).

The report is created from the same worksheet or scorecard, site, filter, and scenario that the alert monitors. If you are creating a report without a worksheet or scorecard selected, you must specify the resources to use. For more information, see ["Create an alert to monitor worksheet data" on page 574](#) and ["Create an alert to monitor scorecard data" on page 581](#).

► Create an alert to generate a report for a worksheet

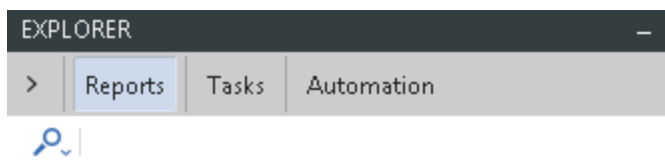
1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that workbooks are shown. You can do this by selecting **Reports**.



2. Double-click a workbook, and then select the worksheet you want to monitor.
3. Select the scenario that contains the data you want to monitor, the filter, the site, and the search criteria to define the data that appears in the report. For more information, see ["Search for specific data" on page 190](#).
4. On the **File** menu, point to **New**, then **Alert** and click **Monitor Worksheet**.
You can also click **New Resource**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.
5. In the **Name** box, enter a descriptive name for the alert.
6. In the **Author notes** box, enter a summary of what the alert monitors.
7. In the **Alert is** area, click **Off**.
8. Click the **Condition** tab.
9. In the **Condition** area, click one of the following:
 - **Alert if this worksheet contains any data**—creates a report only if the worksheet contains data that matches your search criteria.
 - **Always alert (even if the worksheet is empty)**—creates a report even if there is no data to display. This option should be used if you want to receive regular updates.
 - **Only if the number of records in the worksheet**—creates a report when the specified number of records are in the worksheet.
10. Click the **Report** tab.
11. To generate a report, select at least one of the following:
 - the **Attach report to notification message** check box (you must also select the **Deliver notification message** check box on the **Notify** tab).
 - the **Export to file** check box.
 - the **Post to Web site** check box.
12. Select how the report is delivered. For more information, see ["Specify how a report is delivered" on page 312](#).

► Create an alert to generate a report for a scorecard

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that scorecards are shown. You can do this by selecting **Reports**.



2. Double-click the scorecard you want to monitor.
3. Select a filter and site to narrow your search.

4. Click a cell under the scenario you want to monitor.
 - If the scenario you want is not in the scorecard, you can add it. For more information, see "[Specify scorecard viewing options](#)" on page 285.
5. On the **File** menu, point to **New**, then **Alert** and click **Monitor Scorecard**.

You can also click **New Resource**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.
6. In the **Name** box, type a descriptive name for the alert.
7. In the **Author notes** box, enter a summary of what the alert monitors.
8. Click the **Condition** tab.
9. In the **Condition** area, click **Always alert**.
10. Click the **Report** tab.
11. Select at least one of the following:
 - the **Attach report to notification message** check box (you must also select the **Deliver notification message** check box on the **Notify** tab).
 - the **Export to file** check box.
 - the **Post to Web site** check box.
12. Select how the report is delivered. For more information, see "[Specify how a report is delivered](#)" on page 312.

Prerequisites for sending customized reports

You can use one alert to generate and deliver different versions of a report to the recipients. These recipients are commonly suppliers or customers who need updated information provided to them from your company. Alternatively, the recipients could be a group of sales representatives that work in different global regions, and each requires an editable sales forecast worksheet that displays and allows them to import values in their local currency.

Ensure that a profile variable has been defined for each user who will be receiving the report. These profile variables will be used in the worksheet filter expression of the worksheet used for the report.

Example: sending customized reports to suppliers

For example, you might want to send a worksheet to a group of suppliers that informs them of parts you require, including the quantities and the due dates. Each supplier needs only the information related to his own parts. The following is required to ensure that a custom report can be sent to each supplier:

- A worksheet that contains part, quantity and date information for supply orders. The worksheet must use a profile variable to filter records so that each supplier sees only orders they are responsible for. Contact the person in your company who creates workbooks for more information.
- An Alert user account for every supplier. Each user account must include an email address for the contact person who will be receiving reports. All of the suppliers must be members of one group. For more information, contact your RapidResponse administrator.
- User profile variables for all the suppliers. The name of the user profile variable must match the profile variable used in the worksheet. For information about creating profile variables for suppliers, see the [RapidResponse Administration Guide](#).

When these prerequisites have been met, you can send the report to this group of suppliers. When RapidResponse generates the customized report, it finds the value for the profile variable for each user, and includes in the report only the orders that match that SupplierID value.

Testing customized reports

To test customized reports, ensure that a profile variable that uses the value for a target test user has been defined for your user account. For example, to test a report that is being delivered to several suppliers, it is recommended that you verify the report for one supplier. Contact the person responsible for creating RapidResponse resources or your RapidResponse administrator for more information.

Distributing customized reports to Web sites

If you are distributing customized reports to different Web sites, ensure that profile variables for each Web site on which the customized report will be posted have been defined. For more information about profile variables, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).



Note: When sending custom reports to recipients, keep in mind that they receive data for the site or site filter you define in the report rather than the sites to which they have permissions.

Specify report settings

After the alert has been created, you can create the report. The first step is to provide a file name, file type, and encoding type for the report. If you are generating the report in Microsoft Excel format, you can specify the worksheets to be included in the Microsoft Excel file

You can control the title of an HTML document or Tab-delimited text file. If you are generating the report in HTML format, you can also specify a title for the report. If you do not specify a title, the file name is used as the title.

You can choose to include a time stamp in the file name to indicate when the report was generated. You might do this if, for example, you generate daily reports.

1. In the **New Alert** or **Alert Properties** dialog box, click the **Report** tab.
2. Select the **Attach report to notification message** check box.
3. In the **File name** box, type the name of the file.
4. If you want to add a time stamp to indicate when the report was generated, select the **Append time stamp to file name** check box.
5. In the **File type** list, click one of the following file types:
 - **Adobe PDF (*.pdf)**—creates a PDF file which can be opened in a PDF viewer such as Adobe Reader or Preview for Mac OS.
 - **HTML Document (*.html)**—creates an HTML file, which opens in a Web browser.
 - **Microsoft Excel Workbook (*.xlsx)** - Mac OS only (version 2008-2019)
 - **Microsoft Excel Workbook (*.xlsx)** - Windows only (version 2007-2019)
 - **Microsoft Excel 97-2004 Workbook (*.xls)** - Mac OS only
 - **Microsoft Excel 97-2003 Workbook (*.xls)** - Windows only
 - **Tab Delimited (*.tab)**—creates a tab-delimited text file which opens in any word processor

and can be imported into Microsoft Excel 97 and earlier.

- **XML Document (*.xml)**—creates an XML file which opens in a Web browser or text editor.
6. If you selected the **HTML Document**, **XML Document**, or **Tab Delimited** file type in step 5, then in the **Encoding** list, click one of the following:
 - **ANSI (System Locale)**—plain text non-Unicode encoding. The exported file will use the locale setting of RapidResponse.
 - **Unicode**—a 16-bit character encoding system that supports the processing and display of the major texts in the world. Use Unicode encoding for data that will be used in a multilingual setting.
 - **Unicode (Big Endian)**—A sequence of bytes is stored with the most significant value first (a word is stored big-end first). This format is usually supported on computers that do not use an x86 CPU (Intel and AMD) such as the older generation Macintosh computers which used a Motorola CPU.
 - **Unicode (UTF-8)**—an 8-bit version of Unicode that can be used with transmission media that supports only 8 bits of data within one byte. Use the UTF-8 version of Unicode for data that will be used in a multi-lingual setting, and on different operating systems. It is also important to use UTF-8 for files exported in XML format.
 7. If you chose **HTML Document (*.html)** in the **File Type** list, in the **Title** box, type the name of the report.
 8. If you chose a **Microsoft Excel Workbook** type, in the **Include** list, click one of the following:
 - **Selected worksheet**—The data in only the active worksheet is included in the report.
 - **All worksheets in the workbook**—The data in every worksheet is included in the report.
 - **Workbook data using the report template**—The data specified in the workbook's report template is included in the report. This option is available only for alerts that monitor data in a workbook that has a report template defined.



Notes:

- For more information about file types for reports, see ["Specify how a report is delivered" on page 312](#).
- If you select **Workbook data using the report template**, report options such as including column headers and hiding duplicate values are specified by the template. For more information, see ["Specify information included with a report " on page 313](#).

Specify how a report is delivered

When creating a report, you can specify how it is delivered to recipients. Reports are delivered through RapidResponse Message Center and by email to those recipients who have not disabled email delivery, but you can specify additional delivery methods such as:

- Exporting the report to a network file location
- Posting the report to a Web site using either the HTTP or the secure HTTPS protocols
- Sending customized reports to a user group

► Export the report to a file

1. In the **New Alert** or **Alert Properties** dialog box, click the **Report** tab.
2. Select the **Export report to file** check box.

3. In the **File location** list, click the file location to which you want to export the file.
4. If the report file is in tab-delimited text format, click one of the following:
 - **Replace**—if a file with the same name exists, it is replaced with the new report.
 - **Append**—if a file with the same name exists, the new report data is added to it.

All other file formats are always exported in Replace mode.



Note: The **Export report to file** option is available only if your RapidResponse administrator has defined one or more network file locations to which the file can be exported.

► Post the report to a Web site

1. In the **New Alert** or **Alert Properties** dialog box, click the **Report** tab.
2. Select the **Post report to Web site** check box.
3. In the **Address** box, type the complete URL of the Web site. For example, **https://server01/postfile**.

If the Web site uses authentication to control access, you must include your user name and password, separated by a colon, at the beginning of the URL. For example, if the Web site is **https://server01/postfile**, your user name is **ID0023**, and your password is **snmjb**, the URL you enter must be **https://ID0023:snmjb@server01/postfile**.



Note: Before using the **Post report to Web site** feature, consult your RapidResponse administrator to ensure your system is properly configured. Only On-Premises installations of RapidResponse can be configured to allow posting reports to Web sites.

► Send a customized report to a RapidResponse group

1. In the **New Alert** or **Alert Properties** dialog box, click the **General** tab.
2. Click **Advanced**.
3. Select the **Deliver customized reports to members of user group** check box.
4. In the list, click a group name.
5. Click **OK**.



Notes:

- Ensure you have followed the prerequisites for creating customized reports. For more information, see ["Prerequisites for sending customized reports" on page 310](#).
- If you choose to deliver customized reports to a group, you cannot specify other recipients or export the report to a network file location.
- If you choose to deliver customized reports and post the report to a Web site, you must create a profile variable to define the URL, including the user name and password required to access the server. For more information, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

Specify information included with a report

When generating a report, you can control several aspects of the report's presentation. You can hide the column headers in HTML, XML, and tab-delimited text files, and specify how hidden duplicate values are

handled in the report if the RapidResponse worksheet hides duplicates.

In addition, you can include information about the resources used to generate the report content, such as the scenario and workbook. This allows your report recipients to know which resources they require to view the data in RapidResponse.

You can also write an introduction for the report to tell the recipients what the report is about and what specific data is being reported. If your report is in HTML format, you can also change the Web browser window title.

If your report is in PDF format, the report's appearance matches your printed reports. For more information, see ["Customizing appearance of printed reports" on page 332](#).

► **Hide column headers in the report**

1. In the **New Alert** or **Alert Properties** dialog box, click the **Report** tab.
2. Clear the **Include column headers** check box.



Note: This option is available only for HTML, XML, and tab-delimited text files.

► **Specify how hidden duplicate values are included in the report**

1. In the **New Alert** or **Alert Properties** dialog box, click the **Report** tab.
2. In the **Format hidden duplicate data values** list, click one of the following:
 - **Clear**—The hidden duplicate values are not included in the report. The duplicate values are not included in subtotals or grand totals.
 - **Hide**—The hidden duplicate values are included in the report, but are hidden by making the text color the same as the background color. The duplicate values are included in subtotals and grand totals.
 - **Show**—The duplicate values are not hidden, and are shown in the report.



Notes:

- The **Hide** option is available only for file formats that preserve the formatting of the RapidResponse workbook, such as Microsoft Excel, PDF, and HTML files.
- The **Show** and **Clear** options are not available for PDF files.

► **Include resource information in HTML reports**

1. In the **New Alert** or **Alert Properties** dialog box, click the **Report** tab.
2. Click **Options**.
3. In the **Options** dialog box, select the **Include resource information** check box.

► **Include introductory notes in the report**

1. In the **New Alert** or **Alert Properties** dialog box, click the **Report** tab.
2. Click **Options**.
3. In the **Introductory notes** text box, type an introduction for the report.

**Notes:**

- This option is available only for HTML and tab-delimited text files.
- If your report is in HTML format, the introductory notes can include HTML formatting and hyperlinks.

► Specify the title of the Web browser window for HTML reports

1. In the **New Alert** or **Alert Properties** dialog box, click the **Report** tab.
2. Click **Options**.
3. In the **Web browser window title** text box, type the text that you want to be displayed as the title of the Web browser window when the report is opened.

Test a report

Before you schedule the alert and specify recipients, it is important to test the report settings. You should verify the look and content of the report, especially if you are generating reports with content specific to the recipients.

Depending on how you are delivering the report, do one of the following.

► Verify a report

- Click the alert you created, and then on the **Actions** menu, click **Run Now**.
The condition is checked and the report is generated. After verifying that the report is generated and delivered correctly, you can specify when the condition is checked and define the report recipients. For more information, see ["Schedule when an automation task runs" on page 591](#) and ["Send notification messages when an automation task completes" on page 624](#).

► Verify a recipient-specific report

1. Click the **Notify** tab.
2. Click **Select Names**, and then specify yourself as the recipient of the report.
Ensure that any required profile variables are defined for your user account, using the values for one of your target test users. For example, if you are testing a report that will be delivered to several suppliers, you should verify the report for one supplier. To do so, you need a profile variable specified for your user account with the supplier's user values. For more information, contact the person in your company who creates workbooks.
3. Click **OK**.
4. Click the alert you created, and then on the **Actions** menu, click **Run Now**.
After verifying that the report is generated and delivered correctly, you can specify when the condition is checked and define the report recipients. For more information, see ["Schedule when an automation task runs" on page 591](#) and ["Send notification messages when an automation task completes" on page 624](#).

► Verify a report posted to a Web site or network file location

1. In the **Explorer**, select the alert.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Run Now**.

3. Verify that the report is delivered to the correct location and that the report content is as expected.

After verifying that the report is generated and delivered correctly, you can specify when the condition is checked. For more information, see ["Schedule when an automation task runs" on page 591](#).



Note: You might also be able to generate and test reports on a test system computer. For more information, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

CHAPTER 25: Exporting data

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You can export data from a RapidResponse workbook for use in other programs. You can export data from a single worksheet, or from all worksheets in a workbook. You can also use the procedures outlined in this section to export data from an active scorecard. For more information about scorecards, see ["Viewing scorecard data " on page 279](#).

Available file formats

You can export data in the following file formats:

- A Microsoft Excel file, which opens in Microsoft Excel.
- A tab-delimited text file, which opens in any word processor or text editor.
- A PDF file which can be opened in a PDF viewer such as Adobe Reader or Preview for Mac OS.
- An HTML file, which opens in a Web browser.
- An XML file, which opens in a Web browser or word processor.

Depending on the file format you choose, different options are available to you. For example, Microsoft Excel files support formatting, which can be saved when you export a workbook to Microsoft Excel. Text files do not support formatting, so the formatting cannot be saved when you export a workbook to a text file.

Exceeding the worksheet record limit

You cannot export a worksheet that exceeds the worksheet record limit. If your RapidResponse administrator has granted you permission to override the record limit, you must retrieve all records before you can export the data. Otherwise, you must filter or search the worksheet data to reduce the number of records returned before you can export the data. For more information about the worksheet record limit, see ["What if the worksheet record limit is exceeded?" on page 189](#).

Exporting data that includes images

If you export data that includes images, such as a scorecard with targets or a worksheet with an icon column, depending on the type of file you export to, the images might not be exported with the data. For example, if you export a scorecard with targets to a Microsoft Excel file, the scenario score icons are replaced with a text description of what the icon represents, such as "Critical" for values in the critical range. You can export images to Adobe PDF files and HTML documents.

Exporting scaled values

If a column is formatted to display numbers as scaled values, the scaled values that you see in the worksheet are exported, rather than the underlying raw values.

Handling of duplicate values

If you are exporting a RapidResponse worksheet that hides duplicate values, you can specify how the values are handled when exporting. You can choose from the following options:

- **Clear**—The duplicate values are not exported. The cells that contained the duplicate values are empty in the exported file. If you select this option, you cannot use the exported file to import data into RapidResponse.
- **Hide**—The duplicate values are hidden by making the font color and background color the same. The duplicate values are available for editing or reporting.
- **Show**—The duplicate values are visible.

The options available depend on the type of file you are exporting to. For example, you cannot hide duplicate values if you are exporting to an XML file, but you can clear or show them. If you are exporting to a PDF file, you cannot specify any of these options and the duplicate values are hidden. If a worksheet column is not configured to hide duplicate values, any duplicate values in that column appear in both the RapidResponse worksheet and in exported data, regardless of whether you choose to clear, hide, or show duplicate values.

Column arrangement and exporting data

When you export data using a worksheet, the order in which the columns appear in the exported file depends on the current order of columns in the worksheet. You can customize the order of columns in the exported file by reordering the worksheet columns in RapidResponse before exporting the data. For more information, see ["Changing the order of worksheet columns" on page 135](#).

If the worksheet you are exporting contains data you do not want to include in the report, you can hide the columns that contain the data. For more information, see ["Hide worksheet columns" on page 132](#).

If the worksheet contains columns that are hidden or shown according to selections in the Data Settings dialog box, these columns are always included in the exported data, regardless of whether they are hidden.



Caution: Some business process might require columns in the exported data to appear in the default order, and these processes fail or produce unexpected results if you change the order of the columns or hide columns.

Export data to a Microsoft Excel file

You can export data from a workbook to a Microsoft Excel file. When exporting data to a Microsoft Excel file, you can choose whether column headers are exported with the data. Column formatting, such as font color and column width, can be exported with the data. You can choose to export a single worksheet, every worksheet in a workbook, or a set of data defined by a report template.

A report template can be created by the workbook's author, and can be used to export data into a specially-formatted Microsoft Excel file that can include data from multiple worksheets, graphics, charts, customized worksheet names, and so on. The report template specifies which RapidResponse worksheets are exported, also specifies some of the exporting options, such as whether to include column headers or how to format hidden duplicate values. The workbook's author can specify that only the report template is used to export data from the workbook. In this case, you cannot modify any of the exporting options when you export the data.

If you export an entire workbook, any worksheets that cannot open because of errors are not exported. In this case, you can choose to export the valid worksheets, or cancel the export. If you see worksheets with errors, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

You can also import data from a Microsoft Excel file. For more information, see ["Importing data" on page 377](#).

Microsoft Excel uses the Microsoft Windows regional settings to interpret dates exported from RapidResponse. This means the dates in data you export are always imported in the same format your computer uses. You might want to use a four-digit representation of the year format (for example, 2009) in RapidResponse worksheets to ensure dates are correctly interpreted. For more information about setting date formats, see ["Specify formats for dates, times, numbers, and currencies" on page 60](#).

Hidden duplicate values

If you are exporting worksheets that hide duplicate values, you must specify how these values are exported. The option you select depends on how you want the data to be used in the Microsoft Excel file, and is applied to every worksheet you export. For example, if you want to hide the duplicate values but include them in the Microsoft Excel file for editing or reporting, you can hide the values. If you want to hide the duplicate values and not include them in the Microsoft Excel file, you can clear the values. You can also override the worksheet's setting by showing the duplicate values in the Microsoft Excel file.

If you clear the duplicate values, subtotal and grand total rows will have different results in RapidResponse and Microsoft Excel. In addition, if you clear duplicate values, you cannot use the Microsoft Excel file to import data.

Microsoft Excel and the worksheet record limit

You cannot export a worksheet that exceeds the worksheet record limit. If your RapidResponse administrator has granted you permission to override the record limit and you are exporting all worksheets in the workbook, the worksheet record limit for each worksheet is ignored, and all records are exported. However, the worksheets must not contain more records than Microsoft Excel can display in a worksheet.

The Microsoft Excel row limits are shown in the following table

Microsoft Excel version	Row limit
Microsoft Excel Workbook (*.xlsx) - Mac OS only (version 2008-2019)	1,048,576 rows
Microsoft Excel Workbook (*.xlsx) - Windows only (version 2007-2019)	1,048,576 rows
Microsoft Excel Workbook (*.xls) - Mac OS only (version 97-2004)	65,536 rows
Microsoft Excel Workbook (*.xls) - Windows only (version 97-2003)	65,536 rows

If you do not have permission to override the worksheet record limit and you are exporting all worksheets in the workbook, any worksheets that violate the record limit are not exported. In this case, you can choose to export only the worksheets that do not violate the record limit, or to cancel the export and the filter the worksheets to reduce the number of records returned.

Exporting data that can be imported

Your RapidResponse administrator might have provided you with workbooks that you can export data from, and that are intended for another person to import that data. This type of workbook usually contains crosstab worksheets, which are exported to Microsoft Excel and then sent to customers or suppliers to be updated.

When another user imports the data, any existing records that match the workbook controls you specified might be deleted. In this case, you must be careful with the site you select in the workbook. If you use the All Sites site filter and you have access to fewer sites than the person that imports the data, records can be deleted from every site that user has access to. However, because only the data for sites you have access to is exported, that user can lose data.

If you are exporting data that another user will import, you should not use All Sites. You should use a more specific site filter, or export each site's data individually. This ensures that only the sites you have exported data for are affected by the import.

For more information about the data that can be imported and configuring the import data, see ["Worksheets for importing data from a Microsoft Excel file" on page 399](#) and ["Settings worksheets for importing data" on page 404](#).

Example of a report created by a report template

An example of a report created by exporting a workbook with a report template is shown in the following illustration.

B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
Monthly Report										
Quantity by Due Date										
Month										
Part	Site	06-02-08	07-01-08	08-01-08	09-01-08	10-01-08	11-03-08			
CRUISER	HQ	8,000	7,600	7,800	7,400	4,700	3,300			
MOUNTAIN	HQ	3,000	3,000	3,000	3,000	3,000	3,000			
RACER	HQ	1,500	3,020	3,060	3,000	3,000	3,000			

Exporting money data

Your RapidResponse system might support more than one currency. When you export data that contains money values, the value displayed in the column is saved in the exported data. The currency used to display the data in each column is saved in the Microsoft Excel file, as described in ["View the currency used in a column" on page 384](#).

If you intend to use the exported Microsoft Excel file to import data back into RapidResponse or into a different RapidResponse installation, the worksheet that the data is imported into must use the same currency as the data in the Microsoft Excel file. For more information, see ["Import data from a Microsoft Excel file into a workbook" on page 380](#).

► Export data to a Microsoft Excel file

1. On the **Data** menu, click **Export Data**.
2. In the **Export Data** dialog box, specify the location to save the file.
3. In the **File name** box, type a name for the file.

The file name cannot contain more than 217 characters, and cannot contain any of the following characters: \ / : * ? < > |

4. In the **Files of type** list, click one of the following:
 - Microsoft Excel Workbook (*.xlsx) - Mac OS only (version 2008-2019)
 - Microsoft Excel Workbook (*.xlsx) - Windows only (version 2007-2019)
 - Microsoft Excel 97-2004 Workbook (*.xls) - Mac OS only
 - Microsoft Excel 97-2003 Workbook (*.xls) - Windows only
5. In the **Export** area, click one of the following:
 - **Active worksheet**—exports data displayed in the active worksheet.
 - **All worksheets in workbook**—exports data displayed in each worksheet in the active workbook. Each worksheet in the workbook corresponds to a worksheet in the Microsoft Excel file.

- **Workbook data using the report template**—exports data in worksheets as specified in the report template. Selecting this option automatically sets the other exporting options.
6. To include the worksheet's column headers in the Microsoft Excel file, select the **Include column headers** check box.
 7. To include the worksheet's formatting in the Microsoft Excel file, select the **Include formatting** check box.
 8. In the **Format hidden duplicate data values** list, click **Clear**, **Hide**, or **Show**.
For more information about these options, see ["Exporting data" on page 317](#).
 9. If you want to use the exported file to import data to a scenario, select the **Configure the exported file for importing into a scenario** check box.
 10. Click **Save**.
 11. If you are exporting the entire workbook and some worksheets cannot be exported, do one of the following:
 - To export the valid worksheets, click **Yes**.
 - To cancel the export, click **No**.
 12. Once the file is saved, you are given the option to open the file or the folder where the file is saved. If you do not want to do either, click **Cancel**.



Notes:

- If a RapidResponse worksheet's name is longer than 32 characters, the corresponding Microsoft Excel worksheet name is shortened to 32 characters.
- You can export data to a Microsoft Excel file format if you do not have Microsoft Excel installed on your computer.
- Numerical data exported to Microsoft Excel always uses the period character (.) as a decimal separator. If you use a number format with a different separator, you can modify the format in the Microsoft Excel file after the export is complete.
- If you are exporting Unicode or double-byte characters (for example, Japanese), and use Microsoft Excel 97, ensure that your computer's regional settings match the settings of the computer hosting RapidResponse. For more information, contact your RapidResponse administrator.
- When you modify the data in Microsoft Excel and save it, some of the formatting can become corrupted. For example, double quote characters (") are added to certain cells. If you are having problems importing data that was exported and edited in Microsoft Excel into RapidResponse, you can use a text editor to modify the data to avoid any formatting issues.
- When exporting data from the worksheets that display detailed scorecard data to Microsoft Excel 97, any scenario names in the scorecard that begin with a special character, such as a plus (+) or equal sign (=), are interpreted by Microsoft Excel as "NAME?".
- When exporting data from a worksheet that uses scaled numbers, the scaled values displayed in the worksheet will be exported instead of the actual values. For more information, see ["Understanding how numeric values are displayed" on page 153](#).



Tip: You can also export data by clicking **Export Data**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.

Export data to a text file

You can export worksheet data to a text file, which opens in any word processor. When exporting data to a text file, you can choose whether column headers are exported with the data. Column formatting, such as font color and column width, cannot be exported with the data. For example, if you use red to signify negative values, this will not be reflected in the exported data.

If you are exporting worksheets that hide duplicate values, you must specify how these values are exported. The option you select depends on how you want the data to be used in the text file. For example, if you want to hide the duplicate values and not include them in the text file, you can clear the values. You can also override the worksheet's setting by showing the duplicate values in the text file.

If you clear the duplicate values, they are not exported, and you will be unable to use the text file to import data.

If you have applied a worksheet search to limit the number of records shown in the worksheet, the search conditions are not displayed in the text file when you export the data.

You can also import data from a text file. For more information, see ["Import data from a text file" on page 379](#).

1. On the **Data** menu, click **Export Data**.
2. In the **Export Data** dialog box, specify the location to save the file.
3. In the **File name** box, type a name for the file or accept the default.
The file name cannot contain more than 217 characters, and cannot contain any of the following characters: \ / : * ? < > |
4. In the **Files of type** list, click **Tab-Delimited Text (*.tab)**.
5. Optionally, in the **Encoding** list, click one of the following:
 - **ANSI (System Locale)**—plain text non-Unicode encoding. The exported file will use the locale setting of RapidResponse.
 - **Unicode**—a 16-bit character encoding system that supports the processing and display of the major texts in the world. Use Unicode encoding for data that will be used in a multi-lingual setting.
 - **Unicode (Big Endian)**—A sequence of bytes is stored with the most significant value first (a word is stored big-end first). This format is usually supported on computers that do not use an x86 CPU (Intel and AMD) such as the older generation Macintosh computers which used a Motorola CPU.
 - **Unicode (UTF-8)**—an 8-bit version of Unicode that can be used with transmission media that supports only 8 bits of data within one byte. Use the UTF-8 version of Unicode for data that will be used in a multi-lingual setting, and on different operating systems. It is also important to use UTF-8 for files exported in XML format.
6. To include column headers in the text file, select the **Include column headers** check box.
7. In the **Format hidden duplicate data values** list, click **Clear** or **Show**.
For more information these options, see ["Exporting data" on page 317](#).
8. Click **Save**.
9. Once the file is saved, you are given the option to open the file or the folder where the file is saved. If you do not want to do either, click **Cancel**.

**Notes:**

- The text file uses the regional encoding settings of the computer hosting RapidResponse. For more information, contact your RapidResponse administrator.
- Exporting very large data sets as .tab files using this method is not recommended, and might produce unexpected results. You can create an alert with a report to reliably export data to large (1 GB or greater) text files. For more information, see ["Create an alert to monitor worksheet data" on page 574](#).



Tip: You can also export data by clicking **Export Data**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.

Export data to a PDF file

You can export a worksheet's data to a Portable Document Format (PDF) file. PDF files can be opened in a PDF viewer such as Adobe Reader or Preview for Mac OS. This type of file can be distributed to people who do not use RapidResponse.

When exporting data to a PDF file, the active worksheet is exported with all column headers and formatting.

Any worksheet searches you have applied are exported with the PDF file.

1. On the **Data** menu, click **Export Data**.
2. In the **Export Data** dialog box, specify the location to save the file.
3. In the **File name** box, type a name for the file.
The file name cannot contain more than 217 characters, and cannot contain any of the following characters: \ / : * ? < > |
4. In the **Files of type** list, click **Adobe PDF File (*.pdf)**.
5. Click **Save**.
6. Once the file is saved, you are given the option to open the file or the folder where the file is saved. If you do not want to do either, click **Cancel**.



Note: Data in an PDF file can be modified using PDF editing or authoring software such as Adobe Acrobat.



Tip: You can also export data by clicking **Export Data**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.

Export data to an HTML file

You can export a worksheet's data to an HTML document, which opens in a Web browser. When exporting data to an HTML document, the active worksheet is exported with all column headers. The exported file can be uploaded to a Web site.

If you are exporting worksheets that hide duplicate values, you must specify how these values are exported. The option you select depends on how you want the data to be used in the HTML file. For

example, if you want to hide the duplicate values but include them in the HTML file for editing or reporting, you can hide the values. If you want to hide the duplicate values and not include them in the HTML file, you can clear the values. You can also override the worksheet's setting by showing the duplicate values in the HTML file.

1. On the **Data** menu, click **Export Data**.
2. In the **Export Data** dialog box, specify the location to save the file.
3. In the **File name** box, type a name for the file.
The file name cannot contain more than 217 characters, and cannot contain any of the following characters: \ / : * ? < > |
4. In the **Files of type** list, click **HTML Document (*.html)**.
5. Optionally, in the **Encoding** list, click one of the following:
 - **ANSI (System Locale)**—plain text non-Unicode encoding. The exported file will use the locale setting of RapidResponse.
 - **Unicode**—a 16-bit character encoding system that supports the processing and display of the major texts in the world. Use Unicode encoding for data that will be used in a multi-lingual setting.
 - **Unicode (Big Endian)**—A sequence of bytes is stored with the most significant value first (a word is stored big-end first). This format is usually supported on computers that do not use an x86 CPU (Intel and AMD) such as the older generation Macintosh computers which used a Motorola CPU.
 - **Unicode (UTF-8)**—an 8-bit version of Unicode that can be used with transmission media that supports only 8 bits of data within one byte. Use the UTF-8 version of Unicode for data that will be used in a multi-lingual setting, and on different operating systems. It is also important to use UTF-8 for files exported in XML format.
6. In the **Format hidden duplicate data values** list, click **Clear**, **Hide**, or **Show**.
For more information these options, see ["Exporting data" on page 317](#).
7. Click **Save**.
8. Once the file is saved, you are given the option to open the file or the folder where the file is saved. If you do not want to do either, click **Cancel**.



Tip: You can also export data by clicking **Export Data**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.

Export data to an XML file

You can export a worksheet's data to an XML file, which opens in a Web browser or word processor. When exporting to an XML file, the active worksheet is exported with all column headers. The exported file can be uploaded to a Web site or used to generate a report.

If you are exporting worksheets that hide duplicate values, you must specify how these values are exported. The option you select depends on how you want the data to be used in the XML file. For example, if you want to hide the duplicate values and not include them in the XML file, you can clear the values. You can also override the worksheet's setting by showing the duplicate values in the XML file.

1. On the **Data** menu, click **Export Data**.
2. In the **Export Data** dialog box, specify the location to save the file.
3. In the **File name** box, type a name for the file.

The file name cannot contain more than 217 characters, and cannot contain any of the following characters: \ / : * ? < > |

4. In the **Files of type** list, click **XML Document (*.xml)**.
5. Optionally, in the **Encoding** list, click one of the following:
 - **ANSI (System Locale)**—plain text non-Unicode encoding. The exported file will use the locale setting of RapidResponse.
 - **Unicode**—a 16-bit character encoding system that supports the processing and display of the major texts in the world. Use Unicode encoding for data that will be used in a multi-lingual setting.
 - **Unicode (Big Endian)**—A sequence of bytes is stored with the most significant value first (a word is stored big-end first). This format is usually supported on computers that do not use an x86 CPU (Intel and AMD) such as the older generation Macintosh computers which used a Motorola CPU.
 - **Unicode (UTF-8)**—an 8-bit version of Unicode that can be used with transmission media that supports only 8 bits of data within one byte. Use the UTF-8 version of Unicode for data that will be used in a multi-lingual setting, and on different operating systems. It is also important to use UTF-8 for files exported in XML format.
6. In the **Format hidden duplicate data values** list, click **Clear** or **Show**.
For more information these options, see ["Exporting data" on page 317](#).
7. Click **Save**.
8. Once the file is saved, you are given the option to open the file or the folder where the file is saved. If you do not want to do either, click **Cancel**.



Tip: You can also export data by clicking **Export Data**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.

Copy and paste data

You can copy data from a RapidResponse worksheet and paste it into another application. For example, you could copy records and paste them into a Microsoft Excel file, or copy a list of part names and paste them into an email message.

When you copy numeric data (including money values), the raw values are copied to the Clipboard. For example, if a cell displays 39 but has been rounded from 38.7 then the clipboard holds the raw value of 38.7 when copied. This is similar to what happens with scaled data. Assume a cell holds a value of 9 but it represents 9000 (it has been scaled by a thousand). When this cell is copied to the Clipboard, the clipboard will hold the value of 9000. Percentage values are an exception to this rule. For more information, see ["Copying percent values" on page 359](#).

When you paste a cell's data into another application (other than RapidResponse), the actual (raw or unscaled) values are pasted instead of the formatted value. For example, if you copied the cell that held \$39, it would be pasted into Microsoft Word or Microsoft Excel as 38.7 without the currency symbol (this value is based on the previous example).

When you paste a cell's data in RapidResponse, the value is displayed using the number formatting of the cell where it was pasted.

For more information, see ["Understanding how numeric values are displayed" on page 153](#).

► Copy data

1. Select the worksheet cell or cells to copy. If you select data by clicking and dragging along the row numbers, the row numbers are also copied.
2. On the **Edit** menu, click **Copy**.



Notes:

- Data formatting, such as color, is not copied.
- The maximum number of worksheet rows you can copy at one time is 500. If you copy more than the maximum number of rows allowed, export the data. For more information about exporting data, see ["Export data to a text file" on page 323](#).



Tip: You can also copy data by clicking **Copy**  on the toolbar or pressing CTRL+C (or Command + C if you are using Mac OS).

► Paste data

- Open another application, and paste the data by pressing CTRL+V (or Command + V if you are using Mac OS).

CHAPTER 26: Printing reports

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You can print reports from RapidResponse worksheets and scorecards. Printed reports are helpful when reviewing large amounts of data, and can also be used as part of a presentation. RapidResponse prints reports as PDF documents that open in your default PDF viewer. For example, Adobe Reader or Preview for Mac OS.

By default, you can print a maximum of 200 pages per report, however, your RapidResponse administrator might have modified the limit. If your printed report exceeds the maximum limit, you are notified on the first page of the report. If this occurs, use a different filter or search to reduce the content of the report.

You cannot print a worksheet that exceeds the worksheet record limit. If your RapidResponse administrator has granted you permission to override the record limit, you must retrieve all records before you can print the worksheet. Otherwise, you must filter or search the worksheet data to reduce the number of records returned before you can print the worksheet.

You can also print messages that you have received in Message Center. For more information, see ["Print a message" on page 441](#).

Asian characters

To print reports that include Asian characters, download an Asian font pack for Adobe Reader if you are not using an Asian version of Microsoft Windows. You might also need to contact your RapidResponse administrator to ensure the printing of Asian characters is properly set up.

Saving reports

As part of the printing process, RapidResponse generates a PDF file. If you want to send this file by email, you must first save it and then attach it to an email message.

Before you print

The following table provides suggestions on what to do before printing a report. You can also hide columns that you do not want to include in printed reports. For example, you might not want to print columns that contain confidential financial data. For more information, see ["Hide worksheet columns" on page 132](#).

Before you print	For more information, see
Adjust the worksheet column widths on screen. Make columns that have a lot of blank space narrower, or widen columns that do not display all of the data.	"Set worksheet viewing options" on page 129 .
Set up the page layout: • Set page orientation. Print worksheets with fewer columns vertically on a page (portrait), and worksheets with many columns horizontally on a page (landscape). • Choose a paper size. • Set page margins.	"Set page orientation and paper size" on page 333 and "Define page margins" on page 333 .
Adjust how much information is printed on a page.	"Adjust the amount of information printed on a page" on page 333 .
Customize the appearance of the report.	"Customizing appearance of printed reports" on page 332 .
Include information about resources, such as scenarios and filters on the printed report.	"Include data settings in printed reports" on page 333 .
Add or modify headers and footers.	"Set headers and footers for printed reports" on page 334 .

Print worksheet data

1. If you want to print specific rows, select them on the worksheet.
2. On the **File** menu, click **Print**.
3. In the **Print** dialog box, click one of the options.
4. Click **OK**.
5. The worksheet data is opened in your default PDF viewer. For example, Adobe Reader or Preview for Mac OS.
6. Use the printing tools in your PDF viewer to the print the data.



Notes:

- A page break might occur after each subtotal row if you are printing a worksheet that contains subtotal rows. This setting is specified by the worksheet author.
- If the worksheet exceeds the worksheet record limit, you can print only the workbook or worksheet help.
- If you select **Worksheet help** or **Workbook help**, the help is displayed as an HTML document.



Tip: You can also print all the rows in a worksheet by clicking **Quick Print**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.

Print scorecard data

1. When working in a scorecard, on the **File** menu, click **Print**.
2. If the scorecard help is visible, in the **Print** dialog box, click one of the options.
3. Click **OK**.
4. The scorecard data is opened in your default PDF viewer. For example, Adobe Reader or Preview for Mac OS.
5. Use the printing tools in your PDF viewer to the print the data.



Notes:

- For information about printing the details of a metric included in a scorecard, see ["Print worksheet data" on page 330](#).
- If you select **Scorecard help**, the help is displayed as an HTML document.

Copy and print dashboard widgets

You can copy and print dashboard widgets for use in other documents, presentations, or Web pages. You can only perform these functions at the widget level; you cannot copy or print an entire dashboard.

Depending on the widget type, the procedure for copying and printing differs. For chart widgets, the procedures are the same as for charts that are displayed in worksheets. You can also save a chart widget. For more information, see ["Copy, print, and save a chart" on page 215](#).

For worksheet widgets, the printing and copying procedures are the same as for worksheets. For more information, see ["Print worksheet data" on page 330](#) and ["Copy and paste data" on page 326](#).

Text widgets can only be printed.

► Copy a chart widget

1. Select the widget in the dashboard.
2. On the **Edit** menu, click **Copy Chart**.



Tip: You can also copy a chart widget by right-clicking on the widget itself and then clicking **Copy Chart**.

► Print a widget

1. Select the widget in the dashboard.
2. On the **File** menu, click **Print**.

3. In the **Print** dialog box, select print options.
4. Click **OK**.



Note: You cannot print an entire dashboard from the RapidResponse menu. To create a screen capture for use in another application, press PRINT SCREEN to copy the entire screen, or ALT+PRINT SCREEN to copy the active window.



Tip: You can also print a widget by clicking **Quick Print** on the RapidResponse toolbar or right-clicking on the widget itself and then clicking **Print**.

Save a report as a PDF file

1. Print the worksheet data you want to save as the PDF file.
RapidResponse prints reports as PDF documents that open in your default PDF viewer. For example, Adobe Reader or Preview for Mac OS.
2. In the PDF viewer application, specify a location where you want to save the PDF file.

Customizing appearance of printed reports

Your RapidResponse administrator, or the author of the worksheets and scorecards to which you have access, likely configured their printed layout. If these settings do not meet your needs, you can change them by setting page layout, customizing the report appearance, and including information about selected resources on the report.

You can also set headers and footers for printed reports. If standard headers and footers are defined for your organization, any printed reports from a shared worksheet or scorecard use the standard headers and footers to ensure consistency of printed reports across your organization. For more information about headers and footers, see ["Set headers and footers for printed reports" on page 334](#).

The print options you select are saved with the worksheet or scorecard until the next time you change them.

► Access Print Setup options

- When working in a worksheet or scorecard, on the **File** menu, click **Print Setup**.

► Specify whether gridlines and row numbers are printed.

1. In the **Print Setup** dialog box, click the **Options** tab.
2. Select any options you want.



Note: You cannot print row numbers when printing a scorecard or a crosstab worksheet.

► Set page orientation and paper size

1. In the **Print Setup** dialog box, click the **Page** tab.
2. In the **Orientation** section, click **Portrait** or **Landscape**.
3. From the **Paper size** list, select a paper size.

► Define page margins

1. In the **Print Setup** dialog box, click the **Page** tab.
2. In the **Margins** area, specify the options you want.



Note: The margin unit setting you select applies to all of your worksheets and scorecards. For example, if you select Inches, the margins for reports printed from all of your worksheets and scorecards are calculated in inches.

Include data settings in printed reports

You can include the active data settings in a worksheet or scorecard, for example, the scenario and filter, in a printed report. For information about the resources that you might be able to select when viewing a worksheet, see ["Display data in a worksheet" on page 146](#). For information about scorecards, see ["Viewing scorecard data " on page 279](#).

1. In the **Print Setup** dialog box, click the **Options** tab.
2. In the **Data settings** area, select the **Include data settings** check box.
3. In the **Print data settings on** section, click one of the following:
 - **All pages**
 - **First page only**



Note: If the header or footer definition for the printed report includes information about resources, the resource information is duplicated on the printed report.

Adjust the amount of information printed on a page

You can adjust the amount of information printed on a page by scaling the printed document. You might want to scale the document if your worksheet is too wide to be printed on one page, or if you want to enlarge the output to make it easier to read.

The scaling of the report can be affected by the other page layout options. For example, if you adjust the document to print one page wide using a portrait orientation, the columns are reduced more than on a landscape orientation, thus making the document harder to read. Always consider the page layout options when scaling the document.

1. In the **Print Setup** dialog box, click the **Page** tab,
2. In the **Scaling** section, click one of the following.
 - **Actual**—Prints the data in the actual font size.
 - **Adjust to**—Reduces or enlarges the printed information by the percentage value you specify.
 - **Adjust to fit on one page wide**—Reduces or enlarges the printed information to fit onto one page.



Note: The zoom controls on the status bar that are used to control the zoom level on worksheet grids do not affect the appearance of printed reports.

Set headers and footers for printed reports

You can define the appearance and content of the headers and footers displayed in printed reports.

If your RapidResponse administrator standardized the appearance of headers and footers in all printed reports from shared worksheets or scorecards, you can customize the headers and footers only when printing private worksheets and scorecards. Shared worksheets and scorecards use the company-standard headers and footers.

Any settings you create for worksheets and scorecards are stored, so that when your administrator turns off the standardized headers and footers, your header and footer settings for shared workbooks and scorecards are restored.

When setting the header or footer, you can specify that certain information in the header or footer be automatically generated during printing. For example, you can ensure that the active filter name display in the header or footer. When you insert an AutoText item, the AutoText code displays in the box. It consists of the text from the AutoText items list in square brackets, preceded by an ampersand (&), for example, &[Filter]. The items available in the Auto Text list depend on whether you are printing a worksheet or a scorecard summary.

AutoText items you can add

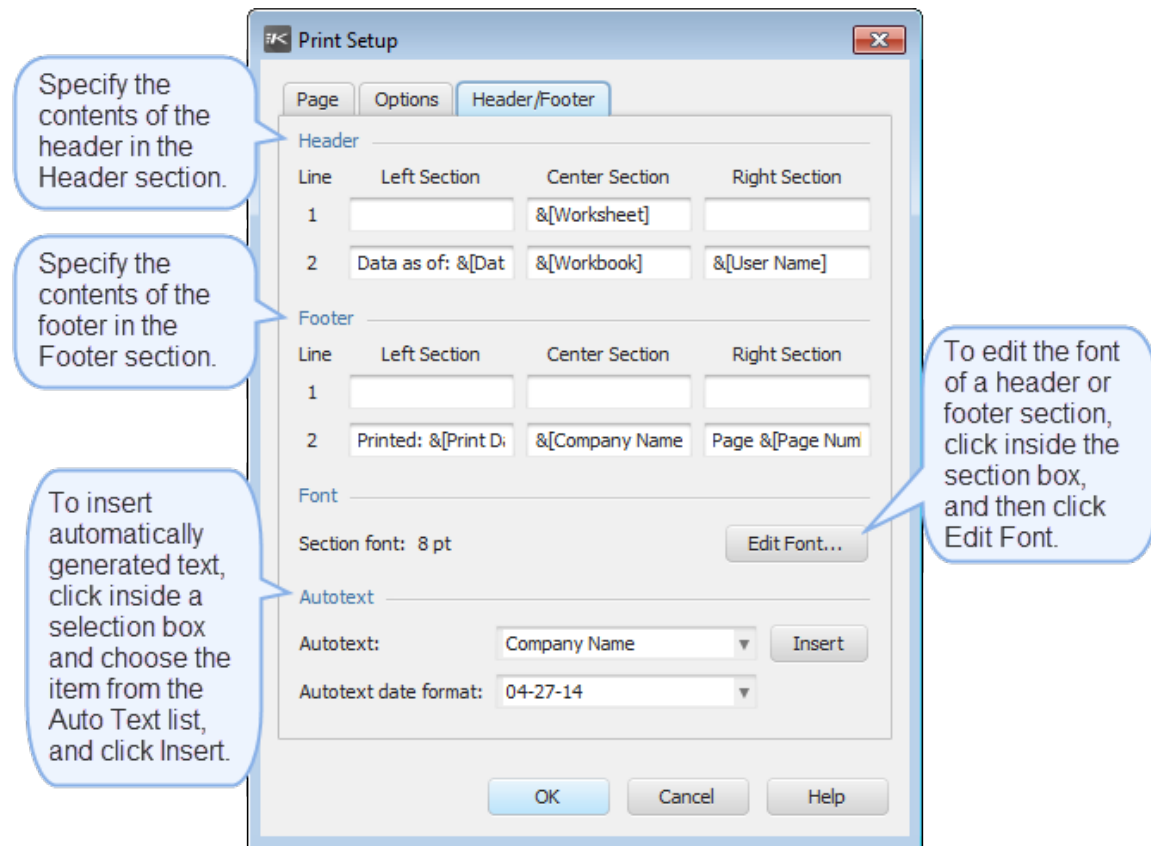
AutoText item	Description
Company Name	Your company's name.
Constraint	The active constraint.
Data as of Date	The date that data was last updated in RapidResponse.
Filter	The active filter.
Filter: Private/Shared	Indicates whether the active filter is private or shared.
Model	The active model.
Page Number	The number of the page in the report.
Part	The selected part.
Pool	The active inventory pool.

AutoText item	Description
Print Date	The date the report was printed.
Scenario	The active scenario.
Scenario: Private/Shared	Indicates whether the active scenario is private or shared.
Site(s)	The active site or sites.
Time Zone	Your time zone.
User ID	Your user ID.
User Name	Your name.
Work Center	The active work center.
Workbook	The active workbook.
Workbook: Private/Shared	Indicates whether the active workbook is private or shared.
Worksheet	The active worksheet.

► Set a header or footer

1. When working in a worksheet or scorecard, on the **File** menu, click **Print Setup**.
2. Click the **Header/Footer** tab.
3. In the **Header** or **Footer** section, click in the box where you want to insert text, and do any of the following:
 - To insert text that is automatically generated during printing, in the **AutoText** list, click the item you want to insert, and then click **Insert**. AutoText can be combined with fixed text you type.
 - To insert fixed text, type the constant text you want.
 Repeat this step for each header and footer section for which you want to specify content.
4. In the **AutoText date format** list, click a date format. This date format is applied to all **AutoText**

dates.



► Edit the font of headers and footers

1. When working in a worksheet or scorecard, on the **File** menu, click **Print Setup**.
2. Click the **Header/Footer** tab.
3. Click inside one of the boxes where you specify header or footer content, and then click **Edit Font**.
4. Set the font options, and then click **OK**.



Notes:

- The font is changed for the text in the individual box. To change the font for each header or footer element, you must change the font in each box.
- If you click **Cancel** in the **Print Setup** dialog box, any changes made to the fonts are not saved.

Part 4: Editing data

- ["Modifying data in workbooks" on page 339](#)
- ["Transferring inventory" on page 371](#)
- ["Importing data" on page 377](#)
- ["Worksheets for importing data from a Microsoft Excel file" on page 399](#)

You can modify data in RapidResponse worksheets by editing or deleting existing records, or by inserting new records. The data is actually modified in a scenario you can edit. See ["Scenarios in RapidResponse" on page 17](#). Modifying data in RapidResponse is different that in other spreadsheet or database applications. Considerations unique to RapidResponse are outlined below.

After editing or deleting records in a worksheet, the worksheet tab is marked with an asterisk (*) to indicate that data has been changed and not yet saved.

Updated Orders A Parts CM3 = All = = All =										
Independent Demands* Scheduled Receipts On Hand Bills Of Material Operations										
	Part		Due	Quantity	Order					Shipped
	Name	Site	Date		Type	Site	Number	Line	Customer ID	Quantity
				90						
1	AC002	CM3	07-25-17	90	CMDemand	CM3	TCS-003	214	TCS	0
2	AC002	CM3	09-26-17	90	CMDemand	CM3	TCS-003	215	TCS	

Save your changes from the File menu or by clicking the Save icon on the RapidResponse toolbar. See ["Save data changes" on page 366](#).

The following lists additional information about saving data in a worksheet:

- When you insert a record, the new record is automatically saved and you do not need to save the data changes.
- You can edit data in multiple worksheets and then save all of the changes. Each worksheet with modified data is marked with an asterisk until the changes are saved.
- Some workbooks that process large amounts of data are set to manually refresh the worksheet data. This means that after saving data in a worksheet, you have to refresh the data in the workbook first to see the effect of those changes in other worksheets in the workbook. For more information, see ["Display most recent data" on page 158](#).
- After you modify data in a worksheet and save the changes, all other worksheets in the workbook are automatically updated to reflect those data changes. Data changes in other open workbooks are reflected after you switch focus to these workbooks.
- Saving data changes in some workbooks can start a process that modifies additional data in that workbook or other workbooks, or in different scenarios. For more information, see ["Run workbook commands" on page 360](#).

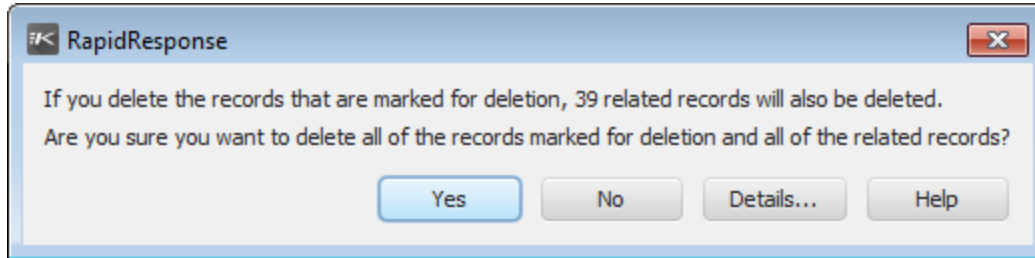
Additional considerations

- You can only modify data in a private scenario or in a shared scenario that you have been authorized to modify, providing that your administrator has also granted you permission to modify shared scenarios.
- Modifying data in RapidResponse does not modify data in your enterprise data source.
- Some worksheets might automatically update calculated fields as you move to another row or cell to cell in the worksheet.
- Data cannot be modified in worksheets that contain multi-scenario columns or in worksheets with grouped columns unless the worksheet author has enabled a column to be editable.
- In some cases, data you modify might be a calculated value. When you modify a calculated value, the underlying values are modified to produce a result close to, but not the same as, the value you entered.
- Some workbooks display the aggregate average value of summarized detail records, as opposed to the sum of detail record values. There are special considerations for editing average values. For more information, see ["Edit summarized records in average values" on page 352](#).
- Forms can be used to modify data in the RapidResponse database. For more information, see ["About forms" on page 601](#).

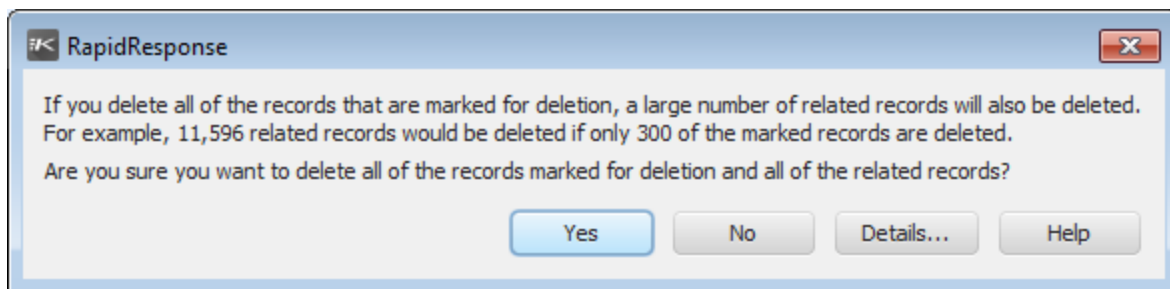
Delete records

When you delete a record, you are actually deleting all the information related to that record from the active scenario. This has important implications on your data, because if you delete a record that is referenced by a record in another table, that referencing record is also deleted. This can result in a large number of records being deleted. For example, if you delete a part record, other records that reference that part value are also deleted (this might include bill of material, on hand inventory, and scheduled receipt records).

If deleting a given record causes related records to be deleted, you are presented with a confirmation dialog box that displays how many other records will be deleted, and you can view a list of database tables that records will be deleted from. The confirmation dialog box is shown in the following illustration.



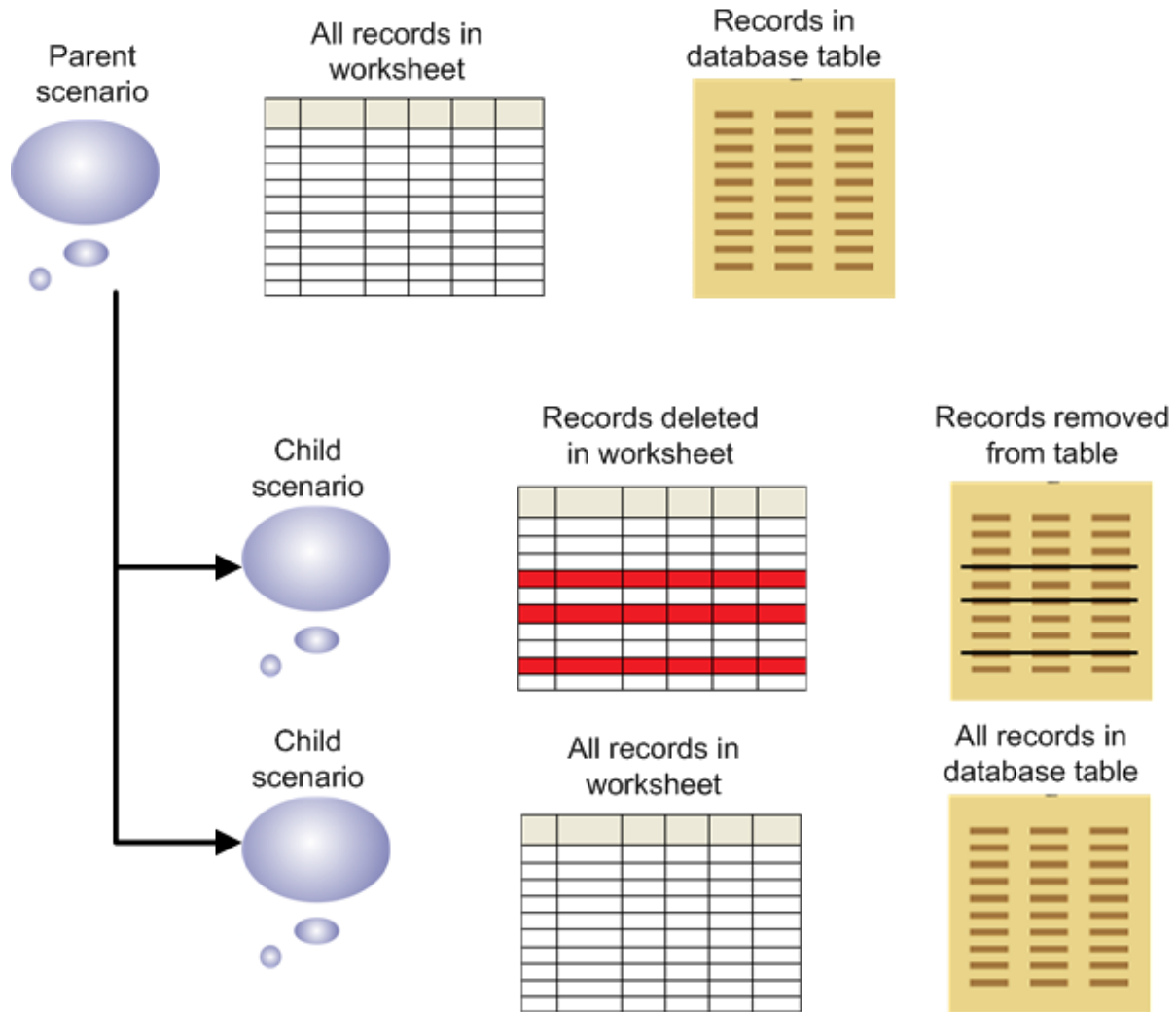
Note that if you delete more than 300 records, the number of related records that will be deleted is displayed for only 300 of the records, as shown in the following illustration. This number represents the minimum number of records that will be deleted, and the actual number of deleted records can be greater.



For more information about database tables, see the [RapidResponse Analytic and Data Model Guide](#), or contact your RapidResponse administrator if you do not have access to this guide.

You must have permission to edit data in the scenario in order to delete records from it. If you do not have permission, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

Deleted records are removed from the active scenario, but are available in other scenarios, as shown in the following illustration.



However, if you delete records in a scenario, you cannot replace those records by updating the scenario with data from its parent. If you commit a scenario after deleting records, those records are deleted from the parent scenario. For more information about updating and committing scenarios, see ["Update data in a scenario" on page 470](#) and ["Commit data changes to a parent scenario" on page 474](#). Deleting records cannot be undone.

Marking records for deletion

Before you delete records, you must mark them for deletion. The marked records are then deleted when you save your changes. When you mark records for deletion in a worksheet that is in table view, they are usually crossed through.

General*							
Planning Policies							
Range of Coverage Overrides							
Reference Parts							
Interchangeable Parts							
Unit of Measure							
	Part	Site	Description	Type	Control Set	Reference Part	ABC Code
1	AC001	030	Audio Card Standard	Outsource	Default	AC001	A
2	AC001	AmeriComp	Audio Card Standard	Normal	Default	AC001	A
3	AC001	BAU-Taiwan	Audio Card Standard	Normal	Default	AC001	A
4	AC001	CM3	Audio Card Standard	CMMP5	Default	AC001	A
5	AC001	CM3-030	Audio Card Standard	MPS	Default	AC001	A

In Form view, records marked for deletion are usually marked with a blue background.

Demand Orders	On Hand*	Supply Orders
Part:	AC-0101	
Site:	HQ	
Quantity:	891	
Type:	Net	

Workbook authors can set worksheets to automatically recalculate results when you make changes to the data. If the worksheet automatically calculates results, records marked for deletion disappear from view immediately. You can still undo the changes and restore the records until you save the changes.

► Delete a record

1. Select the worksheet records you want to delete.
2. On the **Edit** menu, click **Delete**.
The record is marked for deletion.
3. On the **File** menu, click **Save Data**.
4. In the confirmation dialog box, click **Yes** to delete the records or **Details** to view a list of database tables from which records will be deleted.



Notes:

- A small number of RapidResponse reference fields are nullable. These fields are not necessarily required to point to a valid record in the referenced table, and can be left empty (null) if no value is provided. When a record is deleted from a referenced table, values in tables which point to the deleted record through a nullable reference can be configured to have the reference set to null instead of deleting the entire referencing record. For more information about nullable reference fields, see the [RapidResponse Analytic and Data Model Guide](#) or talk to your administrator.



- If you are unable to delete a record in a scenario that you have permission to modify, the workbook author has disabled record deletion in that worksheet. Contact the workbook author or your administrator to enable deletions.
- If records are deleted from a shared scenario, other users can see the changes by clicking the **Pending Commits** or **Pending Updates** tabs on the **Scenario Properties** tab.



Tip: You can also mark records for deletion by clicking **Delete Record(s)**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.

Edit records

You can edit worksheet records in columns that are modifiable. For example, in a Customer Orders worksheet, you can edit the Quantity and Due Date of an order, but not the Order Number. The pen icon indicates that you can edit the records in a column.

Supply & Demand		Split Supplies	In Process (Planned)	D
	Part	Site	Number:Line	Type
1	AC-0201	HQ		
2				
3			PO-02227-02:1	PO
4			PO-02228-02:1	PO
5			PO-02229-02:1	PO

The pen icon indicates columns that are editable.



Caution: Avoid editing shared scenarios. Conflicts can occur when multiple users edit the same scenario simultaneously.

Conflicts can be caused by the following actions:

- **Modify**—Another user modified a record while you were making changes in the same scenario. When you save your edits, they are overwritten by the other user's version of the scenario.
- **Delete**—Either you modify a record that another user deletes, or you delete a record that another user modifies. When the changes are saved, the record is deleted.

► Edit a cell

- Select the cell you want to change, and then enter the new value.



Notes:

- To edit a date, you can click the arrow to select a date from the calendar. For more



information, click **Help** on the Calendar.

- If a cell is formatted to display a check box, select or clear the check box to modify the value.
- In a scaled-number column, you can either select the cell in order to edit the scaled value, or double-click the cell to edit the actual value. Scaled numbers display significant digits after the decimal symbol. For example, if the actual value is 100,134, and the column is scaled in thousands, the formatted value is 100 and displays as 100.134 in edit mode. For more information, see ["Understanding how numeric values are displayed" on page 153](#).
- When you edit a monetary value, the value represents the currency that the column displays. This does not change the currency of the record in the underlying table. For more information, see ["View money data in a worksheet" on page 151](#).



Tip: When you **Copy**  a value in a check-box column, the 'Y' (Yes) and 'N' (No) Boolean values are copied. The values that you **Paste**  into a check-box column must be either 'Y' or 'N'.

Edit Range

You can edit a range of cells in a worksheet column, if the cells are adjacent and the worksheet is set to Table view.

You can perform mathematical operations on numerical data, such as multiplying by 2 to double each cell value. You can also change all cells to the same value, or copy a value from another column.

When using **Edit Range** to modify cells in columns that use numbers or percentage scaling, the following rules apply:

- **Add, Subtract, Change to:** Enter values as scaled numbers. For example, adding 2 to a cell in a column that is scaled to thousands adds 2000 to the cell.
 - **Multiply by, Divide by:** Enter values in actual numbers. For example, multiplying a cell value by 2 on a cell that is scaled to thousands multiplies the cell by 2, not 2000.
- For more information, see ["Understanding how numeric values are displayed" on page 153](#).

► Edit cells in multiple records

1. Select the cells that you want to edit.
To select the entire column, click the column heading.
2. On the **Edit** menu, click **Edit Range**.
3. In the **Edit Range** dialog box, make the appropriate selections.
For more information, see ["Edit dates, and dates and time" on page 346](#).



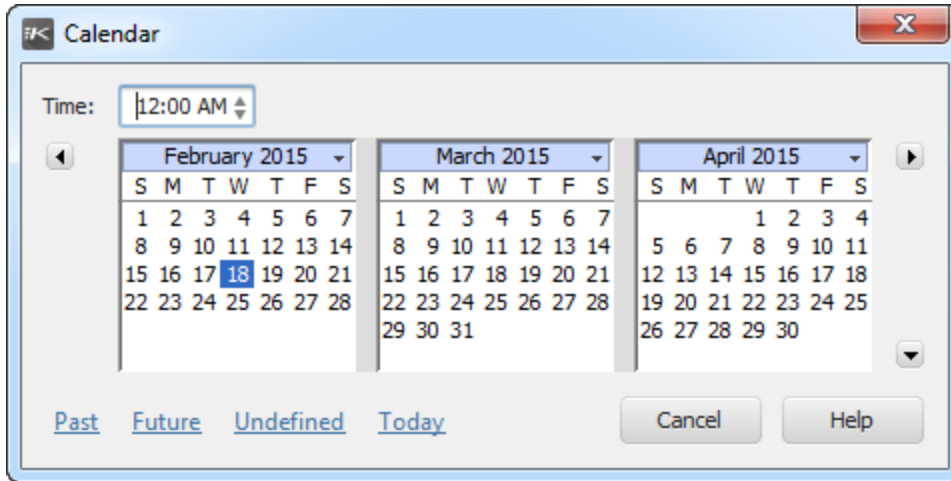
Note: When using **Edit Range** to copy values into a currency-formatted column, the source-column's values are not converted to the destination column's currency. This might result in incorrect or unexpected data values in the column.



Tip: You can also edit multiple records by clicking **Edit Range**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.

Edit dates, and dates and time

You can edit date, and date and time values in worksheets and other resources. Typically, you edit a date by typing a date in a worksheet cell or by selecting a date from the calendar shown in the following illustration. The Time control is not available for date-only fields.



You can also edit date, and date and time values by:

- Copying values from another worksheet column.
- Changing a range of dates to a different date value.
- Moving a date in or out by adding or subtracting a specific period of time, such as three days or two weeks.

When you move a date, you specify a RapidResponse calendar and the number of calendar units to add or subtract. RapidResponse calendars contain a series of dates defined by your company, and different calendars contain different dates. For example, you might have a Workday calendar that defines every work day, a Week calendar that defines the first work day of each week, and a Month calendar that defines the first work day of each month.

The following illustration shows some examples of RapidResponse calendars. The shaded dates are defined in the calendar.

Workday calendar

JULY							AUGUST							SEPTEMBER						
S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S
		1	2	3	4	5						1	2		1	2	3	4	5	6
6	7	8	9	10	11	12	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
13	14	15	16	17	18	19	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
20	21	22	23	24	25	26	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	21	22	23	24	25	26	27
27	28	29	30	31			24	25	26	27	28	29	30	28	29	30				
							31													

Week calendar

JULY							AUGUST							SEPTEMBER						
S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S
		1	2	3	4	5						1	2		1	2	3	4	5	6
6	7	8	9	10	11	12	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
13	14	15	16	17	18	19	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
20	21	22	23	24	25	26	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	21	22	23	24	25	26	27
27	28	29	30	31			24	25	26	27	28	29	30	28	29	30				
							31													

Month calendar

JULY							AUGUST							SEPTEMBER						
S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S
		1	2	3	4	5						1	2		1	2	3	4	5	6
6	7	8	9	10	11	12	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
13	14	15	16	17	18	19	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
20	21	22	23	24	25	26	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	21	22	23	24	25	26	27
27	28	29	30	31			24	25	26	27	28	29	30	28	29	30				
							31													

The calendars available to you depend on your company's calendars, and might not match the ones used in these examples.

Some examples of adding and subtracting dates in the above calendars are shown in the following table.

Date Value	Edit	Result
Friday, August 29	Add 3 Workdays	Thursday, September 4
Tuesday, July 15	Add 10 Workdays	Tuesday, July 29
Tuesday, September 9	Subtract 2 Weeks	Monday, August 25
Wednesday, July 9	Add 1 Month	Friday, August 1
Thursday, August 14	Subtract 0 Months	Friday, August 1
Thursday, August 14	Subtract 1 Month	Tuesday, July 1

When you add or subtract a number of calendar units, the result is always a date in that calendar. However, if you add or subtract a value and the result is outside of the calendar's defined dates, the result is the Past or Future date constant, respectively.

► Select a date from a calendar

1. Click the down arrow beside the date you want to modify.
2. In the **Calendar** dialog box, click the date you want.

3. On the **File** menu, click **Save Data**.

► Edit a range of dates

You can edit one date or contiguous dates in the same worksheet column.

1. Select the date or dates you want to modify.
To select the whole column, click the column heading.
2. On the **Edit** menu, click **Edit Range**.
3. To move the dates by adding or subtracting a number of calendar units, do the following:
 - In the **Operation** list, click **Add** or **Subtract**.
 - In the **Value** box, type the number of calendar units you want to add to or subtract from the date.
 - In the **Calendar unit** list, click the calendar to use for adding or subtracting.
4. To change the range of dates to a different value, do the following:
 - In the **Operation** list, click **Change to**.
 - In the **Value** box, type the date you want to change the range of dates to.
5. To copy the date values from another column, do the following:
 - In the **Operation** list, click **Copy from column**.
 - In the **Column** list, click the column that contains the dates you want to copy.
6. Click **OK**.
7. On the **File** menu, click **Save Data**.



Note: If you add or subtract values from the Past, Future, or Undefined date constants, the date does not change.



Tip: You can also click **Edit Range**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.

Past and Future date limitations

RapidResponse can store specific dates from January 2, 1970 through December 31, 2037. The Past and Future date constants are used to represent dates that fall outside of this range.

When you enter a date using a date format where the year is represented by two digits, 70 through 99 are interpreted as 1970 through 1999. The years 00 through 69 are interpreted as 2000 through 2069. For example, 12-31-30 is interpreted as December 31, 2030.



Notes:

- If you enter a date in a worksheet that is after December 31, 2037, it is changed to "Future." If you enter January 1, 1970, it is changed to "Past."
- You cannot enter dates prior to 1970.

Edit records in a crosstab worksheet

You can edit records in crosstab worksheets that contain rows that are modifiable. For example, in a crosstab worksheet showing customer demands over time, you can change the values in quantity rows that have been made modifiable. The pencil icons represent which rows you can edit, as shown in the following illustration.

Orders by Due Date		Forecast	Forecast - Scaled			
	Part	Customer		Past	06-02-14	07-01-14
1	ACKIT-01	eBikes	Quantity			2,400
2			Revenue			\$147,920
3	ACKIT-02	eBikes	Quantity			3,000
4			Revenue		\$21,733	\$184,900
5	ACKIT-03D	eBikes	Quantity		300	1,350
6			Revenue		\$15,178	\$91,070

Pen icon indicates that rows are editable.

Pen icon indicates that rows are editable.

Because crosstab worksheets display summarized data, any changes you make are reflected in the data that is summarized to create the crosstab view. You can edit crosstab values to be negative only if the workbook's author has allowed negative values.

Depending on how the workbook author has specified that records are modified in crosstab worksheets, the result in the columns might not match the values you enter. This might happen if the individual records in each bucket cannot contain decimal values, or if the value in the bucket is calculated by multiplying values together, such as a column that calculates revenue values by multiplying an order quantity by its selling price. In these cases, when you modify the revenue value, the quantity is modified, and the new quantity used to calculate the new revenue value. If the calculated value is summarized from many records, the quantity of each order record is modified, and the calculated result of each order summarized to produce the overall total. Depending on the values used in the calculations, the result can be greater than or less than the value you entered in the revenue column. If the value in the cell is zero, you cannot modify the value in the cell.

If the worksheet is configured to not allow decimal values, the values added to or subtracted from each record summarized in the column must be whole numbers. In these cases, the values might not divide evenly into the amount you modified the column by, and the value in the column after the modification will typically not match the value you entered in the column.

Depending on how the crosstab worksheet has been created, editing a cell might insert a new record. For more information, see ["Insert a record" on page 366](#).

When you edit data in a shared scenario, you might modify a record that another user has modified. In this case, when you save your changes, you are warned that your changes conflict with another user's changes. You are also asked whether you want to continue saving the data changes, which will overwrite your changes with changes made by the other user, or to cancel saving the data, which undoes all your changes.

Conflicts can be caused by the following:

- **Modify**—The record you are modifying was modified by another user while you were making your changes. When you save your changes, they are overwritten by the other user's changes.
- **Delete**—Either you modify a record that another user deletes, or you delete a record that another user modifies. When you save the changes, the record is deleted.

If the crosstab worksheet uses a hierarchy to summarize data, you cannot edit the values in cells that do not contain records. To change these values, you must insert a record. For more information, see ["Insert a record" on page 366](#). For more information about hierarchies, see ["Filter and summarize data with hierarchies" on page 304](#).

If you edit data in a worksheet summarized with a hierarchy, the change affects records at lower levels of the hierarchy. For more information, see ["Edit summarized records in hierarchies" on page 350](#).

► Edit a crosstab cell

- Select the cell you want to change, and then type the new value.



Notes:

- If the data in the cell also contains a link to another worksheet, the number in the cell will be underlined. To edit the cell's data, click an area of the cell that does not contain text.
- Only rows that contain numerical values can be edited.
- When editing a money cell, the value you enter is saved in the currency the row displays. This value is converted when viewed in a worksheet that uses a different currency.

► Edit multiple cells in a row

1. Select the cells that you want to edit.
2. On the **Edit** menu, click **Edit Range**.
3. In the **Edit Range** dialog box, make the appropriate selections.

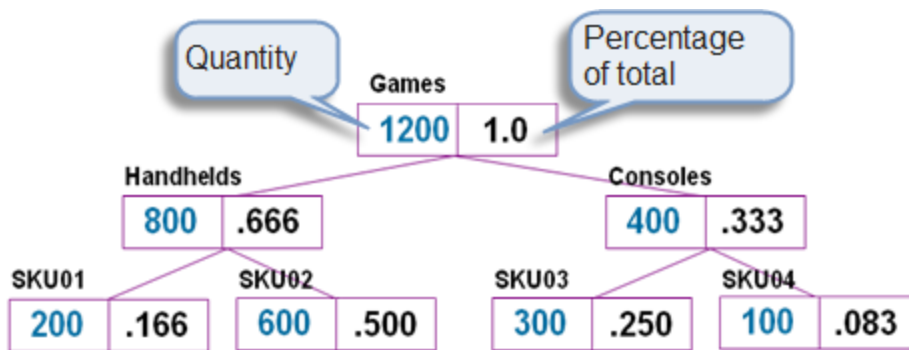
You can perform mathematical operations on numerical data, such as multiplying all cells by 2 to double each cell value. You can also change all cells so they contain the same value, or you can copy a value from another row. You can only copy values from a row with the same dimension columns. For example, in a crosstab worksheet grouped by part, you cannot copy values in a row for one part into a row for another part.

For more information about editing multiple records in a worksheet, see ["Edit cells in multiple records" on page 345](#).

Edit summarized records in hierarchies

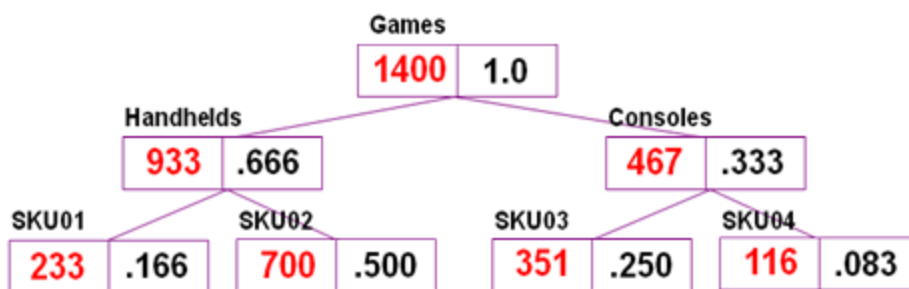
When you modify data in a worksheet that is summarized by a hierarchy, the changes you make are used to modify values in the records at the lowest level of the hierarchy, which are then summarized at the other levels of the hierarchy. For example, if you modify data at the top level of the hierarchy, the change is spread across all the records at the lowest level, and each intermediary level reflects the changes made to the records.

The modified values are spread proportionally, so records with large quantities are given larger percentages of the change. An example of quantities in a hierarchy is shown in the following illustration.



In this example, the quantities for the hierarchy values are shown with the percentage of the total quantity each quantity represents. When the quantity at a higher level is changed, the change is multiplied by the percentage to calculate the new quantity in each lower level. As you can see, the values for the intermediary levels, Handhelds and Consoles, are sums of the quantities in the records beneath them.

For example, assume the quantity for the Games level has been increased to 1,400. This increase is split between the SKU01, SKU02, SKU03, and SKU04 quantities according to their percentages of the total. The Handhelds and Consoles quantities are then calculated by adding the quantities below them. The new quantities at each level are shown in the following illustration.



For more information about editing data, see ["Edit records in a crosstab worksheet" on page 349](#).

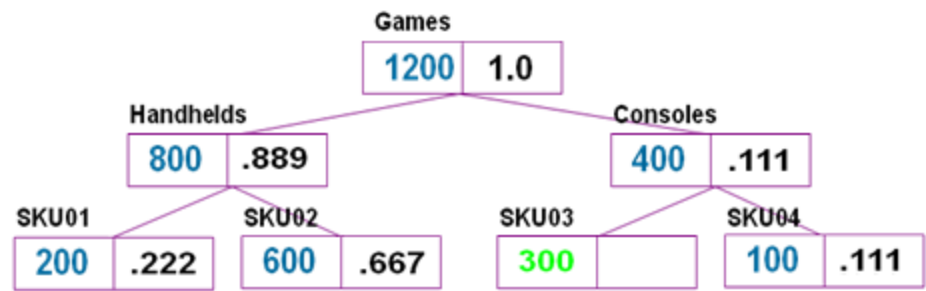
Protected records

In some cases, a workbook author might specify that some records in a worksheet be protected, meaning they are not modified when changes are made to the values at higher levels of the hierarchy.

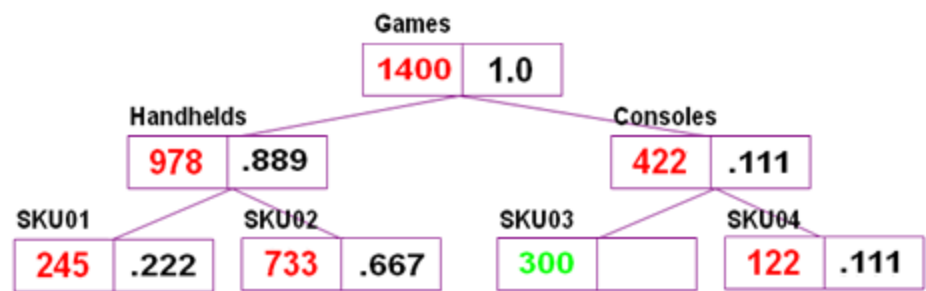
For example, assume the worksheet author has protected records for SKU03. These records are not modified when the higher level quantities are modified, so the percentage of the total for SKU03 is not calculated.

The percentages for the other quantities are calculated after setting aside the quantity for the protected record. This means the percentage for each level is calculated using the difference between the top level quantity and the protected quantity. In this example, the Handhelds level is calculated by dividing its quantity by the difference between the Games quantity and the SKU03 quantity. In this case the

Handhelds quantity is 800, and the difference between the Games and SKU-03 quantities are 900. The percentages for this situation are shown in the following illustration.



When the Games quantity is increased to 1400, the quantities for every other level are increased, except for the SKU03 quantity. The protected quantity is set aside before calculating the new quantities, meaning that the quantities for the other levels are calculated using the difference between the top level and the protected quantities. The new quantities for each level are then calculated by splitting 1100 (the Games quantity minus the protected SKU03 quantity), instead of the 1400 entered for the Games level.



Note: Protected records are only protected when editing data in crosstab worksheets. The values can be modified in vertical worksheets.

Edit summarized records in average values

In some crosstab worksheets, the records display the aggregate average value of the summarized detail records, as opposed to the total value. Editing in average values is particularly beneficial for worksheets in which you are entering and modifying forecast targets. After entering average values at an aggregate level in the hierarchy, you can then modify detail records whose value should be above or below the average value you entered.

When you increase an aggregate average value, the summarized detail records increase by the same percentage difference. For example, if the aggregate average value is 150, and you increase it to 165, that is an increase of 10%. Thus, each detail record summarized by that aggregate average value will be increased by 10%.

Inserting new records

If inserting new records in the worksheet is allowed, by default new detail records are set to the aggregate average value that you entered for the hierarchy level above. For example, if you set an aggregate average value of 100 for a product family, and then insert a new record at the product level, the quantity in the Insert Record dialog box is set to 100. You can then increase or decrease the quantity as needed.

For more information on inserting records, see ["Insert a record" on page 366](#).

Editing detail records

When you make modifications at a detail record level, the changes you make affect the aggregate average value in the hierarchy level above. In the example below, the average values have been entered at a product level.

Product

Product

Card Assy

Case Assy

Cell-Phones

Connectors and Jumpers

Displays

Electronic Components

Hardware

ICs and Processors

Memory

Annual Plan

Settings

	Product	Jun 2014	Jul 2014	Aug 2014	Sep 2014
1	Card Assy		2	1	2
2	System Assy				

In this crosstab worksheet, annual targets have been entered at the Card Assy product level. These values are averages of the summarized detail record values.

When you enter average values for a hierarchy level, the value is copied to each record below that hierarchy level. In the example below, the values that were entered at the product level are copied down to the product part level.

Product

Product

Card Assy

AC001-AMC

AC002-AMC

GC001-AMC

GC002-AMC

GC003-AMC

Case Assy

Cell-Phones

Connectors and Jumpers

Displays

Electronic Components

Annual Plan

Settings

	Product	Jun 2014	Jul 2014	Aug 2014	Sep 2014
1	AC002-AMC		2	1	2

The values entered at the Card Assy product level are copied down to each record at the product part level.

You can then edit the detail records at the product part level, as needed.

The screenshot shows a software interface with a product hierarchy on the left and a data table on the right. The hierarchy includes 'Product' (expanded) with sub-items like 'Card Assy', 'AC001-AMC', 'AC002-AMC' (selected), 'GC001-AMC', 'GC002-AMC', 'GC003-AMC', 'Case Assy', 'Cell-Phones', 'Connectors and Jumpers', 'Displays', 'Electronic Components', 'Hardware', and 'ICs and Processors'. The table has columns for 'Product', 'Part', 'Jun 2014', 'Jul 2014', 'Aug 2014', and 'Sep 2014'. The first row shows '1' in the 'Part' column and 'AC002-AMC' in the 'Product' column. The 'Jul 2014' column contains the value '3'. A callout bubble points to this value with the text: 'You can then change the values at the product part level, as was done for part AC002-AMC for July 2014 above. When you edit a value at a detail level, the changes are aggregated up to change the average value at the product level.'

Product	Part	Jun 2014	Jul 2014	Aug 2014	Sep 2014
1	AC002-AMC		3	1	2

After saving your changes at the detail record level, the aggregate average values in the hierarchy level above are updated to reflect your changes.



Note: When you edit data at a lower level in the hierarchy, the resulting aggregated average value for the level above typically becomes a decimal value. By default, RapidResponse rounds aggregated average values to the nearest whole number. If the author has allowed decimal values for the worksheet, you can click in a record at an aggregate level to view and edit the decimal value.

For more information about editing data, see ["Edit records in a crosstab worksheet" on page 349](#).

Editing records with negative values

Some worksheets contain records with negative values. If the worksheet author has permitted the insertion and modification of records with negative values, then these records will update when you modify the aggregate average value. If inserting and modifying negative value records is not allowed, then negative value records are treated as protected records; they cannot be modified and their share of changes made to the aggregate average value is divided equally among the remaining summarized detail records. For more information on protected records, see ["Edit summarized records in hierarchies" on page 350](#).

Edit records in percentage values

A worksheet might display quantities as a percentage within a bucket. When you edit percentage values, you are not changing the total value for the bucket; instead, you are redistributing the quantity amongst the items in the bucket. For example, a worksheet might allow you to edit the ratio applied to forecast streams, such as marketing and finance, that when combined create a consensus forecast for the bucketed date. In this worksheet, you can assign a weight to each forecast stream by entering the percentage value assigned to each stream.

Edit Ratio			
	Category		Jul 14
1	Finance	Effective Ratio	12.5%
2		Override	20.0%
3	Sales	Effective Ratio	25.0%
4		Override	40.0%
5	Marketing	Effective Ratio	18.8%
6		Override	30.0%
7	Statistical	Effective Ratio	43.8%
8		Override	10.0%
9	Total	Effective Ratio	100.0%
10		Override	

In this worksheet, you can apply a percentage value to forecast streams to assign a weight. The forecast weights are then used to create a consensus forecast.

Worksheets that allow you to enter values in percentages typically rely on a source worksheet to provide default values for each item in the bucket. The default values might be visible in the worksheet, or they might be hidden by the worksheet author. When you edit the percentage values, you are overriding the default values provided by the source worksheet.

If you are entering percentage values in a worksheet that does not yet contain override values, it is recommended that you enter percentage values at the highest level in the hierarchy. This ensures that the override percentage values you entered are disaggregated to all summarized records in the hierarchy. When you enter percentage values at a lower hierarchy level, the values are applied to that hierarchy level only.

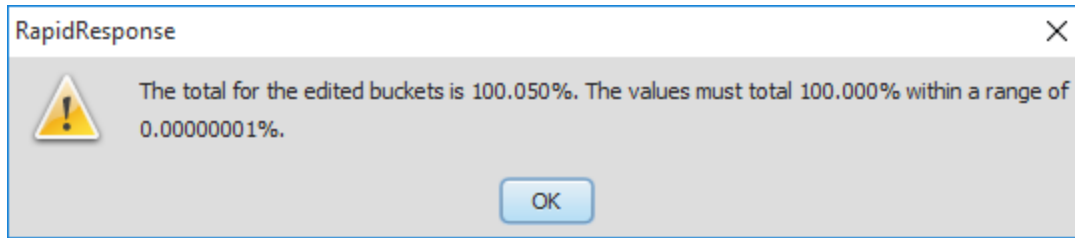
For more information on editing values in a hierarchy, see ["Edit summarized records in hierarchies" on page 350](#).



Note: It is not recommended that you edit percentage data in a worksheet in which the record limit has been exceeded. Editing data in percentage values requires that every cell in a bucket has a value; when the record limit has been exceeded, some buckets will contain empty cells that will cause an error upon saving. You can avoid this error by either using a search to reduce the number of records, or by overriding the worksheet record limit. For more information, see ["Searching data in workbooks" on page 187](#).

Ensuring percentage values total 100%

Some worksheets require a value of approximately 100% for each bucket total before you can save data changes. (The allowable range is determined by the workbook author.) If you enter values that do not add up to a bucket total of 100%, upon saving an error message appears indicating the current bucket total. You must close the error message and re-enter the bucket values to equal approximately 100% before saving again.



If the worksheet does not require that you input values for a bucket total of 100%, upon saving your changes, RapidResponse adjusts the values in the bucket to equal 100%. For example, if the values you enter equal less than 100%, RapidResponse increases each value in the bucket to achieve a total value of 100%.

Item	Original value	Edited value	Value after saving
A	20% (1000)	20%	33% (1667)
B	80% (4000)	40%	67% (3333)
Total Quantity	5000	5000	5000

When this occurs, the percentage values in the bucket increase upon saving. Similarly, if you enter values that add up to a bucket total of more than 100%, RapidResponse decreases each value to achieve a bucket total of 100%.

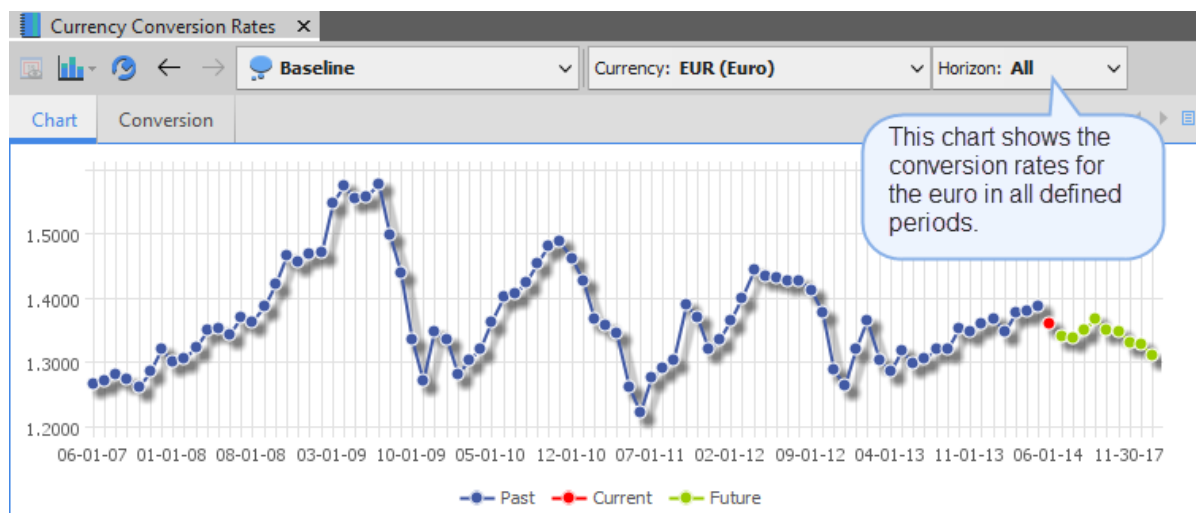
To prevent RapidResponse from adjusting the values, ensure that the values in the bucket add up to an exact total of 100% before saving.



Note: You cannot save a bucket total of 0%, even if the worksheet allows you to input bucket totals that do not equal 100%.

View and simulate currency conversion rates

You can view conversion rates if you have access to the Currency Conversion Rates workbook. Conversion rates determine how the currency is converted to a base currency, which is used as the basis for all conversions. Rates can be viewed for each currency and over multiple periods, which shows how the rates change over time. You can use the rate information to see trends in the relative value of currencies, and to see how the predicted future rates compare to the past rates, as shown in the following illustration.



You can choose to view the rates in a chart showing the past, future, or all rates; or to view all rates in a crosstab view.

You can use this workbook to modify future conversion rates. You might do this if you want to see how forecast orders will increase or decrease revenue if the conversion rate changes, or to simulate changes to the conversion rates that have not yet been brought in to your system. You can simulate the future rate changes for each currency separately.

► View a chart of conversion rates

1. In the **Explorer**, double-click the **Currency Conversion Rates** workbook.
2. Click the **Chart** tab.
3. On the toolbar, click **Data Settings** .
4. In the **Data Settings** dialog box, specify the following:
 - **Currency**—Select the currency you want to view.
 - **Horizon**—Specify whether you want to see **Past**, **Future**, or **All** rates for the selected currency.



Note: You can also select **Current** from the **Horizon** list. However, when this value is selected, the chart displays all rates. This setting is typically used to select the current rate in the **Conversion Detail** worksheet.

► View conversion rates

1. In the **Explorer**, double-click the **Currency Conversion Rates** workbook.
2. Click the **Conversions** tab.
3. On the toolbar, click **Data Settings** .
4. In the **Data Settings** dialog box, in the **Currency** list, select the currency you want to view.

► Simulate rate changes

1. Create a new scenario for simulating the rate changes.
2. In the **Currency Conversion Rates** workbook, click the **Conversion Detail** tab.

3. On the toolbar, click **Data Settings** .
4. In the **Data Settings** dialog box, in the **Currency** list, select the currency you want to simulate changes for.
5. In the **Horizon** list, click **Future**.
6. Click **OK**.
7. For each date, type the new conversion rate.
To edit multiple rates at one time, on the **Edit** menu, click **Edit Range**. For more information, see ["Edit cells in multiple records" on page 345](#).
8. On the **File** menu, click **Save Data**.

**Notes:**

- If you modify multiple records using **Edit Range**, you must specify **None** in the **Rounding** list. Otherwise the decimal values for the rates are rounded to an integer, which could result in incorrect converted values.
- If you select **All** or **Past** in the **Horizon** list, you cannot modify the conversion rates.

Copy data between worksheets

You can copy data from cells in one worksheet to cells in another worksheet. The data can be copied from a single cell, a range of contiguous cells in a column or row, or a block of cells. You can copy up to 500 rows of data at one time.

Two types of decimal formatting are accepted in RapidResponse:

- Period symbol identifies the decimal place—422.99
- Comma symbol identifies the decimal place—422,99

Two different copy options are provided so that you can copy the data with the decimal formatting you want to apply to it.

- Use **Copy** when you want to copy data using the period symbol.
- Use **Copy with comma decimals** when you want to copy data using the comma symbol.

Pasting values

The worksheet you paste the data in must have editable columns or rows of the same type you copied. For example, if you copy a range of date values, you can only paste that data into an editable date column.

If you copy a block of cells, the worksheet you paste the data into must have the same types of columns or rows, the columns or rows must all be editable, and there must be enough cells available to contain the pasted values. For example, if you copy data from a block of three columns and four rows, there must be three adjacent editable columns (for vertical worksheets) or four adjacent editable rows (for crosstab worksheets) in the worksheet you paste the block into.

► Copy and paste worksheet data

1. In a worksheet, select the cells you want to copy.
2. On the **Edit** menu, click **Copy** or **Copy with comma decimals**.

3. Click the worksheet tab for the worksheet you want to paste into.
4. Click the cell that you want to begin pasting into, and then on the **Edit** menu, click **Paste**.
If you are pasting a range of cells, the cell you select is the first cell in the range. If you are pasting a block of cells, the cell you select is the first cell in the first column of the block, and the other columns are pasted automatically. The entire range or block of cells is always pasted, regardless of the cells you have selected.
5. On the **File** menu, click **Save Data**.



Note: You can copy and paste data into different types of worksheets, as long as the data types are the same in the columns or rows of each worksheet. For example, if you copy data from a crosstab worksheet, you can paste into a vertical worksheet if the vertical worksheet contains columns with the same data types as the crosstab rows.



Tip: You can also copy data by clicking **Copy**  on the toolbar or by pressing CTRL+C, and paste data by clicking **Paste**  on the toolbar or by pressing CTRL +V.

Copying scaled values

When copying a cell in a scaled column, the actual value will be copied, not the formatted value. For example, if you copy a cell with the scaled value of 2, and the column scaling is in thousands, then the value copied to the Clipboard is 2000.

Percent values are not considered scaled values. For more information, see ["Copying percent values" on page 359](#).

Pasting values into scaled columns

If you select a cell (with a single click) that has number formatting and paste a value, the value will be formatted accorded to the cell's number formatting. For example, if you copy the value 1000 and paste it into a cell with scaling set to thousands, the value displayed is 1.

However, if you double-click this cell, the cell acts as an input field. When you paste a value into the input field, the value is taken as-is. For example, if you copy the value 1, double-click a cell with scaling set to thousands, and then paste the value, the value displayed is 1. Note that this value is considered to be scaled.

For more information about number formatting, see ["Understanding how numeric values are displayed" on page 153](#).

Copying percent values

Some values in worksheets are formatted to display as percent values. When you copy a percent value by clicking **Copy** on the **Edit** menu or by pressing **Ctrl-C**, the value that is displayed in the cell is the value copied to the Clipboard, regardless of any scaling that is applied to the column. For example, if the value displayed in the cell is 2%, the value copied to the Clipboard is 2.

You can copy actual values from percent columns without any scaling by selecting the value or values to copy and then clicking **Copy Raw % Values** on the **Edit** menu. For example, if the worksheet author has not added scaling to the column, and the value displayed in the cell is 2%, then the value copied to the Clipboard using **Copy Raw % Values** is 0.02. If the column scaling is in thousands and the value displayed in the cell is 2%, then the value copied to the Clipboard using **Copy Raw % Values** is 20.

Copying values from other programs

You can also copy data from files you have open in other programs, such as Microsoft Excel or Adobe Reader, into a RapidResponse worksheet. Some file formats, such as PDF files or text files, do not support copying blocks of cells. If you copy a block of cells from these files, the block is converted to a range of cells in a single column.

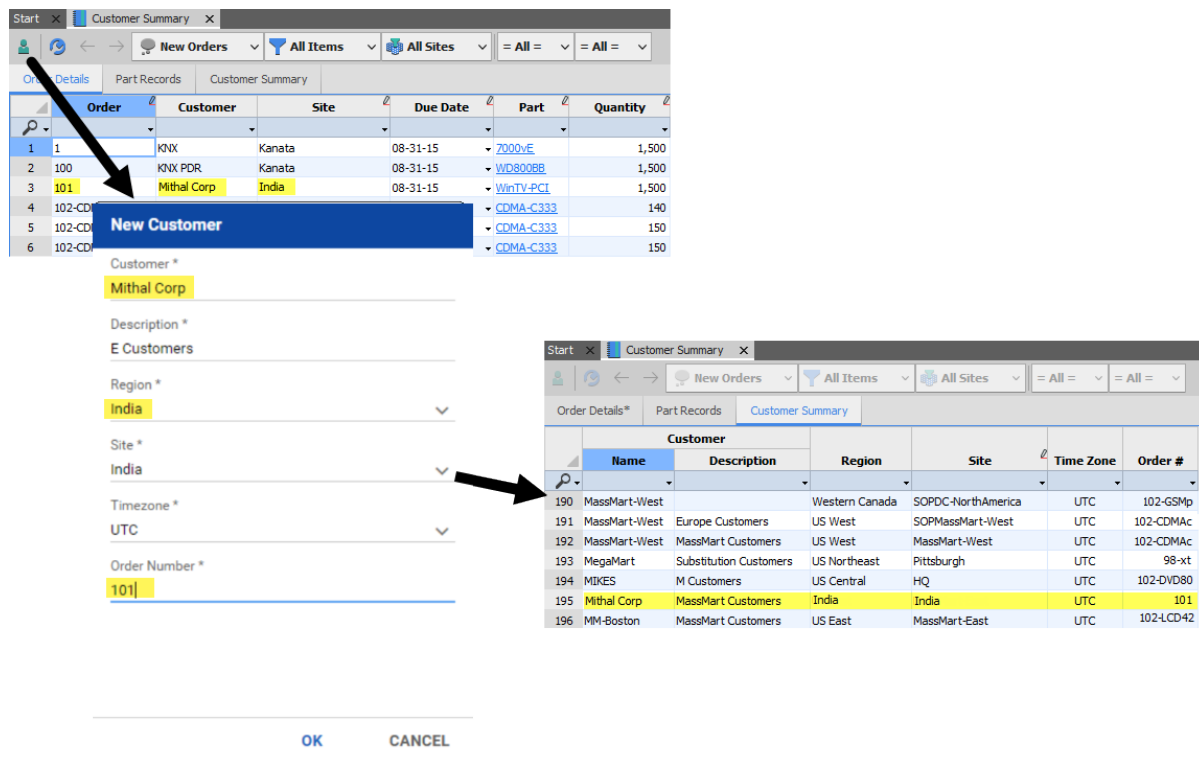
Pasting values into other programs

You can also copy RapidResponse data to other programs, such as Microsoft Excel. If you copy a column that contains money values or quantity values that are formatted to display in scaled units or percentages, the value in the column is copied without formatting (such as currency symbols, rounding, or percentage symbols), which allows you to use and edit the actual values in the application you copy the data to. However, if you copy data from a multi-scenario column that displays differences, the formatted difference values are copied rather than the actual values from that column. For more information, see ["View data from multiple scenarios" on page 159](#). For more information about money data, see ["View money data in a worksheet" on page 151](#). For more information about formatted quantity values, see ["Understanding how numeric values are displayed" on page 153](#).

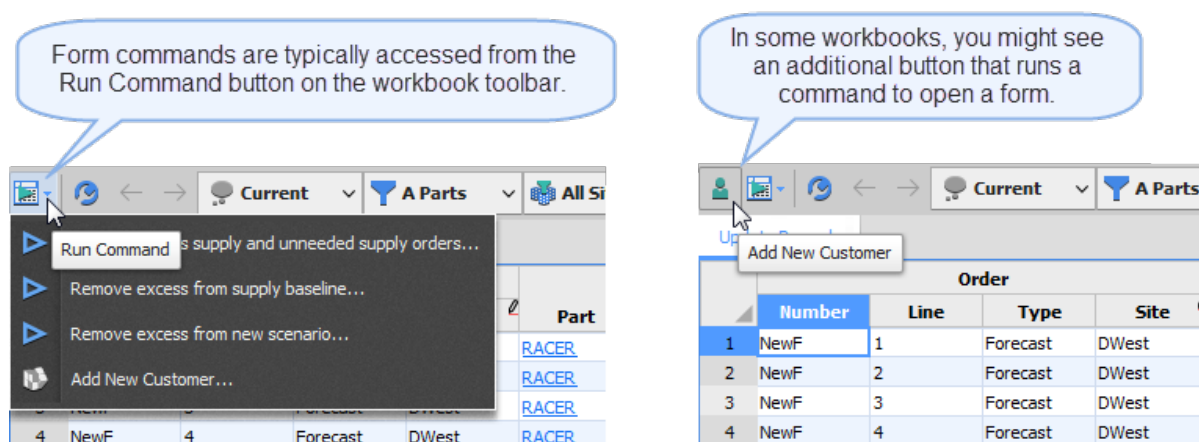
Run workbook commands

Some workbooks include the capability to run a command to automatically modify data, open a form, or run scripts. Commands that modify data typically represent data modifications required for a business process that have been automated for you. For example, part of your business process might be to change newly-received demand orders into firm orders so they can be allocated supply. A command might be created that automatically firms the demand orders, so you can continue with the next steps of the business process.

Forms that open from a command might run multiple operations on a worksheet or allow you to modify data in another worksheet based on another table. For example, when adding a new order in the Order Details worksheet, you might run a command to open the New Customer form. There you can add a new customer linked with the new order you are working on. The customer information is stored in the Customer Summary worksheet and you can then continue working on the order.



Depending on how the workbook has been authored, commands that open forms might display from the Commands button on the toolbar, or from a custom button positioned at the left end of the toolbar.



Commands that run scripts typically represent automated operations required for a task or process. For example, part of a process might require working with historical data for the past three months, with each month represented as a different historical scenario. A command might run a script to create a historical scenario for the past month, and then move the oldest historical data into an archive scenario. With the scenario management automated, you can focus on the rest of the process.

The workbook help typically contains a description of the command and provides instructions for choosing the appropriate settings for running the command.

Commands that run scripts might require you to specify values for the script's arguments. Information about these arguments can be provided in the workbook's help or displayed when you run the command. For more information about passing values to a script, see ["Run a script" on page 623](#).

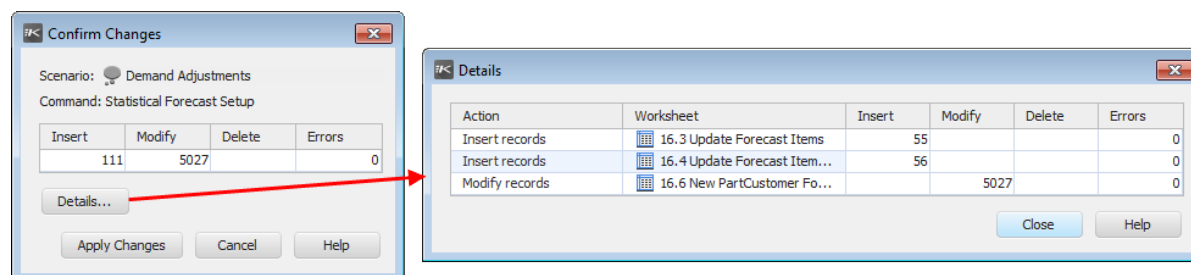
Data modification commands

When you run a command, the command can complete successfully if there are no errors or if the number of errors does not exceed an acceptable number. If the acceptable number of errors is exceeded, the command fails. You can also cancel the command before the data changes are saved.

The acceptable number of errors that can occur when a command runs is set by the worksheet author. Authors can configure whether a data modification command fails when the first error occurs or completes successfully even though some errors have occurred. When the author allows some errors to occur, they set an error limit for the worksheet. If this limit is not exceeded, the command can complete successfully. Therefore, you might be able to confirm a command's data changes even though not all record insertions, modifications, or deletions have occurred successfully.

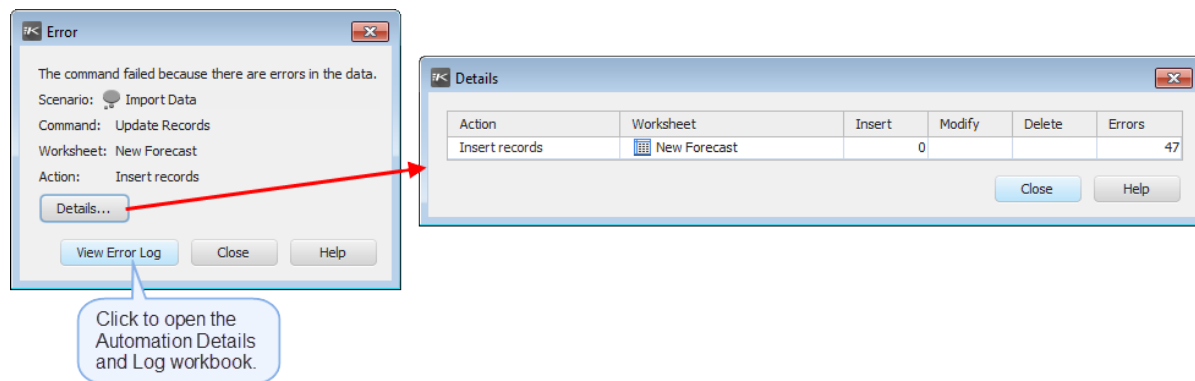
When a data modification command can complete successfully, you might be shown how many records will be modified, inserted, or deleted by the command and how many errors occurred in the Confirm Changes dialog box. You can confirm the changes or, if these numbers do not look right, you can cancel the command. You can then change your data settings and run the command again.

The Confirm Changes dialog box displays the total number of record modifications, insertions, deletions, and errors. You can view more specific information about the records modified by each command action by clicking the Details button. It might be useful to view these details before confirming a command's changes.

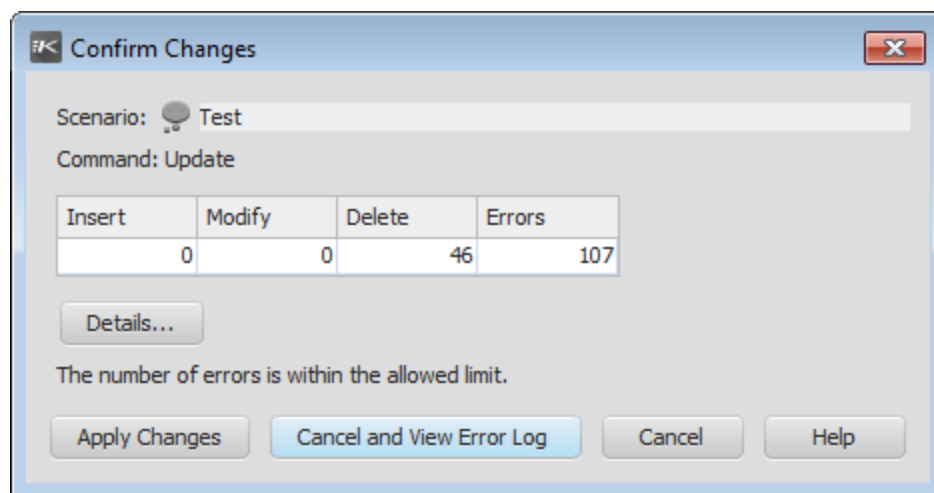


If the number of errors exceeds the acceptable limit, the Error dialog box opens to inform you that the command failed. You can view details about the action that caused the errors and any actions that preceded that action by clicking the Details button. When a command performs multiple actions and one action fails, subsequent actions are not run so no details are provided about those actions.

To better understand why errors occurred, you can click the View Error Log button to open the Automation Details and Log workbook, which displays the Workbook Command Log and Error Details worksheets. For more information about these worksheets, see ["Workbook command logging" on page 647](#).



You can also open the error log if the command completes successfully with errors by clicking the Cancel and View Error Log button in the Confirm Changes dialog box. You might want to do this if the errors should be corrected before you confirm the data modifications performed by the command.



The data changes the command makes might not be visible in the workbook. Depending on how the command was created, the changes it makes might be visible in the scenario properties on the Pending Commits tab. For more information, see ["Track data changes in a scenario" on page 468](#).

► Run a workbook command to modify data

1. On the **RapidResponse** toolbar, click **Workbook Help** .
2. Use the instructions in the workbook help to configure your data settings to run the command.
3. If you are not working in a private scenario, create a new scenario and ensure it is active.
4. On the workbook toolbar, click **Run Command** .
5. In the list, click the command you want to run.
6. In the **Run Command** dialog box, read the notes and ensure you have set the data settings correctly.
7. If you need to adjust your workbook display settings, click **No**.
Otherwise, click **Yes** to run the command.
8. If the command runs successfully and results in no data changes, click **OK**.

9. If you are prompted to confirm changes, do any of the following in the **Confirm Changes** dialog box:
 - Click **Details** to view detailed information about the actions performed by the command. Click **Close** to return to the **Confirm Changes** dialog box.
 - Click **Apply Changes** to save the changes made by the command and return to the worksheet.
 - Click **Cancel** to revert the changes made by the command and return to the worksheet.
 - Click **Cancel and View Error Log** if the command returned some errors to revert the changes made by the command and open the **Automation Details and Log** workbook, which displays the **Workbook Command Log** and **Error Details** worksheets.
10. If the command fails, do any of the following in the **Error** dialog box:
 - Click **Details** to view detailed information about the actions performed by the command and where errors have occurred. Click **Close** to return to the **Error** dialog box.
 - Click **View Error Log** to open the **Automation Details and Log** workbook, which displays the **Workbook Command Log** and **Error Details** worksheets.
 - Click **Close** to return to the worksheet.



Note: Some commands can be run only when a specific worksheet is active. If you want to run a command but it is not available, refer to the workbook help to determine which worksheet it runs on.



Tips:

- If you do not want the **Run Command** dialog box to appear every time you run the command, select the **Do not show me this dialog box again** check box. The **Run Command** dialog box does not display again, and the command runs whenever you click it.
- If you selected the **Do not show me this dialog box again** check box for a command, but want to see the **Run Command** dialog box again, you can reset the workbook layout by clicking **Reset Workbook** on the **View** menu.

► Run a workbook command to open a form

1. On the **RapidResponse** toolbar, click **Workbook Help** .
2. Use the instructions in the workbook help to determine what button provides access to the command.
3. On the workbook toolbar, click the button identified in the help.
The form opens as an overlay on the worksheet.

► Run a workbook command to run a script

1. On the **RapidResponse** toolbar, click **Workbook Help** .
2. Use the instructions in the workbook help to determine the values that must be provided for the script arguments.
3. On the workbook toolbar, click **Run Command** .
4. In the list, click the command you want to run.
5. If required, in the **Run Command** dialog box, specify values for each of the arguments

To view more information about an argument, pause the pointer over it. A description of the argument displays in a tooltip.

6. Click **Yes** to run the command.



Notes:

- Some commands can be run only when a specific worksheet is active. If you want to run a command but it is not available, refer to the workbook help to determine which worksheet it runs on.
- For more information about scripts, see ["About scripting" on page 560](#).



Tips:

- If you do not want the **Run Command** dialog box to appear every time you run the command, select the **Do not show me this dialog box again** check box. The **Run Command** dialog box does not display again, and the command runs whenever you click it. If the script the command runs requires argument values, the **Do not show me this dialog box again** check box is not available.
- If you selected the **Do not show me this dialog box again** check box for a command, but want to see the **Run Command** dialog box again, you can reset the workbook layout by clicking **Reset Workbook** on the **View** menu.

Add a note

You can add text notes to any record in a worksheet that contains a **Notes** column. For example, if you are in a worksheet showing scheduled receipts, you might want to add a note containing up to date information about a specific order or to explain a change you have made to the order. These notes will then be viewable by other users who have access to the scenario in which they were added. All notes are viewed and added through the Notes dialog box.

1. For the record you want to add the note to, click the down arrow at the right of the **Notes** column cell.
2. In the **New Note** box, type your note.



Notes:

- You can add new notes as well as view any existing notes that have been added to the record in the **Notes** dialog box. You cannot, however, edit or delete an existing note.
- Each note you add can contain a maximum of 30,000 characters.

Undo data changes

You can undo changes made on the active worksheet since the last time you saved your data changes. Undoing data changes restores records marked for deletion and undoes changes to existing records.

When you undo data changes, the asterisk (*) that indicates unsaved changes is removed from the worksheet tab.

► Undo data changes

- On the **Data** menu, click **Undo Data Changes**.



Note: When you insert records, they are saved immediately, so you cannot undo record insertion using **Undo Data Changes**.

Save data changes

1. Ensure you are in the worksheet where you modified data.
2. On the **File** menu, click **Save Data**.
3. If you see the **Conflicting Data Changes** dialog box, one or more of your changes conflicts with a change made by another user. Do one of the following:
 - To save your changes and have the conflicting changes overwritten with the other user's changes, click **Yes**.
 - To cancel the save and undo your changes, click **No**.



Notes:

- This command saves changes made in the active worksheet. After saving, the asterisk (*) is removed from the worksheet tab.
- Saving the changes in a worksheet recalculates the data in the active scenario.



Tip: You can also save data changes by clicking **Save Data**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.

Insert a record

You can insert records into scenarios through certain worksheets in RapidResponse. Depending on your RapidResponse permissions, you can insert records into a private scenario or into a shared scenario that you have been authorized to edit. Inserted records are automatically saved in the scenario.

When inserting a record, in most cases you must specify values for a combination of key fields that make the record unique in RapidResponse. These key fields are identified at the top of the Insert Record dialog box. For example, when inserting a new part, the combination of the name and site must be unique to at least one of the part records in RapidResponse. As shown in the following illustration, these fields are identified in the Insert Record - Independent Demand dialog box.

Insert Record - Independent Demand

Key fields

Site: [dropdown]

Order Number: C00001 [dropdown] **Add...**

Line: 1

Order Type: Actual [dropdown]

Non-key fields

Site: HQ [dropdown]

Part: ACKIT-01 [dropdown]

Quantity: 200

Due Date: 06-02-14 [dropdown]

Order Status: Current [dropdown]

Ship Set: [dropdown]

☒ Go to this record after insert

Save and Close **Save** **Close** **Help**

Key fields make a record unique.

Many Insert Record dialog boxes use list controls where you can select the values you want. The contents of some lists are determined by the selections you make in preceding lists. The Site list control can automatically filter other controls, even if those controls display above the Site control.

You might be able to select a blank entry for some non-key reference fields. The blank value will always be located at the top of the list and is not affected by list filtering.

► Insert a record

1. Open the worksheet into which you want to insert a record.
2. If you have made any changes to the data in the worksheet, then on the **File** menu, click **Save Data**.
3. On the **Edit** menu, click **Insert Record**.
4. Type the appropriate information in the fields provided in the **Insert Record** dialog box, or select the appropriate option from the lists.
If you want to automatically select the newly inserted record, select the **Go to this record after insert** check box.
5. If available, in the **Currency** list, select the currency you want to use for money data fields.
For more information about the selected currency, click the  button.
6. Click **Save and Close** to insert the record.
If you want to insert multiple records, click **Save**. You can then type the data for subsequent records.

**Notes:**

- If the worksheet contains a record similar to the record you want to insert, you can select it before inserting to automatically populate the fields in the **Insert Record** dialog box.
- If the new record does not match the query defined by the controls on the worksheet or by a search that might be applied, the record does not display in the worksheet. Select different items from the worksheet controls, or clear the search to see the new record.
- If records are inserted into a shared scenario, other users can see the changes by clicking the **Pending Commits** tab in the **Scenario Properties** tab.



Tip: You can also insert a record by clicking **Insert Record**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.

► Add a new record for a specific field

If you attempt to save a field value that is not valid for the table the worksheet is based on, you will be prompted to click the Add button to insert records into the correct database table. For example, you might want to insert a new part record that includes a new reference part. Because the reference part is new to RapidResponse, and is a reference to another table, you are prompted to insert a new part record. If you know that you want to create a new record using a value that is not valid for the current database table, click the Add button next to the relevant field.

1. In the **Insert Record** dialog box, click **Add** beside the field.
2. In the new **Insert Record** dialog box, type the appropriate information in the fields provided or select the appropriate option from the lists.
3. Click **Save and Close** to insert the record.

**Notes:**

- The newly created record is automatically selected upon returning to the **Insert Record** dialog box.
- The **Add** button displays beside all fields for which new reference records can be created.

► Specify the currency for the new record

When you insert a record that contains money values, such as the standard cost of a part, the currency for that value is displayed beside the money fields. Depending on the worksheet, you might be able to specify the currency to use for inserting the records, which allows you to insert values in your preferred currency regardless of the currency the workbook uses. The value you specify is converted to the column's currency when the record is displayed in the worksheet. For example, if you insert a record in euros, when you view that data in a column that uses US dollars, the euro values are converted to US dollars. For more information about specifying your preferred currency, see ["Specify formats for dates, times, numbers, and currencies" on page 60](#).

- In the **Insert Record** dialog box, click a currency in the **Currency** list.

Inserting a record in a crosstab worksheet

If you modify a crosstab worksheet cell that contains a zero value, a record is always inserted using automatically-generated data values. If the worksheet author has allowed the worksheet to drill to details, you can modify the automatically-generated values in the appropriate detail worksheet. Records inserted in this manner are always inserted at the beginning of the date bucket that was modified. For

example, in a crosstab worksheet displaying order quantities by due date, if you modify a zero value in a bucket beginning on June 9th, a record is inserted with a due date equal to June 9th.

► Report an insert error

In some cases, a worksheet might contain errors that do not allow you to insert records. If an insert fails due to an error, a dialog box containing the error message is displayed. You can copy this message and send it to your RapidResponse administrator so that the error can be corrected.

1. In the error dialog box, click **Copy**.
2. Paste the error message into a text editor or email message.
3. Provide the error message to your RapidResponse administrator.

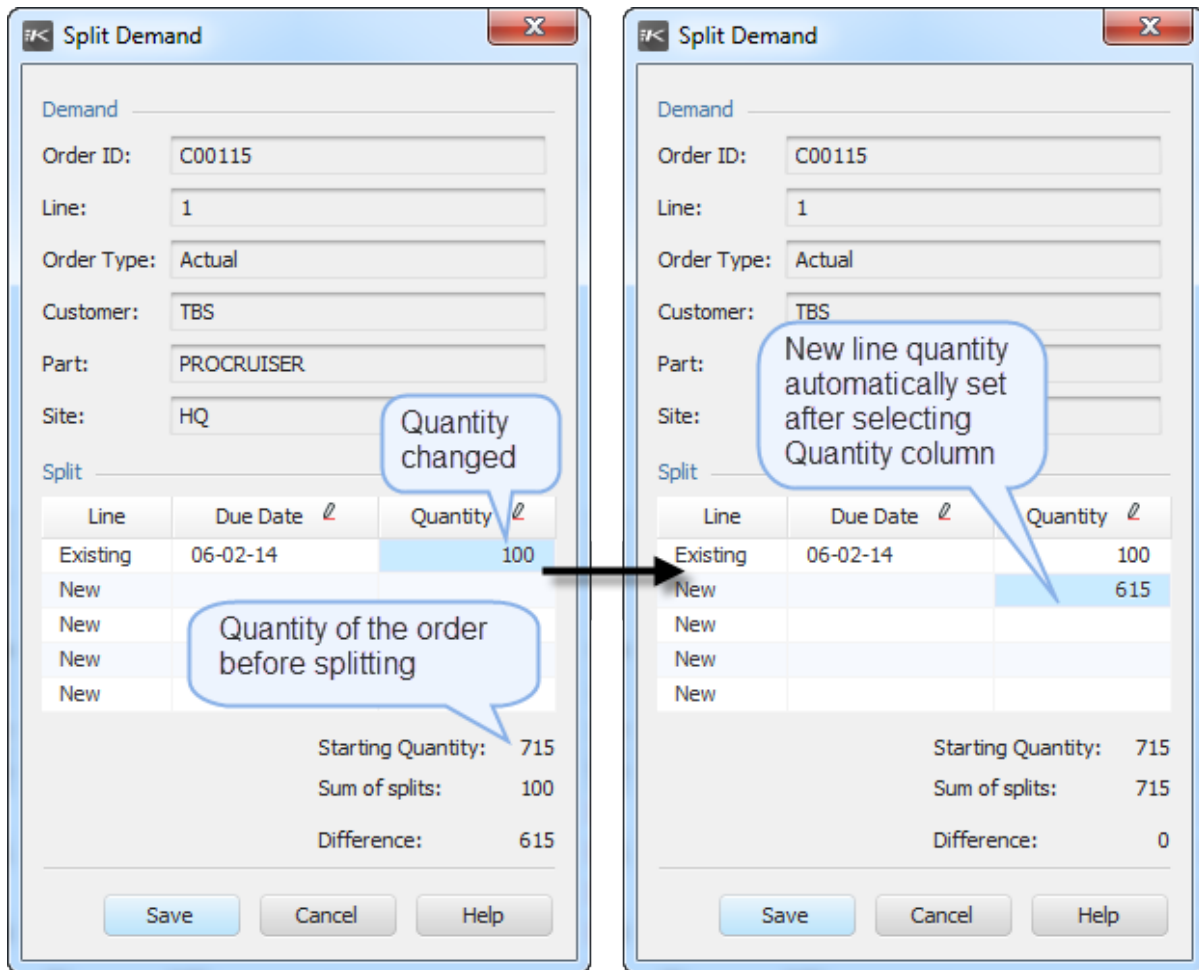
Split a record

You can split demand and supply records to schedule part of an order to be due on one date, and the remainder on a later date.

You can split an order line into up to five lines at one time. If you require further splitting, you can split one of the newly-created lines. When you split a line, a new record is inserted for each split you make. Each new record copies the original record's line number and adds a separator—such as a decimal point—and a number. For example, if you split line 3 of an order, the new record is line 3.1. If you then split line 3.1, the new record created is line 3.1.1, and so on.

Your RapidResponse administrator might have specified a different separator character.

For each split you make, the quantity of the new line is automatically set to the difference between the starting quantity and the sum of split quantities. This quantity is set when you select either the Due Date or Quantity columns on a new line, as shown in the following illustration.



► Split a record

1. In any worksheet that displays demand or supply information and allows record splitting, select the record you want to split.
2. On the worksheet toolbar, click **Split** .
3. In the **Split Demand** or **Split Supply** dialog box, change the value in the **Existing** line's **Quantity** column.
4. On a **New** line, click the **Due Date** column, then either type a date or click the down arrow and select a date from the calendar.
5. To create another split, repeat steps 3 and 4 for each **New** line you want to add.
You can change the quantity in either the **Existing** line or any **New** line.
6. Click **OK**.



Note: The sum of split quantities does not have to equal the quantity of the original order.



Tip: To remove a split, clear its **Due Date** and **Quantity** columns.

CHAPTER 28: Transferring inventory

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You can use RapidResponse to simulate transferring inventory. For example, when faced with an unexpected change that results in an inventory shortage at a particular site, you might choose to transfer inventory from a site that has excess on hand to the site that requires it. Alternatively, you might proactively look for sites in need of inventory which is considered excess at another site.

Inventory transfers can be made using the Inventory Transfers workbook included with RapidResponse. For each part and site combination, this workbook shows bucketed demand, firm supply, and inventory levels, and provides a running balance of inventory over time. You can use the Projected Inventory worksheet to find locations where eligible inventory may exist to be transferred to other locations that require it. For example, in the Balance row you can look for excess on hand or on hand not being used until past the part's lead time date. As shown in the following illustration, red values in the Balance row indicate an inventory shortage, and black values in this row indicate a positive inventory balance or potential excess.

	Site	Lead Time Date	Part	06-02-14	06-09-14	06-16-14	06-23-14	06-30-14
8	CRUISER	HQ	06-09-14	Demand	1	870	900	1,340
9				Firm Supply	0	0	0	0
10				Inventory	0	0	0	0
11				Balance	39	319	-581	-1,231
12	New York	06-04-14	Demand	0	4		2,904	2,986
13			Firm Supply	0	4		0	0
14			Inventory	800	0	0	0	0
15			Balance	800	435	523	-1,970	-4,874

Once you have found available inventory to transfer, you can use the Transfer Inventory dialog box to simulate the transfer. As shown in the following illustration, this dialog box enables you to select the part at the sourcing site to be transferred, and the part at the destination site that will receive the supply. You must also specify the amount to be transferred, as well as the costs and dates associated with the transfer.

The screenshot shows the 'Transfer Inventory' dialog box. It is divided into 'From' (Sourcing site) and 'To' (Destination site) sections. The 'From' section includes fields for Site (New York), Part (CRUISER), Model, Unit, Pool, and Unit of measure (EA). The 'To' section includes fields for Site (HQ), Part (CRUISER), Model, Unit, and Pool. Below these are fields for Transfer cost (500 USD), Quantity (100), Ship date (06-03-14), Arrival date (06-08-14), In-transit time (5), and Dock-to-stock time (1). A 'Note' field is also present. Callouts point to various fields: 'Sourcing site' points to the 'From' section, 'Destination site' points to the 'To' section, 'Part at sourcing site' points to the 'Part' field in the 'From' section, 'Part at destination site' points to the 'Part' field in the 'To' section, 'Quantity of the inventory transfer' points to the 'Quantity' field, and 'Details (cost, dates) of the inventory transfer' points to the 'Transfer cost', 'Quantity', 'Ship date', and 'Arrival date' fields. At the bottom are buttons for 'Save and Close', 'Save', 'Close', and 'Help'.

After you specify the details of the inventory transfer, the Inventory Transfers workbook is updated to reflect the transfer. As shown in the following illustration, a new record is added to the Open Transfers worksheet with all details of the transfer. This includes a reference to the transfer's Type value which is a control value allowing you to change the status of the transfer (for example, from in-transit to received). The transfer is also reflected in the Projected Inventory worksheet with a positive value added to the Transfer row at the destination site, and a negative value added to the Transfer row at the sourcing site.

Inventory Transfers										
Approved Actions All Parts All Sites										
Projected Inventory										
	Part	Site	Lead Time	Date	Past	06-02-14	06-09-14	06-16-14	06-23-14	06-30-14
8	CRUISER	HQ	06-09-14	Demand	0	2,811			650	1,340
9				Firm Supply	0	3,596			0	0
10				Inventory	404	0		0	0	0
11				Transfer	0	0	100	0	0	0
12				Balance		9	419	-481	-1,131	-2,471
13		New York	06-04-14	Demand		5	1,412	2,493	2,904	2,986
14				Firm Supply		0	1,500	0	0	0
15				Inventory		0	0	0	0	0
16				Transfer	0	-100	0	0	0	0
17				Balance	800	335	423	-2,070	-4,974	-7,960

Open Transfers										
	From		Transfer		Shipping					
	Part	Site	Site	Quantity	Cost	Date	Transit			
1	CRUISER	New York	CRUISER	HQ	100	\$499	06-03-14			



Note: Workbook authors in your company might include access to the Transfer Inventory dialog box in some of the workbooks they create.

Transfer inventory

- Do one of the following:
 - In the **Explorer**, ensure that workbooks are shown. You can do this by selecting **Reports**. Double-click the **Inventory Transfers** workbook.
 - From the **Part** column in an open workbook, click the part link in a selected cell and then click **Inventory Transfers**. The **Inventory Transfers** workbook opens in the context of the selected part.
- On the workbook toolbar, click the **Transfer Inventory** button . The **Transfer Inventory** dialog box opens.
- In the **From** area, identify the part providing the transfer by doing the following:
 - From the **Site** list, select the sourcing site.
 - From the **Part** list, select the name of the part at the sourcing site (the transfer part).

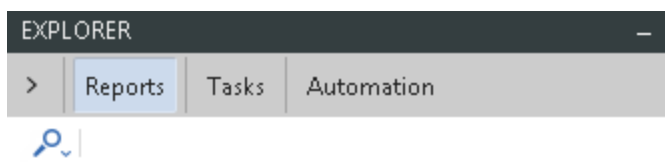
- From the **Model** list, select the model for the transfer part (if applicable).
 - In the **Unit** box, type the start unit for the transfer part (if applicable).
 - From the **Pool** list, select the pool for the transfer part (if applicable).
4. In the **To** area, identify the part receiving the transfer by doing the following:
 - From the **Site** list, select the destination site.
 - From the **Part** list, select the name of the part at the destination site (the receiving part).
 - From the **Model** list, select the model for the receiving part (if applicable).
 - In the **Unit** box, type the start unit for the receiving part (if applicable).
 - From the **Pool** list, select the pool for the receiving part (if applicable).
 5. In the **Quantity** box, type the amount of the inventory transfer. This should be specified in the unit of measure for the receiving part.
It is possible to specify a quantity greater than what is actually available at the sourcing site, but RapidResponse will only transfer what is on hand at the sourcing site.
 6. In the **Transfer cost** box, type the total cost of transferring inventory from the sourcing site to the destination site.
 7. In the **Ship date** box, specify the date the inventory is expected to leave the sourcing site.
 8. Indicate the date the inventory transfer is expected to arrive at the destination site's receiving dock (dock date) by doing one of the following:
 - In the **Arrival date** box, specify a date. The **In-transit time** box is then calculated based on this value.
 - In the **In-transit time** box, type the number of regular (Gregorian) calendar days it takes to transfer inventory to the destination site's receiving dock. The **Arrival date** is then calculated based on this value.
 9. In the **Dock-to-stock time** box, type the number of days it takes to get inventory from the destination site's receiving dock to the warehouse. This value should be specified in the calendar units used by the receiving part, and is used to calculate the date the transfer is expected to be received into inventory at the destination site (stock date).
 10. Do one of the following:
 - To save the transfer and return to the Inventory Transfers workbook, click **Save and Close**.
 - To save the transfer and add another, click **Save**.
 - To return to the **Inventory Transfers** workbook without saving the transfer, click **Close**.



Note: In order to save an inventory transfer, at least one of the values in the **From** area must be different from the corresponding value in the **To** area.

View or modify existing transfers

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that workbooks are shown. You can do this by selecting **Reports**.



2. Double-click the **Inventory Transfers** workbook.
3. In the **Open Transfers** worksheet, modify editable values as required. For example, you might change the **Type** value to indicate the inventory transfer has been received at the destination site and is no longer in transit.

CHAPTER 29: Importing data

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You can import records into the RapidResponse database from either a Microsoft Excel file or a tab-delimited text file. This data can be new customer orders, updated forecast records, and so on. This data is typically provided to you already in a format suitable to be imported into RapidResponse.

You can import data from a Microsoft Excel file into a workbook or directly into a scenario. Importing into a workbook brings in data for only the tables that worksheets are based on, which must be configured to allow importing data. All key and reference fields must be accounted for, either in the worksheet or with customized values. Values for other fields can be included in the worksheet or a custom value can be provided. Otherwise, the default value for the column's data type is used. Depending on how the workbook has been configured, values can be inserted, modified, or deleted by the import. Records are deleted if they are present in the RapidResponse workbook but not in the import file. For more information, see ["Import data from a Microsoft Excel file into a workbook" on page 380](#).

Importing into a scenario brings in data for any table, and can also bring in summarized demand or supply data. This requires the imported Microsoft Excel file to contain worksheets that match or are mapped to the table names that data is provided for, and to contain values for every key field in that table. Values for other fields can be included in worksheets or values for them can be specified in the Microsoft Excel worksheets. Otherwise, the default value for that data type is used. Depending on how the Microsoft Excel worksheets have been configured, records that match an expression in the worksheets can be deleted prior to the import. Depending on how your RapidResponse system has been configured, you can choose to insert and modify records, only insert records, or only modify records. For more information, see ["Import data from a Microsoft Excel file into a scenario" on page 384](#).

You can import data from a tab-delimited text file only into a worksheet.

A summary of the options for importing data is shown in the following table.

To import	Import
Records for a single table	- From a tab-delimited text file into a worksheet. - From a Microsoft Excel file into a worksheet. - From a Microsoft Excel file into a scenario.
Records for multiple tables or crosstab worksheets. This includes cases where data in one worksheet of the import file depends on or references the records in another worksheet, and cases where your customers or suppliers send you Microsoft Excel files with order or forecast information.	- From a Microsoft Excel file into every worksheet in a workbook. - From a Microsoft Excel file into a scenario.

Worksheets used to import data must have been created specifically to allow importing. You can view the imported records in the worksheet or any other worksheet based on the same table. Workbooks that are formatted to allow importing will typically be provided for you by your RapidResponse administrator or a workbook author.

When you import data, you must always specify the scenario the data is imported into. This can be either the active scenario in a worksheet, or the scenario you specify to import data into. You can import data into a private scenario, or a shared scenario that you have permission to modify.

Default values for imported records

Because of the relationship that exists among its tables, the RapidResponse database requires values for certain fields in order to maintain record integrity. During a data import, RapidResponse can automatically generate some of these required field values if your administrator has enabled the tables to automatically create required values. For the remainder of the required fields, you need to provide values in your external data source. If these required values are not provided, the data import will fail. If values are omitted for non-required fields, RapidResponse populates the worksheet with default values based on data type, as outlined in the following table.

Data type	Default
Integer	0
Quantity	0.0
Money	0.0
Time	12:00 AM
Date	Undefined
DateTime	Past
String	Is left blank

The workbook's author can also specify values for fields not included in the worksheet.

Import data from a text file

You can import data from a tab-delimited text file that contains the same columns as the worksheet you are importing into. The data can be imported into any worksheet designed to accept imported data, such as the worksheets in the Import External Data workbook, or any worksheet with all of a table's key fields in it.

A tab-delimited text file can contain data for only one table. Column headers are not required for the import, but are useful if you need to know how data in the text file corresponds to data in RapidResponse. The data in the text file must match the column order of the worksheet you are importing into.

When you import data into a workbook, records can be inserted into, modified in, or deleted from the RapidResponse database. Each worksheet can perform different import operations, which are determined by the worksheet's author. For example, a worksheet could insert new records and modify records that already exist in the database. You should always import data into a private scenario, to ensure the new records do not impact other data in your system.

Money data in the import file is imported using each worksheet column's currency. Before you import the data, you should ensure the currencies in the tab-delimited text file and the RapidResponse worksheets are the same, otherwise you cannot import the data.

Depending on how the workbook you are importing to has been configured, default values might be specified for columns that are not included in the import file. These values are used in any cell that does not have a value in the import file. If these values are not specified, the blank value can use the default value for the table you are importing to, such as a blank value for String columns or 'Undefined' for Date columns. If you are importing data to perform modifications, blank values in Quantity columns are ignored and the data is not modified.

If the import file contains records that would cause an import operation that the worksheet does not support, that record is reported as an error. For example, if the worksheet allows only modifications, any record in the import file that would be inserted results in an import error. When errors occur, you can choose to have the alert fail on the first error, or complete the import and report every error. If you choose to complete the import, you can import only the valid records. For more information about import errors, see ["Data import error categories" on page 393](#).

After you import data, you can verify the correct number of inserts, modifications, and deletions have been made. If the numbers do not look correct, you can cancel the import and then adjust your filtering settings.

1. Create a new scenario.
2. On the **Data** menu, point to **Import Data to**, and then click **Workbook**.
3. In the **Import Data to Workbook** dialog box, in the **Workbook** list, click the workbook you want to import data into.
4. In the **Worksheet** list, click the worksheet you want to import data into.
5. In the **Scenario** list, click the scenario you created in step 1.
6. Specify the filter, site, and other data control settings you want to use to define the data to import.
7. Click **Browse**.
8. Locate and select the source file you want to import, and then click **Open**.

9. If you want to exclude certain records from being imported—for example, the first row of the source file might contain heading names instead of data—select the **File contains header rows** check box.

The number of header rows in the worksheet determines how many rows of the import data are ignored. For example, if the worksheet contains two header rows, the import begins with line 3 of the import file.

10. To determine how errors in the import data are handled, click one of the following:
 - **Stop when the first error is found**—The import process ends when an error is encountered. No values are imported.
 - **Identify all invalid records**—The import process continues when errors are encountered. After all records are processed, you can choose to import the valid records.

By default, the selected option is the one that you selected the last time that you imported data to a workbook.

11. Click **Import**.
12. When the import is complete, in the **Confirm Changes** dialog box, review the number of changes that will be made when you complete the import.
13. To automatically open the workbook after you import, select the **Open the workbook after importing the data** check box.
14. To complete the import, click **Import**.

If any of the records fail to be imported, a **Data Import Errors** dialog box opens. It provides information about the records that were not imported, a summary of the error conditions, and if applicable, the field for which the error occurred. You can then cancel the data import, or import any valid records and save the invalid records to another file. For more information, see ["Data import error categories" on page 393](#).



Notes:

- If the file you import is located on a network drive, browse to the file location using Microsoft Windows Explorer prior to importing the file. This ensures that you are authenticated to connect to the network location.
- Any records for which the key fields are not unique cannot be imported.
- If records are imported into a shared scenario, other users can see the changes by clicking the **Pending Commits** tab in the **Scenario Properties** tab.



Tip: You can also import data into a worksheet by clicking **Import Data**  on the RapidResponse toolbar, and then clicking **Import Data to Workbook**.

Import data from a Microsoft Excel file into a workbook

You can import data from a Microsoft Excel file into a RapidResponse workbook. Depending on the data in the Microsoft Excel file, you can choose to import data into a single worksheet or into every worksheet in a workbook. You can import data only into a workbook that is designed for importing data. These workbooks are typically provided for you by your RapidResponse administrator, and can be configured to insert, modify, or delete records.

When you import data into a workbook, records can be inserted into, modified in, or deleted from the RapidResponse database. Each worksheet can perform different import operations, which are determined by the worksheet's author. For example, a worksheet could insert new records and modify records that already exist in the database. You should always import data into a private scenario, to ensure the new records do not impact other data in your system.

Depending on how the workbook you are importing to has been configured, default values might be specified for columns that are not included in the import file. These values are used in any cell that does not have a value in the import file. If these values are not specified, the blank value can use the default value for the table you are importing to, such as a blank value for String columns or 'Undefined' for Date columns. If you are importing data to perform modifications, blank values in Quantity columns are ignored and the data is not modified.

If the import file contains records that would cause an import operation that the worksheet does not support, that record is reported as an error. For example, if the worksheet allows only modifications, any record in the import file that would be inserted results in an import error. When errors occur, you can choose to have the import fail on the first error, or complete the import and report every error. If you choose to complete the import, you can import only the valid records. For more information about import errors, see ["Data import error categories" on page 393](#).

Importing data into crosstab worksheets

If the workbook contains crosstab worksheets, only the editable rows are affected by the import. The values from the Microsoft Excel file are inserted into the editable rows, and the summarized values are modified according to the crosstab worksheet's data editing rules. Any values provided for a non-editable row are ignored. For more information, see ["Edit records in a crosstab worksheet" on page 349](#).

When you import data into a crosstab worksheet, you must ensure the set of records in the crosstab worksheet and Microsoft Excel worksheet match. For example, if the crosstab worksheet shows demand order quantities for a set of parts and sites, the Microsoft Excel file must contain data values for only those part and site combinations. You cannot insert a new part and site combination into the crosstab worksheet by importing data.

By default, a crosstab worksheet can contain up to 500,000 records, measured by multiplying the number of rows by the number of buckets in the crosstab, because each bucket represents a separate record. If your RapidResponse administrator has increased the record limit, you can still import only up to 500,000 records at a time. When you import data into a crosstab worksheet, if the imported data crosses the import record limit, the import stops and an error is reported.

In this case, you can specify filter settings using the workbook controls (filter, site, part, and so on) to reduce the number of records in the worksheet, and split the import file according to the corresponding settings. For example, you can create a separate data file with records for each site. You should then use those same filter settings when you import each new data file.

Importing money data

Money data from the Microsoft Excel file is imported using the currency specified in the worksheet columns. If the currencies in the Microsoft Excel file and the worksheets you are importing into do not match, you cannot import the data. You can view the currency each money column in the Microsoft Excel file uses, as described in ["View the currency used in a column" on page 384](#). If you receive a Microsoft Excel file from a customer or supplier, you should verify the currencies in each worksheet column match the currencies used in the RapidResponse worksheets. If the currencies do not match, to import the data, you can contact the workbook's author to specify the correct currency, or the person who sent you the file to export using a different currency.

If a currency is not specified in the Microsoft Excel file, the data is imported using the currency displayed in the worksheet you import into. In this case, a warning is displayed during the import. If the currency displayed in the worksheet is not the currency you expect, for example, if you view data in US dollars and you receive orders from a customer in Europe, you can cancel the import and modify the currency in either the workbook or the Microsoft Excel file.

Matching worksheets and columns

When you are importing data from an Excel spreadsheet with multiple worksheets, data is imported into the worksheets that exist in both the RapidResponse workbook and the Microsoft Excel file. If the worksheets do not have the same names, or do not have the same columns in the same order, data is not imported into that worksheet. For example, if the Microsoft Excel file contains a worksheet named Expedited Orders and the RapidResponse worksheet does not contain a matching worksheet, the data in that worksheet is not imported.

However, if the workbook and the Microsoft Excel both contain a single worksheet, the worksheet names do not have to match, and data is imported as long as the columns match. Worksheet names are matched using the first 32 characters in the worksheet name.



Note: Microsoft Excel worksheets for importing data are typically designed based on the default column order of the corresponding worksheets in RapidResponse. If you have reordered the columns in the RapidResponse worksheet so that the order no longer matches, the data cannot be imported until you restore the default column order. For more information, see ["Restore original worksheet appearance in a workbook" on page 138](#).

Handling import errors

After you import data, you can verify the correct number of inserts, modifications, and deletions have been made. If the numbers do not look correct, you can cancel the import and then adjust your filtering settings.

If the import data contains errors, you can choose how those errors are handled during the import process. You can choose to stop importing when an error is encountered, or you can process every record and report all errors. If the import file contains crosstab worksheets, the crosstab import always fails on the first error. For more information about import errors, see ["Data import error messages" on page 394](#).

You can also save a copy of the error messages reported by the import to determine how to fix the issues. In some cases, the saved error messages include additional information that would not fit in the Data Import Errors dialog box. For example, if the import file does not specify a correct reference field value, an error code is shown in the import results, and the full error message is available in the detailed error messages. For more information, see ["Saving data import error messages" on page 396](#).

File size limit

Microsoft Excel files used for importing data must be 50 MB or less in size. If your file is larger than this, you can divide the Microsoft Excel file into multiple files and import them separately. Files near the size limit might take several minutes (or hours, in some cases) to import.

For crosstab worksheets, the 500,000 record limit might be reached before the file size limit, so you should inspect the files you want to import regardless of their file size.

► Import into a workbook

1. Create a new scenario.
2. On the **Data** menu, point to **Import Data to**, and then click **Workbook**.
3. In the **Import Data to Workbook** dialog box, in the **Workbook** list, click the workbook that contains the worksheet you want to import data into.
4. In the **Worksheet** list, click the worksheet you want to import data into.
To import data into all worksheets in the workbook, click **All corresponding worksheets**.
5. In the **Scenario** list, click the scenario you created in step 1.
6. Specify the filter, site, and other data control settings you want to use to define the data to import.
7. Click **Browse**.

8. Locate and select the Microsoft Excel file you want to import, and then click **Open**.
9. If you want to exclude records at the top of the worksheet from being imported—for example, if the first row of the source file contains heading names instead of data—select the **File contains header rows** check box.

The number of header rows in each worksheet determines how many rows of the import data are ignored. For example, if the worksheet contains two header rows, the import begins with line 3 of the import file.

10. To determine how errors in the import data are handled, click one of the following:
 - **Stop when the first error is found**—The import process ends when an error is encountered. No values are imported.
 - **Identify all invalid records**—The import process continues when errors are encountered. After all records are processed, you can choose to import the valid records.

By default, the selected option is the one that you selected the last time that you imported data to a workbook.

11. Click **Import**.
12. When the import is complete, in the **Confirm Changes** dialog box, review the number of changes that will be made when you complete the import.
13. To automatically open the workbook after you import, select the **Open the workbook after importing the data** check box.
14. To complete the import, click **Import**.

If any of the records fail to be imported, a **Data Import Errors** dialog box opens. It provides information about the records that were not imported, a summary of the error conditions, and if applicable, the field for which the error occurred. You can then cancel the data import, or import any valid records and save the invalid records to another file. For more information, see ["Data import error categories" on page 393](#).



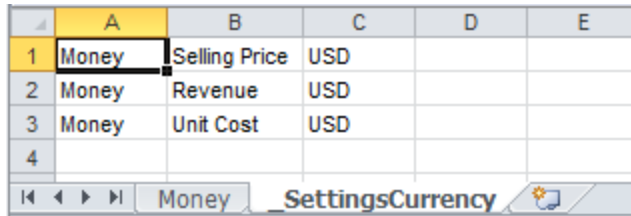
Note: When importing data to worksheet columns that use scaled numbers, the imported data will be scaled. For example, if a column is scaled in thousands and you import a data value of 2, you will see the value as 2 in RapidResponse, but the actual data value is 2000. For more information, see ["Understanding how numeric values are displayed" on page 153](#).



Tip: You can also import data into a workbook by clicking **Import Data**  on the RapidResponse toolbar, and then clicking **Import Data to Workbook**.

View the currency used in a column

When RapidResponse data is exported to Microsoft Excel, you can view the currency used in any Money columns in the Microsoft Excel file in a hidden worksheet named `_SettingsCurrency`. An example of this worksheet is shown in the following illustration.



	A	B	C	D	E
1	Money	Selling Price	USD		
2	Money	Revenue	USD		
3	Money	Unit Cost	USD		
4					

The columns in the `_SettingsCurrency` worksheet are created as described in the following table.

Column	Description
A	The worksheet that contains Money columns.
B	The worksheet column that contains the Money value.
C	The currency used in the column.

Depending on how the worksheet you are importing data to is created, the currencies in the Microsoft Excel file might not match. In this case, you cannot import the data in the Microsoft Excel file. To resolve the issue, you can contact the RapidResponse workbook's author to specify the correct currency, or the person who sent you the file to export using a different currency.

If the Microsoft Excel file does not contain a `_SettingsCurrency` worksheet, the currency displayed in the worksheet is used to import the Money data.

► View the `_SettingsCurrency` worksheet

1. In the Microsoft Excel file, right-click a worksheet name.
2. In the menu, click **Unhide**.
3. In the **Unhide** dialog box, select the `_SettingsCurrency` worksheet, and then click **OK**.

Import data from a Microsoft Excel file into a scenario

If your RapidResponse administrator has granted you the appropriate permissions, you can import data from a Microsoft Excel file into a scenario, which allows you to import the data directly into the RapidResponse database. This does not require a workbook to define the data that is imported, and requires all fields and values to be defined in the import file.

The import file typically must be formatted specifically for importing. Worksheet names in the import files must match the table name it provides data for, along with the namespace that table is in, which ensures the data is provided for the correct table. For example, a worksheet in the import file named `PartSource`

(Mfg) imports data into the PartSource table in the Mfg namespace. Each column in the worksheet must match the fields in the table. For more information, see ["Worksheets for importing data from a Microsoft Excel file" on page 399](#). For more information about namespaces, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

Depending on how the Microsoft Excel file is configured, importing data can insert new records, modify existing records, and delete obsolete records. You should always import data into a private scenario, to ensure the changes do not impact other data in your system.

You can import data from either a Microsoft Excel 97-2003 file (.xls), a Microsoft Excel file (.xlsx), or a macro-enabled Microsoft Excel file (.xlsm). Regardless of the format, the worksheets in the import file must be configured to allow importing.

When importing into a scenario, date values in the Microsoft Excel file are converted to your default date format. For more information, see ["Specify formats for dates, times, numbers, and currencies" on page 60](#).

Money data in the Microsoft Excel file is imported as quantity values, with no currency associated with the values. These values are inserted using either the currency an existing record is stored in, or RapidResponse's default currency for a new record. If the data has a currency specified, you should import the data into a workbook. For more information, see ["Import data from a Microsoft Excel file into a workbook" on page 380](#).

Any columns that do not have a header and do not contain data values, such as separator columns, are ignored when data is imported. These blank columns are not marked as errors, so you should always review the imported data to determine whether a blank column that should have been populated was imported.

You can choose to review the changes that will be made before the data is imported. You can see how many records are inserted, modified, or deleted by the import, and then choose to either continue with the import or to reject the changes and cancel the import. The changes do not include records inserted or deleted automatically, such as by deleting related records. For more information about deleting related records, see ["Delete records" on page 340](#). For more information about defining the records to be deleted, see ["Settings worksheets for importing data" on page 404](#).

Depending on how your administrator has configured RapidResponse, you might have the option to specify how the imported data is handled. You can choose to:

- Import new records and replace existing records with the imported data. You might select this option if you want to bring in new records and modify existing records, such as adding new orders and updating forecast quantities.
- Import only new records and ignore duplicate records in the imported data. You might select this option if you want to only bring in new records but not update other records, such as adding actual orders without modifying existing orders.
- Reject new records and only replace existing records in the imported data. You might select this option if you want to only update records, such as updating order due dates without adding new orders.

If these options are not available, duplicate records in the imported data always replace the records in the RapidResponse database. Regardless of the option you select, if the import file defines records to be deleted, those records are deleted before the records are inserted or modified.

Any data required by, but not included in, the Microsoft Excel file can be automatically created during the import. If your RapidResponse administrator has enabled automatic record creation, the records required to support the data in the Microsoft Excel file are created as the record that needs them is imported. For more information, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

Microsoft Excel files used for importing data into a scenario must be 10 MB or less in size, unless your RapidResponse administrator has modified the size limit. If your file is larger than this, you are notified when you try to import the data in the file. To reduce the file size, you can divide the Microsoft Excel file into multiple files and import them separately.

You can also export data from a RapidResponse workbook and format it so that data can be imported into a scenario. Depending on the format of worksheets in the workbook, the workbook might need to use a report template to export data. For example, a workbook with crosstab worksheets must use a report template that defines the settings used to insert records into the RapidResponse database. For more information, see ["Importing data in crosstab worksheet format" on page 402](#).

When you export an importable worksheet, the column headers are modified to refer to the database tables and fields each column provides data for, namespace qualifications are added to the tables and fields, and money columns are modified to display unconverted (raw) quantity values. If the table or namespace names are longer than 32 characters, the names are shortened and special mapping worksheets that map the truncated name to the full name are inserted. These worksheets are hidden, and are referenced when data is imported from the file to ensure the data is imported into the correct table and namespace. For more information, see ["Importing data in tabular worksheet format" on page 400](#).

To ensure data is read correctly, you must ensure the namespace for each field used in the worksheet is specified. If the namespaces are not specified, the values imported for that field are blank. When you export data from a workbook that specifies how data is imported into scenarios, the namespaces for fields are included automatically. However, any import files you receive from external sources or that were created in RapidResponse 2015.3 (or earlier) might not have the namespaces. In this case, you must modify the import file to ensure all namespaces are specified.

If the workbook contains crosstab worksheets, specialized worksheets called Settings sheets are inserted into the worksheet's export template and exported to the Microsoft Excel file to determine how data in crosstab worksheets relate to the RapidResponse database and whether records are deleted prior to the import. You can modify these Settings worksheets to import data with specific values. For more information, see ["Worksheets for importing data from a Microsoft Excel file" on page 399](#). For more information about report templates, see ["Export data to a Microsoft Excel file" on page 319](#).

► Import data into a scenario

1. Create a scenario to import data into.
2. On the **Data** menu, point to **Import Data to**, and then click **Scenario**.
3. In the **Import Data to Scenario** dialog box, click **Browse**.
4. Locate and select the Microsoft Excel file you want to import, and then click **Open**.
5. In the **Scenario** list, click the scenario you want to import data into.
6. If applicable, click one of the following:
 - **Insert new records and replace existing records**—Records that do not exist in RapidResponse are inserted, and records that do exist are replaced with new records from the imported data.
 - **Insert new records**—Records that do not exist in RapidResponse are inserted, and records that do exist are ignored.
 - **Modify existing records**—Records that exist in RapidResponse are modified, and records that do not exist are rejected.
7. If you would like to see how many records are imported, modified, or deleted during the import, select the **Confirm the changes before importing** check box.
8. Click **Import**.

9. When the import is complete, if you did not select the **Confirm the changes before importing** check box in step 7, click **OK**.

Otherwise, do the following:

- In the **Confirm Changes** dialog box, examine the number of records inserted, modified, and deleted.
- Click **Yes** to confirm the changes and import the data, or click **No** to reject the changes and cancel the import.

If any of the records fail to be imported, a **Data Import Errors** dialog box opens before the **Confirm Changes** dialog box is displayed. It provides information about the records that were not imported, including which records could not be imported, and why the import failed. You can then cancel the data import, or import any valid records and save the invalid records to another file. For more information, see ["Data import error categories" on page 393](#).



Notes:

- If the import automatically creates records in tables, those new records are reported in the **Confirm Changes** dialog box.
- If the Microsoft Excel file contains data for a table that does not exist or for a table that has been defined in multiple namespaces, you might need to modify the Microsoft Excel file to specify the correct table or namespace. For more information, see ["Worksheets for importing data from a Microsoft Excel file" on page 399](#). For more information about tables and namespaces, see the [RapidResponse Data Integration Guide](#).



Tip: You can also import data into a scenario by clicking **Import Data**  on the RapidResponse toolbar, and then clicking **Import Data to Scenario**.

► Export an importable Microsoft Excel file

1. In the **Explorer**, open the workbook that you want to use to import data.
2. On the **Data** menu, click **Export**.
3. In the **Export Data** dialog box, navigate to the location you want to save the exported file.
4. In the **File name** box, type a name for the file
5. In the **Files of type** list, select one of the following:
 - Microsoft Excel Workbook (*.xlsx) - Mac OS only (version 2008-2019)
 - Microsoft Excel Workbook (*.xlsx) - Windows only (version 2007-2019)
 - Microsoft Excel Workbook (*.xls) - Mac OS only (version 97-2004)
 - Microsoft Excel Workbook (*.xls) - Windows only (version 97-2003)
6. In the **Export** area, click one of the following:
 - **Active worksheet**—exports data displayed in the active worksheet.
 - **All worksheets in workbook**—exports data displayed in each worksheet in the active workbook. Each worksheet in the workbook corresponds to a worksheet in the Microsoft Excel file.
 - **Workbook data using the report template**—exports data in worksheets as specified in the report template. Selecting this option automatically sets the other exporting options.
7. If you did not select **Workbook data using the report template** in step 6, select the **Configure**

the exported file for importing data into a scenario check box.

8. Click **Save**.

Example of using a workbook to import data

The following provides an example of the process for using a workbook to import data into the **IndependentDemand** table. This example uses a Microsoft Excel file to import new orders into RapidResponse.

This example uses the Import External Data workbook. For information about the worksheets in the Import External Data workbook, see the workbook help. The help also identifies the columns for which you must specify values in the external data file.

Prepare the external data file

In this example, data is being imported into the **IndependentDemand** table. The source data file contains data for most of the fields required for a successful import, as well as data for the Customer ID field as shown in the following illustration. In this case, the Customer ID, JoeCycle, does not yet exist in the RapidResponse database.

Name	Part Site	Due Date	Quantity	Type	Site	Order Number	Line	Customer ID
CRUISER	HQ	06-06-08	400	Actual	HQ	C000112	1	JoeCycle
MOUNTAIN	HQ	06-25-08	500	Actual	HQ	C000174	1	JoeCycle
PROCRAISER	HQ	06-12-08	300	Actual	HQ	C000196	1	JoeCycle
PRORACER	HQ	06-12-08	500	Actual	HQ	C000218	1	JoeCycle
RACER	HQ	06-26-08	400	Actual	HQ	C000230	1	JoeCycle

Before the data in this file can be imported, it must contain all required fields in the Import External Data workbook. In particular, the file is missing the Order Priority and Status fields. Valid values for these fields can be found in the Control Tables workbook, shown in the following illustration, which is generally available only to administrators. To determine which fields require values, see the Import External Data workbook help.

Start

Control Tables

Baseline

Demand Status

Demand Type

Forecast Item Parameters Type

Historical Demand Category

Order status values

Value

Control Set

Number of Independent Demands

Description

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

Order Policy

Order Priority

Part Source Type

Part Type

Planning Calendar

Order priority values

Value

Control Set

Demand Types

Independent Demands Under Order Priority

Saved Priority

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

DCLow

DCMed

SlottedSR

SOPDefault

SOPDemandMgmt

Default

DemandMgmt

1

2

52

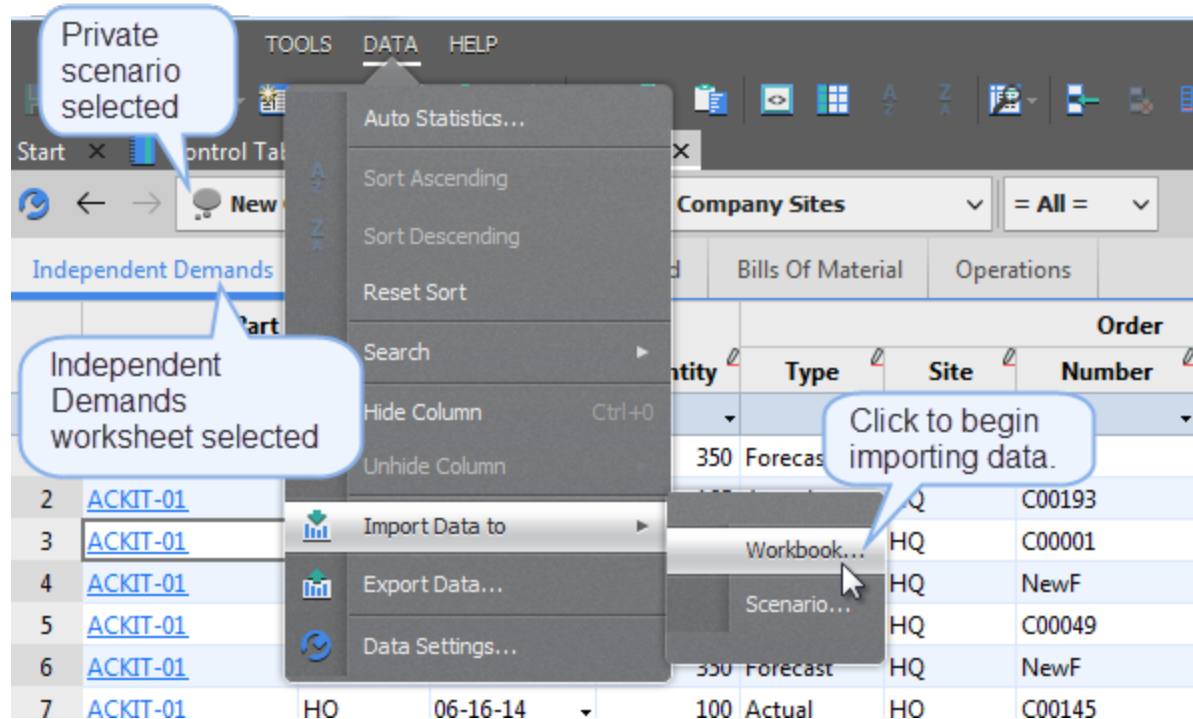
Values for the missing fields then need to be added to the external data file as shown in the following illustration.

Customer ID	Promised Date	Shipped Quantity	Unit Selling Price	Priority	Saved Priority	Status
JoeCycle		0	1,200	Med	Med	Current
JoeCycle		0	950	Med	Med	Current
JoeCycle		0	1,600	Med	Med	Current
JoeCycle		0	950	Med	Med	Current
JoeCycle		0	950	Med	Med	Current

Open the Import External Data workbook

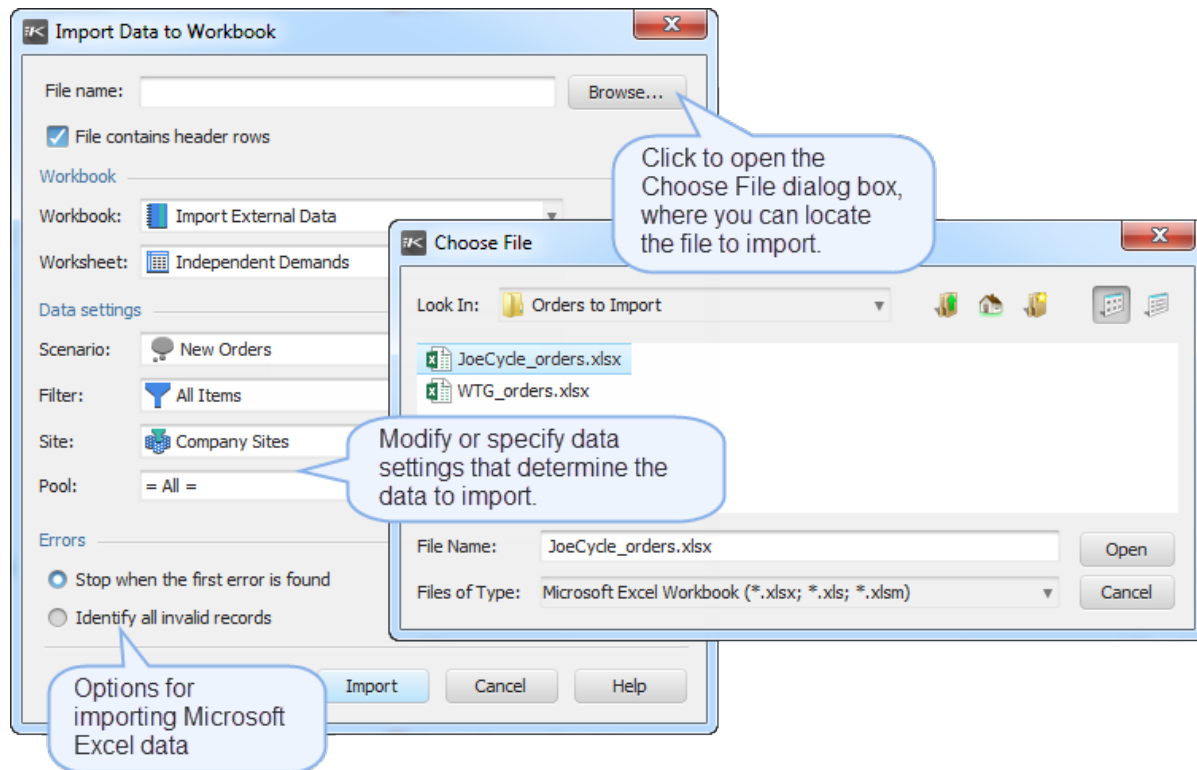
Once all required data fields have been added to the external data file, they can be imported into the Import External Data workbook.

Within the Import External Data workbook, the Independent Demands worksheet is used to import the order data. In order to begin importing data, you must be working in a private scenario. To start the import process, point to **Import Data to** and then click **Workbook** from the **Data** menu, as shown in the following illustration.



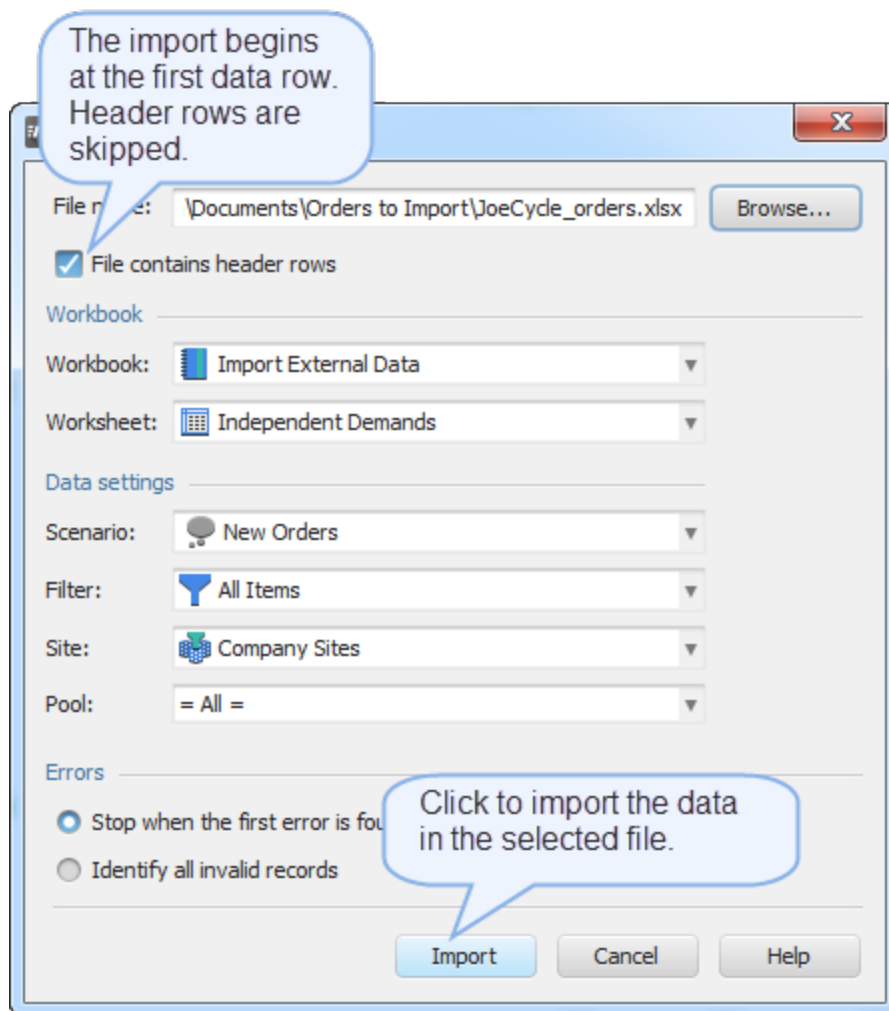
Select the file

After you select the **Workbook** command, the **Import Data to Workbook** dialog box opens. To select a file for import, click **Browse**, and then locate the file.



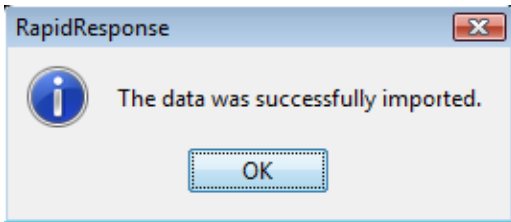
Complete the import

After you select the file for import, the actual importing of the data is initiated by clicking **Import**, as shown in the following illustration.



Records can only be created in those referenced tables that a data administrator has enabled automatic record creation for. For more information, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

You are notified when the import is completed, as in the following illustration. Click **OK** to finish the process.



After a successful import, the new records display in the Independent Demands worksheet.

Independent Demands									
Name		Due Date	Quantity	Type	Site	Order Number	Line	Customer ID	
1	CRUISER	06-17-15	300	Actual	HQ	C00142221	1	JoeCycle	0
2	CRUISER	06-24-15	300	Actual	HQ	C00142222	1	JoeCycle	0
3	MOUNTAIN	06-24-15	100	Actual	HQ	C00142222	3	JoeCycle	0
4	MOUNTAIN	07-01-15	300	Actual	HQ	C00142223	1	JoeCycle	0
5	PROCRUISER	06-24-15	300	Actual	HQ	C00142222	2	JoeCycle	0
6	RACER	07-01-15	50	Actual	HQ	C00142223	2	JoeCycle	0

Besides adding records to the **IndependentDemand** table, the import also added a record to the **Customer** table. This is because the Order Customer ID field in the Independent Demands worksheet is a reference to the Customer table. In this example the value in the imported records for this field, **JoeCycle**, did not already exist on the Customer table.

Data import error categories

When you import data, error messages are displayed if there are problems with the data. Errors are reported when you import data from a Microsoft Excel file or a text file into a workbook or scenario. The errors that might be reported depend on which type of file you import from. You might need to refer to the [RapidResponse Analytic and Data Model Guide](#) to resolve errors. If you cannot access this guide, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

Messages can belong to one of the following categories.

Icon	Description
✓	All records are valid and can be imported
⚠	Some records in the imported file are not valid. Some records are valid and can be imported.
❌	No records are valid and none can be imported, or no records can be imported because of errors in the Microsoft Excel file.

Data import error messages

The following error conditions might occur when you import data into a workbook.

Error message	Description
Invalid data	The data is in the wrong format. For example, an alphabetic value was provided for a numeric field.
Duplicate key field	The values provided for the record's key fields are the same as an existing record.
Invalid reference field	The value provided for a reference field does not exist in the RapidResponse database.
Number of columns does not match	The number of data values in a record you want to import is not the same as the number of columns in the worksheet.
No matching worksheet in import file	The Microsoft Excel file does not have a worksheet with the same name as the RapidResponse worksheet. This message only displays if you import data from a Microsoft Excel file into all worksheets in a workbook.
No matching worksheet in RapidResponse	The Microsoft Excel file contains a worksheet that does not have the same name as a worksheet in the RapidResponse workbook. This message only displays if you import data from a Microsoft Excel file into all worksheets in a workbook. This message is displayed in the file created to save error messages, and is not displayed in RapidResponse.
Records cannot be inserted into the <table name> table	The table the worksheet is based on cannot be used to insert records. To use this worksheet to import data, you must ensure the records in the Microsoft Excel file match the records in the RapidResponse worksheet, and the worksheet allows records to be modified or deleted.
Modify: Data in view-only column will not be changed	A column contains data that cannot be modified. This message is displayed only if the import operation modifies data.
Worksheet does not contain all key fields	The RapidResponse worksheet is missing one or more columns required for inserting records. To use this worksheet to import data, you must ensure the records in the Microsoft Excel file match the records in the RapidResponse worksheet, and the worksheet allows records to be modified or deleted.
No data rows in the import file	The Microsoft Excel worksheet contains no data rows.
Invalid foreign key	The crosstab worksheet's insert definition is defined incorrectly.
Bucket size not in header row	The Microsoft Excel crosstab worksheet does not have a calendar defined.
Buckets not in chronological order	The buckets in the Microsoft Excel crosstab worksheet are not in chronological order.
Date not in mm-dd-yyyy format	A date specified in the Microsoft Excel crosstab worksheet is defined using an invalid format. The date format displayed in the message depends on your date format preference.

Error message	Description
Bucket size "<calendar value>" is not valid	The "<calendar value>" calendar specified in the Microsoft Excel crosstab worksheet is not defined in the RapidResponse worksheet.
Empty buckets cannot be changed	The RapidResponse worksheet contains a bucket with no records or a bucket with protected records, and the worksheet does not allow records to be inserted.
No matching data to modify	The RapidResponse worksheet does not contain any data.
Extra rows in Excel file skipped	The Microsoft Excel file contains rows of data that are not present in the RapidResponse worksheet.
RapidResponse rows omitted from import file	The RapidResponse worksheet contains rows of data that are not present in the Microsoft Excel file.
Invalid data bucket column header	The pivot column in the Microsoft Excel file is not a valid date value.
Row identification values do not match	The group by column values in the Microsoft Excel file and in the RapidResponse worksheet are different.
Invalid header rows in Excel file	The Microsoft Excel file does not contain header rows.
Missing bucket	A date bucket is missing from the Microsoft Excel file.
<table name> is not a valid table	A table or namespace is not specified in the import file or the specified table and namespace do not map to a valid table. For more information, see "Importing data in tabular worksheet format" on page 400 .
Mismatched currency	The currency used in the Microsoft Excel columns does not match the currency used in RapidResponse column.

The following error conditions might occur when you import data into a scenario.

Error message	Description
Invalid data type	The data is in the wrong format. For example, an alphabetic value was provided for a numeric field.
Cannot resolve reference	The value provided for a reference field does not exist in the RapidResponse database.
Duplicate record	The values provided for the record's key fields are the same as an existing record or another record in the import file.
Automatic record creation failed	The record could not be automatically created. This can happen because of a missing reference record, or because the table data is imported into does not allow records to be automatically created.
Automatic record creation ignored	The record could not be automatically created because the record being created already exists in the table.

Error message	Description
Worksheet contains no records	The Microsoft Excel worksheet does not contain data.
The worksheets in this file contain errors and cannot be processed	The worksheets in the Microsoft Excel file contain errors that prevent the data in these worksheets from being imported.

If you are importing crosstab data into a scenario, you might receive error messages related to Settings sheets in the Microsoft Excel file. For information about resolving these error messages, see ["Worksheets for importing data from a Microsoft Excel file" on page 399](#).

► View detail messages

1. In a failed import dialog box, click **OK**.
The **Data Import Errors** dialog box lists the number of valid and invalid records in each worksheet of the imported file.
2. In the **Summary** area of the **Data Import Errors** dialog box, click a worksheet name.
The **Details** area contains a list of invalid records, the error type, and the affected column of the worksheet. You can use this information to correct the errors.

Saving data import error messages

If an import fails, you can save the error and detail messages in a new file to use as a reference when resolving the errors. If any worksheets could not be imported, either because of errors or because they did not have a matching worksheet in the Microsoft Excel file or the RapidResponse workbook, they are listed in the saved error and detail messages. You can also save the invalid records in a file, so you can isolate the records that have errors. Errors and details are saved only for worksheets that have the same name in the Microsoft Excel file and RapidResponse workbook.

If you choose to save both the error and detail messages, and the invalid records, they are combined into one file. For Microsoft Excel files, the error and detail file includes a summary worksheet and additional technical information for resolving the problems with the data. A worksheet is created in the error and detail file for each Microsoft Excel worksheet that had errors on importing. Each row in these worksheets contains the invalid record and the error and detail message, and identifies the column that is affected. For tab-delimited text files, the error and detail messages are listed at the beginning of the file, followed by the invalid records.

1. In the **Data Import Errors** dialog box, in the **Save** area, select at least one of the following check boxes:
 - **Detail messages**—Saves the list of error and detail messages in a new file.
 - **Invalid records**—Saves the invalid records in a new file.

If both check boxes are selected, the invalid records, and error and detail messages are saved in the same file. The file is in Microsoft Excel format.

2. Click **Save**.
3. In the **Save as** dialog box, navigate to the location you want to save the errors and details.
4. Optionally, in the **File name** text box, type a new name for the file.
5. Click **Save**.



Note: If **Invalid Records** is selected, the Microsoft Excel file highlights the invalid record in a color and includes a comment in the cell.

Importing only valid records

If an import fails, after saving the error messages or invalid reports, you can import just the valid records. You can then resolve the errors in the invalid records, and import them separately. If you want to import all the records together, you can cancel the import, resolve the errors, and then import the data again. For more information, see ["Saving data import error messages" on page 396](#).

- In the **Data Import Errors** dialog box, click **Import Valid Records**.
If you do not want to import the valid records, you can cancel the import by clicking **Cancel**.



Notes:

- If the data imported into a scenario did not contain any valid records, the **Data Import Errors** dialog box is not displayed, and you are prompted to save the invalid records.
- The first time you do not click **Save**, when you click **Import Valid Records**, you are notified that you did not save the errors, and are prompted to either continue with importing the valid records by clicking **Yes**, or to return to the **Data Import Errors** dialog box by clicking **No**.

CHAPTER 30: Worksheets for importing data from a Microsoft Excel file

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Settings worksheets for importing data	404
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Worksheets in a Microsoft Excel file can be one of the following:

- A tabular data worksheet—Contains data to be imported, in a vertical format. For more information, see ["Importing data in tabular worksheet format" on page 400](#).
- A crosstab data worksheet—Contains data to be imported, in a horizontal format. For more information, see ["Importing data in crosstab worksheet format" on page 402](#).
- A Settings worksheet—Defines how the data in data worksheets is mapped into the RapidResponse database. Settings sheets are required for crosstab worksheets, and for tabular worksheets only if the Microsoft Excel file also contains crosstab worksheets. For more information, see ["Settings worksheets for importing data" on page 404](#).

Each data worksheet provides the data for a single database table, and each table is contained in a namespace. Namespaces act as containers to identify or give context to groupings of related tables and fields. This provides a means to distinguish between multiple tables, or multiple fields on a given table, that have the same name but different purposes. Worksheets must contain the table's key fields, either as columns in the Microsoft Excel worksheet, or specified in a Settings sheet.

The Microsoft Excel file can contain any number of worksheets. When creating the workbook, the following are recommended:

- You should group all tabular data files.
- If you have a Settings sheet that describes how the tabular worksheets are imported into RapidResponse, you should place it after the last tabular worksheet.
- You should arrange the crosstab worksheets and settings worksheets so that each crosstab worksheet is beside the Settings sheet that describes how its data is imported into RapidResponse.

- DateTime values in the worksheets must contain a year (yyyy), a day (dd), month (mm), as well as the hour (hh), minute (mm), and second (ss). The hour must be specified using a 24-hour clock (for example, 15 instead of 3 PM). The DateTime values are specified in the following format:
yyyy-dd-mm hh:mm:ss
- If you have other worksheets that do not contain data to be imported, you should place them after the last crosstab-Settings pair.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I
1	Name	Site.Value	ReferencePart	ABCCode	BuyerCode	PlannerCode	SourceRule	Type	UnitOfMeasure
2	ACKIT-40	HQ	ACKIT-40X	B	RM	RT	Proportional	MPS	EA
3	WHEEL-04	HQ	WHEEL-04X	B	ST	JH	Proportional	MRP	EA
4	WHEEL-05	HQ	WHEEL-05X	A	JC	JH	Proportional	MRP	EA
5	WHEEL-06	HQ	WHEEL-06X	B	JC	JH	Proportional	MRP	EA
6									
7									
8									

Tabular worksheets

Settings worksheet that describes how the tabular worksheets are imported into RapidResponse

Crosstab worksheet

Settings sheet that describes how the crosstab worksheet is imported into RapidResponse

Kinaxis provides a sample Microsoft Excel file (**SampleImportableSpreadsheet.xls**) that can be used as a template for properly formatting your own Microsoft Excel files. This file contains crosstab and tabular Data worksheets, with related Settings worksheets. The sample Microsoft Excel file can be provided for you by your RapidResponse administrator.

Importing data in tabular worksheet format

A Microsoft Excel worksheet in tabular format is similar to a tabular RapidResponse worksheet. The column headers contain RapidResponse field names, and each row of the worksheet represents a record. The worksheet must contain columns for each of the table's key fields. Columns that represent key fields and referenced records must be labeled with the table and field names, using the TableName.FieldName syntax. For example, Order.Type or Assembly.Part.Name. This syntax is automatically specified if you export a RapidResponse workbook using the option to format the file for importing data to a scenario.

The column headers must exactly match the field names in the table. The worksheet and column names cannot contain spaces.

	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	Part.Name	Part.Site	Location.Id	Location.Warehouse.Id	Type	Quantity
2	Racer	Ottawa	Rack	Main	Net	200
3	Cruiser	Ottawa	Rack	Main	Net	450
4	Mountain	Ottawa	Rack	Main	Net	300
5	FRAME-01	Ottawa	Stores	Main	NoNet	1200
6	FRAME-02	Ottawa	Stores	Main	NoNet	1050
7	FRAME-03	Ottawa	Stores	Main	Net	800
8						
9						
10						

Sheet1 / Sheet2 / Sheet3 / **OnHand** / Other Sheet / Settings / Si

The tabular worksheet in this example provides data for the OnHand table. Each of its column headers indicates which field the record values are inserted into, with table names included for reference records, such as the Part.Name or Location.Id fields.

Tabular worksheets typically have the same name as the tables they provide data for and can refer to the namespace that table is in. Depending on the length of the table name and namespace, the worksheet name might be truncated. For example, if the namespace and table name are longer than 32 characters, the names are shortened and additional hidden worksheets are inserted. These worksheets, `_NamespaceMap` and `_TableMap`, are used to map the full table and namespace names to the worksheet names. An example of a `_TableMap` worksheet is shown in the following illustration.

	A	B	C
1	HistoricalDemandHeader0	HistoricalDemandHeaderTimePhasedAttributes	
2			
3			
4			

HistoricalDemandHeader0 (Mfg) / **_TableMap** /

For these worksheets, the columns are mapped as follows.

Column	Description
A	The table or namespace name as displayed in the worksheet name.
B	The table or namespace name in RapidResponse.

These worksheets are created automatically when you export data from RapidResponse, and can be added to or modified in Microsoft Excel files if required.

If the Microsoft Excel file contains both tabular and crosstab worksheets, a Settings sheet is required for the tabular worksheets. If a Settings sheet exists for a tabular worksheet, the tabular worksheet does not need to have the same name as the table it imports data into. For more information about Settings sheets, see ["Settings worksheets for importing data" on page 404](#).

If the Microsoft Excel file contains a worksheet that provides data for the CurrencyConversionActual table, those records are not included in the import.

► View the _NamespaceMap or _TableMap worksheets

1. In Microsoft Excel, right-click a worksheet name.
2. In the menu, click **Unhide**.
3. In the **Unhide** dialog box, select one of the following:
 - **_NamespaceMap**
 - **_TableMap**
4. Click **OK**.

► Modify the _NamespaceMap or _TableMap worksheets

1. Select the **_NamespaceMap** or **_TableMap** worksheet.
If you need to add these worksheets, click **New Worksheet**, and then name the new worksheet **_NamespaceMap** or **_TableMap**.
2. In column **A**, ensure the value matches the worksheet name.
3. In column **B**, modify the value to match either the RapidResponse table or namespace name.
4. Save your changes.

Importing data in crosstab worksheet format

A Microsoft Excel file with crosstab worksheets must meet several criteria to be included in the data import process. It must contain at least one data worksheet, which contains the data to be imported, and one Settings worksheet, which describes how the data in the crosstab worksheet is mapped to the tables and fields in the RapidResponse database. This section describes the crosstab data worksheets and the criteria they must meet to be valid. For information about Settings worksheets, see ["Settings worksheets for importing data" on page 404](#).

A Microsoft Excel crosstab worksheet can be used to import data only into the ScheduledReceipt or IndependentDemand tables.

An example of a Microsoft Excel crosstab worksheet is shown in the following illustration.

	A	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O
1				15-Jan	22-Jan	29-Jan	Total Jan	5-Feb	12-Feb	19-Feb	26-Feb	5-Mar	Total Feb
2	OTT+NY	Racer	Net Reqts	5	5	10	20	5	5	10	10	10	40
3			TCO	1	0	1	2	1	0	1	1	1	4
4			Ship Plan	4	10	9	23	4	10	9	9	9	41
5			Balance	0	5	0	5	0	5	0	0	0	5
6	OTT	Racer	Net Reqts	5	5	10	20	5	5	10	10	10	40
7			TCO	1	0	1	2	1	0	1	1	1	4
8			Ship Plan	4	10	9	23	4	10	9	9	9	41
9			Balance	0	5	0	5	0	5	0	0	0	5
10	NY	Racer	Net Reqts	5	5	10	20	5	5	10	10	10	40
11			TCO	1	0	1	2	1	0	1	1	1	4
12			Ship Plan	1	0	0	1	1	0	0	0	0	1
13			Balance	-3	-5	-9	-17	-3	-5	-9	-9	-9	-35
14	OTT	Cruiser	Net Reqts	5	5	10	20	5	5	10	10	10	40
15			TCO	1	0	1	2	1	0	1	1	1	4
16			Ship Plan	1	3	1	5	1	3	1	1	1	7
17			Balance	-3	-2	-8	-13	-3	-2	-8	-8	-8	-29
18	NY	Cruiser	Net Reqts	5	5	10	20	5	5	10	10	10	40
19			TCO	1	0	1	2	1	0	1	1	1	4
20			Ship Plan	1	3	1	5	1	3	1	1	1	7
21			Balance	-3	-2	-8	-13	-3	-2	-8	-8	-8	-29

The data worksheet is in crosstab format; that is, date buckets are used in column headers.

In addition to the data being in crosstab format, the following rules apply to crosstab data worksheets:

- The first two visible columns and the last visible column before the pivoted data are reserved for site, part, and type data, respectively. Type data includes items such as commitments and requirements from suppliers or orders from customers. The columns that can be included in the Data worksheets depend on the version of Settings sheets being used. For example, if you are using a Version 300 Settings sheet, the columns between the Part and Type data can contain any number of additional columns, as shown in the following illustration.

A	D	E	F	G	H	I	J
					15-Jan	22-Jan	29-Jan
Boston+Detroit	Racer	W1	C1	Net Reqts	5	5	10
				TCO	1	0	1
				Ship Plan	4	10	9
				Balance	0	5	0
Boston	Racer	W1	C4	Net Reqts	5	9	11.00
				TCO	1	0	1
				Ship Plan	4	10	9
				Balance	0	1	-1

- The first visible row is reserved for dates. The dates begin in the visible column following the Type data and must be formatted as actual date data. When the data is imported, all date values are converted to the user's default format.
- When data is imported, the part and date values can be used to create order line values in the format `Date_Part`. This value can be overridden by specifying a different line value in the Settings worksheet.
- All rows below the date row should be used for data. However, you can include information such as header text in Column A provided the other columns do not contain any text or data.
- Any data related to a site that has not been specified in a settings worksheet is ignored. For example, the following illustration shows a portion of a data worksheet and a portion of a settings worksheet showing the MapSites configuration setting. Only two sites are defined (OTT and NY). Using this example, the data related in the OTT+NY site is ignored. This might have been added to the data worksheet for summation or visibility purposes only. For more information about this configuration setting, see ["MapSites" on page 415](#).

A	D	E	F
			15-Jan
OTT+NY	Racer	Net Reqts	5
		TCO	1
		Ship Plan	4
		Balance	0
OTT	Racer	Net Reqts	5
		TCO	1
		Ship Plan	4
		Balance	0
NY	Racer	Net Reqts	5
		TCO	1
		Ship Plan	1
		Balance	-3

A	B
MapSites	Site
OTT	Ottawa
NY	New York
/MapSites	

- Any data related to a type that has not been specified in a settings worksheet is ignored. For example, the following illustration shows a portion of a data worksheet and a portion of a settings worksheet showing the MapTypes configuration setting. Three types are defined (Net Reqs, TCO, and Ship Plan). Using this example, the data related to the Balance type is ignored. This might have been added to the data worksheet for summation or visibility purposes only. For more information about this configuration setting, see ["MapTypes" on page 415](#).

	A	D	E	F	G	H
1				15-Jan	22-Jan	29-Jan
2	OTT+NY	Racer	Net Reqs	5	5	10
3			TCO	1	0	1
4			Ship Plan	4	10	9
5			Balance	0	5	0
6	OTT	Racer	Net Reqs	5	5	10
7			TCO	1	0	1
8			Ship Plan	4	10	9
9			Balance	0	5	0
10	NY	Racer	Net Reqs	5	5	10
11			TCO	1	0	1
12			Ship Plan	1	0	0
13			Balance	-3	-5	-9

A	
MapTypes	
Ship Plan	Commitm
TCO	SpecialCc
Net Reqs	NetRequir

The crosstab worksheet automatically maps values from the crosstab data for the following fields in the IndependentDemand or ScheduledReceipt table:

- Order.Id
- Order.Type
- Order.Site
- Line
- Part.Name
- Part.Site
- DueDate
- Quantity

You can override the values provided for the Order.Id or Line fields in the AdditionalData section of the Settings sheet. For more information, see ["Version 400 Settings sheets" on page 409](#).

Settings worksheets for importing data

If the Microsoft Excel file contains a crosstab worksheet, then at least one worksheet in the file must have a name that begins with Settings (for example, 'Settings' or 'Settings - Site 1'). Settings worksheets define the configuration settings for the crosstab and tabular data worksheets. The configuration settings indicate to RapidResponse how to read and load the data from the Microsoft Excel file.

It is recommended that you use a Settings sheet to process only one crosstab worksheet.

If the Microsoft Excel file contains a crosstab worksheet and a tabular worksheet, a Settings worksheet is required for each type of worksheet. You can use one Settings sheet to process multiple tabular worksheets.

In each Settings worksheet you must specify a Version setting, which controls the configuration sections you can add to the Settings sheet, how data worksheets can be formatted, and whether separate header and detail records are created. Valid Version settings are shown in the following table.

Version	Description	RapidResponse version
100	Generates separate header and detail records for orders. Data worksheets must contain only three data columns (Site, Part, Type). For more information, see "Version 100 Settings sheets" on page 430 .	8.2.3 and later
200	Automatically generates header records for orders. Requires the header record tables to allow records to be automatically created. Data worksheets must contain only three data columns (Site, Part, Type). For more information, see "Version 200 Settings sheets" on page 426 .	9.2 and later
300	Can optionally generate separate header records for orders. Data worksheets can contain additional columns. Additional data sections can contain variables and obtain values from Data worksheet columns or other sections of the Settings sheet. For more information, see "Version 300 Settings sheets" on page 417 .	9.4 and later
400	Uses namespaces to insert records into tables and fields. For more information, see "Version 400 Settings sheets" on page 409 .	11.0 and later

When RapidResponse loads the Microsoft Excel worksheets, the Settings worksheets are read from left to right.

The sample Microsoft Excel workbook (SampleImportableSpreadsheet.xls), available from your RapidResponse administrator, includes a Settings worksheet. The Settings worksheet is set to protected mode to prevent anyone from accidentally changing the settings it holds. Protected mode can be disabled if you want to make any changes to the Settings worksheet.

If you copy the Settings worksheet, protected mode still applies to the copied worksheet. It is good practice to enable worksheet protection on any Settings worksheet to avoid inadvertent changes.

After making changes to a Settings worksheet, it is recommended that you apply protection again to the Settings worksheet.

► To remove Microsoft Excel 2003 worksheet protection

- On the **Tools** menu, point to **Protection**, and then click **Unprotect Sheet**.

► To remove Microsoft Excel 2007-2016 worksheet protection

- On the **Review** tab, in the **Changes** group, click **Unprotect Sheet**.

► To apply Microsoft Excel 2003 worksheet protection

1. On the **Tools** menu, point to **Protection**, and then click **Protect Sheet**.
2. Click **OK**.



Note: Using a password to protect a worksheet is optional.

► **To apply Microsoft Excel 2007-2016 worksheet protection**

1. On the **Review** tab, in the **Changes** group, click **Protect Sheet**.
2. Click **OK**.



Note: Using a password to protect a worksheet is optional.

For more information about protecting worksheets or other elements in Microsoft Excel, see the *Microsoft Excel Help*.

Settings worksheet syntax

Column A in a Settings worksheet specifies the configuration settings. Settings are specified using the following convention:

SettingName (opens setting configuration section)

Setting information

/SettingName (closes setting configuration section)

The forward slash is used to close the setting specification.

The following illustration shows the settings for specifying site names.

A	B
MapSites	Site
OTT	Ottawa
NY	New York
/MapSites	

In this example, MapSites is used to define site names in RapidResponse for data from the Ottawa and New York sites.

Column B (and in some cases columns C, D, and subsequent) are used to provide additional information about a setting. The following sections describe all the configuration settings that can be used in a Settings worksheet.

Create a Settings sheet for importing data

You can create a new Settings sheet, or copy one from the sample importable file provided with RapidResponse. The configuration sections you can include in a Settings worksheet depend on the value you specify for the Version section.

This section describes creating a Version 400 Settings worksheet. For a description of each section in the Settings sheet, see ["Version 400 Settings sheets" on page 409](#).

If you want to create a different version, see ["Version 300 Settings sheets" on page 417](#), ["Version 200 Settings sheets" on page 426](#) or ["Version 100 Settings sheets" on page 430](#) for the sections that are valid in Version 300, Version 200, and Version 100 Settings sheets.

► **Copy a Settings worksheet from the sample importable file into the Microsoft Excel file**

1. In Microsoft Excel, open both the file you are adding the Settings sheet to and the **SampleImportableSpreadsheet.xls** file.
2. Ensure the **SampleImportableSpreadsheet.xls** file is active.
3. Right-click the Settings worksheet tab, and then click **Move or Copy**.
4. In the **Move or Copy** dialog box, in the **Workbook** list, click the file you exported.
5. In the **Before sheet** list, click the where you want to insert the Settings worksheet.
6. Select the **Create a copy** check box, and then click **OK**.

► **Create a Settings worksheet**

1. Click the **Insert Worksheet** worksheet tab.
2. Right-click the new worksheet tab, and then click **Rename**.
3. Type a name that begins with '**Settings**', and then press **Enter**.
4. Add the Settings sections. For more information, see "[Settings worksheet syntax](#)" on page 406.

► **Configure the Settings worksheet**

1. In the **SheetType** section, specify whether the Settings worksheet processes **Crosstab** or **Tabular** worksheets.
2. If you specified **Crosstab** in step 1, in column B, specify whether the data is imported into the **ScheduledReceipt** or **IndependentDemand** table.
3. In the **SheetsToProcess** section, specify the Data worksheet this Settings worksheet processes.
4. If you specified **Tabular** in step 1, in column B, specify the table the worksheet imports data into.
5. If you want to enable the worksheet to delete records before importing, in column C of the **SheetsToProcess** section, type the expression that defines the records that can be deleted.
If you specified **Tabular** in step 1, go to step 14.
6. In the **OrderPrefix** section, specify the string that will be used in the order number for each imported record.
7. In the **OptionalFlags** section, if you want the header records to be generated, in column A, type '**CreateHeaderRecord**'.
8. In the **ExcelColumns** section, in column A, specify the name assigned to each column in the Data worksheet.
9. If you included the **OptionalFlags** section, in the **AdditionalHeaderData** section, do the following:
 - In column A, type '**Data**', and then in the next row, specify the worksheet these header records are defined for.
 - In column B, in the same row as the **Data** section is defined, specify the field the additional data is defined for.
 - Specify the value inserted into the field for each worksheet you specified.
 - In column A, in the row after the worksheets are defined, type '**/Data**'.Repeat this step for each value you want to specify for the header records.
10. In the **AdditionalData** section, do the following:
 - In column A type '**Data**', and then in the next row, specify the worksheet these records are defined for.
 - In column B, in the same row as the **Data** section is defined, specify the field the additional data is defined for.

- Specify the value inserted into the field for each worksheet you specified.
- In column A, in the row after the worksheets are defined, type **'/Data'**.

Repeat this step for each value you want to specify for the records.

11. In the **MapSites** section, in column A specify the sites that appear in the Data worksheets, and in column B specify the RapidResponse sites they map to.
12. In the **MapTypes** section, in column A specify the order types that appear in the Data worksheets and in column B specify the RapidResponse types they map to.
13. In column C of the **MapTypes** section, specify the field you want to provide additional customization to, and then specify the value inserted into that field for each order type.
Repeat this step for each additional field you want to specify values for.
14. In the **Version** section, type **400**.

Variables and named ranges

In Version 300 and 400 Settings sheets, you can specify values in cells by creating expressions that refer to named ranges in other worksheets. The values in these named ranges are inserted into the expression, as shown in the following illustration.

The illustration consists of two parts. The top part shows a worksheet named 'SelectedCustomer' with columns A through E. Row 2, column A contains the text 'Cust1'. A callout bubble points to cell A2, stating 'Cell A2 is named "/>

The bottom part shows a formula bar for cell B39 with the formula `=SelectedCustomer`. Below the formula bar, a worksheet is shown with columns A and B. Row 39, column B contains the text 'Cust1'. A callout bubble points to cell B39, stating 'The "/>

You can also use named ranges in complex expressions, such as the one shown in ["SheetsToProcess" on page 419](#).

If you have exported data from a RapidResponse workbook to Microsoft Excel using the importable format, a worksheet named 'Settings_Variables' is automatically created in the Microsoft Excel file. This worksheet contains named ranges that define the workbook controls and variables that were used to define the data that was exported. These variables allow you to customize the data in the Settings sheet to match the data you exported.

Version 400 Settings sheets

Version 400 Settings sheets and Version 300 sheets are similar, except Version 400 sheets require table and field names to be namespace qualified. For example, using a Version 300 Settings sheet to import crosstab data into the ScheduledReceipt table, the SheetsToProcess section would specify ScheduledReceipt in column B. However, for a Version 400 Settings sheet, the SheetsToProcess section would specify Mfg::ScheduledReceipt in column B, to indicate the data is for the ScheduledReceipt table in the Mfg namespace.

To ensure data is read correctly, you must specify the namespace for each field used in the Settings sheet. If you do not specify the namespace for a field, the values imported for that field are blank. When you export data from a workbook that specifies how data is imported into scenarios, the namespaces for fields are included automatically. However, any import files you receive from external sources or that were created in RapidResponse 2015.3 (or earlier) might not have the namespaces. In this case, you must modify the import file to ensure all namespaces are specified.

For more information about data sections and settings valid in Version 300 Settings sheets, see ["Version 300 Settings sheets" on page 417](#).

If you have upgraded to RapidResponse 11.0 (or later), it is recommended you update all your Settings sheets to Version 400, to ensure the data is imported to the correct tables and fields in the correct namespaces.

The following sections are valid in a Version 400 Settings sheet. You can create these sections in any order. Each section with 'Yes' in the Mandatory column must be included to import data from the Microsoft Excel file.

Section name	Description	Mandatory?
SheetType	Specifies the type of worksheet (tabular or crosstab) this Settings sheet processes. Specifies the table crosstab worksheets provide data for.	Yes
SheetsToProcess	Specifies the worksheet or worksheets this Settings sheet processes. Specifies the table tabular worksheets provide data for. Specifies the set of records that are deleted before importing the data into RapidResponse.	Yes
OrderPrefix	Specifies the order number assigned to the records imported using this Settings sheet.	No
OptionalFlags	Specifies optional configuration settings. Allows you to specify whether header records are created as part of the import process.	No

Section name	Description	Mandatory?
ExcelColumns	Specifies the names of columns in the Data worksheets processed by this Settings sheet. These names can be used to configure the data values in other sections.	No
AdditionalHeaderData	Specifies values to be inserted into the header records created during the import process. This section can contain any number of data values.	No
AdditionalData	Specifies values to be inserted into the records created during the import process. This section can contain any number of data values.	No
MapSites	Specifies how the site values in the Data worksheets relate to the site values in RapidResponse.	Yes
MapTypes	Specifies how the type values in the Data worksheets relate to the order type values in RapidResponse. Specifies additional data values that can be inserted into the records, depending on the order type.	Yes
Version	Specifies how the Settings sheet is processed during the import process, and the sections that are valid.	Yes

SheetType

The SheetType section specifies the type of the Settings worksheet, which determines the configuration settings that can be applied to worksheets in the Microsoft Excel file. Settings worksheets can be one of the following types:

- **Crosstab**—Contains settings to be applied to worksheets with pivoted data, with records summarized by date.
- **Tabular**—Contains settings to be applied to worksheets with data in columns, with one record per row.

If the Settings sheet type is **Crosstab**, the RapidResponse namespace and table—either **ScheduledReceipt** or **IndependentDemand**—that the worksheets specified in the SheetsToProcess section provide data for must be specified in column B. Each Settings sheet can specify data values for only one table. If the Excel file contains worksheets with data for multiple tables, you must create a separate Settings sheet for each table.

A	B
SheetType	
Crosstab	Mfg::ScheduledReceipt
/SheetType	

In this example, **Crosstab** worksheets specified by this Settings sheet supply data for the **Mfg::ScheduledReceipt** table.

Tabular worksheets require a Settings sheet only if the Microsoft Excel file contains crosstab worksheets or if a template is used to arrange the tabular data in worksheets. Only the SheetType, SheetsToProcess, and Version sections of a **Tabular** Settings sheet are processed during the data import. All tabular

worksheets must contain columns that match the RapidResponse field names, as described in ["Importing data in tabular worksheet format" on page 400](#).

SheetsToProcess

The SheetsToProcess section specifies the Microsoft Excel worksheets that are to be read when RapidResponse loads data. Worksheets specified in this section require the settings in the Settings sheet.

You can specify multiple worksheets in this section. For tabular worksheets, you can use one Settings sheet for all of the tabular worksheet. For crosstab worksheets, each worksheet must have the same columns, and you must define the settings required for each worksheet. It is recommended you use one Settings worksheet for each crosstab worksheet.

In column B of this section, you can specify the table the worksheet supplies data for. This value is required only for tabular worksheets.

In column C of this section, you can specify a deletion scope for the worksheet. This is a RapidResponse query expression that defines the records that will be deleted from the scenario when the data is updated. You can use this to ensure the records defined in the Data worksheet are always the most current. If you do not define a deletion scope, records are not deleted.

A	B	C
SheetsToProcess		
Sheet1		(Mfg::Part[PUBLIC s'All Parts'] and (Mfg::Part.Site like 'Americomp' and Mfg::Part.Name in('MEM001', 'MEM003','MS001')) AND Mfg::Part.Site[PUBLIC Site 'All Sites']) and (DueDate < d'20080901')
/SheetsToProcess		

In this example, the Sheet1 worksheet is processed using the settings in the Settings sheet. The deletion scope for this worksheet includes all the records for the part and site combination in the date range specified.

When you create the deletion scope, you can use any combination of variables, column values, and text. You can also include values from other worksheets by referring to a named range, as shown in the following illustration.

 =DeletionScope_Sheet1

For more information about using named ranges in expressions, see ["Create a Settings sheet for importing data" on page 406](#).

This example uses a named range from the Settings_Variables worksheet, which includes ranges named DeletionScope and WhereClause. These ranges can be used to delete older records in the Data worksheet.

In some cases, the DeletionScope and WhereClause named ranges might delete more records than intended. For example, if the DeletionScope refers to the All Sites site filter, if you have access to three sites and export data for those three sites but set the DeletionScope to use All Sites. If another user with access to eight sites imports that data, the All Sites filter in the DeletionScope deletes the

records from all eight of that user's sites, but imports data for only the three sites available to them. If you use the `DeletionScope` or `WhereClause` to delete records, you should export data using either a specific site or a site filter with a limited set of sites defined in it. For more information about site filters, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

OptionalFlags

The `OptionalFlags` configuration setting specifies settings that are not mandatory. The `CreateHeaderRecord` setting can be specified in this section, which is shown in the following illustration.

A
OptionalFlags
<code>CreateHeaderRecord</code>
<code>/OptionalFlags</code>

The `CreateHeaderRecord` setting specifies that header records are created as part of the import process. You must use this setting if header records are not automatically created. With this flag specified, you can include an `AdditionalHeaderData` section to specify additional information for the header records.

The data used to create the header records is taken from the `SheetType` and `AdditionalHeaderData` sections. The table specified in the `SheetType` section determines whether a demand order or supply order is created. The data specified in the `AdditionalHeaderData` section determines values for other fields in the new header record.

ExcelColumns

The `ExcelColumns` section defines the columns in the Data worksheet this Settings sheet processes. The columns must be listed in the order they appear in the Data worksheet. You can use these columns in other settings sections.

In this section, a `Site` column must be first, a `Part` column must be second, and an `Order Type` column must be last. The columns between the `Part` and `Type` columns are the custom columns you add to the Data worksheet.

An example of an `ExcelColumns` section is shown in the following illustration.

A
ExcelColumns
<code>SiteName</code>
<code>PartName</code>
<code>SupplierId</code>
<code>OrderType</code>
<code>/ExcelColumns</code>

In this example, the Data worksheet contains columns named SiteName, PartName, SupplierId, and OrderType. These columns match the order of columns required for the Data worksheet, because SiteName is a Site column, PartName is a Part column, and OrderType is a Type column.

These columns can be used in other settings sections by putting the column name in angle brackets (< >). For example, the SupplierId column can be included in another section by including '<SupplierId>' in that section.

AdditionalHeaderData

If your Settings sheet includes the OptionalFlags section, the AdditionalHeaderData configuration setting can be included. The data specified in this section is used in creating the header records for the **IndependentDemand** or **ScheduledReceipt** records imported from the data worksheets.

A	B
AdditionalHeaderData	
Data	Id
<all sheets>	_<SupplierId>_<PartName>
/Data	
Data	Mfg::Supplier.Id
<all sheets>	<SupplierId>
/Data	
Data	Mfg::Pool.Value
<all sheets>	Unpooled
/Data	
/AdditionalHeaderData	

In this example, orders in all worksheets processed by this Settings sheet have an **Order.Pool.Value** value of **Unpooled**, an **Order.Id** value equal to that order's values in the **SupplierId** and **PartName** columns, and an Order.Supplier.Id value equal to that order's value in the **SupplierId** column. When the data is imported, these fields are populated with the specified values.

The values added to the **Order.Supplier.Id** fields in this example might insert a new record in the **Supplier** table. If the **Supplier** table allows records to be automatically created, the other key values for the record are inserted automatically using the table's specified default values. If the **Supplier** table does not allow records to be automatically created, you must specify **Data** sections for each of the table's key fields. For complete information about key fields for tables, see the [RapidResponse Analytic and Data Model Guide](#).

The information in column A between the **Data** and **/Data** syntax specifies the worksheets to add information to. The **<all sheets>** setting refers to all data worksheets, if the Settings sheet processes multiple data worksheets, but can be overridden with a specific data worksheet name. If any data worksheet is not defined in a **Data** section, either explicitly or using the **<all sheets>** syntax, that worksheet has a blank added as a value for the field.

The fields you specify in this section should be namespace-qualified to ensure the data is loaded into the correct locations. However, if you are overriding the order number in the **Id** field, you must specify the field without the namespace. Otherwise a column with the namespace qualification is added to the import data, in addition to the column without the namespace. In this case, because the columns are both considered valid, the column used to identify the records cannot be predicted, which can produce unexpected results.

You can include multiple sets of configuration settings as long as each is enclosed in the **Data** and **/Data** syntax.

AdditionalData

The AdditionalData configuration setting specifies information to add to the records imported into RapidResponse when loading the Microsoft Excel data. Data can be added to all worksheets that data is imported from, or you can specify which worksheets data is added to. This section can be used to add data that is required to import records into RapidResponse, but is not included in the Excel crosstab worksheets, or to override values from the crosstab worksheet.

The data values specified in this section might insert records into other tables. Depending on the settings specified for the tables, the data values required to insert those records can be automatically created.

A	B
AdditionalData	
Data	Mfg::Routing.Id
<all sheets>	ACKIT-01
/Data	
Data	OrderPriority
<all sheets>	Med
/Data	
Data	SavedPriority
<all sheets>	Med
/Data	
/AdditionalData	

In this example, the **Routing** value **ACKIT-01** is added to the all orders imported from the Data worksheet. The **OrderPriority** and **SavedPriority** values for each order in all worksheets are set to **Med**.

The information in column A between the **Data** and **/Data** syntax specifies the worksheets to add information to. The **<all sheets>** setting refers to all data worksheets, if the Settings sheet processes multiple data worksheets, but can be overridden with a specific data worksheet name. If any data worksheet is not defined in a Data section, either explicitly or using the **<all sheets>** syntax, that worksheet has a blank added as a value for the field.

The fields you specify in this section should be namespace-qualified to ensure the data is loaded into the correct locations. However, if you are overriding the order number in the **Order.Id** field or the line

number in the **Line** field, you must specify the field without the namespace. Otherwise a column with the namespace qualification is added to the import data, in addition to the column without the namespace. In this case, because the columns are both considered valid, the column used to identify the records cannot be predicted, which can produce unexpected results.

For other columns included in the crosstab data, if you add a segment to the AdditionalData section with the same names, an additional column is added to the import data, which can also produce unexpected results because the column used to provide the data to import cannot be predicted. You should ensure the AdditionalData section contains only fields that are not provided by the crosstab, or that override the **Order.Id** or **Line** values.

For reference fields, you can also include the key field names in the reference. For example, **OrderPriority.Value** or **Part.Type.Value**. This ensures the value is mapped correctly, and avoids ambiguity if the referenced table has multiple key fields.

You can include multiple sets of configuration settings as long as each is enclosed in the **Data** and **/Data** syntax.

MapSites

The MapSites configuration setting specifies how site or location names in the data worksheets are mapped to the RapidResponse database. At least one site must be defined in this section.

The following example shows a MapSites section.

A	B
MapSites	Site
AmeriComp	AmeriComp
/MapSites	

Using this example, the Americomp site (Column A) in the data are mapped to the Americomp site (Column B) in the RapidResponse database.

MapTypes

The MapTypes configuration setting specifies how data category names in the data worksheets are mapped to the RapidResponse database. The data category names in Column A are mapped to the category names in Column B.

The following example shows a MapTypes section.

A	B	C
MapTypes	Type	Mfg::Routing.Id
Ship Plan	Blanket	<default>
TCO	PO	CITYCRUISER
Net Reqts	WO	<default>
/MapTypes		

Using this example, the data categories in Column A (Ship Plan, TCO, and Net Reqts) are used as row labels in the Data worksheets. For an example, see ["Importing data in crosstab worksheet format" on page 402](#). The data categories in Column B (Blanket, PO, and WO) correspond to the values in Column A and are the type values used in the control table records when imported into the RapidResponse database.

Column B must include the heading **Type** as shown in the example.

As discussed in the AdditionalData section, you can use a Settings worksheet to add data to the records imported from the Microsoft Excel data. You can also override the additional data you are adding using the MapTypes configuration setting. To add overrides, you need to add information to the right (Column C, D, and so on) of the MapTypes configuration settings.

Data specified in the MapTypes section insert the value only for one Type value. You can define different values for each Type. If you specify values for a column in both the AdditionalData or AdditionalHeaderData and MapTypes sections, the value in the MapTypes section overrides the AdditionalData or AdditionalHeaderData section.

As with the AdditionalData section, the data values specified in the MapTypes section might insert records into other tables. Depending on the settings specified for the tables, the data values required to insert those records can be automatically created.

The following example shows a MapTypes overrides section (columns C, D, and so on).

B	C	D	F
Type	Mfg::Routing.Id	Mfg::Supplier.Id	Id
Blanket	<default>	CARTONS	<default>
PO	CITYCRUISER	<default>	My new Order Id
WO	<default>	<default>	<default>

The **Routing.Id** heading corresponds to the AdditionalData label and the **Supplier.Id** and **Id** headings correspond to the AdditionalHeaderData labels described in the previous examples. For the PO **Type** value, the **Routing.Id** value is **Citycruiser**, the **Supplier.Id** value is a the default defined in the AdditionalHeaderData section, and the **Order.Id** value is set to **My new Order Id**. For the Blanket **Type** value, the **Routing.Id** value is the default defined in the AdditionalData section, and the **Supplier.Id** value is set to **Cartons**. For the WO **Type** value, all values are set to the defaults from the AdditionalData and AdditionalHeaderData sections.

For columns that are not included in the AdditionalData or AdditionalHeaderData sections, the **<default>** setting inserts the default value for that table.

Version

The Version configuration setting is used by your RapidResponse system and should never be modified. If this section is missing, RapidResponse cannot load data from the Microsoft Excel file.

A
Version
400
/Version

In this example, the Settings worksheet is Version 400, which is compatible with RapidResponse 11.0 and later.

Version 300 Settings sheets

Version 300 Settings sheets are compatible with RapidResponse 9.4 and later. These Settings sheets allow you to customize many aspects of the data being imported. You can use values from the Data worksheets to map values into RapidResponse, or use variables to define values for a specific customer or supplier.

If you are using a Version 300 Settings sheet, the Data worksheets can contain columns in addition to the Site, Part, and Type columns that are required. For example, you can include supplier or customer information in the Data worksheets.

Version 300 Settings sheets can also use the following variables to customize the data values inserted into the data being imported. These variables are not shown in the Settings_Variables worksheet.

Variable	Description
<default>	The value for a field specified in the AdditionalData or AdditionalHeaderData sections. This is typically used in the MapTypes section to indicate the value is not overridden.
<BucketDate>	The date associated with the data value being processed.
<OrderPrefix>	The value specified in the OrderPrefix section.
<SheetName>	The name of the Data worksheet.

The following sections are valid in a Version 300 Settings sheet. You can create these sections in any order. Each section with 'Yes' in the Mandatory column must be included to import data from the Microsoft Excel file.

Section name	Description	Mandatory?
SheetType	Specifies the type of worksheet (tabular or crosstab) this Settings sheet processes. Specifies the table crosstab worksheets provide data for.	Yes
SheetsToProcess	Specifies the worksheet or worksheets this Settings sheet processes. Specifies the table tabular worksheets provide data for. Specifies the set of records that are deleted before importing the data into RapidResponse.	Yes
OrderPrefix	Specifies the order number assigned to the records imported using this Settings sheet.	No
OptionalFlags	Specifies optional configuration settings. Allows you to specify whether header records are created as part of the import process.	No
ExcelColumns	Specifies the names of columns in the Data worksheets processed by this Settings sheet. These names can be used to configure the data values in other sections.	Yes
AdditionalHeaderData	Specifies values to be inserted into the header records created during the import process. This section can contain any number of data values.	No
AdditionalData	Specifies values to be inserted into the records created during the import process. This section can contain any number of data values.	Yes
MapSites	Specifies how the site values in the Data worksheets relate to the site values in RapidResponse.	Yes
MapTypes	Specifies how the type values in the Data worksheets relate to the order type values in RapidResponse. Specifies additional data values that can be inserted into the records, depending on the order type.	Yes
Version	Specifies how the Settings sheet is processed during the import process, and the sections that are valid.	Yes

SheetType

The SheetType section specifies the type of the Settings worksheet, which determines the configuration settings that can be applied to worksheets in the Microsoft Excel file. Settings worksheets can be one of the following types:

- **Crosstab**—Contains settings to be applied to worksheets with pivoted data, with records summarized by date.
- **Tabular**—Contains settings to be applied to worksheets with data in columns, with one record per row.

If the Settings sheet type is **Crosstab**, the RapidResponse table—either **ScheduledReceipt** or **IndependentDemand**—that the worksheets specified in the SheetsToProcess section provide data for must be specified in column B. Each Settings sheet can specify data values for only one table. If the Excel file contains worksheets with data for multiple tables, you must create a separate Settings sheet for each table.

A	B
SheetType	
Crosstab	ScheduledReceipt
/SheetType	

In this example, **Crosstab** worksheets specified by this Settings sheet supply data for the **ScheduledReceipt** table.

Tabular worksheets require a Settings sheet only if the Microsoft Excel file contains crosstab worksheets or if a template is used to arrange the tabular data in worksheets. Only the SheetType, SheetsToProcess, and Version sections of a **Tabular** Settings sheet are processed during the data import. All tabular worksheets must contain columns that match the RapidResponse field names, as described in ["Importing data in tabular worksheet format" on page 400](#).

SheetsToProcess

The SheetsToProcess section specifies the Microsoft Excel worksheets that are to be read when RapidResponse loads data. Worksheets specified in this section require the settings in the Settings sheet.

You can specify multiple worksheets in this section. For tabular worksheets, you can use one Settings sheet for all of the tabular worksheet. For crosstab worksheets, each worksheet must have the same columns, and you must define the settings required for each worksheet. It is recommended you use one Settings worksheet for each crosstab worksheet.

In column B of this section, you can specify the table the worksheet supplies data for. This value is optional for crosstab worksheets, but is required for tabular worksheets. If the value is blank for a crosstab worksheet, the table specified in the SheetType section is used. If a table is specified in this section and the table is different from the one specified in the SheetType section, importing data from this file results in an error.

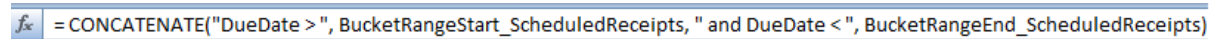
In column C of this section, you can specify a deletion scope for the worksheet. This is a RapidResponse query expression that defines the records that will be deleted from the scenario when the data is updated. You can use this to ensure the records defined in the Data worksheet are always the most current. If you do not define a deletion scope, records are not deleted.

A	B	C
SheetsToProcess		
Sheet_ExtraFields	ScheduledReceipt	DueDate > d'1/15/2009' and DueDate < d'2/26/2009'
/SheetsToProcess		

In this example, the Sheet_ExtraFields worksheet is processed using the settings in the Settings sheet. The records in this worksheet are imported into the ScheduledReceipt table. The deletion scope for this worksheet includes all the records in the date range specified.

When you create the deletion scope, you can use any combination of variables, column values, and text. In this example, the RapidResponse date values d'1/15/2009' and d'2/26/2009' are variables,

which are inserted into this expression by referring to a named range in another worksheet, as shown in the following illustration.



= CONCATENATE("DueDate > ", BucketRangeStart_ScheduledReceipts, " and DueDate < ", BucketRangeEnd_ScheduledReceipts)

In this example, `BucketRangeStart_ScheduledReceipts` and `BucketRangeEnd_ScheduledReceipts` are named ranges in the `Settings_Variables` worksheet. The query expression is created by concatenating the named ranges and the comparisons that will be made when the data is imported into RapidResponse. For more information about using named ranges in expressions, see ["Create a Settings sheet for importing data" on page 406](#).

The `Settings_Variables` worksheet also includes ranges named `DeletionScope` and `WhereClause`, which can be used to delete all records in the `Data` worksheet. The `DeletionScope` named range cannot be used to delete records in crosstab worksheets, worksheets with grouped data, or worksheets that have searches applied. For these worksheets, you must use the `WhereClause` named range instead. You can use these ranges instead of creating a deletion scope if you do not want to leave any of the older records in RapidResponse.

In some cases, the `DeletionScope` and `WhereClause` named ranges might delete more records than intended. For example, if the `DeletionScope` refers to the `All Sites` site filter, if you have access to three sites and export data for those three sites but set the `DeletionScope` to use `All Sites`. If another user with access to eight sites imports that data, the `All Sites` filter in the `DeletionScope` deletes the records from all eight of that user's sites, but imports data for only the three sites available to them. If you use the `DeletionScope` or `WhereClause` to delete records, you should export data using either a specific site or a site filter with a limited set of sites defined in it. For more information about site filters, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

OrderPrefix

The `OrderPrefix` configuration setting specifies the beginning of the **Order.Id** value for every order created by the crosstab worksheet. The full **Order.Id** value is the `OrderPrefix` setting and the worksheet name, separated by a hyphen. For example, `OrderPrefix-SheetName`.

The following example shows an `OrderPrefix` section.

A
OrderPrefix
SupA
/OrderPrefix

In this example, every order created when importing the data is given an **Order.Id** value that begins with **SupA**. In this example, the orders created from `Sheet_ExtraFields` will have **SupA-Sheet_ExtraFields** as their ID.

Each order record also has a **Line** value, which is determined using the part and date values in the crosstab worksheet, in the format `Date_Part`. In this example, an order created from worksheet `Sheet_ExtraFields` for the `Racer` part due on June 12, 2008 will be order **SupA-Sheet_ExtraFields**, line

20080612_Racer. The **Line** value can be overridden by specifying a value in the AdditionalData or MapTypes sections.

If the Settings sheet does not include this section, the **Order.Id** values created during the import use the user ID of the user importing the data and the name of the Microsoft Excel file, separated by a hyphen. For example, UserId-FileName. The **Order.Id** value can be overridden by specifying a value in the AdditionalData or MapTypes sections.

OptionalFlags

The OptionalFlags configuration setting specifies settings that are not mandatory. In RapidResponse 9.4, only the **CreateHeaderRecord** setting can be specified in this section, which is shown in the following illustration.

A
OptionalFlags
CreateHeaderRecord
/OptionalFlags

The **CreateHeaderRecord** setting specifies that header records are created as part of the import process. You must use this setting if header records are not automatically created. With this flag specified, you can include an AdditionalHeaderData section to specify additional information for the header records.

The data used to create the header records is taken from the SheetType, OrderPrefix, and AdditionalHeaderData sections. The table specified in the SheetType section determines whether a demand order or supply order is created. The value specified in the OrderPrefix section determines the order ID assigned to the new record. The data specified in the AdditionalHeaderData section determines values for other fields in the new header record.

ExcelColumns

The ExcelColumns section defines the columns in the Data worksheet this Settings sheet processes. The columns must be listed in the order they appear in the Data worksheet. You can use these columns in other settings sections.

In this section, a Site column must be first, a Part column must be second, and an Order Type column must be last. The columns between the Part and Type columns are the custom columns you add to the Data worksheet.

An example of an ExcelColumns section is shown in the following illustration.

A
ExcelColumns
Plant
SKU
Warehouse
MyCustomField
OrderType
/ExcelColumns

In this example, the Data worksheet contains columns named Plant, SKU, Warehouse, MyCustomField, and OrderType. These columns match the order of columns required for the Data worksheet, because Plant is a Site column, SKU is a Part column, and OrderType is a Type column.

These columns can be used in other settings sections by putting the column name in angle brackets (<>). For example, the Plant column can be included in another section by including '<Plant>' in that section.

AdditionalHeaderData

If your Settings sheet includes the OptionalFlags section, the AdditionalHeaderData configuration setting can be included. The data specified in this section is used in creating the header records for the **IndependentDemand** or **ScheduledReceipt** records imported from the data worksheets.

A	B
AdditionalHeaderData	
Data	Supplier
Sheet_ExtraFields	SupCorpA-2
/Data	
Data	Pool.Value
<all sheets>	Unpooled
/Data	
Data	Id
<all sheets>	<MyCustomField>
/Data	
/AdditionalHeaderData	

In this example, each order in the Sheet_ExtraFields worksheet has an **Order.Supplier.Id** value of **SupCorp-A**. Orders in all worksheets processed by this Settings sheet have an **Order.Pool.Value** value of

Unpooled and an **Order.Id** value equal to that order's value in the **MyCustomField** column. When the data is imported, these fields are populated with the specified values.

The values added to the **Order.Supplier.Id** fields in this example might insert a new record in the **Supplier** table. If the **Supplier** table allows records to be automatically created, the other key values for the record are inserted automatically using the table's specified default values. If the **Supplier** table does not allow records to be automatically created, you must specify **Data** sections for each of the table's key fields. For complete information about key fields for tables, see the RapidResponse Analytic and Data Model Guide.

The information in column A between the **Data** and **/Data** syntax specifies the worksheets to add information to. The **<all sheets>** setting refers to all data worksheets, if the Settings sheet processes multiple data worksheets, but can be overridden with a specific data worksheet name. If any data worksheet is not defined in a **Data** section, either explicitly or using the **<all sheets>** syntax, that worksheet has a blank added as a value for the field.

You can include multiple sets of configuration settings as long as each is enclosed in the **Data** and **/Data** syntax.

AdditionalData

The AdditionalData configuration setting specifies information to add to the records imported into RapidResponse when loading the Microsoft Excel data. Data can be added to all worksheets that data is imported from, or you can specify which worksheets data is added to. This section can be used to add data that is required to import records into RapidResponse, but is not included in the Excel crosstab worksheets.

The data values specified in this section might insert records into other tables. Depending on the settings specified for the tables, the data values required to insert those records can be automatically created.

A	B
AdditionalData	
Data	Routing
<all sheets>	EastAsia
/Data	
Data	Line
Sheet_ExtraFields	<BucketDate><SKU>
/Data	
/AdditionalData	

In this example, the **Routing** value **EastAsia** is added to the all orders imported from the Data worksheet. The **Line** value for each order in the Sheet_ExtraFields worksheet is constructed by concatenating the bucket date (taken from the Data worksheet) and the value in the SKU column.

The information in column A between the **Data** and **/Data** syntax specifies the worksheets to add information to. The **<all sheets>** setting refers to all data worksheets, if the Settings sheet processes multiple data worksheets, but can be overridden with a specific data worksheet name. If any data

worksheet is not defined in a Data section, either explicitly or using the **<all sheets>** syntax, that worksheet has a blank added as a value for the field.

You can include multiple sets of configuration settings as long as each is enclosed in the **Data** and **/Data** syntax.

MapSites

The MapSites configuration setting specifies how site or location names in the data worksheets are mapped to the RapidResponse database. At least one site must be defined in this section.

The following example shows a MapSites section.

A	B
MapSites	Site
Boston	Ottawa
Detroit	Detroit
/MapSites	

Using this example, the Boston and Detroit sites (Column A) in the data are mapped to the Ottawa and Detroit sites (Column B) in the RapidResponse database.

MapTypes

The MapTypes configuration setting specifies how data category names in the data worksheets are mapped to the RapidResponse database. The data category names in Column A are mapped to the category names in Column B.

The following example shows a MapTypes section.

A	B	C	E	F	G
MapTypes	Type	Routing	Supplier	Order.Id	Line
Ship Plan	Commitments	<default>	Y	<default>	<Warehouse><BucketDate>
TCO	SpecialCommitments	SouthAsia	asa	Import_Cust1_<Plant>	<default>
Net Reqts	NetRequirements	<default>	<Warehouse>Bla	<OrderPrefix><SheetName>	<default>
/MapTypes					

Using this example, the data categories in Column A (Ship Plan, TCO, and Net Reqts) are used as row labels in the Data worksheets. For an example, see ["Importing data in crosstab worksheet format" on page 402](#). The data categories in Column B (Commitments, SpecialCommitments, and NetRequirements) correspond to the values in Column A and are the type values used in the control table records when imported into the RapidResponse database.

Column B must include the heading **Type** as shown in the example.

As discussed in the AdditionalData section, you can use a Settings worksheet to add data to the records imported from the Microsoft Excel data. You can also override the additional data you are adding using the MapTypes configuration setting. To add overrides, you need to add information to the right (Column C, D, and so on) of the Map Types configuration settings.

Data specified in the MapTypes section insert the value only for one Type value. You can define different values for each Type. If you specify values for a column in both the AdditionalData or AdditionalHeaderData and MapTypes sections, the value in the MapTypes section overrides the AdditionalData or AdditionalHeaderData section.

As with the AdditionalData section, the data values specified in the MapTypes section might insert records into other tables. Depending on the settings specified for the tables, the data values required to insert those records can be automatically created.

The following example shows a MapTypes overrides section (columns C, D, and so on).

A	B	C	D
MapTypes	Type	Routing.Id	Order.Supplier.Id
Ship Plan	Blanket	<default>	CARTONS
TCO	PO	CITYCRUISER	<default>
Net Reqts	WO	<default>	<default>
/MapTypes			

The **Routing** and **Line** headings correspond to the AdditionalData labels described in the previous examples. For the SpecialCommitments **Type** value, the **Routing** value is **SouthAsia** and the **Line** value is a the default defined in the AdditionalData section. For the Commitments **Type** value, the **Routing** value is the default defined in the AdditionalData section, and the **Line** value is a combination of the value in the **Warehouse** column and the bucket date.

For columns that are not included in the AdditionalData or AdditionalHeaderData sections, the **<default>** setting inserts the default value for that table.

Version

The Version configuration setting is used by your RapidResponse system and should never be modified. If this section is missing, RapidResponse cannot load data from the Microsoft Excel file.

A
Version
300
/Version

In this example, the Settings worksheet is Version 300, which is compatible with RapidResponse 9.4 and later.

Version 200 Settings sheets

Version 200 Settings sheets are compatible with RapidResponse 9.2 and later.

This section discusses the sections that can be included in a Version 200 Settings sheet.

SheetType

The SheetType section specifies the type of the Settings worksheet, which determines the configuration settings that can be applied to worksheets in the Excel file. Settings worksheets can be one of the following types:

- **Crosstab**—Contains settings to be applied to worksheets with pivoted data, with records typically summarized by date.
- **Tabular**—Contains settings to be applied to worksheets with data in columns, with one record per row.

If the Settings sheet type is **Crosstab**, the RapidResponse table—either **ScheduledReceipt** or **IndependentDemand**—that the worksheets specified in the SheetsToProcess section provide data for must be specified in column B. Each Settings sheet can specify only one table. If the Excel file contains worksheets with data for multiple tables, each table must be specified in a separate Settings sheet.

A	B
SheetType	
Crosstab	ScheduledReceipt
/SheetType	

In this example, **Crosstab** worksheets specified by this Settings sheet supply data for the **ScheduledReceipt** table.

Tabular worksheets require a Settings sheet only if the Microsoft Excel file contains crosstab worksheets. Only the SheetsToProcess section of a Tabular Settings sheet is processed during the data import. All tabular worksheets must contain columns that match the RapidResponse field names, as described in ["Importing data in tabular worksheet format" on page 400](#).

SheetsToProcess

The SheetsToProcess section specifies the Microsoft Excel worksheets that are to be read when RapidResponse loads data. Worksheets specified in this section require the settings in the Settings sheet.

A
SheetsToProcess
Sheet1
Sheet2
Sheet3
/SheetsToProcess

In this example, the **Sheet1**, **Sheet2**, and **Sheet3** worksheets are processed using the settings defined in the Settings sheet.

If every worksheet in the Excel file is to be processed, you can use the **<all sheets>** setting instead of specifying every worksheet.

AdditionalData

The AdditionalData configuration setting specifies information to add to the tab-delimited text files generated by your RapidResponse system when loading the Microsoft Excel data. Data can be added to all worksheets that data is imported from, or you can specify which worksheets data is added to. This section can be used to add data that is required to import records into RapidResponse, but is not included in the Excel crosstab worksheets.

The data values specified in this section might insert records into other tables. Depending on the settings specified for the tables, the data values required to insert those records can be automatically created. For more information, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

A	B
AdditionalData	
Data	Order.Supplier.Id
<all sheets>	ALLIED
Sheet1	BBEARING
/Data	
Data	Order.Pool.Value
<all sheets>	Unpooled
/Data	
Data	Routing.Id
<all sheets>	ACKIT-01
Sheet2	ACKIT-02
Sheet3	ACKIT-03
/Data	
/AdditionalData	

The information in column A between the **Data** and **/Data** syntax specifies the worksheets to add information to. The **<all sheets>** setting refers to all data worksheets but can be overridden with a specific data worksheet name. If the **<all sheets>** syntax is not used then any unspecified sheet has a blank added as a value.

You can include multiple sets of configuration settings as long as each is enclosed in the **Data** and **/Data** syntax.

In this example, **ALLIED** is added to the **Order.Supplier.Id** field for every line in the data file generated from every data worksheet in the Microsoft Excel workbook excluding the worksheet named **Sheet1**. Data generated from the **Sheet1** worksheet has **BBEARING** added to it.

The values added to the **Order.Supplier.Id** fields in this example might insert a new record in the **Supplier** table. If the **Supplier** table allows records to be automatically created, the other key values for the record are inserted automatically using the table's specified default values. If the **Supplier** table does not allow records to be automatically created, you must specify **Data** sections for each of the table's key fields. For complete information about key fields for tables, see the [RapidResponse Analytic and Data Model Guide](#).

In the previous example, the field that the data is supplied for is added to Column B at the beginning of the **Data** section. In addition to specifying the RapidResponse field that the specified values are inserted into, this allows you to further override what is added to the generated data file. For more information, see "MapTypes" on page 429.

OrderPrefix

The OrderPrefix configuration setting specifies the beginning of the **Order.Id** value for every order created by the crosstab worksheet. The full **Order.Id** value is the OrderPrefix setting and the worksheet name, separated by a hyphen. For example, OrderPrefix-SheetName.

The following example shows an OrderPrefix section.

A
OrderPrefix
SupA
/OrderPrefix

In this example, every order created when importing the data is given an **Order.Id** value that begins with **SupA**. In this example, the orders created from **Sheet1** will have **SupA-Sheet1** as their ID.

Each order record also has a **Line** value, which is determined using the part and date values in the crosstab worksheet, in the format Date_Part. In this example, an order created from worksheet **Sheet1** for the **Racer** part due on June 12, 2008 will be order **SupA-Sheet1**, line **20080612_Racer**.

If the Settings sheet does not include this section, the **Order.Id** values created during the import use the user ID of the user importing the data and the name of the Microsoft Excel file, separated by a hyphen. For example, UserId-FileName.

MapSites

The MapSites configuration setting specifies how site or location names in the data worksheets are mapped to the RapidResponse database. At least one site must be defined in this section.

The following example shows a MapSites section.

A	B
MapSites	Site
OTT	Ottawa
NY	New York
/MapSites	

Using this example, the OTT and NY sites (Column A) in the data are mapped to the Ottawa and New York sites (Column B) in the RapidResponse database.

MapTypes

The MapTypes configuration setting specifies how data category names in the data worksheets are mapped to the RapidResponse database. The data category names in Column A are mapped to the category names in Column B.

The following example shows a MapTypes section.

A	B	C	D
MapTypes	Type	Routing.Id	Order.Supplier.Id
Ship Plan	Blanket	<default>	CARTONS
TCO	PO	CITYCRUISER	<default>
Net Reqts	WO	<default>	<default>
/MapTypes			

Using this example, the data categories in Column A (**Ship Plan**, **TCO**, and **Net Reqts**) are used as row labels in the Data worksheets. For an example, see ["Importing data in crosstab worksheet format" on page 402](#). The data categories in Column B (**Blanket**, **PO**, and **WO**) correspond to the Column A values and are the type values used in the control table records when imported into the RapidResponse database.

Column B must include the heading **Type** as shown in the example.

As discussed in the AdditionalData section, you can use a Settings worksheet to add data when loading the Microsoft Excel data. You can also override the additional data you are adding using the MapTypes configuration setting. To add overrides, you need to add information to the right (Column C, D, and so on) of the Map Types configuration settings.

As with the AdditionalData section, the data values specified in the MapTypes section might insert records into other tables. Depending on the settings specified for the tables, the data values required to insert those records can be automatically created.

The **Routing.Id** and **Order.Supplier.Id** headings correspond to the AdditionalData labels noted in the previous examples. The column headings must be the same as those used in the other configuration settings. For example, the corresponding AdditionalData is as follows and includes the **Order.Supplier.Id** setting.

A	B
AdditionalData	
Data	Order.Supplier.Id
<all sheets>	ALLIED
Sheet1	BBEARING
/Data	

In this example, instead of **ALLIED** or **BBEARING** being added to every line in the data file, **CARTONS** is added to lines where **Type** is set to **Ship Plan (Blanket)**. The example also shows the override value of **<default>**. This setting indicates not to override with a different value.

Version

The Version configuration setting is used by your RapidResponse system and should never be modified. If this section is missing, RapidResponse cannot load data from the Microsoft Excel file.

A
Version
200
/Version

In this example, the Settings worksheet is Version 200, which is compatible with RapidResponse 9.2 and later.

Version 100 Settings sheets

The following sections were required for Version 100 Settings sheets, which are compatible with RapidResponse 8.2.3 through 9.1. The configurations in this section were used to create the structure required to import data from tab-delimited text files. Because RapidResponse 9.2 and later imports data directly from the Microsoft Excel file, these configurations are no longer required.

Microsoft Excel files with these Settings sheets are supported by RapidResponse 9.2 and later, but should be updated to Version 300 or 400, using the syntax described in ["Version 300 Settings sheets" on page 417](#) and ["Version 400 Settings sheets" on page 409](#). Microsoft Excel files cannot contain Settings sheets with different Version settings.

Version 100 settings sheets must include MapTypes, MapSites, and Version sections. These sections are identical to those for Version 200 sheets. For more information, see ["Version 200 Settings sheets" on page 426](#).

AdditionalHeaderData

The AdditionalHeaderData configuration setting specifies information to add to the tab-delimited text files generated by your RapidResponse system when loading the Microsoft Excel data.

During a data load, RapidResponse generates two tab-delimited text files from the Microsoft Excel workbook. One file contains data header information and the other contains the actual data. This setting adds more data to the header file.

Data can be added to all worksheets that generate header information, or you can specify which worksheets to add data to.

The following example shows an AdditionalHeaderData section.

A	B
AdditionalHeaderData	
Data	Supplier
<all sheets>	SupCorpA-1
Sheet1	SupCorpA-2
/Data	
/AdditionalHeaderData	

In this example, **SupCorpA-1** is added to every line in the data header file generated from every data worksheet in the Microsoft Excel workbook excluding the worksheet named **Sheet1**. Data header information generated from the **Sheet1** worksheet has **SupCorpA-2** added to it.

The information in column A between **Data** and **/Data** syntax specifies the worksheets to add information to. The **<all sheets>** setting refers to all data worksheets but can be overridden with a specific data worksheet name. If the **<all sheets>** syntax is not used then any unspecified sheet has a blank added as a value.

In the previous example, the **Supplier** label is added to Column B in Row 2. This is optional. By adding a label, you can further override what is added to the generated data header file. For more information, see ["MapTypes" on page 429](#).

You can include multiple sets of configuration settings as long as each is enclosed in the **Data** and **/Data** syntax as shown in the following illustration.

A	B
AdditionalHeaderData	
Data	Supplier
<all sheets>	SupCorpA-1
Sheet1	SupCorpA-2
/Data	
Data	Pool
<all sheets>	Unpooled
/Data	
/AdditionalHeaderData	

AdditionalDetailData

The AdditionalDetailData configuration setting specifies information to add to the tab-delimited text files generated by your RapidResponse system when loading the Microsoft Excel data.

During a data load, RapidResponse generates two tab-delimited text files from the Microsoft Excel workbook. One file contains data header information and the other contains the actual data. This setting adds information to the actual data file.

Data can be added to all worksheets that generate data or you can specify which worksheets to add data to.

The following example shows an AdditionalDetailData section.

A	B
AdditionalDetailData	
Data	Routing
<all sheets>	EastAsia
Sheet2	Mexico
Sheet3	USA
/Data	
/AdditionalDetailData	

In this example, **East Asia** is added to every line in the data file generated from every data worksheet in the Microsoft Excel workbook excluding the worksheets named Sheet2 and Sheet3. Data generated from the Sheet2 worksheet has **Mexico** added to it and data generated from the Sheet3 worksheet has **USA** added to it.

The information in column A between **Data** and **/Data** syntax specifies the worksheets to add information to. The **<all sheets>** setting refers to all data worksheets but can be overridden with a specific data worksheet name. If the **<all sheets>** syntax is not used then any unspecified sheet has a blank added as a value.

In the previous example, a **Routing** label is added to Column B in Row 2. This is optional. By adding a label, you can further override what is added to the generated data file. For more information, see ["MapTypes" on page 429](#).

You can include multiple sets of configuration settings as long as each is enclosed in the **Data** and **/Data** syntax.

OutputFileNaming

The OutputFileNaming configuration setting specifies the names of the tab-delimited text files that the RapidResponse generates when loading the Microsoft Excel data.

During a data load, RapidResponse creates two tab-delimited text files from the Microsoft Excel workbook. One file contains data header information and the other contains the actual data.

The data header file name is specified in Column B and the data file name is specified in Column C. Column D contains the name of the company publishing the data to the RapidResponse subscriber. This name is concatenated (using an underscore character) with the items in columns B and C to form the tab-delimited text file names. The following example shows an OutputFileNaming section.

	A	B	C	D
30	OutputFileNaming			
31		POHeader	PO	CMCorp1
32	/OutputFileNaming			

Using this example, the two data files created are **POHeader_CMCorp1.tab** and **PO_CMCorp1.tab**.

WorksheetsIgnore

The WorksheetsIgnore configuration setting specifies the Microsoft Excel worksheets that are to be ignored when RapidResponse loads data. Worksheets specified in this section can be used to store notes or other information not required by RapidResponse. Although this is an optional configuration setting it still must be present in a Settings worksheet.

In the following example, the RapidResponse data load ignores the Notes and Contacts worksheets during a data load.

```
WorksheetsIgnore
```

```
Notes
```

```
Contacts
```

```
/WorksheetsIgnore
```


Part 5: Communication and decision making

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- ["Simulating business changes" on page 461](#)
- ["Managing scenarios" on page 481](#)
- ["Create a scenario with a perspective applied" on page 499](#)
- ["Tracking responsibility" on page 503](#)
- ["Collaborating to solve business challenges" on page 513](#)
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CHAPTER 31: Communicating using Message Center

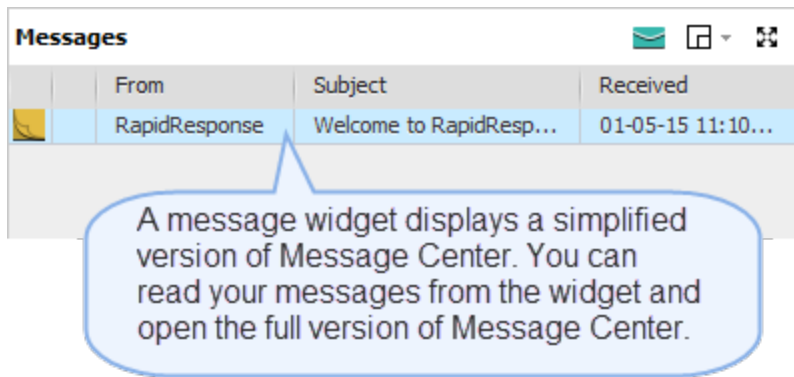
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All communications from RapidResponse and other RapidResponse users are displayed in Message Center. In Message Center, you might receive multiple types of messages depending on your RapidResponse permissions and responsibilities. For example, you might receive an alert notification when one of your alert conditions is met. From the alert notification you can view and correct problems with the affected data. Other notifications that you might receive can include:

- Notification messages, including links to predefined views of resources.
- Urgent notifications from your RapidResponse administrator.
- Scheduled task notifications.
- Scenario messages.
- Error messages or messages about missing resources.
- Messages identifying collaboration comments or posts you are mentioned in.

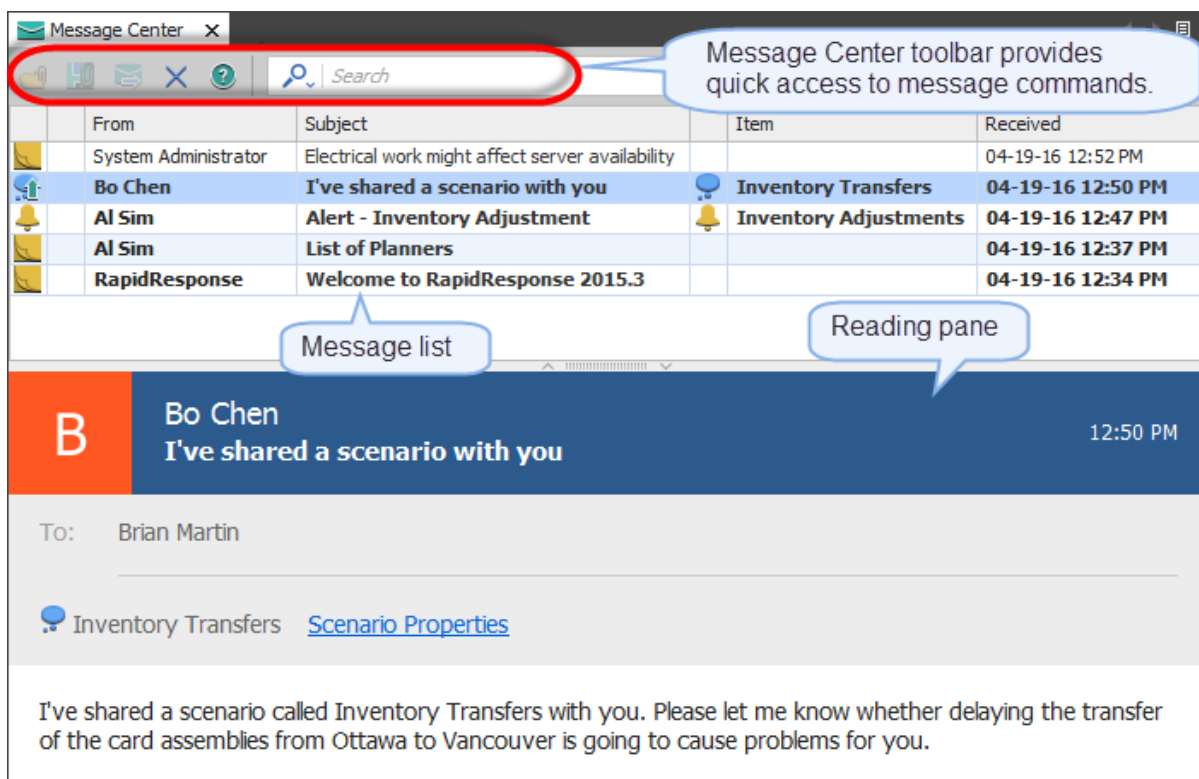
You can choose to have messages received in Message Center sent to your email address. For more information, see ["Message Center and email" on page 451](#).

Messages can also be displayed in a message widget on a dashboard. Message widgets are a simplified version of Message Center. From a message widget, you can read messages, send messages to your email, and open the full Message Center page if you have the permission to Message Center.



Messages are retrieved every five minutes, or whenever you refresh the Message Center window. When messages arrive in Message Center, the **You have new RapidResponse messages** button  appears on the RapidResponse status bar. You can click this button to open Message Center. Close Message Center at any time. To reopen Message Center, click Message Center on the **Go** menu.

RapidResponse Message Center is shown in the following illustration:



Message Center consists of a toolbar, message list, and reading pane. Unread messages are displayed in a bold font. The following table describes each column of the message list.

Column	Description
Message type	Shows an icon corresponding to the type of message. For a complete list of message type icons, see "Summary of Message Center icons" on page 439 .
Attachment	Shows if a message has a file attachment.
From	Shows who the message is from. Alert messages are sent from the alert owner. Collaborative scenario messages are sent from the collaboration team member who made the change. System messages are sent from RapidResponse.
Subject	Shows what the message is about.
Item type	Shows an icon corresponding to the type of resource the message is about. For a list of resource type icons, see "Summary of Message Center icons" on page 439 .
Item	Shows what specific resource the message is about. For alert messages, the item is the name of the alert. For collaborative scenario messages, the item is the scenario.
Received	Shows when the message was sent.

For more information about Message Center, see ["Read a message" on page 440](#) or ["Message Center and email" on page 451](#).

Summary of Message Center icons

The Message Center message list contains three graphical columns, which contain icons indicating the message type, the presence of attachments, and the type of resource the message is about. The graphical columns do not have column headers.

Each message received has an icon, which identifies the type of message. These icons appear in the **Message Type** graphical column. The message types are shown in the following table.

Icon	Message type
	Urgent notification: Your RapidResponse administrator has sent a message. Typically, it is about RapidResponse maintenance that might impact you.
	Alert notification: An alert's condition was met.
	Approval: Somebody added an Accept response to a scenario you own.
	Rejection: Somebody added a Reject response to a scenario you own.
	Commit: Somebody committed a child scenario into a scenario you own.
	Modify: Somebody modified data in a scenario you own.
	Give: Somebody gave you a resource or a scenario.
	Share: Somebody shared a scenario with you.
	Error: An error occurred, such as an automation task failing to run because a resource or scenario is missing.
	Notification: This is the default message type. It is used when the other types do not apply.

Messages with file attachments have the attachment icon  displayed in the **Attachment** graphical column.

Messages related to a specific resource or scenario often have an icon displayed in the **Item** graphical column. Shared and private items use the same icons.

Icon	Resource type
	Scenario
	Alert
	Scheduled task
	Automation chain
	Script
	Process
	Task Flow
	Workbook
	Dashboard
	Widget
	Scorecard (regular or live lens)
	Filter
	Hierarchy

Read a message

- In the Message Center message list, click the message you want to read.
The message is shown in the reading pane.



Tip: You can copy the selected message's text by clicking **Copy** on the **Edit** menu, or by clicking **Copy**  on the toolbar.

Contact a message's sender

If you would like to get in contact with someone who has sent you a message, you can obtain their contact information. You cannot reply to a message through Message Center.

- In the Message Center message list, move the pointer over a sender's name.
The contact information is displayed in a tooltip.



Note: If the other person has not entered any contact information, the tooltip might not contain the information you need. For more information, see "[View another person's contact information](#)" on page 459.

Mark a message as unread

New messages appear in bold in your message list in Message Center. Once a message is displayed in the Message Center reading pane or viewed from the Start page, it is marked as read, and it is no longer shown in bold in your message list.

If you do not have time to read the message or respond to the message, you can mark it as unread so that it will appear in bold again. This can help you remember to look at the message again when you have time.

1. In the **Message Center** message list, click a message you have already read.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Mark as Unread**.

Print a message

You can print the content of any message in the message list. When a message is printed, the contents of the reading pane are printed as they appear. If the message has an attachment, the attachment is not printed.

You cannot print the message list.

1. In the Message Center message list, click the message you want to print.
2. On the **File** menu, click **Print**.
3. In the **Print** dialog box, click **OK**.

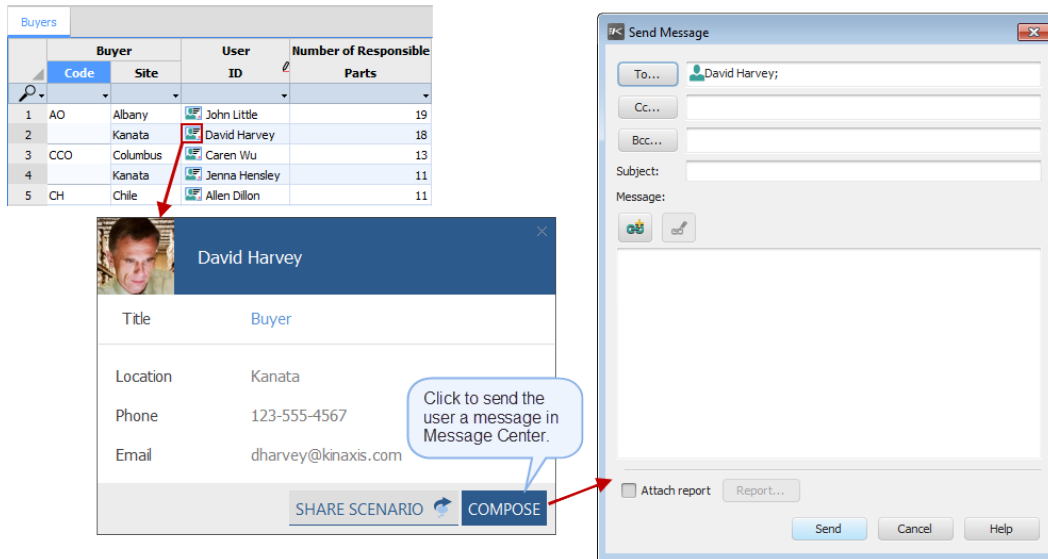


Note: For more information about available print options, see "[Customizing appearance of printed reports](#)" on page 332.

Send a message from a contact card

You can send Message Center messages from user contact cards. Some workbook columns can contain IDs or names of RapidResponse users accompanied by buttons  that can be clicked to open the contact card for each listed user. Often, these columns are meant to show who is responsible for certain data, such as parts, and the contact cards can help you to quickly contact the right people to resolve issues. These buttons can also appear beside a user's name in a responsibility definition.

When the button is clicked, a pop-up displays the profile picture and contact information for the user whose name or ID appears in the cell. The pop-up contains a Compose button that opens the Send Message dialog box, which can be used to send the user a message in RapidResponse Message Center.



In the Send Message dialog box you can:

- Add links to shared resources.
- Include explanatory text.
- Edit link attributes, including data settings for reports or the text displayed for the link.
- Attach a report of a specific worksheet from an open workbook.

For more information about sending links and attaching reports, see ["Send a resource link" on page 442](#) and ["Send a resource link with a report attached" on page 447](#).

When you send messages through Message Center, the recipients might also receive an email message, depending on how their RapidResponse accounts are configured.

Contact cards also contain a Share Scenario button that can be used to share a scenario with the user. For more information, see ["Sharing scenarios from contact cards" on page 489](#).

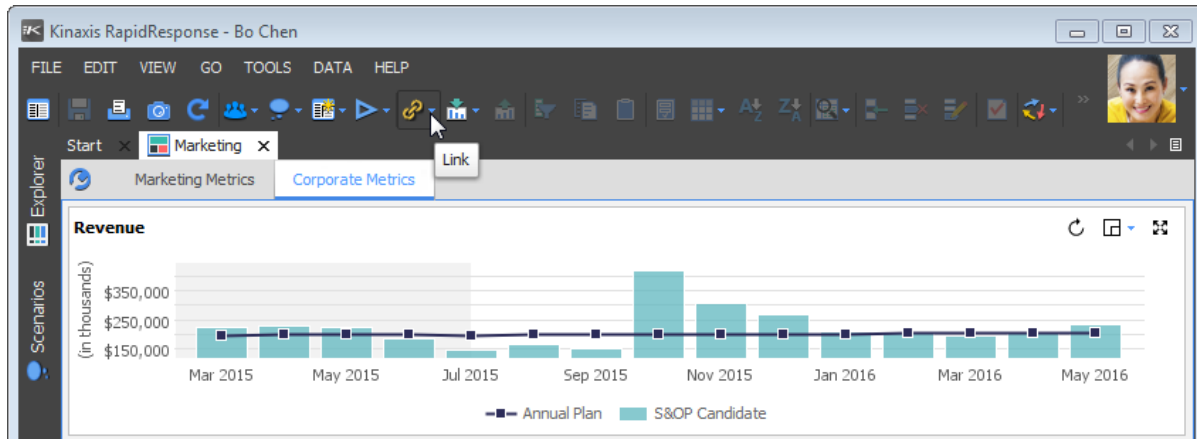
► To send a message from a contact card

1. In a worksheet or responsibility definition, click the **User Contact Information** button. The **Send Message** dialog box opens.
2. Optionally, select additional recipients of the message.
3. Add text in the Message box to explain why you are sending the message.
4. Optionally, add one or more links to the message or attach a report.
5. Click **Send**.

Send a resource link

You might have permission to send resource links to other users. Resource links allow you to send specific views of workbooks, dashboards, and scorecards that display for other RapidResponse users when they open the link. You can also use resource links to send links to forms.

For example, when you are reviewing a dashboard and see that the revenue in S&OP Candidate falls well below Annual Plan values for the same month, you can send your colleague a link to the dashboard. When they open the resource link, they will see the same data context on the dashboard as you are seeing, with the same data settings applied.



If any of the data settings use a private resource, such as a private filter or site, link recipients will not be able to view the resource with its intended context. You must do one of the following before sending the link:

- Change the data settings to use shared resources.
- Share the private resources used in the data settings with those users.

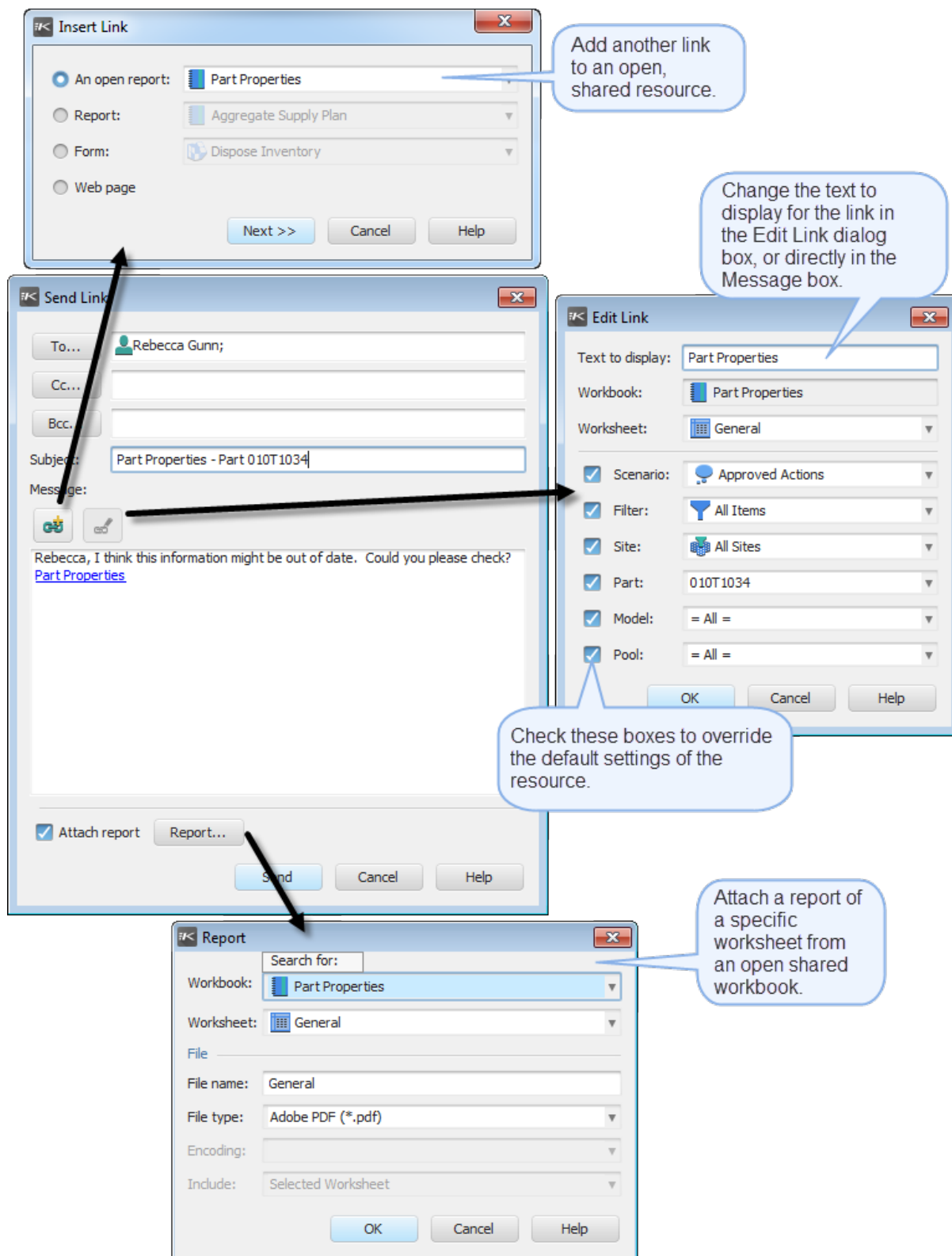
When you send a resource link, you can:

- Add additional links to other shared resources.
- Include explanatory text.
- Edit link attributes, including data settings for reports or the text displayed for the link.
- Attach a report of a specific worksheet from an open workbook. For more information, see ["Send a resource link with a report attached" on page 447](#).



Note: Resource links cannot be sent for system workbooks.

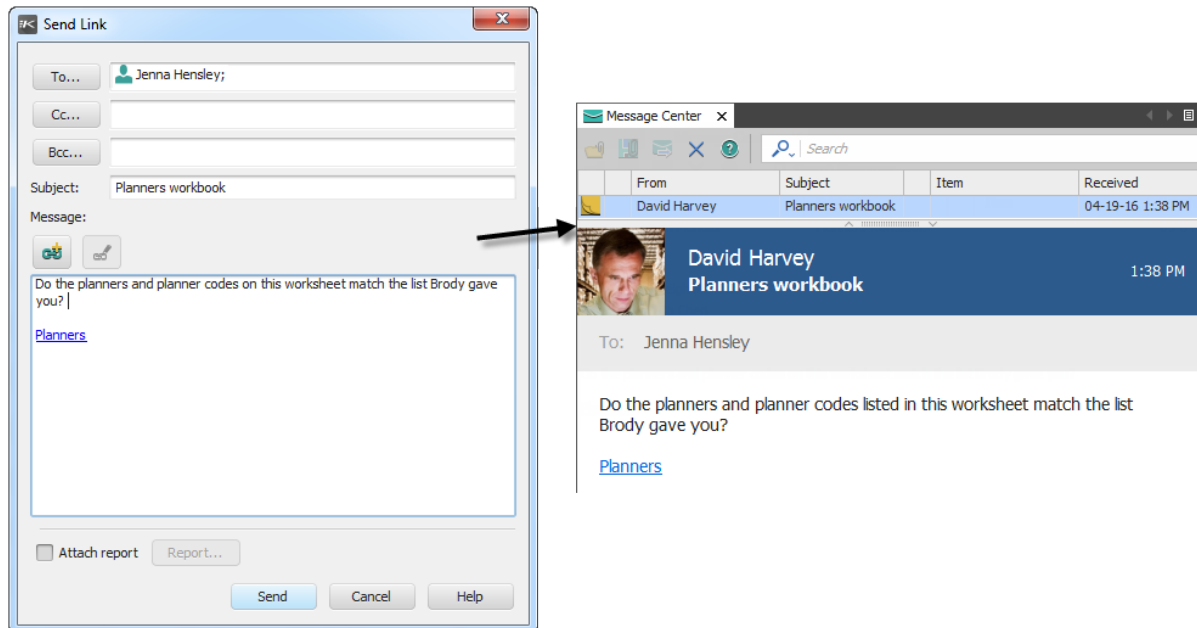
Including explanatory text, other links, and reports can provide further context for the resource view, outline a course of corrective action for a problem, and support faster decision-making.



You can also copy and paste resource links in collaborations and, depending on how your system has been configured, you might also be able to copy and paste resource links in external communications

such as in an instant message. For more information, see ["Add resource links to a collaboration" on page 537](#) and ["Copy and paste a resource link" on page 448](#).

Link recipients can open resource link messages in Message Center or in email messages. When clicked, the link opens the resource with the data settings you specified. If the link recipient is signed in to RapidResponse, the resource link opens in a new tab. If the recipient is not signed in, the resource link opens a RapidResponse sign-in window for them to sign in to view the resource.



The link recipient must have permission to view the resource to open the link. If the resource has not been shared with the recipient, they will receive the link but will be unable to open it. If the link recipient does not have access to resources needed to view the link with the data settings you specified, they will have to change the data settings to view data in the worksheet.

If you would like to ensure that the link recipient is able to view a worksheet exactly as you see it, consider attaching a report. For more information, see ["Send a resource link with a report attached" on page 447](#).



Notes:

- You can only send resource links to shared resources. If you open a Send Link dialog box from a private resource, no default link is added.
- You can also send resource links from contact cards. For more information, see ["Send a message from a contact card" on page 441](#).

► Send a link from an open report

1. Open the resource you want to send a link for.
The resource must be shared, and the link recipient must have permission to view that resource to successfully open it.
2. Select the desired data settings for the resource.

3. On the RapidResponse toolbar, click **Link** .
4. Click **Send Link** .
The resource link is automatically added in the **Message** box.
5. Select one or more recipients for the link.
6. If desired, add text in the **Message** box to explain why you are sending the link. You can also add other links that might be of use.
7. Click **Send**.

► **Send a link without an open report**

1. On the RapidResponse toolbar, click **Link**  and then click **Send Link** .
2. Select one or more recipients for the link.
3. Add one or more links to the message.
4. If desired, add text in the **Message** box to explain why you are sending the link.

► **Add a link to the message**

1. In the open **Send Link** dialog box, place the cursor in the **Message** box where you want to add the link.
2. Click **Add Link** .
3. Select the type of link to add:
 - An open report.
 - A report you have access to.
 - A form.
 - A typed web page address.
4. If desired, change the **Text to display** and any other settings that are available in the **Add Link** dialog box.
The settings that you can specify depend on the type of resource you are sending a link to. If the link is for a form, you can only select the form and the **Text to display**.

► **Edit a link**

Depending on the resource you are sending a link to, you can modify different attributes of the resource to customize the view you are sending.

1. In the open **Send Link** dialog box, place the cursor in the text of the resource link you want to edit.
2. Click **Edit Link** .
3. Perform any of the following modifications to the resource link:
 - Modify the link title.
 - Select the workbook and worksheet to link to.
 - Select the data settings to display for that resource.
 - Modify the data settings for that resource.



Notes:

- The **Edit Link**



 button is only active when the cursor is placed in a link.

- In the **Edit Link** dialog box for dashboards, **User's personal settings** and **Custom settings** can only be selected if the dashboard author has allowed the dashboard to be opened with custom settings.

Send a resource link with a report attached

You can attach a report when you send a resource link to another RapidResponse user. The report is a file that shows the data you see in the selected worksheet in an open workbook at the time the link is sent. For more information about sending links, see ["Send a resource link" on page 442](#).

Why include a report?

When you send a link to a worksheet to another RapidResponse user, the recipient can open the link to view the most current data using the settings you specified.

If someone makes changes to the data after you send the link, though, the recipient might not see the same data that were available to you when you sent the link. In addition, if the recipient does not have access to all of the resources needed to view the worksheet with exactly the same data settings you specified in the link, they will be unable to view the worksheet as you see it.

If it is important that the recipient see the worksheet data exactly as you see it, consider including a report with the link. For example, you could share a view of the data exactly as it looks at 11:25 AM on Monday, using a private filter that you created.

Report options

The file types that are available for reports include:

- A PDF file which can be opened in a PDF viewer such as Adobe Reader or Preview for Mac OS.
- An HTML file, which opens in a Web browser.
- A Microsoft Excel file, which opens in Microsoft Excel.
- A tab-delimited text file, which opens in any word processor.
- An XML file, which opens in a Web browser or word processor.

If you send the report as a Microsoft Excel file, you can include just the selected worksheet, or all of the worksheets in the workbook.

If you send the report as an HTML file, a tab-delimited text file, or an XML file, you can choose the type of encoding for the file. The following options are available.

- **ANSI (System Locale)**—plain text non-Unicode encoding. The exported file will use the locale setting of RapidResponse.
- **Unicode**—a 16-bit character encoding system that supports the processing and display of the major texts in the world. Use Unicode encoding for data that will be used in a multilingual setting.

- **Unicode (Big Endian)**—A sequence of bytes is stored with the most significant value first (a word is stored big-end first). This format is usually supported on computers that do not use an x86 CPU (Intel and AMD) such as the older generation Macintosh computers which used a Motorola CPU.
- **Unicode (UTF-8)**—an 8-bit version of Unicode that can be used with transmission media that supports only 8 bits of data within one byte. Use the UTF-8 version of Unicode for data that will be used in a multi-lingual setting, and on different operating systems. It is also important to use UTF-8 for files exported in XML format.

► **Attach a report to a resource link message**

1. In the **Send Link** dialog box, select the **Attach report** check box.
2. Click **Report**.
3. Select a **Workbook** and a **Worksheet**, and make any necessary changes in the **File** area.

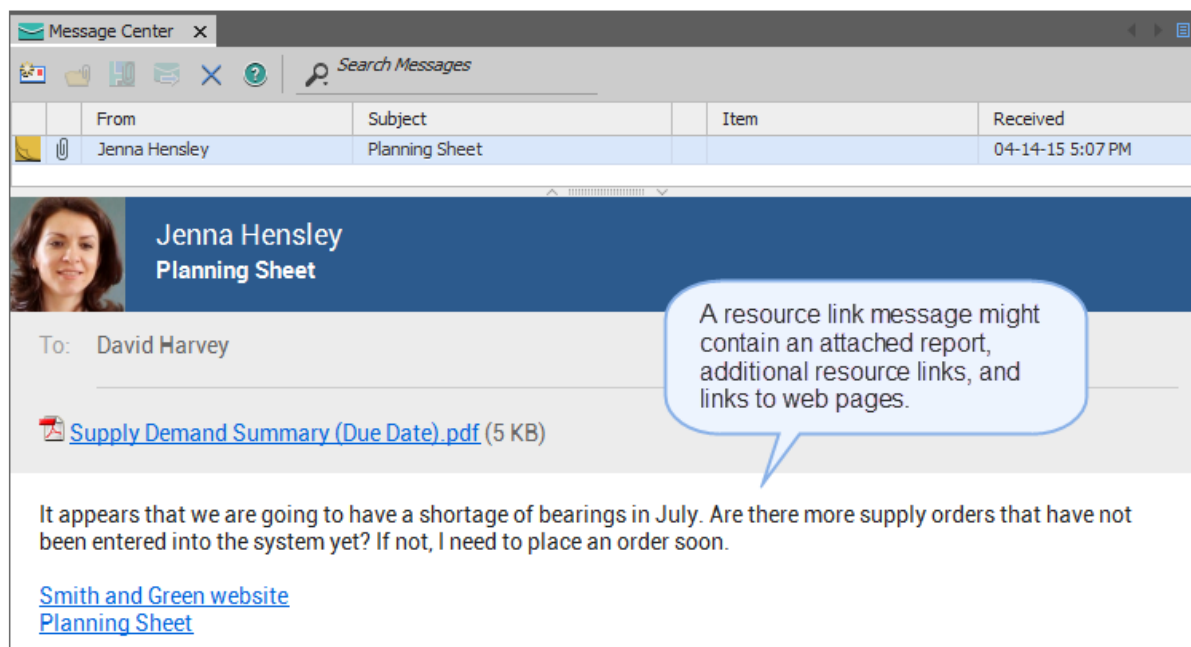
Copy and paste a resource link

You can copy and paste resource links to share and communicate about business contexts. The links can be added to collaborations in RapidResponse, or to external communications such as an email message. For more information about resource links in collaborations, see ["Add resource links to a collaboration" on page 537](#).

1. Open the resource you want to add as a link to a collaboration.
2. Edit the data settings to display the data you want to share.
3. In the open resource, click **Link**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.
4. Click **Copy Link** .
5. Navigate to the location where you want to paste the link, such as a chat window or in the body of an email message.
6. Press CTRL-V to paste the link.

Open a resource link

Resource links are sent to Message Center or your email address and automatically open when you click the link text. The resource link might also display a message from the sender, additional resource links or web page links, and attached reports. You can only open a resource link to a resource you have permission to view.



Resource links are automatically deleted after 45 days. To modify this limit, contact your RapidResponse Administrator.

► Open a link

1. In the Message Center message list, click the message with the resource link.
2. Click the link text to open it.
 - If you are signed into RapidResponse, the link will open the resource in a new tab.
 - If you are not signed into RapidResponse, the link will open a sign-in window for RapidResponse for you to sign in through to view the resource.



Note: If the message opens with unexpected results, such as missing data settings, contact the sender of the link and ask them to resend the link using data settings you have access to or to share the resources used in the data settings.

Open or save an attachment

Messages can be sent with attachments, which contain data and can be opened or saved.

► Open an attachment

1. In the Message Center message list, click a message with an attachment.
2. On the **File** menu, click **Open Attachment**.



Note: If the attachment is too large for RapidResponse to open, you are prompted to save the file and open it with another application.



Tip: You can also click **Open Attachment**  on the Message Center toolbar or click the file name in the reading pane.

► Save an attachment

1. In the Message Center message list, click a message with an attachment.
2. On the **File** menu, click **Save Attachment**.
3. Navigate to the location you would like to save the attachment, and then click **Save**.



Tip: You can also click **Save Attachment**  on the Message Center toolbar.

Sort the message list

You can change the order in which messages are listed in the Message Center. For example, you might want to see your oldest messages at the top of the list so that you can address outstanding issues that still require your attention.

1. In the **Message Center** message list, click the column header you want to sort by.
2. To sort in reverse order, click the column header again.



Note: You can sort by columns that have blank headers, such as the attachment column.

Search the message list

If you have a long list of messages in Message Center, searching the message list might be the fastest way to find the message you are looking for.

1. Place the insertion point in the search box on the **Message Center** toolbar.
2. Type text to search for.
3. The search word does not have to be an actual word. It can be a word, sentence, or just a few characters.
4. To search in a specific column, click , and then click one of the following:
 - **All**—searches all columns in the message list.
 - **From**—searches the From column only.
 - **Subject**—searches the Subject column only.
 - **Item**—searches the Item column only.
 - **Received**—searches the Received column only.
5. To specify where in the column the search word is, click , and then click one of the following:
 - **Match from start**—the search word must be at the beginning of a word in the specified column.
 - **Match anywhere**—the search word can be anywhere in the specified column.

6. To clear a search, click  in the search box.



Note: You can only search one column at a time, unless you select **All**.

Delete messages

You can delete any messages you have received. You can select multiple messages to delete at the same time.

When you delete a message, you are given a confirmation dialog box. If you do not want this dialog box to display, you can disable it.

Messages can be automatically deleted if the following conditions occur:

- You have 1,000 messages in your message list. When a new message arrives, the oldest message is deleted.
- A message is more than 45 days old.

Your RapidResponse administrator can modify these limits.

► Delete a message

1. In the Message Center message list, click a message.
If you want to delete multiple messages, hold the **CTRL** key and click each message you want to delete.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Delete**.



Tip: You can also click **Delete**  on the Message Center toolbar.

► Disable the delete confirmation dialog box

1. On the **Tools** menu, click **Options**.
2. In the **Options** dialog box, click the **Settings** tab.
3. Clear the **Warn before deleting messages** check box.



Tip: If profile pictures are enabled on your RapidResponse system, you can access **Options** by clicking on your profile picture in the RapidResponse toolbar.

Message Center and email

When you receive a message in Message Center, a copy of that message is automatically sent to your email address. This automatic forwarding can be disabled, and all messages will be sent to Message Center only.

Even if you disable automatic forwarding, you can forward a copy of any message to your email address. File attachments in messages are sent if your system administrator has allowed file attachments in email messages. You can only forward a message to your own email address.

Some messages that are sent from RapidResponse contain links to sign in to your RapidResponse account. These links can help you to quickly sign in, see the most up to date information, and take necessary actions. It is possible, however, that unauthorized third parties could attempt to steal RapidResponse account information using a phishing attack—an email message that is intended to look like it comes from your company's RapidResponse server, but directs you to a fake instance of the RapidResponse sign-in page or another website that exists for the purpose of collecting account information. If you have concerns about the authenticity of a RapidResponse message, do not click any of its links. Instead, open your web browser and sign in to RapidResponse directly from there, or contact your RapidResponse administrator.

► **Disable automatic email forwarding**

1. On the **Tools** menu, click **Options**.
2. In the **Options** dialog box, click the **Settings** tab.
3. Clear the **Forward a copy of each message to my email address** check box.



Tip: If profile pictures are enabled on your RapidResponse system, you can access **Options** by clicking on your profile picture in the RapidResponse toolbar.

► **Forward a message to your email address**

1. In the Message Center message list, click a message.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Forward to my Email**.



Notes:

- When a message is sent to an email address, the email is sent from RapidResponse using your name. In some cases, Microsoft Outlook and other email programs might detect this email and warn you that a program is sending an email using your name. If this happens, click **Allow** on the warning to send the message to the email recipients.
- Message center is not available on the Mobile Client. You can however set up email forwarding and send views of dashboards to other users. For more information, see the [RapidResponse User Guide \(Mobile Client\)](#).



Tip: You can also click **Forward to my Email**  on the Message Center toolbar.

Messages from collaborations

Activity in collaborations will generate messages that are sent to you in Message Center. You will see messages when you are:

- Added to a collaboration.
- Made the leader of a collaboration.
- Mentioned in a collaboration post or comment where social markup is used.

For more information, see ["Collaborating to solve business challenges" on page 513](#).

CHAPTER 32: Managing your contact information

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RapidResponse can display contact information such as your title, contact numbers, or location to other users. You can also add a profile picture that displays with your contact information. You can add or edit your contact information and profile picture in the Options dialog box, as shown in the following illustration.

Options

Contact Settings Group Memberships

Natasha Obasanj  Choose Remove

nobasanj@WheelsRUs.com

Name: Natasha Obasanj

User ID: nobasanj

User type: General

Email address: nobasanj@WheelsRUs.com

Title: Buyer

Phone: (555) 444 - 1544

Fax:

Mobile: (555) 444 - 2053

Pager:

Location: Europe ▼

Country/Region:

Notes:

OK Cancel Help

This information must be specified by your RapidResponse Administrator.

RapidResponse administrators can limit users' ability to see each other's contact information.

Specify your contact information

Providing your contact information in RapidResponse allows other users to contact you and determine what collaborations to involve you in and what resources to share with you. For example, someone in your company might want to share a specific workbook with users at a specific location or with the same job title. By viewing contact information, they can select only the applicable users to share the workbook with.

Contact information can also be used by people external to your company (such as customers or suppliers who use RapidResponse) to find out who can help resolve specific business issues.

Your Name, User ID, User type, and email addresses are fields defined by your RapidResponse administrator. Optionally, you or your administrator can provide additional contact information such as your job title or location. If your additional contact information has not been specified, it is recommended that you update your information when you sign in to RapidResponse for the first time.

If profile pictures are turned on, you can upload an image to display as your profile picture. For more information, see ["Set your profile picture" on page 457](#).

1. On the **Tools** menu, click **Options**.
2. On the **Contact** tab, specify the following information:
 - **Title**—your job title. For example, Buyer or Planner.
 - **Phone**—your telephone number. Include your extension if you have one.
 - **Fax**—your fax number.
 - **Mobile**—your mobile telephone number.
 - **Pager**—your pager number.
 - **Location**—where you work. If your office is not in the list of sites provided, you can type it in the text box.
 - **Country/Region**—where your office is located.
 - **Notes**—any additional information about you. You can include your responsibility within the company here, such as customers you deal with, product lines you are responsible for, and so on.
3. Verify the information is correct, and then click **OK**.

**Notes:**

- The telephone numbers should include the area code and country code if you expect to be contacted by people from other parts of the world.
- Some users, such as suppliers external to your company, might not be able to view your contact information. This depends on user account settings, which are specified by administrators.

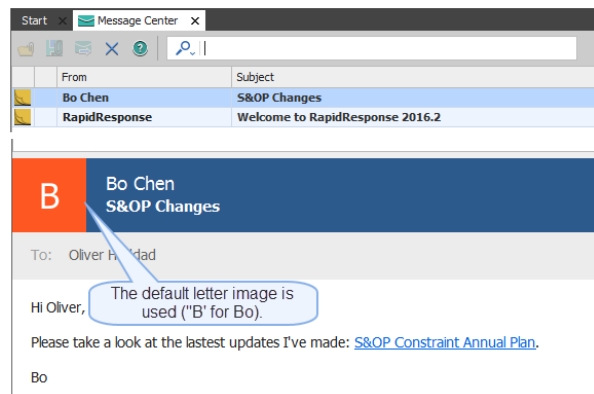
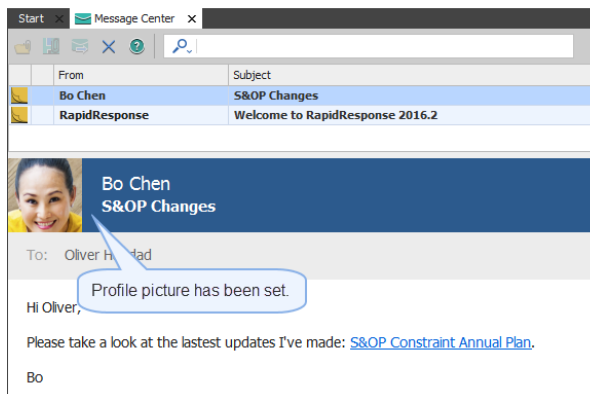


Tip: If profile pictures are turned on, you can access **Options** by clicking on your profile picture in the RapidResponse toolbar.

Set your profile picture

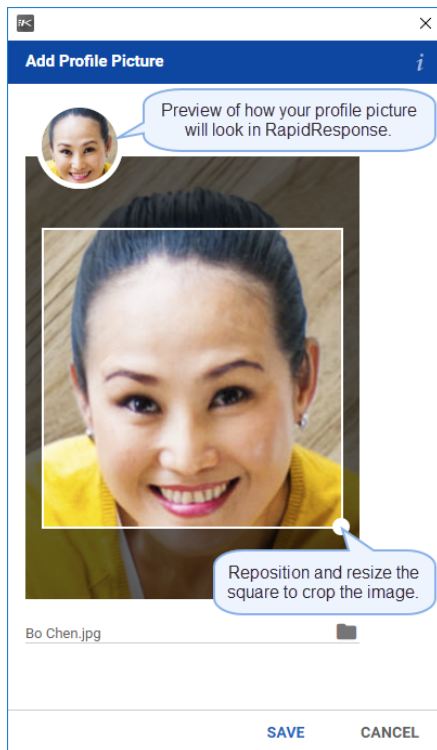
You can set a profile picture for your RapidResponse account that helps other users identify you. This can be especially helpful when you are participating in collaborations. Only users on your RapidResponse system can view your profile picture.

If you do not set a profile picture, a default image of the first initial of your name or user ID displays instead.



In the Desktop Client, profile pictures display in the toolbar, contact cards, broadcast messages, and messages in Message Center.

To set your profile picture, upload an image from your computer or network. When uploaded, you can crop the image using the Add Profile Picture dialog box, shown below. A preview shows you how the profile picture will display in RapidResponse.



Notes:

- If your system administrator has turned off profile pictures, you cannot see any profile pictures or options to set a profile picture.
- An administrator can set a profile picture for you.

► Set or change your profile picture

1. Do one of the following:
 - On the RapidResponse toolbar, click your current profile picture and select **Options**.
 - On the **Tools** menu, click **Options**.
2. On the **Contact** tab, click **Choose**.
3. In the **Add Profile Picture** dialog box, click **Select Image**.
4. Locate and select the image file you want to upload and click **Open**.
5. If necessary, resize the dialog box to show the whole image.
6. To change the image you have uploaded, click the file name below the image.



7. To crop the image, click the white square and drag it to a different area of the image.
8. Click **Save**.
9. Click **OK**.



Notes:

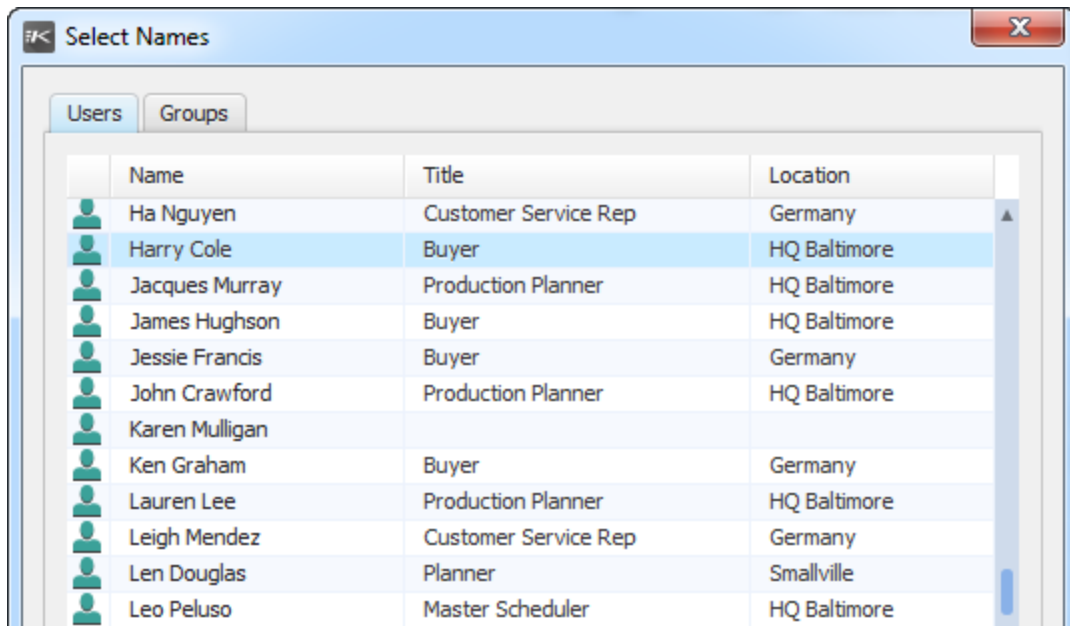
- You can use the following file types to set a profile picture: BMP, GIF, JPG, JPEG, PICT, PNG, TIFF, WEBP, ICO, JFIF, PJPEG, PJP, SVGZ, TIF, XBM, and SVG.
- The image file size must be 20 MB or smaller.
- You cannot re-crop an image after you have exited the **Add Profile Picture** dialog box. To crop the image differently, you must upload the image again.

► Remove an uploaded profile picture

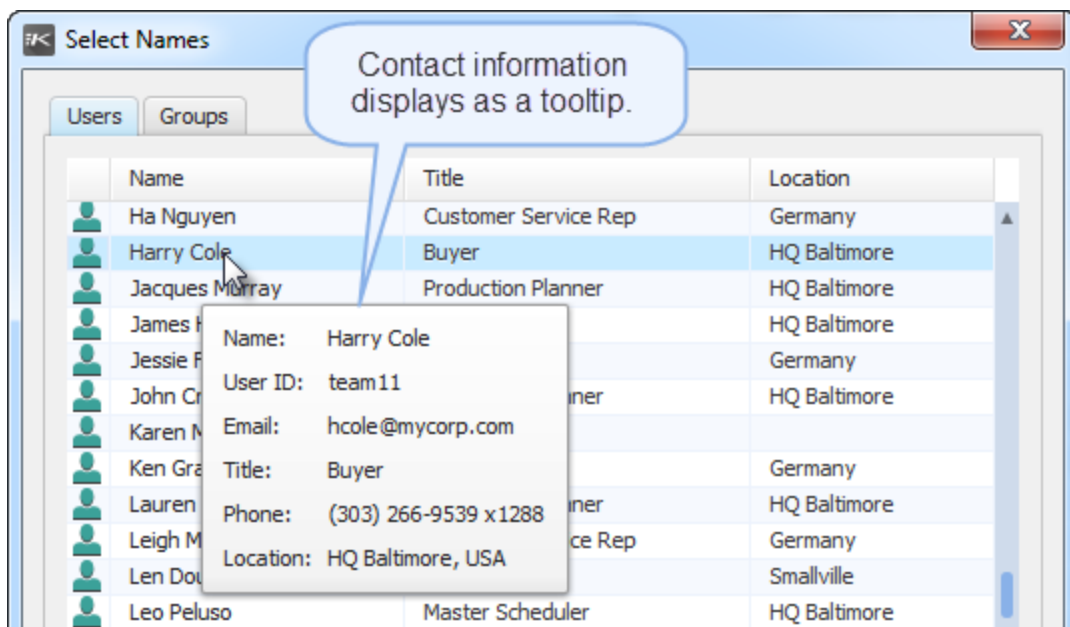
1. Do one of the following:
 - On the RapidResponse toolbar, click your current profile picture and select **Options**.
 - On the **Tools** menu, click **Options**.
2. On the **Contact** tab, click **Remove**.
3. Click **OK**.

View another person's contact information

Wherever you see someone's name in RapidResponse, you can view their available contact information. For example, when you are selecting a user to share a resource with, you might also see their job titles and locations. This information can help you identify who to share the resource with.



To view more information about any one of the users, you can view their contact information by moving the pointer over a name.



This information cannot be copied and displays until you move the pointer off of the name or after ten minutes has elapsed.

You might also be able to view another user's contact information by clicking the  button beside a user's name in a worksheet column. When you view contact information in a worksheet column, you can copy it to the clipboard. For more information, see ["View data responsibility in worksheets" on page 511](#).

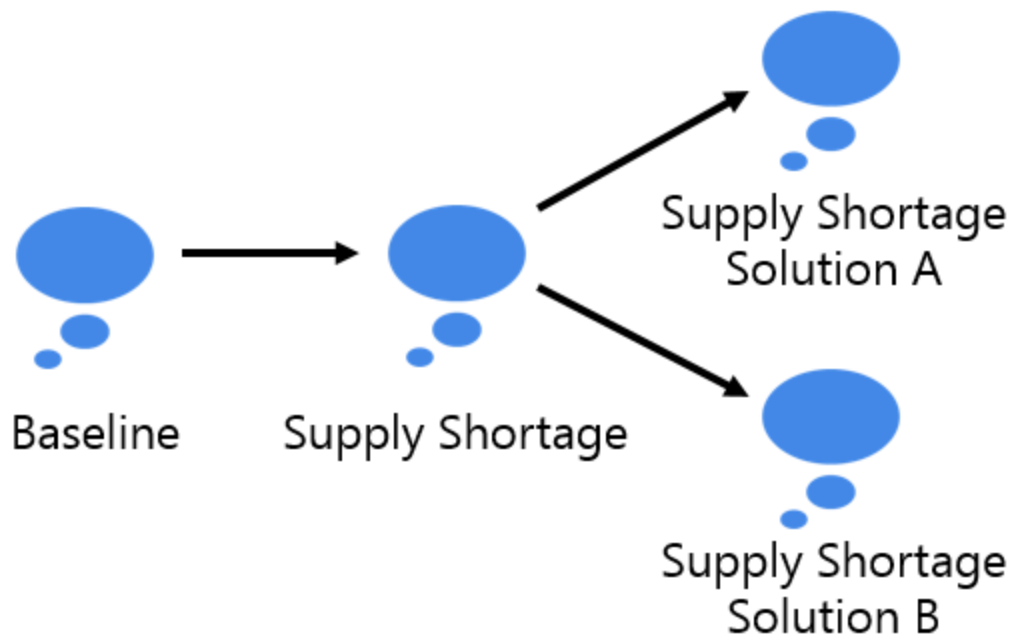
CHAPTER 33: Simulating business changes

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Every company faces daily challenges, such as supply shortages and unexpected orders. The impact of these occurrences is often unknown, as is the impact of proposed solutions.

If you have been granted simulation permissions by your RapidResponse administrator, you can perform what-if analysis by creating scenarios and modifying the data in them to simulate a business challenge. Further, you can use these scenarios as a base for other scenarios that simulate different solutions. If you have not been granted simulation permission, you can view data in any scenario that has been shared with you. For more information, see ["Scenarios in RapidResponse" on page 17](#).

For example, if you receive information from a supplier that a key part is not going to be available on time, you can create a new scenario and change the data in it to reflect the supply shortage. You can then create different scenarios based on this scenario and change the data to simulate various responses. To help determine the optimal solution, you can collaborate with other RapidResponse users by sharing the scenarios that represent the solutions. For more information, see ["Share a scenario" on page 486](#) and ["Collaborating to solve business challenges" on page 513](#).

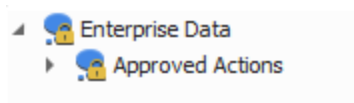


Data is modified in a scenario using a RapidResponse worksheet. For more information, see ["Modifying data in workbooks" on page 339](#).

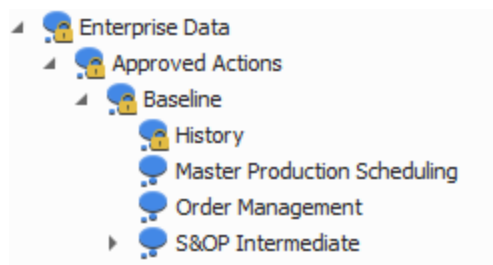
Understanding the scenario structure

Many RapidResponse implementations adhere to a scenario structure that includes a few standard scenarios. These scenarios are used to provide users with data, and each fulfills a different purpose. Depending on your company's data requirements, you might see one or more of the standard scenarios, or you might see a different set of scenarios in a different tree structure.

Data is extracted from your company's enterprise data sources (such as ERP, MRP, PLM, and other databases) and from external sources such as customers, suppliers, and contract manufacturers. Most often, this data is imported into RapidResponse and stored in the root scenario, usually called Enterprise Data. The Approved Actions scenario is the child of the Enterprise Data scenario, and is used for automatic data manipulation purposes. Many users do not have access to these scenarios.



The Baseline scenario is the child of Approved Actions, and it contains user maintained master data, such as annual plan targets, manual data modifications, and IPM project actuals. The Baseline scenario typically has several child scenarios, including History, which is used as the root scenario for historical scenarios.



Your RapidResponse administrator might have created other scenarios to be used for viewing data or simulating business changes. In this case, you should be told which scenarios to use for simulation purposes.

If no other scenarios are available, then, for simulation purposes, you and other users create scenarios based on the Baseline scenario to perform your daily analysis of changes such as a new demand or supply shortage. As you resolve these issues, you commit the data changes in your scenarios to the Baseline scenario. This gives users throughout your company a view into the most current business situation.



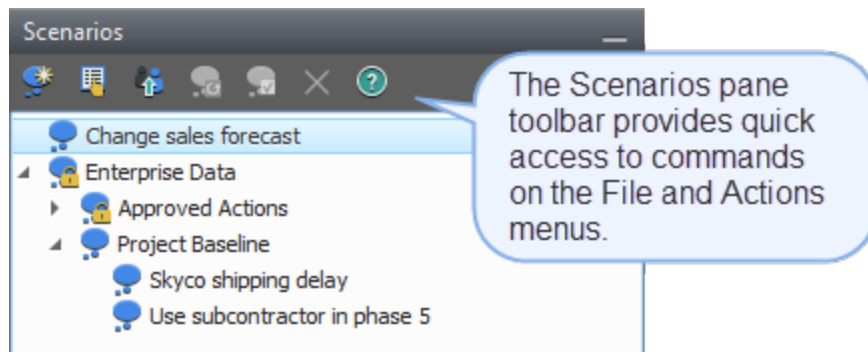
Caution: Modifying data in the Enterprise Data scenario is not recommended, and can result in damage to your data. For more information about committing changes to the Enterprise Data scenario, see the [RapidResponse Administration Guide](#).



Note: The root scenario is usually named Enterprise Data, but its name can be modified by your RapidResponse administrator.

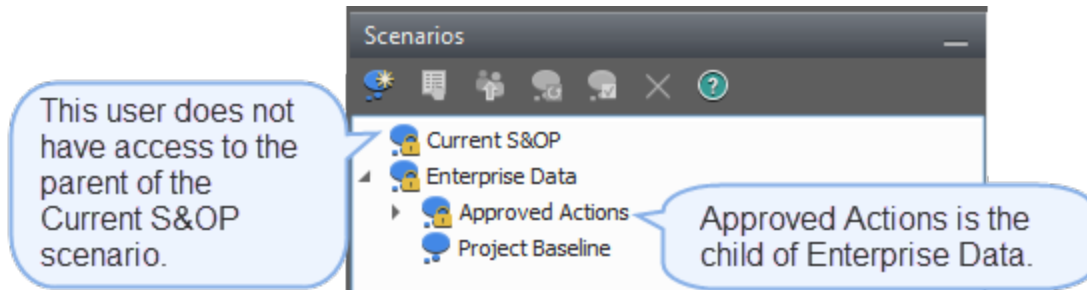
Scenarios pane

If your administrator has given you simulation permission, you have access to the Scenarios pane where all of the scenarios to which you have access are displayed. With the exception of the root scenario, each scenario begins as a copy of another scenario. The scenarios are organized to show the parent/child relationship between the scenarios. In the following illustration, the Enterprise Data scenario is the parent of the Approved Actions and Project Baseline scenarios, which are both parents of other scenarios.



Your Scenarios pane might look different than any of the ones shown in these illustrations. For example, you might have access to only one scenario, or your administrator might have created a hierarchy of scenarios to represent for the divisions of your company, to hold historical information, or to apply modifications to some data. For more information about your company's scenario structure, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

You can see the parent-child relationship between scenarios only if you have access to both a scenario and its parent. Otherwise, the scenarios are listed in alphabetical order in the Scenarios pane. The following illustration shows a Scenarios pane that contains two scenarios in a parent-child relationship, and two scenarios whose parents are not visible.



You can create scenarios in the Scenarios pane. Also, if you have permission to share scenarios, you can share the scenarios you create with other users. The Scenarios pane is refreshed every minute to ensure that you have access to any scenarios that have been shared with you.

The status of the scenarios is identified with various icons in the scenario pane. For information about what each icon depicts, see ["Summary of scenario icons" on page 464](#).

Summary of scenario icons

Scenarios are represented by an icon that indicates the status of the scenario. The following table summarizes the icons and provides a description of each icon.

Icon	What it means
	You cannot change the data in this scenario.
	A shared scenario. This scenario is owned by another user and has been shared with you, or you are the owner of this scenario and you have shared it. You are authorized to change the data in this scenario.
	A private scenario. You are the owner of this scenario and have not shared it with other users.
	The data in this scenario is out of date with its parent scenario because changes have been made to the parent. You can update this scenario with the changes made in the parent. This can apply to a private or a shared scenario. For more information, see "Update data in a scenario" on page 470 .
	Indicates that changes in the scenario's parent have been discarded, making the parent and child scenarios out of sync. Discard changes in the child scenario to make the parent and child scenarios the same. For more information, see "Discard changes in a scenario" on page 472 .

Shared scenarios

Shared scenarios are those to which you have either been given access by a RapidResponse administrator or another user, or you have shared. In the Scenarios pane, shared scenarios are identified with a blue icon . When you share a scenario, you can specify if it is view only or if it is modifiable (others can make changes in the scenario). In scenarios that have been shared with you with the Modify permission, you can modify data by:

- Changing the data directly in the scenario. You can do this only if your administrator has granted you permission to modify data in shared scenarios.
- Creating a new scenario, modifying the data in this scenario, and then committing the changes back to the shared scenario. For more information, see ["Commit data changes to a parent scenario" on page 474.](#)

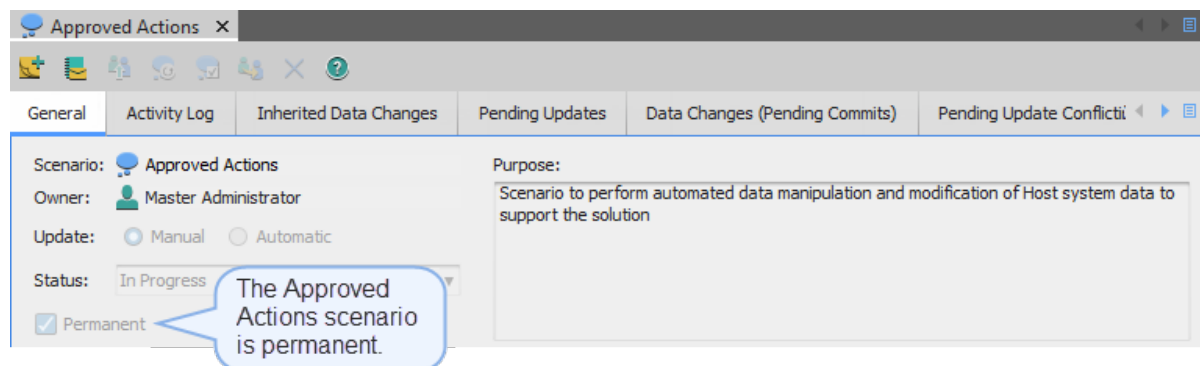
Private scenarios

A private scenario is one that you create and only you can see. In the Scenarios pane, private scenarios are identified with a gray icon . As the scenario owner, you can modify the data it contains to explore various business situations. For more information, see ["Modifying data in workbooks" on page 339.](#)

If your administrator grants you scenario sharing permissions, you can share private scenarios with other users. With the appropriate scenario permissions, you can also commit changes you make in private scenarios back into the shared scenarios from which they were derived (this allows any user with access to the shared scenario to see your changes).

Permanent scenarios

A permanent scenario cannot be deleted, and is always present after committing changes or after a data import. Your RapidResponse administrator can make any shared scenario permanent. Permanent scenarios do not have a different icon, however, the Permanent check box in the scenario properties window appears selected, as shown in the following illustration.



Changes to scenarios during data imports and updates

Regularly scheduled data updates modify the data in the Enterprise Data, Approved Actions, and Baseline scenarios with a latest data set from your enterprise data sources.

Instead of updating the RapidResponse data, your administrator might perform a data import from the enterprise data sources. If this happens, the Enterprise Data and Approved Actions scenarios are replaced with the new data from the enterprise data sources. Every other scenario is deleted, unless the scenario is permanent. For more information, see "[Permanent scenarios](#)" on [page 465](#).

View information about a scenario

If your administrator has given you simulation permission, you can access the properties of each scenario to view information about the scenario and, if you are the scenario's owner, perform many scenario functions, such as sharing or monitoring changes. The General tab is shown in the following illustration:

The screenshot shows the 'Remove Skyco Orders' scenario properties dialog box. The 'General' tab is selected. The dialog includes fields for Scenario, Owner, Update, Status, and a checkbox for Permanent. A 'Purpose' text area is also present. Below these is a 'Collaboration Summary' table. Callouts provide additional context: 'The scenario being viewed' points to the title bar; 'The scenario properties toolbar provides quick access to commands on the Actions menu.' points to the toolbar; 'Information about the scenario, including the name, owner, purpose, update status, permanent setting, and perspective (if applicable)' points to the main form fields; 'Most recent action taken by each person with access to the scenario' points to the Collaboration Summary table; and 'Description of the action, as described by the person taking the action' points to the 'Response' column of the table.

Name	Response	Subject	Responded	Permission
Riley Chen	Note	In Progress	09-16-15 9:58	

Not all of the orders have been removed yet. Waiting to find out whether orders for ground transport vehicle parts would also be affected.

► View scenario information

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select a scenario.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties** .



Tip: You can also click **Properties**  on the **Scenarios** pane toolbar, or click the **Scenario Properties** link in a message inviting you to collaborate on a scenario.

Track activity in a scenario

If a number of people are collaborating on the same scenario, you can see what each of them has done to it. Scenario actions can be viewed in two places in the scenario properties:

- **General tab - Collaboration summary**

Each person's most recent action is shown here. If a person has taken more than one action in this scenario, only the most recent is shown.

- **Activity Log tab**

This tab lists detailed information about every action taken. If a person has taken more than one action in this scenario, all of the actions are shown.

Each action is recorded, including responses, committed child scenarios, and so on. Each activity type has an icon, as shown in the following table.

Icon	Activity
	A collaborator has added a note or the scenario's status was changed.
	An action team member has accepted the changes they are responsible for in the scenario.
	An action team member has rejected the changes they are responsible for in the scenario.
	Data was modified by committing a child scenario into the scenario. You can review the child scenario's activities by clicking the plus symbol beside the commit icon.
	Data was modified by a scheduled task.
	The scenario was updated with changes from its parent.
	Changes in the parent scenario were discarded.
	The scenario was shared with the action team. This activity is recorded the first time the scenario is shared.
	The scenario was renamed.
	The scenario was given to a new owner.
	The scenario was created.

► Review scenario activity

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select a scenario.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. In the scenario properties, click the **Activity Log** tab.



Note: For more information about the activities shown in the **Activity Log** tab, see the ["Managing scenarios" on page 481](#) section and ["Collaborating to solve business challenges" on page 513](#).



Tip: You can also click **Properties**  on the **Scenarios** pane.

Track data changes in a scenario

As people collaborate on resolutions to a given problem, and make changes in scenarios by inserting, deleting, or modifying records, it can become important to understand the differences between scenarios, and to trace the actions that led to these differences. Therefore, RapidResponse provides the ability to track the source and details of user-initiated data changes in a scenario.

You can track the recent changes that have resulted in differences between a selected scenario and its parent scenario. For example, suppose you are ready to update a scenario with changes from its parent scenario. You might want to know the details of the changes in the parent to determine the impact, if any, they would have on the assumptions, decisions, and changes made in the active scenario. You can also track recent changes that have resulted in differences between a selected scenario and the Enterprise Data scenario. For example, you might want to see all inclusive changes that comprise a scenario used to resolve a particular problem, and thus understand what changes need to be made in the host system.

For each RapidResponse scenario, three types of changes are tracked:

- **Pending Updates**—changes that exist in the parent, but which have not yet been updated into the selected scenario. This includes changes made directly in the parent, or changes brought into the parent from another scenario. When a scenario is updated with its parent, all Pending Updates become Inherited Changes.
- **Pending Commits**—changes that have been made in the scenario (either directly or committed up from a child scenario), but which have not yet been committed into the parent scenario. When a scenario is committed into its parent scenario, these changes then become pending commits in that scenario.
- **Inherited Changes**—changes that have been brought into the selected scenario from its parent. This includes changes inherited from the parent at the time the scenario was created, as well as changes subsequently updated into the selected scenario from its parent. Together with any Pending Commits, this represents all recent user-initiated changes resulting in differences between the selected scenario and the Enterprise Data scenario.

For each scenario in your Scenarios pane, the changes in the scenario can be viewed along with details of each change, such as the user who made the change, the type of action that resulted in the change, and the field values affected by the change. These changes are viewed through the scenario properties.

► View the differences between a scenario and its parent

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select a scenario.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. To see changes made in the scenario, in the scenario properties, click the **Data Changes (Pending Commits)** tab.
4. To see changes made in the parent scenario, click the **Pending Updates** tab.

**Notes:**

- Information is displayed on the **Pending Updates** tab only if you have access to the scenario's parent.
- In some cases, data changes made using automated processes, such as workbook commands, are not listed on the Data Changes (Pending Commits) tab. If automated processes have been used to update data, a summary of the changes appears in the Activity Log.
- Changes older than a certain age (45 days by default, but this number can be changed by an administrator) no longer appear on the Data Changes (Pending Commits) tab or the Pending Updates tab.
- These tabs might not be able to display data for a scenario with thousands of changes, due to memory limits. In this case, your RapidResponse Administrator can adjust the limit.



Tip: To access scenario properties, you can also click **Properties**  on the **Scenarios** pane toolbar.

► **View the differences between a scenario and the Enterprise Data scenario**

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select a scenario.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. In the scenario properties, click the **Inherited Data Changes** tab. This shows all changes brought into this scenario from its parent (that is, changes updated in another scenario).
4. Click the **Data Changes (Pending Commits)** tab. This shows all changes made to this scenario.

**Notes:**

- This shows all recent user-initiated changes between a scenario and the Enterprise Data scenario. It does not include any changes resulting from data updates from your host system or automatically made by custom applications.
- Changes older than a certain age (45 days by default, but this number can be changed by an administrator) no longer appear on the Inherited Data Changes tab or the Data Changes (Pending Commits) tab.
- Information is displayed on this tab only if you have access to the scenario's parent.
- These tabs might not be able to display data for a scenario with thousands of changes, due to memory limits. In this case, your RapidResponse Administrator can adjust the limit.



Tip: To access the scenario properties, you can also click **Properties**  on the **Scenarios** pane toolbar.

View conflicting data changes in a scenario

In some cases, you and another user might modify the same records in a scenario and its parent. For example, you might increase the quantity of a demand record in a scenario that another user decreases

the quantity of in the parent scenario. In these cases, the changes in the scenarios conflict, and one of the changes will be overwritten when you update the scenario.

Conflicts can result from the following:

- **Modify**—You and another user modify the same record in the scenario and its parent. When you update the scenario, the value in the parent scenario overwrites your change.
- **Insert**—You and another user insert records with the same key field values in the scenario and its parent. When you update the scenario, the values in the parent scenario's record overwrite the values in your record.
- **Delete**—Either you modify a record that another user deletes in the parent, or you delete a record that another user modifies in the parent. When the scenario is updated, the record is deleted.

You can view the conflicting changes in the scenario's properties to see which changes will be overwritten and the values the records will have after you update the scenario. You can also see the values that are overwritten, and which scenario the overwritten records are in. Some conflicting changes are shown in the following illustration.

Start x Expedited Shipping x											
General Activity Log Inherited Data Changes Pending Updates Data Changes (Pending Commits) Pending Update Conflicting Changes											
	Record				Type of Change	After Update		Changes to be Lost			
	Table	Namespace	Field	Value		Field	Value	Field	New Value	Old Value	Scenario
1	InventoryTransfer	Mfg	Id	12/24/2014 11:19:39 AM	Modify	TransferCost	650	TransferCost	1200	700	This scenario
2			Part.Name	Workstation							
3			Part.Site.Value	AmeriComp							
4			TransferPart.Name	Workstation							
5			TransferPart.Site.Value	600							
6	InventoryTransfer	Mfg	Id	12/24/2014 11:20:12 AM	Delete						This scenario
7			Part.Name	Workstation							
8			Part.Site.Value	AmeriComp							
9			TransferPart.Name	Workstation							
10			TransferPart.Site.Value	600							

Information is displayed on this tab only if you have access to the scenario's parent.

► View conflicting data changes

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select a scenario that is out of date with its parent.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. In the scenario properties, click the **Pending Update Conflicting Changes** tab. This shows all the changes that conflict between the scenario and its parent.



Tip: With a scenario selected, you can also view the scenario properties by clicking **Properties** on the **Scenarios** pane toolbar.

Update data in a scenario

The data in a parent scenario might change as you perform your analysis in your scenario. You can update the data in your scenario with the data in the parent scenario. Scenarios that are out of date with

their parent are identified with an exclamation mark .

You should update a scenario if you require the most recent data from its parent. For example, if a change has been made to a group of parts, you might want to update your scenario to determine how that change has impacted your simulation, or to ensure any data you modify is up to date.

You can update a shared scenario if you have Modify access to the scenario and you have access to the scenario's parent.

Before you update the scenario, you can view the changes that will be made on the Pending Updates tab of the scenario properties. You can also view any conflicts, which are changes that have been made to the same records in the scenario and its parent, on the Pending Update Conflicting Changes tab of the scenario properties. For more information about these tabs, see ["Track data changes in a scenario" on page 468](#) and ["View conflicting data changes in a scenario" on page 469](#).

If you update a scenario that has conflicting changes in its parent, you are warned about the conflicts, and have the choice to overwrite your changes with the changes in the parent, or to cancel the update. If you cancel the update, you can view the conflicts in the scenario's properties.

Some scenarios should not be updated. For example, a scenario that contains historical data will always be out of date with its parent, but updating it removes the historical data. Before you update a scenario, you should determine what changes would be made by the update, and then proceed with the update only if the scenario needs updating.

► **Determine what changes are being updated**

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select the scenario that needs updating.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. In the scenario properties, click the **Pending Updates** tab.

► **Determine what changes conflict with the parent scenario**

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select the scenario that needs updating.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. In the scenario properties, click the **Pending Update Conflicting Changes** tab.

► **Update a scenario**

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select the scenario that needs updating.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. On the scenario properties toolbar, click **Update** .
4. If you have any unsaved data changes in the scenario you are updating, you are asked whether you want to save them. Do one of the following:
 - To save your changes and then update the scenario, click **Yes**.
 - To discard your changes and then update the scenario, click **No**.
 - To continue editing data in this scenario without saving your changes or updating the scenario, click **Cancel**.
5. If you see the **Conflicting Data Changes** dialog box, the changes made in the parent scenario conflict with the changes in your scenario. Do one of the following:

- To update the scenario and overwrite your changes with changes from the parent scenario, click **Yes**.
- To cancel the update, click **No**.



Notes:

- You can also update scenarios identified with a yellow exclamation mark . These scenarios are children of a scenario that had its changes discarded. For more information, see ["Discard changes in a scenario" on page 472](#).
- Each scenario consumes system memory across your entire RapidResponse system. An excess number of scenarios, particularly out-of-date (historical) scenarios, can degrade RapidResponse system performance. Consider updating scenarios that have not been updated for a significant amount of time.



Tips:

- You can also click **Properties** on the **Scenarios** pane toolbar.
- You can also click **Scenarios** on the RapidResponse toolbar and then click **Update Scenario**, click **Update** on the **Scenario** pane toolbar, or click **Update** on the **Actions** menu.
- You can specify that shared scenarios you own update whenever the data in their parent changes. For more information, see ["Automatically update a scenario" on page 485](#).

Discard changes in a scenario

You might want to discard changes you made in a scenario if:

- You have made changes in a scenario that you want to revert. For example, your changes might have corrupted data and made the scenario unsuitable for use.
- You see a yellow exclamation mark on a scenario, which indicates that changes in the scenario's parent have been discarded, making the parent and child scenarios out of sync.

When you discard changes in a child scenario, all changes are deleted, and any changes made to the parent scenario since you created the child scenario are applied. The parent and child scenarios are now the same.

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select a scenario. You must own a scenario to discard changes.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Discard All Changes**.
3. If desired, in the **Discard All Changes** dialog box, in the **Subject** text box, type the subject of the message that is displayed in the scenario's **Activity Log**.
4. In the **Message** text box, type a summary of the changes that will be discarded.
You can add a link to a report in the message. For more information, see ["Send a resource link" on page 442](#).
5. If you want to send the message to owners of child scenarios, select the **Notify the owners of child scenarios** check box.
This check box is available only if child scenarios owned by someone other than yourself exist.



Cautions:

- After discarding all changes, the data will be identical to the data in the parent scenario. Changes in any child scenarios will also need to be discarded if those scenarios are to be synchronized with their parent scenario.
- When you synchronize child scenarios with a changed parent scenario, all changes made in the child scenarios are lost.



Tip: You can also discard changes in a scenario with the yellow exclamation mark  by clicking **Update** on the **Actions** menu.

Export scenario activity

You can export the information on the Inherited Data Changes, Pending Updates, Data Changes (Pending Commits), and Pending Update Data Conflicts tabs of any scenario's properties. You can use this information to make changes to the data in your enterprise data system, or to distribute reports about the data that is being modified in RapidResponse.

You can also create a report showing the data on the General, the Activity Log, and, optionally, the Data Changes (Pending Commits) tab of the scenario properties. This report can include just the changes you have made, or the changes made by every person working on the scenario. If you export the report, you can distribute it to the people who require it. However, you can also automatically distribute it, as discussed in ["Generate and distribute a report of your actions" on page 540](#).

You can export the scenario's actions as any of the following file types:

- A Microsoft Excel file, which opens in Microsoft Excel.
- A tab-delimited text file, which opens in any word processor.
- A PDF file which can be opened in a PDF viewer such as Adobe Reader or Preview for Mac OS.
- An HTML file, which opens in a Web browser.
- An XML file, which opens in a Web browser or word processor.

► Export a scenario's activities

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, click the scenario you want to export activities for.
2. On the **File** menu, click **Properties**.
3. In the scenario properties, click one of the following tabs:
 - **Inherited Data Changes**
 - **Pending Updates**
 - **Data Changes (Pending Commits)**
 - **Pending Update Conflicting Changes**
4. On the **Data** menu, click **Export Data**.
5. In the **Export Data** dialog box, navigate to the location where you want to save the file.
6. In the **File name** box, type a name for the file.
You should include the scenario's name in the file name.
7. In the **Files of type** list, click the type of file you want to save.

8. In the **Export** area, ensure **Active view** is selected.
9. If you do not want the report to include column headers, clear the **Include column headers** check box, if applicable.
10. If you do not want the report to include formatting, clear the **Include formatting** check box, if applicable.
11. Click **OK**.
12. Once the file is saved, you are given the option to open the file or the folder where the file is saved. If you do not want to do either, click **Cancel**.



Tip: You can also export data by clicking **Export Data**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.

► Generate a report of actions

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, click the scenario you want to generate the report for.
2. On the **File** menu, click **Properties**.
3. On the **Data** menu, click **Export Data**.
4. In the **Export Data** dialog box, navigate to the location where you want to save the file.
5. In the **File name** box, type a name for the file.
You should include the scenario's name in the file name.
6. In the **Files of type** list, click one of the following file types:
 - Microsoft Excel Workbook (*.xlsx) - Mac OS only (version 2008-2019)
 - Microsoft Excel Workbook (*.xlsx) - Windows only (version 2007-2019)
 - Microsoft Excel 97-2004 Workbook (*.xls) - Mac OS only
 - Microsoft Excel 97-2003 Workbook (*.xls) - Windows only
 - XML Document (*.xml)
7. In the **Export** area, click **Activity report**.
8. If you want the report to include data changes that should be made in your enterprise data sources, select the **Include pending data change details** check box, and then click one of the following:
 - **All changes**—Includes changes made by every user with access to the scenario.
 - **My changes**—Includes only the changes you have made.
9. Click **OK**.



Tip: You can create a report and automatically distribute it to the people collaborating on the scenario by clicking **Distribute Activity Report**  on the scenario properties toolbar. For more information, see ["Generate and distribute a report of your actions" on page 540](#).

Commit data changes to a parent scenario

When you have completed a simulation, you might want to modify the parent scenario to reflect the changes you have made. This can be important in situations where others need access to the results of the simulation, such as when you are participating in a collaborative effort to determine a solution to a business problem. For more information, see ["Commit a scenario in a collaboration" on page 540](#).

Committing data changes to a scenario incorporates data changes made in a child scenario back into the parent scenario from which it was derived.

Deleting or keeping the child scenario

Typically, when you commit the changes made in a child scenario back into its parent, you have the option to either delete the child scenario or keep it. If your RapidResponse administrator has designated a scenario as permanent, you will not be able to delete it when you commit the changes. To see if a scenario is permanent, review the **General** tab in the scenario's properties.

Deleting the child scenario on commit

If you delete the child scenario when committing it, the child scenario and any child scenarios it might have are removed from the Scenarios pane. The child scenario's Activity Log entries are moved into the parent's Activity Log.

Sometimes deleting a scenario affects other scenarios, users, or resources. Before you confirm your decision to commit and delete the scenario, you are warned if:

- The scenario has child scenarios.
- The scenario or its children are currently being used by other users.
- You own alerts or scheduled tasks based on the scenario or its children.

If you own alerts and scheduled tasks that use the scenario you are committing or its children, you will be prompted to delete or keep these resources. If you keep these resources, they will not function until you modify them to use another scenario. You are not warned about alerts and scheduled tasks owned by other users that use the scenario that you are committing or its children. These alerts and scheduled tasks are always kept.

You can choose to close any resources that are currently using the scenario or leave those resources open after it is deleted. If you choose to leave the resources open, the scenario's data is removed from view. For example, if the scenario is being used in a workbook, the scenario name is shown in the scenario control with the  icon, but no records from the scenario are visible.

In the illustration below, the scenario Supply Shortage is deleted when its changes are committed to Approved Actions:



Keeping the child scenario on commit

If you keep the child scenario, it is not removed from the Scenarios pane. No changes are made to the structure of the scenario tree. The scenario's data changes and Activity Log are committed into its parent, and the two scenarios then have the same data. The child scenario's Activity Log contains only a Commit message.

In the illustration below, the scenario Supply Shortage is kept when its changes are committed to Approved Actions:



Preparing to commit a scenario

In order to commit a scenario, the following three conditions must be met:

- One of the following is true:
 - You own the child scenario.
 - The child scenario is a permanent scenario that has been shared with you, giving you Modify permission.
- The child scenario is up-to-date with the parent scenario. If it is not, you must update the child. Before updating the child, you should review the changes that have been made in the parent, because the update could invalidate the changes you made. For more information, see ["Track data changes in a scenario" on page 468](#).
- You have Modify access to the parent scenario (that is, it is either one of your private scenarios, or a shared scenario to which you have Modify permissions). Shared scenarios to which you do not have Modify access are represented by a blue icon with a lock 🔒.

Before you commit the scenario, you can view the changes that will be made by viewing the Scenario Properties workbook. For more information, see ["Track data changes in a scenario" on page 468](#).

Respond to a scenario

After viewing a scenario's properties or performing some operations to solve the problem, you can add a response to the scenario. This response allows you to keep notes about what you have done, and provides the collaboration leader with a record of your actions. Depending on how you shared the scenario, you might have response notifications already set up. For more information, see ["Share a scenario" on page 486](#) and ["Scenario notifications" on page 491](#).

1. On the **Scenario Properties** tab, click **Respond** .
2. In the **Respond** dialog box, in the **Response** area click one of the following:
 - **Note**—Allows you to tell the collaboration leader what you are doing.
 - **Accept**—Indicates you have solved your portion of the problem.
 - **Reject**—Indicates your portion of the problem cannot be solved.
3. In the **Subject** and **Message** text boxes, specify the message informing the collaboration leader of what you are doing.
4. If you are the scenario owner, select the **Notify everyone who can access this scenario** check box if you want to send the message to each member of the action team.



Note: The message specified in this dialog box is shown on the **General** and **Activity Log** tabs of the **Scenario Properties** tab.



Tip: You can also click **Respond** on the **Actions** menu.

For more information about creating and committing scenarios, see ["Create a scenario" on page 482](#) and ["Commit data changes to a parent scenario" on page 474](#).

Add notes about a scenario

You can add notes to a scenario to help you track changes that you made. Notes are especially useful when you share the scenario with other users to collaborate on a solution to a particular problem.

Anybody with access to a scenario can add a note for any purpose. Notes are visible on the scenario properties General and Activity Log tabs. The General tab shows the most recent note added by a collaborator. The Activity Log tab shows every note added to the scenario. When a note is selected, the note's message displays in the box at the bottom of the scenario properties.

► Add a note

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select a scenario.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. On the scenario properties toolbar, click **Respond** .
4. In the **Response** area, click **Note**.
5. In the **Subject** box, type a subject for the message.
6. In the **Message** box, type the message.
7. Optionally, add a link in the message, click **Add Link**  and select the type of link to add:
 - An open report.
 - A report you have access to.
 - A typed web page address.
8. Optionally, check **Notify everyone who can access this scenario** to inform them of the response you are making.

This option is only available to the scenario owner and anyone who the scenario has been shared with.



Note: Any notes you add include the date and time information of when the note was added. The date and time on your computer is used. For any automatically generated notes, such as when you create or share a scenario, the date and time on the computer where RapidResponse is hosted is used.



Tip: You can also click **Properties**  on the **Scenarios** pane toolbar.

► Read a note

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select a scenario.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. In the scenario properties, click the **General** or **Activity Log** tab, and then click a note.
The message displays at the bottom of the **General** or **Activity Log** tab.

Change a scenario's status

As you work through a collaboration, you can keep the status of its scenarios updated. This can be especially useful if you will be generating a report of the scenario actions taken in the collaboration. For more information, see ["Generate and distribute a report of your actions" on page 540](#).

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select the scenario used in the collaboration, and then on the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
2. In the scenario properties, on the **General** tab, select a **Status** from the list:
 - **In Progress**—Work in the scenario is still in progress.
 - **Suspended**—Work in the scenario is on hold until further notice.
 - **Completed**—Work in the scenario is finished, and a solution was found.
 - **Cancelled**—Work in the scenario is finished, but no solution was found.
3. In the **Change Scenario Status** dialog box, optionally change the subject in the **Subject** text box, and type information related to the status change in the **Details** area.
4. To send a message about the status change to all users with access to the scenario, select the **Notify everyone who can access this scenario** check box.
5. Click **Save**  on the toolbar to save the changes and send the notification message.



Note: The **Notify everyone who can access this scenario** check box is disabled for private scenarios.



Tip: You can also access scenario properties by clicking **Properties**  on the **Scenarios** pane toolbar.

Undo scenario property changes

You can undo all changes made to a scenario's properties since the last save. Changes to a scenario's properties cannot be undone once saved.

- With the scenario properties open, on the **Edit** menu, click **Undo Data Changes**.

Save scenario property changes

If there are unsaved changes to a scenario's properties, an asterisk * displays on the scenario properties. Until the changes are saved, the buttons on the scenario properties toolbar are inactive, and all buttons but **New Scenario**  and **Properties**  are inactive on the Scenarios pane. The Help  button is always active.

- On the **File** menu, click **Save Data**.



Note: You can also click **Save**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.

Distributing a scenario activity report

If you want to distribute an activity report detailing activities in the scenario that you are committing, you can do this from the scenario properties before you commit it. You can also generate a report during the process of committing the scenario. Either way, this report can be sent to each colleague who responded to the scenario, or just to yourself. You can also choose to include the list of data changes made in the scenario, and optionally customize the data in the report for each recipient. The report is sent as an attachment to a message, which is delivered to the specified recipients. For more information, see ["Generate and distribute a report of your actions" on page 540](#) or ["Export scenario activity" on page 473](#).

► Determine what changes are being committed

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select the scenario containing the data changes you want to commit.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. In the scenario properties, click the **Data Changes (Pending Commits)** tab.

► Commit a scenario

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select the scenario containing the data changes you want to commit.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. If the scenario is out of date with its parent, review the changes, and then on the scenario properties toolbar, click **Update** .
4. On the scenario properties toolbar, click **Commit** .
5. In the **Commit Scenario** dialog box, click one of the following to indicate what you want to do with the scenario after you commit it:
 - **Delete this scenario**—The scenario being committed is deleted. Any child scenarios based on the scenario being committed are also deleted.
 - **Keep this scenario**—The scenario being committed is kept. No changes are made to the scenario tree.
6. If you chose to delete the scenario and you want to close the resources that are using the scenario, select the **Close all resources that are using this scenario** check box.

This check box is available only if at least one open resource is using the scenario or one of its child scenarios.

7. If desired, in the **Commit Scenario** dialog box, in the **Subject** text box, edit the subject of the message that is displayed in the parent scenario's **Activity Log**.
8. In the **Message** box, type a description of what changes were made in the committed scenario. You can also include any information people might find useful, such as what should be done next or when you expect to finish your part of a collaboration. This message could also contain notes for transferring the changes back to your host system.

You can add a link to a report in the message. For more information, see ["Send a resource link" on page 442](#).

The message text can be viewed in the scenario properties. The message text is also available in a **Message Center** message if the user who shared the scenario requested notifications.

9. If you are committing into a collaborative scenario and have finished your part of the collaboration, select the **Add response** check box, and then click one of the following:
 - **Accept**—You have solved your part of the problem.
 - **Reject**—You could not solve your part of the problem.

10. If you do not want to send a report of the scenario activity to anyone, click **OK** to finish committing the scenario, and omit all the remaining steps in this procedure.

If you want to send a report of the scenario activity to yourself or members of the collaboration team, click the **Activity Report** tab, select the **Distribute the activity report to** check box, and then click one of the following:

- **Everyone who has responded to this scenario**—Sends a copy of the activity report to the collaborators who have added a response. Anybody the scenario is shared with, but who has not responded, is not sent a copy of the report.
 - **Me**—Sends a copy of the activity report only to you.
11. If you want to include the information on the **Data Changes (Pending Commits)** tab in the activity report, select the **Include pending data change details** check box, and then click one of the following:
 - **All changes**—Each recipient receives a report that contains changes made by every user with access to the scenario.
 - **Only changes made by the report recipient**—Each recipient receives a report that contains only the changes they made.

12. In the **File name** box, type the name for the report file.

13. In the **File type** box, click the type of file you want to save the report as.

Only Microsoft Excel Workbook (*.xlsx and *.xls) and XML Document (*.xml) formats are supported.



Note: Some resources close automatically after a scenario they were using is deleted, including scorecards that will have their only scenarios deleted, workbooks with scenario comparison columns, and scenario properties windows.



Tips:

- You also access the scenario properties by clicking **Properties**  on the **Scenarios** pane.
- You can also commit a scenario by clicking **Commit**  on the scenario properties toolbar, clicking **Commit** on the **Actions** menu, or clicking **Scenarios**  on the RapidResponse toolbar and then clicking **Commit Scenario**.

CHAPTER 34: Managing scenarios

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If you have simulation permissions in RapidResponse, you can perform actions to manage scenarios. These can include:

- **Creating a new scenario**—If you have permission to create scenarios, you can create as many scenarios as you need to simulate data changes. For more information, see ["Create a scenario" on page 482](#) and ["Create a scenario with a perspective applied" on page 499](#).
- **Making changes to a scenario**—You can make changes to a scenario that you own. Changes can include editing its name or its purpose. For more information, see ["Rename a scenario" on page 483](#) and ["Change a scenario's purpose" on page 483](#).
- **Deleting a scenario**—It is good practice to delete a scenario that you own if it is no longer needed. Be careful when deleting shared scenarios, because there is a risk of deleting someone else's work. For more information, see ["Delete a scenario" on page 484](#).
- **Updating scenario**—Some scenarios are updated automatically when changes are made to their parent scenarios, while other scenarios must be updated manually when changes are made to the parent scenario. Keeping scenarios up-to-date helps you to ensure that you are working with the most current data. For more information, see ["Update data in a scenario" on page 470](#) and ["Update a scenario with a perspective applied" on page 501](#).
- **Sharing scenarios**—You might be able to share scenarios with other users, so that a group of RapidResponse users can collaborate to solve a business problem. You can give others permission to view a scenario, or to both view and edit it. For more information, see ["Share a scenario" on page 486](#).
- **Giving scenarios**—You can transfer ownership of a scenario to another user. You might do this if someone else is taking over a task that you have been working on, or if you want someone else to share a scenario for you. (Some users can create scenarios, but not share them.) For more information, see ["Give a scenario" on page 494](#).

Scenarios and RapidResponse system performance

Each scenario consumes system memory across your entire RapidResponse system. An excess number of scenarios, particularly out-of-date (historical) scenarios, can degrade RapidResponse system performance. Scenario management is a task for RapidResponse administrators. They can delete any scenario. They can also set rules to automatically delete scenarios that have not been used for a specified amount of time.

As a RapidResponse user, consider deleting scenarios you own but no longer use. Also consider updating scenarios that have not been updated for a significant amount of time. You can also have scenarios set to be automatically updated.

Create a scenario

If you have permission to create scenarios, you can create as many scenarios as you need to simulate data changes. Each scenario that you create must be based on another scenario that you own or have access to. For more information, see ["Scenarios in RapidResponse" on page 17](#) and ["Simulating business changes" on page 461](#).

You might be able to apply a perspective to the new scenario to modify control table settings and RapidResponse calculations. If your RapidResponse administrators have defined perspectives, you can choose one during scenario creation. If no perspectives have been defined, the perspective control is not shown. Perspectives can only be applied when the scenario is created and cannot be removed. For more information, see ["About perspectives" on page 497](#).

Specifying a purpose for the new scenario can help to avoid confusion. While it is optional, specifying a purpose is good practice, particularly if you intend to share the scenario with other users.

1. On the **File** menu, point to **New**, and then click **Scenario**.
2. In the **Scenario name** box, type the name of the scenario.
3. In the **Based on** list, click the scenario on which the new scenario should be based (the parent scenario).
4. In the **Purpose** box, type a description of the changes being simulated in the scenario.



Notes:

- You cannot own two private scenarios with the same name, and two shared scenarios with the same name cannot exist on a RapidResponse system. In some RapidResponse systems that were upgraded from RapidResponse 2014.4 (or earlier), scenario names might need to be unique.
- If you create a scenario from the **File** menu or the RapidResponse toolbar while using a workbook, the scenario you create is automatically selected in the workbook. If the workbook contains multi-scenario columns, the scenario you create replaces one of the scenarios in the workbook. For more information, see ["View data from multiple scenarios" on page 159](#).



Tip: You can also create a new scenario by clicking **New Scenario**  on the **Scenarios** pane toolbar, or clicking **Scenarios**  on the RapidResponse toolbar and selecting **New Scenario** .

Change a scenario's purpose

You can change the purpose of any scenario you own. For example, if new goals are required, or if a previous goal was found to be unattainable, you can change the purpose to reflect the new goal or to remove the unobtainable goal.

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select a scenario.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. In the scenario properties, on the **General** tab, type a purpose in the **Purpose** text box.



Tip: You also access the scenario properties by clicking **Properties**  on the **Scenarios** pane.

Rename a scenario

You can rename any private scenario you own. You can rename scenarios using the scenarios pane, and you also have an opportunity to rename a private scenario when you give it to another user or share it for the first time. For more information, see ["Share a scenario" on page 486](#) and ["Give a scenario" on page 494](#).

If you rename a scenario that is currently used by an open workbook, you will be prompted to save any unsaved changes in the workbook. After you rename a scenario that is currently in use, the  icon will be shown beside the scenario's former name in the scenario control and records from this scenario will no longer be visible. To view records from the renamed scenario, use the scenario control to select the scenario's new name.

If you own resources (that is, alerts, scheduled tasks, or automation chains) that use the scenario you are attempting to rename, you are prompted to delete or keep these resources. If you keep the resources, you must modify them to use the scenario's new name to allow them to continue functioning as they did before you renamed the scenario.

► Rename a scenario in the Scenarios pane

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select the scenario you want to rename.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Rename**.
3. In the **Rename Scenario** dialog box, type a new name for the scenario, and then click **OK**.

► Rename a scenario by modifying its properties

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select the scenario you want to rename.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. In the scenario properties, on the **General** tab, type a new name in the **Scenario** text box.
4. On the **File** menu, click **Save Data**.



Tips:

- You cannot rename a shared scenario using these procedures. However, if you have permission to create scripts, you can rename shared scenarios using the **rename** method in a



RapidResponse script. For more information, see the [RapidResponse Scripting Guide](#).

- You can also rename a scenario by right-clicking it in the **Scenarios** pane and then clicking **Rename**, or by double-clicking on a scenario in the **Scenarios** pane.

Delete a scenario

You can delete scenarios that you own, whether private or shared, as long as a system administrator has not made them permanent.

When you delete a scenario, all of its child scenarios are also deleted, including child scenarios that belong to other users.

You can choose to close any reports that are currently using a deleted scenario, or leave them open. If you choose to leave the reports open, the scenario is removed from view. For example, if the scenario is being used in a workbook, the scenario is shown in the scenario control with the  icon, and no records from the scenario are visible.

Each scenario consumes system memory across your entire RapidResponse system. An excess number of scenarios, particularly out-of-date (historical) scenarios, can degrade RapidResponse system performance. Consider deleting scenarios you own but no longer use.

Considerations when deleting a scenario

Sometimes deleting a scenario affects other scenarios, users, or resources. Before you confirm the deletion, you are warned if :

- The scenario has child scenarios.
- The scenario or its children are currently being used by other users.
- You own alerts, scheduled tasks, or automation chains that use the scenario.

If you own resources (that is, alerts, scheduled tasks, or automation chains) that use the scenario you are deleting, you are prompted to delete or keep these resources. If you keep the resources, they will not function until you modify them to use another scenario. Resources owned by other users that use the scenario are kept automatically and you are not warned about them.

Other users are not warned if you delete the parent of one of their scenarios or if you delete a scenario that they are using in an open report. Deleted scenarios are removed from their view, just as your scenarios are removed from your view when you delete them. They do not have an opportunity to save their work or prevent scenarios from being deleted.

► Delete a scenario

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select a scenario.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. On the scenario properties toolbar, click **Delete** .
4. If you want to close the resources that use the scenario, in the **Confirm Delete Scenario** dialog box, select the **Close all resources that are using this scenario** check box.

This check box is available only if at least one open resource is using the scenario or one of its child scenarios.

5. Click **Yes**.

The selected scenario and all of its child scenarios are deleted.



Note: Some resources close automatically after a scenario they were using is deleted, including scorecards that will have their only scenarios deleted, workbooks with scenario comparison columns, and scenario properties windows.



Tip: You can also click **Delete** on the **Actions** menu, or click **Delete**  on the **Scenarios** pane toolbar.

Automatically update a scenario

You can specify that any shared scenario you own be automatically updated when data changes in its parent. Automatic updates can be used to ensure a simulation always uses the most recent data.

If a scenario updates automatically, any changes in the parent that conflict with your changes in the scenario will overwrite your changes automatically.

► Make a scenario update automatically

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select a shared scenario that you own.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. In the scenario properties, on the **General** tab, beside **Update**, select **Automatic**.



Notes:

- If the scenario has updates pending, it is updated when you select **Automatic**.
- You cannot make a private scenario update automatically.



Tip: You also access the scenario properties by clicking **Properties**  on the **Scenarios** pane.

► Make a scenario update manually

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select a shared scenario that you own.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. In the scenario properties, on the **General** tab, beside **Update**, select **Manual**.



Tip: You also access the scenario properties by clicking **Properties**  on the **Scenarios** pane.

Currency conversion rates in scenarios

When updated currency conversion rates are brought in to RapidResponse, the updated future and historical rates might not be reflected in your private scenarios. For example, if your scenario's parent does not automatically update, the updated rates might not be available to your scenario. In addition, you might want the updated rates, but not want to automatically update all records in the scenario.

If you want your scenario to receive the updated rates, you can contact your RapidResponse administrator and request to have your scenario added to the list of scenarios updated with the rates.

Share a scenario

You can share scenarios with other users if a RapidResponse administrator has granted you sharing permission. Sharing a scenario lets other users view and possibly modify the scenario. They can access it from the Scenario control in resources such as dashboards and workbooks. Users who can create their own scenarios will also see the scenario in their Scenarios pane and will be able to view its properties and create child scenarios based on the shared scenario.

When you share a scenario that you own with another user, you retain control over the scenario. You can stop sharing the scenario with that user at any time. You can also choose to be notified when others respond to the scenario or modify records in the scenario. Users with whom you share a scenario cannot modify the properties of the scenario, delete the scenario, prevent you from accessing the scenario, or give control of the scenario to someone else. If you want to give full control of a scenario to another user, see ["Give a scenario" on page 494](#).

You can delete shared scenarios that you own. For more information, see ["Delete a scenario" on page 484](#).

Sharing a scenario for the first time

All scenarios are private scenarios when they are created. When a scenario is private, it is shown in your Scenarios pane with a gray icon . When a scenario is shared for the first time, its icon in the Scenarios pane becomes blue .

When a scenario is shared, it can never become a private scenario again. It will always be shared with administrators. For more information, see ["Sharing scenarios with RapidResponse administrators only" on page 488](#).

Sharing scenarios when you are a resource author

If you have resource authoring permissions and you own resources that refer to a private scenario in their resource definitions, these resources will not function after you share the scenario. For example, sharing a scenario for the first time could cause an alert that monitors data in that scenario to fail when it tries to run.

This is because RapidResponse uses both the scenario name and the private or shared status of a scenario to identify it. A shared scenario and a private scenario can both have the same name, and RapidResponse can tell them apart by their private or shared status.

If sharing a scenario for the first time makes a resource stop functioning, you can fix the problem by updating the resource definition to use the shared scenario.

Renaming a scenario when you share it

If you are sharing a scenario for the first time—that is, if the scenario you are about to share is currently private—you can change the scenario name as part of the sharing process.

If no shared scenario with the same name exists yet, renaming the scenario is optional. If a shared scenario with the same name already exists, you are notified when you click OK in the Share Scenario dialog box, and you have an opportunity to type a different name for the scenario.

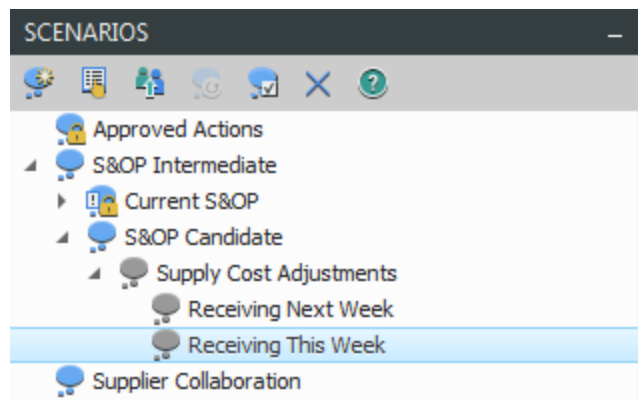
Giving permission to view or modify

When you share a scenario with another user, you can choose whether to allow them to view the scenario or allow them to modify the scenario. Users with view-only access cannot make any changes to the scenario or manually update the scenario. Users who have permission to modify the scenario can make changes to records in the scenario and commit child scenarios into it.

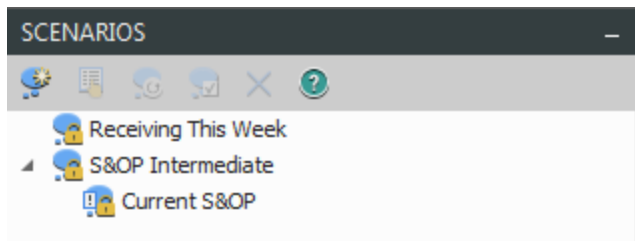
Sharing parent and child scenarios

When you share a scenario with others, they receive access to only the scenario you shared, and not to the scenario's parent or child scenarios. You can share the parent and child scenarios separately, as long as you have the required permission. Users who have access to parent and child scenarios can see the relationship between the scenarios.

For example, assume you are about to share a scenario named Receiving This Week, and that your scenario tree looks like this:



After you share the Receiving This Week scenario, the other user's scenario tree might look like this:



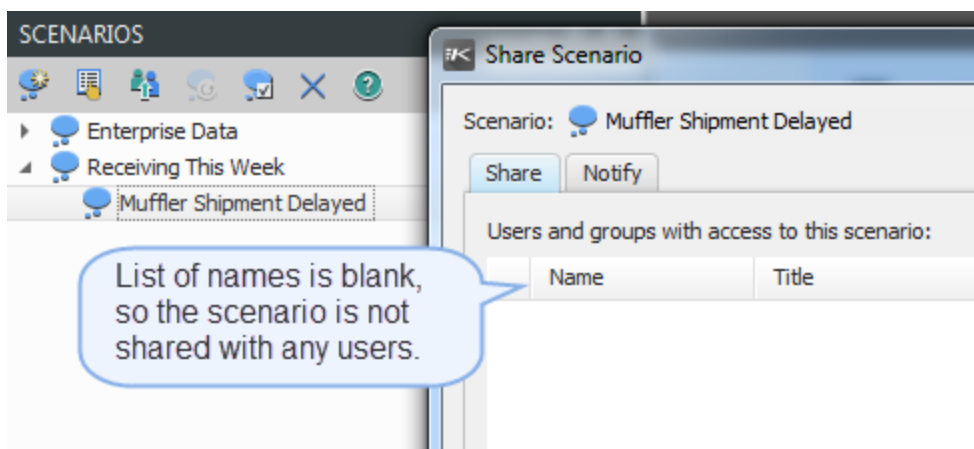
When you share a scenario without its parent, the users with whom you share the scenario cannot manually update the scenario.

Sharing scenarios with RapidResponse administrators only

You might want to share a scenario with RapidResponse administrators so they can make it permanent or so that they can have access to it for the purpose of coordinating processes. Any time you share a scenario with another user, it is shared with RapidResponse administrators too. If you want to share a scenario with administrators only, share the scenario but do not specify any users to share it with.

Sharing the scenario with RapidResponse administrators cannot be undone. Even if you initially specify other users to share the scenario with, then remove all the names from the **Share** list, you cannot make your scenario private again; administrators will always have access to it.

If a scenario's **Share** list is empty and the scenario icon is blue , it means the scenario is shared with RapidResponse administrators only.



In this example, the Muffler Shipment Delayed scenario is not shared with any users, so only you and system administrators can access it.

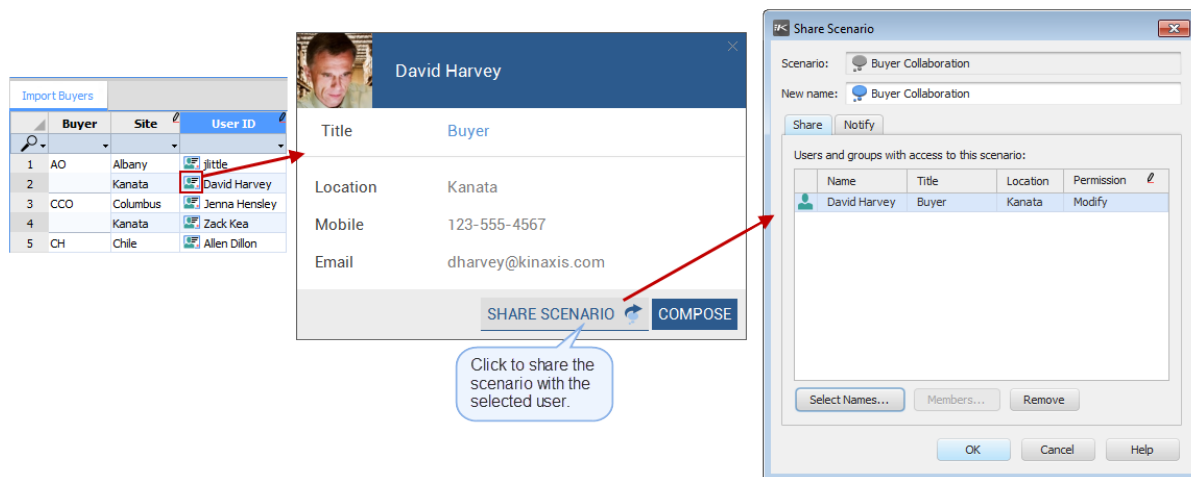
Sharing scenarios owned by other users

Depending on the permissions you have been granted, you might be able to share only the scenarios that you own, or any scenario that you have access to. When sharing a scenario you do not own, you can give view-only permission, but you cannot give other users permission to modify the scenario. The option to set up automatic notifications about the scenario is not available if you do not own the scenario.

Sharing scenarios from contact cards

Some workbook columns can contain IDs or names of RapidResponse users accompanied by buttons  that can be clicked to open the contact card for each listed user. Often, these columns are meant to show who is responsible for certain data, such as parts, and the contact cards can help you to quickly contact the right people to resolve issues. These buttons can also appear beside a user's name in a responsibility definition.

When the button is clicked, a pop-up displays the profile picture and contact information for the user whose name or ID appears in the cell. The pop-up contains a Scenario button that opens the Share Scenario dialog box, which can be used to share the current scenario with the user. The Share Scenario button appears only if you have permission to share scenarios.



Contact cards also contain a Compose button that can be used to send the user a message in RapidResponse Message Center. For more information, see ["Send a message from a contact card" on page 441](#).

► Share a scenario with other users

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select a scenario.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. On the scenario properties toolbar, click **Share** .

4. If applicable, type a new name for the scenario in the **New name** box. For more information, see ["Renaming a scenario when you share it" on page 487](#).
5. Click **Select Names**.
The **Select Names** dialog box opens.
6. On the **Users** tab, click the people you want, and then click one of the following:
 - **Modify**—people can change the data in the scenario by committing changes from other scenarios back into your scenario, or by editing the scenario directly if the user has permission to edit shared scenarios.
 - **View only**—people can view data in the scenario, but cannot change its data.To find out more about the people you can share scenarios with, move the pointer over their names.
7. On the **Groups** tab, click the groups you want, and then click one of the following:
 - **Modify**—group members can change the data in the scenario by committing changes from other scenarios back into your scenario, or by editing the scenario directly if the group member has permission to edit shared scenarios.
 - **View only**—group members can view data in the scenario, but cannot change its data.To review who belongs to a group, click the group, and then click **Members**.
8. Click **OK**.
9. If you want to send a message to people you are sharing the scenario with, click the **Notify** tab.
10. On the **Notify** tab, select the **Notify when given access to this scenario** check box, and then do the following:
 - In the **Subject** box, type the subject for the message sent to people given access to the scenario.
 - In the **Message** box, type the message sent to people given access to the scenario.
For more information, see ["Scenario notifications" on page 491](#).
11. To add a link to the message, click the location where you want to insert the link and click **Insert Link** . For more information, see ["Send a resource link" on page 442](#).

**Notes:**

- If you add a user's name to both the **View only** list and the **Modify** list, the user is granted the Modify permission.
- You cannot share a scenario with the "Modify" permission to users and groups who do not have the permission to edit data in shared scenarios.



Tip: In the **Select Names** dialog box you can search for a specific name by clicking inside the column that contains the names and typing the name you want to find. You can also use the * and ? wildcards to search for text fragments and use the arrow keys to scroll through the items in the box that match the search criteria. To close the search box that displays at the top of the dialog box, press **ESC**.

► **Share a scenario with RapidResponse administrators only**

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select a scenario.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. On the scenario properties toolbar, click **Share** .

The **Share** dialog box opens.

4. Click **OK**.

► **Stop sharing a scenario with other users**

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select a scenario.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. On the scenario properties toolbar, click **Share** .
4. In the **Share** pane, select the users or groups whom you no longer want to share the scenario with.
5. Click **Remove**.

The user or group is removed from the **Share** list.

► **Change if a scenario is shared as view-only or modifiable**

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select a scenario.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. On the scenario properties toolbar, click **Share** .
4. Select the users or groups for whom you want to change the scenario permission, ensuring you click in the **Permissions** column.
5. Click the down arrow button, and then select a permission from the list.



Note: Certain S&OP scenarios are automatically shared upon creation. In these scenarios, you may see **Manage** as a scenario permission in addition to **View only** and **Modify**. This means the user has the same power as a system admin to manage that scenario, including toggling the permanent flag or setting it to update automatically. You can reduce a user's permission from **Manage** to **View only** or **Modify**, but you cannot give **Manage** permission to a user who currently has **View only** or **Modify** permission.



Tip: You can also click **Scenarios**  on the RapidResponse toolbar and then click **Share**, click **Share**  on the **Scenarios** pane toolbar, or click **Share** on the **Actions** menu.

Scenario notifications

When you share a scenario, you can choose to be notified in Message Center when users you have shared it with respond to the scenario. You can be notified when:

Everyone has responded—a message is sent when every user with access to the scenario responds to the scenario or modifies data in the scenario. Select this option when you want to know when all users have feedback on the scenario.

Anyone responds—a message is sent when any user with access to the scenario (excluding yourself) responds to the scenario or modifies data in the scenario. Select this option when you want to know everything that happens with the scenario.

Anyone modifies in this scenario—sends a message when any user commits a child scenario or modifies data in the scenario. Select this option if you only want to know when data has been modified in the scenario.

For more information, see ["Share a scenario" on page 486](#).

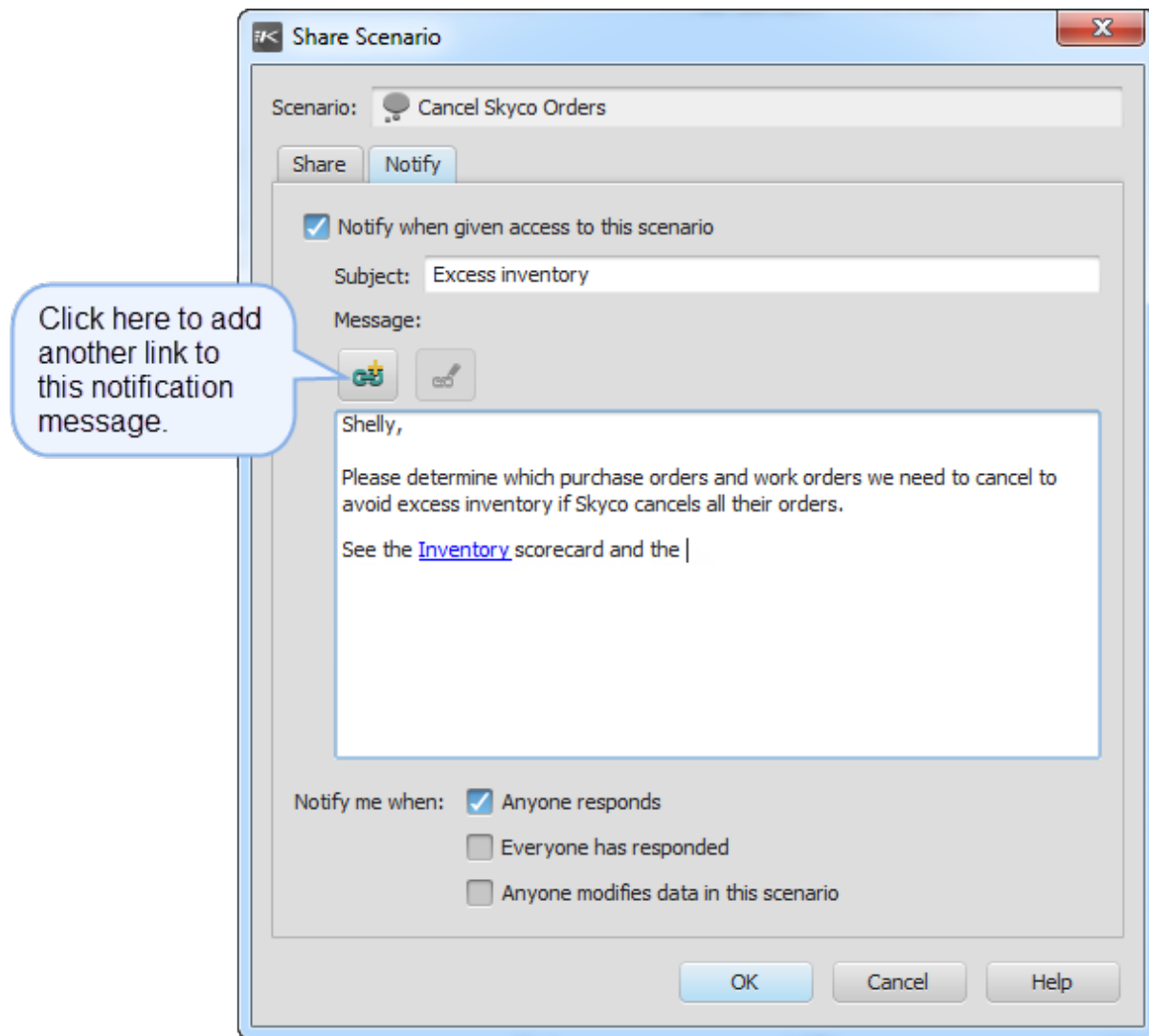
► **Specify notification options**

1. In the **Share Scenario** dialog box, click the **Notify** tab.
2. Select the **Notify when given access to this scenario** check box.
3. In the **Subject** and **Message** text boxes, type the message that is sent to the people the scenario has been shared with.
4. In the **Notify me when** area, select any of the notification options outlined above.
If you select both the **Anyone responds** and **Anyone modifies data in this scenario** options, you receive only one message when someone modifies data or commits a child scenario.

Add links to scenario notifications

You can add additional information to scenario notification messages by adding links to resources with the data context you specify. Message recipients can open the resource with the data settings that you set. You can also include links to RapidResponse forms or to websites.

The following illustration shows a link added to a notification message when sharing a scenario.



To view the data, users require permission to all of the resources you are using to display the data.

► Insert a link

1. In the **Message** area, click the location where you want to insert the link.
2. Click **Insert Link**
3. In the **Insert Link** dialog box, select one of the following:
 - **An open report**—inserts a link to a currently opened shared workbook or scorecard.
 - **Report**—inserts a link to any shared dashboard, workbook, or scorecard.
 - **Form**—inserts a link to a form.
 - **Web page**—inserts a link to a web page outside of RapidResponse.
4. If you are inserting a link to a report or a form, select the report or form from the drop-down list.
5. Click **Next**.
6. Optionally, in the **Add Link** text box, change the default text that displays as the link in the message.
7. In the worksheet list, select the worksheet you want to open.

8. To define the data that is displayed, select the check boxes you want, and click an item in the corresponding lists.

► **Edit a link**

1. In the **Message** box, select the link and click **Edit Link**.
2. Make your changes and then click **OK**.

Remove access to a scenario

If you have shared a scenario with a user or group, and you no longer want that person or group to have access to that scenario, you can remove them from the list of people the scenario is shared with. You might do this prevent people from accessing sensitive information that they no longer require access to. You can also reduce clutter in other users' scenario panes by removing access to unneeded scenarios.

► **Remove access to a scenario**

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select a scenario.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**
3. On the scenario properties toolbar, click **Share** .
4. In the **Share Scenario** dialog box, click a user or group in the **Name** column, and then click **Remove**.



Tip: You can also click **Share**  on the **Scenarios** pane toolbar.

Give a scenario

You can give scenarios you own to another user who has permission to create scenarios. You might give a scenario if you are no longer responsible for maintaining it, you are changing job functions, or you created it for another user. The user to whom you give the scenario becomes the owner of the scenario, though if the scenario is shared, you can choose to retain access to the scenario. Shared scenarios can only be given to recipients who also have permission to share scenarios.

If you want to give another user access to a scenario but still want to maintain control over the scenario, consider sharing the scenario with the other user instead of giving it. For more information, see ["Share a scenario" on page 486](#).

When you give a private scenario, you have the opportunity to rename the scenario. Renaming the scenario is optional unless the recipient already has a private scenario with the same name, in which case, an error message is displayed when you try to give the scenario without renaming it.

► **Give a scenario**

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select the scenario you want to give.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Give**.

3. In the **Give Scenario** dialog box, do the following as applicable:
- In the **Owner** list, click the user you are giving the scenario to.
 - In the **New Name** box, type a new name for the scenario. (Only applies to private scenarios.)
 - Optionally, in the **Notify new owner** area, type a message to notify the new owner that the scenario has been given to them.
 - Select the **Give my child scenarios** check box if you own child scenarios based on this scenario, and you would like to give them to the new owner of this scenario.
 - Select the **Allow me to access this scenario with permission** check box if you want this scenario to be shared with you after you give it to the new owner. Choose **View only** or **Modify** from the drop down list.
This check box is available only if the scenario is already shared.
 - Select the **Close all resources that are using this scenario** check box if you are not retaining access to the scenario and want to close the resources using it.
This check box is available only if at least one open resource is using the scenario or one of its child scenarios.



Notes:

- If you give the parent of one of your scenarios and do not retain access, you will be unable to update the child scenario. You need to retain modify permission to be able to commit any changes to the scenario. Similarly, if you give a child scenario to someone who does not have access to its parent, that user will be unable to update the child scenario or commit any changes.
- Some resources close automatically after a scenario they were using is deleted, including scorecards that are using only that scenario, workbooks with scenario comparison columns, and scenario properties windows.
- If your scenario is currently private, you cannot select the **Allow me access to this scenario with permission** box.



Tips:

- You can also give a scenario by right-clicking the resource and then clicking **Give**, or by opening the scenario properties and clicking **Give** .
- To find out more about the person you have selected in the **Owner** list, pause the pointer over their name.

CHAPTER 35: Simulating with different control settings

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Each scenario is a different version of the RapidResponse database. Scenarios are comprised of three types of data:

- **Input**—data imported from your company's enterprise data sources (for example, ERP) and, if applicable, suppliers (for example, contract manufacturers) and customers.
- **Control**—rules and values that determine how RapidResponse performs calculations.
- **Calculated**—data produced by RapidResponse calculations after applying control settings to the input data.

To simulate business situations, RapidResponse users usually change input data. For example, if you receive information that a key supplier is unable to deliver a large quantity they had already committed to, you can create a new scenario and modify the input data in it to reflect the potential changes.

In addition to changing input data to model a new data state, you can also change control settings on a scenario-by-scenario basis. For example, you could simulate a change in how RapidResponse handles order priorities. To change settings, you must have access to a worksheet based on a Control table and knowledge of the RapidResponse data model and analytics. For information about the RapidResponse data model, see the [RapidResponse Analytic and Data Model Guide](#). For information about creating workbooks, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

Your RapidResponse administrator might have saved a set of control settings as a perspective which can be applied to any scenario you create. For more information, see ["About perspectives" on page 497](#).

About perspectives

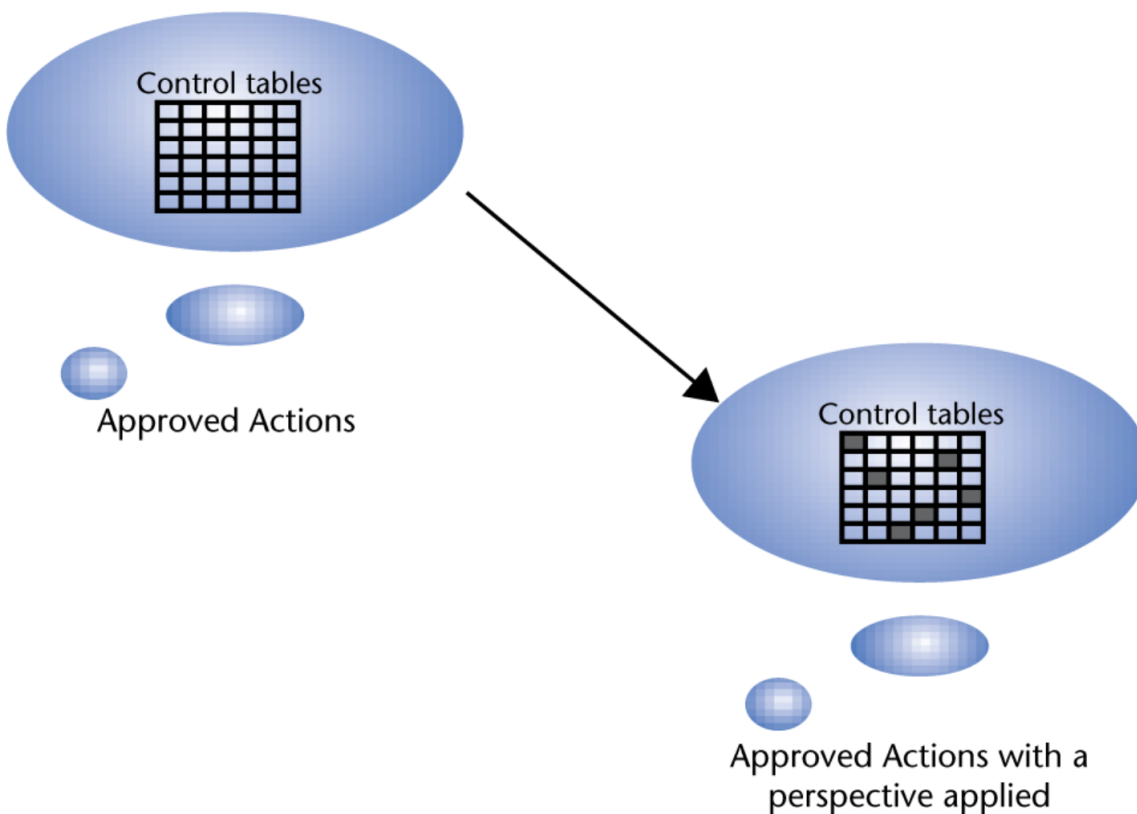
Applying a perspective to a scenario provides another view of the data by changing the way RapidResponse calculates results.

Brand owners that have integrated data from their contract manufacturers commonly use perspectives. By applying perspectives, brand owners can control how the integrated data is calculated into their overall data set.

For example, brand owners can use scenarios with perspectives applied to determine which supplies are active. A brand owner's Enterprise Data (root) or Approved Actions scenarios might show the data from a capable viewpoint; that is, what can be done given the current state of supply and capacity in which supplier commitments such as Available Date are active. By applying a perspective, the scenario can now calculate results with supplier commitments as being inactive. This allows the brand owner to analyze their supply chain data by applying a different view to it.

Perspectives enable you to model your supply chain the same way you perform visibility and response management analysis. For example, you can view data the same way your enterprise data system models it or by excluding supplier commitments as available supply. You can also use perspectives to change the dates used to convert currencies for calculated money values, such as viewing values using the conversion rates used to calculate your annual budget.

When a perspective is applied to a scenario, the scenario's control settings are modified. Control settings specify how RapidResponse performs calculations. Perspectives allow you to apply a preconfigured set of control settings to a scenario without having to manually change control setting data. As shown in the following illustration, a scenario with a perspective applied is originally the same as its parent except the control settings are different, resulting in potentially different calculated values.



You can only apply perspectives to scenarios if you have simulation permission and your RapidResponse administrator has set up perspective definitions.



Caution: Changes made to data in scenarios with perspectives applied might be overlaid with the values defined in the perspective. For more information, see ["Edit and commit a scenario with a perspective applied" on page 500](#).

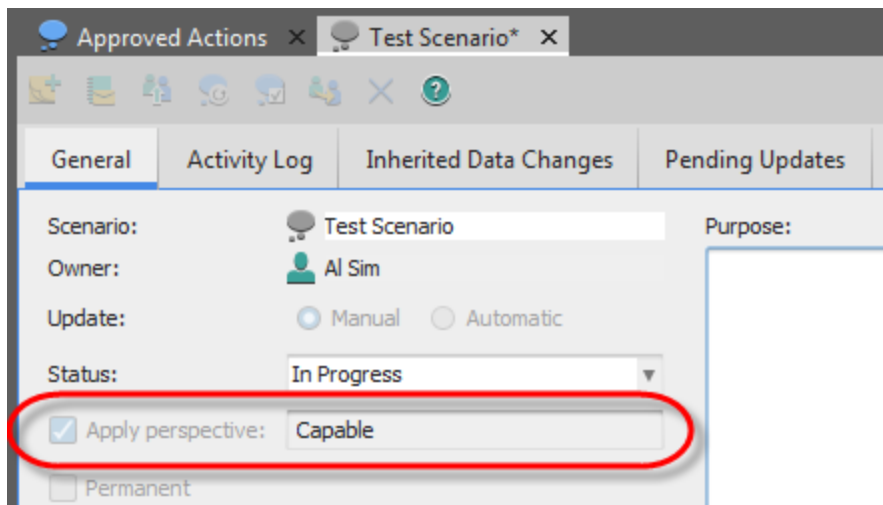
Determine if a scenario has a perspective applied

The easiest way to show whether a scenario has a perspective applied to it is by giving the scenario an intuitive name. For example, **My New Orders - Capable** could indicate the Capable perspective has been applied.

You can also review the scenario's properties to determine whether a perspective has been applied.

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, select a scenario.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.

If a perspective has been applied, in the scenario properties, the **Apply Perspective** check box is checked and the perspective name is displayed.

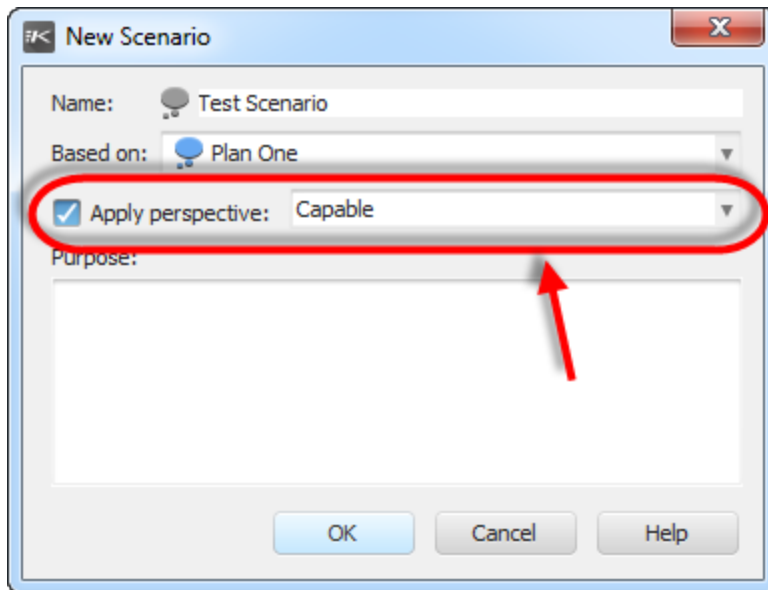


 **Note:** Once a perspective is applied to a scenario it cannot be removed.

 **Tip:** You can also access scenario properties by clicking **Properties**  on the **Scenarios** pane toolbar.

Create a scenario with a perspective applied

You can only create scenarios with perspectives applied to them if you have simulation permission and your RapidResponse administrator has defined at least one perspective. To determine whether you can create a scenario with a perspective applied to it, open the New Scenario dialog box. If perspectives have been defined, the New Scenario dialog box includes the Apply perspective check box and list as shown in the following illustration.



1. On the **File** menu, point to **New**, and then click **Scenario**.
2. In the **Scenario name** box, type the name of the scenario.
It is recommended you add perspective information to the scenario name. For example, **My New Orders - (Capable)** where **Capable** is the perspective name.
3. In the **Based on** list, click the scenario on which the new scenario should be based.
4. Select the **Apply perspective** check box and then select the perspective you want to use from the list.
5. In the **Purpose** box, type any information about the scenario.
It is recommended that you indicate in the **Purpose** box that a perspective has been applied to the new scenario and describe the perspective's intended purpose.



Notes:

- You can only apply a perspective to a scenario when the scenario is created. Once a perspective is applied to a scenario it cannot be removed. However, you can create a child scenario of a scenario that has a perspective applied to it, and not apply a perspective to the new scenario or apply a different perspective. Only one perspective can be applied to a scenario.
- A scenario with a perspective applied can be shared with other RapidResponse users.



Tip: You can also create a scenario by clicking **Scenarios**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.

Edit and commit a scenario with a perspective applied

Scenarios that have perspectives applied can be modified. In fact, you can also modify data that has a perspective applied to it. However, after the data has been modified it is immediately overlaid (or hidden)

with the values defined in the perspective definition. The user-modified data will not affect analytic calculations or query results (for example, data displayed in a worksheet) as it is considered hidden.

For example, assume a user modifies a field in a worksheet that has a perspective value applied to it. When the user saves the data changes in the worksheet, the perspective value is overlaid. To the user it will seem as if the data edit was discarded. In reality, the perspective value is overlaid on the user's data edit. However, the data change is visible from the Data Changes (Pending Commits) tab in the Scenario Properties pane.

A scenario with a perspective applied against it can be committed to its parent. During the commit operation, the data overlaid by the perspective in the child scenario is ignored and not committed to the parent. However, all pending data commits, including the user-modified data that was overlaid by a perspective is committed to the parent. Committing these data values could provide unwanted or unexpected changes to the data in the parent scenario.

RapidResponse system administrators have access to the Perspectives workbook which includes the Hidden Data Changes worksheet. This worksheet identifies user-modified data changes that are hidden in any scenario because a perspective value is overlaid.

For more information about committing, see ["Commit data changes to a parent scenario" on page 474](#).

Update a scenario with a perspective applied

The data in parent scenarios might change as you analyze their child scenarios. You can update the data in your child scenarios with the data changes from their parent scenarios. A child scenario that need updating is identified with an exclamation mark in the scenario icon .

Any control setting in the parent scenario that has been modified as part of the perspective definition applied to a child scenario is not affected by a scenario update command.

In the case of a parent scenario that has a perspective applied to it and its child does not, the scenario update command updates all data in the child scenario except control table settings that were modified due to a perspective being applied to the parent.

For more information about updating, see ["Update data in a scenario" on page 470](#).

CHAPTER 36: Tracking responsibility

Assign responsibility	504
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In RapidResponse, some users might be assigned responsibility for specific data, so that others will know who to contact if there is a problem with the data or if they have questions. For example, your company might track which planners are responsible for which parts, or which customer service representatives are responsible for each product family in each region. Responsibility can be assigned and viewed using a type of resource called a responsibility, also known as a responsibility definition. Worksheets might also display responsibility information.

Responsibility definitions

You might have access to one or more responsibility definitions, which you can use to view responsibility assignments, or to assign responsibility for data to yourself or to other RapidResponse users.

The following illustration shows a responsibility definition that is used to assign responsibility for buyer codes.

The screenshot shows the 'Assign responsibility' interface. On the left, a list of 'Planner Code' entries is shown, grouped by site. A callout points to a filter button above this list. In the center, there is an 'Assign to:' dropdown menu currently showing 'Luke Ward', with 'Add' and 'Remove' buttons below it. Callouts explain that the 'Add' button adds a new record and the 'Remove' button deletes a selected assignment. On the right, the 'Assignments' table is displayed, showing three rows of data. A callout points to this table, stating it shows existing responsibility assignments.

Planner Code List:

Planner Code	Site
AO	Albany
AO	Kanata
ASI	SOPDC-Asia
CCO	Columbus
CCO	Kanata
CD	Chicago
CD	Cycle Systems
CD	Dayton
CD	Framingham
CD	Germany
CD	HQ
CD	New York
CD	Ottawa
CD	Taipei
CH	Chile

Assignments Table:

	Value	Site	Responsible
1	AO	Albany	Signe Holm
2	AO	Kanata	Luke Ward
3	ASI	SOPDC-Asia	Luke Ward

For more information, see ["Assign responsibility"](#) on page 504 and ["View data responsibility using a responsibility definition"](#) on page 508.

Responsibility information in worksheets.

Whether or not you have access to any responsibility definitions, you might be able to use worksheets to find out who is responsible for data. For example, you might see a column that lists parts located next to a column that lists the name of the planner responsible for each part. Each name is accompanied by a button that can be clicked to open the user's contact card. Contact cards allow you to quickly share scenarios or contact the right people with your questions or concerns to resolve issues. For more information, see ["View data responsibility in worksheets"](#) on page 511.

Assign responsibility

If you have access to a responsibility definition, you can open it from the Explorer pane and use it to assign and unassign responsibility for data. Typically, when you create a new responsibility assignment, you select the data that you want to assign, and then you select a user to be responsible for the data. For example, you might assign responsibility for a planner code to a specific planner. The number of fields used to assign responsibility for data varies, depending on the responsibility definition.

Responsibility assignments are listed in the Assignments table, which you see when you open the responsibility definition. If a responsibility assignment in the Assignments table is not correct, you can delete the responsibility assignment, or you can change it so that someone else is responsible for the data. You can also change a responsibility assignment so that no specific user is listed as responsible for that data.

Depending on how the responsibility definition is designed, you might be able to assign responsibility only to yourself or members of certain groups, or you might be able to assign responsibility to any user.

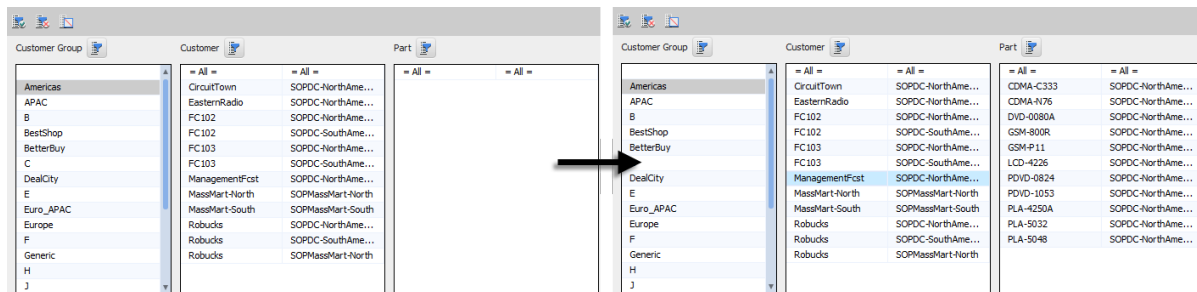


Notes:

- It is possible to create a new responsibility assignment without selecting a specific user to be responsible for the data. For more information, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).
- You cannot assign responsibility for data using a private responsibility definition.

Using multiple fields to assign responsibility for data

When you create a new responsibility assignment, there might be more than one field used to define responsibility. In these cases, the values available in each field after the first depend on the values you selected in the fields to the left of it. Make your selections in order from left to right.



Selecting = All = in a field

When more than one field is used to assign responsibility for data, the first option listed for each field after the first is = All =. You can select this option if you want to make someone responsible for all values in that category for which specific assignments have not been made yet. This can be done as a temporary measure until specific assignments are made.

For example, you might assign responsibility for all parts for a particular customer to a customer service manager. This way, as soon as a new part is added for that customer, someone will be listed as the person responsible. Until a specific customer service representative is assigned responsibility for that part, the manager can handle issues that might arise, or forward inquiries to the appropriate person.

In the following sample Assignments table, Rebecca Gunn is responsible for all products for the customer "Circuit Town," except for DVD-160A, which has been assigned specifically to Maurice Turcotte. If another part is added for the customer "Circuit Town", Rebecca Gunn will be responsible for it by default.

	Customer Group	Customer		Part		Responsible
		Id	Site	Name	Site	
1	Americas	CircuitTown	SOPDC-NorthAmerica	= All =	= All =	Rebecca Gunn
2	Americas	CircuitTown	SOPDC-NorthAmerica	DVD-160A	SOPDC-NorthAmerica	Maurice Turcotte

It is good practice to make specific responsibility assignments as soon as possible to avoid confusion.



Note: When someone is selected to be responsible for all values in a category, any values for which specific assignments have not yet been made are still considered unassigned for the purpose of identifying unassigned data in a responsibility definition. For more information, see ["Identifying unassigned data" on page 508](#).

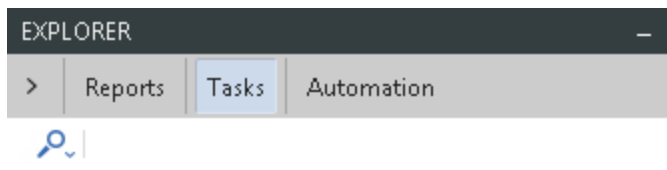
Responsibility definitions where only the Assignments table is displayed

Depending on the properties of the responsibility definition, you might only see the Assignments table when you open it. In these cases, you do not have access to the controls for creating and deleting responsibility assignments, but you can change existing responsibility assignments. You can either make yourself responsible for data or remove your name from a responsibility assignment, leaving it blank so that somebody else can claim responsibility for it. An example of this type of responsibility definition is shown in the following illustration.

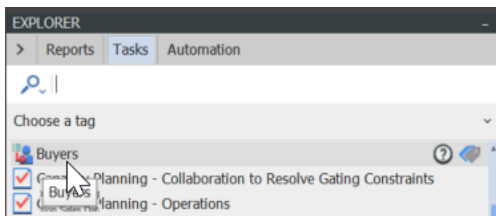
	Planner Code		Responsible
	Value	Site	
1	AO	Albany	
2	AO	Kanata	Search for:
3	ASI	SOPDC-Asia	
4	CCO	Columbus	= Unassigned =
5	CCO	Kanata	Maurice Turcotte
6	CD	Chicago	Maurice Turcotte
7	CD	Cycle System	

► Open a responsibility

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that responsibilities are shown. You can do this by selecting **Tasks**.



2. Double-click a responsibility to open it.



► Create a new responsibility assignment

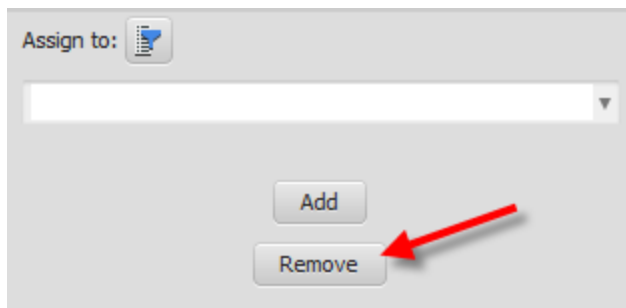
1. [Open the responsibility.](#)
2. For each data field, select the value that you want to assign responsibility for.
3. From the **Assign to** list, select the user who is responsible for the data.
4. Click **Add**.



Tip: You can select multiple values for a data field by clicking on the first value and holding down the mouse button as you move your cursor up or down the list to expand the selection. If a responsibility definition uses more than one field to assign responsibility for data, you can only make multiple selections in the rightmost field.

► Delete a responsibility assignment

1. [Open the responsibility.](#)
2. In the **Assignments** table, select the data that you want to unassign responsibility for.
3. Click the **Remove** button.



4. On the **File** menu, click **Save Data**.

► Change the person responsible for data

1. [Open the responsibility.](#)
2. Locate the row containing the responsibility assignment in the **Assignments** table, and double-click the cell in the **Responsible** column for that row.
3. Select the name of the person you want to transfer responsibility to from the drop-down menu. If you want the **Responsible** field to be blank, select = **Unassigned** =.
4. On the **File** menu, click **Save Data**.



Note: After you remove or change a responsibility assignment, you must save the data before you can create any new responsibility assignments.



Tip: You can filter items in the Assignments table to make it easier to find a specific responsibility assignment. For more information, see ["View data responsibility using a responsibility definition" on page 508](#).

View data responsibility using a responsibility definition

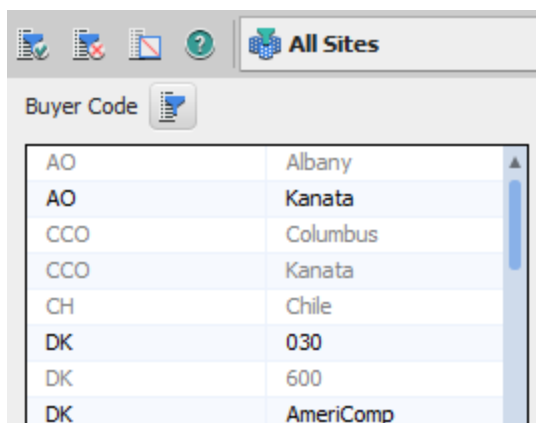
If you have access to a responsibility definition, you can view a list of responsibility assignments that have been made using that responsibility definition. In some cases, you might be able to view all responsibility assignments, but in other cases you might only be able to view the ones that are not assigned to a specific user (that is, the ones where the Responsible field is blank in the Assignments table) and the ones that are assigned to you.

Filtering responsibility assignments

You can use filtering to limit the records displayed in the Assignments table, so that you can find specific information more easily. You can filter the list to see who is responsible for specific data, or you can filter the list by user name to see which data is assigned to a specific user.

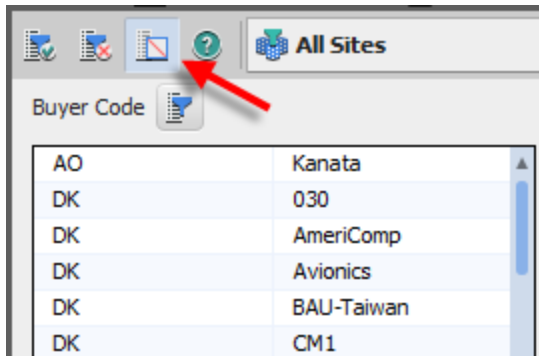
Identifying unassigned data

By default, data values for which responsibility assignments have not been made are listed in black, and values for which responsibility assignments have been made are listed in grey. In the following illustration, AO—Kanata and DK—030 are unassigned.



AO	Albany
AO	Kanata
CCO	Columbus
CCO	Kanata
CH	Chile
DK	030
DK	600
DK	AmeriComp

You can also hide data values that have already been assigned. In the following illustration, assigned values that were shown in gray in the previous illustration are hidden.



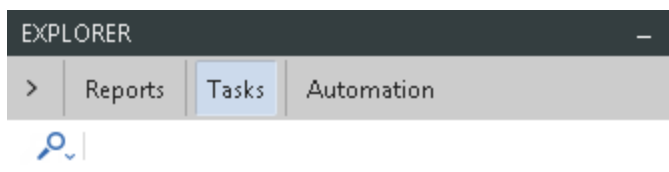
Note: After you assign responsibility for data, it is not immediately marked as assigned. Recently assigned items are marked as assigned when you toggle the Hide Assigned Data  button or close and reopen the responsibility definition.

Searching for text in the Assignments table

In addition to the filter controls discussed in this topic, you can apply column searches to the data in the Assignments table. This works the same way as searching in worksheet columns in a workbook. For more information, see ["Search for specific data" on page 190](#). You can apply a column search at the same time as you are using the filter controls discussed in this topic.

► View list of responsibility assignments

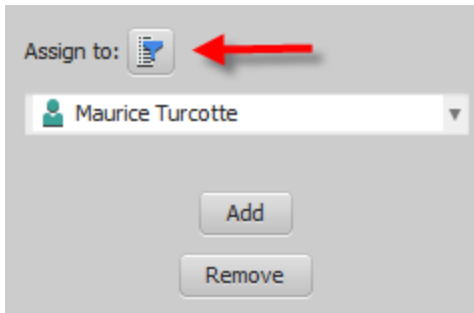
1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that responsibilities are shown. You can do this by selecting **Tasks**.



2. Double-click a responsibility.
Existing responsibility assignments are listed in the **Assignments** table.

► View a specific user's responsibility assignments

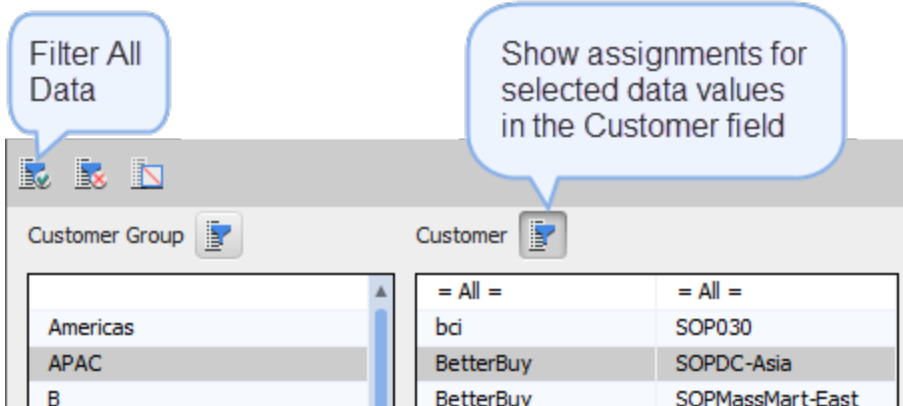
1. In a responsibility definition, under **Assign to**, select the name of the user whose responsibility assignments you want to see.
2. Beside **Assign to**, click **Show assignments for selected person** .



Only responsibility assignments for the selected user are shown in the **Assignments** table.

► Find out who is responsible for data

1. Select the data value or values that you want to view responsibility for.
2. Beside the field name of each field you want to use for filtering, click **Show assignments for selected data values** , or if you want to use all fields to filter data, click **Filter All Data** .



Only responsibility assignments for the selected data are shown in the **Assignments** table.



Tip: You can click **Show assignments for selected data values** again to toggle filtering off for that field.

► Remove all data filtering from the Assignments table

- Click **Remove Data Filtering** .



Note: This does not remove column searches from the Assignments table, nor does it remove filtering based on who is responsible for the data.

► Hide or show assigned data

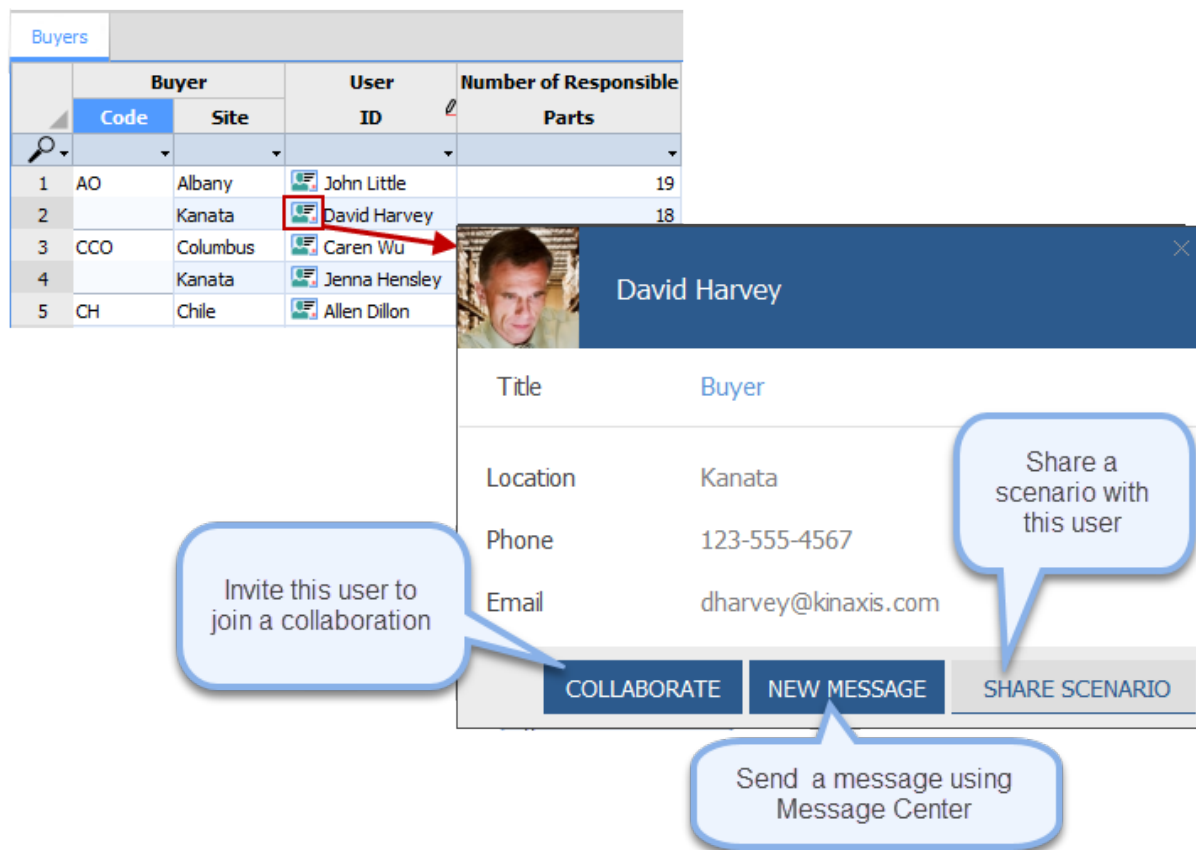
- Click **Hide Assigned Data** .

View data responsibility in worksheets

In some worksheets, you might see columns that list the users responsible for the data. For example, you might see which buyer or planner is responsible for each part in a worksheet. In some cases, you might see the user ID of the responsible person in a worksheet column, but it is more common to see the person's name with a  button beside it.

Viewing contact cards

You can click the  button to view a user's contact card, which displays the user's profile picture and whatever contact information is available for that user in RapidResponse. You can use a contact card to send the user a message through RapidResponse Message Center. When you send messages through Message Center, the recipients might also receive an email message, depending on how their RapidResponse accounts are configured. Contact cards can also be used to share a scenario with the user if you have permission to share scenarios.



Buyer		User ID	Number of Responsible Parts	
Code	Site			
1	AO	Albany	John Little	19
2		Kanata	David Harvey	18
3	CCO	Columbus	Caren Wu	
4		Kanata	Jenna Hensley	
5	CH	Chile	Allen Dillon	

David Harvey

Title: Buyer

Location: Kanata

Phone: 123-555-4567

Email: dharvey@kinaxis.com

[COLLABORATE](#) [NEW MESSAGE](#) [SHARE SCENARIO](#)

Invite this user to join a collaboration

Send a message using Message Center

Share a scenario with this user



Note: Sometimes, a column might contain a mix of user names with  buttons and user ID strings without buttons. This happens if the user ID strings cannot be linked to user accounts. You might not have permission to view information about these users or the accounts might not exist.

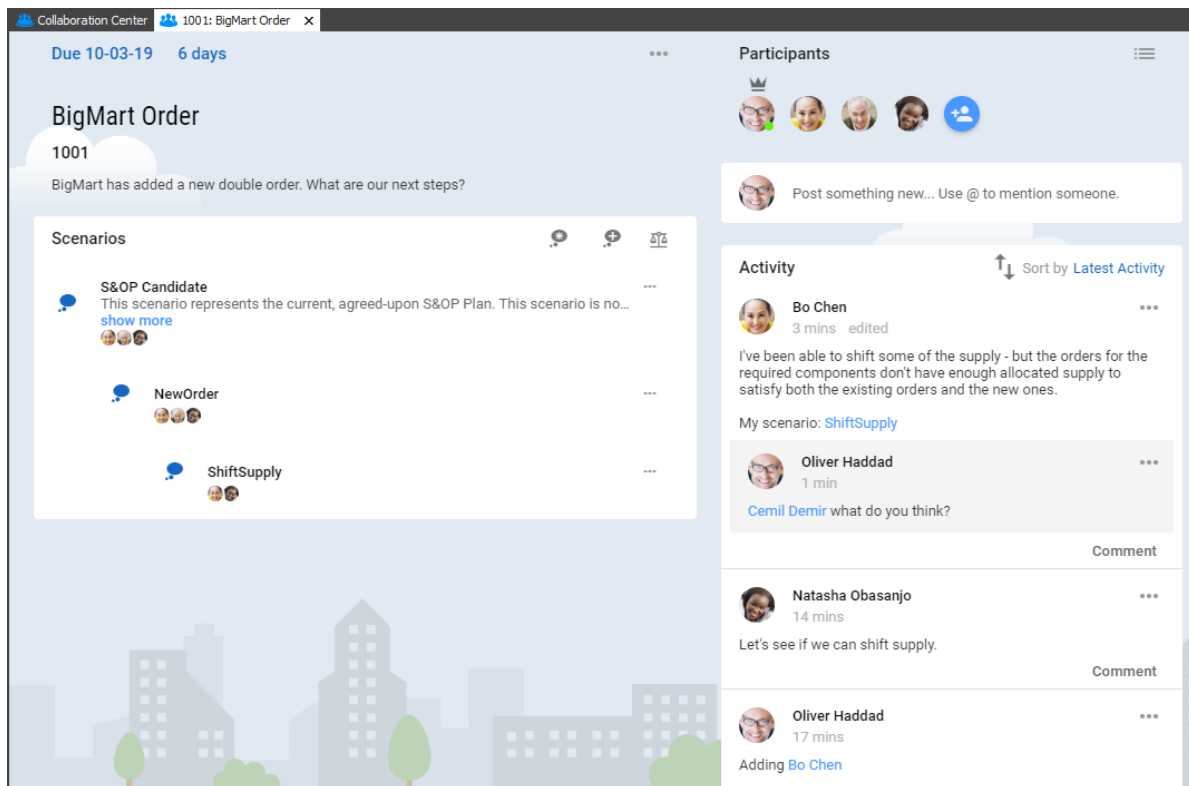
Sharing a scenario with selected users

In some workbooks where you see this type of column with user names, you might also see a  button on the workbook toolbar. You can click this button to quickly share a scenario with users whose names you have selected in the worksheet.

CHAPTER 37: Collaborating to solve business challenges

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Often, a supply chain problem cannot be resolved by one person. The problem might be too complex, involve too many different data sources, or have too much of an impact for one person to handle. In these situations, you can use Adaptive Collaboration in RapidResponse to assemble a dedicated team to work on the problem. Collaborations are available in both the Desktop Client and the Mobile Client.



The team uses a collaboration to communicate, share simulated data in scenarios, and compare solutions. Content in the collaboration is visible only to added participants and to administrators.

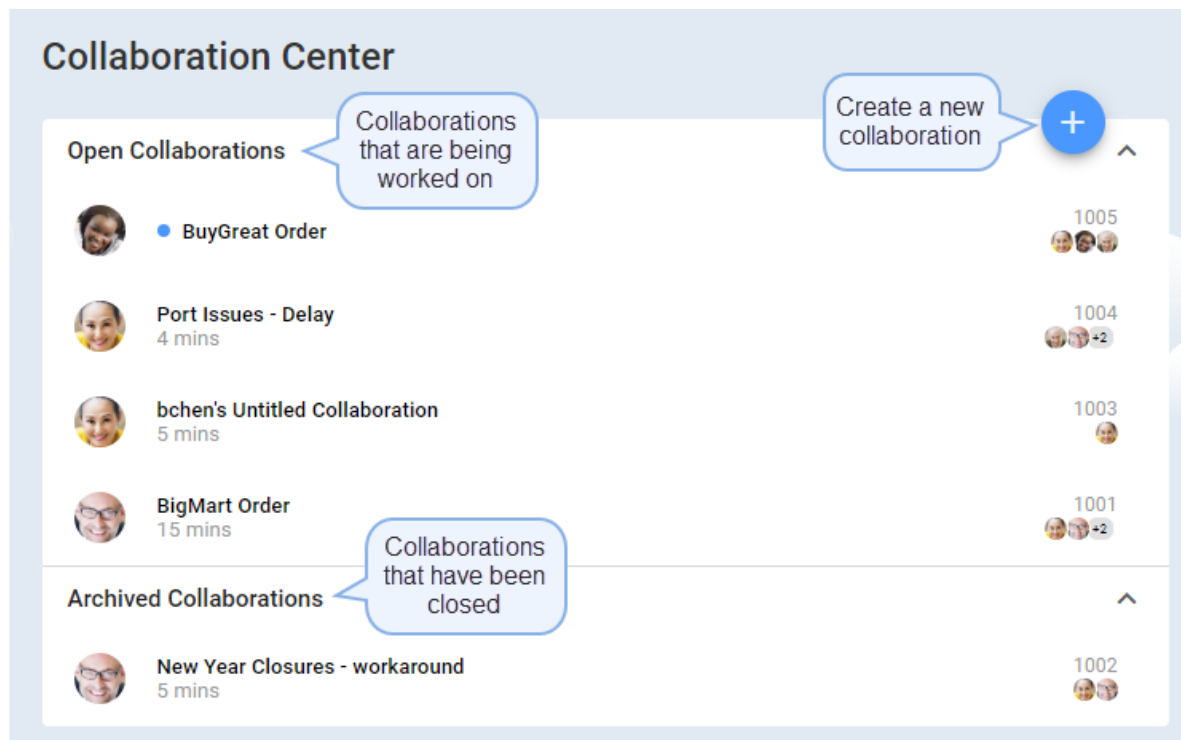
After a course of action has been chosen and the collaboration is no longer needed, you can archive it. Archived collaborations can still be accessed from the Collaboration Center. For more information, see ["Collaboration Center" on page 514](#).



Note: The Desktop Client can be used on Microsoft Windows and Mac OS operating systems. However, the Collaboration Center is not supported on Mac OS. If you are using the Mac OS, consider using the Mobile Client if you want to take advantage of forms or Collaboration Center. For more information about starting the Mobile Client, see ["Sign in to RapidResponse \(On-Demand systems\)" on page 46](#) or ["Sign in to RapidResponse \(On-Premises systems\)" on page 48](#). Alternatively, you might be able to run Microsoft Windows in a Mac OS virtual environment to run the Desktop Client.

Collaboration Center

All the collaborations you have access to display in Collaboration Center. These include collaborations you have started, collaborations you have been added to, and past collaborations you have participated in that are now archived.



► Open a collaboration from Collaboration Center

1. On the RapidResponse toolbar, click  to view the **Collaboration Center**.



2. In the **Open Collaborations** or **Archived Collaborations** pane, click the name of the collaboration you want to view.



Notes:

- When you click a link to a collaboration in a message or add a screenshot to a collaboration, the collaboration automatically opens.
- You can also access Collaboration Center in any message informing you that you have been included in a collaboration. For more information, see ["Participate in a collaboration" on page 526](#).

Start a new collaboration

RapidResponse has multiple starting points for a collaboration.

You can start a new collaboration from:

- File menu
- RapidResponse toolbar - Collaboration button 
- Collaboration Center
- An open dashboard, scorecard, or workbook
- A screenshot of a dashboard, process, scorecard, or workbook
- A contact card in a worksheet cell
- A contact card in an open or archived collaboration

From some starting points, your current context is carried over into the collaboration. For example, when you start a collaboration from an open resource, the scenarios used in the resource are automatically shared in the collaboration along with a link to the open resource.

When you create a new collaboration, you are identified as the collaboration leader.



As leader, your role is to initiate the collaboration by adding the initial participants. You also have the option to describe the context of the issue and/or add scenarios for participants to start working with.

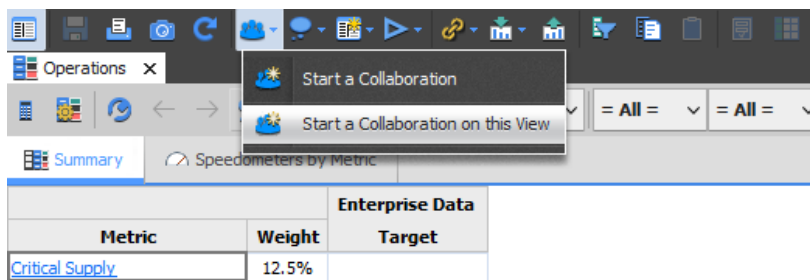
If you are not observing or taking an active role in the collaboration, you can delegate leadership to another participant and then leave the collaboration. For more information, see ["Managing a collaboration" on page 521](#).

► Start a new blank collaboration

- Do one of the following:
 - On the **File** menu, click **New** . Then click **Collaboration**  and click **Start a Collaboration**.
 - Click **Collaboration**  on the RapidResponse toolbar and then click **Start a Collaboration**.
 - In **Collaboration Center**, click . For more information, see "[Collaboration Center](#)" on page 514.

► Start a new collaboration from an open resource

You can start a new collaboration from an open public dashboard, scorecard, or workbook. The scenarios used in the resource are automatically added to the collaboration and a link to the resource is automatically posted in the collaboration.



- In the open resource, do one of the following:
 - On the **File** menu, click **New** . Then click **Collaboration**  and click **Start a Collaboration on this View**.
 - Click **Collaboration**  on the RapidResponse toolbar and then click **Start a Collaboration on this View**.

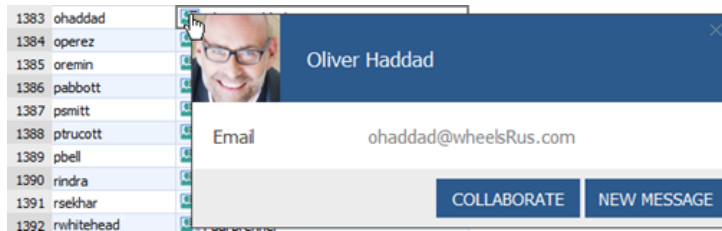
► Start a new collaboration from a screenshot

You can start a new collaboration from a screenshot of a dashboard, process, scorecard, or workbook. The scenarios used in the resource are automatically added to the collaboration.

1. In an open resource, click **Capture Screenshot**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.
2. Optionally, add annotations to the screenshot. For more information, see "[Add screenshots to a collaboration](#)" on page 538.
3. Click **Share** .
4. Click **New Collaboration**.

► Start a new collaboration from a worksheet cell

1. In the worksheet row, click the contact card for the person you want to collaborate with.
2. Click **Collaborate**.



3. In the Collaboration pane, click **New Collaboration**.
The person is automatically added as a participant in the collaboration.

► Start a new collaboration from a contact card in an open collaboration

1. In the open or archived collaboration, click on the profile picture of the person you want to collaborate with.
2. Click **Collaborate** in the contact card.

The collaboration interface

The image and table below provide an overview of the collaboration interface.

Goals

CORPORATE METRICS

	Overall Score	Revenue	Margin %
Annual Plan	100.0%	\$3,900,126,884	35.2%
S&OP Candidate	86.0%	\$6,706,607,599	37.8%
NewOrder	86.0%	\$6,706,607,599	37.8%
ShiftSupply	86.0%	\$6,706,607,599	37.8%

	Key Constraint ...	Ending Inventory	On Time to Req...
Annual Plan	95.0%	\$87,784,307	95.0%
S&OP Candidate	90.7%	\$2,735,157,811	52.4%
NewOrder	90.7%	\$2,735,157,811	52.4%
ShiftSupply	90.7%	\$2,735,157,811	52.4%

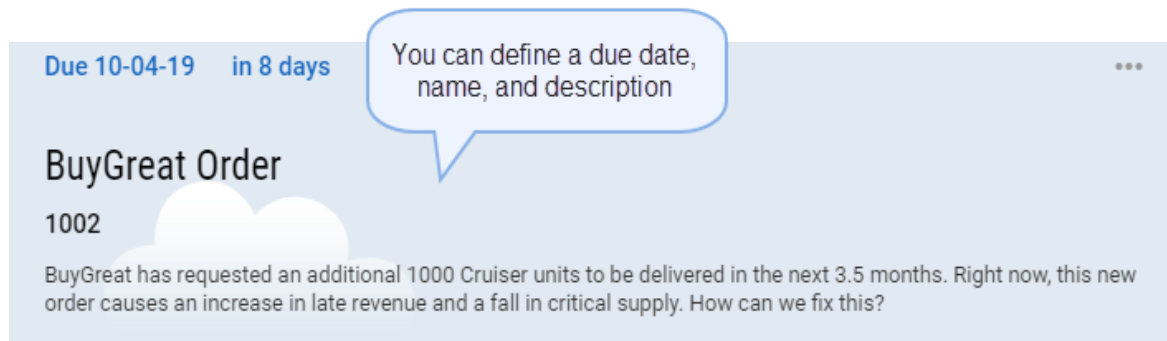
Scenarios

S&OP Candidate
This scenario represents the current, agreed-upon S&OP Plan. This scenario is n...
[show more](#)

Letter	Description	Letter	Description
A	Collaboration toolbar—displays the due date (if one has been specified) and the More ... menu icon.	H	Add participant—You can add people to a collaboration by clicking on the icon and then typing their name or full email in the Add participant field. For more information, see "Add users to a collaboration" on page 522 .
B	Collaboration name—Optionally, specify a name for the collaboration. Each collaboration is also assigned a collaboration ID. For more information, see "Specify a name for the collaboration" on page 519 .	I	Show Details—Click to access details for people added to the collaboration. For more information, see "View information about participants" on page 524 .
C	Collaboration description—Optionally, describe the collaboration's purpose or goals. For more information, see "Describe the collaboration" on page 519 .	J	Post something new—You can add new posts to a collaboration to communicate with other collaboration participants. You can also add participants and scenarios to the collaboration using social markup. For more information, see "Add a new post to a collaboration" on page 535 .
D	Goals—A scorecard that has been added to the collaboration displays in this area. For more information, see "Compare scenarios" on page 531 .	K	Sort by—You can filter posts by viewing posts that have the latest activity or posts that were created first. For more information, see "Communicate in a collaboration" on page 533 .
E	Scenarios—All scenarios that have been added to a collaboration display in this area. For more information, see "Add a scenario to a collaboration" on page 528 and "Manage scenarios in a collaboration" on page 530 .	L	Posts display in white boxes. You can edit or remove posts you add to a collaboration. For more information, see "Edit a collaboration post or comment" on page 536 .
F	Collaboration leader—The leader of the collaboration is identified by a crown over their profile picture.	M	Comments display in light gray boxes. You can edit or remove comments you add to a collaboration. For more information, see "Edit a collaboration post or comment" on page 536 .
G	Collaboration participant—The profile pictures for all collaboration participants display in the Participants area. Participants currently signed in to RapidResponse are identified by a green circle on their profile picture.	N	Add a comment—You can add a comment to a post. For more information, see "Add a comment to a collaboration post" on page 536 .

Set up a collaboration

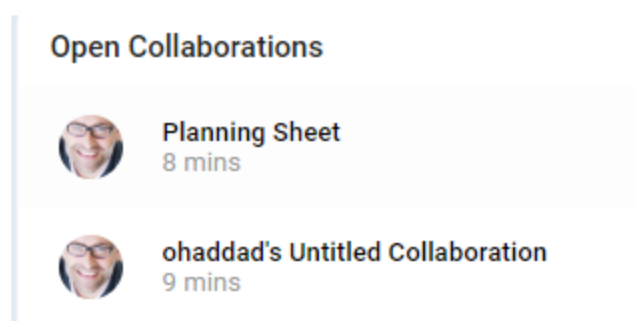
When you set up a collaboration, it's recommended that you add a name, description, and due date for the collaboration. None of these properties are required for the collaboration to work. However, they can provide context and focus for the team. Any participant in the collaboration can add or edit these properties.



Specify a name for the collaboration

The default name for a collaboration is "Untitled Collaboration" prefixed by the user ID of the collaboration leader.

For collaborations started from an open resource, the default name is the name of the resource. For more information, see ["Start a new collaboration from an open resource" on page 516](#).



► Add or edit a collaboration name

- In the collaboration, type text in the **Name this Collaboration** box.

Describe the collaboration

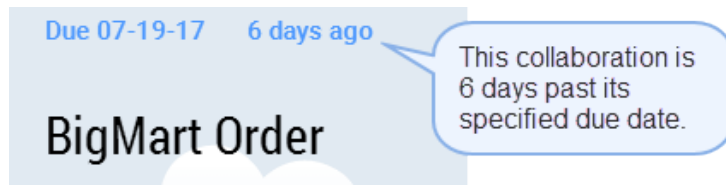
For a collaboration description, you might explain the issue the team is working to resolve, the goals of the collaboration and steps to achieve them, or similar information that provides context for the participants.

► Add or edit a description

- In the collaboration, type text in the **Add a description of the issue** box.

Set a due date

The due date in a collaboration is the deadline proposed for the participants to decide on a solution. The number of days before or after the due date relative to today's date is also identified.



► Add or edit a due date

1. On the collaboration toolbar, click **Set Due Date**.
2. In the calendar, click the left ◀ and right ▶ arrows to move from month to month.
3. To select a date, click the date.
4. To select the due date as today, do one of the following:
 - Click the date identified by a blue corner.
 - Click **Today**.
5. To close the calendar without selecting a due date, click **Close**.

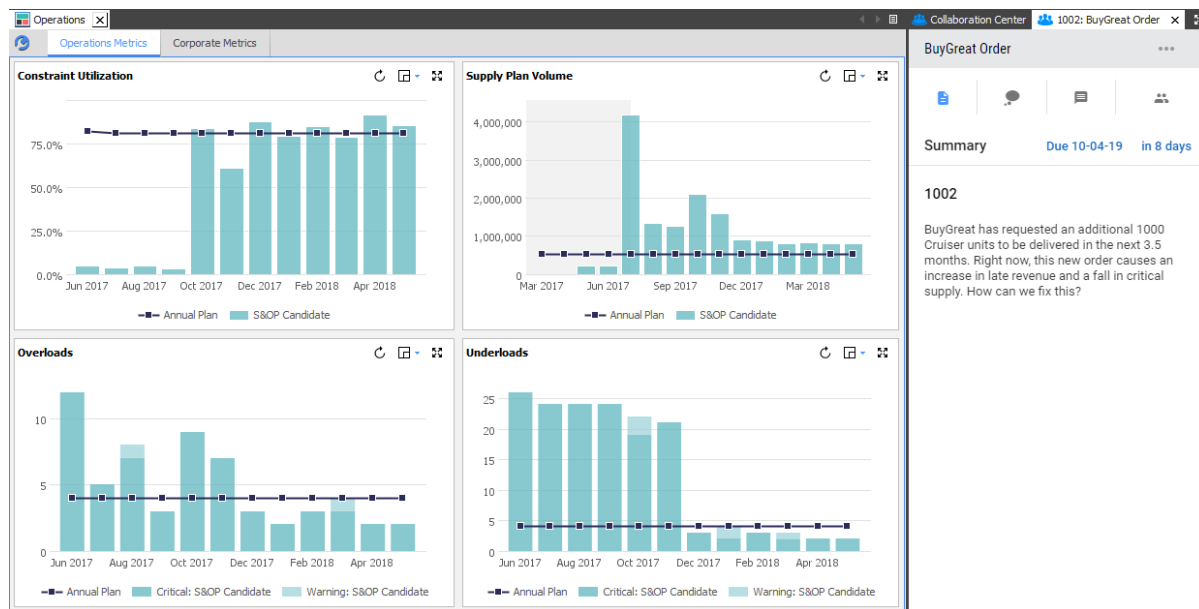
► Remove the due date

1. In the collaboration, click the specified due date on the collaboration toolbar.
2. In the calendar, click **Clear**.

Viewing a collaboration

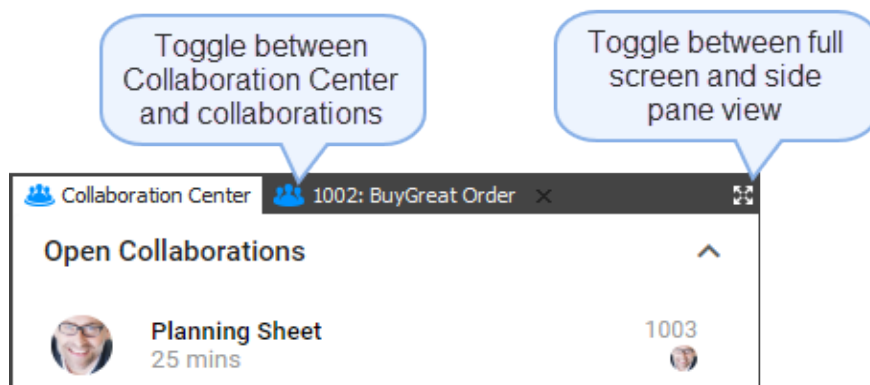
All of the active and archived collaborations you are a participant in display in Collaboration Center. You can open a collaboration by clicking it in Collaboration Center or by opening any automated message in Message Center from a collaboration. For more information, see ["Collaboration Center" on page 514](#) and ["Participate in a collaboration" on page 526](#).

The collaboration center and collaborations can be viewed as full screen or as a side pane next to an open resource.



► Collaboration toolbar

The collaboration toolbar allows you to toggle between individual collaborations and the collaboration center. It also enables you to minimize and maximize your collaborations.



► To toggle between full screen and side pane

- On the collaboration toolbar click .

Managing a collaboration

As a collaboration leader or participant, you can manage collaborations by:

- Adding other RapidResponse users to the collaboration who have the requisite experience or expertise. For more information, see ["Add users to a collaboration" on page 522](#).
- Participating in collaborations you have been added to. For more information, see ["Participate in a collaboration" on page 526](#).

- Leaving collaborations you have been added to where you are not the leader. For more information, see ["Leave a collaboration" on page 527](#).

As a collaboration leader, you can manage collaborations by:

- Removing participants from a collaboration. For more information, see ["Remove participants from a collaboration" on page 524](#).
- Delegating leadership of the collaboration to another participant. For more information, see ["Assign a new leader to the collaboration" on page 527](#).



Note: RapidResponse user and system administrators can also add or remove users from collaborations, reassign leadership, and post and comment in any collaboration.

Add users to a collaboration

In a collaboration, just as in other parts of RapidResponse, you simulate data changes using scenarios. When you are simulating changes that affect areas of data you do not manage, you will need to get others involved to determine the best course of action. Typically, a small team of people are added to the collaboration who have the skills or experience to resolve a particular problem. Collaboration participants might also be selected based on their roles or geographical responsibilities. For example, if you are investigating a critical shortage of a part, you might add the planner responsible for that part to join the collaboration.

When you are deciding whose input is critical for the collaboration, you can check worksheets that list the names of people responsible for data or you might check the list of users for a group. For more information, see ["View information about user groups" on page 525](#).

You can add users to a collaboration by:

- Selecting their name from a list in the collaboration.
- Using social markup in the collaboration posts or texts.
- From their contact card in a worksheet row.

When someone is added to a collaboration, they are notified in Message Center. If you do not have permission to add people to a collaboration, contact your RapidResponse administrator to add the required participants for you.

As work on a collaboration progresses, some participants might leave or other participants might be added. Any member of the collaboration who has permission can add other users to the collaboration.

Collaboration leaders and administrators can remove people from collaborations. For more information, see ["Remove participants from a collaboration" on page 524](#).



Note: RapidResponse administrators can limit users' ability to see each other's contact information. In collaborations, users who cannot see each other's information can still see each other's comments, but might not know who made the comments. Adding users who should not be aware of each other to the same collaboration is not recommended. You are warned if you add users with restricted visibility to a collaboration.

► Add a user to a collaboration

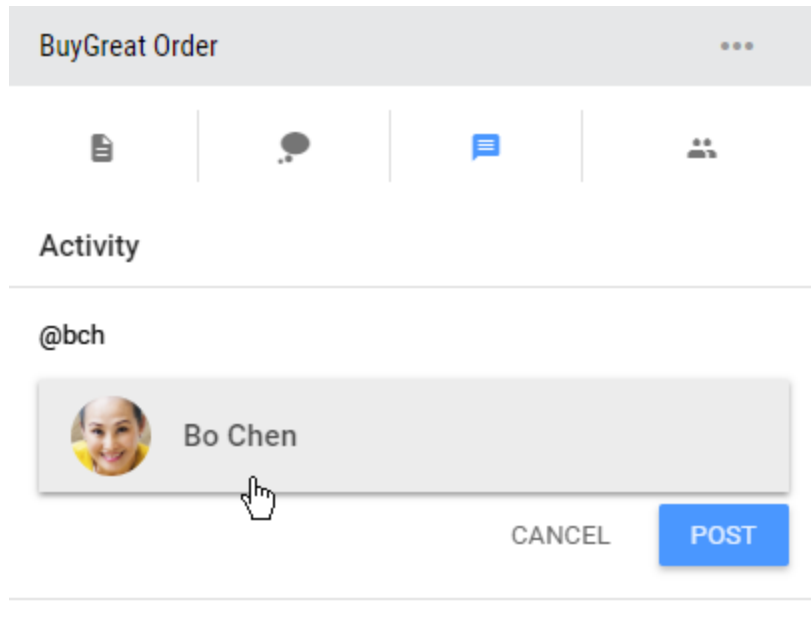
When you add another RapidResponse user to a collaboration, a list of users that match the text you type displays. Anyone who is already a participant in the collaboration is already identified.

If you do not have permission to add people to a collaboration, contact your RapidResponse administrator to add the required participants for you.

1. In the collaboration, click .
2. Start typing the name of the RapidResponse user you want to add.
3. Click the user name from the list of matched users.

► Add a user to a collaboration using social markup

1. In the collaboration, click in a post or comment reply box.
2. Type "@" and then start typing the user name of the person you want to add. For example "@riley".
3. Click the user name from the list of matched users.



The screenshot shows a collaboration interface titled "BuyGreat Order". Below the title is a navigation bar with four icons: a document, a speech bubble, a comment bubble, and a group of people. The "Activity" tab is selected. Below the tab, the text "@bch" is entered into a search bar. A dropdown menu displays a suggestion for "Bo Chen" with a profile picture. A hand cursor points to the suggestion. Below the dropdown are "CANCEL" and "POST" buttons.



Tip: If the person is already a participant in the collaboration, tagging them in a post or comment using @ sends a message telling them that they have been mentioned in the collaboration. For more information, see ["Communicating using Message Center" on page 437](#).

► Add a user to a collaboration from a worksheet contact card

1. In the worksheet row, click the contact card for the person you want to collaborate with.
2. Click **Collaborate**.
3. In the Collaboration pane, click an existing collaboration.

Remove participants from a collaboration

As a collaboration leader, you can remove participants from an open collaboration when their expertise is no longer needed or might not be applicable for the collaboration.

If the participant is in the collaboration when they are removed, they are immediately notified and forced to exit the collaboration. The collaboration is also removed from their view of Collaboration Center.

Your RapidResponse administrators can remove any participant from a collaboration in your system.

1. In the **Participant** area of the collaboration, click **Show participants list** .
2. Click **More**  for the person you want to remove.
3. Click **Remove from Collaboration**.

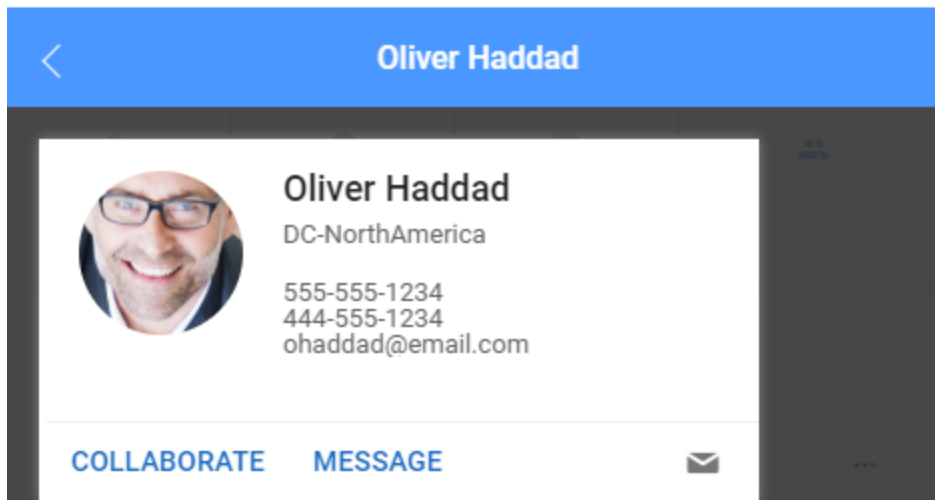


Notes:

- Links in messages to collaborations you have left or been removed from will no longer work.
- You cannot remove participants from an archived collaboration.

View information about participants

In a collaboration, you can view more detailed information for any participant by viewing their contact card. The contact card might have information such as their job title and location, and any contact details such as email and telephone numbers. From the contact card, you can also start a new collaboration with the person or send them a message. For more information, see ["View data responsibility in worksheets" on page 511](#).



Note: If your system is configured to make outgoing calls, you can call telephone numbers from a contact card.

► View a contact card in a collaboration

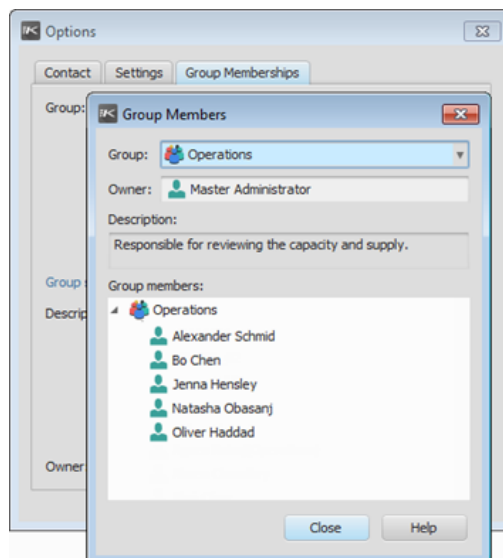
- Do one of the following:
 - Click a participant's profile picture in the collaboration.
 - Click **Show participant list** , click **More**  for the participant you want to view, and then click **View Contact Card**.

► Call a participant from a contact card.

1. Do one of the following:
 - Click the person's profile picture in the collaboration.
 - Click **Show participant list** , click **More**  for the participant you want to view, and then click **View Contact Card**.
2. Click the phone or mobile number in the card.

View information about user groups

Other RapidResponse users on your system might be members of one or more user groups. As a group member, you have access to all the resources that the group has been given access to. Groups might be composed of people with similar job functions. For example, an Operations group has users who are responsible for tracking capacity and supply.



You can view a list of groups you belong to and members that belong in each group in your system. For example, if you are uncertain of who to contact about a part order, you might check the list of members for the Buyer group. Member lists can also be useful in deciding who to include in a collaboration.

► View groups you are a member of

1. On the **Tools** menu, click **Options**.
2. Click the **Group Memberships** tab.

The **Group** list displays all groups you are a member of.

3. In the **Group settings** area, review the following information:
 - **Description**—what the group does.
 - **Owner**—who administers the group and assigns responsibility for data.
 - To view a list of group members, click **Members**.



Notes:

- If the group owner has enabled it, you will receive a message when you are added to a group.
- If your company started tracking responsibility in RapidResponse 2014.2 (or earlier), you might see a Responsibility area on the Group Memberships tab of the Options dialog box. For information about the items displayed in this area, see the [RapidResponse User Guide](#) for Version 2014.2.



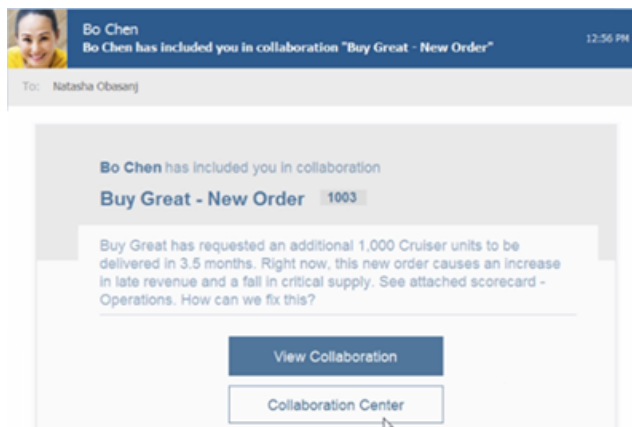
Tip: If profile pictures are enabled on your RapidResponse system, you can also access the **Options** dialog box by clicking your profile picture in the RapidResponse toolbar and then clicking **Options**.

► **View the members of a group**

1. On the **Tools** menu, click **Options**.
2. Click the **Group Memberships** tab.
3. Select the group to view from the **Group** list.
4. Click **Members**.

Participate in a collaboration

You might be added to collaborations initiated by other users in your RapidResponse system. If you have access to Message Center, you will receive a message with a link to the collaboration. From there, you can open the collaboration and start working on solving the problem.



1. Open Message Center.
2. In the message informing you that you have been included in a collaboration, click **View Collaboration**.

All collaborations you are a participant of display in the open collaborations list in Collaboration Center. For more information, see ["Collaboration Center" on page 514](#).

Leave a collaboration

You can leave a collaboration by removing yourself from it. When you leave a collaboration, the collaboration is no longer visible in Collaboration Center and you can no longer view any of the collaboration-specific content. However, you still have access to the shared scenarios and resources in the Scenario and Explorer panes.

When another participant has left a collaboration, you are informed of the departure, but until you accept the update notification, their image still displays in the Participant row.

If you are the leader of the collaboration, you must assign leadership of the collaboration to another participant before you can leave the collaboration.

► Leave a collaboration

1. In the **Participant** area of the collaboration, click **Show Details** .
2. Click **More**  for your name.
3. Click **Remove Myself from Collaboration**.

► Assign a new leader to the collaboration

1. In the **Participant** area of the collaboration, click **Show Details** .
2. Click **More**  for the person you want as the new collaboration leader.
3. Click **Assign Leadership**.



Notes:

- Links in messages to collaborations you have left or been removed from will no longer work.
- The leader of a collaboration or a RapidResponse administrator can remove any participant from a collaboration. For more information, see ["Remove participants from a collaboration" on page 524](#).

Work on a collaboration

As you work on a collaboration, you can add and compare scenarios, communicate with other collaboration participants, and add resource contexts to the collaboration by adding links or annotated screenshots. Once the collaboration has reached a successful conclusion, you can commit the scenario and generate a report of scenario actions and responses for distribution.

Add a scenario to a collaboration

Any time you want to simulate a change in RapidResponse, you should create a scenario to determine the change's impact on your total supply chain. As you are working in a collaboration to resolve an identified issue, you can add scenarios to test the possible solutions.

When you add a scenario to a collaboration, by default you share it with all other participants. You must specify what level of access participants have to the scenario: modify or view only permission. For more information, see ["Manage scenarios in a collaboration" on page 530](#).

All participants can remove scenarios from a collaboration. Depending on the scenario permission they have been granted, they might also be able to perform these other scenario actions:

- Add or remove new or existing scenarios.
- Create child scenarios. For more information see ["Manage scenarios in a collaboration" on page 530](#).
- Commit changes to parent scenarios. For more information see ["Manage scenarios in a collaboration" on page 530](#).
- Compare results between scenarios. For more information see ["Compare scenarios" on page 531](#).

To understand the changes other participants are making in scenarios, view the Activity Logs for those scenarios. For more information, see ["Track activity in a scenario" on page 467](#).



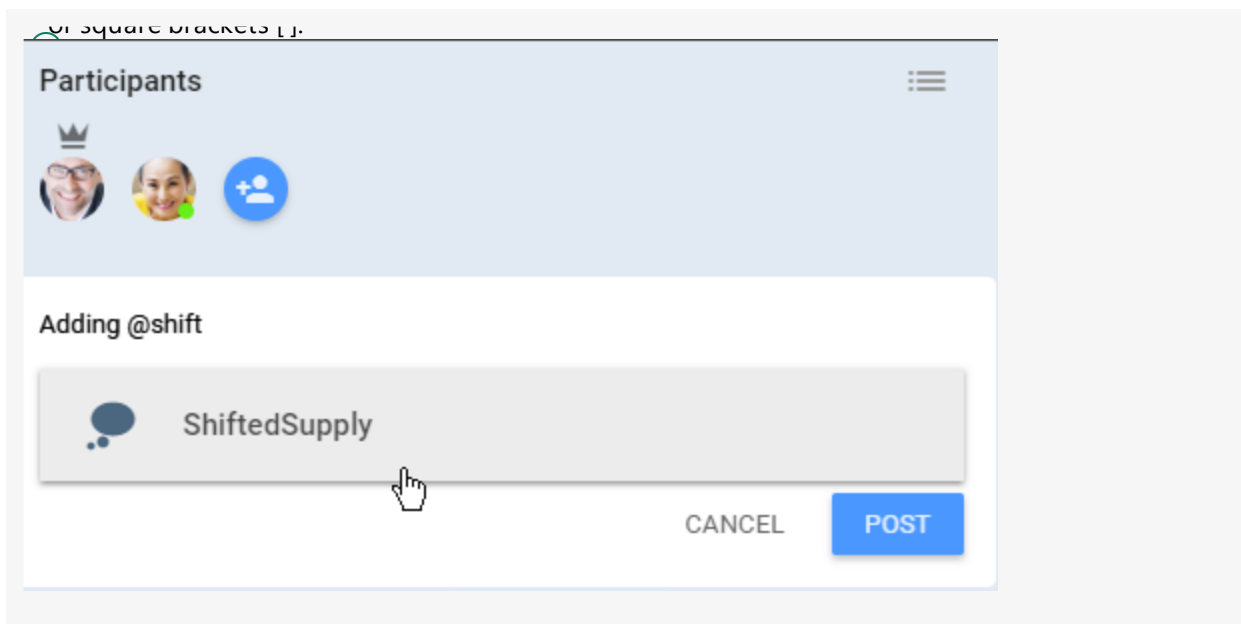
Notes:

- If you do not have permission to create scenarios, you can only remove scenarios that others add to the collaboration.
- The ability to create a new scenario or share scenarios is determined by the scenario permissions given to you by your RapidResponse administrator. For more information, see ["Simulating business changes" on page 461](#).



Tips:

- You can also use the @ markup text to add scenarios to a collaboration.
- To use the @ markup to add scenarios, scenario names should not start with the @ symbol



► Add a new scenario to a collaboration

1. In the **Scenarios** area of the collaboration, click **Create Scenario** .
2. In the **Create a New Scenario** form, type a name for the scenario.
3. Select the scenario to base the new scenario on.
4. Optionally, describe the purpose of the scenario.
5. To keep the scenario private, clear the **Share with everyone in the collaboration** check box.
6. Select the permission to provide to other people in the collaboration:
 - **Modify**—collaboration participants can change the data in the scenario by committing changes from other scenarios back to this scenario, or by editing the scenario directly if the participant has permission to edit shared scenarios.
 - **View Only**—collaboration participants can view data in the scenario, but cannot change its data.
7. Click **Create**.

► Add an existing scenario to a collaboration

1. In the **Scenarios** area of the collaboration, click **Add Scenario** .
2. In the **Scenario** list, select the scenario to add.
3. To keep the scenario private, clear the **Share with everyone in the collaboration** check box.
4. Select the permission to provide to other people in the collaboration:
 - **Modify**—collaboration participants can change the data in the scenario by committing changes from other scenarios back to this scenario, or by editing the scenario directly if the participant has permission to edit shared scenarios.
 - **View Only**—collaboration participants can view data in the scenario, but cannot change its data.
5. Click **Add**.

6. If the scenario has any child scenarios, you will be prompted to do one of the following:
 - Click **Scenario Only** to only add the scenario to the collaboration.
 - Click **Scenario and Children** to add the scenario and all its child scenarios to the collaboration
 - Click **Cancel** to cancel the add a scenario action and exit the form.

Manage scenarios in a collaboration

As you work with scenarios in a collaboration, you might change the level of access other participants have to it or create child scenarios to work in. For example, you might change the permission for a scenario you added from Modify to View Only if you no longer want changes made to the scenario. The View Only permission still allows participants to use the scenario in comparisons. You might also remove scenarios that are not working or are not needed.

► Change the level of access to a scenario in a collaboration

1. In the **Scenarios** area in a collaboration, click **More**  for the scenario you want to change access to.
2. Click **Share Scenario**.
3. In the **Share Scenario** form, do one of the following:
 - To make the scenario private, clear the **Share with everyone in the collaboration** check box.
 - To make the scenario accessible to all collaboration participants, click the **Share with everyone in the collaboration** check box.
4. To change what participants can do with the scenario, click the drop-down list in the **Permission** control and do one of the following:
 - To allow participants to modify the scenario or create child scenarios to test, select **Modify**.
 - To not allow participants to modify the scenario or create child scenarios, select **View Only**.
5. Click **OK**

► Create a child scenario in a collaboration

1. In the **Scenarios** area in a collaboration, click **More**  for the scenario you want to change access to.
2. Click **Create Child Scenario**.
3. In the **Create a New Scenario** form, type a name for the child scenario.
4. To change the parent scenario, select another scenario from the **Based on** control.
5. Optionally, describe the purpose of the child scenario.
6. To keep the scenario private, clear the **Share with everyone in the collaboration** check box.
7. Select the permission to provide to collaboration participants:
 - **Modify**—collaboration participants can change the data in the scenario by committing changes from other scenarios back to this scenario, or by editing the scenario directly if the participant has permission to edit shared scenarios.
 - **View only**—collaboration participants can view data in the scenario, but cannot change its data.
8. Click **Create**.

The new scenario displays in the **Scenarios** area.

► Remove a scenario from a collaboration

1. In the **Scenarios** area, click **More**  for the scenario you want to remove.
2. Click **Remove Scenario**.
3. In the **Remove Scenario** form, do one of the following:
 - To keep the scenario in the **Scenarios** area after removing it from the collaboration, clear the **Delete scenario** check box.
 - To delete the scenario after removing it from the collaboration, select the **Delete scenario** check box.
4. Click **Remove**.

Compare scenarios

As you are exploring the different solutions proposed by the team, you can test the impact of those changes by comparing the solutions in the scenarios. You can compare scenarios in a collaboration by opening a scorecard in another resource tab or by adding a scorecard directly in the collaboration. Any participant in the collaboration can open or add a scorecard they have access to.

Open a scorecard

You can compare the scenarios that are used in a collaboration by opening them in a scorecard. The scorecard opens in a new resource tab and by default, all the scenarios in the collaboration are passed to the scorecard. You can change which scenarios you are comparing using the Add or Remove Scenarios button  on the workbook toolbar. For more information, see "[Specify the data displayed in a scorecard](#)" on page 284.

► Open a scorecard from a collaboration

1. In the **Scenarios** area of a collaboration, click **Compare** .
2. Click a scorecard in the **Select Scorecard** list.
The scorecard opens in a new tab.

Add a scorecard

You can also compare the scenarios directly in the collaboration by adding a scorecard to it. Results for all scenarios in the collaboration display as a series of bullet charts in the Goals panel. For more information, see "[Goals](#)" on page 532.

► Add a scorecard to a collaboration

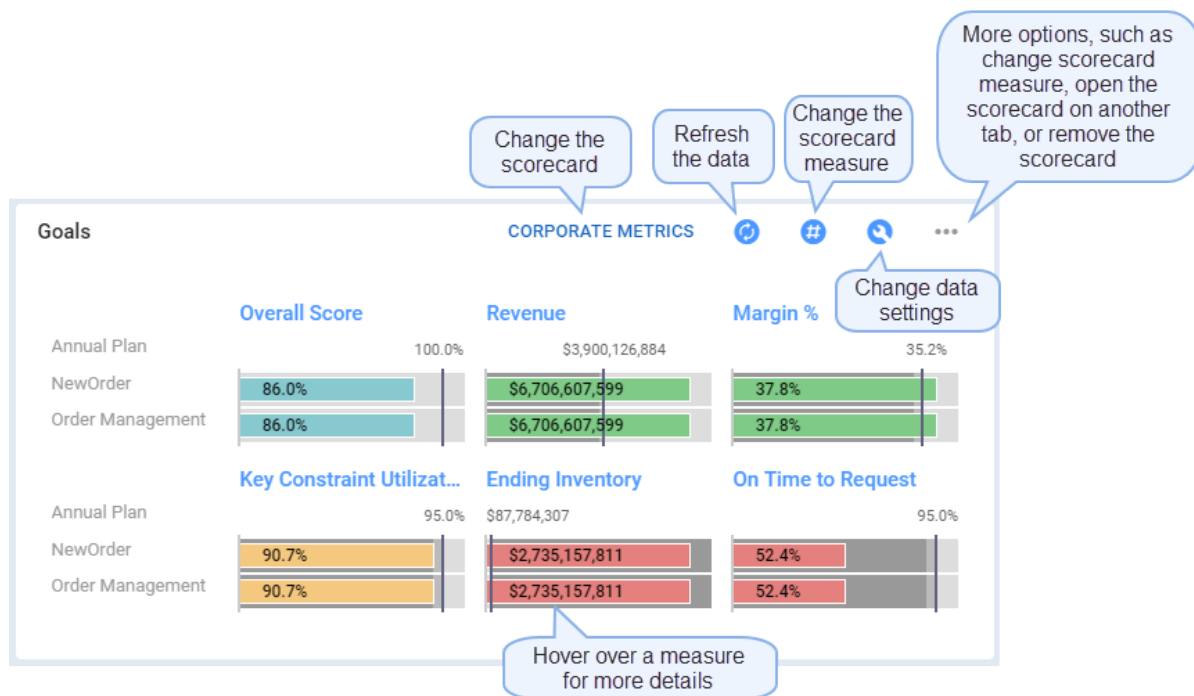
1. Click **More**  on the Collaboration toolbar.
2. Click **Add Scorecard**.
3. Click a scorecard in the **Select Scorecard** list.

► Remove a scorecard from a collaboration

1. Click **More**  on the Collaboration toolbar.
2. Click **Remove Scorecard**.

Goals

The Goals area displays metrics from a scorecard added to the collaboration. The scenarios added to the collaboration all automatically display in the scorecard. You can change the data settings for the scorecard or what measures the data displays in. To view more detailed data or to change what scenarios are measured, you can open the scorecard outside of the collaboration. Any collaboration participant can add a scorecard to the Goals area.



► Change the scorecard in the collaboration

If you have access to more than one scorecard, you can change what data displays in the Goals area by changing the scorecard.

1. Click the scorecard name in the **Goals** area toolbar.
2. Click another scorecard in the **Select Scorecard** list.

The new scorecard now displays in the **Goals** area.

► Change how metric results display in the scorecard

You can change how the data values in the scenarios are measured by showing them as actual values, differences, percent differences, or scores.

- Do one of the following:
 - In the **Goals** area toolbar, click **Measure**  to change between the following measures:
 - **Scores**
 - **Differences**

- **% Differences**
- **Actual Values**
- Click **More**  on the **Goals** area toolbar and then click **Change Scorecard Measure** until the measure you want displays on the toolbar.

► **Refresh the data in the scorecard**

- On the **Goals** area toolbar, click **Refresh** .

► **Change the data settings for the scorecard**

1. Click **Settings**  on the **Goals** area toolbar.
2. In the **Scorecard Settings** pane, make changes to one or more setting.
3. Click **Close**  to close the **Scorecard Settings** pane.

► **View more detailed data for the scorecard**

You can view more detailed data by opening the scorecard outside of the collaboration. This view provides you with the ability to change which scenarios results display and drill to more detailed information.

1. Click **More**  on the **Goals** area toolbar.
 2. Click **Go to Detailed Scorecard**.
- The scorecard opens in a new tab.

Communicate in a collaboration

In addition to adding scenarios, resource links, and screenshots, collaborations are used to communication about the work specific to the collaboration. You can add posts to a collaboration or respond to a post in a comment.

You can filter the posts to view them order by posts created first or by posts with the most recent activity.

Activity

↑↓

Sort by Latest Activity

Sort posts



Post something new... Use @ to mention someone.



Oliver Haddad

15 mins edited

...

Edit or delete your posts

I have been able to shift some of the supply - but the orders for the required components don't have enough allocated supply to satisfy both the existing orders and the new ones.

Added [BG - Shift Supply](#)

Comment



Oliver Haddad

5 hrs

...

I'll take a look at shifting supply.

Comment



Bo Chen

5 hrs

...

Adding [Oliver Haddad](#)



Natasha Obasanjo

5 hrs edited

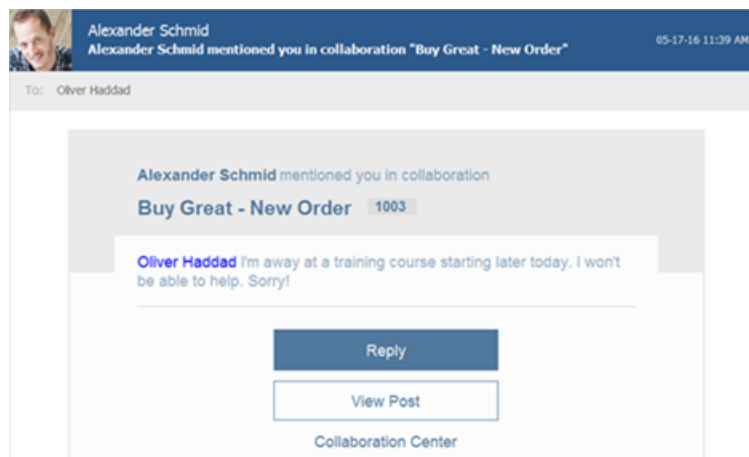
...

Thank you! 😊

Comment

Use the @ markup to add a new participant to a collaboration or to tag a collaboration participant.

When you are tagged in a collaboration, if you have access to Message Center, you are notified when you are mentioned in a post or comment.



Note: You cannot use @ markup to send yourself notifications from a collaboration.

► Add a new post to a collaboration

1. In the **Activity** area of a collaboration, type text in the **Post something new** box.
2. Click **Post**.

► Add a comment to a collaboration post

In the post you want to respond to, do one of the following:

- Click **More** ... and then click **Reply**.
- Click **Comment**.

► Edit a collaboration post or comment

You can edit or delete comments and posts that you have added to the collaboration.

1. Click **More** ... on the post or comment you want to edit.
2. Click **Edit**.
3. Make your changes and then click **Update**.

► Delete a collaboration post or comment

1. Click **More** ... on the post or comment you want to edit.
2. Click **Delete**.

► Filter posts

1. On the **Activity** bar, click **Latest Activity** or **Creation Date**.
2. Click **Latest Activity** or **Creation Date** in the pop up box.

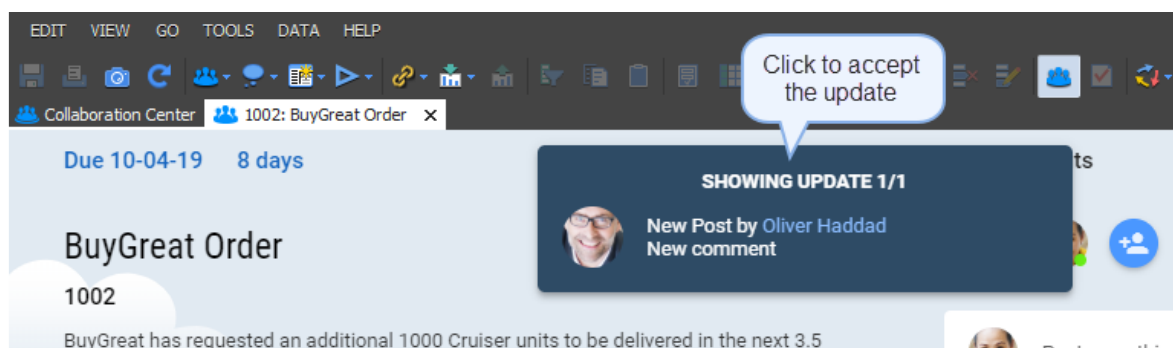
View the latest content in a collaboration

As participants are working simultaneously in an open collaboration, there are two ways for you to ensure that you are viewing the latest content for the collaboration:

- Accept the update notifications
- Refresh the collaboration

Accept update notifications for the collaboration

Update notifications display each time another participant has made a change to a collaboration you have open. This ensures that an active collaboration is not constantly changing from other participant's edits as you are working in it.



- Click anywhere in the notification pop up box to accept the update.
The newest comments and posts in the collaboration are briefly highlighted.



Note: Accepting an update does not affect content you are working on, for example a post or comment you have not sent yet.

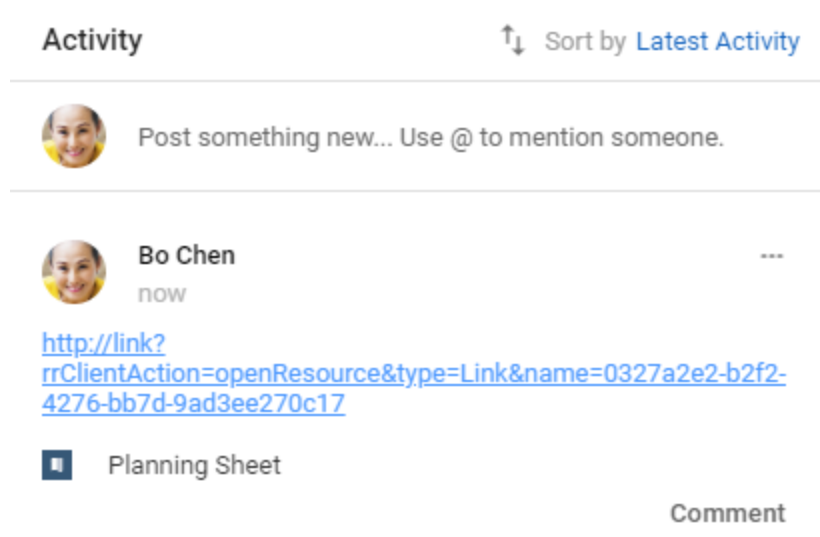
Refresh a collaboration

When you are uncertain of whether or not the content in an open collaboration is the most recent, you can refresh the collaboration.

1. Click **More** **...** on the Collaboration toolbar.
2. Click **Refresh Collaboration**.

Add resource links to a collaboration

As you work in a collaboration, you might want to share specific data views in resources. You can add a link to public dashboard, scorecard, or workbook in collaboration posts or comments.



When clicked, the link opens the resource with the data settings you specified. If you send a link to a resource that uses one or more private data settings, other users will not see the resource with its intended content. Before sending the link, either change the data settings to shared resources or share the private resources used in the data settings with those users.

Other participants open the link and see the resource with the data settings you specified. If a user does not have access to the resource, the link will not work for them.

If you have email forwarding turned on, notification messages from collaboration posts or comments, including those with resource links, are forwarded to your email.

You can also copy and paste resource links in external communications. For more information, see ["Copy and paste a resource link" on page 448](#).

1. Open the resource you want to add as a link to a collaboration.
2. Edit the data settings to display the data you want to share.
3. In the open resource, click **Link**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.
4. Click **Copy Link** .
5. In the collaboration, click in the post or comment box where you want to add the resource link.
6. Press CTRL-V to paste the link.
7. Click **Post** or **Comment**.

Add screenshots to a collaboration

You can add screenshots of private or public resources to a collaboration. If there is something you want to highlight on the resource, you can draw on the screenshot using annotation tools. You can use text, shapes, and a freehand drawing tool in different colors and remove any of the annotations at any time. For example, you might draw an arrow to point out a problem area in a worksheet screenshot.

Activity Sort by Latest Activity

 Post something new... Use @ to mention someone.

 **Oliver Haddad**
9 mins

 **Operations**



Annotation text added to the screenshot appears in the link

July-September showing significant drops - what's causing this?

Comment

By default, a link to the resource is also included in the post or comment. When clicked, the link opens the resource with the data settings you specified. If you send a screenshot with a link of a resource that uses one or more private data settings, other users will not see the resource with its intended content. Before taking the screenshot, either change the data settings to shared resources or share the private resources used in the data settings with those users.

► Add a screenshot to a collaboration

1. In the open resource, click **Screenshot**  on the RapidResponse toolbar.
2. Click **Share** .
3. Do one of the following:
 - To start a new collaboration with the screenshot, click **New Collaboration**.
 - To add the screenshot to an existing collaboration, click the collaboration name in the **Existing Collaborations** list.

► Add annotations to a screenshot

1. Click an annotation tool on the Annotation toolbar. To learn about the different tools and what they do, see the "[Annotation tools](#)" on page 539 table below.
2. To draw a shape, line, or arrow, tap on the shape on the toolbar and click and drag on the screenshot to draw the shape.
3. To add text, click **Text Tool**  and then click and drag on the screenshot to draw the text box. Then start typing text in the box.
4. To remove the last annotation drawn, click **Undo** .
5. To remove all annotations from the screenshot, click **Delete All** .



Notes:

- Once an annotation is drawn, you cannot move it on the screenshot or change its color.
- Screenshots are not saved after you close them or share them in a collaboration.

► Change the color for an annotation

- Click a color drop on the toolbar and then click the tool you want to use.

Annotation tools

The following drawing and text tools are available in RapidResponse:

	Delete All. Removes all annotations from the screenshot. This action cannot be undone.
	Undo. Removes the most recently added annotation object, such as a box or line. You can use this tool repeatedly to remove successively placed objects.
	Zoom and Pan Tool. Zooms in or pans out from the screenshot. Use the scroll wheel on your mouse.
	Pen Tool. Draws freehand lines.
	Rectangle Tool. Draws a box. Start where you want to place the first corner and drag to enlarge the box.
	Circle Tool. Draws a circle. Start at the center of the circle and drag outward to widen the circle.

	Arrow Tool. Draws an arrow. Start at the base of the arrow and drag to position the tip of the arrow.
	Text Tool. Adds text. Start where you want to place the first corner and drag to enlarge the text box. Once the box is in position, you can type text. The font cannot be changed.
	Ink Color. Changes the color of the annotation. The currently selected color displays as an outline and is underlined.

Commit a scenario in a collaboration

When the collaboration team has decided on a solution or approach, changes made in one or more child scenarios can be committed back to the parent scenario. You might also commit a scenario to see how your solution fits with the solutions from other collaboration participants. You can only commit scenarios that you own and have shared in the collaboration.

1. In the **Scenario** area, click **More**  for the scenario you want to commit.
2. Click **Commit Scenario**.
3. In the **Commit Scenario** form, select the action to apply to the child scenario from the **After commit** control.

The default action is to remove and delete the child scenario.

Optionally, you can add a note with the commit. The information you provide in the note also displays in the **Collaboration Summary** and **Activity Log** entries in the scenario properties for the parent scenario. For more information, see ["Track activity in a scenario" on page 467](#) and ["View information about a scenario" on page 466](#).

4. Type text in the **Subject** control. The default subject identifies the child and parent scenarios.
5. Type text in the **Message** control. For example, you might provide a summary of the changes you are committing.
6. In the **Add response** control, select one of the following:
 - **Accept**—your actions solved the problem in your area of responsibility.
 - **Reject**—you are unable to solve the problem.
7. Click **Commit**.

For more information, see ["Commit data changes to a parent scenario" on page 474](#).



Note: If there is only one scenario in the collaboration and you commit it, the collaboration automatically closes after the commit.

Generate and distribute a report of your actions

After you have settled on a course of action to resolve the problem in the collaboration, you can generate a report of the actions the team has taken, or have decided to take. You can use this report as a guide when making changes in your enterprise data sources.

The report consists of the collaboration scenario's summary and activity log, and can optionally include the pending data changes made in the scenario. You can choose to include the data changes if you have simulated your solution in RapidResponse. You can send the report to all participants who have responded to the scenario and depending on how they have configured their message settings, they receive it as a message attachment in Message Center or their email.

The activity report can be customized so people involved in the collaboration can see only their own changes, or the report can include every contributor's changes together. Generating a customized report for each person involved in the collaboration is a resource-intensive process, and might take several minutes.

► Generate and distribute a report

1. In the **Scenarios** pane, click the scenario you are collaborating on.
2. On the **File** menu, click **Properties**.
3. On the toolbar, click **Distribute Activity Report** .
4. In the **Distribute Activity Report** dialog box, in the **Distribute the activity report to** area, click one of the following:
 - **Everyone who has responded to this scenario**—Sends a copy of the activity report to the collaborators who have added a response. Anybody the scenario is shared with, but who has not responded, is not sent a copy of the report.
 - **Me**—Sends a copy of the activity report only to you.
5. If you want to include the information on the **Data Changes (Pending Commits)** tab, select the **Include pending data change details** check box, and then click one of the following:
 - **All changes**—Each recipient receives a report that contains changes made by every user with access to the scenario.
 - **Only changes made by the report recipient**—Each recipient receives a report that contains only the changes they made.
6. In the **File name** box, type the name for the report file.
7. In the **File type** box, click the type of file you want to save the report as.
8. In the **Subject** box, modify the subject of the message that the report will be attached to.
9. In the **Message** box, type a message that will be sent to each recipient.
You can add a link to a report in the message. For more information, see ["Add links to scenario notifications" on page 492](#).
10. Click **OK**.

► View the report

1. In **Message Center**, click the message that includes your copy of the activity report.
2. On the Message Center toolbar, click **Open Attachment** .



Tip: You can also save the attachment by clicking **Save Attachment**  on the Message Center toolbar.

Archive a collaboration

After you have successfully completed a collaboration, you move it from the open collaboration list to the archived collaboration list. A collaboration is considered successful if all the problems in the scenario's data can be resolved without having a negative impact on other data. Changes made in a successful collaboration must be implemented in your enterprise data system.

When the collaboration is archived, the descriptive text and posts and comment are saved. If you delete resources or scenarios that had been shared in the collaboration, the archived collaboration is still saved and the missing resource links and scenarios are identified.

Any collaboration participant can archive a collaboration and if it was archived by mistake or needs to be revisited, you can make it active again by reopening the collaboration.

Optionally, you can update the scenario status and send a message to all participants of the collaboration team. For more information, see ["Change a scenario's status" on page 478](#).



Note: As collaboration leader or administrator, you cannot remove people from an archived collaboration.

► **Archive a collaboration**

1. Click **More** ... on the Collaboration toolbar.
2. Click **Archive Collaboration**.
The open collaboration background turns entirely gray.

► **Reopen an archived collaboration**

1. Click **More** ... on the Collaboration toolbar.
2. Click **Reopen Collaboration**.

CHAPTER 38: Running business processes

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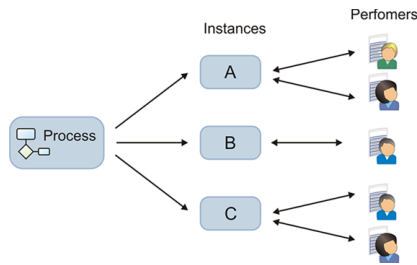
Execution of processes requires a person, typically referred to as a process owner, designated for starting the process instance and monitoring its progress. As a process owner in RapidResponse, you are responsible for creating process instances of a given process whenever they are required.

You are also responsible for ensuring that the instances start on time and are completed in a prompt manner. Other RapidResponse users participate in the business process, and are tasked with performing process activities. For information about participating in business processes, see ["Participating in business processes" on page 95](#).

After you create a new process instance, you can adjust the properties of the process instance and the individual activities within the instance. For example, you can change the timing of activities, or the conditions in which automatic notifications are sent. This allows you to adapt to special circumstances in a particular instance, without affecting the properties of the process that was used to create the process instance. For more information about changing activity properties, see ["Change activity properties" on page 546](#).

Create a process instance

The processes in the Explorer are definitions of various processes used by your company and serve as a starting point for running a process instance. Users do not interact with the process definition, rather they interact with a process instance, as shown in the following illustration.



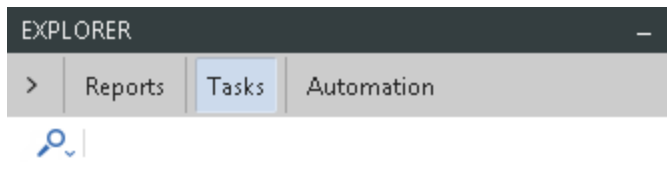
When you want to start running a process, you must create an instance of it. Creating an instance schedules an actionable process instance and:

- Sets the start date for the process.
- Activates the notifications associated with the process. For example, you might have reminders sent to participants a day before an activity is scheduled to start.
- Displays the activities to performers in resources designed for working with business processes, and allows the performers to update activity status.

► Create an instance

To run a process you must create an instance of it that users can interact with. You can create a process instance on an as needed basis. You can also create multiple process instances and schedule them to begin when required. For example, if your company's regular S&OP cycle starts at the beginning of every month, you can create a year's worth of instances and schedule them to start at the beginning of every month.

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that processes are shown. You can do that by selecting **Tasks**.



2. Click a process, and then on the **Actions** menu, click **Create Instance**.



Note: The **Create Instance** option is not available when the process instance's properties are open.

3. In the **New Process Instance** dialog box, in the **Name** box, type the name of the process instance. Ensure that the name will be meaningful to the performers participating in the process.
4. In the **Type** list, select the process instance type suitable for the instance. The type controls the calendar used by the process instance. The default type selected is the type specified by the process author.
5. In the **Start** date list, specify the date you expect the process to start on. This date is used to calculate the expected start dates of all the activities in the process instance. It is also the date used when generating certain notifications. For example, participants can be notified several days before a process instance is supposed to start.
6. Although it includes content defined by the process author, in the **Description** box, you can make changes to the description of the process instance.

7. In the **After creation** area, in the list, click the workbook you want to open after you have created the instance.

► **Include links to reports in the process instance description**

1. In the **New Process Instance** dialog box, click inside the **Description** box.
2. Click **Add Link**.
3. In the **Insert Link** dialog box, click one of the following:
 - **An open report**—inserts a link to a currently opened and shared workbook, scorecard, or dashboard.
 - **Report**—inserts a link to any shared workbook, scorecard, or dashboard.
 - **Web page**—inserts a link to an external website.
4. Click **Next**.
5. In the dialog box that opens, define the link properties.

► **Review the process instance**

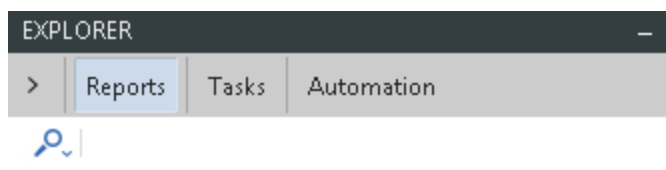
After creating the instance you can review it to ensure all of the activity start dates are scheduled as desired. You might also want to review the performers assigned to the activities. For example, if you are aware that particular performers are away during a scheduled activity, you might want to assign different performers to the activity.

1. If the **Process Activities** workbook is not open, open it by double-clicking it in the **Explorer**.
2. Review the calendar to ensure the dates of the activities.
3. To display the tree view of the process instance, on the workbook toolbar click the **Calendar** button.
4. Review the information in the workbook.

Edit process instance properties

You can change the properties of a process instance at any time after creating it.

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that workbooks are shown. You can do this by selecting **Reports**.



2. Double-click the **Process Activities** workbook.
3. On the workbook toolbar, click **Calendar** to display the tree-view of the activities.
4. In the **Process Instance** list, click a process instance.
5. On the workbook toolbar, click **Process Instance Properties** .
6. In the **Edit Process Instance** dialog box, make the desired changes.

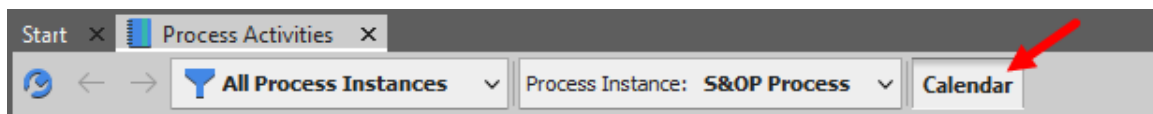
Change activity properties

Process authors typically define most aspects of a given process, from activity durations to the performers assigned to the activities. When creating an instance of a process, you can change the properties of its activities to ensure that they meet the requirements of the specific process occurrence. For example, you might need to adjust the duration of an activity if it needs to be completed early, or play around with the activity start dates to adjust the length of the process.

You can change activity properties within a process instance in the Process Activities workbook, in the Activity Properties dialog box.

► Open the Activity Properties dialog box

1. In the **Process Activities** workbook, if the calendar is displayed, click **Calendar** to display the tree-view of the activities.



2. Click the **Activity Properties** button in the row of the activity you want to modify.

► Specify the activity start day and duration

1. In the **Activity Properties** dialog box, click the **General** tab.
2. In the **Start on day** box, type the day number on which the activity starts.
The number you type is the number of days in relation to the date the process instance starts. For example, if the process starts on October 15, 2012, an activity that is specified to start on day 4 will start on October 18, 2012.
3. In the **Duration** box, type the number of days the activity is expected to take.



Tip: You can also change the activity start day and duration directly on the process page by typing values in the **Start on day** and **Duration** columns.

► Provide instructions for performing an activity

The process author should have defined instructions for performing the activity, including:

- Directions about the tasks they must perform to complete an activity.
- Links to any resources used during the activity. For example, if users require a workbook or scorecard to complete their task the link in the instructions allows them to access it quickly and in context of the activity.

You can modify the instructions if required.

1. In the **Activity Properties** dialog box, click the **General** tab.
2. In the **Instructions** box, type any information that can help users perform their tasks.
3. To add a link to a report or **URL** to the instructions, click **Add Link**.
4. In the **Insert Link** dialog box, click one of the following.
 - **An open report**—inserts a link to a currently opened and shared workbook, scorecard, or dashboard.

- **Report**—inserts a link to any shared workbook, scorecard, or dashboard.
 - **Form**—inserts a link to a shared form.
 - **Web page**—inserts a link to an external website.
5. Click **Next**.
 6. In the dialog box that opens, define the link properties.

► Specify the people who perform activities

For each activity, you can specify the RapidResponse users who will be responsible for performing it. These users will then be able to see their activities in dashboards and workbooks that are designed for working with process activities. If notifications are defined for the activity, they might also be notified when they are supposed to start the activity, or when preceding activities are complete.

IMPORTANT: It is recommended that you avoid using groups when defining performers. Users change their progress status for an activity, for example from In Progress to Finished, so that the process owner can monitor the overall progress of an activity. When a group is defined as a performer, it is not possible to determine the status at the user level.

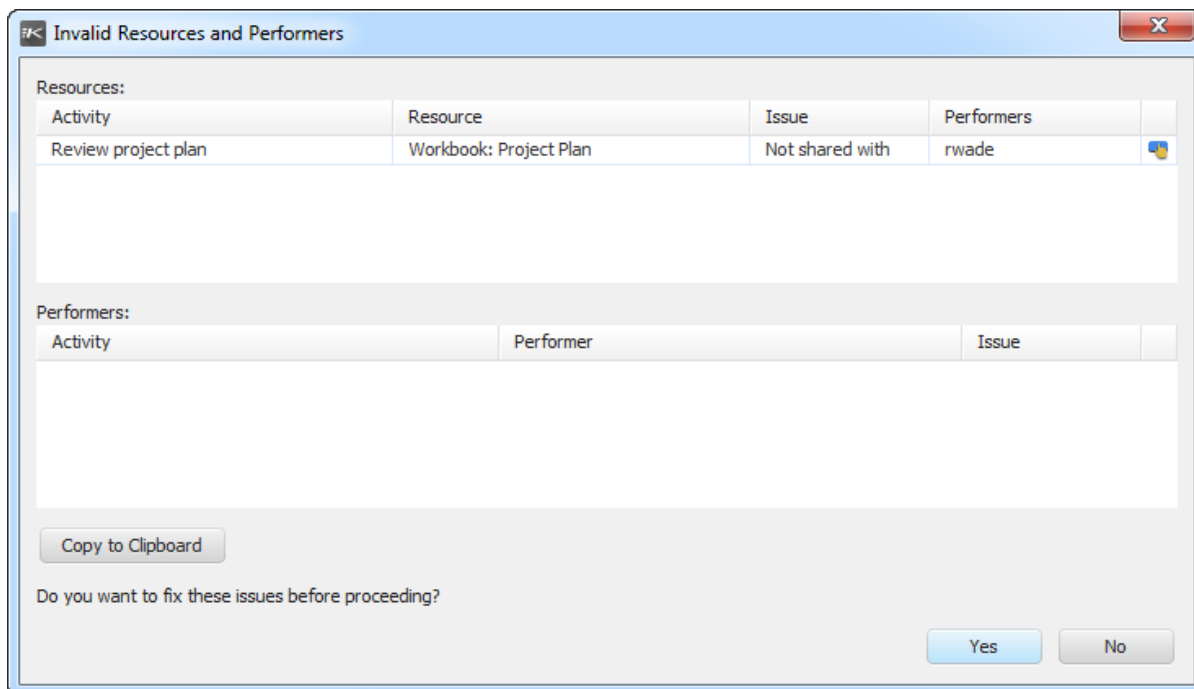
1. In the **Activity Properties** dialog box, click the **Performers** tab.
2. Click **Add**.
3. In the **Select Names** dialog box, on the **Users** tab,
4. In the **Select Names** dialog box, do any of the following:
 - On the **Users** tab, select the users you want to perform this activity, and then click **Select**.
 - On the **Groups** tab, select the groups you want to perform this process, and then click **Select**.
5. Click **OK**.



Note: To remove users or groups from the activity, on the **Performers** tab select those you want to remove, and then click **Remove**.

► Activity validation

When changing the activity properties, you might occasionally see the following dialog box, which indicates that there are some issues with the activity.



The **Resources** list displays issues related to RapidResponse resources, such as workbooks or dashboards, identified in the activity. There are two issues that can arise with resources:

- A resource identified in the activity is not available on the RapidResponse system you are using. This can occur if a process has been imported from another RapidResponse system but the required resources have not, or, when a resource has been deleted from RapidResponse.
- A resource is not shared with a RapidResponse user who requires it to perform an activity.

The **Performers** list displays the activities that have performers that are not in the RapidResponse system. This might occur if a RapidResponse user account is deleted or if the process is imported from another RapidResponse system.

When this dialog box displays, it is recommended that you review and fix the issues if possible, however, you have the option to continue without fixing the problems.

1. In the **Invalid Resources and Performers** dialog box, click **Yes**.
2. The **Activity Properties** dialog box opens, where you can make the required changes.

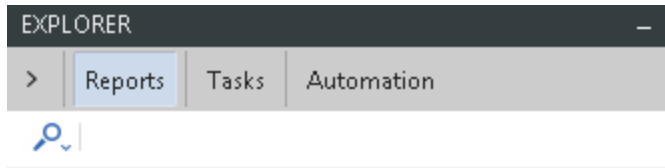
Change the status of a process instance and activities

You can change the status of a process instance to indicate that work has started on a process instance or that an instance has been completed.

Certain notification messages are related to the status of a process instance, therefore, It is particularly important that you change the status of a process instance to In Progress when performers begin working on it. For example, performers might receive needless notifications that a process instance is late if its status is set to Not Started past its expected start date.

► Change the status of a process instance

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that workbooks are shown. You can do this by clicking **Reports**.



2. Double-click the **Process Activities** workbook.
3. If the calendar is displayed, on the toolbar click **Calendar** to display the tree view.
4. In the **Process Instance** list, click the process instance for which you want to change the status.
5. On the workbook toolbar, click **Edit Process Instance**.
6. In the **Edit Process Instance** dialog box, in the **Status** list, click a status.

► Change a process instance to historical

If you do not want to delete a previously completed process instance, but do not want the activities from this process instance to be displayed in process calendar dashboard widgets, you can mark the process instance as historical.

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that processes are shown. You can do this by selecting **Tasks**.
2. Select a process, and then on the **Actions** menu click **View Instances**.
3. Ensure that **Details** is selected on the workbook toolbar.
4. In the **Historical** column of the process instance you want, select the check box.



Note: RapidResponse administrators can still see historical process instances in calendar widgets.

► Change the status of an activity

As a process owner, you can change the status of any activities in a process instance.

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that workbooks are shown. You can do this by clicking **Reports**.
2. Double click the **Process Activities** workbook.
3. In the **Calendar**, click the activity you want.
4. In the pop-up dialog box, in the list beside the performer name you want, click a status.

Delete a process instance

You can delete process instances when required.

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that processes are shown. You can do this by clicking **Tasks**.
2. Click a process and then on the **Actions** menu click **View Instances**.
3. In the **Process Instances** workbook, select a process instance and then on the workbook toolbar click **Delete** .

About process instance notifications

A key aspect of successfully executed business processes is communication of activity and process progress to the process owner and performers. Process authors can create notifications so that performers and process owners can be kept informed about how a process instance is progressing. As a process owner, you can modify the notifications for each instance of a process if required.

Notifications are sent once a day at a time defined by your RapidResponse administrator, with the exception of status-based notifications on activities, which are sent when a performer or process owner changes the status of an activity.

You can add or modify notifications at the process level and at the activity level.

Process and activity level notification criteria

You can set notifications at the process instance level, mainly to let performers and process owners know when a process instance is about to start or when it is late starting.

At the process instance level and also at the activity level, RapidResponse includes the following notification criteria (where n stands for the number of days you specify):

- Scheduled to start in (n) days
- Scheduled to finish (n) days
- Late starting by (n) days
- Late finishing by (n) days

Activity level notification criteria

You can define notifications that apply to all of the activities in a process. You can also define notifications for individual activities in a process.

The notifications listed above, in the *Process level notifications* section, are also available at the activity level.

Additionally, at the activity level, the following status-based notification criteria are available. When you choose any of these options, the notification is generated when a performer changes the status

- Started
- Finished
- Started early
- Finished early

Create or modify process instance notifications

For an overview of notifications, see ["About process instance notifications" on page 550](#).

► Add a notification

1. In the **Process Instances** workbook, click **Process Instance Properties**  for the process instance you want to modify.
2. Click the **Notifications** tab.
3. In the **Send when this process instance is** area, click **Add**.
4. In the list at the top of the **Add Process Notification** dialog box, click the criteria on which you want to send a notification.
5. In the days(s) box, type the number of days as they relate to the notification criteria.
6. In the **Send to** area, select any of the following:
 - **Process owner**—sends the notification to the process owner that created the process instance.
 - **Performers**—sends the notification to all performers defined in the process instance.
7. To notify other RapidResponse users not involved in the process or recipients outside of your company, do any of the following:
 - To add other RapidResponse users, click **Select Names**. In the **Select Names** dialog box add the users and groups you want and then click **OK**.
 - To add recipients who do not have a RapidResponse account, click **Email Addresses**. In the **Email Addresses** dialog box, type the email addresses to which you want to send the notifications. The addresses must be separated by commas or semicolons.

► Modify an existing notification

1. In the **Process Instances** workbook, click **Process Instance Properties**  for the process instance you want to modify.
2. Click the **Notifications** tab.
3. In the **Send when this process instance is** area, select the notification you want to modify, and then click **Edit**.
4. In the list at the top of the **Edit Process Notification** dialog box, click the criteria on which you want to send a notification.
5. In the days(s) box, type the number of days as they relate to the notification criteria.
6. In the **Send to** area, select any of the following:
 - **Process owner**—sends the notification to the process owner that created the process instance.
 - **Performers**—sends the notification to all performers defined in the process instance.
7. To notify other RapidResponse users not involved in the process or recipients outside of your company, do any of the following:
 - To add other RapidResponse users, click **Select Names**. In the **Select Names** dialog box add the users and groups you want and then click **OK**.
 - To add recipients who do not have a RapidResponse account, click **Email Addresses**. In the **Email Addresses** dialog box, type the email addresses to which you want to send the notifications. The addresses must be separated by commas or semicolons.

Create or modify activity notifications

You can create notifications that apply globally to all the activities defined in the process and notifications that apply only to a particular activity.

In general, you might want to limit the number of notifications applicable to all the activities in the process to minimize instances of sending email messages that are not required.

For an overview of notifications, see ["About process instance notifications" on page 550](#).

► Create notifications for all activities in a process instance

1. In the **Process Instances** workbook, click **Process Instance Properties**  for the process you want to modify.
2. Click the **Notifications** tab.
3. In the **Send when an activity is** area, click **Add**.
4. In the list at the top of the **Add Process Notification** dialog box, click the criteria on which you want to send a notification.
5. To notify the process owner, select the **Process owner** check box.
6. To notify performers, click one of the following:
 - **All performers**—notifies all performers involved in the activities.
 - One of the following options, which change depending on the criteria that is selected in the list at the top of the dialog box:
 - **Performers that have not started**—available when the selected criteria is **Scheduled to start in** or **Late starting by**.
 - **Performers that have not finished**—available when the selected criteria is **Scheduled to finish in** or **Late finishing by**.
 - **None**—none of the performers are modified.
7. To notify other **RapidResponse** users not involved in the process or recipients outside of your company, do any of the following:
 - To add other RapidResponse users, click **Select Names**. In the **Select Names** dialog box add the users and groups you want and then click **OK**.
 - To add recipients who do not have a RapidResponse account, click **Email Addresses**. In the **Email Addresses** dialog box, type the email addresses to which you want to send the notifications. The addresses must be separated by commas or semicolons.

► Create notifications for an individual activity in a process instance

1. In the **Process Instances** workbook, click on the name of the process that you want to modify. The **Process Activities** workbook opens.
2. On the **Process Activities** tab of the **Process Activities** workbook, ensure that the Gantt chart view is selected. If the worksheet is displayed in calendar view, click **Calendar** on the workbook toolbar to toggle the view.
3. Click **Activity Properties**  for the activity that you want to modify.
4. Click the **Notifications** tab and select the **Override Notifications** check box.

Any notifications that have been defined for all activities are listed in the **Send when an activity is box**. You can turn on or turn off any of these notifications by selecting or clearing the corresponding check box.

5. Click **Add**.
6. In the list at the top of the **Add Process Notification** dialog box, click the criteria on which you want to send a notification.
7. To notify the process owner, select the **Process owner** check box.
8. To notify performers, click one of the following:
 - **All performers**—notifies all performers involved in the activities.
 - One of the following options, which change depending on the criteria that is selected in the list at the top of the dialog box:
 - **Performers that have not started**—available when the selected criteria is **Scheduled to start in** or **Late starting by**.
 - **Performers that have not finished**—available when the selected criteria is **Scheduled to finish in** or **Late finishing by**.
 - **None**—none of the performers are modified.
9. To notify other **RapidResponse** users not involved in the process or recipients outside of your company, do any of the following:
 - To add other RapidResponse users, click **Select Names**. In the **Select Names** dialog box add the users and groups you want and then click **OK**.
 - To add recipients who do not have a RapidResponse account, click **Email Addresses**. In the **Email Addresses** dialog box, type the email addresses to which you want to send the notifications. The addresses must be separated by commas or semicolons.

CHAPTER 39: Extensions and add-in applications

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Your RapidResponse administrator might have given you access to the Extensions and Add-ins panes. In the Extensions pane, you can access external applications from Kinaxis, any custom external applications developed by your company, and links to internal or external Web pages or documents.

In the Add-ins pane you can access add-in applications, which are custom applications generally developed by your company. These applications typically address specific processes or solutions to daily operations. Add-in applications do not have a user interface. Once accessed, they run and perform a specific task.

Access an external application or link

- In the **Extensions** pane, click an application or click a link.

Run an add-in application

1. In the **Add-ins** pane, select an add-in application.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Run**.



Notes:

- If the add-in application is developed to run in the foreground, you will be unable to perform any other tasks in RapidResponse while the application is running. When an application runs in the foreground, an hourglass is displayed, and you are notified when the process is complete.
- If the add-in application is developed to run in the background, you can continue working in RapidResponse. You are not notified when the application finishes running.

Scheduling the running of an add-in

Add-in applications can be scheduled to run at specific times using the RapidResponse RunAddin command. For more information about scheduling, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

View information about an add-in application

When implementing an add-in application, your RapidResponse administrator can include important information about the application, which you can review.

1. In the **Add-ins** pane, select an add-in application.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.

Part 6: Automating tasks

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- ["Monitoring data with alerts"](#) on page 573
- ["Scheduling tasks"](#) on page 591
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- ["Automating sequences of tasks"](#) on page 607
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CHAPTER 40: About automation tasks

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RapidResponse automation tasks are resources that support automated processes. You can use automation tasks to automatically modify data, run other automated processes, and notify you of changes made by the process. Automation tasks consist of alerts, scheduled tasks, automation chains, and scripts.

- Alerts are typically used for monitoring dashboard, workbook or scorecard data for changes, so that you are notified when a specific condition is met. This feature can be used for exception reporting. For more information, see ["About alerts and data monitoring" on page 560](#).
- Alerts can also be used to send regularly scheduled reports. For more information, see ["Scheduling reports" on page 307](#).
- Scheduled tasks are typically used to automatically run data modifications and scripts. For more information, see ["About scheduled tasks" on page 560](#).
- Scripts typically represent a custom application, and are used to perform an automated process. For more information, see ["About scripting" on page 560](#).
- Forms are interfaces based on scripts that are used to run automated business tasks. For more information, see ["About forms" on page 601](#).
- Automation chains are used to run a sequence of other automation tasks. For more information, see ["About automation chains" on page 561](#).

You can run any automation task you have access to. For more information, see ["Running automation tasks manually" on page 617](#).

About alerts and data monitoring

Using alerts, you can monitor your worksheet or scorecard data for changes that you specify, allowing you to respond as soon as they occur. You can also generate reports about the affected data and alert other people when your condition occurs.

When your specified condition is met you receive a message in RapidResponse Message Center and, optionally, in your email. You can also choose to send alerts to other RapidResponse users or even people who do not use RapidResponse. The message will include a link to the affected data. For example, you can send material planners a daily report listing all the parts with excess inventory greater than \$50,000.

You can also generate reports that will be included in the message sent when your condition occurs. The report shows the data as it was when the change occurred. To view the current affected data in RapidResponse, anybody you send alert messages to must also have permission to access the resources the alert uses, such as the workbook, filter, and scenario.

Data values monitored by or specified in alerts are not updated after the alert is created. This ensures the values specified for an alert remain constant, however, in some cases this might produce unexpected results in the alert. For example, if your alert uses the Today date constant in a date value, that value is not updated, which can result in date values that are out of date. You can modify the alert to update the value, or you can monitor different data. Typically, the Today date constant should not be used for scheduling, because it can be interpreted as different dates for different users. For more information, see ["About modifying automation tasks" on page 562](#).

You must have permission to create alerts. For more information, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

About scheduled tasks

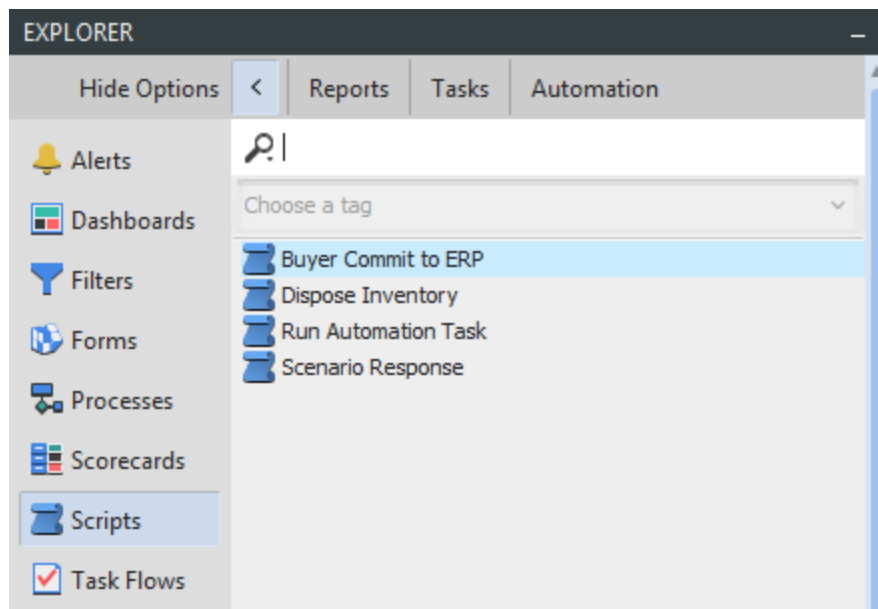
If your administrator has granted you the appropriate permission, you can schedule tasks to run on a regular basis. For example, if you have access to a script, you can run that script on a daily or weekly basis, or whenever data in a scenario is modified.

The types of scheduled tasks you can create depend on the resources available to you. For example, you can create scheduled tasks that run scripts if you have access to at least one script, or you can create scheduled tasks to run data modifications if you have access to a workbook with a data modification defined in it. For more information, see ["Scheduling tasks" on page 591](#).

About scripting

Scripts can be used to automate parts of your business processes, such as creating and updating historical scenarios or ensuring data changes are available in multiple scenarios. Scripts perform a specific series of actions, and are typically provided by your RapidResponse administrator or a user with script authoring permission.

Scripts you have access to are shown in the Explorer.



For more information about running scripts, see ["Run a script" on page 623](#). For more information about viewing scripts that have run, see ["Script logging" on page 652](#).

For information about creating scripts, see the [RapidResponse Scripting Guide](#).



Note: You might have access to scripts that are linked to workbooks, and do not appear in the **Explorer**. You can run these scripts only through a workbook command. For more information, see ["Run workbook commands" on page 360](#).

About automation chains

Automation chains define a series of automation tasks—alerts, scheduled tasks, and automation chains—that run in the sequence specified. Each automation task represents a step in the automation chain, and each step runs either when the step before it finishes or at the same time as other steps, depending on how you have configured the automation chain.

Each step's notification messages are sent as defined in its properties. You could use an automation chain to, for example, run a scheduled task that creates a scenario using a script, run a sequence of scheduled tasks that run workbook commands to modify data in that scenario, and then run an alert that reports the results of those changes.

Typically, an automation task that runs as part of an automation chain should be unscheduled and turned off, which ensures it runs only as part of the automation chain. For more information see ["Schedule when an automation task runs" on page 591](#).

Depending on the steps specified for the automation chain, the automation tasks can be configured to only run if the step before it ran successfully. For more information, see ["Add steps to an automation chain" on page 609](#).

About modifying automation tasks

If you have authoring permission for a specific type of automation task, such as alerts, you can modify your private tasks and any public tasks you own. To modify a public automation task, you must check the resource out of the versioned repository. All public resources are stored in a centralized, versioned repository where multiple versions of a resource are tracked along with comments about any changes to the resources. This version control supports resource development by controlling and tracking changes, ownership and prevents conflicts in multi-authoring environments. To make a private automation task public, you must add the task to the versioned repository. For more information about version control, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

In RapidResponse systems with version control turned off, you can modify private and shared automation tasks you own without adding or checking the tasks in or out of a versioned repository.



Caution: If you have upgraded from RapidResponse 2013.4 or earlier, and version control is turned on, you should not revert changes to the automation tasks you own if they are used in an automation chain. Doing so can cause automation chains to not run, which can break processes.

Use a temporary scenario in an automation task

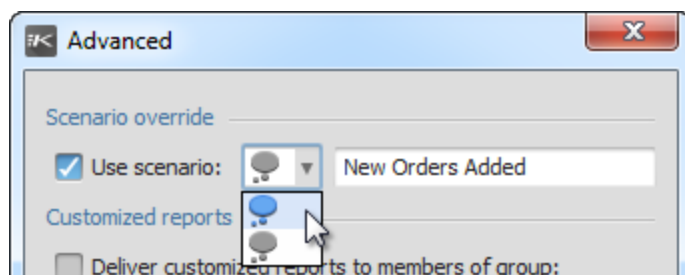
You can use advanced options to specify a scenario that doesn't exist yet to be used with an alert or scheduled task. Ensure you spell the scenario correctly, because if the name does not match the temporary scenario, the automation task fails.

Although resources that refer to private scenarios typically cannot be added to the versioned repository, alerts and scheduled tasks that refer to a private temporary scenario using a scenario override can be added to the versioned repository. For more information about adding resources to the versioned repository, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

Specify a temporary scenario for an alert

You might want to create an alert that monitors data in a scenario that does not exist, such as a temporary scenario created by a script. Because the scenario does not normally appear in the RapidResponse user interface, you cannot select it from the list in the New Alert dialog box.

An alert that monitors a temporary scenario cannot be run manually if the scenario does not exist.



► Specify a temporary scenario for an alert

1. In the **New Alert** dialog box, on the **General** tab, click **Advanced**.
2. In the **Scenario override** area, select the **Use scenario** check box.
3. In the **Scenario override** area, select the Shared  or Private  scenario icon from the drop-down list.
4. In the **Use scenario** text box, type the name of the scenario.
5. Click **OK**.



Notes:

- The scenario specified in the Use scenario text box is used instead of the one specified on the General tab. When the Use scenario check box is selected, the Scenario list on the Condition tab appears dimmed.
- If you select the Use scenario check box, you cannot leave the scenario name blank.

Specify a temporary scenario for a scheduled task

For data modification tasks, you can run the scheduled task using a scenario that does not exist when you create the scheduled task. For example, the scenario might be created as part of another process, or created by a script that runs in another scheduled task. Because you cannot select the scenario, you must know what the scenario name is before you create the scheduled task.

The scenario you specify is used in place of the one you specify in the scheduled task's properties.

► Specify a scenario to use in a scheduled task

1. In the **New Scheduled Task - Modify Data** or **Modify Data Scheduled Task Properties** dialog box, on the **General** tab, click **Advanced**.
2. In the **Scenario override** area, select the **Use scenario** check box.
3. In the **Scenario override** area, select the Shared  or Private  scenario icon from the drop-down list.
4. In the **Use scenario** box, type the name of the scenario to use.
5. Click **OK**.

Allow automation task customization

You can specify how other users run alerts and scheduled tasks you share with them. Automation chains cannot be customized, and the settings for each alert or scheduled task in the automation chain are used.

Using the owner's settings when running an automation task

For alerts and scheduled tasks, you can specify that the automation task runs using the task owner's resource access and settings. This offers a couple of advantages:

- It allows other users to run automation tasks that use resources they do not have access to.
This applies to both resources and permissions. For example, if you share a scheduled task that runs a script, the user who runs that scheduled task can perform any functions within that script, such as sharing scenarios, that they otherwise do not have permission to perform. In this case, you can limit the scheduled task to other users who have the same level of permission as you.

In addition, if you are using a shared script, other users could edit the script after you create and share the scheduled task. This could introduce functions that you have permission to perform but other users do not, and could violate your company's security policies. To prevent this, you could use only private scripts or have the scheduled task run with each user's resources and permissions.
- It ensures that the automation task is not affected by personal workbook settings of the users running the automation task.
This can help to provide consistent results. For example, an alert that generates a report will not use different bucket settings depending on the personal workbook settings of users who run the alert. However, if this option is selected, the scheduled task or alert owner's settings affect the results that other users get when they run it.

Using the settings of the person who ran the automation task

Alternatively, you can run the automation task using the other user's resource access, which also allows those users to run the automation task manually using data settings they want or to choose who to notify when the automation task is successful.

If you do not allow users to change any settings, the automation task runs with the data and notification settings that you created.

For more information, see ["Share an automation task" on page 568](#).



Note: The settings you allow to be customized apply only when the alert or scheduled task is run manually. For automation tasks that run on a schedule or as part of an automation chain, the settings you specify are always used. To ensure the automation chain runs successfully for these users, you should ensure the resources the automation task requires are shared with the user.

► Specify that an alert runs using the owner's RapidResponse account

1. In the **Explorer**, select the alert you want.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.

3. On the **General** tab, in the **Sharing** area, click **Alert owner**.

► **Specify that a scheduled task runs using the owner's RapidResponse account**

1. In the **Explorer**, select the scheduled task you want.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. On the **General** tab, in the **Sharing** area, click **Scheduled task owner**.

► **Specify that the automation task runs using the user's RapidResponse account**

1. In the **Explorer**, select the automation task you want.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. On the **General** tab, in the **Sharing** area, click **User**.

► **Allow the user to control data settings and notifications**

1. In the **Explorer**, select the automation task you want.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
3. On the **General** tab, in the **Sharing** area, click **User**.
4. To allow users to change data settings, select the **Data settings** check box.
5. To allow users to change notification settings, select the **Notification settings** check box.



Notes:

- You must separately share scenarios, filters, and sites that the automation task depends on. Workbooks, scorecards, and scripts are shared automatically.
- Users who do not own the automation task cannot alter failure notification settings.
- If you do not have permission to share the automation task, the **Sharing** section does not appear.

Modify an automation task

Sometimes you might want to make changes to an alert. For example, you might want to change when the alert runs, add a recipient, change the scenario that is monitored, or change the search conditions. You can edit any alert you have created. If you change the resources required by the alert, you should ensure every recipient has access to the new resources. For more information, see "[Modify an alert](#)" on [page 588](#).

You can modify a scheduled task you own. For example, you might want to change when the scheduled task runs, add a notification message recipient, or change the scenario the scheduled task runs on. If you change the resources required by the scheduled task, you should ensure every recipient has access to the new resources. For more information, see "[Modify a scheduled task](#)" on [page 599](#).

You can modify any automation chain you own. You can change when the automation chain runs, add a notification message recipient, add or remove steps, change the order the steps run in, or edit the automation tasks the automation chain runs. If you change the steps the automation chain runs, you should ensure every recipient has access to the alerts, scheduled tasks, or automation chains you have added to the automation chain. For more information, see "[Modify an automation chain](#)" on [page 614](#).

If any of the alerts, scheduled tasks, or automation chains are public resources that you own, you must first check the resource out of the versioned repository. For more information, see ["About modifying automation tasks" on page 562](#) and the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

Copy an automation task

When you create an automation task by copying any automation task you have access to. If you copy a private automation task, you must specify a name for the new automation task.

Copying an automation task copies all properties, including the resource an alert monitors, the workbook or script a scheduled task uses, or the steps defined in an automation chain, when the automation task runs, and the users notified when the automation task finishes or fails.

► Copy an automation task

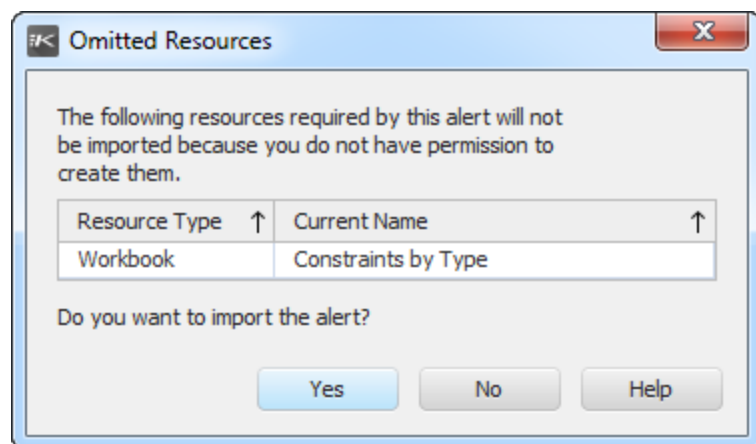
1. In the **Explorer** pane, select the automation task you want to copy.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Copy**.
3. Specify a name for the new automation task, and then click **OK**.

Import or export an automation task

If you are moving an automation task from one system to another, or you have been provided with an automation task from an external source, such as a customer, a supplier, or third-party developer, you can import that automation task into your RapidResponse system.

Automation tasks you import or export also include any linked resources, such as workbooks, scorecards, filters, and other automation tasks. If you import an automation task, the linked resources are also imported as private resources. If you already have access to a resource with the same name, you can choose to either not import the resource, replace the existing resource, or rename it. If you choose to rename a resource, all references to it must also be renamed. You must have permission to author each type of resource that the automation task imports.

If you cannot create the resource type, you can import the automation task, but cannot use it to monitor data, modify data, run scripts, or run a sequence of automation tasks. The resources you cannot create are specified when you import the automation task, as shown in the following illustration.



You can export any automation task you have created, which allows you to send the automation task to another system or allow another user to import and modify the automation task, or to share automation tasks with an external partner. Any resources required by the automation task, such as workbooks, scorecards, filters, or other automation tasks, are included with the automation task.

Automation tasks are exported using the following extensions.

Automation task	Extension
Alert	.alt
Scheduled task	.stk
Automation chain	.acn

If you have upgraded to RapidResponse 2014.1 and are importing an automation chain that replaces an alert that runs another alert, you must replace the alerts and scheduled tasks that automation chain imports. Otherwise, the alerts and scheduled tasks in the automation chain will not be valid, and the automation chain will not be able to run.

► Import an automation task

1. On the **File** menu, point to **Import**, and then click one of the following:
 - Alert
 - Automation Chain
 - Scheduled Task
2. In the **Import Resource** dialog box, do the following:
 - In the **Look in** list, navigate to the location where the automation chain is saved.
 - Select the automation chain, and then click **Open**.
 - If you already have a private automation task with the same name, you are prompted to enter a unique name.

The automation task is now visible in the Explorer.

► Specify how duplicate resources are managed when importing an automation task

1. In the **Import Resource - Duplicate Resource Names** dialog box, for each resource, in the **Action** column click one of the following:
 - **Use existing shared**—The resource is not imported, and the existing shared resource is used.
 - **Use existing private**—The resource is not imported, and the existing private resource is used.
 - **Use existing** —The resource is not imported, and the existing resource is used. Applies to macros, profile variables, images, and insert definitions.
 - **Replace**—The resource being imported replaces the existing resource.
 - **Rename**—The resource's name is changed. The new name is automatically used in the resource. The new name is typed in the **New Name** column of the dialog box.
 - **Import**—The resource is imported as private. Available when there is not a duplicate conflict in the system.
2. Click **Ok** twice.



Caution: If you replace a macro, it is replaced for all other workbooks, filters, and so on that use the macro. This can result in workbooks and filters not returning the data you expect, or possibly not returning any data. Before you replace a macro, you should ensure the new macro is similar to the existing macro.



Note: You must select the **Replace** option if you are importing an automation chain that replaces an alert that runs another alert.

► Export an automation task

1. In the **Explorer**, click the automation chain you want to export.
2. On the **File** menu, click **Export**.
3. In the **Export Resource** dialog box, specify the location you want to save the file.
4. In the **File name** box, type the name of the file.
5. Click **Save**.

Share an automation task

If you have been granted permission to do so, you can share public alerts, scheduled tasks, or automation chains you create with other RapidResponse users. This allows those users to run the automation task and, if they are automation task authors, copy it.

Sharing other resources along with automation tasks

Sharing an automation task also shares any resources the automation task uses to run, including the automation tasks an automation chain runs, the workbook or scorecard an alert monitors, or the workbook or script a scheduled task uses. However, users you share the automation task with might not see those resources in their resource panes and cannot run or open them separately.

You can share an automation task only if you own the automation tasks or resources it uses. Otherwise, you must give the automation task to your RapidResponse administrator, and ask them to share the automation task for you. For more information, see ["Give an automation task" on page 569](#). Only automation tasks that you have added to the repository, making them public resources, can be shared. For more information, see ["About modifying automation tasks" on page 562](#).

Scenario sharing and automation tasks

Resources, including automation tasks, that refer to private scenarios typically cannot be added to the versioned repository or shared. You must share the scenario first. Other users will only be able to run the automation task if they are on the list of users who have access to the scenario. For more information, see ["Share a scenario" on page 486](#).

Alerts and scheduled tasks that refer to a private temporary scenario using a scenario override—for example, alerts that check for a condition in a scenario created as part of an automation chain—are an exception to the rule. They can be added to the versioned repository and shared. For more information, see ["Use a temporary scenario in an automation task" on page 562](#).

► Share an automation task

1. In the **Explorer**, select the public automation task you want to share.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Share**.
3. In the **Share** dialog box, click **Select Names**.
4. In the **Select Names** dialog box, do the following:
 - On the **Users** tab, select the user or users you want to share the automation task with, and then click **Share with**.
 - On the **Groups** tab, select the group or groups you want to share the automation task with, and then click **Share with**.



Notes:

- In systems with version control turned off, you can share private and shared alerts, scheduled tasks, and automation chains that you own.
- If you add an automation task to the versioned repository (or, in systems with version control turned off, share an automation task for the first time) and it uses a private predefined schedule, the predefined schedule is shared automatically. For more information, see ["Share a predefined schedule" on page 634](#).

Give an automation task

You can give any automation task you own to another author of the same type of automation task. You might do this if you have created an automation task for another user, or if you are no longer responsible for the automation task.

When you give an automation task, any automation tasks or resources used by that automation task are not given to the recipient. The tasks and resources must be given or shared separately. Those tasks or resources include workbooks or scorecards monitored by an alert, the workbook or script used by a scheduled task, or the alerts, scheduled tasks, and automation chains used in an automation chain.

When you give an alert, scheduled task, or automation chain to another user, it is automatically locked. The new owner of the automation task must edit the properties of the automation task to unlock it before it can run. For more information, see ["Unlock an automation resource" on page 570](#). Automation tasks that were configured to run automatically are also turned off or disabled. The new owner must turn on or enable a task before it will run automatically.

► Give an automation task

1. In the **Explorer**, select the automation task you want to give.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Give**.
3. In the **Give Alert**, **Give Scheduled Task**, or **Give Automation Chain** dialog box, do the following:
 - In the **Owner** list, click the user you are giving the automation task to.
 - If you want to rename the automation task, in the **New Name** box, type a name for the automation task.
 - Optionally, in the **Notify new owner** area, type a message to notify the new owner that the automation task has been given to them.
 - Click **OK**.



Note: If the new owner already has an automation task of the same type with the same name as the one you are giving them, you must specify a new name for the automation task.



Tips:

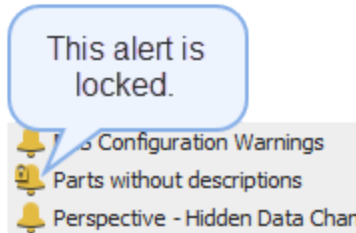
- You can also give an automation task by right-clicking the automation task and then clicking **Give**.
- To find out more about the person you have selected in the **Owner** list, move the pointer over their name.

Unlock an automation resource

If someone gives you a scheduled task, alert, or automation chain, it is locked and cannot run until you unlock it. This gives you a chance to ensure that it is configured correctly. Before unlocking an automation resource, check for problems that might occur as a result of your permissions being different from those of the previous owner.

For example if someone who only has access to one site creates an alert and gives it to a user who has access to all sites, the alert will be configured to check data at all sites by default. The new alert owner might want to specify the site so that the alert does not check data for other sites that it was not intended to check.

An automation resource that is locked is shown in the Explorer with a lock on its icon.



Note: Most users can only unlock automation resources that they own, but administrators can unlock any shared automation resources that they have access to.

► Unlock an automation resource

1. In the **Explorer**, right-click a locked automation resource that you own.
2. Select  **Edit** or  **Check Out and Edit**.
3. Review the automation task's properties and make any necessary changes.
4. On the **General** tab of the automation task's properties, clear the **Locked** box.



5. Click **OK** to save your changes.

6. If you selected  **Check Out and Edit** in the first step, check the changes in to the versioned repository. For more information, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

Delete an automation task

If an automation task you own is not needed, you can delete it. Deleting an automation task removes it from all users who had access to it, and it no longer runs. The workbooks, scorecards, scripts, alerts, scheduled tasks, or automation chains used in the automation task are not deleted.

If you delete an automation task that is used in an automation chain, you are notified that deleting the automation task might cause the automation chain that uses it to fail.

► Delete an automation chain

1. In the **Explorer**, select the automation task you want to delete.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Delete**.
3. If the automation task is used in an automation chain, to confirm the deletion, in the **Delete Alert**, **Delete Scheduled Task**, or **Delete Automation Chain** dialog box, click **Yes**.
If you do not want to affect the automation chains this automation task depends on, click **No**.

CHAPTER 41: Monitoring data with alerts

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You can use alerts to monitor data in reports and receive automatic notifications when specified conditions are met. Monitoring data using alerts saves you the trouble of repeatedly checking the same reports for the same conditions. For example, you could create an alert that checks the Project Plan workbook daily for delays that cause tasks to extend past the end of June.

When the alert conditions you specify are met, you receive an alert message in Message Center and you might receive an email message too. For more information about how messages are delivered, see ["Message Center and email" on page 451](#).

Alerts can monitor either a worksheet or a scorecard. When you create an alert based on a dashboard widget, the alert monitors the worksheet that the widget gets its data from, and is considered a worksheet alert.

Each type of alert requires different data, and can monitor different conditions. For more information, refer to the following table.

Alert type	Monitors	Alerts when
Worksheet	All records that match the worksheet display settings or a specific record in the RapidResponse database.	Either any records match the display criteria; or always, regardless of if any records match the display settings. For alerts monitoring a specific record, when the data contained in the record matches a specified condition.
Scorecard	The value of a scorecard metric.	Either the value of the metric matches a specified condition; or always, regardless of if any value matches a condition.

Create an alert to monitor worksheet data

You can create an alert to monitor data in an open worksheet. For example, you might want to be alerted when orders are more than one week late. It is recommended that you specify the worksheet data you want to monitor by making selections in the worksheet control settings (scenario, filter, and so on). In addition, any search criteria you apply to the worksheet are saved as part of the alert. For worksheets that contain column searches, you can use the worksheet's search or define your own, depending on the data you want to monitor. All of these settings are used to determine if the worksheet contains relevant data when the alert runs.

If the worksheet has searches applied to it, an alert on that worksheet uses the worksheet searches by default. By using the default searches, the alert always uses the default worksheet search. If the worksheet's author modifies the default searches, the alert uses the new searches. If you want to add, edit, or remove the searches in the alert, you must ensure the defaults are not used. If you are creating the alert without an open worksheet context, any searches defined in the worksheet are included in the alert, and you must specify to not use the defaults to add or change the searches.

If you apply different searches to the worksheet, those searches are specified for the alert instead of the default searches. You can then add, edit, or remove these searches. If you decide to use the defaults instead, the searches you have applied in the worksheet and in the alert are ignored.

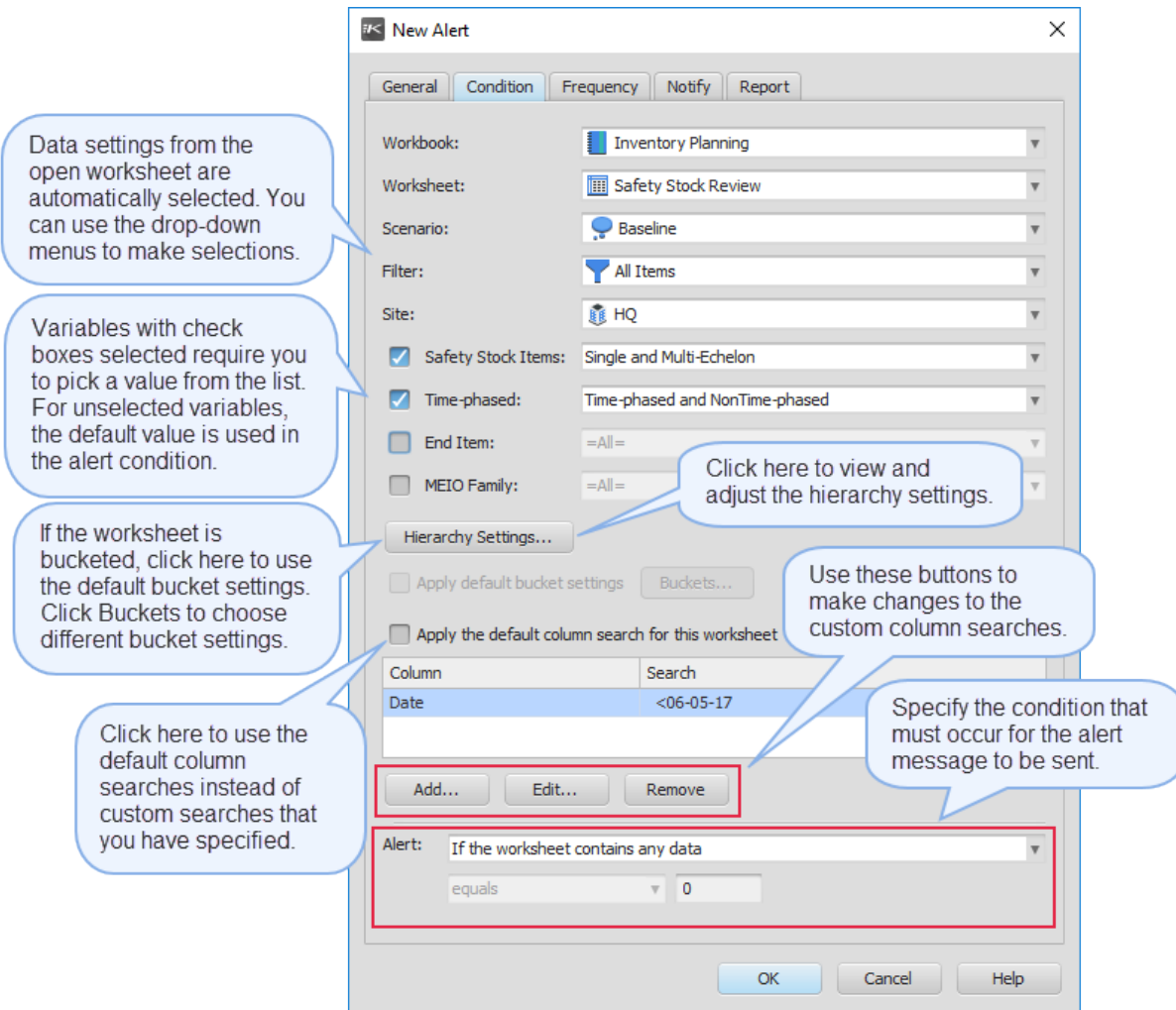
If the worksheet has date buckets, you can select the bucket settings that will be used when the alert runs. Reports generated by the alert will use the bucket settings specified by the alert properties. Similarly, clicking the View Current Data link in an alert message will open the worksheet using the specified bucket settings.

If you do not apply bucket settings in the alert properties, the data will be grouped according to the personal bucket settings of the user running the alert. For more information about setting buckets, see ["Set date buckets" on page 176](#).

For worksheets that use variables, you can specify which value is used in an alert condition: a value you specify or the default value for the variable. For workbooks that you do not expect authoring changes for, specifying a value ensures that it is always used in any alerts for worksheets in the workbook.

In a new alert, by default, all variables are set to use a value you have selected from a list or that you have defined. If a new variable is added to a worksheet that you have already created an alert for, the default value for the variable is used in that alert condition.

For workbooks that might change, it is recommended that you use default variable values. This ensures that any worksheets alerts for the workbook run with the most current variable values.



Notes:

- In some worksheets, column searching might be disabled in some or all columns. For more information, see ["Searching data in workbooks" on page 187](#).
- Only the data settings visible in the selected worksheet are available in the alert. However, if you are generating a report from the alert, additional settings might be made available on this tab. For more information, see ["Attach a report to an alert message" on page 586](#).
- Columns that are conditionally hidden by the worksheet author cannot be used in alerts, even if they are visible when you are creating the alert. Examples include columns that are only visible to administrators, or only shown if a button is clicked on the worksheet toolbar.

Creating an alert without an open workbook

You can also specify alert settings without opening a workbook. However, to ensure your alerts monitor the correct data, you should create alerts from an open worksheet. To specify alert settings without opening a workbook, you must specify what worksheet—including the workbook and worksheet controls (scenario, filter, site, and so on)—you want to monitor. Creating using the New Resource button on the RapidResponse menu without an open worksheet is not recommended because worksheets that

display different data based on worksheet settings, such as the Demand Order Analysis - Whole Orders or Supply Order Analysis workbook, might not display the data you expect when the alert runs.

Modifying alerts

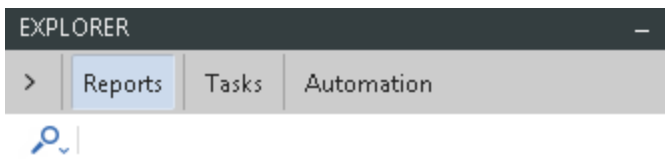
After an alert is created, you can modify its settings. For example, if you create an alert with a private scenario active, but that you intended to monitor the Approved Actions scenario, you can change the scenario being monitored. Similarly, if you create an alert with search conditions that do not match what you intended, you can override the default searches and add, modify or remove conditions in the alert. For more information, see "[Modify an alert](#)" on page 588.

Specifying the alert message condition

You can be alerted if any worksheet records match the condition you specify, or you can be alerted regardless of records matching the condition. For example, you can use a worksheet to monitor whether any orders for a part are late. If you want to receive alert messages when any orders are late, you can choose to be alerted if the worksheet contains data.

► Create an alert to monitor worksheet data

1. If you are creating this alert without a worksheet open, skip to step 5. Otherwise, in the **Explorer**, ensure that workbooks are shown. You can do this by selecting **Reports**.



2. Double-click a workbook, and then click the worksheet you want to monitor.
3. Select the scenario that contains the data you want to monitor, the filter, and the site. Optionally, you might want to specify other worksheet control settings.
4. Optionally, specify the search criteria. For more information, see "[Search for specific data](#)" on page 190.
5. On the **File** menu, point to **New**, then **Alert**  and click **Monitor Worksheet**.
6. In the **New Alert** dialog box, in the **Name** box, type a descriptive name for the alert.
7. In the **Author notes** box, type a summary of what the alert monitors.
8. If you are going to schedule the alert, beside **Alert is**, click **On**.
9. If you want to stop monitoring when the condition is met, select the **Run alert once (and then disable it)** check box.
10. If you will share the alert, configure how the alert is run by users you share it with. For more information, see "[Allow automation task customization](#)" on page 563.
11. Click the **Condition** tab.
12. If you created the alert without a worksheet open, or you want to modify the worksheet data settings, specify any of the following:
 - In the **Workbook** list, click the workbook that contains the worksheet you want to monitor.
 - In the **Worksheet** list, click the worksheet you want to monitor.
 - In the **Scenario** list, click the scenario that contains the data you want to monitor.

- If the monitored worksheet contains multi-scenario columns, in the **Scenarios** area, click **Select** to select the scenarios to monitor. If the scenario you want to monitor does not exist, such as a scenario created by running a script, see ["Use a temporary scenario in an automation task" on page 562](#).
 - In the **Filter** list, click the filter you want to be applied to the worksheet.
 - In the **Site** list, click the site the data you want to monitor originates from.
 - If the worksheet on which you are basing the alert contains the **Part, Model, Pool, Reference Part, Currency**, or other controls, select the desired values.
13. If the worksheet uses variables, do the following:
 - For variables you want to specify a value for, ensure the check box for the variable is selected and then do one of the following:
 - For text and quantity variables, type a value.
 - For all other variable types, pick a value from the drop-down list.
 - For variables that you want the default value used for, clear the check box for the variable.
 14. If the worksheet uses a hierarchy, click **Hierarchy Settings** and then do the following:
 - In the hierarchy list, click the hierarchy you want to apply to the worksheet.
 - To add another hierarchy, click **Add Hierarchy**, and then click a hierarchy in the list.
 - Select the hierarchy value or values you want to apply to the worksheet. For more information about selecting multiple values in a hierarchy, see ["Filter and summarize data with hierarchies" on page 304](#).
 - To remove a hierarchy, click the ✕ beside the hierarchy you want to remove.
 - Click **OK**
 15. If the worksheet uses date buckets, click **Apply default bucket settings** to use the worksheet's default bucket settings (as defined by the worksheet author) when the alert runs. Optionally, click **Buckets** to specify the bucket settings used when the alert runs.
 16. To modify the alert's search conditions, ensure the **Apply the default column search for this worksheet** check box is cleared, and then in the **Search** area, click one of the following:
 - **Add**—add a search condition. You must specify a column, a comparison operator and a value for the search condition. For more information, see ["Currency considerations in alerts" on page 586](#).
 - **Edit**—edit an existing search condition.
 - **Remove**—remove a search condition.
 17. In the **Alert** area, click one of the following:
 - **Alert if this worksheet contains any data**—sends an alert message if any records match the condition.
 - **Always (even if worksheet is empty)**—sends an alert message whenever the condition is checked. This option is typically used when generating scheduled reports. For more information, see ["About automatically generating reports" on page 307](#).
 - **Only if the number of records in the worksheet**—sends an alert message when the specified number of records are in the worksheet. You must also specify the comparison operator and the number of records for this type of condition.
 18. On the **Frequency** tab, specify when the condition is checked. Alerts are scheduled similarly to other automation tasks. For more information, see ["Schedule when an automation task runs" on page 591](#).

19. On the **Notify** tab, if you want to send notifications, specify the message and who will receive it. For more information, see ["Send notification messages when an automation task completes" on page 624](#).
20. On the **Report** tab, if you want to send a report, specify report settings. For more information, see ["Attach a report to an alert message" on page 586](#).



Caution: If you create an alert that monitors data in a private scenario, and then you share the scenario, the alert will not function correctly until you edit its properties to specify the shared scenario.



Notes:

- You cannot create an alert using a library workbook.
- You can create alerts using linked workbooks. Linked workbooks are not available in the Explorer. For more information, see ["Resources that can only be opened from links" on page 88](#).
- You can specify search conditions only if the worksheet the alert monitors allows searching. If the worksheet does not have a search row, the alert's search options are not available.
- Your alert might be based on a worksheet for which one of the workbook controls is not active; however, to save the alert, you must select an item from this control on the **Condition** tab (you are prompted if there is no selection). The selection is not applied to the worksheet and does not affect the alert.



Tips:

- You can also create an alert by clicking **New Resource** , pointing to **Alert** , and then clicking **Monitor Worksheet**.
- You can also create an alert from an open workbook by right-clicking the worksheet, clicking **New Alert** , and then clicking **Monitor Worksheet**.

► Override a worksheet's default search

1. In the **New Alert** or **Alert Properties** dialog box, click the **Condition** tab.
2. Clear the **Apply the default column search filtering for this worksheet** check box.
3. Edit or remove the searches you do not want to include in the alert.
4. Add searches you want to apply to the alert.

► Apply a worksheet's default search

1. In the **New Alert** or **Alert Properties** dialog box, click the **Condition** tab.
2. Select the **Apply the default column search for this worksheet** check box.



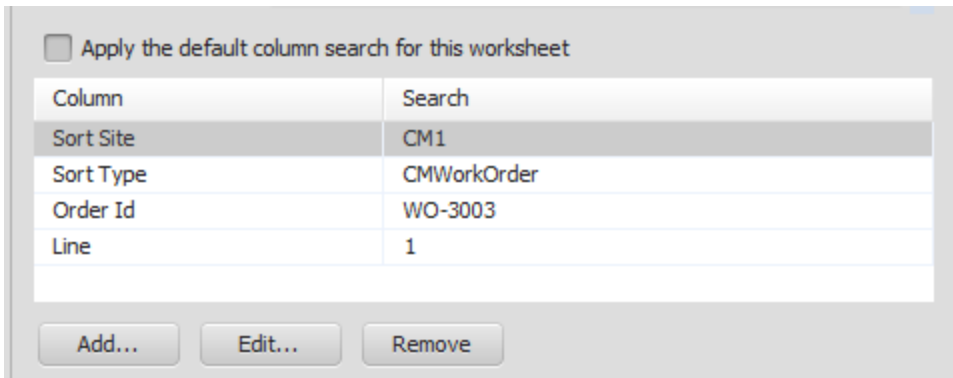
Note: If you apply the default searches, any search conditions you have specified are removed.

Creating an alert to monitor a specific record

You can also create an alert that monitors a single record in the RapidResponse database. The record displays as a row in vertical worksheets. This allows you to keep track of and respond to changes made to specific areas of your business, such as an order or part. For example, you can monitor the on hand nettable inventory of a part, and be alerted if the quantity drops below a level you specify.

When creating an alert to monitor a specific record, you can specify a value for a field of that record to be compared against and receive notifications only if the field matches the specified value. The conditions available depend on the data type of the field being monitored. For example, a date field has conditions such as 'is before' and 'is after', while a numeric field has conditions such as 'is less than' and 'is not equal to'.

The monitored record is uniquely defined by its key fields. For example, if the record is an order, it is defined by its order number, line, type, and site. No other order can have the same combination of key fields. You cannot monitor a single record if the worksheet you are creating the alert from does not uniquely identify records, such as a crosstab worksheet. The following illustration shows the New Alert dialog box displaying the column searches that uniquely identify the selected record.



The screenshot shows a dialog box titled "New Alert" with a checkbox "Apply the default column search for this worksheet" which is unchecked. Below the checkbox is a table with two columns: "Column" and "Search". The table contains the following rows:

Column	Search
Sort Site	CM1
Sort Type	CMWorkOrder
Order Id	WO-3003
Line	1

At the bottom of the dialog box are three buttons: "Add...", "Edit...", and "Remove".

After an alert is created, you can modify its settings. For example, if you create an alert with a private scenario active, but that you intended to monitor the Approved Actions scenario, you can change the scenario being monitored. Similarly, if you create an alert with search conditions that do not match what you intended, you can add, modify or remove conditions in the alert. For more information, see "[Modify an alert](#)" on page 588.

► Create an alert to monitor a specific record

1. Open a workbook from the **Explorer**, and then click the worksheet that contains the record you want to monitor.
2. Select the scenario that contains the data you want to monitor, the filter and the site. Optionally, you might want to specify other worksheet control settings, such as model and pool.
3. Click anywhere in the row you want to monitor. You can also select one or more cells in the row, or click the row number.
4. On the **File** menu, point to **New**, then **Alert**  and click **Monitor the Selected Record**.

If you do not get the option to Monitor the selected record, then the worksheet does not uniquely identify records. In this case, you can only monitor the worksheet, and not the selected record.

5. In the **New Alert** dialog box, in the **Name** box, type a descriptive name for the alert.
6. In the **Author notes** box, type a summary of what the alert monitors.
7. If you are going to schedule the alert, beside **Alert is**, click **On**.
8. If you want to stop monitoring when the condition is met, select the **Run alert once (and then disable it)** check box.
9. If you will share the alert, configure how the alert is run by users you share it with. For more information, see "[Allow automation task customization](#)" on page 563.
10. Click the **Condition** tab.
11. If you want to modify the worksheet data settings, specify any of the following:
 - In the **Scenario** list, click the scenario that contains the data you want to monitor. In some cases, you might want your alert to monitor data in a scenario that does not exist, such as a temporary scenario created by a script. For information on handling this situation, see "[Use a temporary scenario in an automation task](#)" on page 562.
 - If the monitored worksheet contains multi-scenario columns, in the **Scenarios** area, click **Select** to select the scenarios to monitor.
 - In the **Filter** list, click the filter you want to be applied to the worksheet.
 - In the **Site** list, click the site the data you want to monitor originates from.
 - If the worksheet on which you are basing the alert contains other controls, select the desired values.
12. If the worksheet uses variables, do the following:
 - For variables you want to specify a value for, ensure the check box for the variable is selected and then do one of the following:
 - For text and quantity variables, type a value.
 - For all other variable types, pick a value from the drop-down list.
 - For variables that you want the default value used for, clear the check box for the variable.
13. If the worksheet uses a hierarchy, click **Hierarchy Settings**, and then do the following:
 - In the hierarchy list, click the hierarchy you want to apply to the worksheet.
 - To add a hierarchy, click **Add Hierarchy**, and then click a hierarchy in the list.
 - Select the hierarchy value or values you want to apply to the worksheet.
 - To remove a hierarchy, click **Remove Hierarchy** ✕ beside the hierarchy you want to remove.
 - Click **OK**
14. If you want to modify the alert's search conditions, ensure the **Apply the default column search for this worksheet** check box is cleared, and then do one of the following in the **Search** area:
 - To add a condition, click **Add**. In the **Search** dialog box, click the column you want to monitor, the condition you want to check and enter a value to compare to the field. To create advanced search conditions click **Advanced Search** button.
 - To edit a condition, click **Edit**. In the **Search** dialog box, choose the alert's search conditions.
 - To remove a condition, click the condition you want to remove, then click the **Remove** button.
15. In the **Alert** area, click one of the following:
 - **Alert if this worksheet contains any data**—sends an alert message if any records match the condition.

- **Always (even if worksheet is empty)**—sends an alert message whenever the condition is checked. This option is typically used when generating scheduled reports. For more information, see ["About automatically generating reports" on page 307](#).
 - **Only if the number of records in the worksheet**—sends an alert message when the specified number of records are in the worksheet. You must also specify the comparison operator and the number of records for this type of condition.
16. If the data value you are monitoring is in a multi-scenario column, in the **Scenario** area, click one of the following:
- **Baseline**—monitors the value in the workbook's baseline scenario.
 - **Comparison**—monitors the value in the comparison scenario or scenarios.
- For more information about multi-scenario columns, see ["View data from multiple scenarios" on page 159](#).
17. On the **Frequency** tab, specify when the alert conditions are checked. For more information, see ["Schedule when an automation task runs" on page 591](#).
18. On the **Notify** tab, if you want to send notifications, specify the message and who will receive it. For more information, see ["Send notification messages when an automation task completes" on page 624](#).
19. On the **Report** tab, if you want to send a report, specify settings. For more information, see ["Attach a report to an alert message" on page 586](#).



Caution: If you select the **Apply the default column search for this worksheet** check box, the alert no longer monitors a specific record because the search conditions that uniquely identify the record are not applied.



Note: Your alert might be based on a worksheet for which one of the workbook controls is not active; however, to save the alert, you must select an item from this control on the **Condition** tab (you are prompted if there is no selection). The selection is not applied to the worksheet and does not affect the alert.

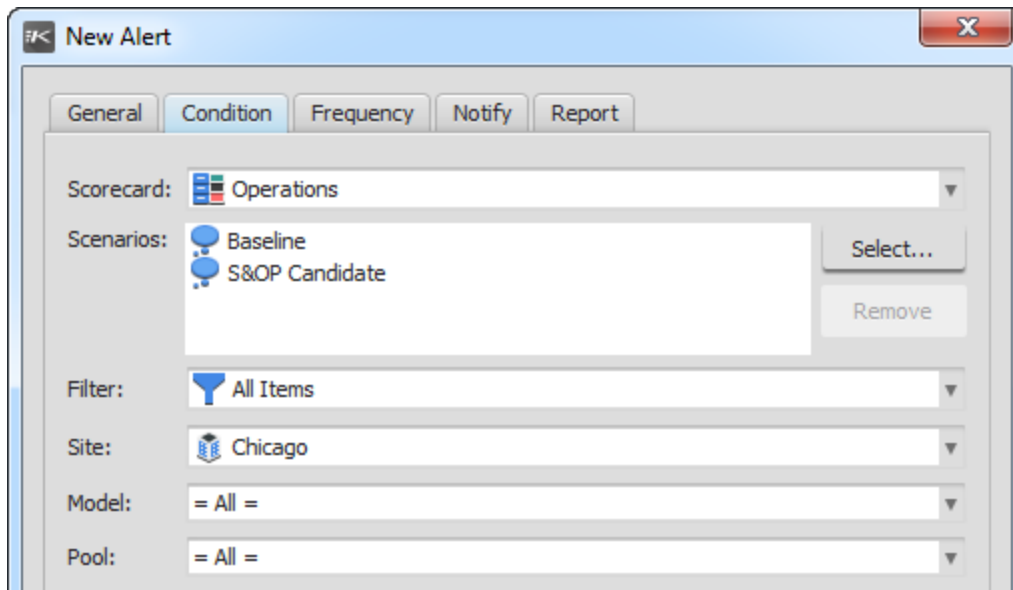


Tip: You can also monitor a record by right-clicking a cell, clicking **New Alert** , and then clicking **Monitor the Selected Record**.

Create an alert to monitor scorecard data

You can create an alert to monitor changes in a scorecard's calculated metric values. This allows you to be notified when a data change causes a significant problem, such as on-time deliveries dropping below a certain percentage or late order revenue rising over a certain value.

You can create an alert to monitor metric results in a scorecard you have open. When you create an alert of this type, the data settings (filter, site, and so on) are automatically set for you, as shown in the following illustration.



If you do not have a scorecard open, you can still create a scorecard-based alert. In this case, you must specify the scorecard to monitor, along with the scenario, site, filter, and any other data the scorecard requires.

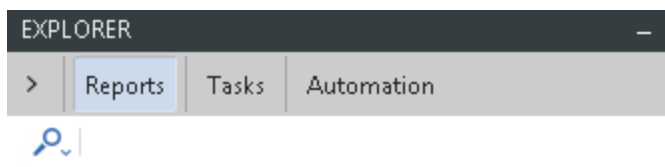
Creating an alert without an open scorecard is not recommended. The metric worksheets that a scorecard reports can use profile variables or other worksheet settings to customize the data reported by the metric, and might not display the data you expect when the alert checks for its condition. To ensure your alerts return the correct data, you should always create alerts from an open scorecard.

If you create an alert with settings that do not match what you intended, you can change any of the scorecard controls in the alert. For example, if you create an alert with a private scenario active, but that you intended to monitor the Approved Actions scenario, you can change the scenario being monitored.

If the scorecard has targets, you can be notified when a metric result moves into the Warning or Critical ranges. For more information, see "[Using a target scorecard to make decisions](#)" on [page 298](#).

► Create an alert to monitor scorecard data

1. If you are creating the alert without a scorecard open, skip to step 5.
Otherwise, in the **Explorer**, ensure that scorecards are shown. You can do this by selecting **Reports**.



2. Double-click the scorecard you want to monitor.
3. Select a filter and site to narrow your search.
Optionally, you might want to specify other control settings, such as model and pool.
4. Click a cell under the scenario you want to monitor.

If the scenario you want to monitor is not in the scorecard, you can add it. For more information, see ["Specify scorecard viewing options" on page 285](#).

5. On the **File** menu, point to **New**, then **Alert** and click **Monitor Scorecard**.
6. In the **New Alert** dialog box, in the **Name** box, type a descriptive name for the alert.
7. In the **Author notes** box, type a summary of what the alert monitors.
8. If you are going to schedule the alert, beside **Alert is**, click **On**.
9. If you want to stop monitoring when the condition is met, select the **Run alert once (and then disable it)** check box.
10. If you will share the alert, configure how the alert is run by users you share it with. For more information, see ["Allow automation task customization" on page 563](#).
11. Click the **Condition** tab.
12. If you created the alert without a scorecard open, or you want to modify the scorecard data settings, specify any of the following:
 - In the **Scorecard** list, click the scorecard you want to monitor.
 - In the **Scenarios** area, click **Select** to select the scenarios to monitor. In some cases, you might want your alert to monitor data in a scenario that does not exist, such as a temporary scenario created by a script. For information on handling this situation, see ["Use a temporary scenario in an automation task" on page 562](#).
If the scenario you want to monitor is not in the scorecard, see ["Specify scorecard viewing options" on page 285](#).
 - In the **Filter** list, click the filter you want to be applied to the scorecard.
 - In the **Site** list, click the site the scorecard data originates from.
 - If the scorecard contains the **Model** or **Pool** controls, select the desired values.
13. If the scorecard uses a hierarchy, click **Hierarchy Settings**, and then do the following:
 - In the hierarchy list, click the hierarchy you want to apply to the scorecard.
 - To add a hierarchy, click **Add Hierarchy**, and then click a hierarchy in the list.
 - Select the hierarchy value or values you want to apply to the scorecard.
 - To remove a hierarchy, click **Remove Hierarchy**  beside the hierarchy you want to remove.
 - Click **OK**.
14. To specify when to send an alert, do one of the following:
 - Select **Alert if this condition occurs**—sends an alert message if the metric's results match the selected condition.
 - **Always alert**—sends an alert message regardless of if any metric's results match a condition. This option is typically used when generating scheduled reports. For more information, see ["About automatically generating reports" on page 307](#).
15. If you selected **Alert if this condition occurs** in step 11, then in the metric list, click the metric you want to monitor.
16. Do one of the following:
 - Select **Actual Value** to monitor a result value calculated by the scorecard.
 - Select **Score** to monitor a metric's overall performance.
17. Click the condition you want to monitor, and then enter a value to compare to the metric.
If you selected the **is between** or **is not between** condition in this step, enter the beginning and end of a range of values to compare the field's value with in the text boxes. The top text box must contain the beginning value of the range, which must be less than the end of the range.

If you selected the **is in the OK range**, **is in the Warning range**, **is in the Critical range**, or **is in the Warning or Critical range** condition in this step, you cannot specify a value. These conditions are available only for scorecards with targets.

18. In the **In scenario** list, click the scenario that you want to monitor.
19. On the **Frequency** tab, specify when the condition is checked. Alerts are scheduled similarly to other automation tasks. For more information, see ["Schedule when an automation task runs" on page 591](#).
20. On the **Notify** tab, if you want to send notifications, specify the message and who will receive it. For more information, see ["Send notification messages when an automation task completes" on page 624](#).
21. On the **Report** tab, if you want to send a report, specify report settings. For more information, see ["Attach a report to an alert message" on page 586](#).



Caution: If you create an alert that monitors data in a private scenario, and then you share the scenario, the alert will not function correctly until you edit its properties to specify the shared scenario.



Notes:

- An alert can monitor only one condition. If you want to monitor more than one condition, you must create an alert to monitor each of the other conditions or copy the alert and specify a new condition in the copy's properties. For more information, see ["Copy an automation task" on page 566](#).
- For more information about metric performance, see ["Using a target scorecard to make decisions" on page 298](#).



Tips:

- You can also create a scorecard alert by clicking **New Resource** , pointing to **Alert** , and then clicking **Monitor Scorecard**.
- You can also create an alert from an open scorecard by right-clicking the scorecard and pointing to **New Alert**  then clicking **Monitor Scorecard**.

Create an alert based on a widget

You can create an alert that notifies you of data changes in a worksheet widget in a dashboard. For more information, see ["Create an alert to monitor worksheet data" on page 574](#).

► Create an alert to monitor a worksheet data or chart widget in a dashboard

1. Open the dashboard that contains the widget you want to create the alert on.
2. Maximize the widget.
3. From the **File** menu, click **New, Alert** , and **Monitor Worksheet**.
4. Name the alert and select alert conditions and other alert properties in the **New Alert** dialog box.
5. Click **OK**.



Caution: If you create an alert that monitors data in a private scenario, and then you share the scenario, the alert will not function correctly until you edit its properties to specify the shared scenario.



Note: You cannot create an alert based on a calendar widget.



Tip: For worksheet data widgets, you can also create an alert by right-clicking the widget and selecting New Alert 🧑🏻💡.

Create an alert to monitor collaboration progress

If you want to monitor the commits and updates made to a scenario used in a collaboration without having to check back into a collaboration, you can create an alert to monitor the scenario. For example, you might no longer be a participant in the collaboration or only want to check it when a condition has been met in the scenario, such as an order that is no longer late.

When you receive the alert message, it indicates that the collaboration team has produced a potential solution. You can then review the solution.

1. Open the workbook or scorecard that contains the data you want to monitor.
2. Click the worksheet cell or scorecard calculated result you want to monitor.
3. On the **File** menu, point to **New**, and then click **Alert**.
4. If you are monitoring a record, click **The selected record**, and then click **OK**.
5. On the **General** tab, specify a name and description for the alert.
6. On the **Condition** tab, specify the success condition.
7. On the **Frequency** tab, select **When data changes in scenario** and then select the collaboration scenario.
8. If you want to send the alert message to the collaboration team, click the **Notify** tab, and then add each action team member to the recipients list.



Note: For more information about alerts, see ["About alerts and data monitoring" on page 560](#).



Tips:

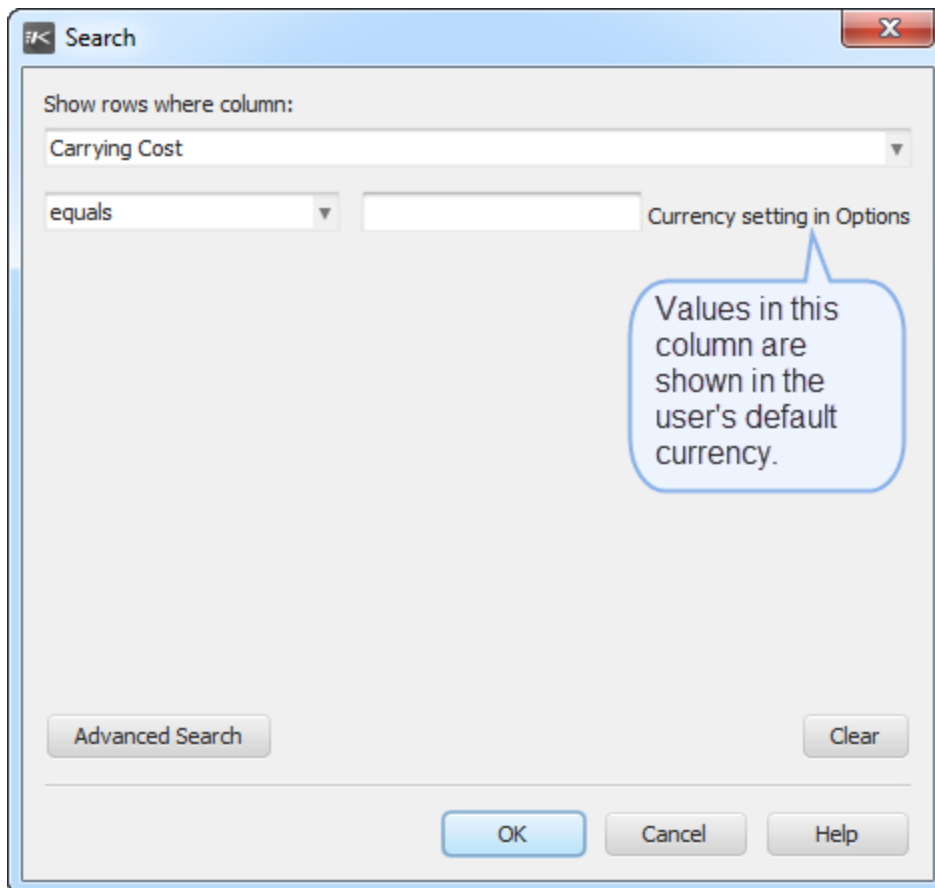
- You can also notify the action team by adding a response to the scenario after the alert's condition is met.
- You can also create an alert by clicking **New Resource** 🧑🏻💡 on the RapidResponse toolbar.

Currency considerations in alerts

When creating a search condition for an alert that monitors a worksheet, if the search condition is on a money column, the column setting can affect alert results. The same also applies to alerts that monitor a money metric in an alert that monitors a scorecard.

If a money column is set to use a user's own currency settings, an alert created using your account's currency settings might not display the intended results. To avoid this situation, either change the money column setting to use a specific currency, or do not share the alert.

The currency used by the money column is displayed in the Search dialog box:



If you can select the currency used to display Money values, the currency you selected is displayed in the Search dialog box.

Attach a report to an alert message

You can choose to create a report of the monitored data. Whenever the alert's condition is met, the report can be attached to the alert message and delivered to each recipient's Message Center or email account; and can also be exported to a network file location or posted to a Web site. You might include a report if you want to view the data in another application, or to summarize the alert data for people who

do not have access to RapidResponse. For more information, see ["About automatically generating reports" on page 307](#).

Before creating a report, ensure that you performed the appropriate preparation tasks described in ["Scheduling reports" on page 307](#). In order to generate a report, you must have an alert that checks for a condition at scheduled intervals, either at a specified date and time or according to a schedule. For more information, see ["Schedule when an automation task runs" on page 591](#). You can also generate a report that contains data customized for a specific group. For more information, see ["Prerequisites for sending customized reports" on page 310](#).

For more information about creating and scheduling alerts that generate reports, see ["Create a scheduled report" on page 308](#).

Reports can be generated in the following formats:

- Portable Document Format (PDF)
- HTML
- Microsoft Excel
- Tab-delimited text
- XML

When you attach a report, you can include every worksheet in the workbook in the report. If you include all worksheets, any additional data settings used in those worksheets are available in the Conditions tab, and you must specify values for them to create the report. For example, if you generate a report that displays all worksheets in the workbook, data settings that were available in only one of those worksheets are now required for the alert.

You can choose to not attach a report and also not send notification messages. You might choose to do this if you want to use the alert's condition to control an automation chain's processing order. For more information, see ["Add steps to an automation chain" on page 609](#).

► **Attach a report to an alert message**

1. In the **New Alert** or **Alert Properties** dialog box, click the **Notify** tab.
2. Ensure the **Deliver notification message** check box is selected.
3. Click the **Report** tab.
4. Select the **Attach report to notification message** check box.
5. In the **Report** area, specify the report file's name, format, and properties.
6. If necessary, click the **Condition** tab, and then specify values for any data settings required for the other worksheets in the workbook.



Caution: If you attach a Microsoft Excel report to an alert message and the number of records selected by the data settings and column searches specified in the alert exceeds the maximum number of rows allowed in a Microsoft Excel file, the alert will fail. The row limit for Microsoft Excel 2007 and later is 1,048,576. The row limit for Microsoft Excel 97-2003 is 65,536.



Note: For more information about other report delivery methods and the available reporting options, see ["Specify how a report is delivered" on page 312](#), ["Specify report settings" on page 311](#), and ["Specify information included with a report" on page 313](#).

Modify an alert

If you have permission to create alerts, you can modify any of your private alerts and any public alerts you own. For private alerts, you can open the alert's properties and directly make your modifications. For a public alert, you must first check it out of the versioned repository. For more information, see ["About modifying automation tasks" on page 562](#) and the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

If you are working in a RapidResponse system with version control turned off, shared alerts you own can be modified like private alerts. For more information about whether or not version control is turned on or off in your system, contact your RapidResponse Administrator.

► To modify a private alert

1. In the **Explorer**, select a private alert.
2. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties** .
3. In the **Alert Properties** dialog box, make changes to any of the following:
 - The resources required.
 - The condition that is checked for.
 - When the alert runs.
 - Whether a report is sent to the recipients, and the report options.
 - The notification message recipients.



Notes:

- If you change the workbook that is monitored or use the worksheet's default searches, the search criteria are cleared.
- If the worksheet includes searches on hidden columns, those searches are visible in the **Alert Properties** dialog box. You cannot modify or remove these searches, but, if you add or modify searches in the alert, the searches on hidden columns are removed. You can also remove the search if the column is deleted from the worksheet.
- If any of the resources (for example a workbook or filter) required become unavailable to you, they are marked with a . For example, the scenario you are monitoring might no longer exist. If any resources are unavailable, the condition is not checked, and you receive a message identifying the missing resource. Contact your RapidResponse administrator for more information.



Tip: You can also modify an alert by selecting the alert in the **Explorer** and pressing **ALT + ENTER**.

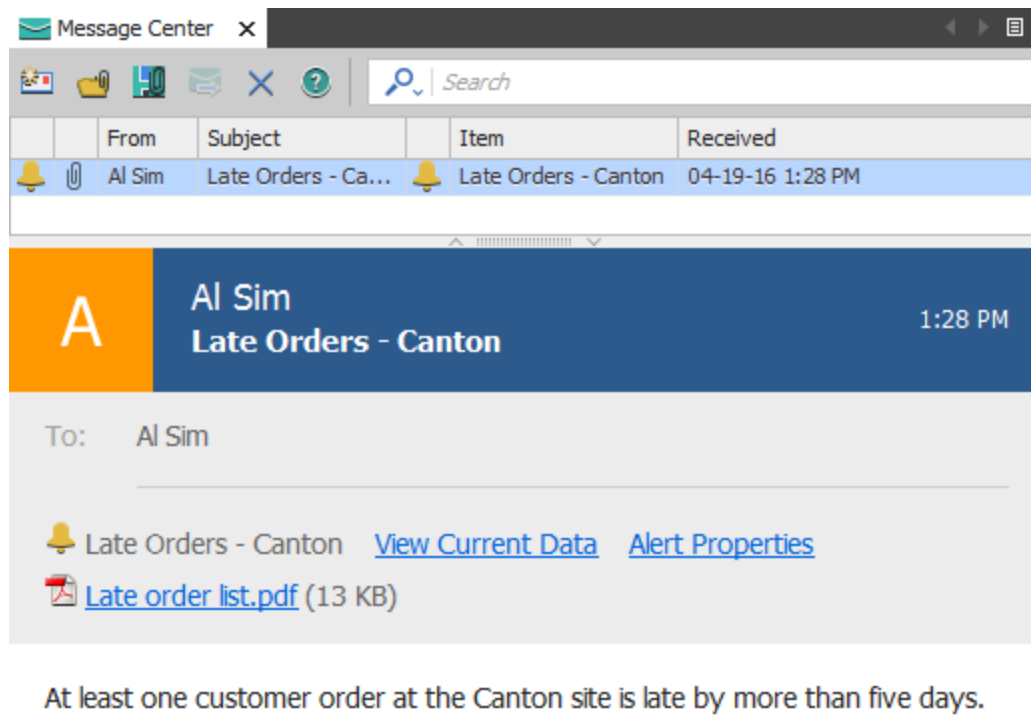
Alert messages in Message Center

When an alert message is received in RapidResponse Message Center, you can view the notification message, which includes a link to view the attached report (if applicable). If you own the alert, links to view the alert properties and the data that triggered the alert are included as well. You can also see the link to the data if the alert author allowed all users to view the current data. For more information about Message Center, see ["Communicating using Message Center" on page 437](#).

► View an alert message

1. On the **Go** menu, click **Message Center**.
2. Click an alert message.

The message is displayed in the reading pane.



► View an attached report

- With the alert message selected, in the reading pane, click the attached report name.



Tip: You can also view the report by clicking **Open Attachment**  on the Message Center toolbar.

► View affected data

- With the alert message selected, in the reading pane, click **View current data**.



Note: If the alert message is old or if you are missing certain resources such as a scenario or filter, the data opened by the View current data link might not be the same data that met the condition.

► View alert properties

- With the alert message selected, in the reading pane, click **Alert Properties**.

Alert messages by email

When you receive an alert message by email, you can open the affected worksheet by signing in to RapidResponse, or open the report if one has been attached and your administrator has enabled email file transfers. For more information, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

► View affected data

1. In the email body, click **View data**.
2. On the RapidResponse sign in screen, type your user name and password.
3. Click **OK**.
4. In **Message Center**, click the alert message you want to see.
5. In the reading pane, click **View current data**.

CHAPTER 42: Scheduling tasks

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You can schedule tasks to do the following:

- Perform automatic data modifications. For more information, see "[Schedule an automatic data modification](#)" on page 595.
- Run scripts. For more information, see "[Schedule a script](#)" on page 598.
- Publish data to subscribers. For more information, see "[Publishing data to subscribers](#)" on page 655.

Depending on the permissions you have been granted and the resources available to you, you might be able to create any of the scheduled task types. For example, if you have access to a script, you can create a scheduled task to run that script either on a schedule, when a scenario is modified, or on a data update.

You can also run any scheduled task that has been shared with you. Running a scheduled task either runs the command, runs the script, or exports data from the Data Publish workbook defined in the scheduled task.



Note: The scheduled tasks discussed in this section are not related to the system scheduled tasks available to RapidResponse administrators. For more information, see the [RapidResponse Administration Guide](#).

Schedule when an automation task runs

By default, any automation task you create is disabled and not scheduled. If you want an alert, scheduled task, or automation chain to run automatically, you must specify when it runs. You can run an automation task in any of the following ways:

- On a schedule
- When data is modified in a scenario
- After a data update
- After a data import

Running automation chains automatically

The automation task must be on or enabled in order to run automatically. Running an automation task performs a set of operations that depend on the type of automation task. Scheduled tasks run the command or script specified in their definitions. Automation chains run the first automation task specified. Alerts perform the following actions when they run:

1. The alert's condition is checked.
2. If the condition is met, alert notification messages are created.
3. If the alert generates a report, the report is created and attached to the alert notification messages.
4. If the alert has a post-process command defined, that command runs.

Selecting an effective date window

To run automatically, an automation task requires an effective date window. Within a date window, an automation task can run whenever data in the scenario changes, on a specified day and time, or when data is imported into RapidResponse. The effective dates specify when the automation task is active. On any date earlier than the Start date or later than the End date, the automation task does not run automatically, even if it is enabled. However, an automation task can be run manually outside of its effective dates. For more information, see ["Run an automation chain" on page 621](#).

► Specify an automation task's effective dates

1. In the **New Alert, Alert Properties, New Scheduled Task, Scheduled Task Properties, New Automation Chain** or **Automation Chain Properties** dialog box, click the **Frequency** tab.
2. In the **Start** box, optionally change the date the automation task is first active.
3. In the **End** box, select the last date the automation task is active.



Tip: If you want the automation task to always be active, set the **End** date to **Future**.

Running an automation task when data is modified

An automation task that runs when a scenario you specify is modified runs when data is modified in the scenario, when the monitored scenario has changes committed, or when data in the scenario is updated. You can also choose to run the automation task only on changes made by updating a scenario or when changes are made by committing a child scenario. If the automation task runs on a scenario that has many changes made to it per day, you can disable the automation task after it runs.

If an automation chain contains a scheduled task that runs on a change in a scenario and another that modifies data in the same scenario, the change made in the automation chain does not trigger the other scheduled task to run. In addition, other changes to the scenario do not run these tasks until the automation chain is complete. If you want the scheduled task to run on every data change, you can remove it from the automation chain.

► Run an automation task when data in a scenario is modified

1. In the **New Alert, Alert Properties, New Scheduled Task, Scheduled Task Properties, New Automation Chain** or **Automation Chain Properties** dialog box, click the **General** tab.
2. In the **Alert is, Scheduled task is, or Automation chain is** area, click **Enabled**.
3. Click the **Frequency** tab.
4. Click **On data change in scenario**.
5. For an automation chain or scheduled task that runs a script, in the list, select the scenario you want to run the automation chain from. For alerts and scheduled tasks that run workbook commands, this scenario is specified on the **Condition** or **Data** tab.
6. If you want to limit when the automation task runs, select the **Only on changes made by** check box, and click either **Updating the scenario** or **Committing a child scenario**.



Notes:

- If you select **Committing a child scenario** and the selected scenario is shared, the automation task runs when you commit a child scenario to the selected scenario, and when you edit data in the selected scenario and save your changes. This is because, internally, RapidResponse creates temporary child scenarios to keep track of unsaved data changes to shared scenarios, and commits them whenever you save the changes.
- For a scheduled task that modifies data, scheduling the task to run when data in a scenario is modified makes the **Update task scenario before applying the data actions** option on the **Data Actions** tab unavailable.

Running an automation task on a schedule

An automation task that runs on a schedule runs only on a specified day and time. A scheduled automation task can be run on a repeating basis. For example, you can specify the automation task run at noon each work day, and then run again every three hours until midnight.

If your region participates in Daylight Saving Time (DST), your scheduled automation tasks might not run as you expect if they are scheduled between 1:00 AM and 3:00 AM on the dates DST begins and ends. When DST begins, tasks scheduled between 2:00 AM and 3:00 AM run at the equivalent time an hour later, for example, at 3:15 instead of 2:15. When DST ends, tasks scheduled between 1:00 AM and 2:00 AM run only once, despite the hour repeating.

► Run an automation task on a schedule

1. In the **New Alert, Alert Properties, New Scheduled Task, Scheduled Task Properties, New Automation Chain** or **Automation Chain Properties** dialog box, click the **Frequency** tab.
2. Click one of the following:
 - **Every**—Runs the automation task on the specified calendar period.
 - **Use schedule**—Runs the automation task according to the selected schedule.
3. If you selected **Every** in step 2, specify the calendar used to determine how often the automation task runs, the time it runs at, and the time zone used to determine that date and time.
4. Optionally, if you want the automation task to run again, select the **Repeat every** check box, specify the time interval to repeat the automation task, and then in the **Until** box, specify the last time the automation task runs.

5. If you selected **Use schedule** in step 2, in the list, select the schedule to use for running the automation task. For more information about schedules, see ["Using predefined schedules to run automation tasks" on page 633](#).
6. Optionally, in the **Sequence** box, specify the sequence number for this automation task.



Note: The Today date constant should not be used for scheduling, because it can be interpreted as different dates for different users.

Running an automation task on data import or update

An automation task that runs on a data update runs whenever data in RapidResponse is updated from the enterprise data sources.

An automation task that runs on a data import runs whenever new data is imported into RapidResponse from your enterprise data sources. Most implementations of RapidResponse only import data once. Data is refreshed using a data update process. For more information about the differences between data updates and imports, see ["Changes to scenarios during data imports and updates" on page 466](#).

► Run an automation task on a data import or update

1. In the **New Alert, Alert Properties, New Scheduled Task, Scheduled Task Properties, New Automation Chain** or **Automation Chain Properties** dialog box, click the **Frequency** tab.
2. Click one of the following:
 - **On data update**—The automation task runs after a data update finishes.
 - **On data import**—The automation task runs after a full data import.



Note: These options are available for scheduled tasks that run scripts, but not for scheduled tasks that modify data. If you need a scheduled task that modifies data to be run on data update or import, you can include it in an automation chain and then schedule the automation chain to run on data update or import. (An automation chain does not need to contain more than one task.) For more information, see ["Create an automation chain" on page 607](#).

Unscheduled automation tasks

An automation task that is not scheduled never runs automatically, and must either be run manually or run after as part of an automation chain. An automation task that is not scheduled is automatically turned off, and if you choose a different frequency setting, you are prompted to turn the automation task on. For more information about non-scheduled automation chains, see ["Run an automation chain" on page 621](#).

Specifying whether a task must finish before it can be run again

Regardless of the condition that causes an automation task to run, you can choose whether multiple instances of the task can run at once, or if it must finish running before it can run again.

- If multiple instances of the automation task can run at once, it is added to the queue each time the condition that causes it to run occurs. This can result in the automation task being queued and starting again while another instance of the same task is running. Notification messages are sent each time the task completes.
- If the automation task must finish before it can run again, it cannot be added to the queue again while it is running. If the condition that would normally cause the automation task to run occurs while it is already running, it is not queued to run again. You might choose this setting to improve system performance and reduce the number of messages and reports generated. In the case of a scheduled tasks that modifies data, you might also want to prevent multiple simultaneous instances of the same task to prevent errors. For more information, see ["Timing of data modifications" on page 595](#).

An automation task that must complete before running again can be run multiple times if it runs as part of an automation chain. In this case, the automation task can be queued when the automation chain is running.

► **Specify whether a task must finish before it can be run again**

1. In the **New Alert, Alert Properties, New Scheduled Task, Scheduled Task Properties, New Automation Chain** or **Automation Chain Properties** dialog box, click the **Frequency** tab.
2. Clear the **Alert must finish running before it can be run again, Scheduled task must finish running before it can be run again, or Automation chain must finish running before it can be run again** check box.

Schedule an automatic data modification

You can schedule automatic data modifications to run on a regular basis or after a specific event occurs. A scheduled data modification runs a workbook command using a scenario and filter settings you specify. You can schedule data modifications defined in any workbook you have access to. A scheduled task can run one command, which can perform any number of modifications. For more information about running commands, see ["Run workbook commands" on page 360](#).

To schedule an automatic data modification, create a scheduled task.

When the scheduled task runs, it modifies data in the scenario you specify. To accomplish this, it first creates a private scenario that is a child of the specified scenario. You do not see the private scenario in your scenarios pane because it belongs to the scheduled task. The scheduled task performs the data modifications in this private scenario using the workbook command. It then commits and deletes the private scenario, bringing the changes into the specified scenario. The data changes cannot be undone.

Timing of data modifications

Automatic data modifications can be performed when a scenario is updated, when data is imported, or on a schedule. For example, you can schedule records to be deleted every Friday at midnight, or schedule records to be inserted into a worksheet for historical data whenever a scenario created to contain yesterday's data changes is updated.

Only one data modification task should be scheduled to run at one time for a scenario. If two or more scheduled tasks modify data at the same time, they can interfere with each other, overwrite data that has already been modified, and cause the child scenario to be updated with incorrect data. Data

modifications made by one task can also cause another task to fail if they cause data conflicts. For example, if a task attempts to modify records that were deleted after it started running, it will fail.

In cases where the same scheduled task might run more than once at one time—for example, if it runs on a scenario update and changes are brought in by two or more subsequent updates—you can specify that it cannot be queued again until it completes. This can prevent errors and improve system performance. For more information, see ["Specifying whether a task must finish before it can be run again" on page 594](#).

If you have multiple modifications to perform, you can create multiple scheduled tasks and add them to an automation chain, which runs the scheduled tasks in sequence. For more information, see ["Automating sequences of tasks" on page 607](#).

Updating child scenarios after data modifications

After the scheduled task's modifications to the specified scenario are complete, you can automatically update a child scenario with the changes or commit the changes to the scenario's parent. When you commit the scenario, you can specify whether that scenario is kept or deleted. If you choose to delete the scenario, you can also specify whether its children, if any exist, are deleted. If the scenario has children that you do not own, you cannot delete them, and the scheduled task fails. If you delete the scenario after committing, you cannot update a child scenario.

If the modification updates a child scenario, that scenario must be set to update manually. If it updates automatically, the child will be updated with the same changes that cause the data modifications, which might conflict with the data modifications. Users must use this child scenario for simulations, and not the scenario the scheduled task modifies. If data is modified in the scenario modified by the scheduled task, that data might be automatically modified and produce incorrect results in the child scenario.

If the command modifies data in the same scenario it takes source data from, you should run the scheduled task using a scenario that is not used for simulation, because any data changes or commits made to it will be processed by the automatic data modification, and might produce incorrect results. To make the modified data available to other users for simulations, you should create a scenario based on the scenario the scheduled task runs on, and have the scheduled task update that scenario when the modifications are complete. This scenario can be shared with the users who require it, and must be set to update manually.

Committing the data changes

If you commit the scenario, the changes in the specified scenario are committed after the data modifications are complete. Committing the changes to the scenario's parent allows them to be used in other scenarios. You can only commit the scenario if you have permission to modify the scenario's parent.

Notifications

When the task completes successfully, the specified users are notified in Message Center. A summary of the actions performed by the scheduled task can be included with the notification message. This includes the number of records modified, inserted, and deleted by each action in the workbook command. You can use this information to verify the scheduled task is modifying the correct data.

If the data modifications cannot be completed, the specified users are notified in Message Center. These do not have to be the same users who are notified when the task runs successfully. You can use the information in the notification message to correct the problem, and then try the modifications again.

► **Schedule a data modification**

1. On the **File** menu, point to **New**, and then click **Scheduled Task**.
If you have access to multiple types of resources you can schedule, point to **Scheduled Task**, and then click **Modify Data**.
2. In the **New Scheduled Task - Modify Data** dialog box, in the **Name** box, type a name for this scheduled task.
3. In the **Author notes** box, type an explanation of what the scheduled task does.
4. If you are going to schedule the scheduled task, beside **Scheduled task is**, click **Enabled**.
5. If you clicked **Enabled** in step 4 but want the scheduled task to run only one time, select the **Run scheduled task once (and then disable it)** check box.
6. If you are going to share this scheduled task, configure how it is run by users you share it with. For more information, see "[Allow automation task customization](#)" on page 563.
7. Click the **Data** tab.
8. In the **Workbook** list, select the workbook that contains the command you want the scheduled task to run.
9. Specify the scenario the command runs on, and the filter, site, and other data settings that determine the set of data the command runs on.
10. If the worksheet uses variables, do the following:
 - For variables you want to specify a value for, ensure the check box for the variable is selected and then do one of the following:
 - For text and quantity variables, type a value.
 - For all other variable types, pick a value from the drop-down list.
 - For variables that you want the default value used for, clear the check box for the variable.
11. If the worksheet uses a hierarchy, click **Hierarchy Settings**, and then do the following:
 - In the hierarchy list, click the hierarchy you want to apply to the worksheet.
 - To add a hierarchy, click **Add Hierarchy**, and then click a hierarchy in the list.
 - Select the hierarchy value or values you want to apply to the worksheet.
 - To remove a hierarchy, click **Remove Hierarchy** ✕ beside the hierarchy you want to remove.
 - Click **OK**
12. On the **Frequency** tab, specify when the task will run. For more information, see "[Schedule when an automation task runs](#)" on page 591.
13. On the **Notify** tab, if you want to send notifications, specify the message and who will receive it. For more information, see "[Send notification messages when an automation task completes](#)" on page 624.
14. Click the **Data Actions** tab.
15. To ensure the scenario the scheduled task modifies data in is up to date, select the **Update task scenario before applying the data actions** check box.
16. In the **Run command** list, click the command you want the scheduled task to run.
17. To commit the changes into the parent of the scenario the command modifies data in, select the **Commit task scenario** check box.

18. If you are committing the scenario, click one of the following:
 - **Delete scenario**—Removes the scenario after committing it.
 - **Keep scenario**—The scenario exists after committing it.
19. If you selected **Delete scenario** in step 18, select the **Delete child scenarios** check box if you want all child scenarios of the scenario that is being committed to be deleted, no matter who owns them. If this box is left unchecked and the scenario being committed has child scenarios, the task will fail.
20. If you selected **Keep scenario** in step 18 and want to update one of the scheduled task scenario's children, select the **Update child scenario** check box, and then in the list, click the scenario you want to update.
21. If you want the child to be updated regardless of whether there are conflicting changes, select the **Always update** check box.
22. To include a summary of changes made by the command, select the **Include data change summary in notification message** check box.
23. Specify when the scheduled task runs. For more information, see ["Schedule when an automation task runs" on page 591](#).
24. Optionally, specify the users you want to notify when the scheduled task runs. For more information, see ["Send notification messages when an automation task completes" on page 624](#).



Caution: If you select a private scenario for the scheduled task to modify, and then you share the scenario, the task will fail unless you edit its properties to specify the shared scenario.



Tip: You can also create a new scheduled task by clicking **New Resource**  on the RapidResponse toolbar. Point to **Scheduled Task**, and then click **Modify Data**.

Schedule a script

You can schedule any script you have access to. Scheduling a script runs it at the specified time or runs it periodically for the specified amount of time. How often you run a script depends on what the script does. For example, if the script automatically commits changes from a scenario, you might want to run it multiple times during a day. However, if the script resets a scenario hierarchy and rolls up historical data, you might want to run it only weekly or monthly.

When you specify the script to schedule, you can view its help, which can help you decide how often to run the script. This also provides information about the script's arguments, which are data values you can specify to customize the data the script runs on.

Regardless of how the scheduled task runs, you can choose whether it can be run multiple times, or if it must finish running before it can run again. If the scheduled task can run multiple times, it is added to the task queue multiple times, and the script runs for each task. If the script performs an operation that should not run often or to improve system performance, you can prevent the task from running again until it finishes. In this case, if the task is triggered again before it has finished running, it is not added to the queue. You can limit the scheduled task to running only once at a time to preserve system resources, or to prevent the same script operations from being performed multiple times. The task must have the same name and run the same script as a currently-running task in order to be considered the same.

► Create a scheduled task to run a script

1. On the **File** menu, point to **New**, and then click **Scheduled Task**.
If you have access to multiple types of resources you can schedule, point to **Scheduled Task**, and then click **Run Script**.
2. In the **New Scheduled Task - Run Script** dialog box, in the **Name** box, type a name for the scheduled task.
3. In the **Script** list, select the script you want this scheduled task to run.
4. To view information about the script you have selected, click **Script Help**.
5. In the **Author notes** box, type an explanation of what the scheduled task does and how often you expect it to run.
6. If you are going to schedule the scheduled task, beside **Scheduled task is**, click **Enabled**.
7. If you clicked **Enabled** in step 6 and want the scheduled task to run only once, select the **Run scheduled task once (and then disable it)** check box.
8. If you will share the scheduled task, configure how it is run by users you share it with. For more information, see "[Allow automation task customization](#)" on page 563.
9. Click the **Arguments** tab.
10. For each script argument, select or type a value to be used in the script.
11. Specify when the scheduled task runs. For more information, see "[Schedule when an automation task runs](#)" on page 591.
12. Optionally, specify the users you want to notify when the scheduled task runs. For more information, see "[Send notification messages when an automation task completes](#)" on page 624.



Tip: You can also create a new scheduled task by clicking **New Resource**  on the RapidResponse toolbar. Point to **Scheduled Task**, and then click **Run Script**.

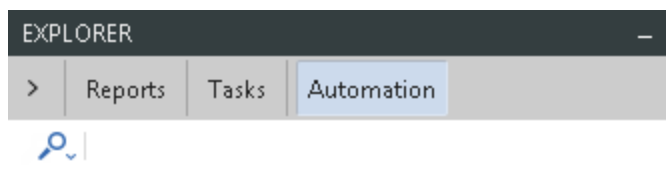
Modify a scheduled task

If you have permission to create scheduled tasks, you can modify any of your private scheduled tasks and any public scheduled tasks you own. For private scheduled tasks, you can open the scheduled task's properties and directly make your modifications. For a public scheduled task, you must first check it out of the versioned repository. For more information, see "[About modifying automation tasks](#)" on page 562 and the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

If you are working in a RapidResponse system with version control turned off, shared scheduled tasks you own can be modified like private scheduled tasks. For more information about whether or not version control is turned on or off in your system, contact your RapidResponse Administrator.

► Modify a private scheduled task

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that scheduled tasks are shown. You can do this by clicking **Automation**.



2. Select a private scheduled task.
3. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties** .
4. In the **Scheduled Task Properties** dialog box, make changes to any of the following:
 - For scheduled tasks that run scripts, the script the scheduled task runs and the values passed to the script arguments. For more information, see ["Schedule a script" on page 598](#).
 - For scheduled tasks that modify data, the resources required to run the workbook command and the command the scheduled task runs. For more information, see ["Schedule an automatic data modification" on page 595](#).
 - When the scheduled task runs. For more information, see ["Schedule a script" on page 598](#) or ["Schedule an automatic data modification" on page 595](#).
 - The notification message and recipients. For more information, see ["Send notification messages when an automation task completes" on page 624](#).



Tip: You can also edit a scheduled task by selecting it in the **Explorer** and then pressing **ALT + ENTER**.

CHAPTER 43: About forms

Run a form	603
Upload data to a form	604

Forms are resources that guide you through data entry or help you complete a task. With forms, you can complete tasks faster and on the go. Typically, forms perform a single business task or focused set of actions such as editing data. Only the information and controls you need to complete the tasks are included in the form. This way you can avoid making common mistakes, such as accidentally editing data with the wrong data settings selected.

For example, you might use a form to respond to a scenario or dispose of inventory stock.

Scenario Response*i*

Scenario *

Enterprise Data

Response *

Accept

Message

Subject *

Message

☐ Notify everyone who can access this scenario *

RESPOND

CANCEL

Dispose Inventory*i*

Scenario

Enterprise Data

Disposing of Inventory

Quantity to Dispose: *

Disposition Code: *

Inventory Type: *

Current Values

Existing Quantity:

Part:

DISPOSE

CANCEL

You can open a form from the Start page or the Explorer pane. Some forms open from links in a worksheet, when a workbook command is run, or from a step in a task flow. For more information, see ["RapidResponse application window basics" on page 78](#), ["Link to different resources from a worksheet" on page 181](#), ["Run workbook commands" on page 360](#), and ["Open and follow a task flow" on page 91](#).

Forms launched from a worksheet can enable you to make changes in a worksheet based on a different table. For example, when working on a new supply order, you might open a form to add a new order record.

	Part					
	Name	Site	Order	Line	Due Date	Quantity
16	BR-0301	Germany	PO-G00030	1	06-08-17	120
17	BR-0301	Germany	PO-G00031	1	06-09-17	150
18	BR-0301	Germany	PO-G00032	1	06-12-17	120
19	BR-0301	Germany	PO-G00033	1	06-13-17	210
20	BR-0301	Germany	PO-G00034	1	06-14-17	90
21	BR-0301	Germany	PO-G00035	1	06-15-17	150
22	BR-0301	Germany	PO-G00036	1	06-16-17	150
23	BR-0301	Germany	PO-G00037	1	06-19-17	90
24	BRAKE-01	Germany	WO-G10019	11	06-08-17	150
25	C-FRAME-STD	Germany	WO-G10028	1	06-09-17	140
26	C-FRAME-STD	Germany	WO-G10029	1	06-09-17	120
27	CRUISER	Germany	WO-G10001	1	06-05-17	25
28	CRUISER	Germany	WO-G10001	2	06-05-17	25
29	CRUISER	Germany	WO-G10002	1	06-09-17	30
30	CRUISER	Germany	WO-G10002	2	06-09-17	30
31	CRUISER	Germany	WO-G10002	3	06-09-17	30
32	CRUISER	Germany	WO-G10003	2	05-31-17	25
33	CRUISER	Germany	WO-G10003	3	06-01-17	25
34	CRUISER	Germany	WO-G10003	4	06-05-17	25
35	CRUISER	Germany	WO-G10003	5	05-31-17	25
36	CRUISER	Germany	WO-G10003	7	06-01-17	25
37	CRUISER	Germany	WO-G10003	8	06-05-17	25
38	DR-0101	Germany	PO-G00038	1	06-01-17	120
39	DR-0101	Germany	PO-G00039	1	06-02-17	310
40	DR-0101	Germany	PO-G00040	1	06-05-17	80
41	DR-0101	Germany	PO-G00041	1	06-06-17	50
42	DR-0101	Germany	PO-G00042	1	06-07-17	215
43	DR-0101	Germany	PO-G00043	1	06-08-17	150
44	DR-0101	Germany	PO-G00044	1	06-09-17	205
45	DR-0101	Germany	PO-G00045	1	06-12-17	160
46	DR-0101	Germany	PO-G00046	1	06-13-17	170
47	DR-0101	Germany	PO-G00047	1	06-15-17	220

Edit Order

Edit Order

Scenario *

Baseline

Site *

Germany

Customer *

Part Name *

C-FRAME-STD

Quantity *

Due Date *

06/09/2017

Undefined

Past

Today

Future

Order Number

WO-G10028

Order Type *

☐ High Priority *

CONTINUE

CANCEL

Help embedded in a form might be available for both the form and for individual controls on the form. For more information, see ["View form help" on page 71](#).



Note: The Desktop Client can be used on Microsoft Windows and Mac OS operating systems. However, Forms are not supported on Mac OS. If you are using the Mac OS, consider using the Mobile Client if you want to take advantage of forms or Collaboration Center. For more information about starting the Mobile Client, see ["Sign in to RapidResponse \(On-Demand systems\)" on page 46](#) or ["Sign in to RapidResponse \(On-Premises systems\)" on page 48](#). Alternatively, you might be able to run Microsoft Windows in a Mac OS virtual environment to run the Desktop Client.

Run a form

As a user, you are responsible for filling all required controls with appropriate values. Depending on the type of control on the form, you might have to type a value, select a value from a list, or select a check box. Some forms might have a control to upload data in text files to the RapidResponse database. For more information, see ["Upload data to a form" on page 604](#).

Controls might be required, optional, or read-only.

The screenshot shows a form titled "Scenario Response" with a blue header bar containing an information icon. The form includes several controls: a "Scenario *" dropdown menu with "Baseline" selected, a "Response *" dropdown menu with "Accept" selected, a "Message" section with a "Subject *" text input and a "Message" text input, and a checkbox labeled "Notify everyone who can access this scenario". Annotations include a blue callout box pointing to the "Response *" dropdown with the text "Required controls are identified by an asterisk (*)" and another blue callout box pointing to the "Message" text input with the text "Optional control". At the bottom of the form are two buttons: "RESPOND" in blue and "CANCEL" in grey.

Scenario Response *i*

Scenario *
Baseline

Response *
Accept

Required controls are identified by an asterisk (*).

Message

Subject *

Message

Optional control

☐ Notify everyone who can access this scenario

RESPOND **CANCEL**

- Required controls must have a defined value because the values are required to successfully run the form. They are identified by an asterisk (*).

Scenario Response *i*

Scenario
Baseline

Response *
Accept

Message

Subject *

Define a value.

You are prompted to fill all missing values for required controls when you submit the data in a form.

- Optional controls do not need a defined value. The form runs with or without a value in these types of fields.
- Read-only controls display a fixed value you cannot modify. These controls might require a value to run the form and display to provide context for other controls on the form. Read-only controls cannot be edited when you click the control.

Each form displays only the information and controls specific to the tasks the form runs. If you are uncertain about how to use the form or what type of value to define for a control, view the help embedded in the form. For more information, see ["View form help" on page 71](#).

You might also see a dynamic form that changes in response to the values you select or type in a control. For example, in the form below, you can create a part constraint. You also have the option to apply that constraint to a part source when you click in the Apply Constraint check box. New controls specific to applying that constraint now display on the form.

Create Curve Parameter

ID *

Curve Type *

Create Curve Parameter

ID *

Curve Type * *i*

Linear Curve

Exponential Curve

Diffusion Curve

Create Curve Parameter

ID *

Curve Type *
Exponential Curve

Initial Value *
0

Exponential Rate *
0

OK CANCEL

OK CANCEL

OK CANCEL

Selecting a curve type in the list displays new controls specific to that type of curve.

Upload data to a form

On some forms, you can upload data from text files up to 10 MB in size in to the RapidResponse database. Only .txt, .tab, and .csv file types can be uploaded.

For example, you can upload an external list representing parts being phased out from specific BOMs.

Part List *

Select a text file



CHAPTER 44: Automating sequences of tasks

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You can create automation chains from any automation task, which includes alerts, scheduled tasks, or automation chains, or you can create an empty automation chain and add the required automation tasks. If you create an automation chain using an automation task, that automation task is added as the first step in the automation chain. You must have access to at least one automation task to create an automation chain.

After creating the automation chain, you can add additional steps to it, specify whether any steps run at the same time, and then specify when the automation chain runs. If you want to be notified when the automation chain completes, you can add a notification message. You can choose who to notify when the automation chain finishes, and if you want to notify people in the case the automation chain fails.

Each alert or scheduled task in the automation chain runs using the resources and permissions of the user specified in the alert or scheduled task. For more information, see "[Allow automation task customization](#)" on page 563.

You can share the automation chain with any other user or group who requires access to it, or give it to another automation chain author. For more information, see "[Share an automation task](#)" on page 568 and "[Give an automation task](#)" on page 569.

Create an automation chain

If you have been granted the necessary permissions by your RapidResponse administrator, you can create an automation chain to perform a series of automation tasks in a predefined order. For more information, see "[Automating sequences of tasks](#)" on page 607.

You can begin by creating an empty automation chain and then add steps to it. Alternately, you can begin by selecting the task that you want to use for the first step, add it to a new automation chain, and then add additional steps.

► Create an automation chain

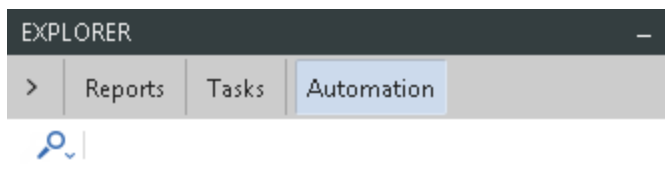
1. On the **File** menu, click **New**, and then click **Automation Chain** .
2. In the **New Automation Chain** dialog box, in the **Name** box, type the name for the automation chain.
3. In the **Author notes** area, type a description of the automation chain and the steps it runs.
4. If you are going to schedule the automation chain, beside **Automation chain is**, click **Enabled**.
5. If you clicked **Enabled** in step 4 and want the automation chain to run only once, select the **Run automation chain once (and then disable it)** check box.
6. On the **Steps** tab, add additional alerts, scheduled tasks, or automation chains. For more information, see ["Add steps to an automation chain" on page 609](#).
7. Configure any steps you want to run at the same time. For more information, see ["Create groups of parallel steps" on page 611](#).
8. On the **Frequency** tab, specify when the automation chain runs. For more information, see ["Schedule when an automation task runs" on page 591](#).
9. On the **Notify** tab, specify who is notified when the automation chain completes or fails. For more information, see ["Send notification messages when an automation task completes" on page 624](#).



Tip: You can also create an automation chain by clicking **New Resource**  on the RapidResponse toolbar, and then clicking **Automation Chain** , or by selecting an automation chain in the Explorer and then clicking **New Automation Chain**  on the **Actions** menu.

► Create an automation chain from an automation task

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that automation tasks are shown. You can do this by clicking **Automation**.



2. Select the alert, scheduled task, or automation chain you want to create the automation chain using.
3. On the **Actions** menu, click **Add to Automation Chain** .
4. In the **Add to Automation Chain** dialog box, in the **To** area, click **New automation chain**, and then click **OK**.
5. In the **New Automation Chain** dialog box, in the **Name** box, type the name for the automation chain.
6. In the **Author notes** area, type a description of the automation chain and the steps it runs.
7. If you are going to schedule the automation chain, beside **Automation chain is**, click **Enabled**.
8. If you clicked **Enabled** in step 6 and want the automation chain to run only once, select the **Run automation chain once (and then disable it)** check box.
9. On the **Steps** tab, add additional alerts, scheduled tasks, or automation chains. For more information, see ["Add steps to an automation chain" on page 609](#).

10. On the **Frequency** tab, specify when the automation chain runs. For more information, see ["Schedule when an automation task runs" on page 591](#).
11. On the **Notify** tab, specify who is notified when the automation chain completes or fails. For more information, see ["Send notification messages when an automation task completes" on page 624](#).



Note: If the automation task you add as the first step is scheduled, its frequency settings are copied to the automation chain.



Tip: You can also create an automation chain from an automation task by right-clicking on the automation task and then clicking **Add to Automation Chain**.

Add steps to an automation chain

You can add any automation task (alerts, scheduled tasks, or automation chains) to an automation chain. Each automation task you add to an automation chain adds an additional step to the automation chain. When you add an automation task, it is added as the last step in the automation chain. You can also add a step to a new automation chain, which creates the automation chain and adds the specified automation chain as its first step. For more information, see ["Automating sequences of tasks" on page 607](#). When you add an automation task to an automation chain, you can also verify the steps are in the correct order, rearrange the steps, and specify which steps, if any, are conditional.

Adding alerts and scheduled tasks from RapidResponse 2013.4 and earlier

If you have upgraded from RapidResponse 2013.4 or earlier and you add an alert or scheduled task that runs another alert or scheduled task, each of those alerts and scheduled tasks are added to the automation chain. You must modify the alerts and scheduled tasks to remove the relationships before you can run the automation chain, which also ensures the alerts and scheduled tasks run as part of the automation chain. This allows you to perform the same operations, but provides visibility into how the sequence of alerts and scheduled tasks are arranged, and to rearrange these steps if desired. For more information, see ["Modify an alert" on page 588](#) and ["Modify a scheduled task" on page 599](#).

Making steps conditional

After you add a step, you can specify whether the automation chain can stop running based on this step. Typically, this should be a step that the rest of the automation chain depends on, such as an alert that determines if a process should be run. A step can conditionally stop the automation chain from running if one of the following conditions occurs:

- The step is an alert, and its condition is not met.
- The step is a scheduled task that runs a script, and the script either does not return a value, or returns a value other than 'True'.

A step that runs a scheduled task that modifies data cannot conditionally stop the automation chain. If a step is marked conditional and either its condition is not met or the script does not return 'True', the automation chain fails and no further steps run. An example of conditional steps is shown in the following illustration.

Automation Chain Properties					
General Steps Frequency Notify					
	Automation Task	Start	Conditionally Stop	Resource	Scenario
1	Adjust to Supply Plan		☐	Supply Management	Approved Actions
2	Consolidate Supplies	After	☐	Supply Adjustment Consolidation	
3	Balance Supplies	After	☒	Consolidated Supply Balancing	
4	Consolidated Balance Report	After	☐	Supply Management	Approved Actions

In this example, the Balance Supplies step fails if the Consolidated Supply Balancing script it runs does not return a 'True' value. If the Balance Supplies step fails, the automation chain fails. Depending on the requirements of your automation chain, you can include alerts that do not send notifications, and are used only to control whether an automation chain continues running. For more information, see ["Send notification messages when an automation task completes" on page 624](#).

Running steps in parallel

If you add a step to an automation chain and the last steps in the automation chain run in parallel, the step you add is not added to the parallel group. The parallel steps must complete before the newly-added step runs. If you want to include the new step in the parallel group, you must edit the automation chain to make the step part of the group. For more information, see ["Create groups of parallel steps" on page 611](#).

Creating valid automation chains

When you are adding steps to an automation chain, you cannot include an automation chain that includes the automation chain you are modifying. For example, if you have an automation chain A that runs automation chain B, you cannot add automation chain A to automation chain B.

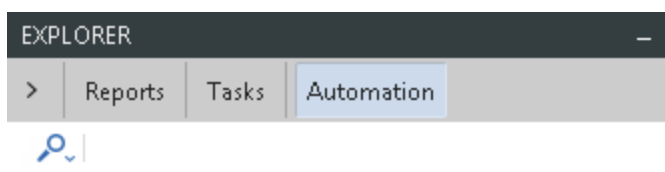
If you add an automation chain to an automation chain, you must ensure all steps in the automation chain you are adding are valid. For example, if the automation chain includes a scheduled task that has been deleted, that step fails when your automation chain runs. If any step encounters an error, the automation chain fails, regardless of whether it is specified as conditional. For more information about failed steps, see ["Automation task logging" on page 641](#).

Adding steps that run independently of the automation chain

You are warned if you add an automation task to an automation chain, and that automation task is already set to run automatically. Disabling tasks that you add to an automation chain is generally good practice, so that these tasks do not run more often than necessary. However, disabling these tasks is optional, since there might be situations when it makes sense for the task to run independently of the automation chain. For example, you might want an alert to run on a regular schedule and every time you manually run an unscheduled automation chain that imports and modifies data.

► Add an automation task to an existing automation chain

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that automation tasks are shown. You can do this by clicking **Automation**.



2. Select the alert, scheduled task, or automation chain you want to add to an automation chain.
3. On the **Actions** menu, click **Add to Automation Chain**.
4. In the **Add to Automation Chain** dialog box, in the **To** area, click **Automation chain**.
5. In the list, select the automation chain you want to add the automation task to.
6. Click **OK**.
7. In the **Automation Chain Properties** dialog box, on the **Steps** tab, verify the step is in the position you want it. Otherwise, drag the step up or down in the list.



Tip: You can also create a new automation chain by adding a step. For more information, see ["Automating sequences of tasks" on page 607](#).

► Add a step by modifying an automation chain

1. In the **New Automation Chain** or **Automation Chain Properties** dialog box, click the **Steps** tab.
2. Click **Add**.
3. In the **Add Step** dialog box, select the alert, scheduled task, or automation chain you want to add, and then click **Add**.
4. Repeat step 3 for each step you want to add, and then click **OK**.



Tip: You can also add a step by right-clicking the steps and then clicking **Add**.

► Change the order of steps

1. In the **New Automation Chain** or **Automation Chain Properties** dialog box, click the **Steps** tab.
2. Drag the steps up or down in the list.

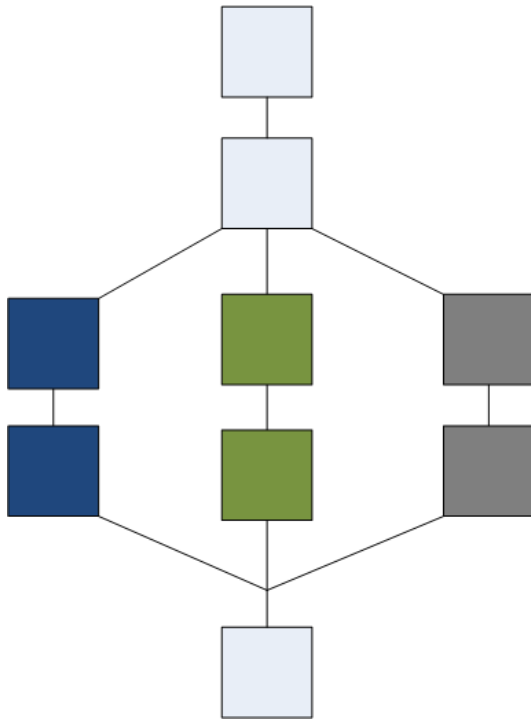
► Specify if a step can stop the automation chain

1. In the **New Automation Chain** or **Automation Chain Properties** dialog box, click the **Steps** tab.
2. For each step you want to make conditional, select the **Conditionally Stop** check box.

Create groups of parallel steps

In any automation chain you create, you can specify a group of tasks to run in parallel. This runs the alert, scheduled task, or automation chain in each step at the same time, and allows you to improve system performance by running multiple steps at once, instead of waiting for each step to complete before the next can begin. Typically, you should make steps run in parallel if they have no dependency on each other. For example, scheduled tasks that modify data in different tables can run in parallel because one does not require the other to be finished.

An example of this structure is shown in the following illustration.



In this example, the light-colored boxes represent steps in the automation chain. The dark-colored boxes represent other automation chains that run in parallel with each other as part of the light-colored automation chain. When all the parallel automation chains are complete, the last step in the light-colored automation chain runs.

Steps in the automation chain run in the order specified, steps in parallel groups run after the step before the group runs, and steps after the parallel group run after all steps in the group complete.

Steps that run in a parallel group cannot also be set to conditionally stop the automation chain, except for the first step in the parallel group. If a step must be able to conditionally stop the automation chain, you should ensure it is the first in the parallel group.

The structure of steps in an automation chain is indicated using the following:

- blank—The first step in the automation chain.
- After—The step runs after the step before it completes.
- With previous—The step runs in parallel with the automation task above it in the list.



Note: When an automation chain is nested as a step within another automation chain, the steps within the nested automation chain do not run in parallel, even if they are set to run with the previous step. Instead, they run sequentially in the order they are listed.

Automation chains with multiple parallel groups

An automation chain can contain parallel groups that run after other parallel groups. For example, the following illustration contains three parallel groups, two of which run two scheduled tasks in parallel and the other runs a scheduled task and an alert in parallel.

Automation Chain Properties					
General Steps Frequency Notify					
	Automation Task	Start	Conditionally Stop	Resource	Scenario
1	Create Processing Scenario		☐	Create Processing Scenario	
	Create Stock Scenario	With previous	☐	Create Scenario	
2	Order Update	After	☐	saveOrder	
3	Commit Processing Scenario	After	☐	Commit Processing Scenario	
4	Automated Order Update	After	☐		Approved Actions
5	Move Supply to Stock	After	☐	Update Stock	Run Stock
	Write Aggregate Supply Plan	With previous	☐	Aggregate Supply Plan	S&OP Candidate
6	Balance Supplies	After	☐	Consolidated Supply Balancing	
7	Notification	After	☐	Messaging	
	Order Process Report	With previous	☐	Demand Order Analysis - Whole Orders	Approved Actions

Choosing a good number of parallel steps

Because parallel steps run at the same time, each step requires a worker thread and memory. Because worker threads are limited, you should not create parallel groups that contain too many steps. Typically, three or four steps should be the most you run at one time. You can use the Automation Details and Log workbook to determine how long an automation chain takes to run, and compare the duration using different sizes of parallel groups to determine the optimal number of steps in a parallel group. For more information, see ["Automation task details and logging" on page 637](#).

► Specify steps that run in parallel

1. In the **New Automation Chain** or **Automation Chain Properties**, click the **Steps** tab.
2. Locate the step you want to run in parallel.
3. Click in the **Start** column, and then click **With previous**.



Note: If you run steps in parallel, you cannot start running the automation chain from a step in a parallel group.



Tip: You can also drag a step into a parallel group to run it with the group.

► Modify a parallel step to not run in parallel

1. In the **New Automation Chain** or **Automation Chain Properties**, click the **Steps** tab.
2. Locate the step you want to no longer run in parallel.
3. Click in the **Start** column, and then click **After**.



Tip: You can also drag a step out of a parallel group to run it after the previous step.

► Remove a step that runs in parallel

When you remove a step that is part of a parallel group, the other steps in that group continue to run in parallel. However, if there is only one other step in the group, that step is modified to run in series. For

more information about removing automation chain steps, see ["Modify an automation chain" on page 614](#).

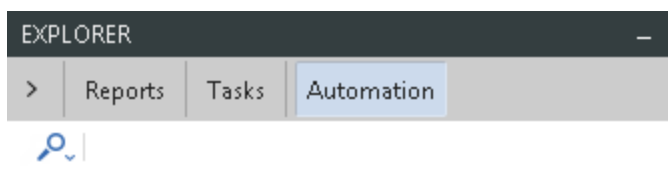
Modify an automation chain

If you have permission to create automation chains, you can modify any of your private automation chains and any public automation chains you own. For private automation chains, you can open the automation chain's properties and directly make your modifications. For a public automation chain, you must first check the automation chain and each of its tasks out of the versioned repository. For more information, see ["About modifying automation tasks" on page 562](#) and the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

If you are working in a RapidResponse system with version control turned off, shared automation chains you own can be modified like private automation chains. For more information about whether or not version control is turned on or off in your system, contact your RapidResponse Administrator.

► Modify a private automation chain

1. In the Explorer, ensure that automation chains are shown. You can do this by selecting Automation



2. Select a private automation chain.
3. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties** .
4. In the **Automation Chain Properties** dialog box, do any of the following:
 - Add steps or remove steps For more information, see ["Add steps to an automation chain" on page 609](#).
 - Drag steps up or down in the list to change the order they run in.
 - Specify whether steps run in parallel. For more information, see ["Create groups of parallel steps" on page 611](#).
 - Specify whether steps can conditionally stop the automation chain. For more information, see ["Specify if a step can stop the automation chain" on page 611](#).
 - Change when the automation chain runs. For more information, see ["Schedule when an automation task runs" on page 591](#).
 - Edit the notification message that is sent when the automation chain runs, and add or remove recipients it is sent to. For more information, see ["Send notification messages when an automation task completes" on page 624](#).



Tip: You can also edit an automation chain by selecting it in the **Explorer** and then pressing **ALT + ENTER**.

► **Add or remove steps in an automation chain**

1. In the **Automation Chain Properties** dialog box, click the **Steps** tab.
2. To add a step, click **Add**, and then add the step as described in ["Add steps to an automation chain" on page 609](#).
3. To remove a step, select the step you want to remove, and then click **Remove**.



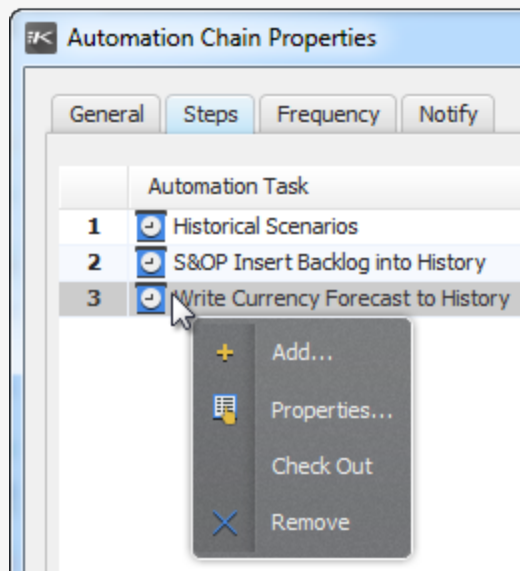
Tip: You can also remove a step by right-clicking it and then clicking **Remove**.

► **Modify an automation task included in an automation chain**

1. In the **Automation Chain Properties** dialog box, click the **Steps** tab.
2. Select the automation task you want to modify.
3. On the **Actions** menu, click **Check Out** .
4. Click **Properties**.
5. Modify the automation task properties as described in ["Modify a scheduled task" on page 599](#) or ["Modify an alert" on page 588](#).



Tip: You can also edit a step by double-clicking it, or by right-clicking it and then clicking **Properties**.



CHAPTER 45: Running automation tasks manually

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Automation tasks can be scheduled to run at predefined times, and they can also be run manually as needed. Some automation tasks do not run on a preset schedule at all, and are only intended to be run manually. If you create or modify an automation task, it is also good practice to run the automation task manually to test it before you schedule it to run or add recipients to the notification list.

When you run an automation task manually, it does not affect any regularly scheduled runs of the task. If the task is scheduled to run at certain times, it will still run at those times.

When you run an alert, scheduled task, or automation chain manually, you might be able to change some of its settings without affecting the default settings. The person who owns the alert or scheduled task can specify which types of settings, if any, can be changed when someone runs the alert manually.

For example, if an alert is scheduled to run every Monday and send information to many recipients, but you want to receive updated information on Wednesday, you could run the alert manually. To avoid sending unneeded information to all of the usual recipients, you could specify that only you will receive a notification this time. Next Monday, the alert will still run, and it will send a report to all of the usual recipients. For more information about running alerts and scheduled tasks manually, see ["Run alerts manually" on page 618](#) and ["Run a scheduled task" on page 620](#).

When you run an automation chain manually, you might be able to choose to begin at a step other than step one. For more information, see ["Run an automation chain" on page 621](#).

Run an automation task

You can run any automation task you have access to, as long as it is not [locked](#).

Your automation tasks are available in the Run Automation Task dialog box, which you can access from the RapidResponse toolbar.

You can also search for the automation task you want to run.

► Run an automation task

1. On the RapidResponse toolbar, click **Run Automation Task** .
 2. In the **Run Automation Task** dialog box, select the automation task you want to run.
 3. Optionally, do the following to sort the automation task list.
 - Click **Name** to sort the list alphabetically by name, which allows you to select from the beginning or end of the list.
 - Click **Type** to sort the list by type, which allows you to select from only the type of automation tasks you want to run.
 4. Click **OK**.
 5. Depending on the automation task type you selected and the settings of that automation task, specify settings for the automation task.
- For more information, see ["Run alerts manually" on page 618](#), ["Run a scheduled task" on page 620](#), ["Run an automation chain" on page 621](#), or ["Run a script" on page 623](#).

► Search for an automation task

1. On the toolbar, click **Run Automation Task** .
2. To search in a specific column, in the search box, click **Search Options** , and then click one of the following:
 - **All**—searches all columns in the list for the specified text.
 - **Name**—searches the Name column for the specified text. Select this option if you are searching for a specific automation task.
 - **Type**—searches the Type column for the specified text. Select this option if you are searching for a specific type of automation task.
3. To specify where in the column the search word is, click **Search Options** , and then click one of the following:
 - **Match from start**—the search word must be at the beginning of a word in the specified column.
 - **Match anywhere**—the search word can be anywhere in the specified column.
4. In the search box, type the automation task name or type you want to find.

Run alerts manually

You can manually run alerts that have been shared with you by other users or administrators. You can run an alert from the RapidResponse toolbar or using the Explorer. Depending on the alert settings you might be prompted to specify the data settings you want the alert to use, to define notification settings, or both.

If you have permission to create alerts you can also manually run alert to test alerts you create, or to periodically run alerts that are not meant for data monitoring.

An alert can be run manually at any time, as long as the resources required are available to you. Manually running an alert does not consider the alert's effective dates.

An alert that is not scheduled can also be run as part of an automation chain. For more information, see ["About automation chains" on page 561](#).

You can customize data, notification settings, or both when you run a shared alert, if the alert's author has allowed it. If you have not been granted these permissions, the alert runs using the alert author's chosen settings.

► Run an alert

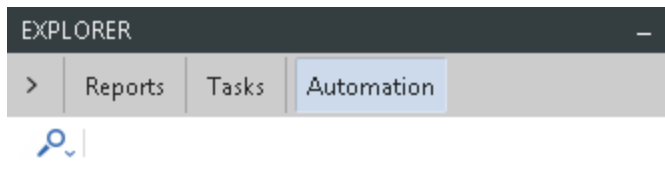
1. On the toolbar, click **Run Automation Task** , and then click **Run Automation Task**.
2. In the **Run Automation Task** dialog box, select the alert you want to run, and then click **OK**.



Tip: You can also search for the alert you want to run by typing its name in the search box.

► Run an alert from the Explorer

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that alerts are shown. You can do this by selecting **Automation**.



2. Select the alert you want to run.
3. On the **Actions** menu, click **Run Alert Now**.
4. In the confirmation dialog box, click **Yes**.
5. Click **Run**.



Note: It can take several minutes to run an alert. If the alert takes a significant amount of time to complete, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

► Run an alert manually with customized settings

1. Run an alert from the **Run Automation Task** dialog box or the **Explorer**.
2. In the **Run Alert** dialog box, on the **Data Settings** tab, select the data settings you want to monitor. For more information, see ["Create an alert to monitor worksheet data" on page 574](#).
3. On the **Notify** tab:
 - Select **Alert owner** to send a notification message to the alert's owner.
 - Select **User running the alert** to send a notification message to yourself.
 - Select **Others** to send a notification message to the list of recipients you specify. For more information, see ["Send notification messages when an automation task completes" on page 624](#).
 - In the **Message** area, type a **Subject** and a **Message** in the text boxes.
4. Click **Run**.



Notes:

- The **Run Alert** dialog box might contain both or only one of the **Data Settings** and **Notify** tabs.



- If you do not have access to a resource required by the alert, it displays with a  on the **Data Settings** tab. To access the resource, contact the alert owner.
- It can take several minutes to run an alert. If the alert takes a significant amount of time to complete, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

Run a scheduled task

In addition to running a scheduled task according to its schedule, you can run a scheduled task manually from the RapidResponse toolbar or using the Explorer. Running a scheduled task executes the script or modifies the data.

If a scheduled task author has allowed, you can customize data and/or notification settings when you run a shared scheduled task. If you have not been granted these permissions, the scheduled task runs using the author's chosen settings.

► Run a scheduled task

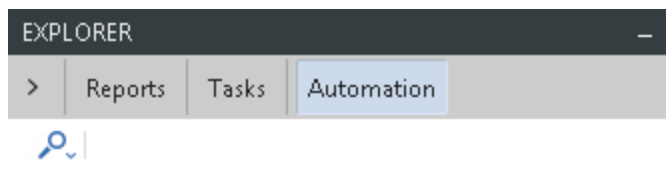
1. On the toolbar, click **Run Automation Task** , and then click **Run Automation Task**.
2. In the **Run Automation Task** dialog box, select the scheduled task you want to run, and then click **OK**.



Tip: You can also search for the scheduled task you want to run by typing its name in the search box.

► Run a scheduled task from the Explorer

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that scheduled tasks are shown. You can do this by clicking **Automation**.



2. Select the scheduled task you want to run.
3. On the **Actions** menu, click **Run Now** .
4. In the confirmation dialog box, click **OK**.



Note: It can take several minutes to run a scheduled task. If a scheduled task takes a significant amount of time to complete, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

► Run a scheduled task manually with customized settings

1. Run a scheduled task from the **Run Automation Task** dialog box or the **Explorer**.

2. In the **Run Scheduled Task** dialog box, on the **Data Settings** tab, select the data settings you want to monitor. For more information, see ["Schedule an automatic data modification" on page 595](#) and ["Schedule a script" on page 598](#).
3. On the **Notify** tab:
 - Select **Scheduled task owner** to send a notification message to the scheduled task's owner.
 - Select **User running the scheduled task** to send a notification message to yourself.
 - Select **Others** to send a notification message to the list of recipients you specify. For more information, see ["Send notification messages when an automation task completes" on page 624](#).
 - In the **Message** area, type a **Subject** and a **Message** in the text boxes.
4. Click **Run**.

**Notes:**

- The **Run Scheduled Task** dialog box might contain both or only one of the **Data Settings** and **Notify** tabs.
- If you do not have access to a resource required by the scheduled task, it displays with a  on the **Data Settings** tab. To access the resource, contact the scheduled task owner.
- It can take several minutes to run a scheduled task. If the scheduled task takes a significant amount of time to complete, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

Run an automation chain

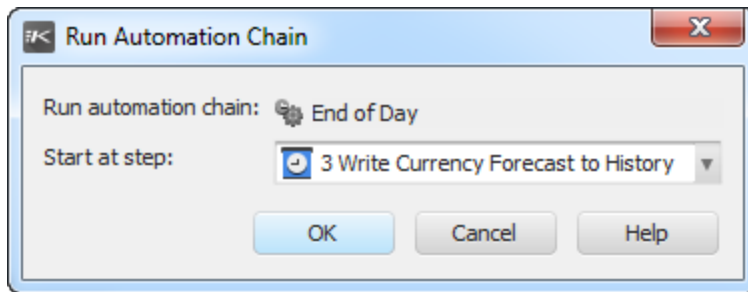
In addition to scheduling automation chains, you can run them manually. You can run an automation chain from the RapidResponse toolbar or using the Explorer. Running an automation chain runs each alert, scheduled task, or automation chain included in the automation chain's steps, and sends any notification messages defined by those steps.

You can run any automation chain you own or that has been shared with you, as long as it is not locked. For more information, see ["Unlock an automation resource" on page 570](#).

If any step of the automation chain fails, you and the users or groups specified in that step are notified of the failure.

If you are running an automation chain that has been shared with you and you have the ability to change the recipients, you can add or remove recipients before you run the automation chain. This changes the recipients of the notification sent when the automation chain completes, but does not affect the recipients of notifications sent by each automation task in the automation chain.

If you can create automation chains, when you run an automation chain, you can choose which step the automation chain begins running on. You can run a step that you have just added to ensure it works as part of the automation chain, to test parts of the automation chain without running every other automation task, or to re-run a failed automation chain from the step where the failure happened. For more information about failed automation chains, see ["Automation task logging" on page 641](#). Automatically running the automation chain always runs every step.



If any step in an automation chain is missing, for example, if an alert has been deleted, you are notified about the missing step and the automation chain does not run.

► Run an automation chain

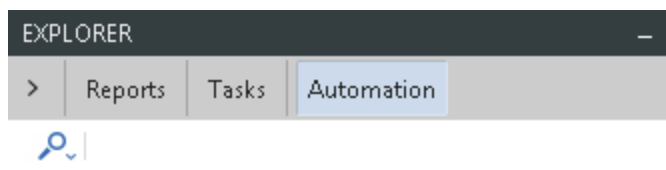
1. On the toolbar, click **Run Automation Task** , and then click **Run Automation Task**.
2. In the **Run Automation Task** dialog box, select the automation chain you want to run, and then click **OK**.



Tip: You can also search for the automation chain you want to run by typing its name in the search box.

► Run an automation chain from the Explorer

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that automation chains are shown. You can do this by selecting **Automation**.



2. Select the automation chain you want to run.
3. On the **Actions** menu, click **Run Now**.
4. In the confirmation dialog box, click **OK**.

► Specify recipients when running an automation chain

1. Run an automation chain from the **Run Automation Task** dialog box or the **Explorer**.
2. In the **Run Automation Chain** dialog box, add or remove recipients for the message. For more information, see ["Send notification messages when an automation task completes" on page 624](#).
3. In the **Message** area, specify the subject and message to be sent when the automation chain completes.
4. Click **OK**.

► Run an automation chain from a specific step

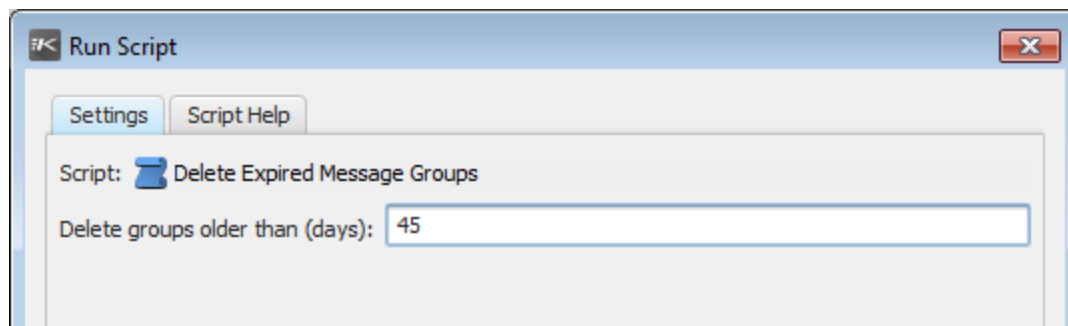
1. Run an automation chain from the **Run Automation Task** dialog box or the **Explorer**.
2. In the **Run Automation Chain** dialog box, in the **Start at step** list, click step you want to run first.
3. Click **OK**.

Run a script

You can run any script you have access to. When you run a script, the operations defined in the script are performed. Depending on what the script does, it could take a long time to complete. If you think a script has been running for too long, you can contact your RapidResponse administrator to cancel the script.

Depending on how the script was created, it can take arguments, which are values you specify and that are used in the script. Arguments can take text, date, Boolean, or quantity values, or a scenario name. Information about each argument is typically found in the script's help.

When you run a script, you are often prompted to provide values for the script's arguments, as shown in the following illustration.



The script's author specifies default values for each argument, so you can specify values for only the arguments you want to change. All arguments must have a value specified.

You can also view help about the script and its arguments. For more information, see ["View script help" on page 72](#).

You can run a script from the RapidResponse toolbar, using the Explorer, by scheduling it to run at a specific time, or by running a workbook command. For more information, see ["Schedule a script" on page 598](#) and ["Run workbook commands" on page 360](#).

► Run a script

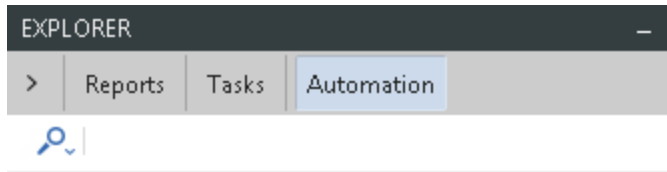
1. On the toolbar, click **Run Automation Task** , and then click **Run Automation Task**.
2. In the **Run Automation Task** dialog box, select the script you want to run, and then click **OK**.



Tip: You can also search for the script you want to run by typing its name in the search box.

► Run a script from the Explorer

1. In the Explorer, ensure that scripts are shown. You can do this by selecting **Automation**.



2. Select the script you want to run.
3. On the **Actions** menu, click **Run Now** .
4. If the script has arguments, in the **Run Script** dialog box, on the **Settings** tab, specify values for each argument you want to modify.
5. Click **OK**.

When the script completes, a confirmation dialog might display the output of the script, including whether it completed successfully.

Send notification messages when an automation task completes

When an alert's condition is met, a scheduled task completes its modifications or script, or the steps in an automation chain complete, you can send notification messages to people who have access to that automation task. Similarly, if the automation task fails, you can notify your RapidResponse administrator or other users who have access to the automation task. You can send a notification message to each member of a RapidResponse group, a list of RapidResponse users, and any other message recipients you specify. RapidResponse users receive notifications in Message Center, and might also receive notifications by email depending on their personal settings. Recipients who do not use RapidResponse only receive messages by email. You can also specify the message's subject and body to explain the purpose of the automation task and why the message is being sent.

For each person you send the notification message to, you can specify how they receive it.

- **To**—Primary recipients. These are typically the users and groups affected by changes made by the scheduled task.
- **Cc**—Carbon copied recipients. These are typically users who are not impacted directly by the changes, but might want to know a change has happened.
- **Bcc**—Blind carbon copied recipients. These recipients are not shown in the message's list of recipients.

For notification messages sent by alerts, recipients are unable to view the affected data unless you specifically allow them to view the current data or attach a report to the alert. For more information about reports, see ["Attach a report to an alert message" on page 586](#).

For notification messages sent by scheduled tasks, you should send messages to users or groups if the scheduled task affects a resource they use. For example, if a script creates a scenario that a group uses for simulations, you can notify them when the script runs so they know when the scenario is available. If a data modification consolidates data from a number of scenarios into one scenario the group uses for reference, you can notify the group with a summary of the data changes made to that scenario.

Some scripts automatically send messages when they run. However, unless you are a script author, you cannot modify these recipients.

If the automation task cannot run for any reason, you will automatically receive a message that explains what went wrong. You can also choose to send a failure message to other users. Failed automation task messages have the  icon. An automation task typically fails because a resource is missing. For example, if the worksheet or scorecard being monitored by an alert is deleted, the alert fails the next time it runs.

You can send success and failure notifications if you created the automation task. If you have been shared an automation task created by someone else, you might have been granted permission to send success notifications. Otherwise, you can run the automation task and the notification messages are sent to the recipients specified in the automation task.

You can also choose to not send notification messages. You might not send notifications if you want to use an alert's condition to control an automation chain's processing order, or if you want a scheduled task or automation chain to perform its operations silently. For more information, see ["Add steps to an automation chain" on page 609](#).

► Specify RapidResponse user recipients

1. In the **New Alert, Alert Properties, New Scheduled Task, Scheduled Task Properties, New Automation Chain** or **Automation Chain Properties** dialog box, click the **Notify** tab.
2. On the **Success** sub-tab, select any of the following, depending on the type of automation task:
 - **Alert owner**—Sends the notification message to the person who created the alert.
 - **User who ran the alert**—Sends the notification message to the user who ran the alert.
 - **Scheduled task owner**—Sends the notification message to the person who created the scheduled task.
 - **User who ran the scheduled task**—Sends the notification message to the user who ran the scheduled task.
 - **Automation chain owner**—Sends the notification message to the person who created the automation chain.
 - **User who ran the automation chain**—Sends the notification message to the user who ran the automation chain.
 - **Others**—Sends the notification message to a list of users you specify.
3. If you selected **Others**, click **Select Names**.
4. In the **Select Names** dialog box, do the following:
 - On the **Users** tab, click a user you want to be notified, and then click **To**, **Cc**, or **Bcc**; depending on how you want the recipient to receive the message.
 - On the **Groups** tab, click a group you want to be notified, and then click **To**, **Cc**, or **Bcc**, depending on how you want the recipients in the group to receive the message.
5. Repeat step 4 for every user or group you want to add.
6. Click **OK**.



Notes:

- You are included in the recipient list of every automation task you create. If you do not want to receive the message, you can remove yourself from the list of recipients.
- The **To**, **Cc**, or **Bcc** setting is most useful if the recipient chooses to receive messages by email.



Tip: To find out more about the people you can send notification messages to, move the pointer over their names.

► Specify email recipients

1. In the **New Alert, Alert Properties, New Scheduled Task, Scheduled Task Properties, New Automation Chain** or **Automation Chain Properties** dialog box, click the **Notify** tab.
2. On the **Success** sub-tab, click **Email Addresses**.
3. In the **To**, **Cc**, or **Bcc** text boxes, enter the recipients' email addresses, separated by commas or semicolons.
4. Click **OK**.



Caution: Email is not a secure method of transmitting data. Ask your system or RapidResponse administrator whether your company's email server uses encryption before sending notification messages to recipients using email.



Notes:

- The **Email Addresses** button is inactive if your RapidResponse account does not have an email address defined. For more information, contact your RapidResponse administrator.
- When a notification is sent to an email address, the email is sent from RapidResponse using your name. In some cases, Microsoft Outlook and other email programs might detect this email and warn you that a program is sending an email using your name. If this happens, click **Allow** on the warning to send the notification to the email recipients.



Tip: If you often send messages to the same email address, ask your RapidResponse administrator to create an Alert user account for that email address. By creating an Alert user, you no longer need to type in the address; instead you can select the name from the list of RapidResponse users.

► Specify the message content

1. In the **New Alert, Alert Properties, New Scheduled Task, Scheduled Task Properties, New Automation Chain** or **Automation Chain Properties** dialog box, click the **Notify** tab.
2. On the **Success** sub-tab, in the **Subject** box, type a descriptive name.
3. In the **Message** box, type a description of the automation task or a summary of what actions the automation task performs.
4. If you want the message to include a link to a resource, see ["Add links to automation task notifications" on page 627](#).
5. If you want the resource link to provide access to the current data, make sure that the **Allow all recipients to view current data** box is checked.

► Modify how a recipient receives messages

1. In the **New Alert, Alert Properties, New Scheduled Task, Scheduled Task Properties, New Automation Chain** or **Automation Chain Properties** dialog box, click the **Notify** tab.

2. On the **Success** sub-tab, in the **Recipients** list, click the value in the **Address** column for the recipient you want to change.
3. Click **To**, **Cc**, or **Bcc**.

► **Remove a message recipient**

1. In the **New Alert, Alert Properties, New Scheduled Task, Scheduled Task Properties, New Automation Chain** or **Automation Chain Properties** dialog box, click the **Notify** tab.
2. On the **Success** sub-tab, click the recipient you want to remove.
3. Click **Remove**.
4. Repeat steps 2 and 3 for every recipient you want to remove.

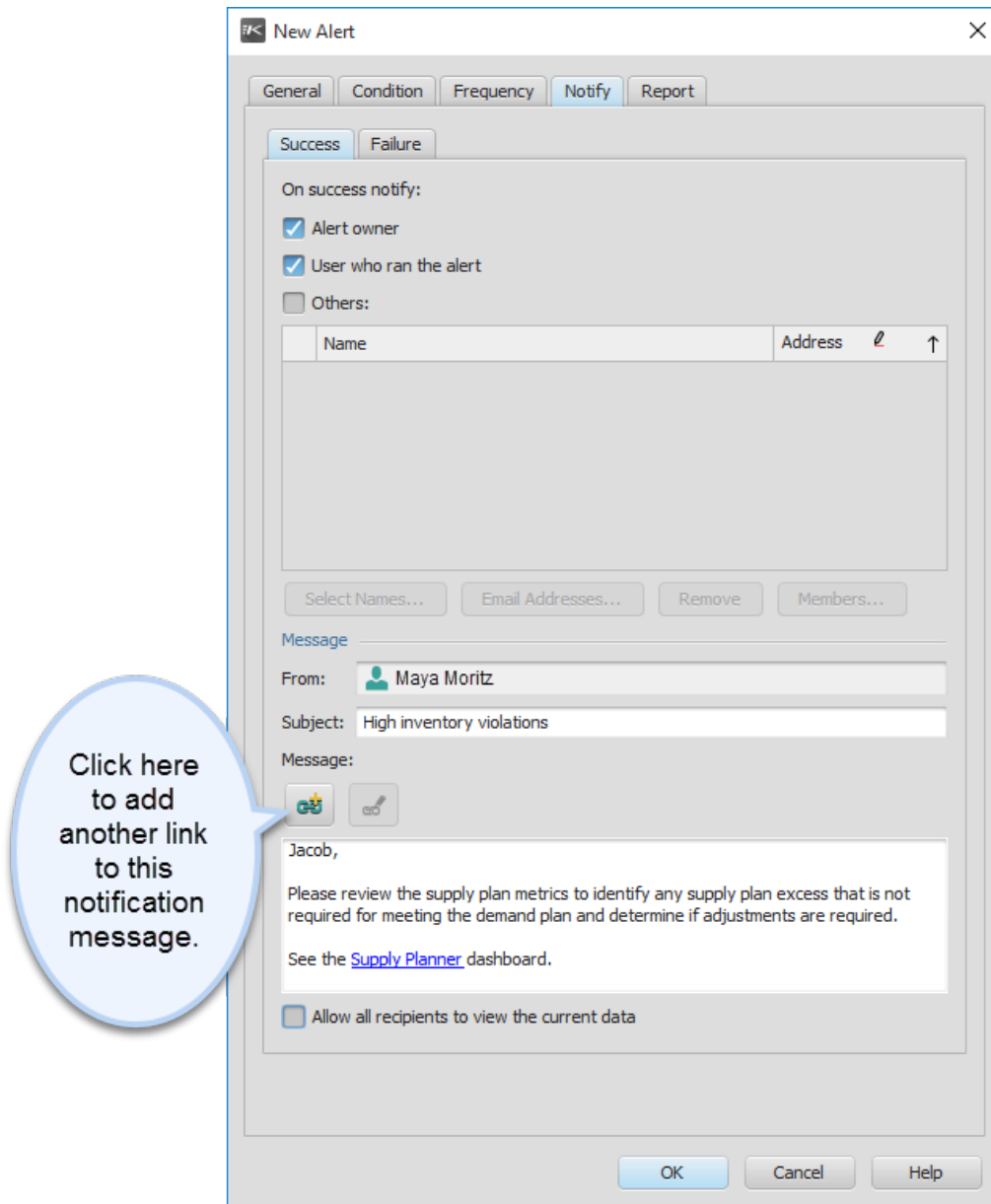
► **Send a failure notification**

1. In the **New Alert, Alert Properties, New Scheduled Task, Scheduled Task Properties, New Automation Chain** or **Automation Chain Properties** dialog box, click the **Notify** tab.
2. On the **Failure** sub-tab, select who you want to receive the failure notification, depending on the type of automation task:
 - **Alert owner**—Sends the notification message to the person who created the alert.
 - **User who ran the alert**—Sends the notification message to the user who ran the alert.
 - **Scheduled task owner**—Sends the notification message to the person who created the scheduled task.
 - **User who ran the scheduled task**—Sends the notification message to the user who ran the scheduled task.
 - **Automation chain owner**—Sends the notification message to the person who created the automation chain.
 - **User who ran the automation chain**—Sends the notification message to the user who ran the automation chain.
 - **Others**—Sends the notification message to a list of users you specify.
3. If you selected **Others**, do one of the following to add failure message recipients:
 - Click **Select Names**, and then in the **Select Names** dialog box, select the user or group you want to send the failure message to, and then click **To**, **Cc**, or **Bcc** to specify how the message is delivered.
 - Click **Email Addresses**, and then in the Email addresses dialog box, type the address you want to send the failure message to, and then click **To**, **Cc**, or **Bcc** to specify how the message is delivered.

Add links to automation task notifications

You can add additional information to notification messages for all automation tasks (alerts, automation chains, and scheduled tasks) by adding links to resources with the data context you specify. Message recipients can open the resource with the data settings that you set. You can also include links to RapidResponse forms or to websites.

The following illustration shows a link added to a notification message for an alert.



To view the data, users require permission to all of the resources you are using to display the data.

► Insert a link

1. Click the **Notify** tab.
2. Ensure that the **Success** sub-tab is selected.
3. In the **Message** area, click the location where you want to insert the link.
4. Click **Insert Link** .
5. In the **Insert Link** dialog box, select one of the following:
 - **An open report**—inserts a link to a currently opened shared workbook, scorecard, or dashboard.

- **Report**—inserts a link to any shared dashboard, workbook, or scorecard.
 - **Form**—inserts a link to a form.
 - **Web page**—inserts a link to a web page outside of RapidResponse.
6. If you are inserting a link to a report or a form, select the report or form from the drop-down list.
 7. Click **Next**.
 8. Optionally, in the **Add Link** text box, change the default text that displays as the link in the message.
 9. To define the data that is displayed, select the settings that you want to use to open the resource.

► Edit a link

1. In the **Message** box, select the link and click **Edit Link** .
2. Make your changes and then click **OK**.

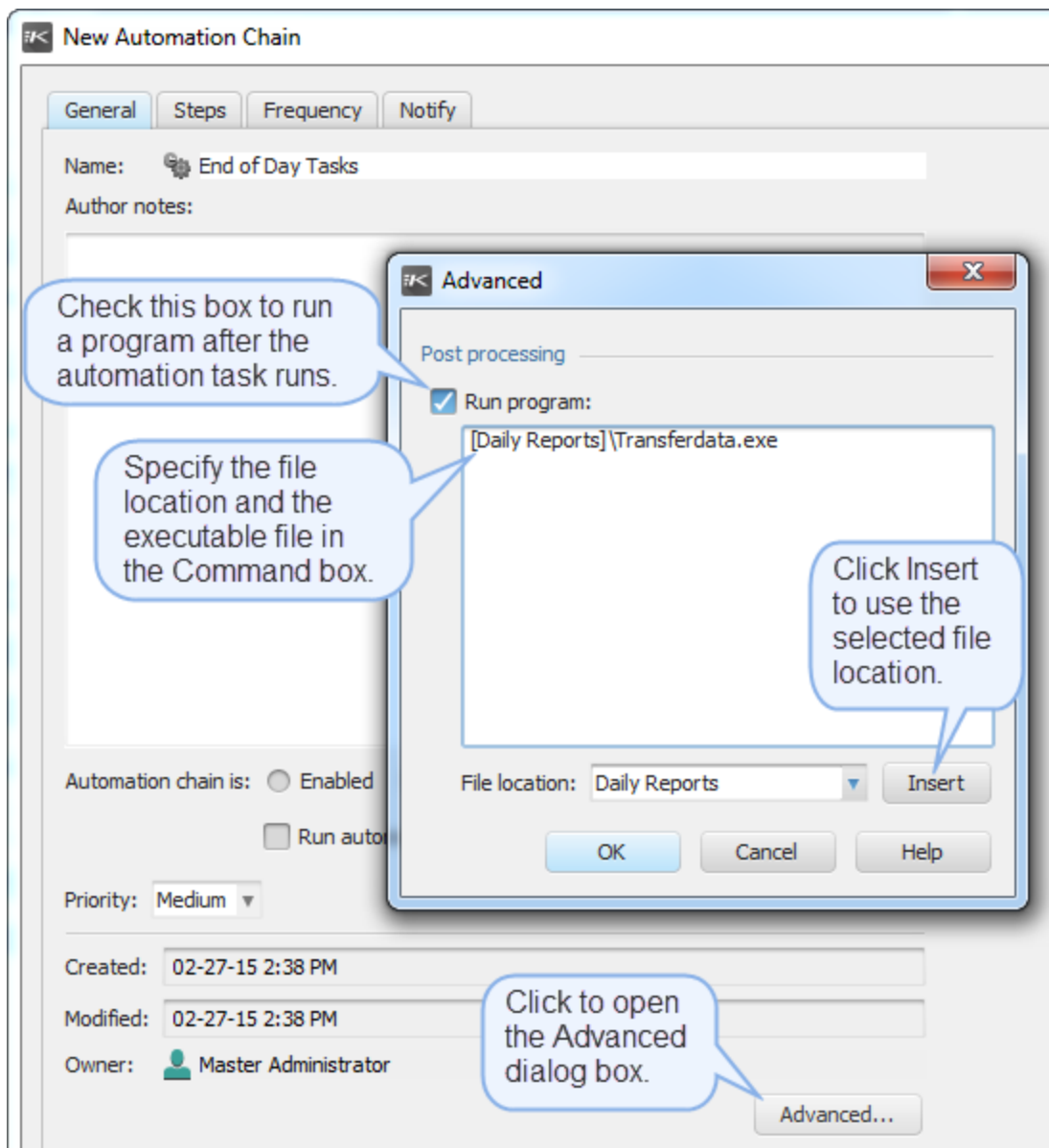
Run a program with an automation task

If your company has deployed the On-Premises version of RapidResponse, you can specify that another process be activated after an automation task has been successfully completed. For example, once a scheduled task has been processed, you can export a report of the data modified by the scheduled task back to your enterprise data system ("closing the loop") by specifying that an additional operation is run to complete the export back to your enterprise data system.

To run an external process, you must include appropriate instructions. These instructions take the form of a command string, which specifies a program to run and the file(s) it should use.

When you create a command string to launch a program, you must provide a path that is fully resolvable by RapidResponse. If the path or the command string contains spaces, you must enclose the command string in double quotes (""). Otherwise, the program will be unable to run.

To create a command string, you use one or more of the existing File locations, which are created by your RapidResponse administrator. The first element in the command string must contain the path to the executable, which must contain a defined File location. The File location and the executable must be separated by a backslash (\), which can either be typed in the command string or specified in the File location. For example, [FileLocation]\executable.bat.



The executable can be any file that executes commands, for example, an executable file (.exe), a script, or a batch file (.bat). If no File locations have been defined, you will not be able to use this feature. The File location, as it appears in the command string, must be surrounded by square brackets [] and must be spelled exactly as it appears in the File locations drop-list.

In addition to the File location, you must provide the name of the executable and its associated parameters. The required syntax for the command string is equivalent to entering the same string at a command prompt. The elements of the string are separated by a space.

The command string can only reference one executable. RapidResponse verifies the contents of the command string when it attempts to run it. If the first element in the command string does not include a defined File location, the command string is not accepted.

**Notes:**

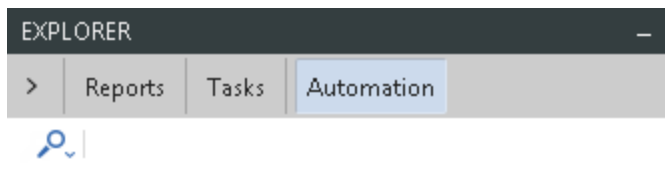
- A command string is always associated with an alert, scheduled task, or automation chain.
- The automation task must be successfully completed or run to completion in order for RapidResponse to run the program.

► Example: creating a command string

You have run an automation task that has exported worksheet data to a file called **myreport**, to a file location called `PostFiles`. To transfer the contents of this file to your enterprise data system using FTP, you need to run an FTP script called **FTPtransfer.bat**, which will FTP the file from RapidResponse to the enterprise data system. The script is stored in the file location called `PostPrograms`.

The following steps include the syntax you would use to create a command string that would FTP the file **myreport** to your enterprise data system.

1. In the **Explorer**, ensure that automation tasks are shown. You can do this by selecting **Automation**.



2. Select an automation task.
3. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties**.
4. On the **General** tab, click **Advanced**.
5. Select the **Run program** check box.
6. In the **File location** list, click the location containing the script or program you want to run, and then click **Insert File Location**.
7. The file location, surrounded by square brackets `[ ]`, is added to the **Command** box.
8. In the **Command** box, type the name of the script or program, using the appropriate syntax. For example:
`"[PostPrograms]\FTPtransfer.bat"`
9. Insert a space.
10. In the **File location** list, click the location containing the files exported by the alert, and then click **Insert File Location**.
 The second file location, surrounded by square brackets, is added to the **Command** box, at the end of the command string.
11. In the **Command** box, type the file name that you want the program to work with, as well as any other required parameters. For example:
`"[PostPrograms]\FTPtransfer.bat [PostFiles]\myreport"`
12. Click **OK**.
 RapidResponse verifies the command string when it attempts to run the command.

**Notes:**

- You can type file locations in the command string, but they must be surrounded by square



brackets.

- The command string should only contain one reference to an executable.
- When you insert a file location into a command string by double-clicking or by using the **Insert** button, it is placed at the location of the insertion point.

CHAPTER 46: Using predefined schedules to run automation tasks

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You can create predefined schedules with which you can associate multiple automation tasks at the same time. You can use a schedule to run alerts that you want to generate reports on a consistent schedule, scheduled tasks that you want to run regularly, or automation chains that perform a sequence of tasks according to the schedule you define. For example, your organization might have a data update scheduled every night. After each update, you want to provide the latest details of your operation to key suppliers. You can create a predefined schedule for after the update, and then associate numerous automation tasks that generate reports with it. You can also share the schedule so that other people can schedule their automation tasks for the same time.

Create a predefined schedule

You can create schedules for generating reports or running automation tasks. Each schedule must specify when the automation task runs, the dates the automation task is effective, and, if required, how often the automation task repeats. You can specify the automation task run and generate a report on a specific day and time, or whenever data is imported from your enterprise data sources.

If your region participates in Daylight Saving Time (DST), your scheduled automation tasks might not run as you expect if they are scheduled between 1:00 AM and 3:00 AM on the dates DST begins and ends. When DST begins, tasks scheduled between 2:00 AM and 3:00 AM run at the equivalent time an hour later, for example, at 3:15 instead of 2:15. When DST ends, tasks scheduled between 1:00 AM and 2:00 AM run only once, despite the hour repeating.

► **Create a schedule to run automation tasks**

1. On the **View** menu, click **Schedules**.
2. In the **Schedules** dialog box, click **New Schedule** .
3. In the **New Schedule** dialog box, type the schedule name in the **Name** box.
4. In the **Description** box, type information about the schedule.
5. Click **Every**, and then click the calendar period in which you want to run the automation task.

If you select a weekly or monthly calendar, the automation task runs on the first day of the week or month.

6. In the **Time** and **Time zone** boxes, specify the time you want to run the automation task.
7. If you want the automation task to run multiple times, do the following:
 - Select the **Repeat every** check box.
 - In the **Repeat every** box, type the interval you want the automation task to repeat on.
 - In the list, click either **Hours** or **Minutes**.
 - In the **Until** box, type the time you want the automation task to stop running.
8. In the **Effective** area, specify the time span during which automation tasks associated with the schedule will run.



Note: The Today date constant should not be used for scheduling, because it can be interpreted as different dates for different users.



Tip: You can also open the **Schedules** dialog box by clicking **Show Schedule Details**  on the **Automation Details and Log** workbook toolbar. For more information, see "[Automation task details and logging](#)" on page 637.

► Create a schedule to run automation tasks on a data import

1. On the **View** menu, click **Schedules**.
2. In the **Schedules** dialog box, click **New Schedule** .
3. In the **New Schedule** dialog box, type the schedule name in the **Name** box.
4. In the **Description** box, type information about the schedule.
5. Click **On data import**.
6. In the **Effective** area, specify the time span during which alerts associated with the schedule will check for conditions.



Tip: You can also open the **Schedules** dialog box by clicking **Show Schedule Details**  on the **Automation Details and Log** workbook toolbar. For more information, see "[Automation task details and logging](#)" on page 637.

Share a predefined schedule

You can allow other users to use predefined schedules that you create for running automation tasks. Unlike sharing resources and scenarios, you do not share predefined schedules with specific users. Once you share a predefined schedule, it is available to all users who have permission to create alerts, automation chains, or scheduled tasks.

If you create a private predefined schedule, and then you start to use the schedule to run a public automation task, the schedule is shared automatically. This can occur when you edit a public automation task to use a private schedule, or when you add an automation task that uses a private predefined schedule to the versioned repository. In systems with version control turned off, sharing an automation task automatically shares the predefined schedule it uses.

1. On the **View** menu, click **Schedules**.
2. In the **Schedules** dialog box, select a schedule and then click **Properties** .
3. In the **Schedule Properties** dialog box, select the **Shared** check box.



Note: If nobody else owns an automation task that uses a predefined schedule that you have shared, and you do not own a public automation task that uses that schedule, you can stop sharing it by clearing the **Shared** box in the **Schedule Properties**.

View predefined schedules

You can view information about all the predefined schedules to which you have access.

- On the **View** menu, click **Schedules**.



Tip: You can also access this information when you are creating or editing an alert, automation chain, or scheduled task. Click the **Frequency** tab and then click **Schedule Details**.

Edit a predefined schedule

You can edit any predefined schedule that you have created for running automation tasks. This changes the schedule for all automation tasks that use that predefined schedule.

1. On the **View** menu, click **Schedules**.
2. In the **Schedules** dialog box, select a schedule and then click **Properties** .
3. In the **Schedule Properties** dialog box, change the properties you want.

Delete a predefined schedule

You can delete any predefined schedule that you have created for running automation tasks.

If the schedule that you are deleting is used by one or more automation tasks, you are warned. You have the opportunity to cancel the deletion or choose what happens to any automation tasks that you own that use that schedule. If automation tasks that use the schedule that you are deleting are owned by other people, those automation tasks are not modified by the Delete Schedule dialog box. They keep the deleted schedule, and do not run.

1. On the **View** menu, click **Schedules**.
2. In the **Schedules** dialog box, click a schedule and then click **Delete** .
- If the schedule is used by an automation task, the **Delete Schedule** dialog box appears.
3. In the **Delete Schedule** dialog box, do one of the following:
 - To keep running automation tasks on the same schedule, click **Apply the deleted schedule's settings to the alerts**, and then ensure the **Turn alerts Off** check box is cleared.
 - To stop running automation tasks, click **Apply the deleted schedule's settings to the alerts**, and then select the **Turn alerts Off** check box.

- To run automation tasks on a different schedule, click **Assign a different schedule to these alerts**, and then select a schedule from the **Use schedule** list. This option is available only if another schedule exists.
- To delete the automation tasks using the deleted schedule, click **Delete the alerts**.

CHAPTER 47: Automation task details and logging

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You can view details about each automation task you have access to in the Automation Details and Log workbook. This workbook lists all automation tasks you have access to, including automation chains, alerts, and scheduled tasks. This workbook also provides logs that show details about automation tasks, workbook commands, and scripts that you run, including when they ran and, for automation chains, the automation tasks that ran as part of the automation chain. You can view information about any automation chain that failed to run, and re-run the chain starting from the step that failed.

The Automation Tasks worksheet provides information about all automation tasks you have access to, including whether it is scheduled, the resource and scenario used, and when it runs. You can choose which type of automation task is displayed in this worksheet. An example of the Automation Tasks worksheet displaying alerts is shown in the following illustration.

Automation Details and Log						
Automation Tasks						
Automation Task	On/Off	Owner	Resource	Scenario	Frequency	
1 Buyer - Overdue Requests	On	David Darvey	Supplier Collaboration Notification	Supplier Collaboration	Monday 12:00 AM ((GMT))	
2 Buyer New Forecast	Off	Master Administrator	Supplier Collaboration Notification	Supplier Collaboration	Not scheduled	
3 Buyer New Requests	Off	Master Administrator	Supplier Collaboration Notification	Supplier Collaboration	Not scheduled	
4 Buyer Overdue Forecast	Off	Master Administrator	Supplier Collaboration Notification	Supplier Collaboration	Not scheduled	

Additional information is displayed only if you click the Details button on the workbook toolbar. This includes details about the resource used in an alert or scheduled task, whether alerts generate reports, and other information. An example of alerts with additional information displayed is shown in the following illustration.

Show: Alerts Details >> Reset									
Workbook Command Log					Script Log				
On/Off	Owner	Resource	Worksheet/Metric	Scenario	Frequency	Last Completed	Next Start	Sequence	Report
On	David Darvey	Supplier Collaboration Notification	Buyers Overdue Requests	Supplier Collaboration	Monday 12:00 AM ((GMT 07-06-15 10:43 AM	07-06-15 10:43 AM	07-13-15 12:00 AM		Microsoft Excel 2007 Workbook
Off	Master Administrat	Supplier Collaboration Notification	Buyers New Forecast	Supplier Collaboration	Not scheduled				
Off	Master Administrat	Supplier Collaboration Notification	Buyers New Requests	Supplier Collaboration	Not scheduled				

When an automation task runs, this activity is logged in the Automation Task Log worksheet. When you run a workbook command interactively, this activity is logged in the Workbook Command Log worksheet. When a script runs, this activity is logged in the Script Log worksheet.

You can also use the Automation Details and Log workbook to manage automation tasks.

Managing automation tasks

The Explorer and Automation Tasks worksheet can be used to create, edit, delete, and run automation tasks. You can edit an automation task if you have checked it out. A checked out resource is displayed with the  icon, as shown in the following illustration.

Automation Task	
1	 Buyer New Forecast
2	 Buyer New Forecast

You can also use this worksheet to print a list of your automation tasks, or export the details to create a report of your automation tasks. For more information, see ["Print worksheet data" on page 330](#) or ["Exporting data" on page 317](#).

You can sort the list of automation tasks to view information about the resources used by the scheduled tasks. This information can be used to organize scheduled tasks into groups; or to find obsolete scheduled tasks, unused resources, or problems with schedules. For more information, see ["Sort the automation task details" on page 640](#).

► View details about automation tasks

1. On the RapidResponse toolbar, click **Run Automation Task** , and then click **Automation Details and Log**.
2. Click the **Automation Tasks** tab.
3. In the **Show** list, click one of the following:
 - **All Automation Tasks**—Shows alerts, scheduled tasks, and automation chains.
 - **Alerts**—Shows only alerts.

- **Automation Chains**—Shows only automation chains.
- **Scheduled Tasks**—Shows only scheduled tasks.

► Create an automation task

1. In the **Automation Details and Log** workbook, click the **Automation Tasks** tab.
2. On the toolbar, click one of the following:
 - **New Alert** —Creates an alert to monitor a worksheet or scorecard. For more information, see ["Create an alert to monitor worksheet data" on page 574](#) or ["Create an alert to monitor scorecard data" on page 581](#).
 - **New Scheduled Task** —Creates a scheduled task to modify data or run a script. For more information, see ["Schedule an automatic data modification" on page 595](#) or ["Schedule a script" on page 598](#).
 - **New Automation Chain** —Creates an automation chain. For more information, see ["Automating sequences of tasks" on page 607](#).

► Copy an automation task

1. In the **Automation Details and Log** workbook, in the **Automation Tasks** worksheet, select the automation task you want to copy.
2. On the toolbar, click **Copy** .

► Modify an automation task

1. In the **Automation Details and Log** workbook, click the **Automation Tasks** worksheet.
2. Do one of the following:
 - In the **Name** column, click the name of the automation task you want to modify.
 - Select the automation task you want to modify, and then on the toolbar, click **Properties** .

► Add an automation task to an automation chain

1. In the **Automation Details and Log** workbook, click the **Automation Tasks** worksheet.
2. Optionally, in the **Show** list, click the type of automation task you want to add to the automation chain.
3. Select the automation task you want to add to an automation chain.
4. On the toolbar, click **Add to automation Chain** .
5. In the **Add to Automation Chain** dialog box, select the automation chain to add the automation chain to, or click **New automation chain** to create a new automation chain with this automation task as its first step. For more information, see ["Add steps to an automation chain" on page 609](#) or ["Automating sequences of tasks" on page 607](#).

► Give an automation task

1. In the **Automation Details and Log** workbook, click the **Automation Tasks** worksheet.
2. Select the automation task you want to give, and then on the toolbar, click **Give** .
3. In the **Give Alert**, **Give Scheduled Task**, or **Give Automation Chain** dialog box, specify the person

you want to give the automation task to.

For more information, see ["Give an automation task" on page 569](#).

► Run an automation task

1. In the **Automation Details and Log** workbook, in the **Automation Tasks** worksheet, select the automation task you want to run.
2. On the toolbar, click **Run Now** .



Notes:

- If an automation task has been shared with you, you might have been given permission to customize the automation task's data or notification settings. For more information, see ["Running automation tasks manually" on page 617](#).
- If an automation task is locked, its owner must unlock it before it can run. For more information, see ["Unlock an automation resource" on page 570](#).

► Delete an automation task

1. In the **Automation Details and Log** workbook, in the **Automation Tasks** worksheet, select the automation task you want to delete.
2. On the toolbar, click **Delete** .

► Refresh data in the worksheet

- On the toolbar, click **Refresh All** .



Note: You might need to refresh the worksheet if you create or copy an automation task and it does not automatically appear in the worksheet.

► Sort the automation task details

1. In the **Automation Details and Log** workbook, click the **Automation Tasks** worksheet.
2. Click the column header you want to sort.
3. On the RapidResponse toolbar, click either **Sort Ascending**  or **Sort Descending** .

Sort by	To find
Type (no column header)	How many automation tasks of the same type you have access to.
Automation Task	Automation tasks with similar names.
On/Off	How many automation tasks are actively scheduled, and run automatically. This includes alerts that monitor data, and scheduled tasks and automation chains that run automatically.
Owner	How many automation tasks you own or have been shared with you. This column is available only if you are a RapidResponse administrator or you have permission to create automation tasks.

Sort by	To find
Resource	How many alerts and scheduled tasks monitor or modify data in the same workbook or scorecard, or how many scheduled tasks run the same script. This column is blank for automation chains. Workbooks and scorecards with many automation tasks should not be deleted without editing or deleting the associated alerts. For more information, see "Modify an automation task" on page 565 or "Delete an automation task" on page 571 .
Worksheet/Metric	Same as Resource. This column is visible only if you have clicked Details on the workbook toolbar.
Scenario	Same as Resource.
Frequency	Predefined schedules that are not being used. Schedules that do not appear in the list can be deleted. For more information, see "Delete a predefined schedule" on page 635 . The time shown in this column is reported in the time zone specified by the automation task. For example, if the schedule runs an alert at midnight Pacific Time, this column reports the time as '12 AM'.
Last Completed	Automation tasks that have not run recently. Automation tasks that have not run for a long time can then be deleted. For more information, see "Delete an automation task" on page 571 . The time shown in this column is reported using your time zone. For example, if the schedule runs a scheduled task at midnight Pacific Time but you are in the Eastern time zone, this column reports the time as '3 AM'.
Next Start	When automation tasks tend to run. If many automation tasks run at the same time, performance can suffer, especially if the automation tasks run during periods of high use. Automation tasks that run at the same time can be rescheduled. For more information, see "Schedule when an automation task runs" on page 591 . The time shown in this column is reported using your time zone. For example, if the schedule runs an automation chain at midnight Pacific Time but you are in the Eastern time zone, this column reports the time as '3 AM'.
Sequence	Automation tasks with the same sequence number. If many automation tasks share a sequence number and run at the same time, some notification messages could arrive later than expected. This column is visible only if you have clicked Details on the workbook toolbar.
Report	How many alerts generate reports. This column is visible only if you have clicked Details on the workbook toolbar.

Automation task logging

You can view all automation tasks you have run in the Automation Task Log worksheet in the Automation Details and Log workbook. You can use the information in the Automation Task Log worksheet to verify your automation tasks are running properly. Each automation task's start and end time are recorded, which show you if the automation task is running on schedule, and how long the automation task or steps in an automation chain take to run. If an automation task is not running on schedule, it might be starting at the same time as several other automation tasks and cannot complete until the others have completed. In this case, you can modify the start times.

You can display only specific automation tasks by selecting a type from the Show list, and you can view log entries that have run in a specific time frame by selecting from the Horizon list.

You can also use this worksheet to run automation tasks.

Records in the Automation Task Log are automatically deleted after 14 days. Your RapidResponse administrator can modify this number.

Automation task status

The Automation Task Log worksheet provides a status column and a color bar to help you quickly recognize whether an automation task has completed successfully or failed.

When a data modification command is run as a scheduled task, the command can complete successfully if there are no errors or if the number of errors does not exceed an acceptable number. If the acceptable number of errors is exceeded, the command fails.

The acceptable number of errors that can occur when a command runs is set by the worksheet author. Authors can configure whether a data modification command fails when the first error occurs or completes successfully even though some errors have occurred. When the author allows some errors to occur, they set an error limit for the worksheet. If this limit is not exceeded, the command can complete successfully. Therefore, a command might be successful even though not all record insertions, modifications, or deletions have occurred successfully. The Status column and the color bar can help you to differentiate between the commands that were successful and the commands that were successful yet had errors.

The status of a task can be one of the following:

 **Completed**—The automation task completed successfully. If a data modification command was run, there were no errors.

 **Completed**—Applies to data modification commands. The command completed successfully with some errors.

 **Failed**—The automation task failed. If a data modification command was run, the command failed because the acceptable number of errors was exceeded. No data changes were made. A data modification command might also fail due to a non-data error, such as an invalid scenario or a missing resource that prevents it from completing successfully. Information about these errors is provided in the Details column.

 **Canceled**—The automation task was canceled. If a data modification command was run, details about the command are not available. In addition, the number of records inserted, modified, and deleted are displayed in gray text, and the changes are not applied.

The Automation Task Owner column displays the user name of the user who owns the Automation task. When automation tasks fail, consider contacting this user for assistance. Click the icon beside the user's name to view contact information.

In the following example, the Commit Buyer Response scheduled task and the Buyer Overdue Requests alert have completed successfully, while the Update Part Records scheduled task failed both times that it was run.

Automation Details and Log

Horizon: Today's activity Show: = All Automation Tasks = Reset

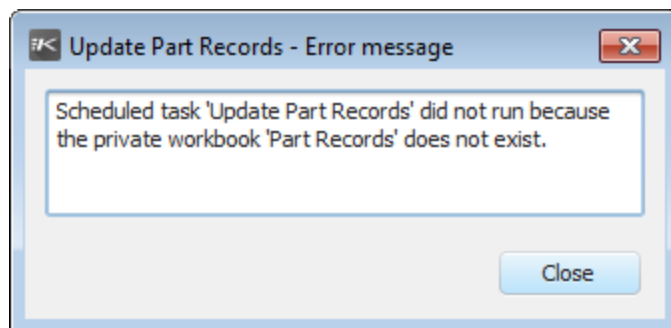
Automation Tasks Automation Task Log Workbook Command Log Script Log

	Start	Finish	Run Time (seconds)	Automation Task	Automation Task Owner	Run By	Status	Details	Resource
1	07-16-15 2:02 PM		0	Update Part Records	Caren Wu	Caren Wu	Failed	Errors	Part Records
2	07-16-15 1:57 PM		1	Update Part Records	Caren Wu	Caren Wu	Failed		Part Records
3	07-16-15 1:55 PM	07-16-15 1:55 PM	1	Buyer Overdue Requests	Master Administrator	Caren Wu	Completed		Supplier Collaboration Notification
4	07-16-15 1:54 PM	07-16-15 1:54 PM	5	Commit Buyer Response	Master Administrator	Caren Wu	Completed		Supplier Collaboration - Orders

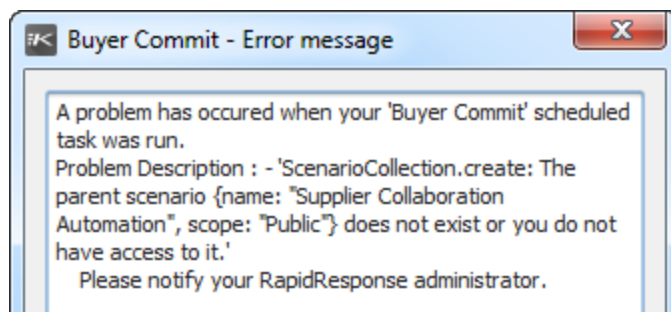
Click to view the user's contact information.

Use the color bar and Status column to determine the result of the automation task.

The Update Part Records scheduled task failed the first time because the task runs a data modification command that could not be completed due to errors. The second time, the scheduled task failed because the workbook that contains the command is missing, as indicated by the error message displayed when the Errors link in the Details column is clicked.

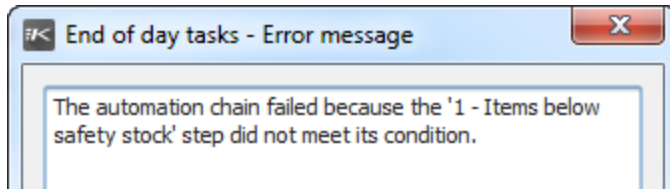


Scheduled tasks can fail if the command that a workbook runs cannot access a resource or data setting, or if the script it runs contains an error. For example, the following message explains that a scheduled task failed because of a script error.



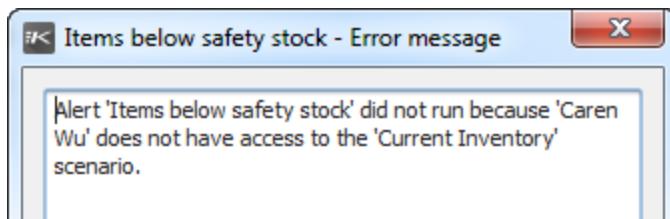
Automation chains fail only if they contain a conditional step that does not meet its condition. For automation chains that do not contain conditional steps, each step that fails is identified as a failed automation task in the Automation Task Log, but the automation chain itself is identified as successful.

For each automation task that failed, the automation chain that it ran from is identified in the log. For more information, see ["Add steps to an automation chain" on page 609](#).



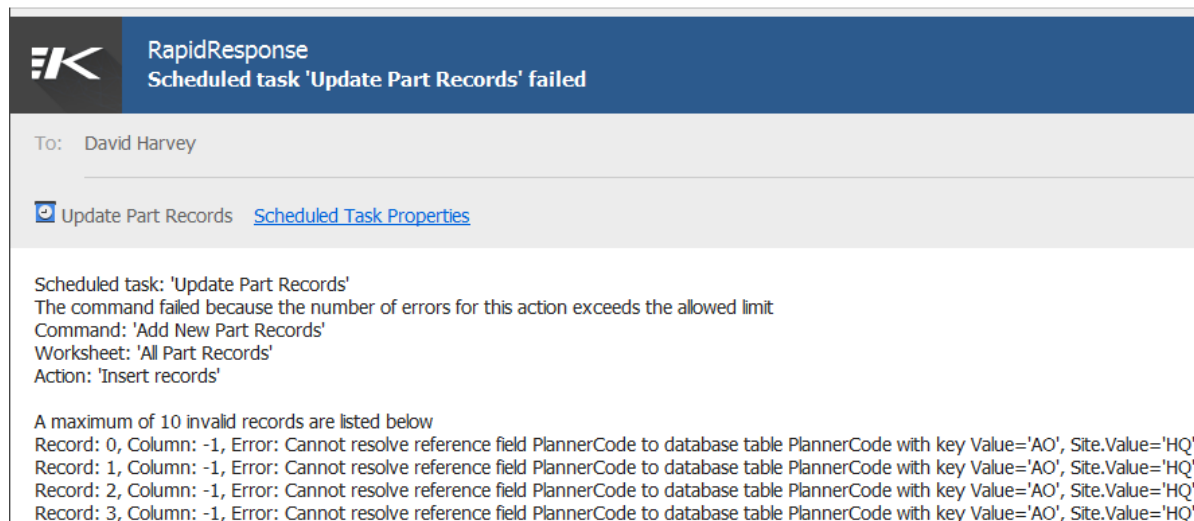
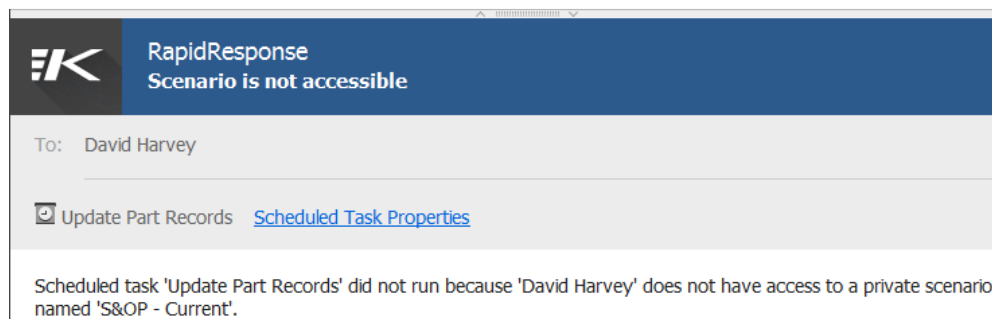
You can run an automation chain that has failed from the step it failed on. This allows you to resolve the issue that was affecting the automation chain, and then resume the sequence of operations the automation chain performs. For more information, see ["Run an automation chain" on page 621](#).

Alerts can fail if the resource they monitor or one of the data settings is not available. For example, the following message explains that an alert failed because its scenario is missing.



You can also use the information in the log to determine if an automation task is failing consistently. If an automation task has failed, you can search the worksheet for that automation task to determine if the failure was an isolated incident, or an indication of a problem with the automation task. For more information, see ["Searching data in workbooks" on page 187](#).

When an automation task fails, a notification is sent to your Message Center and your email address if you have forwarded your messages to email. When a scheduled task that runs a data modification command fails due to data errors, the message lists a maximum of ten invalid records. You can review the Error Details worksheet for information about all of the errors that occurred. For more information about accessing this worksheet, see ["Data Modification columns" on page 645](#).



For more information about using Message Center, see ["Message Center and email" on page 451](#).

Data Modification columns

The Data Modification columns contain information about data changes made by scheduled tasks that run data modification commands. The number of records that are inserted, modified, and deleted are displayed with the number of errors, if any, that occurred. These record counts apply only to the data in tables that the worksheets updated by the command are based on. They do not include inserted reference records or related deleted records.

The Inserted, Modified, and Deleted columns contain a number if the worksheet is configured to perform that operation (this number can be zero). If there is no number in the column, the worksheet is not configured to perform that operation. If the data modification cannot complete successfully, these numbers are displayed in gray text to indicate that the changes were not made.

Data Modification				
Command	Records			
	Inserted	Modified	Deleted	Errors
Update Part Records	0			11
Statistical Forecast Setup	111	5,027		185
Add New Part Records	0			185
Record Demand Adjustments	0	0	0	
Generate and Save Forecast	2,888	0	2,778	

The totals for the number of inserted and modified records use gray text because the Statistical Forecast Setup command failed.

Click the link to open the Data Modification Details worksheet to view details about the command actions.

Click the link to open the Error Details worksheet to view more details about the errors.

The Data Modification columns display the total number of records that are inserted, modified, and deleted by a command. You can click the name of a command to open the Data Modification Details worksheet, which displays the number of records modified by each command action. For more information about this worksheet, see ["Data Modification Details worksheet" on page 650](#).

You can click the number of errors in the Errors column to open the Error Details worksheet, which provides information about any errors that occurred. For more information about this worksheet, see ["Error Details worksheet" on page 651](#).

When you open the Data Modification Details worksheet or the Error Details worksheet by clicking a link, the row is highlighted with yellow. Click Reset on the workbook toolbar to close the detail worksheets.



Note: The Data Modification Details and Error Details worksheets are also accessible from the Workbook Command Log worksheet. For more information, see ["Workbook command logging" on page 647](#).

► View the log of automation tasks that have run

1. On the RapidResponse toolbar, click **Run Automation Task** , and then click **Automation Details and Log**.
2. Click the **Automation Task Log** worksheet.
3. In the **Show** list, click one of the following:
 - **All Automation Tasks**—Shows alerts, scheduled tasks, and automation chains.
 - **Alerts**—Shows only alerts.
 - **Automation Chains**—Shows only automation chains.
 - **Scheduled Tasks**—Shows only scheduled tasks.
4. If you want to view all automation tasks that run as part of an automation chain, do the following:
 - In the **Show** list, click **All Automation Tasks**.
 - Search the **Automation Chain** column to display only non-blank values. For more information, see ["Searching data in workbooks" on page 187](#).
5. In the **Horizon** list, click the number of days of log activity to view in the worksheet.



Note: If an automation task has been deleted, an icon is not displayed beside its name.

► Find failed automation tasks

1. In the **Automation Details and Log** workbook, click the **Automation Task Log** tab.
2. On the RapidResponse toolbar, click **Search Worksheet Data**  and then click **New Search**.
3. In the **Search** dialog box, specify one of the following:
 - In the **Finished** column, in the **Matches search expression** box, type a blank String (' ').
 - In the **Status** column, select either **contains**, **is like**, or **is exactly**, and then in the box type **Failed**.
4. For each failed automation task, look in the **Automation Chain** column to determine if the automation task was part of an automation chain.



Note: For more information about searching, see ["Search for specific data" on page 190](#).

► View details about why an automation task failed

1. In the **Automation Details and Log** workbook, click the **Automation Task Log** tab.
2. Do one of the following:
 - In the **Details** column, click the **Errors** link for the failed alert, scheduled task, or automation chain you want to view details about.
The error message for the automation task is displayed in the **Error message** dialog box.
 - For a failed scheduled task that runs a data modification command, click the link in the **Errors** column to open the **Error Details** worksheet. When you are finished reviewing details, click **Reset** on the toolbar to close the details worksheet.

► Run an automation task

1. In the **Automation Task Log** worksheet, select a failed automation chain.
2. On the toolbar, click **Run Now** .

► Run a failed automation chain from the point it failed

1. In the **Automation Task Log** worksheet, select a failed automation chain.
2. On the toolbar, click **Run Now** .
3. In the **Run** dialog box, select the step you want to run the automation chain from, and then click **Run**.

Workbook command logging

Each time you interactively run a workbook command, this activity is logged in the Workbook Command Log worksheet in the Automation Details and Log workbook. You can use this worksheet to review information about the commands that you have run. Additionally, the Workbook Command Log worksheet includes links to the following worksheets:

- ["Data Modification Details worksheet" on page 650](#)
- ["Error Details worksheet" on page 651](#)

The Data Modification Details worksheet can be used to more closely examine the data modifications made by the command, and the Error Details worksheet can be used to investigate errors.

For information about running workbook commands, see ["Run workbook commands" on page 360](#).

Workbook Command Log worksheet

The Workbook Command Log worksheet displays information about the worksheet commands you have run, including when the command was run, the workbook that contains the command, the scenario that was modified by the command, and the status of the command (for example, whether it completed successfully or failed). This worksheet also provides counts of the number of records that were inserted, modified, or deleted by the command and of the number of records in error.

The Workbook Owner column shows the name of the user who owns the workbook that contains the command. Consider contacting this user if you require assistance with the command. Click the icon beside the user's name to view contact information.

You can display log records that have run in a specific time frame by selecting from the Horizon list.

	Start	Finish	Run Time (seconds)	Status	Details	Workbook	Workbook Owner	Run By	Scenario
1	07-07-15 2:41 PM	07-07-15 2:41 PM	0	Completed		Independent Demands	Jenna Hensley	Jenna Hensley	S&OP
2	07-07-15 2:40 PM	07-07-15 2:40 PM	0	Failed		Independent Demands	Jenna Hensley	Jenna Hensley	S&OP
3	07-07-15 2:39 PM	07-07-15 2:39 PM	0	Failed	Errors	Independent Demands	Jenna Hensley	Jenna Hensley	S&OP
4	07-07-15 2:37 PM	07-07-15 2:37 PM	0	Completed		Independent Demands	Jenna Hensley	Jenna Hensley	S&OP
5	07-07-15 2:34 PM	07-07-15 2:34 PM	0	Canceled		S&OP Forecast Items	Jenna Hensley	Jenna Hensley	S&OP
6	07-07-15 2:27 PM	07-07-15 2:27 PM	0	Canceled		S&OP Forecast Items	David Harvey	Jenna Hensley	Demand Adjustments

Command status

When you run a workbook command, the command can complete successfully if there are no errors or if the number of errors does not exceed an acceptable number. If the acceptable number of errors is exceeded, the command fails. You can also cancel the command before the data changes are saved. This worksheet provides a status column and a color bar to help you recognize whether a command has completed successfully, failed, or was canceled.

The acceptable number of errors that can occur when a command runs is set by the worksheet author. Authors can configure whether a data modification command fails when the first error occurs or completes successfully even though some errors have occurred. When the author allows some errors to occur, they set an error limit for the worksheet. If this limit is not exceeded, the command can complete successfully. Therefore, you might be able to confirm a command's data changes even though not all record insertions, modifications, or deletions have occurred successfully.

The status of a command can be one of the following:

- **Completed**—The command completed successfully with no errors.
- **Completed**—The command completed successfully with some errors.
- **Canceled**—You canceled the command. No data changes were made.
- **Failed**—The command failed because the acceptable level of errors was exceeded. No data changes were made. A command might also fail due to a non-data error, such as an invalid scenario or a missing resource that prevents the command from completing successfully. Information about these errors is provided in the Details column, which contains a link to open a dialog box that provides more information about the error.

Data Modification columns

The Data Modification columns contain information about data changes made by commands. The number of records that are inserted, modified, and deleted are displayed with the number of errors, if any, that occurred. These record counts apply only to the data in tables that the worksheets updated by the command are based on. They do not include inserted reference records or related deleted records.

The Inserted, Modified, and Deleted columns contain a number if the worksheet is configured to perform that operation (this number can be zero). If there is no number in the column, the worksheet is not configured to perform that operation. These numbers are displayed even if a command fails or is canceled. In this case, the text is gray to indicate that the changes were not made.

Data Modification				
Command	Records			
	Inserted	Modified	Deleted	Errors
Update Part Records	0			11
Statistical Forecast Setup	111	5,027		185
Add New Part Records	0			185
Record Demand Adjustments	0	0	0	
Generate and Save Forecast	2,888	0	2,778	

The totals for the number of inserted and modified records use gray text because the Statistical Forecast Setup command failed.

Click the link to open the Error Details worksheet to view more details about the errors.

Click the link to open the Data Modification Details worksheet to view details about the command actions.

The Data Modification columns display the total number of records that are inserted, modified, and deleted by a command. You can click the name of a command to open the Data Modification Details worksheet, which displays the number of records modified by each command action. You can click the number of errors in the Errors column to open the Error Details worksheet, which provides information about any errors that occurred.

When you open the Data Modification Details worksheet or the Error Details worksheet by clicking a link, the row is highlighted with yellow. Click Reset on the workbook toolbar to close the detail worksheets.

Records in the Workbook Command Log worksheet are automatically deleted after 14 days. Your RapidResponse administrator can modify this number.



Tip: The Errors column in the Data Modification Details worksheet also includes a link to the Error Details worksheet. To view error information for one specific command action only, open Error Details from this worksheet instead.

Data Modification Details worksheet

This worksheet shows details about the results of each action of a data modification command. The number of records that were inserted, modified, or deleted by each action of the command and the errors that occurred, if any, are reported. This worksheet also provides other information, including the statuses of the actions (such as whether they completed successfully or failed) and the worksheet that is updated by each action.

You can access this worksheet by clicking a link in the Command column of the Automation Task Log worksheet or the Workbook Command Log worksheet.

Action status

An action can complete successfully if there are no errors or if the number of errors does not exceed an acceptable number. If the acceptable number of errors is exceeded, the action fails, causing the command to fail. This worksheet provides a status column and a color bar to help you recognize whether a command action has completed successfully or failed.

The acceptable number of errors that can occur when an action is performed is set by the worksheet author. Authors can configure whether a data modification action fails when the first error occurs or completes successfully even though some errors have occurred. When the author allows some errors to occur, they set an error limit for the worksheet. If this limit is not exceeded, the action can complete successfully. Therefore, you might be able to confirm a command's data changes even though not all record insertions, modifications, or deletions have occurred successfully. The Status column and the color bar can help you to differentiate between the actions that were successful and the actions that were successful yet had errors.

The status of an action can be one of the following:

Completed—The action completed successfully with no errors.

Completed—The action completed successfully with some errors.

Failed—The action failed because the acceptable number of errors was exceeded. No data changes were made because a failed action results in a failed command. If an action fails, any subsequent actions are not displayed in this worksheet. A command might also fail due to a non-data error, such as an invalid scenario or a missing resource that prevents the command from completing successfully.

When you click a command name in the Automation Task Log worksheet or the Workbook Command Log worksheet, the row is highlighted with yellow to clearly identify the command that you are viewing information about. To close the Data Modification Details worksheet and remove any highlighting, click Reset on the workbook toolbar. This will also close the Error Details worksheet if it is open.

6	07-08-15 2:20 PM	07-08-15 2:20 PM	0	Completed	S&OP Forecast Items	David Harvey	David Harvey	Current S&OP	Generate and Save Forecast	0	0	0
7	07-08-15 2:19 PM	07-08-15 2:19 PM	0	Completed	S&OP Forecast Items	David Harvey	David Harvey	Current S&OP	Generate and Save Forecast	2,888	0	2,778 185
Data Modification Details												
	Command	Action	Status	Source Scenario	Source Worksheet	Updated Worksheet	Insert	Modify	Delete	Errors	Updated Table	Namespace
1	Generate and Save Forecast	1 Update	Completed	Current S&OP	5.0 Hist Demand Header - Source	5.3 Hist Demand Header - Insert	244	0	0	0	HistoricalDemandHeader	Mfg
2		2 Update	Completed	Current S&OP	4.0 Cmd: Forecast Detail - Source	4.1 Cmd: Forecast Detail - Insert	1,980	0	2,778	185	ForecastDetail	Mfg
3		3 Delete	Completed			3.3 Cmd: FitOutput - Delete			0	0	ForecastItemParametersFitOutp	Mfg
4		4 Update	Completed	Current S&OP	3.0 Cmd: FitOutput - Source	3.1 Cmd: FitOutput - Insert	664	0	0	0	ForecastItemParametersFitOutp	Mfg

Click to open the Error Details worksheet.

If errors occurred when an action was being performed, you can click the link in the Errors column to open the Error Details worksheet, which displays information about only those errors.

Records in the Data Modification Details worksheet are automatically deleted after 14 days. Your RapidResponse administrator can modify this number.

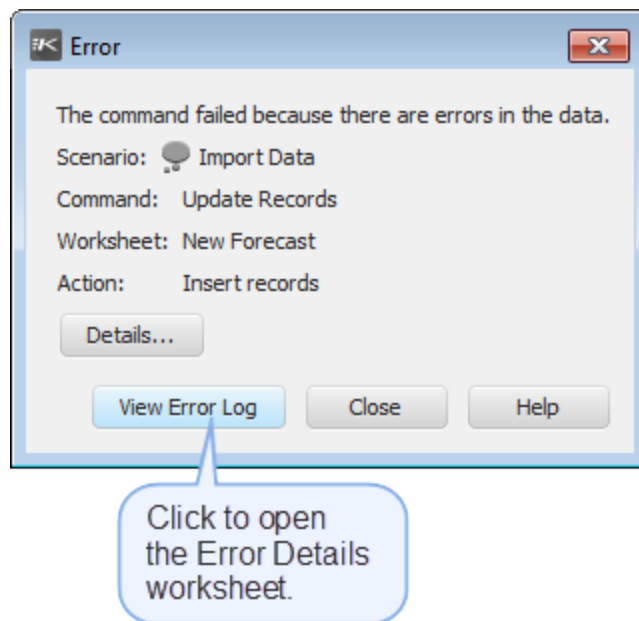


Note: For information about accessing this worksheet from the Automation Task Log worksheet, see "[Automation task logging](#)" on page 641.

Error Details worksheet

If errors occur when a data modification command runs, you might need to fix the errors so that the command can run successfully. You can use the information logged in this worksheet to investigate data modification errors. Any errors that are identified when an action is performed are logged in this worksheet. You can view information about the errors, including the location of the records in error and why the errors occurred.

You can access this worksheet by clicking on the number of errors that appears in the Errors column of the Automation Task Log worksheet, the Workbook Command Log worksheet, or the Data Modification Details worksheet. You can also open this worksheet from the Error dialog box. When you run a command that fails, the Error dialog box opens. You can click View Error Log in this dialog box to open the Automation Details and Log workbook, which displays the Workbook Command Log and the Error Details worksheets.



When you click this link in the Automation Task Log worksheet or the Workbook Command Log worksheet, the row that contains the link is highlighted with yellow to clearly identify the command that you are viewing information about. When you are done reviewing the details, click Reset on the workbook toolbar to close the detail worksheet. This also closes the Data Modification Details worksheet.

	Start	Finish	(seconds)	Status	Details	Workbook	Workbook Owner	Run By	Scenario	Command	Inserted	Modified	Deleted	Errors
1	07-09-15 12:19 PM	07-09-15 12:19 PM	0	Completed	Part Records	Part Records	David Harvey	David Harvey	Current S&OP	Add New Part Records	0			370
2	07-09-15 12:17 PM	07-09-15 12:17 PM	0	Completed	Part Records	Part Records	David Harvey	David Harvey	Current S&OP	Add New Part Records	0			370
Error Details														
	Command	Action	Source Worksheet	Updated Worksheet	Record	Column	Error							
1	Add New Part Records	1	Insert	New Part Records	All Part Records	1	0	Cannot resolve reference field PlannerCode to database table PlannerCode with key Value='AO', Site.Value='HQ'.						
2						2	0	Cannot resolve reference field PlannerCode to database table PlannerCode with key Value='AO', Site.Value='HQ'.						
3						3	0	Cannot resolve reference field PlannerCode to database table PlannerCode with key Value='AO', Site.Value='HQ'.						

If a command performs multiple actions and one action fails, the actions that follow the failed action are not run and no error information is logged for those actions.

The number of errors displayed in this worksheet is determined by your RapidResponse administrator.

Records in the Error Details worksheet are automatically deleted after 14 days. Your RapidResponse administrator can modify this number.



Note: For information about accessing this worksheet from the Automation Task Log worksheet, see ["Automation task logging" on page 641](#).

► View the log of data modification commands that have run interactively

1. On the RapidResponse toolbar, click **Run Automation Task** , and then click **Automation Details and Log**.
2. Click the **Workbook Command Log** worksheet.
3. In the **Horizon** list, click the number of days of log activity to view in the worksheet.

► View details about the actions of a command

1. In the **Automation Details and Log** workbook, click the **Workbook Command Log** tab.
2. In the **Command** column, click the command's name link to open the **Data Modification Details** worksheet.
3. When you are finished reviewing details, click **Reset** on the toolbar to close the details worksheet.

► View details about why a data modification command failed

1. In the **Automation Details and Log** workbook, click the **Workbook Command Log** tab.
2. Do one of the following:
 - In the **Details** column, click the **Errors** link for the command you want to view details about. The error message for the command is displayed in the **Error message** dialog box.
 - For a command that failed due to data errors, click the link in the **Errors** column to open the **Error Details** worksheet. When you are finished reviewing details, click **Reset** on the toolbar to close the details worksheet.

Script logging

Each time you run a script, either from the Run Automation Task dialog box, by a scheduled task, from the Explorer, or by a workbook command, the script's activity is logged. This information indicates when the script started running, how long it ran for, the result of running it, and any values passed to the

script. You can use this information to find scripts that are not functioning properly, or to review the results of scripts that have run multiple times.

Scripts are logged when they complete properly and when they fail. However, a completed script might not have performed the operations you expect. For example, if a script creates a scenario and that scenario already exists, the script does not perform its function. However, because the code defined in the script executed properly, the script is logged as running successfully. To determine whether a script has performed its function, the result of running the script is included in the log. Typically, this information will contain an error message if the script did not perform its function. If a script fails consistently, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

An example of script log information is shown in the following illustration.

	Start	Finish	Run Time (seconds)	Script	Status	Result
1	07-06-15 11:45 AM	07-06-15 11:45 AM	0	Reset User Account	Success	
2	07-06-15 11:45 AM	07-06-15 11:45 AM	0	Scenario Response	JavaScriptException	Script: Scenario Response (Public), Line: 36, Colu
3	07-06-15 11:44 AM	07-06-15 11:44 AM	0	Scenario Response	Script.Argument.NotFound	Script: Manage Activities (Public), Line: 4, Colum

One script shown in the log is identified as successful, and the other two failed.

Sometimes, scripts that could not perform their functions are identified as successful. The values in the Result column show which scripts could not perform their functions, and why. In the following example, the Historical Scenarios script ran, and it was successful, but a scenario it required to perform its function was not available.

Script	Status	Result
Historical Scenarios	Success	ScenarioCollection.get: The scenario with key '{name: "History", scope: "Public"}' does not exist or you do not have access to it.

If you own a script, you can also view any messages written to the output console in the Console Output column. This column is blank if you do not own the script.

You can specify how much history to display in the worksheet. For example, you can view only scripts that have run on the current date, the past three days, or the past month.

► View information about scripts

1. On the RapidResponse toolbar, click **Run Automation Task** , and then click **Automation Details and Log**.
2. In the **Automation Details and Log** workbook, click the **Script Log** tab.

► Specify how many days of log entries are displayed

1. In the **Automation Details and Log** workbook, click the **Script Log** worksheet.
2. In the **Horizon** list, click the number of days to display entries for.

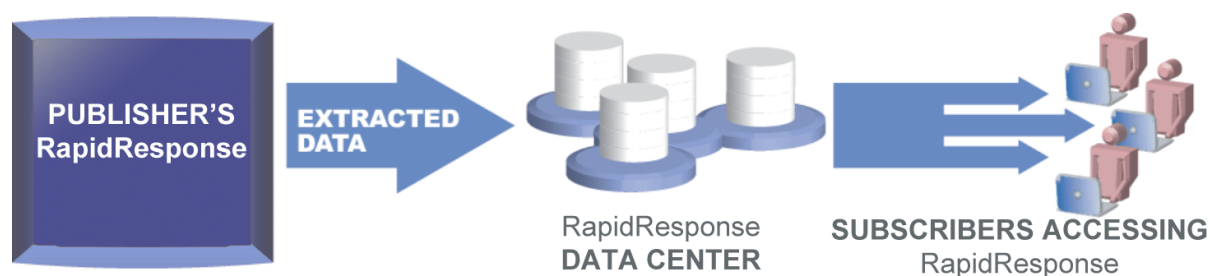
► **View properties of a script**

1. In the **Automation Details and Log** workbook, click the **Script Log** worksheet.
2. Click the link in the **Script** column.

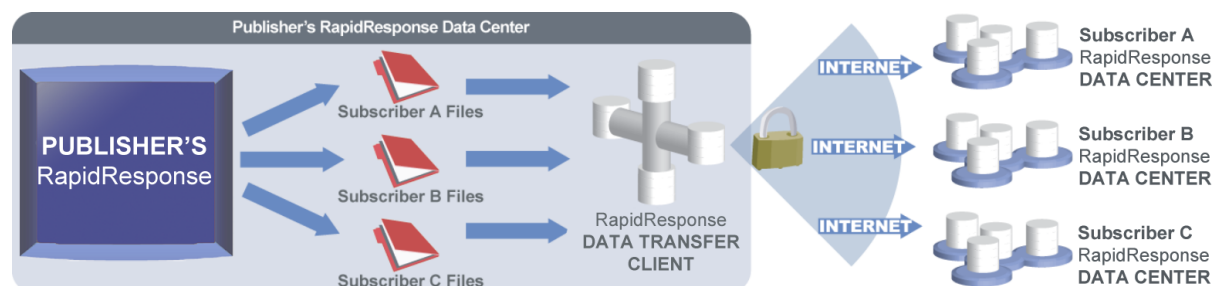
CHAPTER 48: Publishing data to subscribers

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The RapidResponse-to-RapidResponse connection enables manufacturers (publishers) to publish data to their customers (subscribers). This provides subscribers with greater visibility into current supply status as well as the impact of planned or potential changes in demand, supply, and product. The following illustrates the concept of the RapidResponse-to-RapidResponse connection.



If your company is publishing RapidResponse data, you might be responsible for extracting the appropriate subscriber data to a network location from where the data can be transferred to the subscriber's RapidResponse Data Center. The following illustrates how data is moved from your company's RapidResponse Data Center to the subscriber's RapidResponse Data Center.



The data extracted from your RapidResponse system is defined in a Data Publish workbook. To control the data that each subscriber receives, you create a filter identifying each subscriber's parts. To export the data, you create a scheduled task that generates the data extract files. The extract files are then moved to the RapidResponse Data Transfer Client. The RapidResponse Data Transfer Client sends the extract files through a secure Internet connection to each subscriber's RapidResponse Data Center.

About setting up a data extract

The following list summarizes the steps required to publish data to a subscriber. Repeat these steps for each subscriber.

1. Create a copy of the Data Publish workbook and customize it as required for the subscriber.
2. Create a filter that matches the subscriber's parts.
3. Ensure to validate that the correct data will be extracted by opening the Data Publish workbook with the filter for the subscriber's parts. Confirm that only the subscriber's data is displayed.
4. Create the scheduled task to publish the subscriber data. The task runs automatically according to a predefined schedule.

When the task runs, text files that contain the data are created on a network location. The text files are then automatically moved to the computer where the RapidResponse Data Transfer Client is installed. The data from these files is then transferred into the subscriber's RapidResponse system.

Cautionary notes about customizing the Data Publish workbook

The Data Publish workbook has been designed to export data in a specific format. Note the following when customizing this workbook:

- Do not modify existing worksheet names.
- Do not delete worksheets.
- Do not delete columns from this workbook.
- The date format for all date columns must be `yyyymmdd`.
- Number formats cannot include a comma as a thousands separator.
- Do not delete the following line from the workbook help: `Data Publish="server_version"`.
- Do not modify column identifiers.



Note: Hiding a column does not prevent the data in that column from being published to a subscriber. For information about hiding data, see ["Customize the Data Publish workbook" on page 656](#).

Customize the Data Publish workbook

The Data Publish workbook is used to publish data to subscribers. You can customize this workbook to control the type of data you share with the subscriber. It is recommended that you make a copy of this

workbook for every subscriber. If your RapidResponse system uses multiple currencies, you should set each copy of the Data Publish workbook you make to use the currency the subscriber does business in.

The Data Publish workbook includes data from all of the tables from which data is required for most subscribers to get value from RapidResponse. However, certain tables contain fields that store information which you might not want to share with your subscribers. These fields, listed in the following table, are cost and price fields and are set to display zero using a column expression.

Table	Field
OnHand	UnitCost
Part	- AverageSellingPrice - CarryingCost - MaterialCost
PartSource	- LaborCost - MaterialCost - OverheadCost - OverheadCost2 - UnitCost
ScheduledReceipt	UnitPrice

To protect other company data, you can set columns that contain numeric data to zero and fields that contain string data to blank. Note that hiding a column does not prevent the data in that column from being published to a subscriber.

Standard Unit Cost

The **StdUnitCost** column in the Part worksheet is not set to zero because the data in the **StdUnitCost** field is used for many RapidResponse cost calculations. It is recommended that you set this column to the price that your company and the subscriber have agreed upon. This can be done by creating a custom field in the Part table to store the data, and then referencing this field in the **StdUnitCost** column expression.



Note: You can also customize worksheet filters; however, make sure you do not omit values referenced by other tables from which data is extracted. Missing referenced values can prevent other data from being imported into the subscriber's RapidResponse system.

Hide PlannedOrder data

By default, the Data Publish workbook is designed to publish PlannedOrder data. This data is required during the initial stage of the integration at the subscriber's RapidResponse deployment to validate the data extract and ensure that planning results match those in your RapidResponse system. Once the validation is complete, it is not necessary to publish PlannedOrder data to the subscriber. When the subscriber's initial integration and data mapping is complete, if you do not want to publish this data, set the worksheet filter expression for the CPO_BaselinePlannedOrder worksheet to FALSE.

Custom tables and fields

You might want to publish other data to your subscriber if your company implemented custom tables and fields. If so, you must work together with the subscriber to modify your publishing process and the subscriber's import process to include this data.

► Set a column's value to zero or blank

1. Ensure that the **Data Publish** workbook you want to edit is not open.
2. In the **Explorer**, select the appropriate workbook.
3. On the **File** menu, click **Properties**.
4. On the **Worksheets** tab, select a worksheet in the **Worksheets in this workbook** list, and then click **Properties**.
5. Click the **Columns** tab.
6. In the **Columns in this worksheet** list, select a column.
7. In the **Expression** box, type the appropriate expression:
 - To display a zero for a numeric value column, type 0
 - To display a blank cell for a string column, type two single quote characters (")

► Specify the currency to use

1. Ensure that the **Data Publish** workbook you want to edit is not open.
2. In the **Explorer**, select the appropriate workbook.
3. On the **File** menu, click **Properties**.
4. In the **Currency** list, select the currency the subscriber does business in.



Note: You can also set up the Data Publish workbook to put out unconverted quantity values for each money column. For more information, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

Create a filter for subscriber data

To extract data for a subscriber, you must create a part-based filter that returns data for only the subscriber's parts manufactured by your company. The filter must return all top-level parts and all component parts across all sites. To help you design such a filter, you might need to do one of the following:

- If your company is not using the **ProductGroup1** or **ProductGroup2** field in the part table, for each part, you can populate either field with the appropriate subscriber name.
- You can also add a custom field to the Part table and populate it with the subscriber name for each part. Note that you do not include this field in the data extract.



Notes:

- Contact your RapidResponse administrator for more information about the tasks listed



above.

- You might also want to create a site filter. For more information about creating filters and site filters, see the [RapidResponse Resource Authoring Guide](#).

Schedule data publishing to a subscriber

You can publish data to your subscribers at regular intervals by using scheduled tasks. The subscriber receives new data according to the task's schedule. This type of scheduled task is available only if you have access to the Data Publish workbook and you have been designated by a RapidResponse administrator as the publisher to at least one subscriber. For more information, contact your RapidResponse administrator.

► Create a scheduled task to publish data

1. On the **File** menu, point to **New**, and then click **Scheduled Task**.
If you have access to multiple types of resources you can schedule, point to **Scheduled Task**, and then click **Publish Data**.
2. In the **Name** box, type a descriptive name for the alert.
3. In the **Subscriber** list, click the subscriber for whom the data is intended.
4. In the **Description** box, type a summary of what data the task publishes.
5. In the **Scheduled task is** area, click one of the following:
 - **Enabled**—The task runs at its specified time.
 - **Disabled**—The task does not run automatically.
6. If you clicked **Enabled** in step 5 but want the task to run only one time, select the **Run scheduled task once (and then disable it)** check box.
7. Configure how the scheduled task is run by users you share it with. For more information, see "[Allow automation task customization](#)" on page 563.
8. Click the **Data** tab.
9. In the **Scenario** list, click the scenario that contains the data you want to publish.
10. In the **Filter** list, click the filter appropriate for the subscriber.
11. In the **Site** list, click a site or site filter.
12. If the workbook contains the **Model** and **Pool** controls, select the desired values.
13. Specify when the scheduled task runs. For more information, see "[Schedule when an automation task runs](#)" on page 591.
14. Optionally, specify the users you want to notify when the task runs. For more information, see "[Send notification messages when an automation task completes](#)" on page 624.



Notes:

- You should schedule the task to run during a low RapidResponse usage period, for example, overnight.
- Tasks for publishing subscriber data generate multiple files—one for each worksheet in the **Data Publish** workbook.
- You cannot create a scheduled task and an alert with the same name.

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